

Tafsir Ibn Kathir — Modular Volume 2

Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition

Audited English narrative — redundant narrations removed

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Module 11

Surah 7: Al-Araf

Surah 7: Al-Araf

PDF pages 1888–2121

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 1888]

Opening The Tafslrof Surat Al-Araf (Chapter - 7)

In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1888–1900]

' > * < ' 1 * / Ji 1 - i ^ i Aj 3 ' is Pi ' i \ pp % % , " j ' i \$ u ii vu ; h) \ I * / , j . 41 . Alif-Lam-Mim-Sad 42. (This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down unto you, so let not your breast be narrow there- from, that you warn thereby; and a reminder unto the believers.} 43 . Follow what has been sent down unto you from your Lord, and follow not any Awliya' (protectors), besides Him (Allah). Lit- tle do you remember!} We mentioned before the explanation of the letters [such as, Alif-Lam, that are in the beginning of some Surahs in the Qur an). i < % i ' 4 & Jr \ # \ 5 z % " gf e \$ m A . j L L j b 4 0 6 Mi & x Ccy . ; \$ " " o K tj \$ j | Cp < * \$ " 0 0 ^ \) jo . a _ ^ - jj ' y * oxai , j * i \ ^ f " - r

i (This is the) Book (the Qur'an) sent down unto you (O Muhammad)}, from your Lord, 4 A & ^ iso let not your breast be narrow therefrom,} meaning, having doubt about it according to Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi. It was also said that the meaning here is: do not hesitate to convey the Qur an and warn with it, o * ^ cr ^ } i Therefore be patient as did the Messengers of strong will} [46:35). Allah said here, i that you warn thereby meaning, We sent down the Qur an so that you may warn the disbelievers with it, 4 3 s * " i and a reminder unto the believers}. Allah then said to the world, 4 & i Follow what has been sent down unto you from your Lord} meaning, follow and imitate the unlettered Prophet j , who brought you a Book that was revealed for you, from the Lord and master of everything. 4 \$ ji l Ar i and follow not any Awliya', besides Him (Allah)} meaning, do not disregard what the Messenger brought you and follow something else, for in this case, you will be deviating from Allah s judgment to the decision of someone else. Allah s statement, i Little do you remember!} is similar to. m At-Tabari 12 :296

4 And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly}[12: 103] , and; JgH" l Cy 4 And if you obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far away from Allah's path}[6:116], and, cyji " 3 > 4 And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him}[12: 106] & \ & a el: & & " & & A 9 \$ c 5 % til 44. And a great number of towns We destroyed. Our torment came upon them by night or while they were taking their midday nap.} 45 . No cry did they utter when Our torment came upon them but this: "Verily, we were wrongdoers. } 46. Then surely, We shall question those (people) to whom it was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers.} 47. Then surely, We shall narrate unto them (their whole story) with knowledge, and indeed We have not been absent.} Nations that were destroyed Allah said. ji \$ > } 4 And a great number of towns We destroyed.} for defying

Our Messengers and rejecting them. This behavior led them to earn disgrace in this life, which led them to disgrace in the Hereafter. Allah said in other Ayat, *ly^=* I ssjtit jSsj} 4*And indeed (many) Messengers before you were mocked at.

but their scoffers were surrounded by the very thing that they used to mock at} (6:10], and *Jt i*And many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing, so that it lie in ruins (up to this day), and (many) a deserted well and lofty castle!} [22:45], and. {And how many a town have We destroyed, which was thankful for its means of livelihood And those are their dwellings, which have not been inhabited after them except a little. And verily, We have been the /ieirs>[28:58]. Allah s saying, (*U i%et&}* {Our torment came upon them by night or while they were taking their midday nap.} means, Allah s command, torment and vengeance came over them at night or while taking a nap in the middle of the day. Both of these times are periods of rest and leisure or heedlessness and amusement. Allah also said *J &s\ jit ^t ji < . et j j^ ^*Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?}[7:97-98] and, *s-krTff _}* Jrj 4 j* >-"4 jt ! J* i '.v'L rj 4*Do then those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allah will

not sink than into the earth, or that the torment will not seize than from directions they perceive not? Or that He may catch them in the midst of their going to and from, so that there be no escape for them? Or that He may catch them with gradual wastage. Truly, Your Lord is indeed full of kindness, Most Merciful?) [16:45-47]. Allah s saying; *&A % A pii ij of 4*No cry did they utter when Our torment came upon them but this: "Verily, we were wrongdoers.") This means, when the torment came to them, their cry was that they admitted their sins and that they deserved to be punished. Allah said in a similar Ayat, *cJi f-tj jj) i*How many a town given to wrongdoing, have We destroyed)[2 1:11], until, *4*Extinct)[21:15]. Allah s saying. *4x4 ' xl4 > 4*Thai surely. We shall question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent is similar to the Ayat, *4*And (remember) the Day (Allah) will call them, and say: "What answer gave you to the Messengers?") [28:65], and, *SJ u% y ijsX4 EC 4A2 jif lit yx>_) 4*On the Day what Allah will gather the Messengers together and say to them "What was the response you received?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, verily, only You are the Knower of all that is unseen.") [5:109]. Allah will question the nations, on the Day of Resurrection, how they responded to His Messengers and the Messages He sent them with. He will also question the Messengers if they conveyed His Messages. So, Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from

Ibn Abbas, who said commenting on the Ayat *i*Thai surely, We shall question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent and verily, We shall question the Messengers. He said; About what they conveyed. Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, *i*Then surely, We shall narrate unto them (their whole story) with knowledge, and indeed We have not been absent The Book'21 will be brought forth on the Day of Resurrection and it will speak, disclosing what they used to do. |3 &&& iand indeed We have not been absent meaning, On the Day of Resurrection, Allah will inform His servants about what they said and did, whether substantial or minor. Certainly, He witnesses to everything, nothing escapes His observation, and He is never unaware of anything. Rather, He has perfect knowledge of what the eyes are deluded by and what the hearts conceal, *i*Not a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain

in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.[^][6:59] +8. And the weighing on that Day will be the true (weighing). So, as far those whose scale (of good deeds) will be heavy, they will be the successful (by entering Paradise).} Tabari 12:306. ' The Book . See Surat Al-Kahf 18 :49 Tabari 12:308.

i9. And as for those whose scale will be light, they are those who will lose themselves for their wrongful behavior with Our Aydt.} The Meaning of weighing the Deeds Allah said, iAnd the weighing of deeds on the Day of Resurrection, iwill be the true (weighing)}, for Allah will not wrong anyone. Allah said in other Ayat, oi f- iAnd We shall set up the Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything. And if there be the weight of a mustard seed, We will bring it. And Sufficient are We to take account.}[2VA7], l/r' oi iSurely, Allah wrongs not even the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good (done). He doubles it, and gives from Him a great reward.} [4:40), ft Xyy SIS is Ci& E; &S iThen as for him whose scale (of good deeds) will be heavy. He will live a pleasant life (in Paradise). But as for him whose scale (of good deeds) will be light. He will have his home in Hawiyah (pit. Hell). And what will make you know what it is? (It is) a fiercely blazing Fire!} [101:6-11) and,

{Then, when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no kinship among them that Day, nor will they ask of one another. Then, those whose scales (of good deeds) are heavy, they are the successful. And those whose scales (of good deeds) are light, they are those who lose themselves, in Hell will they abide (23:101-103). As for what will be placed on the Balance on the Day of Resurrection, it has been said that the deeds will be placed on it, even though they are not material objects. Allah will give these deeds physical weight on the Day of Resurrection. Al- Baghawi said that this was reported from Ibn Abbas. 111 It is recorded in the Sahib that Al-Baqarah (chapter 2) and Al Imran (chapter 3) will come on the Day of Resurrection in the shape of two clouds, or two objects that provide shade, or two lined groups of birds. 121 It is also recorded in the Sahth that the Qur'an will come to its companion (who used to recite and preserve it) in the shape of a pale-faced young man. He will ask (the young man), Who are you? He will reply, I am the Qur'an, who made you stay up sleeplessly at night and caused you thirst in the day. 131 The Hadith that Al-Bara narrated about the questioning in the grave states. IUULip tlf :J^ " if '-djQ gifa ir-*" ifW^ A young man with fair color and good scent will come to the believer, who will ask, 'Who are you? He will reply, 'I am your good deeds' . The Prophet ^ mentioned the opposite in the case of the disbeliever and the hypocrite. It was also said that the Book of Records that contains the deeds will be weighed. A Hadith states that a man will be brought forth and ninety-nine scrolls containing errors and sins will be placed on one side of the balance each as long as the sight can reach. He will then be brought a card on which 111 Al-Baghawi 2:149. 1 :553. 131 Ibn Majah 2:1242. 4 :287

Al-A'raf (8 - 9) (Part-8) La ilaha illallah will be written. He will say, O Lord! What would this card weigh against these scrolls? Allah will say, You will not be wronged. So the card will be placed on the other side of the Balance, and as the Messenger of Allah ^ said, (UiiLji oii ; c-tiLii "Behold! The (ninety-nine) scrolls will go up, as the card becomes heavier ." (11

410. And surely. We gave you authority on the earth and appointed for you therein livelihoods. Little thanks do you give-} All Bounties in the Heavens and Earth are for the Benefit of Mankind Allah

reminds of His favor on His servants in that He made the earth a fixed place for dwelling, placed firm mountains and rivers on it and made homes and allowed them to utilize its benefits. Allah made the clouds work for them (bringing rain) so that they may produce their sustenance from them. He also created the ways and means of earnings, commercial activities and other professions. Yet, most of them give little thanks for this. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And if you count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed a wrongdoer, an ingrate.} [14:34] js j) f'4 WWt f p*c!Z zsj} OS 411. And surely, We created you and then gave you shape; then We told the angels, Prostrate yourselves to Adam," and they prostrated, except Iblis (Shaytan), he refused to be of those who prostrated.} Prostration of the Angels to Adam and Shaytan s Arrogance Allah informs the Children of Adam about the honor of their father and the enmity of Shaytan, who still has envy for them and for their father Adam. So they should beware of him and not follow in his footsteps. Allah said, a '{ -JZj} 4And surely, We created you and then gave you shape ; then We told the angels, Prostrate yourselves to Adam, and they prostrated,}

Al-A'rdf (10 -11) (Part-8) Jr (SJaiiss \ox (223\$ p4*r-o?j p^j^froVliSf cPbj*^ ji*jul^;jrp du3 ln& ^mj3 C%1 \ This is like His saying, ^li- i^LM dCj JB ^ %t^ & j; \$And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "I am going to create a man from dried (sounding) clay of al- tered mud. So, when I have fashioned him com- pletely and breathed into him the soul (which I created for him), then fall (you) down prostrat- ing yourselves unto him."} [15:28-29). After Allah created Adam with His Hands from dried clay of altered mud and made him in the shape of a human being, He blew life into him and ordered the angels to prostrate before him, honoring Allah s glory and magnificence. The angels all heard, obeyed and prostrated, but Iblis did not prostrate. We explained this subject in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. Therefore, the Ayah (7:11) refers to Adam, although Allah used the plural in this case, because Adam is the father of all mankind. Similarly, Allah said to the Children of Israel who lived during the time of the Prophet ig, j tfjj ' fOi(iAnd We shaded you with clouds and sent down on you manna and the quail,}[2:57] This refers to their forefathers who lived during the time of

28 Tafsir Ibri Kathir Moses. But, since that was a favor given to the forefathers, and they are their very source, then the offspring have also been favored by it. This is not the case in: 4And indeed We created man out of an extract of clay (water and earth.))[23:12\ For this merely means that Adam was created from clay. His children were created from Nutfah (mixed male and female sexual discharge). This last Ayah is thus talking about the origin of mankind, not that they were all created from clay, and Allah knows best. 4; .; yd * S 3.U& ft} 412. (Allah) said: What prevented you (O Iblis) that you did not prostrate, when I commanded you?" Iblis said: "I am better than him (Adam), You created me from fire, and him You created from clay."} Allah said, iWhat prevented you (O Iblis) that you did not prostrate} (7:12) meaning, what stopped and hindered you from prostrating after I ordered you to do so, according to Ibn Jarir. This meaning is sound, and Allah knows best. Iblis, may Allah curse him, said, 4/ am better than him (Adam)}, and this excuse is worse than the crime itself! Shaytan said that he did not obey Allah because he who is better cannot prostrate to he who is less. Shaytan, may Allah curse him, meant that he is better than Adam, So how can You order me to prostrate before him? Shaytan said that he is better than Adam because-he was created from fire while, You created him from clay, and fire is better. The cursed one looked at the origin of creation not at the honor bestowed, that is, Allah creating

Adam with His Hand and blowing life into him. Shaytan made a false comparison when confronted by Allah's command,

4"Then you fall down prostrate to /ii'm">[38:72]. Therefore, Shaytan alone contradicted the angels, because he refused to prostrate. He, thus, became Ablasa from the mercy, meaning, lost hope in acquiring Allah's mercy. He committed this error, may Allah curse him, due to his false comparison. His claim that the fire is more honored than mud was also false, because mud has the qualities of wisdom, for - bearance, patience and assurance, mud is where plants grow, flourish, increase, and provide good. To the contraiy, fire has

the qualities of burning, recklessness and hastiness. Therefore,

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the origin of creation directed Shaytan to failure, while the origin of Adam led him to return to Allah with repentance, humbleness, obedience and submission to His command, admitting his error and seeking Allah's forgiveness and pardon for it.

for Qiyas?] This statement also has an authentic chain of narration. JI JU U J is& & JUS &> . (Allah) said : "(O Mis) get down from this (Paradise), it is not for you to be arrogant here. Get out, for you are of those humiliated and disgraced. } . (Mis) said: "Allow me respite till the Day they are raised up (the Day ofResurrection)."} . (Allah) said: "You are of those respited."} Allah ordered Iblis; <"?"W down yrom this} because you defied My command and disobeyed Me. Get out, it is not for you to be arrogant here, in Paradise, according to the scholars of Tafsir. It could also refer to particular status which he held in the utmost highs. Allah said to Iblis, m *si"l out, for you are of those humiliated and disgraced.} as just recompense for his ill intentions, by giving him the opposite of what he intended (arrogance). This is when the cursed one remembered and asked for respite until the Day of Judgment, iThen allow me respite till the Day they are raised up. (Allah) said: "Then you are of those respited."} (15: 36-37] Allah gave Shaytan what he asked for out of His wisdom, being His decision and decree, that is never prevented or resisted. Surely, none can avert His decision, and He is swift in reckoning. [i] j*> Ift if?, o; p ijiV ^ &S14* rt# At-Tabari 12:328.

Al-A'raf (16 - 17) (Part-8) 116. (Iblis) said: Because You have 'Aghwaytni', surely, I will sit in wait against them (human beings) on Your straight path 117. "Then I will come to them from before them and behind them, from their right and from their left, and You will not find most ofthem to be thankful."} Allah said that after He gave respite to Shaytan, itill the Day they are raised up (resurrected)} and Iblis was sure that he got what he wanted, he went on in defiance and rebellion. He said, i'fdpx p 528 ts} i"Because You have Aghwaytani , surely, I will sit in wait against them (human beings) on Your straight path."} meaning, as You have sent me astray. Ibn Abbas said that Aghwaytani means, Misguided me. 111 Others said, As You caused my ruin, I will sit in wait for Your servants whom You will create from the offspring of the one you expelled me for. He went on, iYour straight path}, the path of truth and the way of safety. I (Iblis) will misguide them from this path so that they do not worship You Alone, because You sent me astray. Mujahid said that the straight path , refers to the truth. Imam

21S iiiSj jf 2 of ,JU ll"- oi o\j i2 iiU-ju of "3"l "2 iLj-jJ of "&i ,jji- u>- ois "Shaytan sat in wait for the Son of Adam in all his paths. He sat in the path of Islam, saying, "Would you embrace Islam and abandon your religion and the religion of your forefathers?" However, the Son of Adam disobeyed Shaytdn and embraced Islam. So Shaytdn sat in the path of Hijrah (migration in the cause of Allah), saying, Would you migrate and leave your land and sky?' But the parable of the Muhdjir is that of a horse in his stamina So, he disobeyed Shaytdn and migrated. So Shaytdn sat in the path of jihad, against one's self and with his wealth, saying, 'If you fight, you will be killed, your wife will be married and your wealth divided.' So he disobeyed him and performed jihad. Therefore, whoever among them (Children of Adam) does this and dies, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. If he is killed, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. If he drowns, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise. If the animal breaks his neck, it will be a promise from Allah that He admits him into Paradise ."[11 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on: f) iThen I will come to them from before them) Raising doubts in them concerning their Hereafter, iand (from) behind them), making them more eager for this life, &) ifrom their right), causing them confusion in the religion, iand from their left) luring them to commit sins. 121 This is meant to cover all paths of good and evil. Shaytan Ahmad 3:483. |2) At-Jabari 12:338.

discourages the people from the path of good and lures them to the path of evil. Al-Hakam bin Abban said that Ikrimah narrated from Ibn Abbas concerning the Ayah, iThett I will come to them from before them and behind them, from their right and from their left,} He did not say that he will come from above them, because the mercy descends from above. 1 11 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, icUfr- 35^ Yj} iatid You will not find most of them to be thankful.} means, those who single Him out [in worship]. 121 When Shaytan said this, it was a guess and an assumption on his part. Yet, the truth turned out to be the same, for Allah said, tCr & & > 4 i+4 j* cAi o j: iAnd indeed Iblis (Shaytan) did prove true his thought about them, and they followed him, all except a group of true believers. And he had no authority over them, except that We might test him who believes in the Hereafter, from him who is in doubt about it. And your Lord is Watchful over everything.} [34:20-21]. This is why there is a Hadith that encourages seeking refuge with Allah from the lures of Shaytan from all directions. Imam Ahmad narrated that Abdullah bin Umar said, The Messenger of Allah used to often recite this supplication in the morning and when the night falls, J '3 iu'W J] 1} dillJ iliUf JI 1^*^ r^ ,JU3 ^'3 ^di} jiiif j{ ^'3jy ju-i j jaj Tabari 12:341. At-Tabari 12:342.

Al-A'rdf(18 - 21) (Part-8) Hateful and expelled. 111 Qatadah commented, Cursed and despised ,121 while Mujahid said, Expelled and banished. 131 Ar-Rabl bin Anas said that Madh wn means banished, while, Madhura means belittled.,4! Allah said, p* m fc. & iWhoever of them (mankind) will follow you, then surely, I will fill Hell with you all.} This is similar to j Cldj "i ****" 0 oii -ili ij. VI i(Allah) said: "Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all) an ample recompense. And gradually delude those whom you can among them with your voice, make assaults on them with your cavalry and your infantry, share with them wealth and children, and make promises to them. But Shaytdn promises them nothing but deceit. "Verily, My servants - you have no authority over them. And All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian. } [17:63-65] U @ % C4 5? It yfc S3i si& ls2) J% # ">- ui ijij ci Sj 1j< i2i LS3 oj C/S ji y^L 6 J V] "ji j 419. "And O Adam! Dwell you and your wife in Paradise, and eat thereof as you both wish, but approach not this tree otherwise you both will be of the

wrongdoers.} 420. Then Shaytdn whispered suggestions to them both in order At-Tabari 12:343. At-Tabari 12:343. At-Tabari 12:343. [41 At-Tabari 12:344.

to uncover that which was hidden from them of their private parts (before); he said: "Your Lord did not forbid you this tree save you should become angels or become of the immortals . " } ill . And he Qdsamahuma : "Verily, I am one of the sincere well-wishersfor you both." } Shaytan s Deceit with Adam and Hawwa and Their eating from the Forbidden Tree Allah states that He allowed Adam and his wife to dwell in Paradise and to eat from all of its fruits, except one tree. We have already discussed this in Surat Al-Baqarah. Thus, Shaytdn envied them and plotted deceitfully, whispering and suggesting treachery. He wished to rid them of the various favors and nice clothes that they were enjoying. iHe (Shaytdn) said} uttering lies and falsehood, igx. J .ii (&J Cfc? } i"Your Lord did not forbid you this tree save you should become angels..." } meaning, so that you do not become angels or dwell here for eternity. Surely, if you eat from this tree, you will attain both, he said. In another Ayah, / ? V/ ""/ // ' / ""/ i&*_ dtUj Jc albl JI"f iShaytdn whispered to him, saying : "O Adam! Shall I lead you to the Tree of Eternity and to a kingdom that will never waste away? } [20:120]. Here, the wording is similar, so it means, so that you do not become angels as in; d &10 i(Thus) does Allah make clear to you (His Law) lest you go astray.} [4:176] meaning, so that you do not go astray, and, iAnd He has affixed into the earth mountains standing firm,

Al-A'rdf(21 - 23) (Part-8 lest it should shake with you ; } [16:15] that is, so that the earth does not shake with you. iAttd he Qdsamahuma}, swore to them both by Allah, saying, 'Jo d3 4"Verily, I am one of the sincere well-wishers for you both." } for I was here before you and thus have better knowledge of this place. It is a fact that the believer in Allah might sometimes become the victim of deceit. Qatadah commented on this Ayah, Shaytan swore by Allah, saying, 1 was created before you, and I have better knowledge than you. Therefore, follow me and I will direct you. LTiCf Tor mm V, 7M < : 't f/si'.ilJO' OjjJ 4julo-l IjLjiililj (1)y-jj* iftijj."Uji?1?V "*" "*_ ? **> -S' -if ""-I X , '<,1! t'if>***.*':< -S y " J 1 tSJUfc MCLtfju_g-4 jJJ-302*Uj jjj os UilS C-'J kA SZ \f&\ (ft Ui ii :f:^& c23 o^iiT Si tscj its &sit c b ^ OJ U i o\j C^jit Uilk vl2j 422. So he misled them with deception. Then when they tasted of the tree, that which was hidden from them of their shame (private parts) became manifest to them and they began to cover themselves with the leaves of Paradise. And their Lord called out to them (saying): "Did I not forbid you that tree and tell you : Verily, Shaytan is an open enemy unto you?" }

Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers.

Al-A'rdf(24 - 25) (Part-8 What if I repented and sought forgiveness? Allah said, Then, I will admit you into Paradise. As for Shaytan, he did not ask for forgiveness, but for respite. Each one of them was given what he asked for. * Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim commented, Oi U jv* jl jjj Ciil Ul* ilj} 4 Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves. If You forgive us not, and bestow not upon us Your mercy, we shall certainly be of the losers. } These are the words that Adam received from his Lord. S? fe 4&& V5J Wrp 424. (Allah) said: Get down, one of you an enemy to the other. On earth will be a dwelling place for you and an enjoymentfor a time. } 425. He said: "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, andfrom it you shall be brought out (resurrected). } SendingThem AllDown to Barth It was said that, " 4Get down}, was addressed to Adam, Hawwa , Iblis and the snake. Some scholars did not mention the

snake, and Allah knows best. The enmity is primarily between Adam and Iblis, and Hawwa follows Adam in this regard. Allah said in Surah TaHa, 4 Get you down (from the Paradise to the earth), both of you, together..."} [20:123). If the story about the snake is true, then it is a follower of Iblis. Some scholars mentioned the location on earth they were sent down, but these accounts are taken from the Israelite tales, and only Allah knows if they are true. If having known these areas was useful for the people in matters of religion or l 1 Abdur-Razz&q 2 :226 . See Surat Al-Baqarah 2 :37Tabari 12:357.

life, Allah would have mentioned them in His Book, and His Messenger would have mentioned them too. Allah s statement. iOti earth will be a dwelling place for you and an enjoyment for a time.} means, on earth you will have dwellings and known, designated, appointed terms that have been recorded by the Pen, counted by Predestination and written in the First Record. 4He (Allah) said : "Therein you shall live, and therein you shall die, andfrom it you shall be brought out (resurrected)." } This Ayah is similar to Allah s other statement, ft &p4 pa iThereof (the earth) We created you, and into it We shall return you, and from it We shall bring you out once again.} 20 :55]. Allah states that He has made the earth a dwelling place for the Children of Adam, for the remainder of this earthly life. On it, they will live, die and be buried in their graves; and from it, they will be resurrected for the Day of Resurrection. On that Day, Allah will gather the first and last of creatures and reward or punish each according to his or her deeds. oi ""j j*" - viUj JXt'j liijj 'Sjy Qf jj fx xsr~t\$ 4^ 'ofA'A 426. O Children of Adam! We have bestowed Libas (raiment) upon you to cover yourselves with, and as Rish (adornment) and the Libas (raiment) of Taqwa, that is better. Such are among tlte Ayat ofAllah, that they may remember.} BestowingRaiment andAdornment on Mankind Allah reminds His servants that He has given them Libas and Rish. Libas refers to the clothes that are used to cover the private parts, while Rish refers to the outer adornments used

Al-A'rdf (26 - 27) (Part-8) for purposes of beautification. Therefore, the first type is essential while the second type is complimentary. Ibn Jarir said that Rish includes furniture and outer clothes.111 Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on the Ayah, iand the Libds (raiment) of Taqwa...} When one fears Allah, Allah covers his errors. Hence the Libas of Taqwa. (that the Ayah mentions). ,21 I- '(jll p^arVi.ii V |"S"" Zjr~i &S 'i itk P* ft 427. O Children ofAdam! Let not Shaytan deceive you, as he got your parents out of Paradise, stripping them of their raiment, to show them their private parts. Verily, he and his tribe see youfrom where you cannot see them. Verily, We made the Shaydtin friends of those who believe not.}

Warning against the Lures ofShaytan

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 1912–2071]

Allah warns the Children of Adam against Iblis and his followers, by explaining about his ancient enmity for the father of mankind, Adam peace be upon him. Iblis plotted to have Adam expelled from Paradise, which is the dwelling of comfort, to the dwelling of hardship and fatigue (this life) and caused him to have his private part uncovered, after it had been hidden from him. This, indeed, is indicative of deep hatred (from Shaytan towards Adam and mankind). Allah said in a similar Ayah, 05-s^iiU J-L jit | iij (jjj Oi Cijj1 ^ iWill you then take him (Iblis) and his offspring as protectors and helpers rather than

Me, while they are enemies to you? What an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers.} [18:50]. Tabari 12:364. Tabari 12:368.

1* \Vj \$ -1 ji Tg)^ ; * c \$ & SJS^f v>- ^/J Mi/ JS IjJ CT CfjJt ij ijdj ^syys^ it^" :ti;1 4L0>(Ij3&^ SSUif . And when they commit a Fahishah, they say: "We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us." Say: "Nay, Allah never commands Fahishah. Do you say about Allah what you know not?") 429. Say: "My Lord has commanded justice and that you should face Him only, in every Masjid and invoke Him only, making your religion sincere to Him. As He brought you (into being) in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again") 430. A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error; (because) surely, they took the Shayditi as supporters instead of Allah, and think that they are guided.) Disbelievers commit Sins and claim that Allah commanded Them to do so! Mujahid said, The idolaters used to go around the House {Ka'bah} in Tawaf while naked, saying, *We perform fawdfas our mothers gave birth to us. The woman would cover her sexual organ with something saying, Today, some or all of it will appear, but whatever appears from it, I do not allow it (it is not for adultery or for men to enjoy looking at!). Allah sent down the Ayah, it i'A% tc er; \ti //V 4 And when they commit a Fahishah (sin), they say: We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us.'>[7:28]m I say, the Arabs, with the exception of the Quraysh, used to perform Tawaf naked. They claimed they would not make Tawaf while wearing the clothes that they disobeyed Allah in. As for the Quraysh, known as Al-Hums, * they used to 111 Literally: strictly religious. Called such, as they used to say. We are the people of Allah, we shall not go out of the sanctuary. At-Tabari 12:377.

43 Siirah 7. Al-A'rdf (28 - 30) (Part-8) perform Tawaf in their regular clothes. Whoever among the Arabs borrowed a garment from one of Al-Hums, he would wear it while in Tawaf. And whoever wore a new garment, would discard it and none would wear it after him on completion of Tawaf. Those who did not have a new garment, or were not given one by Al-Hums, then they would perform Tawaf while naked. Even women would go around in Tawaf while naked, and one of them would cover her sexual organ with something and proclaim, Today, a part or all of it will appear, but whatever appears from it I do not allow it. Women used to perform Tawaf while naked usually at night. This was a practice that the idolators invented on their own, following only their forefathers in this regard. They falsely claimed that what their forefathers did was in fact following the order and legislation of Allah. Allah then refuted them, Allah said, iitj tJwj ijli i And when they commit a Fdhishah, they say : "We found our fathers doing it, and Allah has commanded it for us."} Allah does not order Fahsha , but orders Justice and Sincerity Allah replied to this false claim, \$Say}, O Muhammad, to those who claimed this, at <,[} i "Nay, Allah never commands Fahsha'..."} meaning, the practice you indulge in is a despicable sin, and Allah does not command such a thing. i "Do you say about Allah what you know not? } that is, do you attribute to Allah statements that you are not certain are true? Allah said next, iSay : "My Lord has commanded justice, (fairness and honesty)"},

4& k/ > .je-jij 4 "And that you should face Him only, in every Masjid, and invoke Him only making your religion sincere to Him ..."> This Ayah means, Allah commands you to be straightforward in worshipping Him, by following the Messengers who were supported with miracles and obeying what they conveyed from Allah and the Law that they brought. He also commands sincerity in worshipping

Him, for He, Exalted He is, does not accept a good deed until it satisfies these two conditions: being correct and in conformity with His Law, and being free of Shirk.

The Meaning of being brought into Being in the Beginning and brought back again Allah's saying 4* ZpZ cr" 4^s He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again [7:29]. Until; ierror.^ There is some difference over the meaning of: fi'Z l2> 4-As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again .4 Ibn Abi Najlh said that Mujahid said that it means, He will bring you back to life after you die. **l Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented, As He made you begin in this life. He will bring you back to life on the Day of Resurrection. |21 Qatadah commented on: 4<>/iyupZ L 4As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again .4 At-Tabari 12:385. At-Tabari 12:385.

He started their creation after they were nothing, and they perished later on, and He shall bring them back again. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, As He created you in the beginning, He will bring you back in the end. 121 This last explanation was preferred by Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir and he supported it with what he reported from Ibn Abbas, The Messenger of Allah sg stood up and gave us a speech, saying, iliA 4il JI \ \ U 45'1' U) lIde 'lij tfS. 3 di: (Z) ri "0 people! You will be gathered to Allah while barefooted, naked and uncircumcised, 4As We began the first creation, We shall repeat it. (It is) a promise binding upon Us. Truly, We shall do 1:104] This Hadith was collected in the Two Sahihs . [41 Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, pi) 4As He brought you in the beginning, so shall you be brought into being again. A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error;) Allah, the Exalted, began the creation of the Sons of Adam, some believers and some disbelievers, just as He said. 4He it is Who created you, then some of you are disbelievers and some of you are believers) [64:2]. He will then return them on the Day of Resurrection as He started them, some believers and some disbelievers.151 I say, what supports this meaning, is the Hadith from Ibn Mas*ud that

46 Tafsir Ibtt Kathtr "By He, other than Whom there is no god, one of you might perform the deeds of the people of Paradise until only the length of an arm or a forearm would separate him from it. However, that which was written in the Book takes precedence, and he commits the work of the people of the Fire and thus enters it. And one of you might perform the deeds of the people of the Fire until only the length of an arm or a forearm separates between him and the Fire. However, that which was written in the Book takes precedence, and he performs the work of the people of Paradise and thus enters Paradise. We should combine this meaning - if it is held to be the correct meaning for the Ayah - with Allah's statement: 4So set you your face towards the religion, Hanifan. Allah's Fitrah loith which He has created mankind \$> [30:30], and what is recorded in the Two Sahlhs from Abu Hurayrah who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: jJl\j2aiiJ o\jj(i jJjJ (JS8 *Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, it is only his parents who turn him into a Jew, a Christian or a Zoroastrian. "'31

Al-A'rdf (28 - 30) (Part-8) lAllah said, 7 created My servants Hunafa' (monotheists), but the devils came to them and deviated them from their religion ."(11 The collective meaning here is, Allah created His creatures so that some of them later turn believers and some turn disbelievers. Allah has originally created all of His servants able to recognize Him, to single Him out in worship, and know that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. He also took their covenant to fulfill the implications of this

knowledge, which He placed in their consciousness and souls. He has decided that some of them will be miserable and some will be happy, io'S1 Jft 4He it is Who created you, then some of you are disbelievers and some of you are believers} [64:2]. Also, a Hadith states, jA*j ^ull JS iAll people go out in the morning and sell themselves, and some of them free themselves while some others destroy themselves. "l2) Allah s decree will certainly come to pass in His creation. Verily, He it is 3 4ft iWho has measured (everything); and then guided [87:3], and, 4He Who gave to each thing its form and nature, then guided it aright (20:50). And in the Two Sahihs: ssuDi jil ^ b\sX 156" yUill Jit Vj&' Jit If* 'J* lib *jSli 11 JUJ 1,1 Muslim 4:2197. 1 :203

As for those among you who are among the people of happiness, they will be facilitated to perform the deeds of the people of happiness. As for those who are among the miserable, they will be facilitated to commit the deeds of the miserable. 111 This is why Allah said here, j. ** > " <'< [vplc Viy*J if-U 4A group He has guided, and a group deserved to be in error ;)> Allah then explained why, {Qji ijji% ibecause) surely, they took the Shaydtn as supporters instead of Allah). Ibn Jarir said, This is one of the clearest arguments proving the mistake of those who claim that Allah does not punish anyone for disobedient acts he commits of deviations he believes in until after knowledge of what is correct reaches him, then he were to obstinately avoid it anyway. If this were true, then there would be no difference between the deviations of the misguided group - their belief that they are guided - and the group that is in fact guided. Yet Allah has differentiated between the two in this noble Ayah, doing so in both name and judgement. 121 *** At-Tabari 12:388. See the explanation of Surat At-Tawbah 9:115, and At-Tabari s comments on it. Path Al-Bari 3 :267 and Muslim 4 :2039 mm~ V. s'S* " ,** < ".Xis ' ><"- A -i "3SJ

Al-A'rdf (31) (Part-8) i V ft % i S5 gfc-S^ iSLj Wt fsc 431. O Children of Adam! Take your adornment to every Masjid, and eat and drink, but waste not by extravagance, certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful.) Allah commands taking Adornment when going to the Masjid This honorable Ayah refutes the idolators practice of performing Tawaf around the Sacred House while naked.

Al-A'rdf(31) (Part-8) that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg saying, jls <}aj {jA "l j ^il li (Ut^ ^ "77ie Son of Adam will not fill a pot worse for himself than his stomach. It is enough for the Son of Adam to eat a few bites that strengthens his spine. If he likes to have more, then let him fill a third with food, a third with drink and leave a third for his breathing V An-Nasal and At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith, Tirmidhi said, Hasan or Hasan Sahih" according to another manuscript. Ata Al-Khurasani said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, 4And eat and drink but waste not by extravagance, certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful . With food and drink. 13' Ibn Jarir commented on Allah s statement, 4-4 ^Certainly He (Allah) likes not the wasteful. Allah the Exalted says that He does not like those who trespass the limits on an allowed matter or a prohibited matter, those who go to the extreme over what He has allowed, allow what He has prohibited, or prohibit what He has allowed. But, He likes that what He has allowed be considered as such (without extravagance) and what He has prohibited be considered as such. This is the justice that He has commanded. '4' 4 u? J* OJ J gfo Jjl *ul iij (j>- .2i .-Jtff t "4> Ahmad 4:132. |2' Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 7:51 and An-Nasal 4 :178 Tabari 12:394. 4| At-Tabari 12:395.

Who has forbidden the adornment with clothes given by Allah, which He has produced for His servants, and At-Tayyibdt (good things) of sustenance?

Surah 7, Al-A'raf (32 - 33) (Part-8 None is more jealous than Allah, and this is why He prohibited Fawdhish, committed openly or in secret. And none likes praise more than Allah/a/ii.' 11 This was also recorded in the Two Sahfhs. * In the explanation of Surat Al-An'am, we explained the Fahishah that is committed openly and in secret. Allah said next, A#6" iand Ithm, and transgression without right, (7:331- As-Suddi commented, Al-Ithm means, disobedience . As for unrighteous oppression, it occurs when you transgress against people without justification. * Mujahid said, Ithm includes all types of disobedience. Allah said that the oppressor commits oppression against himself. 14 * Therefore, the meaning of, Ithm is the sin that one commits against himself, while oppression pertains to transgression against other people, and Allah prohibited both. Allah's statement, iand joining partners with Allah for which He has given no authority, prohibits calling partners with Allah in worship. iand saying things about Allah of which you have no knowledge.> such as lies and inventions, like claiming that Allah has a son, and other evil creeds that you - O idolators - have no knowledge of. This is similar to His saying: 4So shun the abomination (worshipping) of the idols [22:30]. m Ahmad 1:381. * Fath Al-Bari 9 :230 and Muslim 4:2114. * At-Tabari 12:403. > At-Tabari 12:403.

434. And every Ummah has its appointed term; when their term comes, neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment).} 435. O Children of Adam! If there come to you Messengers from among you, reciting to you My Aydt, then whosoever has Taqwd and becomes righteous, on them shall be no fear nor shall they grieve.} 436. But those who reject Our Aydt and treat them with arrogance, they are the dwellers of the Fire, they will abide thereinforever.} Allah said, 4And every Ummah has}, meaning, each generation and nation, <&%.%#} 4its appointed term; when their term comes} which they were destined for, 4neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment)}. Allah then warned the Children of Adam that He sent to them Messengers who conveyed to them His Aydt Allah also conveyed good news, as well as warning, ip 4then whosoever has Taqwd and becomes righteous} by abandoning the prohibitions and performing acts of obedience. 4X fiH 4on them shall be no fear nor shall they grieve. But those who reject Our Aydt and treat them with arrogance,} meaning, their hearts denied the Aydt and they were too

Al-A'raf (34 - 37) (Part-8) arrogant to abide by them, q |U> . ithey are the dwellers of the Fire, they will abide therein forever.} without end to their dwelling in it. # ^ ^ i c^r## igf 4i^vS^ | Jit 437. Who is more unjust than one who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt? For such their appointed portion will reach them from the Book (of Decrees) until Our messengers (the angel of death and his assistants) come to them to take their souls, they (the angels) will say: Where are those whom you used to invoke and worship besides Allah," they will reply, "They have vanished and deserted us." And they will bear witness against themselves, that they were disbelievers.} Idolators enjoy Their destined Share in This Life, but will lose Their Supporters upon Death Allah said, o&f& 50 } 4Who is more unjust than one who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Aydt?} meaning, none is more unjust than whoever invents a lie about Allah or rejects the Ayat that He has revealed. Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi said that, 4S f&J jiS^} 4For such their appointed portion will reach them from the Book} refers to each person's deeds, allotted provisions and age. Similar was said by Ar-Rabi bin Anas and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin AslamJ2 * Allah said in similar statements, At-Tabari 12:413. At-Tabari 12:413-414.

>* ./, > <. i* . *// ^ > . * y ,/^r! -{/ - >;^ ^ bJJ ^ ..W, V V~' J6 H_ _ . _ . c*ji' '* ' ojj&i iyli==> ll> jujuilt .- |l" is il iVerily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve .> (10:69-70) and, 4yJi iAnd whoever disbelieves, let not his disbelief grieve you . To Us is their return, and We shall inform them what they have done. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of what is in the breasts (of men). We let them enjoy for a little while. [31:23-24]. Allah said next, iuntil when Our messengers come to them to take their souls.} Allah states that when death comes to the idolaters and the angels come to capture their souls to take them to Hellfire, the angels horrify them, saying, Where are the so-called partners (of Allah) whom you used to call in the life of this world, invoking and worshipping them instead of Allah? Call them so that they save you from what you are suffering. However, the idolaters will reply, i"They have vanished and deserted us"} meaning, we have lost them and thus, we do not hope in their benefit or aid, iAnd they will bear witness against themselves^ they will admit and proclaim against themselves, ithat they were disbelievers.}

Al-A'rdf (38 - 39) (Part-8 ^ r? ot \y"- \J" v. (i-^uSu O^JbO^/,^Cj)ljudi*b JISjO 1^UjL^SjIAc- "/>, / # >" ijL^ji^i^ifj\$4^ujig JLiJ"pV^blil ^ ^ i*, Jioif*A^ - /J s>&3&&z3vj^jtiz pio^yj \$38. (Allah) will say: "Enter you in the com- pany of nations who passed away before you, of men and Jinn, into the Fire." Every time a new nation enters, it curses its sister nation (that went before) until they are all together in the Fire. The last of them will say to the first of them : "Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire." He will say: "For each one there is double (torment), but you know not."} . The first of them will say to the last of them: "You were not better than us, so taste the torment for what you used to earn. } ij^ CiU Ji 4 Ijliol J5^ j 0^ O 1,11.1 U iit cJti Li jQi cJtt L^- 1}v m % &h jj UiJa C'Lt p^lii y Siv p ju ts P & UA <" >/ < Lj iyjji JL"> i> People of the Fire will dispute and curse Each Other Allah mentioned what He will say to those who associate others with Him, invent lies about Him, and reject His Ayat, 4A 4 tf&" 4Enter you in the company of nations}, who are your likes and similar to you in conduct,

Al-A raf (38 - 39) (Part-8) the first nations to enter. This is because the earlier nations were worse criminals than those who followed them, and this is why they entered the Fire first. For this reason, their followers will complain against them to Allah, because they were the ones who misguided them from the correct path, saying, ip\ C\Z > 4"Our Lord! These misled us, so give them a double torment of the Fire."} multiply their share of the torment. Allah said in another instance, q% tflij Ob ai M j 420 crJuL* \J ijVjbUcJl UJjL. 0,1 40" the Day when their faces will be turned over in the Fire, they will say: "Oh! Would that we had obeyed Allah and obeyed the Messenger. And they will say: "Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the (right) way. Our Lord! Give them a double torment."} [33:66-68]. Allah said in reply, p.0 4He will say: "For each one there is double (torment)..."}, We did what you asked, and recompensed each according to their deeds. Allah said in another Ayah, o* "xfc ^Jjf} iThose who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them We will add torment}[!6:88]. Furthermore, Allah said, [SS d 2S} iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own} [29:13] and, iAnd also (some thing) of the burdens of those whom they

60 Tafstr Ibn Kathir misled without knowledge} (16:25]. 4The first of them will say to the last of them meaning, the followed will say to the followers, a} 4"You were not better than us..."} meaning, you were led astray as we were led astray, according to As-Suddi.111 4 c;u\&} 4"So taste the tormentfor what you used to earn. } Allah again described the condition of the idolators during the gathering (of Resurrection), when He said; & jr* km iszs# o' i) JZ-* J5 iIs&LJ Ct&t cA\ J15) "fp'Oryj/i? Q J&K U^j \ % O Z\j3\ foil il !> VI ji c?jjl //lose who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it come to you? Nay, but you were criminals." Those wlv were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him!" And each ofthem (parties) will conceal their own regrets, when they behold the torment. And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?} [34:32-33] gfi <\$* OjUoj% .jJ*\ ZijS "fk gji v tfi l i"s2_0l> lliSiL iyIs" o),j -n oi fX ZipCgfuix A%i s*j iCii j Jill / .y v c n/ . Verily, those who belie Our Aydt and treat them with m At-Tabari 12 :420.

Al-A'rdf(40 - 41) (Part-8) arrogance, for than the gates of the heavens will not be opened, and they will not enter Paradise until the Jamal goes through the eye of the needle. Thus do We recompense the criminals.} 441. Theirs will be Mihad from the Fire, and over them Ghawdsh. Titus do We recompense the wrongdoers.} Doors of Heaven shall not open for Those Who deny Allah sAyat, and They shall never enter Paradise Allah said, i&l&pp'i} ifor them the gates of the heavens will not be opened,} meaning, their good deeds and supplication will not ascend through it, according to Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Ibn Abbas, as Al-'Awfi and Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from him. 1 1 Ath-Thawri narrated that, Layth said that Ata narrated this from Ibn Abbas.12 It was also said that the meaning here is that the doors of the heavens will not be opened for the disbelievers* souls, according to Ad-Dahhak who reported this from Ibn Abbas.131 As-Suddi and severed others mentioned this meaning. What further supports this meaning, is the report from Ibn Jarir that Al-Bara said that the Messenger of Allah mentioned capturing the soul of the Fajtf (wicked sinner or disbeliever), and that his or her soul will be ascended to heaven. The Prophet said, ?LiJi .li U ijJU V) <&&ii ji & JU fa 4 1* b "1j yi i) i*i; o .ilui "So they (angels) ascend it and it will not pass by a gathering of the angels, but they will ask, who's wicked soul is this?' They will reply, 'The soul of so-and-so, calling him by theTabari 12:422-423.Tabari 12:422. At-Tabari 12:422. At-Tabari 12:422.

Al-A'rdf (42 - 43) (Part-8) Dahhak bin Muzahim and As-Suddi. * Allah said next, ? %j} <(77ims do We recompense the wrongdoers.} hs^ ^ vi n* J 2 * ip:> c jjl Jui IjJUj jvV> jlfj; 4/? 0; 4 Hjij |gj l"j l: J \;i& Jii G iii ; 3 & & 3 Vjj S' e uSliH5& e* V 442. But those who believed, and worked righteousness - We burden not any person beyond his scope - such are the dwellers ofParadise. They will abide therein .} 443. And We shall remove from their breasts any Ghill ; rivers flowing under them, and they will say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has guided us to this, and never could we havefound guidance, were it not that Allah had guided us! Indeed, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth." And it will be cried out to them : "This is the Paradise which you have inheritedfor what you used to do."} Destination ofRighteous Believers After Allah mentioned the condition of the miserable ones, He then mentioned the condition of the happy ones, saying, \pr. \$j} 4But those who believed, and worked righteousness} Their hearts have believed and they performed good deeds with their limbs and senses, as compared to those who disbelieved in the Ayat of Allah and were arrogant with them. Allah

also said that embracing faith and implementing it are easy, when He said. > Vi OS pftpii 4 C & 4But those who believed, and worked righteousness - WeJabari 12:436.

burden not any person beyond his scope - such are the dwellers of Paradise. They will abide therein. And We shall removefrom their breasts any Ghill; } meaning, envy and hatred.

x "Each of the people of Paradise will see his seat in the Fire and he will say, 'Had not Allah guided me! And this will cause him to be grateful. Each of the people of the Fire zuill see his seat in Paradise, and he will say, 'Might that Allah had guided me!' So it will be a cause of an- guish for Wra.i111 This is why when the believers are awarded seats in Paradise that belonged to the people of the Fire, they will be told, This is the Paradise that you inherited because of what you used to do. This means, because of your good deeds, you earned Allah s mercy and thus entered Paradise and took your designated dwellings in it, comparable to your deeds. This is the proper meaning here, for it is recorded in the Two Sahths that the Prophet jg said, ill- l) jl ' And knoiv that the good deeds of one of you will not admit him into Paradise ." UU ifji 'Xfffx* jl 1 1 / > *y */./ ./ / > r*/ sEJ i -C-&j*~\$**j_ They said, Not even you, O Allah s Messenger? He said, j" 4i>! Nj lii "Not even I, unless Allah grants it to me out ofHis mercy and An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 6 :447

favor, n11 ' l*" - J&j U ^ju U*> Uy L liju-j ju ^ jGJI t r"" %"* " -f , ^ * r * > ' ' -If . ifif ^ i; < *>'~ f*t ;> l' \s yj*-j 5s sWt' j6 *JJ-i^ad u^' aUI o' p-p^ . > 'jJli 4 sjfi\ |A) . And Me dwellers of Paradise will call out to the dwellers of the Fire (saying) : "We have indeedfound true what our Lord had promised us; have you also found true what your Lord promised (warned)?" They shall say: "Yes." Then a crier will proclaim between them: "The curse of Allah is on the wrongdoers."> . Those who hindered (men) from the path of Allah, and would seek to make it crooked, and they were disbelievers in the Hereafter. People of Hellfire will feelAnguishuponAnguish Allah mentioned how the people of the Fire will be addressed, chastised and admonished when they take then- places in the Fire, <"We (dwellers of Paradise) have indeed found true what our Lord had promised us; luwe you (dwellers of Hell) also found true what your Lord promised (warned)?" They shall say: "Yes."> In Surat As-Saffat, Allah mentioned the one who had disbelieving companion. Crt ilSJ^ ili S/J)j Q;y_)jA lie looked down and saw him in the midst of the Fire. He said: "By Allah! You have nearly ruined me. Had it not been for the grace of my Lord, I would certainly have been among those brought forth (to Hell). (The dwellers of Paradise will say!) "Are we then not to die (any more)? Except our firstAl-Bdri 11 :300 and Muslim 4:2170.

Al-A'rdf(44 - 45) (Part-8) death, and we shall not be punished? } [37:55-59]. Allah will punish the disbeliever for the claims he used to utter in this life. The angels will also admonish the disbelievers, saying, V Ijc* LJj IT C 2 Gi IT' IAG y iThis is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste you therein its heat and whether you are patient of it or impatient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requitedfor what you used to do} [52:14-16]. The Messenger of Allah jg admonished the inhabitants of the well at Badr: "' ' -* #< * \ ""<" ' ' * '!* I + I " I"! I\y, # ." * * < * * + " j * ' < . , {< "0 Afw Jahl bin Hishaml O 'Utbah bin Rabfah! O Shaybah bin Rabi'ah (and he called their leaders by name)! Have you found what your Lord promised to be true (the Fire)? I certainly found what my Lord has promised me to be true (victory). Umar said, O Allah s Messenger! Do you address a people who have become rotten carrion? He jg said. ifoA^: 'i& '-J I WV W By He in Whose

Hand is my soul! You do not hear what I am saying better than they do, but they cannot reply. Allah's statement, *I, ~ 'frV Tf-rV. iThen a crier will proclaim between them} will herald and announce, Je 4al ild 4The curse of Allah is on the wrongdoers} meaning, the curse will I1 * Muslim 3:2203. Those were the disbelievers of the Quraysh who were killed at the battle of Badr, Their corpses were thrown into the well.*

Al-A'raf (46 - 47) (Part-8 that Allah described, *iSo a wall will be put up between them, with a gate therein. Inside it will be mercy, and outside it will be torment. [57:13] It is also about Al-A'raf that Allah said, iXj iand on Al-A'raf will be men}. 111 Ibn Jarir recorded that As-Suddi said about Allah's statement, ibk<&} iAnd between them will be a screen It is the wall, it is Al- A raf. Mujahid said, uAl-A'raf is a barrier between Paradise and the Fire, a wall that has a gate. Ibn Jarir said, "Al-A'raf is plural for 'Urf where every elevated piece of land is known as Urf to the Arabs. As-Suddi said, Al-A'raf is so named because its residents recognize (Ya'rifun) the people. Al-A raf's residents are those whose good and bad deeds are equal, as Hudhayfah, Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and several of the Salaf and later generations said. Ibn Jarir recorded that Hudhayfah was asked about the people of Al-A'raf and he said, A people whose good and bad deeds are equal. Their evil deeds prevented them from qualifying to enter Paradise, and their good deeds qualified them to avoid the Fire. Therefore, they are stopped there on the wall until Allah judges them. Ma'mar said that Al-Hasan recited this Ayah, iand at that time they will not yet have entered it (Paradise), but they will hope to enter (it).} Then he said, By Allah! Allah did not put this hope in their hearts, except for an honor that He intends to bestow on At-Tabari 12:249. At-Tabari 12:449. Tabari 12 :451 ,4! At-Tabari 12:453.*

Al-A'raf (50 - 51) (Part-8) bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas, *it 4Are they those, of whom you swore that Allah would never show them mercy? refers to the people of Al-A'raf who will be told when Allah decrees: 4(Behold! It has been said to them): "Enter Paradise, no fear shall be on you, nor shall you grieve.'V r^u %s c. % \$\$ os eL& 'M 5 M&& \j\ s" Uj l-ii* > IjLi ^ | v .Vi u 450. And the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise : "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provided you with. They will say: "Both (water and provision) Allah has forbidden for the disbelievers 451 . "Who took their religion as amusement and play, and the life of the world deceived them." So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this Day, and as they used to reject Our Aydt-4 The Favors of paradise are Prohibited for the People of the Fire Allah emphasizes the disgrace of the people of the Fire. They will ask the people of Paradise for some of their drink and food, but they will not be given any of that. As-Suddi said, 4& " GL-& \ 3 jSP 4And the dwellers of the Fire will call to the dwellers of Paradise: "Pour on us some water or anything that Allah has provided you with That is food .121 Ath-Thawri said that TJthman Ath-Thaqafi At-Tabari 12:469. At-Tabari 12:473.*

said that Said bin Jubayr commented on this Ayah, *One of them will call his father or brother, I have been burned, so pour some water on me. The believers will be asked to reply, and they will reply, jpo#-sSf 4"Both Allah has forbidden to the disbelievers . } Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that, 4"Both Allah has forbidden to the disbelievers Refers to the food and drink of Paradise. Allah describes the disbelievers by what they used to do in this life, taking the religion as amusement and play, and being deceived by this life and its adornment, rather than working for the Hereafter as Allah commanded, 4'-^* - -t'iJi Ui==" 4So this Day We shall forget them as they forgot their meeting of this*

Day meaning, Allah will treat them as if He has forgotten them. Certainly, nothing escapes Allah's perfect watch and He never forgets anything. Allah said in another Ayah, 4In a Record. My Lord neither errs nor forgets^ [20:52] Allah said - that He will forget them on that Day - as just recompense for them, because, if they have forgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them} [9:67] i Like this: Our Ayat came unto you, but you disregarded them, and so this Day, you will be neglected [20:126] and, *U! Tabari 12:474. At-Tabari 12:474.

Al-A'raf (51 - 52) (Part-8) (\$Di& "'v c4 ' *i< ' <;' AT'i ! > ' I". r-'-r-J J-^-joLolSJ'jjc,_)4> uJ 'jvJ ..AS 0/\ f ;)V^=* Hi IJy~*- 5[IULjlji-oy.jtj ^:Vf ljl^*cii (i ly-li ' "-^"-li" LJ\ C^jS-J^ZJLm")JIS iAtid it will be said This Day We will for- get you as you Jbrgot the meeting of this Day of yours."} (45:34) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas commented on, i^=" y\$>} 7-t ' &, 4So this Day We shall forget them as they Jbr- got their meeting of this Day} Allah will forget the good about them, but not their evil. And Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, We shall forsake them as they have forsaken the meeting of this Day of theirs. Mujahid said, We shall leave them in the Fire. As-Suddi said, We shall leave them from any mercy, just as they left any action on behalf of the meeting on this Day of theirs. It is recorded in the Sahih that Allah will say to the servant on the Day of Resurrection: * # Jf il Jflij Jili iu jff ?iu/f Jjf o.&r d jjt j : _^U5 43)1 JjZj iV : lilii c. bt ".", J IIS ""Have I not gotten you married? Have I not honored you? Have I not made horses and camels subservient for you and allowed you to become a leader and a master?" He will say, "Yes." Allah will say, "Did you think that you will meet

Tahurum raimir Me?" He will say, "No." Allah the Exalted will say, 'Then this Day, I will forget you as you have forgotten Me.'" J* CpajL-jf /A <^u ifi* & < U J-f" , ill, JiJ oiU. jj jj os jjL 4 Jus 15 ^to S' *jft i u \&Z . Certainly, We have brought to them a Book (the Qur'an) which We have explained in detail with knowledge, a guidance and a mercy to a people who believe i53. Await they just for the final fulfillment of the event? On the Day the event is finally fulfilled, those who neglected it before will say : "Verily, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? Or could we be sent back (to the first life of the world) so that we might do (good) deeds other than those (evil) deeds which we used to do?" Verily, they have lost themselves and that which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} The Idolaters have no Excuse Allah states that He has left no excuse for the idolaters, for He has sent to them the Book that the Messenger came with, and which is explained in detail, i(This is) a Book, the Ayat whereof are perfected (in every sphere of knowledge), and then explained in detail > [11:1] Allah said next, iWe have explained in detail with knowledge> meaning, *We have perfect knowledge of what We explained in it . Allah said in another Ayah, Muslim 4 :2279

Al-A'rdf (52 - 53) (Part-8) 4He has sent it datum with His Knowledge,} [4:166] The meaning here is that after Allah mentioned the loss the idolaters end up with in the Hereafter, He stated that He has indeed sent Prophets and revealed Books in this life, thus leaving no excuse for them. Allah also said; 4And We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).> [17:15] This is why Allah said here, 4Await they just for the final fulfillment of the event?} in reference to what they were promised of torment, punishment, the Fire; or Paradise, according to Mujahid and several others. 11 4On the Day the event is finally fulfilled,} on the Day of Resurrection, according to Ibn Abbas, 4those who neglected it before will say} those who ignored it in this life and neglected abiding by its

implications will say, 4TS[A& :t& o-,UA 4 Verily, the Messengers of our Lord did come with the truth, now are there any intercessors for us that they might intercede on our behalf? } so that we are saved from what we ended up in. 4 Or could we be sent back }, to the first life, 4 So that we might do (good) deeds other than those (evil) deeds which we used to do? }. Af-Tabari 12:479. 121 AMabari 12:479.

This part of the Ayah is similar to Allah's statement, & i g;^ tflfiM % \ s5 %} yfc iz# Q !4 3 !AJ jt&^ IX IS ^ n; if you could but see when they will be held over the (Hell) Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back! Then we would not deny the Aydt of our Lord, and we would be of the believers!" Nay, it has become manifest to them what they had been concealing before. But if they were returned (to the world), they would certainly revert to that which they were forbidden. And indeed they are liars [6:27-28] Allah said here, yu==" U jSj ii' ""4 rjfs. iVerily, they have lost themselves and tint which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} meaning, they destroyed themselves by entering the Fire for eternity, if 1 j} 4And that which they used to fabricate has gone away from them.} What they used to worship instead of Allah abandoned them and will not intercede on their behalf, aid them or save them from their fate. !sj-Z f ; 4 i/yV?) c/^L1T\ jiu ^ji fit ^>[} jii' j v* tsfh fjiz ji^if jjf 4 && i'C- 454. Indeed, your Lord is Allah, VJho created the heavens and the earth in Six Days, and then He rose over (Istawa) the Throne. He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} The Universe was created in Six Days Allah states that He created the universe, the heavens and

Al-A'raf (54) (Part-8) earth and all that is in, on and between them in six days, as He has stated in several Ayat in the Qur'an. These six days are: Sunday, Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday and Friday. On Friday, the entire creation was assembled and on that day, Adam was created. There is a difference of opinion whether these days were the same as our standard days as suddenly comes to the mind, or each day constitutes one thousand years, as reported from Mujahid , 1 1 Imam

took in this regard, such as Malik, Al-Awzal, Ath-Thawri, Al- Layth bin Sa'd, Ash-Shafit, Ahmad, Ishaq bin Rahwayh and the rest of the scholars of Islam, in past and present times. Surely, we accept the apparent meaning of, Al-Istawa, without discussing its true essence, equating it (with the attributes of the creation), or altering or denying it (in any way or form). We also believe that the meaning that comes to those who equate AU4h with the creation is to be rejected, for nothing is similar to Allah, iThere is nothing like Him, and He is the All-Hearer, the All- Seer.) (42:11) Indeed, we assert and affirm what the Imams said, such as Nu'aym bin Hammad Al-Khuzai, the teacher of Imam Al- Bukhari, who said, Whoever likens Allah with His creation, will have committed Kufr. Whoever denies what Allah has described Himself with, will have committed Kufr. Certainly, there is no resemblance (of Allah with the creation) in what Allah and His Messenger^ have described Him with. Whoever attests to Allah's attributes that the plain Ayat and authentic Hadiths have mentioned, in the manner that suits Allah's majesty, all the while rejecting all shortcomings from Him, will have taken the path of guidance. The Day and the Night are among the Signs of Allah Allah said. ife S4' 4He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly,) meaning, the darkness goes away with the light, and the light goes away with the darkness. Each of them seeks the other rapidly, and does not come late, for when this vanishes,

the other comes, and vice versa. Allah also said; iAnd a sign for them is the night. We withdraw therefrom the

Al-A'rdf (54) (Part-8) day, and behold, they are in darkness . And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed). That is the decree of the All-Mighty, the All-Knowing. And the moon, We have measured for it mansions (to traverse) till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:37-40) Allah s statement, iNor does the night outstrip the day} (36:40) means, the night follows the day in succession and does not come later or earlier than it should be. This is why Allah said here, (" j 4seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command.} meaning, all are under His command, will and dominion. Allah alerted us afterwards, iSurely, His is the creation and commandment} the dominion and the decision. Allah said next, i\ isa iBlessed is Allah, the Lord of the all that exists!} which is similar to the Ayah, .till' 4 -&0} 4Blessed beHeWhohas placed in the heaven big stars} (25:61) Abu Ad-Darda said a supplication, that was also attributed to the Prophet j* iiiUf iik .>: Jjdp is iuii iii;& itiiit iu *IS JI "iL *iS "0 Allah! Yours is all the kingdom, all the praise, and Yours is the ownership of all affairs. I ask You for all types of good and seek refuge with Youfrom all types ofevil.

and Khujyah}, with the humbleness in your hearts and certainty of His Oneness and Lordship not supplicating loudly to show off.111 Forbidding Aggression in Supplications It was reported that Ata Al-Khurasani narrated from Ibn Abbas, who said about Allah s statement, 4 &U *At 4He likes not the aggressors In the Du a and otherwise. [2) Abu Mijlaz commented on, U vAt 4He likes not the aggressors>, Such (aggression) as asking to reach the grade of the Prophets. Imam

^ &mm y mm ^ is0jjjJii js "J^ ^iljij^jljpSjj^SCi^as) 'ui^j^liljf^,iwc/jKj*cljc1i 4^tj3c^JjJ & e\$mi\$ ^jBl^jO^iitSuiSjii^.*\$&. "*" - 5 / , - ^ ijlUAU'i ^J ^^J ,*-* L^<^,j" Allah prohibits causing mischief on the earth, especially after it has been set in order. When the affairs are in order and then mischief occurs, it will cause maximum harm to the people; thus Allah forbids causing mischief and ordained worshipping Him, supplicating to Him, begging Him and being humble to Him. Allah said, ite; t \&} iand invoke Him with fear and hope} fearing what He has of severe torment and hoping in what He has of tremendous reward. Allah then said, * dyi& Sl> 4Surely , Allah's mercy is (ever) near unto the good-doers} meaning, His mercy is for the good-doers who obey His commands and avoid what He prohibited. Allah said in another Ayah, sjii ^r^ * ji> 'y i\$~*-ji} iAnd My mercy envelopes all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those who who have Taqwa.} [7:156). Matar Al-Warraq said, Earn Allah s promise by obeying Him, for He ordained that His mercy is near to the good-doers. Ibn

Al-A'raf (57 - 58) (Part-8 Abi Hatim collected this statement,m iiii ^ {*) (XIIJ jj-1' Jj Uj& yiD < * ^ * 'S .*& 6 ft; S.^ ^yJ u^*"j i/U'V^~o . And it is He Who sends the winds as heralds of glad tidings, going before His mercy (rain). Till when they have carried a heavy-laden cloud, We drive it to a land that is dead, then We cause water (rain) to descend thereon. Then We produce every kind offruit therewith. Similarly, We shall raise up the dead, so that you may remember or take heed.} i58 . The vegetation of a good land comes forth (easily) by the permission of its Lord; and that which is bad, brings forth nothing but (a little) with difficulty. Thus do We explain variously theAyatfor a people who give thanks.} AmongAllah s Signs,HesendsdowntheRainandbrings forth the Produce After Allah stated that He

created the heavens and earth and that He is the Owner and Possessor of the affairs Who makes things subservient (for mankind), He ordained that He be invoked in Du'd , for He is able to do all things. Allah also stated that He is the Sustainer and He resurrects the dead on the Day of Resurrection. Here, Allah said that He sends the wind that spreads the clouds that are laden with rain. Allah said in another Ayah, AylrP of J-j{ o! jy} iAnd among His signs is this, that He sends the winds with glad tidings} (30:46). Allah's statement, Agoing before His mercy} means, before the rain. Allah also said; m Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1501

84 Tafsir Ibtī Kattrir iff * \% frz2% 4And He it is Who sends down the rain after they have despaired, and spreads His mercy. And He is Al-Wali (the Guardian), Al-Hamid (the praiseworthy^ (42:28) and, dfi)1 &\$ }Look then at the results of Allah's mercy, how He revives the earth after its death. Verily, that [is the one Who] shall indeed raise the dead, and He is able to do all things} [30:50]. Allah said next, jjil Til -^} iTill when they have carried a heavy-laden cloud} when the wind carries clouds that are heavy with rain, and this is why these clouds are heavy, close to the earth, and their color is dark. Allah s statement. #A 4We drive it to a land that is dead} that is, a dry land that does not have any vegetation. This Ayah is similar to another Ayah, iAnd a signfor them is the dead land. We give it life} [36:33], This is why Allah said here, 43>*i' \ijf if ^ ii 4Then We produce every kind offruit therewith. Similarly, We shall raise up the dead.} meaning, just as We bring life to dead land, We shall raise up the dead on the Day of Resurrection, after they have disintegrated. Allah will send down rain from the sky and the rain will pour on the earth for forty days. The corpses will then be brought up in their graves, just as the seeds become grow in the ground (on receiving rain). Allah often mentions this similarity in the Qur an when He gives the example of what will happen on the Day of Resurrection, and bringing life to dead land,

iso that you may remember or take heed.} Allah s statement, "k fiQ 4*. 4-^ -ffiy} iThe vegetation of a good land comes forth (easily) by the permission of its Lord;} meaning, the good land produces its vegetation rapidly and proficiently. Allah said in another Ayah (about Maryam, mother of Isa, peace be upon him); i H iHe made her groiu in a good manner.} [3:37] The Ayah continues, iand thatwhich is bad, bringsforth nothing but with difficulty.} Mujahid, and others such as As-Sibakh, etc. also said this .

animals drink from it, and for irrigation of the land for cultivation . And a portion of it was barren which could neither hold the water nor bring forth vegetation. The first is the example of the person who comprehends Allah's religion and gets benefit which Allah sent me with, by leamign and teaching others. The last example is that of a person who does not care for it and does not accept the guidance Allah sent me with.W 4 Sktf ^ ot JK . Indeed, We sent Nuh to his people and he said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Certainly, Ifearfor you the torment ofa Great Day!"} 460. The leaders of his people said: "Verily, we see you in plain error."} 461. [Nuh] said: "O my people! There is no error in me, but I am a Messengerfrom the Lord ofall that exists!} 462. I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord and give sincere advice to you. And I know from Allah what you know not."} The Story ofNuh and His People After Allah mentioned the story of Adam in the beginning of this Surah, He started mentioning the stories of the Prophets, the first then the latter of them. Allah mentioned the story of NOh, because he was the first Messenger Allah sent to the people of the earth after Adam. His name was Nah bin Lamak bin MatQshalakh bin KhanQkh. And Khanukh was, as they

claim, the Prophet Idris. And Idris was the first person to write letters using pen, and he was the son of Barad bin Mahlil, bin Qanln bin Yanish bin Shith bin Adam, upon them all be peace. This lineage is mentioned by Muhammad bin Ishaq and other Im^{ams} who document lineage. Al-Bari 1:211.

Al-A'rdf(59 - 62) (Part-8) Abdullah bin Abbas and several other scholars of Tafstr said that the first idol worship began when some righteous people died and their people built places of worship over their graves. They made images of them so that they could remember their righteousness and devotion, and thus, imitate them. When time passed, they made statues of them and later on worshipped these idols, naming them after the righteous people: Wadd, Suwa , YaghQth, Ya'dq and Nasr. After this practice became popular, Allah sent Ndh as a Messenger, all thanks are due to Him. Ntlh commanded his people to worship Allah alone without partners, saying, Sti 41 .4 & Vj\$ 4%} i 0 my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Certainly, Ifearfor you the torment ofa Great Day!"} the torment of the Day of Resurrection, ifyou meet Allah while associating others with Him. 4**?" Vat ji;" 4The leaders of his people said} meaning, the general public, chiefs, commanders and great ones of his people said, fU, 4 t\} 4"Verily, we see you in plain error } because ofyour calling us to abandon the worship of these idols that we found our forefathers worshipping. This, indeed, is the attitude of evil people, for they consider the righteous people to be following misguidance. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd when they saw them, they said: Verily, these have indeed gone astray! } [83:32] and, 4^ -Sil 4And those who disbelieve say of those who believe: "Had it been a good thing, they (the weak and poor) xvould not have preceded us thereto! And when they have not let themselves be

guided by it (this Qur'an), they say: "This is an ancient lie!"} [46:11] There are several other Aydt on this subject. yj OJ 3 Jpj cHI -aP*. i[Nuh] said: "O my people! There is no error in me, but I am a Messengerfrom the Lord ofall that exists!"} meaning, there is nothing wrong with me, but I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists, Lord and King of all things, 4"I convey unto you the Messages ofmy Lord and give sincere advice to you. And I knowfrom Allah what you know not. } This is the attribute of a Messenger, that he conveys using plain, yet eloquent words, offers sincere advice and is knowledgeable about Allah; indeed, no other people can compete with the Prophets in this regard. In his Sahlh,

Al-A rdf(68 - 64) (Part-8) warn you, so that you mayfear Allah and that you may receive (His) mercy?"} 464. But they belied him, so We saved him and those along with him in the Fulk, and We drowned those who belied Our Aydt. They were indeed a blind people.} Allah said that Nuh proclaimed to his people, 4"Do you wonder... }, do not wonder because of this. Surely, it is not strange that Allah sends down revelation to a man among you as mercy, kindness and compassion for you, so that he warns you that you may avoid Allah s torment by associating none with Him, &hj} 4"and that you may receive (His) mercy."} Allah said, 4*&>} 4But they belied him} but they insisted on rejecting and opposing him, and only a few of them believed in him, as Allah stated in another Ayah. Allah said next, 4SoWe savedhim and thosealong with him in the Fulk} the ark, 4And We drowned those who belied Our Aydt.} Allah said in another Ayah, iBecause of their sins they were drowned, then they were admitted into the Fire. And they found none to help them instead ofAllah.} [71:25] Allah said, Cy ijVfe. [} 4They were indeed a blind people.} meaning, blind from the Truth, unable to recognize it or find their way to it. Here, Allah said that He has taken revenge from His enemies and saved His

Al-A'rdf(65 -69) (Part-8) said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him. Will you then not have Taqwa?" } 466. The leaders of those who disbelieved among his people said: "Verily, we see you in foolishness, and verily, we think you are one of the liars. } 467. (Hud) said : "O my people! There is no foolishness in me, but (I am) a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists!" } 468. "I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord, and I am a trustworthy adviser (or well-wisher) for you." } 469. "Do you wonder that there has come to you a Reminder (and an advice) from your Lord through a man from among you to warn you? And remember that He made you successors (generations after generations) after the people of Nuh and increased you amply in stature. So remember the graces (bestowed upon you) from Allah so that you may be successful." } The Story of Hud, Peace be upon Him, and the Lineage of the People of Ad Allah says, just as We sent Nuh to his people, similarly, to the Ad people. We sent Hud one of their own brethren. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the tribe of Ad were the descendants of Ad, son of Iram, son of Aws, son of Sam, son of Nuh. I say, these are indeed the ancient people of Ad whom Allah mentioned, the children of Ad, son of Iram who were living in the deserts with lofty pillars or statues. Allah said, 4 (A ^ j 4 Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with 'Ad (people). Of Iram like (lofty) pillars . The like of which were not created in the land? } [89:6-8] because of their might and strength. Allah said in another instance, ij\$ \jj> frf "ji llj o* ijltt, *(c Oi} 4 As for 'Ad, they were arrogant in the land without right, and they said: "Who is mightier than us in strength?" See they not

He said, Yes, O Commander of the faithful! By Allah, you described it as if you have seen it before. Ali said, I have not seen it, but it was described to me. The man asked, What about it, O Commander of the faithful? Ali said, There is the grave of Had, peace be upon him, in its vicinity. 1 11 Ibn Jarir recorded this statement, which gives the benefit of indicating that Ad used to live in Yemen, since Prophet Hud was buried there. Prophet Hud was among the noble men and chiefs of Ad, for Allah chose the Messengers from among the best, most honorable families and tribes. Had's people were mighty and strong, but their hearts were mighty and hard, for they were among the most denying of Truth among the nations. Prophet Hud called Ad to worship Allah alone without partners, and to obey and fear Him. Debate between Hud and his People w

Al-A'rdf(65 -69) (Part-8) Similarly, the chiefs of Quraysh wondered at the call to worship One God, saying, 4 "Has he (Muhammad) made the gods (all) into One God? } [38:5]. 4 (Hud) said : "O my people! There is no foolishness in me, but (I am) a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists!" } Hud said, I am not as you claim. Rather, I brought you the Truth from Allah, Who created everything, and He is the Lord and King of all things, 41%/oy) 45 4-&-V 4 "I convey unto you the Messages of my Lord, and I am a trustworthy adviser for you." } These, indeed, are the qualities of the Prophets: conveying, sincerity and honesty, \$># A% \$Zr i - k 3" 4 "Do you wonder that there has come to you a Reminder from your Lord through a man from among you to warn you?" } Prophet Hud said, do not wonder because Allah sent a Messenger to you from among yourselves to warn you about Allah's Days (His torment) and meeting with Him. Rather than wondering, you should thank Allah for this bounty. i^y SymU sGSt jto. i)M^%} 4 "And remember that He made you successors (generations after generations) after the people of Nuh..." } meaning, remember Allah's favor on you in that He made you among the offspring of Nuh, because of whose supplication Allah destroyed the people of the earth after they defied and opposed him. 4 "and increased you amply in stature." } making you taller than other people. Similarly, Allah said in the description of Talut

iv miv diqxsom, pjnoi{S am fvqf sn of aiwoo acwq no :ptvs Ram} 4?{\ fn? trz j? Crf" unq uodn aq aasad unq oj uopisoddo Jiaqi pire ajdoad s.puH jo ssaiuoqqrqs pue aoireyap uotyaqai aqj suopuaui qsnv ^sxaaatpq fou axam Ratp puv '.fvRyxno paipq oqcn asoip fo sjoou aip pouaaos a^\ Puv 'SH m0J4 Jo fno uiif iptai 3i3 oqm asoip puv rniq poem 3/Vt 05 'Zl} 4,/n oqai asoip Suouto noR ipim uiv j 'jivoi uaqi iqPUV uioxj Rfuoinpv ou ipim - sxatptj xnof\ puv noR - pauivu aavq noR iptqm sduivu xaaout ipim noR afndsiQ 'pxoj xnoR tuoxj noR uo ua\vjRpvxsp aavq tpvxn puv (fuauuof) shy,, :ptvs (pnf-i) iz} 4,/infnm *u Jo 3xv noR ft sn pauafvaxip aavq noR tpiaiaxqm fvip sn Sutxq 05 dtqxsom of pasn sxaipvjxno iptqm fmp aqvsojpuv auojy t"/y diqxsom pjnoqs am fmp sn of autoo aovq nox ' pivs Raw 0Z> ursft vfifti 'f> # fp 5Srof \fi a p If? ftiffif ? 5#\$ *? 7!!^ SfSl J ? ?C ST ffi 5 f?r ^ pn? trir j? srrf 5 -95 53f fra 4 injssaoons aq Rvui noR fvip os,,} sSuijsajq pus sjoabj s.qBjiV 1 aouaaajaj ui i,/t{viij utoxj (noR uodn paowfsaq) saovxd aip xaquimax 05,,} 4ys=?S\w if> panuquoo poH [L*Z-Z\ 4'axnfVfs puv aSpaiowuq ui Rpuvpunqv mif pasvaxout svqpuy 4cMi tj t iff ffrt> (piBS) xtftrx uqi xisjv f6

Al-A'raf (70 - 72) (Part-8) Later on, the disbelievers of Quraysh said, ir* t,*jf. be* i>] f 1)1 ipL> I4ii ji li (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment."} Muhammad bin Ishaq said that the people of Hud used to worship several idols, such as Suda , SamUd and Al-Haba . This is why Hud, peace be upon him, said to them, " ' it. .V'.i . -{V i"Rijs and wrath have alreadyfallen on youfrom your Lord."} you deserve Rijs from your Lord because of what you said. Ibn Abbas said that, Rijs , means scorn and anger. 11 ijss&z& i"Dispute you with me over names which you have named - you and yourfathers?"} (7:71). Hud said, do you dispute with me over these idols that you and your fathers made gods, even though they do not bring harm or benefit; did Allah give you authority or proof allowing you to worship them? Hud further said, i"with no autlwritry from Allah? Then wait, I am with you among those who wait."} this is a threat and warning from the Messenger to his people. TheEnd of Ad So Allah said; 1\$ Lj [)=s c/j t j\i ULLLSj fez j sf&} iSo We saved him and those who were with him out of mercy |i| At-Tabari 12:522.

96 Tafsir Ibn Kathir from Us, and We severed the roots of those who belied Our Ayat; and they were not believers. Allah mentioned severed times in the Qur'an, the way the people of Ad were destroyed stating that He sent a barren wind that destroyed everything it passed by. Allah said in another Ayah, p JU \jkc !A & it jLc iAnd as for 'Ad, they were destroyed by a furious violent wind! They were subjected to it for seven nights and eight days in succession, so that you could see men lying overthrown (destroyed), as if they were hollow trunks of date palms! Do you see any remnants of them?} [69:6-8] When Ad rebelled and transgressed, Allah destroyed them with a strong wind that carried them, one by one, up in the air and brought each one of them down on his head, thus smashing his head and severing it from its body. This is why Allah said, as if they were hollow trunks of date palms!} [69:7] Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ad used to live in Yemen between Oman and Hadramawt. They also spread throughout the land and defeated various peoples, because of the strength that Allah gave them. They used to worship idols instead of Allah, and Allah sent to them Prophet Hud, peace be upon him. He was from their most common lineage and was the best among them in status. HQd commanded them to worship Allah Alone and associate none with him. He also ordered them to stop committing injustice against the people. But they rejected him and ignored his call. They said, Who is stronger than us? Some of them, however, followed HQd, although they were few and had to

conceal their faith. When Ad defied the command of Allah, rejected His Prophet, committed mischief in the earth, became arrogant and built high palaces on every high place - without real benefit to them - Hud spoke to them, saying,

Al-A'rdf (70 - 72) (Part-8) ** \ ' > Zf i.i: "Do you build high palaces on every high place, while you do not live in them? And do you get for yourselves palaces (fine buildings) as if you will live therein forever. And when you seize (somebody), seize you (him) as tyrants? Have Taqwa of Allah, and obey me. } (26:128-131] However, Uj cf ~SjLi b i u"

98 Tafsir Ibtai Kathir take me to him? So I took her along with me to Al-Madlnah and found the Masjid full of people. I also found a black flag raised high, while Bilal was holding a sword before the Messenger of Allah jg. I asked, What is the matter with the people? They said, The Prophet sg intends to send Amr bin Al- As (on a military expedition) somewhere. So I sat down. When the Prophet \$S went to his house, I asked for permission to see him, and he gave me permission. I entered and greeted him. He said, Was there a dispute between you and Bani Tamlm? I said, Yes. And we had been victorious over them. I passed by an old woman from Bani Tamlm, who was alone, and she asked me to bring her to you, and she is at the door . So he allowed her in and I said, O Allah s Messenger! What if you make a barrier between us and (the tribe of) Bani Tamlm, such as Ad-Dahna (Desert)? The old woman became angry and opposed me. So I said, My example is the example of a sheep that carried its own destruction. I carried this woman and did not know that she was an opponent. I seek refuge with Allah and His Messenger that I become like the emissary of Ad. So the Prophet jg asked me about the emissary of Ad, having better knowledge in it, but he liked to hear the story again. I said, Once, Ad suffered from a famine and they sent an emissary [to get relief], whose name was Qayl. Qayl passed by Mu'awiyah bin Bakr and stayed with him for a month. Mu'awiyah supplied him with alcoholic drinks, and two female singers were singing for him. When a month ended, Qayl went to the mountains of Muhrah and said, O Allah! You know that I did not come here to cure an ill person or to ransom a prisoner. O Allah! Give Ad water as You used to. So black clouds came and he was called, Choose which one of them you wish (to go to Ad)! So he pointed to one of the black clouds and he heard someone proclaiming from it. Take it, as ashes that will leave none in Ad. And it has been conveyed to me that the wind sent to them was no more than what would pass through this ring of mine, but it destroyed them. Abu Wa il said, That is true. When a man or a woman would send an emissary, they would tell him, Do not be like the emissary of Ad (bringing disaster and utter destruction to them instead of relief),. Imam Ahmad collected this story in the Musnad At- tn Ahmad 3 :482

Al-A'rdf(73 - 78) (Part-8) mm sa v^Tirmidhi recorded jli*jJo ^)= t jJUjUjjj== -d ^dsj-ty ' S' *"' s >~'S * '\ AiIJ l\jAjti {^J oi<- U i'dit^ ii Ei.itj gfjVi 4 ^ >*** ^il4^ Jf}i\ 4 1 S V; if j 4\$ fcif ju :w;^/j__ii 4;jJJ . 4^" >^; ">" "s "1 (! * O 4** C^*i j"* "" ci/if ju 4 j_J ui \$is .*j ji ^ ijiiij jL*jJ S* iilli' H r- 1*'t *Jk 4 ijilifc fcSgjf Sj& 4 ft* b Gjff 4^r &~ - j^CilbU o^tilz jlijlLjSj^ WsiKcaPw^ similar wording for it, as did An-Nasal12 and Ibn Majah. 3 |V*13 jjIj - A. < t > *f #</ J* a=su U 4JJI yJjfr' ^yLj Alii 4*jb -*iiA p^J 02 "4 J^="t Ujjji iSl. ^k=J A v; Sr 4" 473. And to Thamud (people, We sent) their brother Salih. He said : "O my people! Worship Allah! You have ho other god but Him. Indeed there has come to you a clear signfrom your Lord. This she-camel ofAllah is a sign unto you; so you leave her to TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi9:161. 121 Al-Kubra 5:181. 131 Ibn Mfijah 2 :941

O Salih! Bring about your threats if you are indeed one of the Messengers (of Allah).

Al-A'rdf(73 - 78) (Part-8 before. They used that water to make dough and placed the pots (on fire) for cooking. However, the Prophet s | commanded them to spill the contents of the pots and to give the dough to their camels. He then marched forth with them from that area to another area, near the well that the camel (as will follow) used to drink from. He forbade the Companions from entering the area where people were tormented, saying, JJ-jj u jL oiJJ. i J "/" fear that what befell them might befall you as well. Therefore, do not enter on than .a 11 ' Ahmad narrated that Abdullah bin Umar said that the Messenger of Allah jg said while in the Hijr area, * jgt i JJZ p oii j-si; ol V) Wji JU i ft "Do not enter on these who were tormented, unless you do so while crying. If you are not crying, then do not enter on them, so that what befell them does not befall you, as wellP2] The basis of this Hcudith is mentioned in Two Sahihs. 3| The Story of Prophet Salih and Thamud Allah said, 4And to Thamud meaning, to the tribe of Thamud, We sent their brother Salih, 4&AotPt a* ijiiit > 4He said: O my people! Worship Allah! You have no otlter god but Him."4 All Allah s Messengers called to the worship of Allah alone without partners. Allah said in other Ayat. '0 ViAV %a 2:117. 2 :74 Path Al-Bari 6 :436 and Muslim 4 : 2286.

iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying) : "None has the right to be worshipped but I, so worship Me." } [21:25] and, ii' vuJ 'if-j p,\ ^ llil' verily, We have sent among every Utnmah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit (all false deities) } [16:36]. Thamudasked that aCamel appear from a Stone, and it did Prophet Salih said, 4. Indeed there has come to you a clear sign from your Lord. This she-camel ofAllah is a sign unto you;" } meaning, a miracle has come to you from Allah testifying to the truth ofwhat I came to you with. Salih s people asked him to produce a miracle and suggested a certain solid rock that they chose, which stood lonely in the area of Hijr, and which was called Al-Katibah. They asked him to bring a pregnant camel out of that stone. Salih took their covenant and promises that if Allah answers their challenge, they would believe and follow him. When they gave him their oaths and promises to that, Salih started praying and invoked Allah (to produce that miracle). All of a sudden, the stone moved and broke apart, producing a she-camel with thick wool. It was pregnant and its fetus was visibly moving in its belly, exactly as Salih s people asked. This is when their chief, Jundu bin Amr, and several who followed him believed. The rest of the noblemen ofThamud wanted to believe as well, but Dhu ab bin Amr bin Labld, Al-Habbab, who tended their idols, and Rabbab bin Sum ar bin Jilhish stopped them. One of the cousins of Jundu* bin Amr, whose name was Shihab bin Khalifah bin Mikhlal bin Labld bin Jawwas, was one of the leaders ofThamud, and he also wanted to accept the message. However, the chiefs whom we mentioned prevented him, and he conceded to their promptings. The camel remained in Thamud, as well as, its offspring

Al-A'rdf (73 - 78) (Part-8)_ after she delivered it before them. The camel used to drink from its well on one day and leave the well for Thamud the next day. They also used to drink its milk, for on the days she drank water, they used to milk her and fill their containers from its milk. Allah said in other Ayat, fr*. sDI iAtid inform thetn that the water is to be shared between (her and) them , each one's right to drink being established (by turns)} [54:28] and, fS. Ziri ZiA ^^ iHere is a she-camel : it has a right to drink (water), and you have a right to drink (water) (each) on a day, known} [26:155] The camel used

to graze in some of their valleys, going through a pass and coming out through another pass. She did that so as to be able to move easily, because she used to drink a lot of water. She was a tremendous animal that had a strikingly beautiful appearance. When she used to pass by their cattle, the cattle would be afraid of her. When this matter continued for a long time and Thamud's rejection of Salih became intense, they intended to kill her so that they could take the water for themselves every day. It was said that all of them (the disbelievers of Thamud) conspired to kill the camel. Qatadah said that he was told that, The designated killer of the camel approached them all, including women in their rooms and children, and found out that all of them agreed to kill her. 111 This fact is apparent from the wording of the Ayat, iThen they denied him and they killed it. So their Lord destroyed them because of their sin, and made them equal in destruction!} [91:14], and, [foiii \re? iitl' ifo iAnd YJe sent the she-camel to Tltamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong.} [17:59]Tabari 12:537.

104 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah said here, iSo they killed the she-camel} Therefore, these Ayat stated that the entire tribe shared in agreeing to this crime, and Allah knows best. Thamud kills the She-Camel Imam Abu Ja'far Ibn Jarir and other scholars of Tafsir said that the reason behind killing the camel was that a disbelieving old woman among them named Umm Ghanm TJnayzah, the daughter of Ghanm bin Mijlaz, had the severest enmity among Thamud towards Salih, peace be upon him. She had beautiful daughters and she was wealthy, and Dhu ab bin Amr, one of the leaders of Thamud, was her husband. There was another noblewoman whose name was Saduf bint Al-Muliayya bin Dahr bin Al-Muhayya, who was of noble family, wealthy and beautiful. She was married to a Muslim man from Thamud, but she left him. These two women offered a prize for those who swore to them that they would kill the camel. Once, Saduf summoned a man called Al-Habbab and offered herself to him if he would kill the camel, but he refused. So she called a cousin of hers whose name was Musaddi* bin Mihraj bin Al-Muhayya, and he agreed. As for TJnayzah bint Ghanm, she called Qudar bin Salif bin Jundu, a short person with red-blue skin, a bastard, according to them. Qudar was not the son of his claimed father, Salif, but the son of another man called, Suhyad. However, he was born on Salif's bed (and thus named after him). TJnayzah said to Qudar, I will give you any of my daughters you wish, if you kill the camel. Qudar bin Salif and Musaddi* bin Mihraj went along and recruited several mischievous persons from Thamud to kill the camel. Seven more from Thamud agreed, and the group became nine, as Allah described, when He said, 4And there were in the city nine men, who made mischief in the land, and would not reform These nine men were chiefs of their people, and they lured the entire tribe into agreeing to kill the camel. So they waited

Al-A'raf(73 -78) (Part-8 until the camel left the water well, where Qudar waited beside a rock on its path, while Musaddi* waited at another rock. When the camel passed by Musaddi' he shot an arrow at her and the arrow pierced her leg. At that time, TJnayzah came out and ordered her daughter, who was among the most beautiful women, to uncover her face for Qudar, encouraging Qudar to swing his sword, hitting the camel on her knee. So she fell to the ground and screamed once to warn her offspring. Qudar stabbed her in her neck and slaughtered her. Her offspring went up a high rock and screamed.(1) Abdur- Razzaq recorded from Ma'mar that someone reported from Al- Hasan Al-Basari that the offspring said, O my Lord! Where is my mother? It was said that her offspring screamed thrice and entered a rock and vanished in it, or, they followed it and killed it together with its mother. 121 Allah knows best. When they finished the camel off and the news reached Prophet Salih, he came to

them while they were gathered. When he saw the camel, he cried and proclaimed, "Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days." [1 1:65] The Wicked Ones Plot to Kill Prophet Salih, But the Torment descended on them. The nine wicked persons killed the camel on a Wednesday, and that night, they conspired to kill Salih. They said, If he is truthful, we should finish him before we are finished. If he is a liar, we will make him follow his camel. They said: "Swear one to another by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household, and thereafter we will surely say to his near relatives: We witnessed not the destruction of his household, and verily, we are telling the truth." So they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while At-Tabari 12:531. Abdur-Razzaq 2 :23 1

they perceived not.} [27:49-50] When they conspired to kill Salih and gathered at night to carry out their plot, Allah, to Whom belongs all might and Who protects His Messengers, rained down stones that smashed the heads of these nine people before the rest of the tribe. On Thursday, the first of the three days of respite, the people woke up and their faces were pale (yellow), just as Prophet Salih had promised them. On the second day of respite, Friday, they woke up and found their faces had turned red. On the third day of the respite, Saturday, they woke up with their faces black. On Sunday, they wore the fragrance of Hanut [the perfume for enshrouding the dead before burial] and awaited Allah's torment and revenge, we seek refuge with Allah from it. They did not know what will be done to them or how and from where the torment would come. When the sun rose, the Sayhah (loud cry) came from the sky and a severe tremor overtook them from below; the souls were captured and the bodies became lifeless, fall in an hour. 4 And they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.} They became dead and lifeless and none among them, whether young, old, male or female, escaped the torment. 1 The scholars of Tafsir said that none from the offspring of Thamud remained, except Prophet Salih and those who believed in him. A disbelieving man called Abu Righal was in the Sacred Area at the time and the torment that befell his people did not touch him. When he went out of the Sacred Area one day, a stone fell from the sky and killed him. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Ismail bin Umayyah said that the Prophet (ﷺ) passed by the gravesite of Abu Righal and asked the Companions if they knew whose grave it was. They said, Allah and His Messenger know better. He said, ji Ji U 4 Li! Uii i 4 il Olip 4) 1 ^ji- _Li 4) 1 j l S Tabari 12:534.

O my people! I have indeed conveyed to you the Message of my Lord, and have given you good advice, but you like not good advisers.'> These are the words of admonishment that Salih conveyed to his people after Allah destroyed them for defying Him, rebelling against Him, refusing to accept the truth, avoiding guidance, and preferring misguidance instead. Salih said these words of admonishment and criticism to them after they perished, and they heard him (as a miracle for Prophet Salih from Allah). Similarly, it is recorded in the Two Sahih's that after the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) defeated the disbelievers in the battle of Badr, he remained in that area for three days, and then rode his camel, which was prepared for him during the latter part of the night. He went on until he stood by the well of Badr (where the corpses of the disbelievers were thrown) and said, u Uj'** j-^ If- .. - - 1 - uv . . nX~' V ft , r x' !*'

victory) to be true. Umar said to him, O Allah's Messenger! Why do you speak to a people who have rotted? He (ﷺ) said, ^ (4* Jyt UJ By He in Whose Hand is my soul! You do not hear what I am saying

better than they, but they cannot reply, n11 ! Similarly, Prophet Salih, peace be upon him, said to his people, ip ^ i"l have indeed conveyed to you the Message ofmy Lord, and have given you good advice, } but you did not benefit from it because you do not like the Truth and do not follow those who give you sincere advice, i"but you like not good advisers. } i&^sp &s in& ojG i80. And (remember) Lut, when he said to his people: "Do you commit lewdness such as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations?} ill. "Verily, you practice your lusts on men instead of women. Nay, but you are a people transgressing beyond bounds. } The Story ofProphet Lut, upon Him be Peace, and His People Allah said, We sent, iji iAtid} Fath. Al-Bari 7 :351 and Muslim 4 :2204.

iLut, when he said to his people.. Lut (Lot) is the son of Haran the son of Azar (Terah), and he was the nephew of Ibrahim, peace be upon them both. Lut had believed in Ibrahim and migrated with him to the Sham area. Allah then sent Lut to the people of Sadum (Sodom) and the surrounding villages, to call them to Allah, enjoin righteousness and forbid them from their evil practices, their sin, and wickedness. It this area, they did things that none of the children ofAdam or any other creatures ever did before them. They used to have sexual intercourse with males instead of females. This evil practice was not known among the Children ofAdam before, nor did it even cross their minds, so they were unfamiliar with it before the people of Sodom invented it, may Allah s curse be on them. Amr bin Dinar conmented on; 4". . .as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations."} Never before the people of Lut did a male have sex with another male. ' This is why Lut said to them. 4"Do you commit lewdness such as none preceding you has committed in all of the nations? Verily, you practice your lusts on men instead ofwomen meaning, you left women whom Allah created for you and instead had sex with men? Indeed, this behavior is evil and ignorant because you have placed things in their improper places. Lot, peace be upon him, said to them: i'crlfi 4 U>' 4"these (the girls of the nation) are my daughters (to marry lawfully), ifyou must act (so)."} [15:71] So he reminded them of their women, and they replied that they do not desire women!,Tabari 12:548.

no Tafsir Ibn Kathir ^ * 'jr CiJ \$They said: ",Surely 1/om know that we have neither any desire nor need of your daughters, and indeed you know well what we want! ^ [1 1:79] meaning, you know that we have no desire for women and you know what we desire with your guests. ^=^>} ifi \$>-* J J-i&i o-lii \$82. And the answer of his people was only that they said: "Drive them out of your town, these are indeed men who want to be pure (from sins)! \$ So they answered Prophet Lut by trying to expel and banish him from their village, along with those who believed with him. Allah indeed removed Prophet Lot safely from among them, and He destroyed them in their land in disgrace and humiliation. They said (about Ltit and the believers): \$ These are indeed men who want to be pure (from sins)! } Qatadah commented, They shamed them (Lut and the *** This refers to the angels who came in the shape of men to destroy them. vJj (iilSJVi(ituswss 1 1 \ * * .tvi O ojJ&y 0 \ S s / -'t-' if t / -1 ff>:r

IllSurah 7. Al-A'rdf (82 - 84) (Part-8 believers) with what is not a shame at all. ' Mujahid commented, (Lilt s people said about Lot and the believers,) They are a people who want to be pure from men s anuses and women s anuses! * Similar was narrated from Ibn Abbas. JJaS J2^ *& && Vi ,&1j 453. Then We saved him and his family, except his wife; she was of the Ghdbirin (tlwse who lagged behind).} . And We rained down on them a rain (of stones). Then see what was the end of the criminals .} Allah says, We saved Lut and his family, for only his household believed in him. Allah said

in another Ayah, ji. \i Cly U i'gjoojii' Si d? S iSo We brought out from therein the believers. But We found not there any household of the Muslims except one [of Lut and his daughters]} [51:35-36]. Only his wife (from his family) did not believe, remaining on the religion of her people. She used to conspire with them against Lot and inform them of who came to visit him, using certain signals that they agreed on. This is why when Lut was commanded to leave by night with his family, he was ordered not to inform his wife or take her with him. Some said that she followed them, and when the torment struck her people, she looked back and suffered the same punishment as them. However, it appears that she did not leave the town and that Lot did not tell her that they would depart. So she remained with her people, as apparent from Allah's statement, iexcept his wife; she was of the Ghdbirin meaning, of those who remained, or they say: of those who were destroyed, and this is the more obvious explanation. ll At-Jabari 12 :550. ' At-Tabari 12:550. * At-Tabari 12:550.

Allah's statement, 4And We rained down on them a rain> is explained by His other statement, 0: (j; Silj x iipli ^ ^ l|fr i^nd rained on them stones of baked clay, in a well-arranged manner one after another. Marked from your Lord; and they are not everfarfrom the wrongdoers.> [1 1:82-83], Allah said here, iThen see what was the etid of the criminals> This Ayah means: See, O Muhammad, the end of those who dared to disobey Allah and reject His Messengers. Imam

Al-A'raf (85) (Part-8) you are believers.) Story of Shu'ayb, upon him be Peace, and the Land of Madyan Muhammad bin Ishaq said, They (the people of Madyan) are the descendants of Madyan, son of Midyan, son of Ibrahim. Shu'ayb was the son of Mlikil bin Yashjur. And in the Syrian language, his name was Yathrun (Jethro) . 1 11 I (Ibn Kathir) say, Madyan was the name of the tribe and also a city that is close to Ma'an on route to the Hijaz (from Ash-Sham). Allah said in another Ayah, Hi? -M mV UJj> 4And when he arrived at the water (a well) of Madyan he found there a group of men watering (their flocks). (28 :23 They are also the people of Al-Aykah (the Woods), as we will mention later on, Allah willing, and our trust is in Him. 4He said: "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other God but Him") and this is the call of all Messengers, ^ s>) 4"Verily, a clear proof (sign) from your Lord has come unto you;" meaning, Allah has presented the proof and evidences of the truth of what I brought you. He then advised them and commanded them to give full measure and full weight and not to wrong men in their dealings, meaning, to refrain from cheating people in buying and selling. They used to treacherously avoid giving full weight and measure. Allah said in other Ayat, 4Woe to Al-Mutafflin (those who give less in measure and weight)... [83 : 1] m At-Tabari 12:554.

until He said, 4.U >' ibefore the Lord of all that exists?} [83:6], These Aydt contain a stern warning and sure promise that we ask Allah to save us from. Shu'ayb was called Speaker of the Prophets, because of his eloquent words and eloquent advice, and Allah stated that Shu'ayb said: ii O* \$ Jyf- JjXc-j ijju W fs*d&u h ism;U> taws i^si; J "j c-is-jl tfjil olT jJj *y .vi -iil> 486. "And sit not on every road, threatening, and hindering from the path of Allah those who believe in Him, and seeking to make it crooked. And remember when you were but few, and He multiplied you. And see what was the end of the mischief-maker\$. \$ 487. ", And if there is a party of you who believes in that with which I have been sent and a party who does not believe, so be patient until Allah judges between us, and He is the best of judges/> Prophet Shu'ayb forbade his people from setting up blockades on the roads, saying, 4fi/sc.y 4"And sit not on every road, threatening threatening people with death if they do not give up their

money, as they were bandits, according to As-Suddi.m Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several others commented: 4ojX?y 4^=4 4" And sit not on every road, threatening the believers who come to Shu'ayb to follow him."121 The first meaning is better, because Prophet Shu'ayb first said to them, At-Tabari 12:557. At-Tabari 12:557.

4"on every road. .. } He then mentioned the second meaning, 4 and hindering from the path of Allah those who believe in Him, and seeking to make it crooked."} meaning, you seek to make the path of Allah crooked and deviated. 4" And remember when you were but few, and He multiplied you. } meaning, you were weak because you were few. But you later on became mighty because of your large numbers. Therefore, remember Allah's favor. 4U" And see what was the end of the mischief-makers. } from the previous nations and earlier generations. See the torment and punishment they suffered, because they disobeyed Allah and rejected His Messengers. Shu'ayb continued; 4 And if there is a party of you who believes in that with which 1 have been setit and a party who does not believe, } that is, if you divided concerning me, 4"so be patient } that is, then wait and see, 4"until Allah judges between us, }, and you, 4<*&i %} 4 and He is the best of judges. } Surely, Allah will award the best end to those who fear and obey Him and He will destroy the disbelievers.

J mm nr V : * U^CLmi'C/jl I ^LJUUA^ jljt ilij(j^S/l^l^i Juoj^jl*j bjj ij_l ^igfeUJh*^ |j^| uj_r~ 'aI^-*}l.4"-c^^ d?; \$^u^yi; \$ i^yr yj."JlSS cuawaij(Jjvikiy|^s=l*iljt ?0&s&&)\$&k^&xw ^^ijisji^^f^jio^ui; He said: "Even though we hate it?"} iw&it y> *o ju >-!;Jl) 4-^ . ,> r> >^" 4 T'->* 'i ;^O j" Uijy ^ du" CT jJjt Jli U.jL ^ tli jt C^ ?af & &y"l ji 44 *it 4f< m j4 (^=uL. j J JyO J UJ j 4 ty j^pi j^ liy ty iil l2j U 35 jJit ^ llic >.' '1' ;^If , ' < . -{* C-'j vj"JU U*j" | 4. Tire chiefs of those who were arrogant among his people said: "We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb and those ivho have believed with you from our town, or else you (all) shall return to our religion." 489. "We should have invented a lie against Allah if we returned to your religion, after Allah has rescued us from it. And it is not for us to return to it unless Allah, our Lord, should will. Our Lord comprehends all things in His knoioledge. In Allah (Alone) we put our trust. Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth, for You are the best of those who give judgment."} Allah describes the way the disbelievers answered His Prophet Shu'ayb and those who believed in him, by threatening them with expulsion from their village, or with forceful reversion to the disbeliever s religion. The chiefs spoke the words mentioned here to the Messenger Shu'ayb, but intended it for those who followed his religion too. The statement,

&m 4"Even though we hate it?"}, means, would you force us to do that, even though we hate what you are calling us to? Certainly if we revert to your religion and accept your ways, we will have uttered a tremendous lie against Allah by calling partners as rivals to Him, & J VI& ai U ajS iAtid it is not Jbr us to return to it unless Allah, our Lord, should will.} This part of the Ayah refers all matters to Allah s will, and certainly, He has perfect knowledge of all matters and His observation encompasses all things, 4&j\$ iln Allah (Alone) we put our trust.}, concerning all our affairs, what we practice of them and what we ignore, 4Our Lord! Judge between us and our people in truth} judge between us and our people and give us victory over them, Jr 4for You are the best of those who give judgment} and You are the Most Just Who never wrongs any in His judgment. ssr t Ui p& isir yr3^ . The chiefs of those who disbelieved among his people said (to their people) : "If you follow Shu'ayb, be sure then you will be the losers!"}

491. So the earthquake seized them and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.} 492. Those who belied Shu'ayb, became as if they had never

493. So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!"} [26:187], Therefore, Allah stated that each of these forms of punishment struck them on the Day of the Shadow. First, the torment of the Day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud) seized them} (26:189) when a gloomy cloud came over them (containing) fire, flames and a tremendous light. Next, a cry from the sky descended on them and a tremor shook them from beneath. Consequently, their souls were captured, their lives were taken and their bodies became idle, and they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes}. Allah said next, "They became as if they had never dwelt time" meaning, after the torment seized them, it looked as if they never dwelled in the land from which they wanted to expel their Messenger Shu'ayb and his followers. Here, Allah refuted their earlier statement, "Those who belied Shu'ayb, they were the losers."} Prophet Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, turned away from his people after the torment, punishment and destruction struck them, admonishing and censuring them by saying to them,

"O my people! I have indeed conveyed my Lord's Messages unto you and I have given you good advice. } Shu'ayb said, I have conveyed to you what I was sent with, so I will not feel any sorrow for you since you disbelieved in what I brought you, & Then how can I grieve over people who are disbelievers? } & Then how can I grieve over people who are disbelievers? } & And We sent no Prophet unto any town (and they denied him), but We seized its people with Ba's and Darr', so that they might humble themselves (to Allah).} 495. Then We changed the evil for the good, until they were increased, and said: "Our fathers were touched with evil and with good. So We seized them all of a sudden while they were unaware.} Afflictions that struck Earlier Nations Allah mentions the Ba's and Darr' that struck the earlier nations to whom He sent Prophets. Ba's, refers to the physical sicknesses and ailments that they suffered, while Darr', refers to the poverty and humiliation that they experienced, & so that they might humble themselves} supplicate, humble themselves and invoke Allah, that He might remove the afflictions that they suffered from. This Ayah indicates that Allah sent down severe afflictions to them so that they might invoke Him, but they did not do what He ordered them. Therefore, He changed the affliction into prosperity to test them, & Then We changed the evil for the good,} f

Al-Araf (94 - 95) (Part-9) Therefore, Allah changed the hardship into prosperity, disease and sickness into health and well-being, and poverty into richness in provision, so that they might be thankful to Allah for this, but they did none of that. Allah's statement, until they were increased refers to increase in numbers, wealth and offspring. Allah said next, "Our fathers were touched with evil and with good. So We seized them all of a sudden while they were unaware" He tested them with this (afflictions) and that (ease and abundance) so that they may humble themselves and repent to Him. However, they failed both tests, for neither this nor that compelled them to change their ways. They said, We suffered Ba's and Darr' but prosperity came afterwards, just as like our forefathers in earlier times. Therefore, they said, it is a cycle where we sometimes suffer a hardship and

at other times, we enjoy a bounty. However, they did not comprehend Allah's wisdom, nor the fact that He is testing them in both cases. To the contrary, the believers are grateful to Allah in good times and practice patience in hard times. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith that says; *فإن الله لا يهدي القوم الظالمين* [1] The matter of the believer is amazing, for nothing that Allah decrees for him, but it is better for him. If a harm strikes him, he is patient, and this is better for him, if he is given prosperity, he thanks Allah for it and this is better for him. [1] The believer, therefore, is aware of the test behind the Muslim 4:2295.

Al-A'raf (96 - 99) (Part-9 * * Lt & L3 JS (LIV rfet J aCsK Jity jl J53T% -if & 496. And if the people of the towns had believed and had Taqwa, certainly. We should have opened for them blessings from the heaven and the earth, but they belied (the Messengers). So We took them (with punishment) for what they used to earn.} 497. Did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep?} 496. Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} 499. Did they then feel secure against Allah's plan? None feels secure from Allah's plan except the people who are the losers.} Blessings come with Faith, while Kuf brings Torment Allah mentions here the little faith of the people of the towns to whom He sent Messengers. In another instance, Allah said, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* [10:98] This Ayah indicates that no city believed in its entirety, except the city of Prophet Yunus, for they all believed after they were stricken by punishment. Allah said (about Prophet Yunus), *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* And We sent him to a hundred thousand (people) or even more. And they believed; so We gave them enjoyment for a while.} [37:147-148]

Allah said in another Ayah, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* [34:34] Allah said here, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* And if the people of the towns had believed and had Taqwa...} meaning their hearts had faith in what the Messenger brought them, believed and obeyed him, and had Taqwa by performing the acts of obedience and abstaining from the prohibitions, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* We should have opened for them blessings from the heaven and the earth,} in reference to the rain that falls from the sky and the vegetation of the earth. Allah said, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* but they belied (the Messengers). So We took them (with punishment) for what they used to earn.} They denied their Messengers, so that We punished them and sent destruction on them as a result of the sins and wickedness that they earned. Allah then said, while warning and threatening against defying His orders and daring to commit His prohibitions, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* Did the people of the towns then feel secure, meaning the disbelievers among them, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* that should come to them our punishment, Our torment and punishing example. *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* during the night, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ*

Al-A'raf (99 - 100) (Part-9) *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} while they are busy in their affairs and unaware. *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* Did they then feel secure against Allah's plan?} His torment, vengeance, and His power to destroy them while they are inattentive and heedless, *وإن من قرية إلا نحن فرغنا من أمرها في يومئذ* None feels secure from Allah's plan except the people who are the losers.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, The believer

performs the acts of worship, all the while feeling fear, in fright and anxiety. The Fdjir (wicked sinner, or disbeliever) commits the acts of disobedience while feeling safe (from Allah's torment)! o* Hi 5\$} 4 ^ . v^^ |< | \ ,n "L-J y O' 4100. Is it not a guidance for those who inherit the earth from its previous inhabitants that had We willed, We would have punished them for their sins. And We seal up their hearts so that they hear not?} Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4^\\^U& >>. Hi jfy 4ls it not a guidance for those who inherit the earth from its previous inhabitants...} (Allah says,) did We not make clear to them that had We willed, We would have punished them because of their sins? Mujahid and several others said similarly. 111 Abu Ja'far bin Jarir At-Tabari explained this Ayah, Allah says, Did We not make clear to those who succeeded on the earth after destroying the previous nations who used to dwell in that land. Then they followed their own ways, and behaved as they did and were unruly with their Lord. [Did We not make clear m At-Tabari 12 :580

to them] that, it had We willed, We would have punished them for their sins.} by bringing them the same end that was decreed for those before them. iAnd We seal up their hearts}, We place a cover over their heart, ^so that they hear not}, words of advice or reminding? I say that similarly, Allah said, JjV yfoj kiU'j j jj 4 Cy/) ' r&j L p 1 ^A ""* " ils it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them, in whose dwellings they walk? Verily, in this are signs indeed for men of understanding.} [20:128] 4 5] 4 Si 4 p pi "" py^ ils it not a guidance for them : how many generations We have destroyed before them in whose dwellings they do walk about? Verily, therein indeed are signs. Would they not then listen?} [32:26] and, }Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter). And you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves} [14A4-45] Also, Allah said. j'P Si J* J>& && pf} m At-Tabari 12:579.

227Siirah 7. Al-A'raf dOl - 102) (Part-9) 4And how many a generation before them have We destroyed! Can you find a single one of them or hear even a whisper of them?} [19:98] meaning, do you see any of them or hear their voices? There are many other Aydt that testify that Allah's torment strikes His enemies, while His bounty reaches His faithful believers. Thereafter comes Allah's statement, and He is the Most Truthful, the Lord of all that exists, KLi Cj i2j ^ it css Cj && j4 o* ife 4 . *V. ;;^l .>*a == bJu.j 4202 . 77iose were the towns whose story We relate unto you. And there came indeed to them their Messengers with clear proofs, but tlthey were not such who would believe in what they rejected before. Thus Allah does seal up the hearts of the disbelievers.} 4202. And most of them We found not true to their covenant, but most of them We found indeed rebellious.} After narrating the stories of the people of Prophets Nuh, Hud, Salih, Lut and Shu'ayb, destroying the disbelievers, saving the believers, warning these nations by explaining the truth to them with the evidence sent in the words of His Messengers, may Allah's peace and blessings be on them all, Allah said; 4J& &,) iTlwse were the towns that We relate to you} O Muhammad, 4their story}, and news, 4v Jt ,#5 (2* Z'fo 4And there came indeed to them their Messengers with clear proofs,} and evidences of the truth of what they brought them. Allah said in other Ayah,

128 Tafsir Ibtî Katlur iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).} [17: 15J, and, l>* & &C3 } iThat is some of the news of the towns which We relate unto you ; of them, some are standing, and some have been reaped. We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves.} [11 : 100-101 Allah said ^ l l ibut they were not such who would believe in what they had rejected before.}

meaning they would not have later on believed in what the Messengers brought them, because they denied the truth when it first came to them (although they recognized it), according to the Tafsir of Ibn Atiyyah. This explanation is sound, and is supported by Allah's statement, iAnd what will make you perceive that if it came, they will not believe? And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time.} [6:109-110] This is why Allah said here, ty "_yl" if Sit iThus Allah does seal up the hearts of the disbelievers. And most of them We found not...} meaning, We did not find most of the previous nations, ^uAi ^ HiJwj Xf -^} it true to their covenant, but most of them We found to indeed be rebellious.}

This Ayah means, We found most of them to be rebellious, deviating away from obedience and compliance. The covenant mentioned here is the Fitrah that Allah instilled in them while still in their fathers' loins, and taking their covenant, that He is their Lord, King, and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him,. They affirmed this covenant and testified against themselves to this fact. However, they defied this covenant, threw it behind their backs and worshipped others besides Allah, having no proof or plea, nor support from rationality or by divine law. Surely, the pure Fitrah defies these actions, while all the honorable Messengers, from beginning to end, forbade them.

130 Tafsir Ibn Kathir nmm \m Ji&S\ jcjjjVvul 0Si 'Sjo^ojtjrc&/j&ci^ . ^y_5 cJ^j*O^-aJc^liU dL^ac-^tiJ\ 4yfc0 ^i .gj}juJuiJ-jV"*U-t*\$9^ E36 %^iThert after them We sent}, after the Messengers whom We mentioned, such as Nakh, Hud, Salih Ldt and Shu'ayb (may Allah's peace and blessings be on them and the rest of Allah's Prophets), We sent, 4C^IL frji} iMusa with Our signs> proofs and clear evidences, to Fir'awn, who was ruler of Egypt during the time of Musa, i'ipjb {and his chiefs> the people of Fir'awn, ibut they wrongfully rejected them}, they denied and disbelieved in the signs, out of injustice and stubbornness on their part. Allah said about them in another Ayah, jJbB Ob X&\$Xj \$ ijZZ# U lit o ' li ijLll LLJi[jiJ \jU ^And they belied them (those Aydt) wrongfully and arrogantly, though they were themselves convinced thereof. So see what was the end of the evildoers.>(27: 14] The Ayah says, those who hindered from the path of Allah and belied in His Messengers, look how We punished them, We caused them to drown, all of them, while Musa and his people were watching. Public drowning added disgrace to the punishment that Fir'awn and his people suffered, while adding comfort to the hearts of Allah's party, Musa and those people

Al-A'raf(104 - 106) (Part-9) who believed in him. if Jy' V J jje Jj-o 4l 'n' 4 ' : A v i : "s' if c-a 4 Jt" in ** o^ cn 4r 4104. And Miisa said: "O Fir'awn! Verily, I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists."} 4105. "Proper it is for me that I say nothing concerning Allah but the truth. Indeed I have come unto you from your Lord with a clear proof. So let the Children of Israel depart along with me."} [Fir'awn] said: "If you have come with a sign, show it forth, if you are one of those who tell the truth."} Allah mentions a debate that took place between Musa and Fir'awn, and Musa's refuting Fir'awn with the unequivocal proof and clear miracles, in the presence of Fir'awn and his people, the Copts of Egypt. Allah said, 4And Musa said : "O Fir'awn! Verily, I am a Messenger from the Lord of all that exists".} meaning Musa said, the one Who sent me is the Creator, Lord and King of all things, iJeJ' \$M Jy' V J if 4"Proper it is for me that I say nothing concerning Allah but the truth."} It is incumbent and a duty for me to convey only the Truth from Him, because of what I know of His might and power. iftij in 4"Indeed I have come unto you from your Lord with a clear proof."} I brought unequivocal evidence

that Allah gave me to prove that I am conveying the truth to you, 4"So let the Children of Israel depart along with me. }

means, release them from your slavery and subjugation. Let them worship your Lord and their Lord. They are from the offspring of an honorable Prophet, Isra'il, who is Ya'qub son of Ishaq son of Ibrahim, the Khalil (intimate friend) of Allah. 4 Ol * *^ l)J If? ulj 4[Fir'awn] said: "If you have come with a sign, show it forth, if you are one of those who tell the truth."} Fir'awn said, will not believe in what you have said nor entertain your request. Therefore, he said, if you have proof, then produce it for us to see, so that we know if your claim is true. il07. Then [Musa] threw his staff and behold! it was a [Thu'bdn] serpent, manifest!} 4108. And he drew out his hand, and behold! it was white (with radiance) for the beholders.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4a [Thu'bdn] serpent, manifest}, refers to The male snake. As-Suddi and Ad-Dahhak said similarly.12 ' A report from Ibn Abbas said, 4 Then (Musa) threw his staff}, and it turned into a huge snake that opened its mouth and rushed towards Fir'awn. When Fir'awn saw the snake rushing towards him, he jumped from his throne and cried to Musa for help, so that Musa would remove the snake from his way. Musa did that. 13, As-Suddi commented, ian.i behold! It was a [Tlw'bdn] serpent, manifest!} At-Jabari 13:16. Jabari 13:15-17. ;3) At-Taban 13:16.

Al-A'rdf(107 - 110) (Part-9) This [Thu'ban] refers to male snakes. The snake opened its mouth and headed towards Fir'awn to swallow him, placing its lower jaw on the ground and its upper jaw reaching the (top of the) wall of the palace. When Fir'awn saw the snake, he was frightened, so he jumped and wet himself and he never wet himself before this incident. He cried, O Musa! Take it away and I will believe in you and release the Children of Israel to you. So MQsa, peace be on him, took it, and it became a staff again." 4 ' JI 'i)i VSi {fj} 4And he drew out his hand, and behold! it was white (with radiance) far the beholders.} Musa took his hand out of his cloak after he inserted his hand in it and it was shining, not because of leprosy or sickness. Allah said in another Ayah, *T " /w o r/ , ""/ r V iAnd put your hand into your bosom, it will come forth white without hurt.} (27:12] Ibn Abbas said, without hurt, means, not because of leprosy. Musa inserted his hand again in his sleeve and it returned back to its normal color. Mujahid and several others said similarly. liCi < * -ty. oj Cfi Stll' 4109. The chiefs of the people of Fir'awn said: "This is indeed a well-versed sorcerer."} 4110. "He wants to get you out of your land, so what do you advise?"} Fir'awn's People say that Musa is a Magician! The chiefs and noblemen of the people of Fir'awn agreed with Fir'awn's statement about Musa. After Fir'awn felt safe and At-Tabari 13:15. ' At-Jabari 13:17. ' At-Tabari 13:18.

136 Tafsir Ibn Kathir into them, and they displayed a great trick.} The magicians challenged Mtsa, when they said, 0 o' Utj {jdj J lil^ iEither you throw (first), or shall we have the (first) throw?} before you. In another Ayah, they said, iOr we be the first to throw} [20:65]. Musa said to them, you throw first. It was said that the wisdom behind asking them to throw first, is that - Allah knows best - the people might witness the magicians' sorcery first. When the magicians had cast their spell and captured the eyes, the clear and unequivocal truth came, at a time when they all anticipated and waited for it to come, thus making the truth even more impressive to their hearts. This is what happened. Allah said, ^ oasas no stssiga ii1 aS-u!'j Jlijs^}} "A/ </ // . // A/'/' i* . Jjjojj 0-iU_jLo_ll La A tijjf , r? -- *> . ^ "> c^fj j " p-r-s^,4UvT^j o> < 9'A' ^ * < o^io-fp v . a* ^ Ijpl ^ (j^A-mJI o-uji ij^L. ipji uii> 4So when they

threw, they bewitched the eyes of the people, and struck terror into them,} meaning, they deceived the eyes and made them think that that trick was real, when it was only an illusion, just as Allah said,

Al-A'rdf(U6 - 222) (Part-9) .;> ' i " mis-y l j 1 1-'r-" L. yJuJj 4So Miisa conceived fear in himself. We (Allah) said: "Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand. And throw that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain"} [20:67-69]. Ibn Abbas commented that the magicians threw, Thick ropes and long sticks, and they appeared to be crawling, an illusion that they created with their magic. jh "y Ji 'i' tj' J lyy ill] ILL ij)S tjfi L4- .V1 iyy vj y-4 4217. And We revealed to Musa (saying): "Throw your stick," and behold! It swallowed up straight away all the falsehood which they showed.} 4223. Thus truth was confirmed, and all that they did was made of no effect.} 4229. So they were defeated there and returned disgraced.} 4120. And the sorcerers fell down prostrate.} 4222. They said: "We believe in the Lord of all that exists.} 4222. "The Lord of Musa and Harun. } Musa defeats the Magicians, Who believe in Him Allah states that at that tremendous moment, in which Allah differentiated between Truth and Falsehood, He sent a revelation to His servant and Messenger Musa, peace be upon him, ordering him to throw the stick that he held in his right hand, it swallowed straight away} and devoured, Tabari 13:28.

4'oj& C) iall the falsehood which they showed.) the magic that they caused the illusion with, of magic with which they caused making it appear real, whereas it was not real at all. Ibn Abbas said that Musa's stick swallowed all the ropes and sticks that the magicians threw. The magicians realized that this was from heaven and was by no means magic. They fell in prostration and proclaimed, i fry 4 &L) 4'We believe in the Lord of all that exists. The Lord of Musa and Harun). Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, It followed the ropes and sticks one after another, until nothing that the sorcerers threw remained. Musa then held it in his hand, and it became a stick again just as it was before. The magicians fell in prostration and proclaimed, *We believe in the Lord of all that exists, the Lord of Musa and Harun. Had Musa been a magician, he would not have prevailed over us. 111 Al-Qasim bin Abi Bazzah commented, Allah revealed to Musa to throw his stick. When he threw his stick, it became a huge, manifest snake that opened its mouth and swallowed the magicians ropes and sticks. On that, the magicians fell in prostration. They did not reuse their heads before seeing the Paradise, the Fire, and the recompense of their inhabitants. [2) Vt 6# 4&& & Sih oSC 4123. Fir'awn said: "You have believed in him [Musa] before I gave you permission. Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people, but you shall come to know/")Tabari 13:30. At-Tabari 13:30.

Al-A'rdfd23 - 126) (Part-9 4224. Surely, I will cut off your hands and your feet from opposite sides, then I will crucify you all."} 4225. They said: Verily , we are returning to our Lord."} 4226. "And you take vengeance on us only because we believed in the Aydt of our Lord when they reached us! Our Lord! pour out on us patience, and cause us to die as Muslims."} Fir'awn threatens the Magicians after They believed in Musa and Their Response to Him Allah mentions the threats that the Fir'awn - may Allah curse him - made to the magicians after they believed Musa, peace be upon him, and the deceit and cunning that Fir'awn showed the people. Fir'awn said, ft8^u* i&& S3& tfr i Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city to drive out its people,} meaning Fir'awn proclaimed, *Musa's defeating you today was because you plotted with him and agreed to that. Fir'awn also said, #pz 4He

(Musa) is your chief who has taught you magic.) [20:71] However, Fir'awn and all those who had any sense of reason knew for sure that what Fir'awn said was utterly false. As soon as MQsa came from Madyan, he called Fir'awn to Allah and demonstrated tremendous miracles and clear proofs for the Truth that he brought. Fir'awn then sent emissaries to various cities of his kingdom and collected magicians who were scattered throughout Egypt. Fir'awn and his people chose from them, summoned them, and Fir'awn promised them great rewards. These magicians were very eager to prevail over MCksa in front of Fir'awn, so that they might become closer to him. Mttsa neither knew any of them nor saw or met them before. Fir'awn knew that, but he claimed otherwise to deceive the ignorant masses of his kingdom, just as Allah described them,

iTlius lie [Fir'awrt] fooled his people, and they obeyed him.) [43:54] Certainly, a people who believed Fir'awn in his statement, i I am your lord, most high.") [79:24], are among the most ignorant and misguided creatures of Allah. In his Tafsir, As-Suddi reported that Ibn Mas ud, Ibn Abbas, and several other Companions, commented, A&& 4 -fop pi& k) 4"Surely, this is a plot which you have plotted in the city..." Musa met the leader of the magicians and said to him, If I defeat you, will you believe in me and bear witness that what I brought is the truth? The magician said. Tomorrow, I will produce a type of magic that cannot be defeated by another magic. By Allah! If you defeat me, I will believe in you and testify to your truth. Fir'awn was watching them, and this is why he said what he said. His statement, 4"to drive out its people"), means, so that you all cooperate to gain influence and power, replacing the chiefs and masters of this land. In this case, power in the state will be yours, 4fL^c- Sp) 4"but you shall come to know"), what I will do to you. He then explained his threat, Afor ft ffofo fofo ifoP) 4"Surely, I will cut off your hands and your feet from opposite sides") by cutting the right hand and the left leg or the opposite, ifoufo! Pifoi 'f) 4"then I will crucify you all.) just as he said in another Ayah, 4P& gfo At-Jabari 13:33.

Al-A'raf(123 - 126) (Part-9 4 Fi the trunks of date palms") [20:71], FT in this Ayah means on . Ibn Abbas said that Fir awn was the first to crucify and cut off hands and legs on opposite sides.' ' The magicians said, 4^% 4"Verily, we are returning to our Lord."} They said, We are now sure that we will go back to Allah. Certainly, Allah s punishment is more severe than your punishment and His torment for what you are calling us to, this day, and the magic you forced us to practice, is greater than your torment. Therefore, we will observe patience in the face of your punishment today, so that we are saved from Allah s torment. They continued, 4 , SL& VZZf} 4"Our Lord! pour out on us patience }, with your religion and being firm in it, 4oi-L"and cause us to die as Muslims."}, as followers of Your Prophet Musa, peace be upon him. They also said to Fir awn, U ,VV, CjJl a. w * ,/-> >{* { . " ' . 'i'Y a. , /"/I ou rto ol cr J*- <'>_> 4 -Vs , aUljli c '>. ' -a Yj Vt Cjyu 4"So decide whatever you desire to decree, for you can only decide for the life of this world. Verily, we have believed in our Lord, that He may forgive us our faults, and the magic to which you did compel us. And Allah is better [to reward] and more lasting [in punishment] . Verily, whoever comes to his Lord as a criminal, then surely, far him is Hell, wherein he will neither die nor live. But ivhoever comes to Him (Allah) as a believer, and has done righteous good deeds, far such are the high ranks (in the Hereafter).} [20:72-75]. The magicians started the day as sorcerers and ended as honorable martyrs! Ibn Abbas, Ubayd bin Umayr, Qatadah u7 At-Tabari 13:34.

and Ibn Jurayj commented, They started the day as sorcerers and ended it as martyrs. ^ JijXj J*}i\ j J fry oyji -tj in fi^j} ^ S is A ,V(^ > "jf *> \ i*z C jJu Oij Cjtj jl VSi 4i i il^a ^Vt 4 4227. 77ie chiefs of Fir'awn's people said: "Will you leave Musa and his people to spread mischief in the land, and to abandon you and your gods?" He said: We will kill their sons, and let their women live, and we have indeed irresistible power over them. } 4228. Musa said to his people: "Seek help in Allah and be patient. Verily, the earth is Allah's. He gives it as a heritage to whom He wills of His servants ; and the (blessed) end is for the pious and righteous persons. } 4229. They said: We suffered troubles before you came to us, and since you have come to us. He said: "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you act?"} Fir'awn vows to kill the Children of Israel, Who complain to Musa; Allah promises Them Victory Allah mentions the conspiracy of Fir'awn and his people, their ill intentions and their hatred for Musa and his people. iThe chiefs of Fir'awn s people said}, to Fir'awn, fry 4"TWill you leave Musa and his people"}, willyou let them be free, 4c?:Vt j [i} 4"to spread mischief in the land"}, spreading unrest among your m At-Tabari 13:36.

Al-A'rdf (127 - 129) (Part-9) subjects and calling them to worship their Lord instead of you? Amazingly, these people were worried that Musa and his people would cause mischief. Rather, Fir'awn and his people are the mischief-makers, but they did not realize it. They said, 4"and to abandon you and your gods? } Your gods , according to Ibn Abbas, as As-Suddi narrated from him, Were cows. Whenever they saw a beautiful cow, Fir'awn would command them to worship it. This is why As- Samiri, made the statue of a calf that seemed to moo for the Children of Israel. 11 Fir'awn accepted his people s recommendation, saying, 4"YJe will kill their sons, and let their women live } thus reiterating his previous order concerning the Children of Israel. He had tormented them (killing every newly bom male] before MUsa was bom, so that MUsa would not live. However, the opposite of what Fir'awn sought and intended occurred. The same end struck Fir'awn that he intended to subjugate and humiliate the Children of Israel with. Allah gave victory to the Children of Israel, humiliated and disgraced Fir'awn, and caused him to drown along with his soldiers. When Fir'awn insisted on his evil plot against the Children of Israel, h&& try ^Miisa said to his people: "Seek help in Allah and be patient"} and promised them that the good end will be theirs and that they will prevail, saying, oi i Verily, the earth is Allah's. He gives it as a heritage to whom He ivills of His servants; and the (blessed) end is for the pious and righteous persons." They said: "We suffered troublesJabari 13:38.

before you came to us, and since you Imve come to us The Children of Israel replied to Musa, they (Fir awn and his people) inflicted humiliation and disgrace on us, some you witnessed, both before and after you came to us, O Musa ! Musa replied, reminding them of their present situation and how it will change in the future, o' 4"It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy... } encouraging them to appreciate Allah when the afflictions are removed and replaced by a bounty. s mm t4_iJ,>*J jSu fe '-* '_>!Uj ills (vn),W-ll C^ i" lT^-"*j J-j j 5t/-t "{ {, > I'" -*>'<' > *.*' IjgSJ 'y'-====>'y'J .*U_j") v. j * -*-*"W '*)* Oj~Jl ojf^i JI* U-ii.1 xilj^ &SJ ^ i*^) Vi ,ll: ^ ^ oii 4& U \)6 4130. And indeed We punished the people of Fir'awn with years of drought and lack of fruits (crops), that they might remember (take heed).} 4131. But whenever good came to them, they said: This is far us." And if evil afflicted them, they considered it an omen about Musa and those with him. Be informed! Verily, their omens are with Allah but most of them know not.}

Al-A'raf (130 - 131) (Part-9) Fir'awn and His People suffer Years of Drought Allah said, 4And indeed We punished the people of Fir'awn We tested and tried them, iwith years of drought) offamine due to little produce, 4and lack of fruits), which is less severe, according to Mujahid. * Abu Ishaq narrated that Raja bin Haywah said, The date tree used to produce only one date! |2))That they might remember (take heed). But whenever good came to them) such as a fertile season and provisions, Q \Z) 4they said, "This is for us."), because we deserve it, U& 4and if evil afflicted them) drought and famine, (>'S " ' > (> V' 4they considered it an omen Musa and those with him.) saying that this hardship is because of them and what they have done. 4Verily, their omens are with Allah) Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, At-Tabari 13:46. Tabari 13:46.

146 Tafstr Ibn Kathir xi~ \2[4Verily, their omens are with Allah} Allah says that their afflictions are with and from Him, 4but most of them know not.} jjiyij uU Hi (J. ^L2j fX, j* ^ tf; ^ *y: \%&& \$sn; #.t; Z& css. ci*r oi 3i*v c igj ag ijii 5^t c 2- csf ^ su; a ^ <'n . They said [to Musa] : "Whatever Ayat you may bring to us, to work therewith your sorcery on us, we shall never believe in you."} 4133. So We sent on them: the Tufan, the locusts, the Qummal, the frogs, and the blood (as a succession of) manifest signs, yet they remained arrogant, and they were of those people who were criminals.} 4134. And when the punishment struck them, they said: "O Musa! Invoke your Lord for us because of His promise to you If you remove the punishment from us, we indeed shall believe in you, and we shall let the Children of Israel go with you."} 4135. But when We removed the punishment from them for a fixed term, which they had to reach, behold! They broke their word!} Allah punishes the People of Fir'awn because of Their Rebellion Allah describes the rebellion, tyranny, defiance of the truth and insistence on falsehood of the people of Fir'awn, prompting them to proclaim, Ill Ip .yb 1 ill At-Tabari 13:48.

Al-A'raf (132 - 135) (Part-9) 'Whatever Aydt you may bring to us, to work therewith your sorcery on us, we shall never believe in you. \$ They said, whatever miracle, proof and evidence you bring us, we will neither accept it from you nor believe in you or what you came with. Allah said, 4So We sent on them the Tufan Ibn Abbas commented; It was a heavy rain that ruined the produce and fruits. He is also reported to have said that Tuwfdn refers to mass death. MujeLhid said it is water that carries the plague every where. As for the locust, it is the well- known insect, which is permissible to eat. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs, that Abu Ya ftlr said that he asked Abdullah bin Abi Awfa about locust. He said, We participated in seven battles with the Messenger of All&h jg, and we used to eat locusts. 111 Ash-Shafit,

148 Tafsir Ibn Kathir are small black insects. Abu Jafar bin Jarir recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, When Musa came to Fir'awn, he demanded, Release the Children of Israel to me. But, Fir'awn did not comply; and Allah sent the Tufan, and that is a rain which continued until they feared that it was a form of torment. They said to Musa, Invoke your Lord to release us from this rain, and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you. Musa invoked his Lord and He removed the affliction from them. However, they did not believe, nor did they send the Children of Israel with him. In that year, Allah allowed (the earth) to grow various types of produce, fruits and grass for them as never before. They said, This is what we hoped for. So Allah sent the locusts, and the locusts started to feed on the grass. When they saw the effect the locusts had on the grass, they knew that no vegetation would be saved from devastation. They said, O Musa! Invoke your Lord so that He will remove the locusts

from us, and we will believe in you and release the Children of Israel to you. Musa invoked his Lord, and He removed the locusts. Still, they did not believe and did not send the Children of Israel with him. They collected grains and kept them in their homes. They said, We saved our crops. However, Allah sent the Qummal, grain bugs, and one of them would take ten bags of grains to the mill, but only reap three small bags of grain. They said, O Musa! Ask your Lord to remove the Qummal (weevil) from us and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you. Musa invoked his Lord, and Allah removed the Qummal from them. However, they did not send the Children of Israel with him. Once, when he was with Fir'awn, Musa heard the sound of a frog and said to Fir'awn, What will you and your people suffer from this (the frogs)? Fir'awn said. What can frogs do? Yet, by the time that night arrived a person would be sitting in a crowd of frogs that reached up to his chin and could not open his mouth to speak without a frog jumping in it. They said to Musa, Invoke your Lord to remove these frogs from us, and m At-Tabari 13:55.

Al-A'rdf(132 - 135) (Part-9) we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you. Musa invoked his Lord, but they did not believe. Allah then sent blood that filled the rivers, wells and the water containers they had. They complained to Fir'awn, saying, *We are inflicted with blood and do not have anything to drink. He said, Musa has bewitched you. They said, How could he do that when whenever we look for water in our containers we found that it has turned into blood? They came to Musa and said, Invoke your Lord to save us from this blood, and we will believe in you and send the Children of Israel with you. Musa invoked his Lord and the blood stopped, but they did not believe nor send the Children of Israel with him. A similar account was attributed to Ibn Abbas, As- Suddi, Qatadah and several others among the Salaf. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, The enemy of Allah, Fir'awn, went back defeated and humiliated, after the sorcerers believed (in Musa). He insisted on remaining in disbelief and persisted in wickedness. Allah sent down the signs to him, and he (and his people) were first inflicted by famine. Allah then sent the flood, the locusts, the Qummal, the frogs then blood, as consecutive signs. When Allah sent the flood, it filled the surface of the earth with water. But the water level receded, and they could not make use of it to till the land or do anything else. They became hungry. This is when, id oqyJ jXf d* iixc. jl LL tlcj 5 iThey said : "O Musa! Invoke your Lord far us because of His promise to you . If you remove the punishment from us, we indeed shall believe in you, and we shall let the Children of Israel go with you.") Musa invoked his Lord and He removed the affliction from them, but they did not keep their promises. So Allah sent locusts that ate the trees and consumed the nails on their doors, until the doors fell from their homes and residences. They again said what they said to Musa before, and he called on his Lord and He removed the affliction. Still, they did not keep their promises, and Allah sent the

Al-A'rdf(136 - 137) (Part-9 transgressed, even though He inflicted them with consecutive signs, one after another, He took retribution from them by drowning them in the sea that Musa parted by Allah s power, and he and the Children of Israel passed through. In their pursuit, Fir'awn and his soldiers went in the sea chasing MOsa and his people. When they all had gone inside the water, the sea closed in on them and they all drowned, because they belied the Ayat of Allah and were heedless of them. Allah said that He has granted the people who were considered weak, the Children of Israel, to inherit the eastern and western parts of the land. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah commented that Allah s statement, 4k&A# 6^} i...the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed.} refers

covenant with you on the right side of the Mount (20:80). Musa left his brother Harun with the Children of Israel and commanded him to use wisdom and refrain from mischief. This was only a reminder, for Harun was an honorable and noble Prophet who had grace and exalted standard with Allah, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him and the rest of the Prophets. c0.!> alif t?X Jkit kl*j Jii fSj fl&j ivy;..) i^y &&& a %jl\ 4 jt if X Sfl , > 4143. And when Musa came at the time and place appointed by Us, and his Lord (Allah) spoke to him; he said: "O my Lord! Show me (Yourself), that I may look upon You." Allah said: "You cannot see Me, but look upon the mountain ; if it stands still in its place then you shall see Me." So when his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it collapse to dust, and Musa fell down unconscious. Then when he recovered his senses he said: "Glory be to You, I turn to You in repentance and I am the first of the believers Musa asks to see Allah Allah said that when Musa came for His appointment and spoke to Him directly, he asked to see Him,

156 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 'O my Lord! Show me (Yourself), that I may look upon You. Allah said: "You cannot see Me, ' 4 You cannot (Lan) by no means indicates that seeing Allah will never occur, as (the misguided sect of) Al-Mu'tazilah claimed. The Hadiths of Mutawatir grade * narrated from the Messenger of Allah, affirm that the believers will see Allah in the Hereafter. We will mention these Hadiths under the explanation of Allah's statement, 4Some faces that Day shall be radiant. Looking at their Lord.} (75:22-23] In earlier Scriptures, it was reported that Allah said to Musa, O Musa! No living soul sees Me, but will perish, and no solid but will be demolished. Allah said here, 4So when his Lord appeared to the mountain, He made it collapse to dust, and Musa fell down unconscious .4 In his Musnad Imam

reported from Ibn Abbas about Allah's saying, 4&k&U 4And what his Lord appeared to the mountain, Only the extent of the little finger appeared from Him, 4He made it collapse^ as dust; try 4And Musa fell down unconscious fainting from it. Ibn Jarir recorded these because of the relation to the word Al-GhashL^ iTheti when he (Miisa) recovered his senses} after he lost consciousness, 4^i it} 4he said: "Glory be to You, } thus, praising, glorifying and honoring Allah since no living soul could see Him in this life and remain alive. Musa statement, idtil } 4 I turn to You in repentance } means, according to Mujahid, that from asking you to look at you, 4 and I am the first of the believers. }, among the Children of Israel, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, and Ibn Jarir preferred this view. Or, according to another narration from Ibn Abbas, the meaning of, K\$ U'j} 4"and I am the first of the believers. }, is that none shall see You (in this life). Allah said, 1yy y~)} 4And Musa fell down unconscious.} m At-Tabari 13:97.

Abu Said Al-Khudri and Abu Hurayrah narrated a Hadith from the Prophet that is suitable to mention here. As for the Hadith from Abu Sa'id,

Al-A'rdf(144 - 145) (Part-9 his) unconsciousness on (Mount) At-Tur.n' 1 '

iSo hold to that which I have given you\$, of My Speech and conversation with you, iand be of the grateful^ , for it and do not ask for what is beyond your capacity to bear. Allah stated that He has written lessons and exhortation for all things and explanations for all things on the Tablets. It was said that in the Tablets, Allah wrote advice and the details of the commandments for lawful and prohibited matters. The Tablets contained the Tawrah, that Allah described; iAnd indeed We gave Musa - after We

had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment for mankind}[28A3]. It was also said that Allah gave Musa the Tablets before the Tawrah, and Allah knows best. Allah said next, *irk ihold unto these with firmness>, be firm on the obedience, bilt iand enjoin your people to take the better therein.* Sufyan bin TJaynah said, Abu Sa d narrated to us from Ikrimah from Ibn Abbas that Musa, peace be upon him, was commanded to adhere to the toughest of what was ordained on his people. * Allah s statement, *il shall sixmo you the home of the rebellious>, means, you will witness the recompense of those who defy My order and deviate from My obedience, the destruction, demise and utter loss they will suffer.* V iji" J^==" 'JJIj jCu 4 o oli:\$ iK oij -juf 'i j\$\\ i;>:& 14. ijL-S m At-Tabari 13:110.

ylfj tbibli; [ylS" jib 4ti^fc ^ ji cJ^-. I shall him away from My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right, and (even) if they see all the Ayat, they will not believe in them. And if they see the way of righteousness, they will not adopt it as the way, but if they see the way of error, they will adopt that way, that is because they have rejected Our Ayat and were heedless of them 4247. Those ivho deny Our Ayat and the meeting in the Hereafter, vain are their deeds. Are they requited with anything except what they used to do?} Arrogant People will be deprived ofAllah s Ayat Allah said, 41 shall turn awayfrom My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right}. Allah says, I shall deprive the hearts of those who are too proud to obey Me, and arrogant with people without right, from understanding the signs and proofs that testify to My Might, Law and Commandments. And just as they acted arrogantly without justification, Allah has disgraced them with ignorance. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time} [6:110], and, ill d&} 4So when they turned away (from the path of Allah), Allah turned their hearts away (from the right path).} [61:5] Sufyan bin Uyaynah commented on this Ayah, 44 J' IA j}

41 shall turn away from My Ayat those who behave arrogantly on the earth, without a right}, (Allah says) I shall snatch away comprehension of the Qur an from them and turn them away from My Ayat. * Ibn Jarir commented on Sufyan s statement that, This indicates that this part of the Ayah is addressed to this Ummah." 121 This is not necessarily true, for Ibn TJaynah actually meant that this occurs in every Ummah and that there is no difference between one Ummah and another Ummah in this regard. Allah knows best. Allah said next, 4^ y ** !iit 4and (even) if they see all the Ayat, they will not believe in them}. Allah said in a similar Ayah, jX % 'i &j iTruely, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) Allah s statement, 'i 11 t ' 1: . 1'V 4And if they see the way of righteousness, they will not adopt it as the way,} means, even if the way of guidance and safety appears before them, they will not take it, but if the way that leads to destruction and misguidance appears to them, they adopt that way. Allah explains why they do this, Am 4that is because they have rejected Our Ayat}, in their hearts, 4and were heedless of them.}, gaining no lessons from the Ayat. Allah s statement, At-Tabari 13:112.Tabari 13:113.

iThose who deny Our Ayat and the meeting in the Hereafter, vain are their deeds.} indicates that whoever among them does this, remaining on this path until death, then all his deeds will be in vain. Allah said next, i&tetW vi jl" iAre they requited with anything except what they used to do?} meaning,

We only recompense them according to the deeds that they performed, good for good and evil for evil. Surely, as you bring forth, you reap the harvest thereof. Vj V\$ IjL1"- St iti Xjf-i)} -1* \5l)j lij 'A, rcfr. << "3 0% ^ ijiu . And the people of Musa made in his absence, out of their ornaments, the image of a calf (for worship). It had a sound. Did they not see that it could neither speak to them nor guide them to the way? They took it (for worship) and they were wrongdoers.} 4149. And when they regretted and saw that they had gone astray, they said: "If our Lord have not mercy upon us and forgive us, we shall certainly be of the losers"} Story of worshipping the Calf Allah describes the misguidance of those who worshipped the calf that As-Samiri made for them from the ornaments they borrowed from the Copts. He made the shape of a calf with these ornaments and threw in it a handful of dust from the trace of the horse that the Angel Jibril was riding, and the calf seemed to moo. This occurred after Musa went for the appointed term with his Lord, where Allah told him about what happened when he was on Mount Tur. Allah said about His Honorable Self,

iw tv sTiffT Fty J9 UB JO adA; JS3J3A3S aqj si jajSaj jo fisy reqi pres .BpjBQ-pv nqv jaj3aj jo nnj
pire XjSub aureoaq aq pjoq siq qjiM uotjBSiaAuoa jayB ajdoad siq oj pairqaj Bsnpj uaqA\ jBq; sajBjs
qBfly 4,/Rauam awqs oqoi asoiy fo ittfpjayq fSop\j aqi axv no* jqf 'Rauaut utioj}ui sn puipv puv
'xatpoxq Rui ptw am aoiSuoq jpjcq Rut o :pws (vsnyq) ap i i} 4,/suaopSuouc ajv oqcn a\doad aq)
Suoiuv am }tid jou 'am xaoa aaiohx saimaua aip)ou a>(vm os 'am piq o) jttoqv auam puv qvam am
paSpnf ajdoad aip paapu] jjaipout Rrn jo uos o 'pps (utuvjj) api uiiq spuvmu) uuq paSSvxp puv
pvai{ s11/ (fo Jim/ aip) Rq uaipouq siq paztas puv sjajqv x aijf ucnop majif) aq puy it, Rfo W)vm ui
uajsvq noR piQ auuasqv Rm tuunp auop aavq noR qaiqrn jvq) si Suiq) paa uv /"t/M : P!vs aq 'paoauS
puv RjSuv a\doad siq o) pamnp x vsnpq uaqoi puy 0Slt && f %? <" 5 jiff4?# SC f ^T? "O jfpgj % pf
HTTP Qft tff % P ?C J5 i H \h& \$ Y r* %? zF- c*Er F ^ FT 9C * "p rp^\-v rtf/?^ fwiifqr &\ r?? rz
\$aptftizV p \fs^Z\ \hf?s\zT Cp^r-3 tJ ?v pT^!. ^ mss vu ^ (6-m) (isi - osi)Mv-iv7mmS9l

Al-A'rdf(150 - 151) (Part-9 you have not respected (waited or observed) my word!' } [20:92-94). Here, Allah said that Hariin said, Ms yflScJ l\ jJ\$} i"0 son of my mother! Indeed the people judged me weak and were about to kill me, so make not the enemies rejoice over me, nor put me among the people who are wrongdoers. } Harun said, T)o not place me on the same level as they are, as if I was one of them. Further, Harun said, O son of my mother , so that MQsa would feel more mercy and leniency towards him, even though Harun was also the son of Musa s father. When Musa was satisfied that his brother was innocent, I j ojj it yk Jb ot -&j} 4And Harun indeed had said to them beforehand: O my people! You are being tried in this, and verily, your Lord is (Allah) the Most Gracious, so follow me and obey my order."} [20:90], this is when, iti} 4he said} Musa, 4"0 my Lord! Forgive me and my brother, and admit us into Your mercy, for you are the Most Merciful of those who show mercy. } Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Ibn Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah sg said, jJU ojJ \jZt jl Jpj 3* lj>. (Uo Lib Cl\l jii aMay Allah grant His mercy to Musa! Surely, he who observes [something] is nothing like he who is informed about it. His Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, told him that his people

168 Tafstr Ibn Kathir were tested after him, but he did not throw the Tablets. Wlten he saw them with his eyes, then he threw the TabletsV 4 (i+jj oi v-i* bi* 4J' 6^ UjJo >* ii&j Uj1(ijili 'jj> Lji>- "cjjjtj 4252. Certainly, those who took the calf (for worship), wrath from their Lord and humiliation will come upon them in tire life of this world. Thus do We recompense those who invent lies.} il53. But those who

committed evil deeds and then repented afterwards and believed, verily, your Lord after (all) that is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The wrath mentioned here that struck the Children of Israel because of their worshipping the calf, means, Allah did not accept their repentance until some of them (who did not worship the calf) killed others [who worshipped the calf]. We mentioned this story in Surat Al-Baqarah, ji ft iep% -pti it %) ii-S 4So turn in repentance to your Creator and kill yourselves (the guilty), that will be better for you before your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance. Truly, He is the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.} [2:54] As for the humiliation mentioned in the Ayah, it pertains to the disgrace and humiliation that the Jews suffered in the life of this world. Allah's statement, iThus do We recompense those who invent lies} is for all those who invent an innovation (in religion). Surely, the disgrace resulting from inventing an innovation (in religion) and defying Allah's Message, will be placed in the heart and from there on to the shoulders. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said; The disgrace of innovation will weigh on their shoulders even if m Ibn Majah 2:380.

Al-A'rdf (152 - 153) (Part-9) they were to gallop on their mules or trot on their work horses. Ayyub As-Sakhtiyani narrated from Abu Qilabah Al- Jarmi that he commented on this Ayah, iThus do We recompense those who invent lies.} By Allah! This Ayah is for all those who invent a lie, until the Day of Resurrection. * Also, Sufyan bin Uyaynah said, Every person who invents a Bid'ah (innovation in the religion) will taste disgrace. * Allah tells His servants that He accepts repentance from His servants for any sin, even Shirk, Kufr, hypocrisy and disobedience. Allah said: i&j \Vpo lj> 2 11 ijU jMj} iBut those who committed evil deeds and then repented afterwards and believed, verily, your Lord} OMuhammad, Messenger of Repentance and Prophet of Mercy, 'ft iafter that} after committing that evil action, iis indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Ibn Abi Hatim reported that Abdullah bin Mas'ud was asked about a man committing fornication with a woman and then marrying her, and Ibn Mas'ud recited this Ayah, #2 h&h U W 4ft iBut tlwse who committed evil deeds and then repented afterwards and believed, verily, your Lord after (all) that is indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Abdullah recited this Ayah ten times, neither allowing nor disallowing it. & A 4i \$ c!^' 4-3 Jabari 13:135. ' At-Tabari 13:136. * Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 3:566.

i d?18'i&g w* staiSB \sn il54. And when the -* lc-Jls*sb^JUk y*-v". *A'< Aw'***> '\< c ->. - ' bv-^b"JL^Ct> _ a*^-- ||l - ^Jy^-=aHl JLjifj -^ 'Ajl ^ ^ ^ ^ ""ft/ >*/?' > ^ iAnd when calmed and subsided, .Ji "ff ^yy &} 4the anger of Musa with his people, iffi\ '&} 4he took up the Tablets}, which he had thrown out of jealousy for Allah and anger for His sake, because of his people worshipping the calf, A'oyfs. ftp, r* UM- ***" <&> i}} anger of Musa calmed, he took up the Tablets; and in their inscription was guidance and mercy \for those who fear their Lord.} Musa picked up the Tablets when His Anger subsided Allah said next, 4>^/- &j} }and in their inscription was guidance and mercyfor those who fear their Lord.} Several scholars of Tafsir said that when Musa threw the Tablets on the ground they were shattered and he collected the pieces afterwards. Musa found in its inscription guidance and mercy, but the specific details of the Law was lost, so they said. They also claimed that the shattered pieces of the Tablets still remained in the treasury safes of some Israelite kings until the Islamic State came into existence. Only Allah knows if these statements are true.

Al-A'raf (155 - 156) (Part-9) 3 cfj& n SsU *:; tf *_ *S2^ -I&i.t Ji4% Q% 4 fl 3"t"* #SfcSK 5- Q^ ;^& J* " a* v'l ^ J p* Cfe^b -iyjjj JyLl V . And Musa chose out of his people seventy (of the best) men for Our

appointed time and place of meeting, and when they were seized with a violent earthquake, he said: "O my Lord, if it had been Your Will, You could have destroyed them and me before; would You destroy us far the deeds of the foolish among us? It is only Your trial by which You lead astray whom You will, and keep guided whom You will. You are our protector, so forgive us and have mercy on us : far You are the best of those who forgive il56. "And ordain far us good in this world, and in the Hereafter. Certainly we have Hudna unto You." He said: (As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain far those who have Taqwd, and give Zakdh ; and those who believe in Our Ayat.} Seventy Men from the Children of Israel go for the appointed Meeting Place that Allah designated, Allah later on destroys Them Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented; Allah commanded MOsa to choose seventy men. So he chose them and proceeded with them in order that they supplicate to their Lord. Their supplication included asking Allah, O Allah! Give us what you have never given anyone before us and will never give anyone after us! Allah disliked this supplication and they were seized with a violent earthquake, Musa said: Ji* o; 5# i"0 my Lord, if it had been Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before. At-Tabari 13:141.

As-Suddi said, Allah commanded Musa to come with thirty men from the Children of Israel, apologizing for worshipping the calf; and He gave them an appointed time and place. iAnd Miisa chose out of his people seventy (of the best) men .} He chose these men and went along with them so that they could apologize. When they reached the appointed place, they said, 4We shall never believe in you}, [2:55] O Musa, 4 J-i* Jj iuntil we see Allah plainly,} for you spoke to Him, they said, therefore, show Him to us, ibut they were struck with a bolt of lightning [4:153] and they died. Musa stood up crying, invoking Allah, O Lord! What should I tell the Children of Israel, when I go back to them after You destroyed their best men? 4"0 my Lord, if it had been Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before Muhammad bin Ishaq said, Musa chose seventy of the best men from the Children of Israel. He said to them, Go to the meeting with Allah and repent for what you committed. Beg His forgiveness for those of your people whom you left behind. Fast, purify yourselves and clean your clothes. So, he went with them to Mount Tur in Sinai for the meeting place and time designated by his Lord. He went there only with the leave and knowledge of Allah. According to what has been mentioned to me, when the seventy did what he ordered them to do, and went with him to the meeting of Musa with his Lord, they said, Request that we may also hear the words of m At-Tabari 13:140.

Al-A'rdf (155 - 156) (Part-9)_ our Lord. So he replied, I shall. When Musa approached the mountain it became completely covered with columns of clouds, Musa approached it and entered in them. He said to the people, Approach. But when Allah spoke to Musa, his cloak was surrounded by a brilliant light which no human could bear to look at, so below him a barrier was placed and the people approached. When they entered the cloud they fell prostrate and they heard Him while he was speaking to Musa, commanding him and forbidding him, saying what to do and what not to do. When He completed commanding him, and removed the cloud from Musa, he faced the people and they said, O Musa! We will not believe in you unless we see Allah directly. So the thunder shook them, their souls were captured and they all died. Musa stood up invoking, begging and supplicating to his Lord, i"0 my Lord, if it had beat Your will. You could have destroyed them and me before.'V' 1 meaning, They were foolish. Would You destroy anyone who comes after me from the Children of Israel? Ibn Abbas,

Qatadah, Mujahid and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari said, They were seized by the tremor or lightning, because they neither shunned nor forbade their people who worshipped the calf. 121 This is supported by Musa's statement, 4 'would You destroy us for the deeds of the fools among hs?'"\$ He said next, yj, j i It is only Your Fitnah affliction, test and trial, according to Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ar-Rabi bin Anas and several among the Salaf and latter scholars. 13 ' This is the only plausible meaning, in which Musa says, The decision is Yours (O Allah), and the judgment, and whatever You willTabari 13:140.Tabari 13:143-144. ,31 At-Tabari 13:151.

occurs. You misguidewhom You will, guidewhom You will, andnone can guide whom You misguide or misguide whom You guide. There is none who can give what You deprive or avert what You give. The sovereignty is all Yours, and Yours is the judgment, the creation and the decision. The Ayah, 4"You are our protector, so forgive us and have mercy on us: for You are the best of those whoforgive.'y, pertains to (Allah s) covering the mistake and not punishing for the sin. Whenever mercy is mentioned along with forgiveness [such as in Musa's supplication to Allah], it includes the hope that Allah does not permit one to fall into that act again. i'for You are the best of those who forgive/> for none except You can forgive the sin. UjIi .jci j VJ i"And ordain for us good in this world, and in the Hereafter.'y The first part of Musa's supplication was to fend off what should be avoided, while this part is a request for what is sought. The meaning of, C& 4 Q i"And ordainfor us good in this world, and in the Hereafter '> is, ordain for us and grant us all that is good in both lives. We mentioned the meaning of good before in Surat Al- Baqarahft i"We have Hudna unto You'y we repent, go back and return unto You, according to the meaning of, Hudna. , given by Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Abu Al- Aliyah, Ad-Dahhak, Ibrahim At-Taymi, As-Suddi, Qatadah and several others. ** See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah [2 : 200-202]. At-Tabari 13:154-155.

Al-A'rdf(155 - 156) (Part-9) 'i i oy/i uM, J 4. r 4He said : (As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those who have Taqwa, and give Zakah ; and those who believe in Our Aycity (7:156) Allah's Mercy is for ThoseWho have Taqwa and believe in Allah's Ayatand His Messenger sgj Allah answers the statement, i&k% ji i'Tt is only Your trial... } (7:155), by saying, 4(As to) My punishment I afflict therewith whom I will and My mercy embraces all things.} Allah says here, 1 do what I will, decide what 1 will and I have wisdom and justice in all matters. Certainly, there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. Allah's statement, iandMy mercy embraces all things testifies to His encompassing mercy. Allah said that the angels who carry His Throne and those around the Throne supplicate, 4"Our Lord! You comprehend all things in mercy and knowledge. } (40:7) Imam

commented (to his Companions), U I pi^ jf Jj,{ lii "Do yoM think that this man is more misguided or his camel? Did you not hear what this man has said? They said, Yes.' He ag said, ZJ-j Jyti ZJ-j iib jL4 j jl UL-lj i4>-j o^k>- AiJi jii li-lJ Ljjjjj 14L. jiijl You (the bedouin man) have restricted a vast mercyl Allah, the Exalted, the most Honored has created a hundred mercies and sent down one of them by which the creation, men, Jinn and animals, show mercy to each other. He left with Him ninety-nine mercies, so do you say that this man is more misguided or his camel?

iki# *_j; p; iHe has prescribed mercyfar Himselfa [6:12] Allah's statement, ifar those who have Taqwa}, means, 1 will ordain My mercy for those who possess these qualities, and they are the Ummah of

Muhammad, Ukt ifar those wlv have Taqwifa, who avoid Shirk and major sins. iand give the Zakah}, purify themselves, according to one opinion. It was also said that, *the Zakah', here pertains to wealth. It is possible that both meanings are included here, for this Ayahwas revealed in Makkah [before Zakah in fixed shares was ordained), iand those who believe in Our Aydt.}, those who have faith in them. j (Uie&& iS/s* is# IS & U/j jS=uli(f -CLtk -& \$ ts ;iif il57. Those who fallow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom they find written of with them in the Tawrah and the Injil, - he commands them to do good; and forbids them from evil; he makes lawful far them the good things, and forbids them from the evil things, he releases them from their heavy burdens and from the fetters that were upon them. So those who believe in him, honor him, help him, and fallow the light which has been sent down with him, it is they ivho will be successful.}

The Description ofthat Messenger ^}H\ oydi hjfy iThose who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom theyfind written with them in the Tawrah and the Injil This is the description of the Prophet Muhammad in the Books of the Prophets. They delivered the good news of his advent to their nations and commanded them to follow him. His descriptions were still apparent in their Books, as the rabbis and the priests well know. Imam

Al-A'rdf (57) (Part-9) from Anas. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Muthanna said that Ata bin Yasar said, I met Abdullah bin 'Amr and asked him, Tell me about the description of Allah s Messenger jg in the Tawrah. He said, Yes, by Allah! He is described in the Tawrah, just as he is described in the Qur an, 40 Prophet! Verily, We have sent you as a witness, and a bearer ofglad tidings, and a warner. [33:45] as a safe refuge for the unlettered ones. You are My servant and Messenger. I have called you Al-Mutawakkil (who trusts in Allah), not hard or harsh. Neither uttering foul speech in the markets nor returning evil deed with one in kind. Rather, he forgives and forgoes. Allah will not end his life until He straightens through him the crooked religion, so that they might proclaim, There is no deity worthy of worship except Allah. He will open through him sealed hearts, deaf ears and blind eyes. Ata then said, I also met Ka*b and asked him the same question, and his answer did not differ from Abdullah s answer, even concerning one letter. ,2)

4 04 you who believe!}, then pay it your full attention, for it is a good that you are being commanded, or an evil that you are being forbidden. And the most important and greatest of these commands and prohibitions, is that Allah has sent the Messenger j to order worshipping Him Alone without partners and forbid worshipping others besides Him. This is the Message that Allah has sent all Messengers with before Muhammad m, just as Allah said, JV > 5 si ji- 4And verily, We have sent among every Utntnah a Messenger (proclaiming): "Worship Allalt, and avoid the Tdghut (false deities)">[16:36]. Allah s statement, 4He makes lawful for them the good things, and forbids them from the evil things,} meaning, he makes the Bahlrah, Sa ibah, Wasllah and Ham, etc., lawful. They were prohibitions that they invented which were only hard for themselves. He also forbids them from evil things, such as the flesh of the pig, Riba, and foods that were treated as lawful although Allah the Exalted had forbidden them. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported this from Ibn Abbas. Allah s statement, 4^&\$ 4He (Muhammad) releases them from their heavy burdetis, and from thefetters that were upon them.} indicates that Muhammad came with leniency and an easy religion. As mentioned in the Hadith recorded from many

routes that Allah's Messenger[^] said. 0/ was sent with the easy way of Hanifiyyah [monotheism]" Jabari 13:166. Ahmad 5:266 and 6:116.

The Prophet ﷺ said to the two Commanders he appointed, Mu'adh and Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari, when he sent them to Yemen, ﷺ said: "Bring glad tidings and do not drive people away, make things easy and do not make them difficult, obey each other and do not differ among yourselves". 111 Abu Barzah Al-Aslami, the Prophet's Companion, said, I accompanied the Messenger of Allah and saw how easy he was. The nations that were before us had things made difficult for them in their laws. Allah made the law encompassing and easy for this Ummah. Hence the statement of the Messenger of Allah, ﷺ said: "Allah has forgiven my Ummah for what occurs in themselves, as long as they do not utter it or act upon

The Prophet ﷺ said, ﷺ said: "My Ummah was forgiven (by Allah) unintentional errors, forgetfulness and what they are forced to do. This is why Allah has guided this Ummah to proclaim, ﷺ said: "Our Lord! Punish us not if we forget or fall into error, our Lord! Lay not on us a burden like that which You did lay on those before us (Jews and Christians); our Lord! Put not on us a burden greater than we have strength to bear. Pardon us and grant us forgiveness. Have mercy on us. You are our Mawla (Patron, Supporter and Protector) and give us victory over the 1,1 Fath Al-Bari 5 :188 Al-Bdn 9:300. 131 Ibn Majah 1 :659

41 am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah,} This Ayah mentions the Prophet's honor and greatness, for he is the Final Prophet who was sent to all mankind [and the Jinns]. Allah said, 4' ' (5j ' ' 3[jrj'j ^ fj rr - *Say, "Allah is Witness between you and 1; this Qur'an has been revealed to me that I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach."} [6:19], 4but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place}[11:17], and, ijiL-t oji yi'S Ja cwi1 4And say to those who were given the Scripture and to the illiterates (Arab pagans) : "Do you (also) submit yourselves (to Allah in Islam)?" If they do, they are rightly guided; but if they turn away, your duty is only to convey the Message.} [3:20] There are many other Ayat and more Hadiths than can be counted on this subject. It is also well-known in our religion that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was sent to all mankind [and the Jinns).

Al-Araf (158 - 159) (Part-9) gives life and causes death.} describes Allah by the words of the Messenger ﷺ that He Who has sent him is the Creator, Lord and King of all things and in His Hand is the control, life, death and the decision. Just as Allah said ﷺ said: "So believe in Allah and His Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write,} Allah proclaims here that Muhammad ﷺ is His Messenger and reiterates this fact by commanding that he be believed in and followed. Allah said, ^} iThe Prophet ﷺ who can neither read nor write} who you were promised and given the good news of in previous revealed books. Certainly, Muhammad was amply described in the previous books, including his description as being the unlettered Prophet. Allah's statement, iwho believes in Allah and His Words}, means, his actions conform with his words and he believes in what he was given from his Lord. iAnd follow him}, embrace his path and guidance, so that you may be guided} to the Straight Path. ftJ cA & 2ry jiA 4259 . And of the people of Musa there is a community who lead (the men) with truth and establish justice therewith.} Allah stated that of the Children of Israel there are some who follow the truth and judge by it, just as He said in another Ayah,

People of the Scripture, those who believe in Allah and in that which has been revealed to you, and in that which has been revealed to them, humbling themselves before Allah. They do not sell the verses of Allah for a small price, for them is a reward with their Lord. Surely, Allah is Swift in account.} [3:199] jilt lix ijlli ^c- liji 'yflofS. ti f* Oi *i/ i&< ^ tip oj iTfwse to whom We gave the Scripture before it, they believe in it (the Qur'an). And when it is recited to them, they say: "We believe in it. Verily, it is the truth from our Lord. Indeed even before it we have been from those who submit themselves. These will be given their reward twice over, because they are patient.}[28:52-54], and,

jliiSi C> ij-^t 'jj. "Jj j; | CfJ 4 " \$ > " lyf^yU.J > **> 6^ iVerily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it (this Qur'an) is recited to them, fall down on their faces in humble prostration. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled. And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.}[7:107-109] L IX zfy& bl ^ Gili; o?GI^^ ii. 5 o. ajJUS 3 p# qsf e ^ Scg8f sii^ # Ji Hj c&j Mii J&j :4 4,d" LIL* tj& jj Sg 4 ^ . And We divided them into twelve tribes (as distinct) nations. We revealed to Musa when his people asked him for water (saying): "Strike the stone with your stick, and there gushed forth out of it twelve springs, each group knew its own place for water. We shaded them with the clouds and sent down upon them the manna and the quail (saying) : "Eat of the good things with which We have provided you." They harmed Us not but they used to harm themselves. 4161. And (remember) when it was said to them : "Dwell in this toion (Jerusalem) and eat therefrom wherever you wish, and say, (O Allah) forgive our sins ; and enter the gate prostrating (bowing with humility). We shall forgive you your wrongdoings. We shall increase (the reward) for the good- doers . " } 4162. But those among them who did wrong, changed the word that had been told to them. So We sent on them a torment from the heaven in return for their wrongdoings.}

We discussed these Ayat in Surat Al-Baqarah which was revealed in Al-Madlnah, while these Ayat were revealed in Makkah. We also mentioned the difference between the two narrations, and thus we do not need to repeat it here, all thanks are due to Allah and all the favors are from Him. H vli' 4 O'?*- if p } > f. JW * I / " .f / fJt IL> 4163. And ask them about the town that was by the sea; when they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath : when their fish came to them openly on the Sabbath day, and did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath . Thus We made a trial for them, for they used to rebel against Allah's command. The Jews transgress the Sanctity of the Sabbath This Ayah explains Allah's statement, 4^1*.-!' 4 ojj' JiLlt 4 And indeed you knew those among you who transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath..} {2:65} Allah says to His Prophet sg here. 4 And ask them} ask the Jews who are with you, about the story of their fellow Jews who defied Allah's command, so that His punishment overtook them all of a sudden for their evil actions, transgression and defiance by way of deceit. Also, warn the Jews (O Muhammad) against hiding your description that they find in their books, so that they do not suffer what their forefathers suffered. The village mentioned here is Aylah, on the shore of the Qulzum (Red) Sea. Muhammad bin Ishaq recorded from Ddwud bin Al-Husayn from Ikrimah that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, if (^) 4 And ask them about the town that was by the sea...} I 1 See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah [2 :60)

A village called Aylah between Madyan and At-Tur (which is in Sinai). 111 Ikrimah, Mujahid, Qatadah and As-Suddi said similarly.12 ' Allah's statement, iwhett they transgressed in the matter of the Sabbath;} means, they transgressed in the Sabbath and defied Allah's command to them to keep it

sanctified, " }y. iwhen theirfish came to them openly on the Sabbath day,} visible on top of the water, according to Ad-Dahhak who reported it from Ibn Abbas.'3 ' Ibn Jarir said, Allah s statement, .41' ie > . V iand did not come to them on the day they had no Sabbath. Thus We made a trial ofthem,} means, this is how We tested them by making the fish swim close to the surface of the water , on the day which they were prohibited to fish. The fish would be hidden from them on the day when they were allowed to fish, ii)& =*} iThus We made a trialfor them,} so thatWe test them. i&Z V , } ifor they used to rebel against Allah's command} by defying His obedience and rebelling against it. [4) Therefore, these were a people who used a trick to violate Allah s prohibitions, taking an action that seemed legal on the surface. However, in reality, this action was meant to transgress the prohibition. Imam and scholar Abu Abdullah Ibn Battah reported that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah \$5 said, ITabari 13:180. ' At-Tabari 13:180-181.Tabari 13:183. '41 At-Tabari 13:183.

Mm* wr asaip ^ o (4|vrt^Si |v| < V". " -"i< i-";c tf 3^Z* >-o}jiAyp^iU#Ai^l^U^ctj^uu^ ' ./ ':f " < . . ' ' "s; \ ' 's' \':x O4 ' ^sj-; i>*~!<%>'-'J OJJ(nHJ #;<' "f fT"T< *i -" *m>\ " \'.<.\' a.l^-, , , Uo 0>*y;f*-fruu v_)U.t..~l >_> - >.>" ' ^'" c VI" ^TK "t ' ' <> ^" * * fr S' m \y .s iAS^S Ijii i oJ5ji U l^s5> v" 4)1 ^jL>"-4 ljJL g*j| "Do not repeat what the Jews committed, and violate Allah's prohibitions using deceitful tricks This Hadith has a reasonable chain. & p i iil & } 0 ^ ji ^ sjoJ^ ijllj IjbJS c ys c\$ ivuiSjii; 4% ^ b& Cii ^(&4 !j& k 1j ^ ^ \y^ llj j-Cj ^jiJUi if wf*V* > !ir ^ * \jr*^ t# p. us is 4 ""ii' 1 4264. Aw/ when a community among them said: "Why do you preach to a people whom AllOh is about to destroy or to punish ivith a severe torment? (The preachers) said: "In order to be free from guilt before your Lord (Allah), and perhaps they may fear Allah."} 4265. So when they forgot the reminder that had been given to them, We rescued those who forbade evil, but with a severe torment We seized those who did wrong, because they used to rebel against Allah s command.} 4166. So when they exceeded the limits of what they were prohibited, We said to them: Be you monkeys, despised. } * J * Adab Az-Zafafp. 192.

Al-A'raf (164 - 166) (Part-9) Those Who breached the Sabbath were turned into Monkeys, but Those Who prohibited Their Actions were saved Allah said that the people of this village were divided into three groups, a group that committed the prohibition, catching fish on the Sabbath, as we described in the Tafsir of Surat Al- Baqarah.' 1| Another group prohibited them from transgression and avoided them. A third group neither prohibited them, nor participated in their action. The third group said to the preachers, 4"Why do you preach to a people whom Allah is about to destroy or to punish with a severe torment?"}. They said, why do you forbid these people from evil, when you know that they are destroyed and have earned Allah s punishment? Therefore, they said, there is no benefit in forbidding them. The preachers replied, 4# ell i "In order to befreefrom guilt before your Lord (Allah),"} forwe were commanded to enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, i and perhaps they may fear Allah"} for on account of our advice, they might stop this evil and repent to Allah. Certainly, if they repent to Allah, Allah will accept their repentance and grant them His mercy. Allah said, }So when they forgot the reminder that had been given to them,} when the evil doers refused the advice, i\& G i\ %} iWe rescued those who forbade evil, but We seized who did wrong,} l 1 * See the Tafsir of Surat Al-Baqarah [2 : 65-66)

192 Tafsir Ibn Kathir who committed the transgression, (with a severe torment). Allah stated that those who enjoined good were saved, while those who committed the transgression were destroyed, but He did not mention the end of those who were passive (the third group), for the compensation is comparable to the deed. This type did not do what would warrant praise, nor commit wrong so that they are admonished. Ikrimah said, Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah: 1 do not know whether or not the people were saved who said; i.e. by jU 4 "Why do you preach to a people whom Allah is about to destroy...?) So I continued discussing it with him until I convinced him that they were. Then he gave me [the gift of] a garment. 111 Allah said, and We seized those who did wrong with a Ba's torment) indicating that those who remained were saved. As for Bats , it means severe , according to Mujahid, 121 or painful , according to Qatadah.131 These meanings are synonymous, and Allah knows best. Allah said next, 4fr^l) despised), humiliated, disgraced and rejected. ? I 1 > -> > *' 4167. And (remember) when your Lord declared that He would certainly keep on sending against them, till the Day of Resurrection, those who would afflict them with a humiliating At-Tabari 13:187. At-Tabari 13:202. At-Tabari 13:202.

Al-A'rdf(164 - 167) (Part-9) torment. Verily, your Lord is quick in retribution and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) Eternal Humiliation placed on the Jews 4Ta'dhdhana} means declared , according to Mujahid, or ordained , according to others. This part of the Ayah indicates a vow, 4that He will keep on sending against them} against the Jews, 4till the Day of Resurrection, those who would afflict them with a humiliating torment.} on account of their disobedience, defying Allah's orders and Law and using tricks to transgress the prohibitions. It was reported that Musa required the Jews to pay the production tax for seven or thirteen years, and he was the first to do so. Also, the Jews fell under the humiliating rule of the Greek Kushdanln , 1 1 Chaldeans and later on the Christians, who subjugated and disgraced them, and required them to pay the Jizyah (tribute tax). When Islam came and Muhammad was sent, they became under his power and had to pay the Jizyah, as well. Therefore, the humiliating torment mentioned here includes disgrace and paying the Jizyah, as Al- Awfi narrated from Ibn Abbas . 121 In the future, the Jews will support the Dajjal (False Messiah); and the Muslims, along with Isa, son of Mary, will kill the Jews. This will occur just before the end of this world. Allah said next, 4Verily, your Lord is quick in retribution}, with those who disobey Him and defy His Law, 4JU: 3A2 %~} 111 Perhaps it refers to the Kushite Dynasty, and Allah knows best. Tabari 13:205.

and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.) for those who repent and go back to Him. This Ayah mentions both the mercy, as well as, the punishment, so that no despair is felt. Allah often mentions encouragement and warning together, so that hearts always have a sense of hope and fear. 1 JS5 *Ut& 3? ftji i'flkok ofj \$31 OjiL ! ">^ff JtiifJ ! _ C jij . And We have broken them (the Jezos) up into various separate groups on the earth : some of them are righteous and some are away from that. And We tried them with good (blessings) and evil (calamities) in order that they might turn (to Allah.) il69. Then after them succeeded an (evil) generation, which inherited the Book, but they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life saying: "(Everything) will be forgiven to us." And if (agabi) the offer of the like (evil pleasures of this world) came their way, they would (again) seize them (would commit those sins). Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth? And they have studied what is in it (the Book). And the home in the Hereafter is better for those who have Taqia. Do not you then understand?) 4170. And as to those who hold fast to the Book (act on its teachings) and perform the Salah, certainly We shall never waste the

reward of those who do righteous deeds.) The Children of Israel scatter throughout the Land Allah states that He divided the Jews into various nations, sects and groups, *jiytf Si &>*) 4And We said to the Children of Israel after him (after Musa

Al-A'raf (168 - 170) (Part-9) died): "Divell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as a mixed crowd (gathered out of various nations) . }[17:104] 4some of them are righteous and some are away from that}, some of them are led aright and some are not righteous, just as the Jinns declared, 4 !^4 OJi it* \$j} 4 There are among us some that are righteous, and some the contrary; we are groups having different ways (religious sects). } [72:1 1] Allah said here, iAnd We tried them}, and tested them, iwith good and evil}, with times of ease, difficulty, eagerness, fear, well-being and affliction, 4in order that they might turn (to Allah)} Allah said next, 'ji d*i/- yf} wiii- OJ iThen after them succeeded an (evil) generation, which inherited the Book, but they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life} This Ayah means, after the generation made up of righteous and unrighteous people, another generation came that did not have goodness in them, and they inherited the Tawrah and studied it. Mujahid commented on Allah's statement, {They chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life} They will consume anything they can consume in this life, whether legally or illegally. Yet, they wish for forgiveness,

196 Tafstr Ibn Kathir t fi-t ij- oiy U oyyyr iSaying: "(Everything,) will be forgiven for us. And if (again) the offer of the like came their way, they would (again) seize them.y] Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, ia h'i Jv- 'oy Xf they chose (for themselves) the goods of this low life" This, by Allah, is an evil generation, <^& %> iwhich inherited the Booty after their Prophets and Messengers, for they were entrusted with this job by Allah's command to them. Allah said in another Ayah, iThen, there has succeeded them a posterity who neglect the Salah (the prayers) .} [19:59] Allah said next, 1 " /> >// oyyb) oj-ii-Uy iThey chose the goods of this low life saying: "(Everything) will be forgiven to us."} They wish and hope from Allah, while deceiving themselves, iAnd if (again) the offer of the like came their way, they would (again) seize them.} Nothing stops them from this behavior, for whenever they are given an opportunity in this life, they will consume regardless of it being allowed or not. |2! As-Suddi said about Allah's statement, iThen after them succeeded an (evil) generation} until. m At-Tabari 13:212. At-Tabari 13:213.

Al-A'raf (168 - 170) (Part-9) 4and they have studied what is in it (the Book).} Every time the Children of Israel appointed a judge, he used to take bribes. The best ones among them held a counsel and took covenants from each that they would not take bribes. However, when one of them would take bribes in return for judgment and was asked, What is the matter with you; you take a bribe to grant judgment? , he replied, 1 will be forgiven. So the rest of his people would admonish him for what he did. But when he died, or was replaced, the one who replaced him would take bribes too. Therefore, Allah says, if the others (who admonished him) would have a chance to loot this world, they will take it. * Allah said, i&\ ^U \)X * \$} 4Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth?} thus, admonishing them for this behavior. Allah took a pledge from them that they would declare the truth to people and not hide it. Allah said in another Ayah, ifSe, y; oM 'yj* jM & & '>& i(And remember) when Allah took a covenant from those who were given the Scripture to make it known and clear to mankind, and not to hide it, but they threw it away behind their backs, and

purchased with it some miserable gain! And indeed worst is that which they bought} (3:187). Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah, yjU 'J cJ U. \$} 4Was not the covenant of the Book taken from them that they would not say about Allah anything but the truth?}, Their claim that Allah will forgive the sins they keep committing without repenting from them. ' Allah said, Tabari 13:213. * At-Tabari 13:215.

^Li i jOj iAnd the home in the Hereafter is better for those who have Taqwd Do not you then understand?} Encouraging them to seek Allah s tremendous reward and warning them against His severe torment. Allah says here, My reward and what I have are better for those who avoid prohibitions, abandon lusts and become active in the obedience of their Lord. iDo not you then understand?} Allah says Do not these people, who preferred this life instead of what is with Me, have any sense to prohibit them from their foolish and extravagant ways? Allah then praises those who adhere to His Book, which directs them to follow His Messenger Muhammad jg, iAnd as to those who holdfast to the Book} adhere to it, implement its commands and refrain from its prohibitions, }and perform the Saldh, certainly We shall never waste the reward of those who do righteous deeds.} ^ tiam&i wr ^ -**' 'S ^ ly jL.ajlj.fe&lsj 1 yiff

Al-A rdf (171) (Part-9) ip il71. And (remember) when We hlataqna the mountain over them as if it had been a canopy, and they thought that it was going to fall on them (We said) : "Hold firmly to what We have given you [the Tawrdh], and remember that which is therein (act on its commandments) , so that you may fear Allah and obey Him."} Raising Mount Tur over the Jews, because of Their Rebellion Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, iAnd (remember) when We Nataqna the tmountain over them}, We raised the mountain, as Allah s other statement testifies, iAnd for their covenant, We raised over them the mountain} (4:154). 111 Also, Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that Al-A mash said that. Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, The angels raised the Mount over their heads, as reiterated by Allah s statement, i'jA iWe raised over them the mountain} (4:154). Al-Qasim bin Abi Ayyub narrated that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said, MQsa later on proceeded with them to the Sacred Land. He took along the Tablets, after his anger subsided, and commanded them to adhere to the orders that Allah ordained to be delivered to them. But these orders became heavy on them and they did not want to implement them until Allah raised the mountain over them, Tabari 13:218.

20 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir ias if it had been a canopy}, that is, when the angels raised the mountain over their heads.

The meaning of this Ayah is, "Dedicate yourself to the natural

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2071–2120]

religion of Allah which He made for humanity."

jjy -u oljjli iOjiaAJl jJjj J|5 * ^Lp"i>- 1^6 j^w l_*_*kJ>- "Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, it is only his parents who turn him into a Jew, a Christian or a Zoroastrian. Just as animals are bom having full bodies, do you see any of them having a cutoffnose (when they are bom)* . [11

ij! jA A f> ~.' ^ ^I" -laij-j pi iji>- UJ B pi p Jr Csi^j i >'~^[J* j** J*>-3 (*r U f4~! ^rj ii'3* '3-Ljji "Vya : Jli ?*Vp> i ' J Jli; 3il^ ^Slt _^>-I (J^j !-L& ! JI3 ?lJLa i_jj ^l :JU aIIic- j '~aj jjj v^j ^ji :JU -

Jli ?"p O-bb- jj vjj : Jli jbb Cr? (Tip j' : Jli o3"Jl dL> oSli- pi 3^- llli ,lr? o o oJL pi jl"J : Jli VsJVi Ji2l lfk"j p ji : Jli i^ . j_jp3' t?^ , * *? ; ;| r : >-r . t - - " ;"? , . : J-7 :- "OjJ OJk fj Ja^j OjJ C__^ (Ol "W/icii A// fl/? created Adam, He wiped Adam's back and every person that He luill create from him until the Day of Resurrection fell out from his back. Allah placed a glimmering light between the eyes of each one of them. Allah showed them to Adam and Adam asked, O Lord! Who are they?' Allah said, These are your offspring. Adam saw a man from among them whose light he liked. He asked, O Lord! Wlw is this man?' Allah said, 'This is a man from the latter generations of your offspring. His name is Ddwud.' Adam said, 'O Lord! How many years would he live?' Allah said, Sixty years.' Adam said, O Lord! I have forfeited forty years from my life for hint.' When Adam's life came to an end, the angel of death came to him (to take his soul). Adam said, 7 still have forty years from my life term, don't I?' He said, Have you not given it to your son Ddwud?' So Adam denied that and his offspring followed suit (denying Allah's covenant), Adam forgot and his offspring forgot, Adam made a mistake and his offspring made mistakes ."

Al-A'rdf (172 - 174) (Part-9) and separated between the inhabitants of Paradise and those of the Fire. Allah then said, ^ if 4 made 1/jem testify as to themselves (saying): "Am I not your Lord? They said: "Yes!"} Therefore, Allah made them testify with themselves by circumstance and words. Testimony is sometimes given in words, such as, if txji iThey will say: "We bear witness against ourselves."} [6:130] At other times, testimony is given by the people themselves, such as Allah s statement, (*\$4 if J of 4/1 is not for the Mushrikin, (polytheists) to maintain the mosques of Allah, while they testify against their own selves of disbelief.) [9:17] This Ayah means that their disbelief testifies against them, not that they actually testify against themselves here. Another Ayah of this type is Allah s statement. 4And to that he bears witness (by his deeds).\$ [100:7] The same is the case with asking, sometimes takes the form of words and sometimes a situation or circumstance. For instance, Allah said, iAnd He gave you of all that you asked for.} [14:34] Allah said here, ilest you should say}, on the Day of Resurrection 4ui if- i==> iwe were of this} of Tawhid

Al-A'raf(175 - 177) (Part-9) said, He is Sayfi, son of Ar-Rahib. Qatadah commented that Ka*b said, He was a man from Al-Balqla (a province of Jordan) who knew Allah s Greatest Name. He used to live in Bayt Al-Maqdis with the tyrants. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, He is BaTam bin Ba'ura , a man from Yemen whom Allah had given the knowledge of His Ayat, but he abandoned them. Malik bin Dinar said, He was one of the scholars of the Children of Israel whose supplication was acceptable. They used to seek his lead in suplication in times of difficulty. Allah s Prophet Musa sent him to the King of Madyan to call him to Allah. That king appeased him and gave him land and gifts, and he reverted from the religion of Musa and followed the king s religion. Imran bin TJyaynah narrated that Husayn said that Imran bin Al-Harith said that Ibn Abbas said, He is BaTam son of Ba ura . ,2, Similar was said by Mujahid and IkrimahJ3 Therefore, it is well-known that this honorable Ayah was revealed about a man from the Children of Israel in ancient times, according to Ibn MasTid and several others among the Salaf. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, He is a man from the city of the tyrants (Jerusalem) whose name was BaTam and who knew Allah s Greatest Name. 151 Ali bin Abi Talhah also reported that Ibn Abbas that he said, When Musa and those with him went to the city of the tyrants (Jerusalem), the cousins of BaTam and his people came to him and said, Musa is a strong man, and he has many soldiers. If he gains the upper hand over us, we will be destroyed. Therefore,

supplicate to Allah that He prevents Musa and those with him from prevailing over us. BaTam said, If I supplicate to Allah that He turns back Musa and those with him, I will lose in this life and the Hereafter. They kept luring him until he supplicated against Musa and his people, and Allah took away what he bestowed on him (of knowledge). Hence Allah's statement, At-Tabari 13:261. At-Tabari 13:253. At-Tabari 13:254. ' At-Tabari 13:253 ,s| At-Tabari 13:258.

206 Tahir Ibtī Kathīr L4L Ql&} he threw them away; so Shayṭān followed him up} ll] Allah said next, ḡs ja t i-s? 12 4And had We willed, We would surely have elevated him therewith but he clung to the earth and followed his own vain desires. Allah said, 124 jjj^> iAnd had We willed, We would surely have elevated him therewith} from the filth of this earthly life through the Āyat that We gave him knowledge of, iBut he clung to the earth}, he became interested in the adornment of this life and its delights. He indulged in the lusts of life and its joys and was deceived by it, just as life deceived others like him, without sound comprehension or a good mind. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar narrated from Salīm, from Abu An-Nadr that when Musa entered the land of Bani Canaan in the area of Ash-Sham (Greater Syria), the people of Bal'am came to him, saying, This is Musa, son of Imran with the Children of Israel. He wants to drive us out from our land, kill us and replace us with the Children of Israel. We are your people and have no other dwelling area. You are a person whose supplication is acceptable (to Allah), so go out and supplicate to Allah against them. He said, Woe to you! Here is Allah's Prophet (Musa) with whom the angels and believers are! How can I supplicate against them when I know from Allah what I know? They said, We have no other dwelling area. So they kept luring and begging him until he was tempted by the trial and went on his donkey towards Mount Ḥusban, which was behind the Israelite military barracks. When he proceeded At-Tabari 13:260.

Al-A'raf(175 - 177) (Part-9) on the Mount for a while, the donkey sat down and refused to proceed. He got off the donkey and struck it until it stood up again and he rode it. The donkey did the same after a little while, and he struck it again until it stood up... So he proceeded and tried to supplicate against Musa and his people. However, Allah made his tongue mention his people with evil and the Children of Israel with good instead of his people, who protested, O Bal'am! What are you doing? You are supplicating for them and against us! He said, It is against my will. This is a matter that Allah has decided. He then said to them, as his tongue was made to loll out of his mouth, Now I have lost this life and the Hereafter. This Āyah was revealed about the story of BaTam son of BaTira 4 jiliu ilyX zsM b iAnd recite to them the story of him to whom We gave Our Āyat, but he threw them away .} , until. iPerhaps they may reflect. Allah said next, iSo his parable is the parable of a dog : if you drive him away, he pants, or if you leave him alone, he (still) pants.} Scholars of Tafsir have conflicting opinions regarding the meaning of this Āyah. Some scholars said that it refers to the end of Bal'am's tongue which flickered out of his mouth, as in the story narrated from Ibn Ishaq, from Salīm, from Abu An-Nadr. Therefore, his example is the example of the dog, its tongue pants regardless of whether it is driven away or not. It was also said that the meaning here is a parable of this man - and his like - concerning their misguidance, persisting the wrong path and not being able to benefit from faith or comprehend what they are being called to. So his example is that of a dog which pants whether it was driven away or left alone. The person described here does not benefit from the m At-Tabari 13:265.

Al-A'rdf(177 - 178) (Part-9) commanded them to follow him. Therefore, whoever among them defies the knowledge in their Books or hides it from the servants, Allah will place disgrace on him in this life, followed by humiliation in the Hereafter. Allah said, 4&4L Ijllr o=gSt iEvil is the parable of the people who rejected Our Ayat> Allah says, evil is the example of the people who deny Our Ayat in that they are equated with dogs that have no interest but to collect food and satisfy lusts. Therefore, whoever goes out of the area of knowledge and guidance, and seeks satisfaction for his lusts and vain desires, is just like a dog; what an evil example. The Sahth recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg said, iThe evil example is not suitable for us: he who goes back on his gift is just like the dog that eats its vomit. s' 11 Allah s statement, 0&& \jt iand they used to wrong themselves.} means, Allah did not wrong them, but they wronged themselves by rejecting guidance, not obeying the Lord, being content with this life that will soon end, all the while seeking to fulfill desires and obey lusts. 4178. Whomsoever Allah guides, he is the guided one, and whomsoever He sends astray, - then those! They are the losers.} Allah says, whomever He leads aright, then none can lead him to misguidance, and whomever He leads astray, will have acquired failure, loss and sure misguidance. Verily, whatever Allah wills occurs; and whatever He does not will, does not occur. A Hadith narrated from Abdullah bin Mas'ud reads, , >*S , > . ; I, ' .1' w 1 ; 'ti * im JAJ L-iil fjA jiiL 0 0-U j[ji JLf-itj iSl "*" JLi; {/ J ^ Ir Al-Bari 5 :288 .

V .JJ.) 4)1 VI Ul V jl J " ">* l* > y*jj sXs* \ "All praise is due to Allah, Whom we praise and seek help, guidance and forgiveness from We seek refuge with Al- lah from the evils within ourselves and from the burden of our evil deeds. He whom Allah guides, will never be misled and he whom He misguides, will never have one who will guide him. I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah without partners and that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger." The complete Hadith was collected by Imam Ahmad and the collectors of Sunan and others. jr wt &sm5 ujti rj&Vtf&j lj n^^)_j1Jji) 4jj jj *rlrt3* lj VCjAUI Ajojij j^Ja.1 -c- < - > ^ i# ^^ VfJ != ^RoyUiit Jbjjl jSl ^ l' ^vT iblvi T'- il79. And surely. We have created many of the Jinn and mankind for Hell. They have hearts wherewith they understand not, and they have eyes wherewith they see not, and they have ears wherewith they hear not (the truth). They are like cattle, nay even more astray; those! They are the heedless ones.} Ahmad 1:392, Abu Dawud 2:591, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 4:237, An- Nasal 3 :105 and Ibn Majah 1 :609.

Al-A'rdf(179) (Part-9) Disbelief and the Divine Decree Allah said, i'JZi \$7> %;} 4And surely, We have created for Hell> We made a share in the Fire for, . . , many of the Jinn and mankind} We prepared them for it by their performance of the deeds of its people. When Allah intended to create the creation, He knew what their work will be before they existed. He wrote all this in a Book, kept with Him, fifty thousand years before He created the heavens and earth.

them nothing since they used to deny the Ayat> [46:26]. Allah also said about the hypocrites, 4(They are) deaf, dumb, and blind, so they return not (to the right path)} (2: 18), and about the disbelievers, V & ft iffliey are) deaf, dumb and blind. So they do not understand for [2:171] However, they are not deaf, dumb or blind, except relation to the guidance. Allah said; (H"lj fj iii iHad Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even if He had made them listen, they would but have turned away with aversion (to the truth) for [8:23], or*" 4Verily, it is not the eyes that grow blind, but it is the hearts which are in the breasts that grow blind> [22:46], and, 4And whosoever turns away

blindly from the remembrance of the Most Gracious (Allah), We appoint for him Shayṭān to be an intimate companion to him. And verily, they hinder them from the path, but they think that they are guided aright! [43:36-37] Allah's statement, 4J2\$T 4They are like cattle>, means, those who neither hear the truth, nor understand it, nor see the guidance, are just like grazing cattle that do not benefit from these senses, except for what sustains their life in this world. Allah said in a similar Ayah,

jIj V tc Jjj" jllS" the example of those who disbelieve is as that of one who shouts to those who hear nothing but calls and cries .) [2:171] meaning, their example, when they are called to the faith, is the example of cattle that hear only the voice of their shepherd, but cannot understand what he is saying. Allah further described them inay even more astray), than cattle, because cattle still respond to the call of their shepherd, even though they do not understand what he is saying. As for the people described here, they are unlike cattle, which fulfill the purpose and service they were created for. The disbeliever was created to worship Allah alone in Tawḥīd, but he disbelieved in Allah and associated others in His worship. Therefore, those people who obey Allah are more honorable than some angels, while cattle are better than those who disbelieve in Him. So Allah said; iThey are like cattle, nay even more astray; those! They are the heedless ones.) \yr ^ . \$ \j% 21 t&Vi as) 4180. And (all) tlte Most Beautiful Names belong to Allah, so call on Him by them, and leave the company of those who belie His Names. They will be requited for what they used to do.) Allah's Most Beautiful Names Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, jo S^J 4^?^*^ 'yj l o * I A 'jj *jj\ LsA Verily, Allah has ninety-nine Names, a hundred less one; whoever counts (and preserves) them, will enter Paradise. Allah is Witr (One) and loves Al-Witr (the odd numbered things)

224 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Two Sahṥs collected this Hadith.^ We should state that Allah's Names are not restricted to only ninety-nine. For instance, in his Musnad, Imam

Al-A rdf(180 - 181) (Part-9) derived from Allah's Name. 111 Ibn Jurayj narrated from Mujahid that he commented, iand leave the company of those who belie His Names ^ They derived Al-Lat (an idol's name) from Allah, and Al- Uzza (another idol) from Al- Aziz (the All-Mighty). 121 Qatadah stated that Ilhdd refers to associating others with Allah in His Names (such as calling an idol Al-Vzdd)}3^ The word Ilhdd (used in the Ayah in another form) means deviation, wickedness, injustice and straying. The hole in the grave is called Lahd, because it is a hole within a hole, that is turned towards the Qiblah (the direction of the prayer). 4181. And of those whom We have created, there is a community who guides (others) with the truth, and establishes justice therewith. Allah said, 4And of those whom We have created}, in reference to some nations, iiA} 4a community}, that stands in truth, in words and action, iwhoguides (others) with the truth}, they proclaim it and call to it, 4and establishes justice therewith}, adhere to it themselves and judge by it. It was reported that this Ayah refers to the Ummah of Muhammad sg. In the Two SahOis, it is recorded that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Sufyan said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, At-Tabari 13:282.Tabari 13:283.Tabari 13:283.

'jj N J Iji* J* " Jlj V" UILJl py oThere will always be a group of my Ummah who are apparent on the Truth, unabated by those who fail or oppose them, until the (Last) Hour commences ." In another narration, the Messenger gr said, ilJi ji. 4)1 y\$ JU-" *Until Allah's command (the Last Hour) comes while they are still like this ." and in yet another narration, pilli And they will dwell in Ash-Sham (Greater Syria). s oj#\$ V " p&* filT . Those who reject Our Ayat, We shall gradually seize them with

punishment in ways they perceive not.} 4183. And I respite them; certainly My plan is strong.} Allah said, 4%o^i * o; Those who reject Our Ayat, We shall gradually seize them in ways they perceive not} meaning, the doors of provisions will be opened for them and also the means of livelihood, in this life. They will be deceived by all this and think that they are on the correct path. Allah said in another instance, Vyj\ \f>.j ij| jj*. 'j "jw A. ! pi 2* p So, when they forgot (the warning) with which they had been reminded, We opened for them the gates of every (pleasant) thing, until in the midst of their enjoyment in that which they were given, all of a sudden, We took them (in punishment) and lo! They were plunged into destruction with deep regrets m Fath Al-Bari 13:451 and Muslim 3:1524.

and sorrow. So the root of the people who did wrong was cut off. And all the praises and thanks are to Allah, the Lord of all that exists>[6:44-45]. Allah said here, iAnd I respite them} prolong what they are in, i oj) icertainly My plan is strong and perfect. . Do they not reflect? There is no madness in their companion. He is but a plain wamer.} Allah said, 4Do they not reflect?} those who deny Our Ayat, ithere is not in their companion}, Muhammad sg, iU*& imadness Muhammad is not mad, rather, he is truly the Messenger of Allah, calling to Truth, ibut he is a plain wamer}, and this is clear for those who have a mind and a heart by which they understand and comprehend. Allah said in another Ayah, 4And (O people) your companion is not a madman.}[81:22] Allah also said, 1yj* o" \J US} Jif oj* 'J* f 4Say : "I exhort you to one (thing) only, that you stand up for

Allah's sake in pairs and singly, and reflect, there is no madness in your companion . He is only a wamer to you in face of a severe torment."} [34:46] meaning, 1 ask you to stand for Allah in sincerity without stubbornness or bias, iin pairs and singly} [34:46] individuals and in groups, iand reflect [34:46], about this man who brought the Message from Allah, is he mad? Ifyou do this, it will become clear to you that he is the Messenger of Allah in truth and justice. Qatadah bin Di amah said, We were informed that the Prophet of Allah H once was on (Mount) As-Safa and called the Quraysh, subtribe by subtribe, proclaiming, "0 Children of so-and-so, O Children of so-and-so! He warned them against Allah's might and what He has done (such as revengefrom His enemies) Some of them commented, This companion of yours (Prophet Muhammad) is mad; he kept shouting until the morning? Allah sent down this Ayah, 4D0 they not reflect? There is no tnadness in their companion. He is but a plain wamer} [7:184]. Ji Sjs jl fly OJ^ . Do they not look in the dominion of the heavens and the earth and all things that Allah has created; and that it may be that the end of their lives is near. In what message after this will they then believe?}T l)ari 13 :289. This narration is not authentic. Al-BukhSri (nos. 4770 -1) recorded a similar story about the revelation of Ayah 214 of SuratAsh-Shu ar& (26) and SuratAl-Masad (111).

Al-A'rdf(185 - 186) (Part-9) Allah asks, those who denied faith, did they not contemplate about Our Ayat in the kingdom of the heavens and earth and what was created in them? Do they not contemplate about all this and learn lessons from it, so that they are certain that He Who has all this, has no equal or rival? All this was made by He Who Alone deserves the worship and sincere religion, so that they might have faith in Him and believe in His Messenger, all the while turning to Allah s obedience, rejecting any rivals to Him, and rejecting idols. They should be warned that their lives may have reached their end, and they, thus, face their demise while disbelievers, ending up in Allah s torment and severe punishment. Allah said. iltt what message after this will they then believe?> Allah says, what more

warnings, and discouragements should compel them to believe, if the warnings and threats that Muhammad jg brought them from Allah in His Book do not compel them to do so? Allah said next, itf&I 4 lit il86. Wltomsoever Allah sends astray, none can guide him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgressions.> Allah says, those who were destined to be misguided, then none can lead them to guidance, and even if they tiy their best effort to gain such guidance, this will not avail them, iAnd whomsoever Allah wants to put in Fitnah (error, because of his rejecting of Faith, or trial), you can do nothing far him against Allalfy [5:41], and, iSay: "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth, but neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who believe not> [10 :101]. 4 Jjl % rJi v % te oCl # If c&j \$ Zt-jf- <\$> iZ yj y

220 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4 ojtli j&\ 4187. They ask you about the Hour (Day of Resurrection): "When will be its appointed time?" Say: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord (Alone). None can reveal its time but He. Heavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth. It shall not come upon you except all of a sudden." They ask you as if you have a good knowledge of it. Say: "The knowledge thereof is with Allah (Alone), but most of mankind know not."4 The Last Hour and its Portents Allah said here, 4They ask you about the Hour}, just as He said in another Ayah iPeople ask you concerning the Hour} (33:63]. It was said that this Ayah was revealed about the Quraysh or the Jews, although it appears that it was about the Quraysh, because this Ayah was revealed in Makkah. The Quraysh used to ask about the Last Hour, because they used to deny it and discount its coming. For instance, Allah said in another Ayah, 4And they say : "When will be this promise (the torment or the Day ofResurrection), ifyou speak the truth?"} [10:48], and, 0 ip jp: S 3> v pit ip ie\li\ j) 'dj/jCL i/M o\ 4Those who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth. Verily, those who dispute concerning the Hour are certainly in errorjar away} [42:18], Allah said here (that the Quraysh asked), 4V>> '&}

Al-A'rdf(187) (Part-9) i"When will be its appointed time?") in reference to its commencement, according to Ali bin Abi Talhah who reported this from Ibn Abbas.111 They asked about the Hour s appointed term and when the end of this world will begin; is "Im Qf. V Sj l L LiJ \$) iSay: "The knowledge thereof is with my Lord (Alone). None can reveal its time but He.") Allah commanded His Messenger jg that when asked about the appointed term of the Last Hour, he referred its knowledge to Allah, the Exalted. Only Allah knows the Last Hour s appointed term and when it will certainly occur, and none besides Him has this knowledge, ilM 4 iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma mar said that Qatadah commented on this Ayah, i\$\ 4 era) iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth) Its knowledge is heavy on the residents of the heavens and earth, they do not have knowledge in it. 121 Also, Ma'mar said that Al-Hasan commented on this Ayah, When the Last Hour comes, it will be heavy on the residents of the heavens and earth. (3) Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas explained this Ayah, ilM 4 iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth,) saying, All creatures will suffer its heaviness on the Day of Resurrection. Ibn Jurayj also said about this Ayah, iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth.) At-Tabari 13:294. 121 Abdur-Razzaq 2 : 244 131 Abdur-Razzaq 2 :245

When it commences, the heavens will be tom, the stars will scatter all over, the sun will be wound round (thus losing its light), the mountains will be made to pass away and all of which Allah spoke of

will occur. This is the meaning of its burden being heavy. As-Suddi said that, iHeavy is its burden through the heavens and the earth means, its knowledge is hidden in the heavens and earth, and none, not even a close angel or a sent Messenger has knowledge of its appointed timeJ ilt shall not come upon you except all of a sudden> indicating that the Hour will start all of a sudden, while they are unaware. Qatadah said, Allah has decided that, ilt shall not come upon you except all of a sudden. He then said, We were informed that Allah s Prophet jg said, - it, " ! * > "a**JL) o'jri yj, (-*! "The Hour will start (suddenly) for the people while one is mending his watering hole, giving water to his cattle, setting his goods in the market or lowering his scale and raising it (selling and buying

Al-A'rdf (187) (Part-9 j\ >*" jfjh) is-'-Ul <.4J jaj; y>'j UlUl "The Hour will not commence until the sun rises from the west. When it rises (from the west) and the people see it, then, all people will believe. However, this is when faith does not benefit a soul that did not believe beforehand nor earned good in faith. The Hour will (all of a sudden) commence while two men have spread a garment between them, and they will neither have time to conclude the transaction nor to fold the garment. The Hour will commence after a man milked his animal, but he will not have time to drink it. The Hour will start when a man is making his watering hole (for his animals), but will not have time to make use of the pool. And the Hour will commence while a man has raised his hand with a bite to his mouth, but will not eat it ,"[11 Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, iThey ask you as ifyou have good knowledge of it.> As if you have good relations and friendship with them! Ibn Abbas said, When the people (pagans of Quraysh) asked the Prophet about the Last Hour, they did so in a way as if Muhammad was their friend! Allah revealed to him that its knowledge is with Him Alone and He did not inform a close angel or Messenger of it. 121 The correct explanation for this Ayah is, as narrated from Mujahid, through Ibn Abi Najlh, iQZ Iff iThey ask you as ifyou have Hafi of it.f means, as if you had asked about its time and so its knowledge is with you. Allah said, y "jfr 33;& i* Cfc& iSay : "The knowledge thereof is with Allah (Alone), but most |1? Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :360Tabari 13:298.

ofmankind know not."} When Jibril came in the shape of a bedouin man to teach the people matters of their religion, he sat next to the Messenger of Allah sjg asking him as if to learn. Jibril asked the Messenger jg about Islam, then about Iman (faith) then about Ihsan (Excellence in the religion). He asked next, When will the Hour start? Allah s Messenger jg said, oJJlUl^ lp. "He who is asked about it has no more knowledge of it than the questioner ." Therefore, the Prophet jg was saying, 1 have no more knowledge in it than you (O Jibril), nor does anyone have more knowledge in it than anyone else. The Prophet jg then recited the Ayah, jtie Jx* -Jit 5^ iVerily, Allah, with Him (Alone) is the knowledge of the Hour.} [31:34] In another narration, Jibril asked the Prophet about the portents of the Hour, and the Prophet jg mentioned them. The Prophet jgs also said in this narration, "iii Yj Y J? "Five, their knowledge is only with Allah " then recited this Ayah (31:34). In response to the Prophet s answers after each question, Jibril would say, You have said the truth. This made the Companions wonder about this questioner who would ask a question and attest to every answer he was given. When Jibril went away, the Messenger of Allah sg said to the Companions, "77ijs is Jibril, he came to teach you matters ofyour religion ." In yet another narration, the Prophet^ commented, IfJ d'jf. Yj ;JJ~0 * UjB "/ recognized him (Jibril) in every shape he came to me in, except this one. s 11 m Fath Al-Bdri 1 :140.

jf J"-j > t)\ *t* j* <*>' *>' 4! ^ : Jli lijij^ liji tj***j - Jli - j -jU- l^ilJ)| lj :Jj* ^' ^! Lf*~ </ib 'H ij\ ,3-&
 g-3; J43 3 "<^ki* *-^ nkiU kl)Jiiali iQjl ...t * J-X>- ^jA JUj ^>"j kiiJi x : Jli jw : Jli : *y.s* ^! i Jjj*i 'ij ^
 ^ p-&~> J^j > r+ jQ? o- c?3i ')a^ fe-j> iiii Jj4* ^Or1 rt^iJ Cr' Ji u^J^ lS3* Xwj JII >-i'-i jvJ "Ojjl* {J.
 Jjji t#5 j^AjLL^f 3* Jj ***** ^ (*~J.^ JI P ^' ^ l*Uf ^ji: 'tf jyj> J-UJtf fcllJl 1\$ iSiiZ h\\$ \\\ JIJa of "i3tf jf
 ii;W>. ^-u; "During the night of Isrd', I met Ibrahim, Musa and 'Isa. They mentioned the matter of the
 Last Hour, and they asked Ibrahim about it, who said, 'I do not have knowledge of it. They asked Musa
 about it and he said, 'I have no knowledge of it.' They then asked 'Isa about it, and he said, 'As for when
 it will occur, only Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, knows that. My Lord has conveyed to me that
 the Dajjal (False Messiah) will appear, and I will have two staffs (spears) with me. When he sees me, he
 will dissolve just as lead is dissolved. Allah will destroy him when he sees me, and the tree and the
 stone will say, O Muslim! There is a disbeliever under (behind) me, so come and kill him.' Allah will
 destroy them (the Dajjal and his army), and the people will safely go back to their lands and areas.
 Thxereafter, Gog and Magog will appear, and they will be swarming from every mound, sweeping over
 the earth and destroying everything they pass by. Thxey will drink every water source they pass. The
 people will come to me complaining about Gog and Magog and will invoke Allah, the Exalted and
 Most Honored, against them, and Allah will bring death to all of them until the earth rots with their
 stinking odor. Allah will send down rain on them and the rain will carry their corpses,

until it throws them in the sea... My Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored has conveyed to me that when
 this occurs, the Hour will be just like the pregnant women when the term of pregnancy is full, her
 family does not know when she will surprise them and give birth, whether by night or by day.ii111

Sura}i 7. Al-A'rdf (188) (Part-9) 229 1J& sa; u x* a* \$} iSay: The knowledge thereof is with Allah
 (alone), but most of mankind know not."} Si C3Kp JTT jjj& it* {.li&'Tja ^ dp "v ji> ^ \a s> ^ us pt
 4188. Say : "I possess no power over benefit or harm to myself except as Allldlt wills. If I had the
 knowledge of the Ghayb (Unseen), I should have secured for myself an abundance of wealth, and no
 evil should have touched me. I am but a wamer, and a bringer of glad tidings unto people who
 believe."} The Messenger sg does not know the Unseen, and He cannot bring Benefit or Harm even to
 Himself Allah commanded His Prophet jg to entrust all matters to Him and to inform, about himself,
 that he does not know the unseen future, but he knows of it only what Allah informs him. Allah said in
 another Ayah, i:"& *s sr-Uif 4(He Alone is) the All-Knower of the Ghayb (Unseen), and He reveals to
 none His Ghayb.} [72:26] Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said that, 4If I had the knowledge of the
 Ghayb (Unseen), I should have securedfor myselfan abundance ofwealth.} refers to money. In another
 narration, Ibn Abbas commented, I would have knowledge of how much profit I would make with what
 I buy, and I would always sell what I would make profit from, 4"and no evil should have touched me."}
 and poverty would never touch me. ,1] Ibn Jarir said, And others said. This means Ad-DurrAl-
 Manthur3 :622

that if I know the Unseen then I would prepare for the years of famine during the prosperous years, and
 in the time of high cost, I would have prepared for it. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam also
 commented on this Ayah; ^C3} 4"and no evil should have touched me."}, I would have avoided and
 saved myself from any type of harm before it comes. 11 Allah then stated that the Prophet ig is a wamer
 and bearer of good news. He warns against the torment and brings good news of Paradise for the

believers, 44s a_> \2\$} iSo We have made this (the Qur'an) easy on your tongue, only that you may give glad tidings to the pious, and warn with it the most quarrelsome of people.} [19:97] uij '4">& a?" Jt j U &SJ C& it& US ^ c i fci c i i it u c&k tffi 4189. It is He Who has created you from a single person, and (then) He has created from him his wife, in order that he might enjoy the pleasure of living with her. When he covered [had sexual relation with] her, she became pregnant and she carried it about (lightly). Then when it became heavy, they both invoked Allah, their Lord (saying) : "If You give us a Salih (good in every aspect) child, we shall indeed be among the grateful. } 4190. But when He gave them a Salih child, they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them. High be Allah, Exalted above all that they ascribe as partners to Him.} AllMankind are the Offspring of Adam Allah states that He has created all mankind from Adam, m At-Tabari 13:302.

Al-A'raf (189 - 190) (Part-9) peace be upon him, and from Adam, He created his wife, Hawwa and from them, people started to spread. Allah said in another Ayah, i* &M iO mankind! We have created you from a male and a female, and made you into nations and tribes, that you may know one another. Verily, the most honorable of you with Allah is that (believer) who has Taqwa (49:13], and. Jt \$%- Jyfr \$ } 40 mankind! Have Taqwa of your Lord, Who created you from a single person, and from him He created his wife.}4:1] In this honorable Ayah, Allah said; iAnd (then) He has created from him his wife, in order that he might enjoy the pleasure of living with her.} so that he is intimate and compassionate with her. Allah said in another Ayah, 3i C3 "P \$L -5 zl) 4And among His Signs is this, that He created for you wives (spouses) from among yourselves, that you may find repose in them, and He has put between you affection and mercy.} [30:21] Indeed, there is no intimacy between two souls like that between the spouses. This is why Allah mentioned that the sorcerer might be able with his trick to separate between a man and his wife [thus indicating the difficulty of separating them in normal circumstances]. Allah said next, \$When Ik covered her} meaning had sexual intercourse with her.

AU ishe became pregnant and she carried it about lightly} in reference to the first stage of pregnancy when the woman does not feel pain, for at that time, the fetus will be just a Nutfah (the mixture of the male and female discharge), then becomes an Alaqah (a piece of thick coagulated blood) and then a Mudghah (a small lump of flesh). Allah said next, iand she carried it about}, she continued the pregnancy, according to Mujahid. * It was reported that Al-Hasan, Ibrahim An-Nakha 1 and As-Suddi said similarly. * Maymun bin Mahran reported that his father said, She found the pregnancy unnoticeable. Ayyub said, I asked Al-Hasan about the Ayah, iand she carried it about} and he said, Had you been an Arab, you would know what it means! It means that she continued the pregnancy [through its various stages]. * Qatadah said, i*m iand she carried it about (lightly).}, means, it became clear that she was pregnant. ' Ibn Jarir commented, This Ayah means that the liquid remained, whether she stood up or sat down. Al- Awfi recorded that Ibn Abbas said, The semen remained in, but she was unsure if she became pregnant or not, iThen when it became heavy}, she became heavier with the fetus , * As-Suddi said, The fetus grew in her womb. 13) 16) At-Tabari 13:305. At-Jabari 13:304-305. At-Tabari 13:304. At-Tabari 13 :305 At-Tabari 13:304. At-Jabari 13 :305 At-Jabari 13:305.

Ojj '- |V iil ithey both invoked Allah, their Lord (saying) : ",If You give us a Salih child,} if he is bom human in every respect. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas commented, They feared that their child might be bom in the shape of an animal! 111 while Abu Al-Bakhtri and Abu Malik commented, They feared

that their newborn might not be human. 121 Al-Hasan Al-Basri also commented, If You (Allah) give us a boy. *lii fcifc Zi C&K ts u Z&}* iwe shall indeed be among the grateful. But when He gave them a Salih child, they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them. High be Allah, Exalted above all that they ascribe as partners to Him.} (7:189-190) Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Hasan commented on this part of the Ayah, *4i4 r. TL* Jj 4*they ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them This occurred by followers of some religion, not from Adam [or Hawwa]. 141 Al-Hasan also said, This Ayah refers to those among the offspring of Adam who fell into Shirk, *4t x Za* ithey ascribed partners to Him (Allah) in that which He has given to them.} 151 Qatadah said, Al-Hasan used to say that it refers to the Jews and Christians. Allah gave them children, and they turned Tabari 13:306. Tabari 13:306. Tabari 13:306. At-Tabari 13:314. At-Tabari 13:314.

For cases, Allah said them into Jews and Christians. 111 The explanations from Al-Hasan have authentic chains of narration leading to him, and certainly, it is one of the best interpretations. This Ayah should therefore be understood this way, for it is apparent that it does not refer to Adam and Hawa , but about the idolators among their offspring. Allah mentioned the person first [Adam and Hawwa] and then continued to mention the species [mankind, many of whom committed Shirk]. There are similar cases in the Qur'an. *Gjji 53^)* \$And indeed We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps} It is well-known that the stars that were made as lamps in the sky are not the same as the shooting missiles that are thrown at the devils [mentioned later in the Ayah]. There are similar instances in the Qur'an. Allah knows best. m At-Tabari 13:315.

Al-A'raf (191 - 198) (Part-9 *6^ = r==*Jlt*i j\J-e "" " oj* # ^ fl^ *a^ ,4p >% ^ y*j40 4P 4 C4 ^ # \$ i ^ j ?* \$i 14 J* 'n44 pr-"^ "5lj |"fe="jsoi 4:!?- -1 "i -A ui iy 4'j .>(Jj-. * # # ; te *a* jj #2 ojs :i^: > > 4191. Do they attribute as partners to Allah those who created nothing but they themselves are created?} 4292. No help can they give them, nor can they help themselves. 4193. And if you call them to guidance, they follow you not. It is the same for you whether you call them or you keep silent. 4294. Verily, those whom you call upon besides Allah are servants like you. So call upon them and let them answer you if you are truthful.} 4295. Have they feet wherewith they walk? Or have they hands wherewith they hold? Or have they eyes wherewith they see? Or have they ears wherewith they hear? Say: "Call your (so-called) partners (of Allah) and then plot against me, and give me no respite!"} 4296. Verily, my protector is Allah Who has revealed the Book (the Qur'an), and He protects the righteous .} il97. And those whom you call upon besides Him (Allah) cannot help you nor can they help themselves.} 4298. And if you call them to guidance, they hear not and you will see them looking at you, yet they see not. } Idols do not create, help, or have Power over Anything Allah admonishes the idolators who worshipped idols, rivals and images besides Him, although these objects were created by Allah, and neither own anything nor can they bring harm or benefit. These objects do not see or give aid to those who worship them. They are inanimate objects that neither move, hear, or see. Those who worship these objects are better than

236 Tafsir Ibtal Katlur they are, for they hear see and have strength of their own. Allah said, *iTrti vmp& m. s c i* Do they attribute as partners to Allah those who created nothing but they themselves are created? \$ meaning, T you associate with Allah others that neither create, nor have power to create anything? Allah said in another Ayah, ** >* > - > -i UAij Si Jj jjJ fcil ji- al 'jjij C 40* mankind! A similitude has

been coined, so listen to it (carefully): Verily, those on whom you call besides Allah, cannot create (even) a fly, even though they combine together for the purpose. And if the fly snatches away a thing from them, they will have no power to release it from the fly. So weak are (both) the seeker and the sought. They have not estimated Allah His rightful estimate. Verily, Allah is All- Strong, Almighty [22:73-74]. Allah states that if all false gods of the disbelievers gather their strength, they would not be able to create a fly. Rather, if the fly steals anything from them, no matter how insignificant, and flew away, they would not be able to retrieve it. Therefore, if an object is this weak, how can it be worshipped and invoked for provisions and aid? This is why Allah said, ﴿وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ أَتَىٰ لَهُمُ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ الَّذِي كَانُوا يُنَادُونَ﴾ {4 who created nothing but they themselves are created?} these worshipped objects themselves were created and made. Prophet Ibrahim Al-Khalil proclaimed, ﴿وَعِبَادُ اللَّهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ فَاعِلُ شَيْءٍ﴾ {Worship you that which you (yourselves) carve? [37:95]} Allah said next, ﴿وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ﴾

Al-A'raf (191 - 198) (Part-9) ﴿وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ أَتَىٰ لَهُمُ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ الَّذِي كَانُوا يُنَادُونَ﴾ {No help can they give them} those who worship them, nor can they help themselves nor are they able to aid themselves against those who seek to harm them. For instance, Allah's Khalil, peace be upon him, broke and disgraced the idols of his people, just as Allah said he did, ﴿وَلَمَّا تَوَلَّوْا بَنَاتِهِنَّ الْمُلُوكَ قَاتِلَهُنَّ أَنْفُسَهُنَّ يَوْمَ تَأْتِي سُورَةُ الْاِنشَارِ﴾ {Then he turned upon them, striking (them) with his right hand,} [37:93] and, ﴿وَلَمَّا تَوَلَّوْا بَنَاتِهِنَّ الْمُلُوكَ قَاتِلَهُنَّ أَنْفُسَهُنَّ يَوْمَ تَأْتِي سُورَةُ الْاِنشَارِ﴾ {So he broke them to pieces, (all) except the biggest of them, that they might turn to it.} [21:58] Mu'adh bin Amr ibn Al-Jamuh and Mu'adh bin Jabal, may Allah be pleased with both of them, were still young when they embraced Islam after the Messenger of Allah ﷺ came to Al-Madinah. So they were attacking the idols of the idolators at night, breaking, disfiguring them and using them as fuel for needy widows. They sought to give a lesson to their people to make them aware of their error. Amr bin Al-Jamuh, who was one of the chiefs of his people, had an idol that he used to worship and perfume. The two Mu'adhs used to go to that idol, turn it on its head and tarnish it with animal waste. When Amr bin Al-Jamuh would see what happened to his idol, he would clean it, perfume it and leave a sword next to it, saying, Defend yourself. However, the two young men would repeat their actions, and he would do the same as before. Once, they took the idol, tied it to a dead dog and threw it in a well while tied to a rope! When Amr bin Al-Jamuh saw this, he knew that his religion was false and said, By Allah! Had you been a god who has might, you would not end up tied to a dog on a rope! Amr bin Al-Jamuh embraced Islam, and he was strong in his Islam. He was later martyred during the battle of Uhud, may Allah be pleased with him, give him pleasure, and grant him Paradise as his dwelling. Allah said, ﴿وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ أَتَىٰ لَهُمُ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ الَّذِي كَانُوا يُنَادُونَ﴾ {And if you call them to guidance, they follow you not.}

Allah says, these idols do not hear the calls of those who worship them. Therefore, the result is the same, whether calling the idols or shunning them. Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said, ﴿وَعِبَادُ اللَّهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ فَاعِلُ شَيْءٍ﴾ {O my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?} [19:42] Next, Allah states that the idols were created, just as those who worship them. Rather, the people are better than the idols, because they are able to hear, see and exert harm. The idols, on the other hand, have no such powers. Allah said next, ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اسْمَعُوا لِلَّهِ وَاللَّهِ شَهِيدٌ﴾ {Say: "Call your (so-called) partners (of Allah) to invoke the idols for aid against me and do not give me respite, even for an instant, and give it your best effort. Verily, my protector is Allah Who has revealed the Book (the Qur'an), and He protects the righteous. Allah's support is sufficient and He will suffice for me, He is My supporter, I trust in Him and take refuge with Him. He is my protector, in this life and the Hereafter, and the protector of every righteous believer after me. Similarly, the people of Hud said, ﴿وَمَا يَشْعُرُونَ أَتَىٰ لَهُمُ يَوْمُ الدِّينِ الَّذِي كَانُوا يُنَادُونَ﴾ {All that we say is that some of our gods have

seized you with evil (madness)." Hud replied: I call Allah to witness, and bear you witness that I am free from that which you ascribe [as partners in worship, with Him (Allah)]. So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite. I put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving (living) creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on a path

Al-A'rdf (191 - 198) (Part-9) that is straight> [1 1:54-56]. Ibrahim Al-Khalil proclaimed (to his people), h 4 %\$ 2 s & * \$> / /.'-a y /'" <# //" .#4* (^U- VJ iDo you observe that which you have been wershipping, You and your ancient fathers. Verily, they are enemies to me, save the Lord of all that exists . Who has created me, and it is He Who guides me.") [26:75-78] He also said to his father and his people, j UC ~ ff jMxr- isM i"Verily, I am innocent of what you warship. Except Him Who did create me; and verily, He will guide me." And he made it a legacy lasting among his offspring, that they may turn back (to Allah.) [43:26-28] Allah said here, ojj ot oji' iVerily, those whom you call upon besides Allah) until the end of the Ayah, reiterating what has been said earlier, but He uses direct speech this time, 8 % i) icannot help you nor can they help themselves.) The Ayah, > > *> ' "\\ ' >|.VJ (*A> "J] (HVj iAttd ifyou call them to guidance, they hear not and you will see them looking at you, yet they see not.) is similar to another Ayah, \ k v o\ ilf you invoke (or call upon) them, they hear not your call.) [35:14], Allah said next,

240 Tafstr Ibn Kathir &Js*i Y (Uj) r&yj iand you will see them looking at you, yet they see not.> meaning, they have eyes that stare as if they see, although they are solid. Therefore, the Ayah treated them as if they had a mind [saying, Tarahum, instead of Taraha], since they are made in the shape ofhumans with eyes drawn on them. ffr ot 1j if fits C f a *' f / >*" ^*i I * /*jJ Att\j Xfr . Show forgiveness , enjoin Al-'Urf (the good), and turn awayfrom the foolish (don't punish them).} . And ifan evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan, then seek refuge with Allah. Verily, He is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} Showing Forgiveness Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam commented on Allah s statement, < >; " iShow forgiveness Allah commanded [Prophet Muhammad jg] to show forgiveness and turn away from the idolators for ten years. Afterwards Allah ordered him to be harsh with them. And more than one narration from Mujahid says, From the [bad) behavior and actions of the people, of those who have not committed espionage. 12, And Hashim bin TJrwah said that his father said, Allah ordered Allah s Messenger jg to pardon the people for their behavior. 131 And in one narration, pardon what I have allowed you of their behavior. In Sahih

Al-A'rdf(199 - 200) (Part-9 character. There is a narration from Mughirah from Hisham from his father from Ibn Umar; and another from Hisham from his father from A ishah, both of whom said similarly. [2) And Allah knows best. Ibn Jarir and Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Yunus said that Sufyan bin Uyaynah narrated that Umay said, When Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, revealed this Ayah, iShmu forgiveness, enjoin Al-'Urf (what is good), and turn awayfrom the foolish to His Prophet, the Messenger of Allah^ asked, 1Aa Li n'What does it mean, O Jibril?" Jibril said, Allah commands you to forgive those who wronged you, give to those who deprived you, and keep relations with those who cut theirs with you. 131

Uyaynah to meet him, and Umar gave him permission. When Uyaynah entered on Umar, he said, O Ibn Al-Khattab! You neither give to us sufficiently nor rule with justice between us. Umar became so angry that he almost punished Uyaynah. However, Al-Hur said, O Chief of he Faithful! Allah, the Exalted,

said to His Prophet jg, 4. if J jk> iShcrw forgiveness, enjoin Al-'Urf, and turn away from the foolish} Verily this man (Uyaynah) is one of the fools! By Allah, Umar did not do anything after he heard that Ayah being recited, and indeed, he was one who adhered to the Book of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. '

\$Verily, He is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} Allah hears the ignorance that the fools subject you to, your seeking refuge with Him from the devil s whispers, and the rest of the speech of His creation; none of it escapes His knowledge. He knows what drives the lures of the devil away from you, as well as, the rest of what His creatures do. We mentioned the Hadiths concerning Isti'adhah (seeking refuge with Allah) in the beginning of this Tafsir, so we do not need to repeat them here. ^ Si 61 ^} i201. Verily, those who have Taqwa, when an evil thought comes to them from Shaytan, they remember (Allah), and (indeed) they then see (aright).} \$202. But (as for) their brothers (the devils' brothers) they (the devils) plunge them deeper into error, and they never stop short.} The Whispering of Shaytan and the People of Taqwa Allah mentions His servants who have Taqwa, obeying His orders, and avoid what He forbade: iwhen comes to them} an evil thought, or anger, or the whispers of Shaytan cross their mind, or intend to err, or commit an error, \$they remember} Allah s punishment, as well as, His tremendous reward. They remember Allah s promises and threats, then repent, go back to Him, seek refuge with Him and ask for forgiveness before death, (Jk At-Tabari 13:332.

Li ~.fi elk* ijC ^ Lii ilfWe will, We could send down to them from the heaven a sign, to which they would bend their necks in humility.} [26:4] The pagans asked the Prophet, why did you not strive hard to bring us an Ayah (miracle) from Allah so that we witness it and believe in it. Allah said to him, 4^j oi &[Sri Say : "I but follow what is revealed to me from my Lord/" I do not ask such things of my Lord. I only follow what He reveals and commands me. Therefore, if Allah sends a miracle, I will accept it. Otherwise, I will not ask for it unless He allows me. Certainly, Allah is Most Wise, the All-Knower. Allah next directs the servants to the fact that this Qur'an is the most powerful miracle, clearest evidence and most true proof and explanation, saying, 0? \-k kf iThis (the Qur'an) is nothing but evidences from your Lord, and a guidance and a mercy for a people who believe.} 4204. So, when the Qur'an is recited, listen to it, and be silent that you may receive mercy.} The Order to listen to the Qur'an After Allah mentioned that this Qur'an is a clear evidence, guidance and mercy for mankind, He commanded that one listen to the Qur'an when it is recited, in respect and honor of the Qur'an. This is to the contrary of the practice of the pagans of Quraysh, who said, 4m. 536 4"Listen not to this Qur'an, and make noise in the midst of its (recitation)" [41:26]. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Mas'ud said; We would give Salams to each other during Salah. So the Ayah of Qur'an was revealed;

U&X \sj> fy} iWhen the Qur'an is recited, then listen to it.} j2 &.% ^jsj j> % . (* & iixj&k ij' ol ijg5cs^' . And remember your Lord within yourself, humbly and with fear and without loudness in words in the mornings and in the afternoons, and be not of those who are neglectful}. 4206. Surely, those who are with your Lord (angels) are never too proud to perform acts of worship to Him, but they glorify His praise and prostrate themselves before Him.} Remembering Allah in the Mornings and Afternoons Allah ordains that He be remembered more often in the mornings and the afternoons. Just as He ordered that He be worshipped during these two times when He said, 4's Ar^ j2> j5 Qj -uij Tr*j} 4And glorify the praises of your Lord, before the rising of the sun and before (its) setting.} [50:39]

Before the night of Isra', when the five daily prayers were ordained, this Ayah was revealed in Makkah ordering that Allah be worshipped at these times, Allah said next, {humbly and with fear} meaning, remember your Lord in secret, not loudly, with eagerness and fear. This is why Allah said next, {Aj} and without loudness in words}. Therefore, it is recommended that remembering Allah in Dhikr is not performed in a loud voice. When the Companions asked the Messenger of Allah, Is our Lord close, so that we call Him in secret, or far, so that we raise our voices? Allah sent down the verse,

li' f'-i' -1 w 4And when My servants ask you concerning Me, then (answer them), 1 am indeed near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant ivhen he calls on Me (without any mediator or intercessor).} [2:186] m In the Two Sahibs, it is recorded that Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari said, The people raised their voices with Du'a (invoking Allah) while travelling. The Prophet said to them. \$! iJli. i'j by-i N ijjL-iii Js. ^01 U" _ . , - >> " i - f " , > ,!{ v ; *' " ; ^ ') , 4iP v4 . Ji J I -> J Aj "0 people! Take it easy on yourselves, for He Whom you are calling is not deaf or absent. Verily, He Whom you are calling is the All-Hearer, close (by His knowledge), closer to one of you than the neck of his animal .n These texts encourage the servants to invoke Allah in Dhikr often, especially in the mornings and afternoons, so that they are not among those who neglect remembering Him. This is

why Allah praised the angels who praise Him night and day

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2120–2121]

without tiring, o* V Xf; o',4 iSurely, those who are with your Lord (i.e., angels) are never too proud to perform acts of worship to Him Allah reminded the servants of this fact so that they imitate the angels in their tireless worship and obedience of Allah. Prostration, here, upon the mention that the angels prostrate to Allah is legitimate. A Hadith reads; Liy^i tf;3 -lie- iwi2aj US dyhj ' Why not you stand in line (for the prayer) like the angels stand in line before their Lord? They continue the first then the This narration is recorded by Ibn Abi HShim with a weak chain of narrators. There are other texts to support its meaning. Al-Bari6 : 157 and Muslim 4 :2077

next lines and they stand close to each other in This is the first place in the Qur'an where it has been legitimized - according to the agreement of the scholars - for the readers of the Qur'an, and those listening to its recitation, to perform prostration. 1:322.

Module 12

Surah 8: Al-Anfal

Surah 8: Al-Anfal

PDF pages 2122–2239

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2122]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Anfal (Chapter - 8)

Which was revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2122–2129]

TL \vv mm ^ mmmmmm 'mSrMwiMwmiOSm oil i 4JJUuV'J" jiiLs 1-rdJ_yt)jiit l . - ' ' I i/V . -T' ' 'lil'fl
' ->> 'li <' . * if- < > "rf"* <* - . > five At/at in this Surah. The word count of this Surah is one thousand, six hundred and thirty- one words and its letters number five thousand, two hundred and ninety- four. P * -i In the Name of Allah the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful juVJ \$ J * & & y^j'j Sif I
|t^uu Oo 41 . They ask you about Al-Anfal (the spoils of war). Say: "Al-Anfal are for Allah and the Messenger. So have Taqwd of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you, and obey Allah and His Messenger, if you are believers.} cjCiAia) \ 'Pf0 * fog Meaning of Anfal

the battle of Badr. When the two armies met, Allah defeated the enemy and some of us pursued them inflicting utter defeat and casualties. Another group of us came to the battlefield collecting the spoils of war. Another group surrounded the Messenger of Allah 5g, so that the enemy could not attack him suddenly. When it was night and the various army groups went back to our camp, some of those who collected the spoils said, *We collected it, so none else will have a share in it. Those who went in pursuit of the enemy said, *No, you have no more right to it than us. We kept the enemy away from the war spoils and defeated them. Those who surrounded the Messenger of Allah 1:178. 121 Abu Dawud 3 :177, Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8:466, An-Nasal in Al- Kubra 6 :348 5 :322

254 Tafstr Ibn Kathir M to protect him said, *You have no more right to it than us, we surrounded the Messenger of Allah jgg for fear that the enemy might conduct a surprise attack against him, so we were busy. The Ayah, 4(*^=*i* otj iThey ask you about Al-Anfdl (the spoils of war). Say: Al- Anfdl are for Allah and the Messenger. So fear Allah and settle all matters of difference among you.} was revealed and the Messenger of Allah jg divided the Anfal equally between Muslims. '\$\$ J> jUl lij jg)l And Allah's Messenger would give a fourth for Anfal when there was a surprise attack in the land of the enemy, and when there was a confrontation then a third to the people who returned". The Prophet jg used to dislike the Anfal and encouraged strong fighters to give some of their share to weak Muslim fighters. At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah collected a similar narration for this Hadith, and At-Tirmidhi said, uHasan".m Allah said, olj 4l iSo have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you,} The Ayah commands, have Taqwa of Allah in all your affairs, settle matters of differences between you, do not wrong each other, do not dispute, and do not differ. Certainly, the guidance and knowledge that

Allah has granted you is better than what you are disputing about [such as Al-Anfal\, at \fS\j} 4.and obey Allah and His Messenger,} in the division that the Messenger makes according to Allah s Ahmad 5:323. TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :468 and Ibn Majah 2 :95 1

Al-Anfdl (2 - 4) (Part-9 order. The Prophet ag only divided according to what Allah ordained, which is perfectly just and fair. Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, This is a command from Allah and His Messenger jg to the believers, that they should have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of differences between them. A similar statement was reported from MujahidJ2 As-Suddi also commented on Allah s statement, o'i 'jid'- ls iSo have Taqwa of Allah and settle all matters of difference among you}, meaning Do not curse each other. 131 & tfty Jc& # "l 2\$. f " >! 1 '-' 42 . 77ie believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts and when His Ayat are recited unto than, they increase theirfaith; and they put their trust in their Lord;} 43. Who perform the Salah and spend out of what We have provided them.} 44. It is they wlv are the believers in truth. For them are grades of dignity with their Lord, and forgiveness and a generous provision (Paradise).} Qualities ofthe Faithful and Truthful Believers Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah, iThe believers are only tlwse who, when Allah is mentioned, feel a fear in their hearts } None of Allah s remembrance enters the hearts of the hypocrites upon performing what He has ordained. They At-Tabari 13:384.Tabari 13:384.Tabari 13:384.

neither believe in any of Allah s Ayat nor trust (in Allah) nor pray if they are alone nor pay the Zakdh due on their wealth. Allah stated that they are not believers. He then described the believers by saying, iij ft X> 4The believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel afear in their hearts and they perform what He has ordained, ifoi *> jc# 0V0 4and when His Ayat are recited unto them, they increase their faith^ and conviction, iand they put their trust in their Lord}, having hope in none except Him. 111 Mujahid commented on, 4their hearts Wajilafy, Their hearts become afraid and fearful. 121 Similar was said by As-Suddi and several others. 131 The quality of a true believer is that when Allah is mentioned, he feels a fear in his heart, and thus implements His orders and abstains from His prohibitions. Allah said in a similar Ayah, j-i*. o*) p-gjQ 'jy" Sit [])X* 'jiili jl i-lyui ijlSj X-> ^ ft 4And those who, when they have committed FdliishaJi (immoral sin) or wronged themselves with evil, remember Allah and ask forgiveness for their sins; - and none can forgive sins but Alldlt - and do not persist in what (wrong) they have done, while they know^ [3:135], and, ^cfjUll^ uf*J *A if* Uyy At-Tabari 13:386. At-Tabari 13:386.Tabari 13:386.

Al-Anfdl (2 - 4) (Part-9) iBut as for him who feared standing before his Lord, and restrained himselffrom vain desires. Verily, Paradise will be his abode.\$ (79:40-41] Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated that As-Suddi commented, <!>&\$ 'C\} iThe believers are only those who, when Allah is mentioned, feel afear in their hearts> A man might be thinking of committing injustice or a sin. But he abstains when he is told, Have Taqwa of Allah , and his heart becomes fearful. Faith increaseswhen the Qur'an is recited Allah s statement. 4 A'* ^ iAnd when His Aydt are recited unto them, they increase their faith;} is similar to His statement, ijiJ. & 1 Jjij , "4~* Vui* U whatever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say: Which of you has had his faith increased by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice} [9:124]. Al-Bukhari and other scholars relied on this Ayah (8:2) and those similar, as evidence that faith increases and varies in strength from heart to heart. This is also

the view of the majority of the scholars of Islam, prompting some scholars, such as Ash-Shafil, Ahmad bin Hanbal and Abu Ubayd to declare that this is the consensus of the Ummah, as we mentioned in the beginning of the explanation of Sahih. Al- Bukhari. All the thanks and praises are due to Allah. The Reality of Tawakkul Allah said,

}And they put their trust in their Lord.} Therefore, the believers hope in none except Allah, direct their dedication to Him alone, seek refuge with Him alone, invoke Him alone for their various needs and supplicate to Him alone. They know that whatever He wills, occurs and that whatever He does not will never occurs, that He alone is the One Who has the decision in His kingdom, without partners; none can avert the decision of Allah and He is swift in reckoning. Hence the statement of SaTd bin Jubayr, Tawakkul of Allah is the essence of faith. Deeds of Faithful Believers Allah said next, -t. * " li iWho perform the Saldh and spend out of what We have provided them.} Allah describes the actions of the believers after He mentioned their faith. The acts mentioned here include all types of righteous acts, such as establishing prayer, which is Allah s right. Qatadah said, Establishing the prayer requires preserving its times, making ablution for it, bowing down and prostrating. (1 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan said, Establishing the prayer means to preserve its times, perform perfect purity for it, perform perfect bowings and prostrations, recite the Qur an during it, sitting for Tashahhud and reciting the Saldh (invoking Allah s blessings) for the benefit of the Prophet. ' Spending from what Allah has granted includes giving the Zakah and the rest of the what is due from the servant, either

what is obligatory or recommended. All of the servants are

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2129–2152]

AllAh s dependents, and the most beloved among them to Him are the most beneficial to His creation. The Reality of Faith AllAh s statement, Ibn Abi Hatim 1:37. ' Ibn Abi Hatim 1:37.

"Residents of Paradise see the residents of the highest grades just as you see the distant planet in the horizon of the sky. Verily, Abu Bakr and 'Umar are among them (in the highest grades), and how excellent they are . d j Si St u\$> iit^ ? jt J"J' 4*: J 4i\ ijij oli j" J ayj pS-S : ;^ / MJ&^ : :S^#gs 45. As your Lord caused you to go out from your home xoith the truth; and verily, a party among the believers disliked it.} 46 . Disputing xoith you concerning the truth after it xoas made manifest, as if they were being driven to death, while they were looking (at it).} 47. And (remember) when Allah promised you (Muslims) one of the two parties, that it should be yours ; you wished that the one not armed should be yours, but Allah willed to justify the truth by His Words and to cut off the roots of the disbelievers.} 48. That He might cause the truth to triumph and bring falsehood to nothing, even though the criminals hate it.} Following the Messenger^ is Better for the Believers Allah said, 4&& "T} 4As your Lord caused you to go out...} After Allah described the believers as fearing their Lord, resolving matters of dispute between themselves and obeying Allah and His Messenger He then said here, since you disputed about dividing war spoils and differed with each other about them, Allah took them away from you. He and His Messenger then divided them in truth and justice, thus ensuring continued benefit for all of you. Similarly, you disliked meeting the armed enemy in battle, 2:27, Abu Dfiwud 4 :287 , Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 8 :142 and Ibn Majah 1 :37.

Al-Anfal (5 - 8) (Part-9) who marched in support of their religion and to protect their caravan. You disliked fighting, so Allah decided that battle should occur and made you meet your enemy, without planning to do so on your part. This incident carried guidance, light, victory and triumph. Allah said; \ zzpJ% % 2 p#% \$ \$ < lit; tis ?2 X 2 4Jihad is ordained for you though you dislike it, and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you, and that you like a thing which is bad for you. Allah knows but you do not know.} (2:216) As-Suddi commented, 4, Sop" oi lAj} 4And verily, a party among the believers disliked} to meet [the armed] idolators. 4% 4 4Disputing with you concerning the truth after it was made manifest,} Some have commented, (Allah says:) they ask and argue with you about Al-Anfal just as they argued with you when you went out for the battle of Badr, saying, You marched with us to confiscate the caravan. You did not inform us that there will be fighting and that we should prepare for it. 4-t^i U- J 4but Allah willed to justify the truth by His Words} Allah says, He willed for you to meet the armed enemy [rather than the caravan] so that He makes you prevail above them and gain victory over them, making His religion apparent and Islam victorious and dominant above all religions. He has perfect knowledge of the consequences of all things, you are surrounded by His wise planning, although people only like what appears favorable to them, J /r- &2 !" J fr-c-jp JVilt C^f} ip

262 Tafstr Ibn Kafhir ijihad (fighting in Allah's cause) is ordained for you (Muslims) though you dislike it, and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you and that you like a thing which is bad for you > [2:216]. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Abdullah bin Abbas said, When the Messenger of Allah ^ heard that Abu Sufyan had left the Sham area (headed towards Makkah with Quraysh s caravan), he encouraged the Muslims to march forth to intercept them, saying. " Lit jf 4)1 Jil I lj_j j oji iThis is the caravan of Quraysh carrying their property, so march forth to intercept it, Allah might make it as war spoils for you.D The people started mobilizing Muslims, although some of them did not mobilize, thinking that the Prophet 5g\$ would not have to fight. Abu Sufyan was cautiously gathering information on the latest news spying on travelers he met, out of fear for the caravan, especially upon entering the area of Hijaz (Western Arabia). Some travelers told him that Muhammad had mobilized his companions for his caravan. He was anxious and hired Damdam bin Amr Al-Ghifari to go to Makkah and mobilize the Quraysh to protect their caravan, informing them that Muhammad jg had mobilized his Companions to intercept the caravan. Damdam bin Amr went in a hurry to Makkah. Meanwhile, the Messenger of Allah jg marched with his companions until he reached a valley called Dhafirah. When he left the valley, he camped and was informed that the Quraysh had marched to protect their caravan. The Messenger of Allah consulted the people for advice and conveyed the news about Quraysh to them. Abu Bakr stood up and said something good, and so did Umar. Al-Miqdad bin Amr stood up and said, O Allah s Messenger! March to what Allah has commanded you, for we are with you. By Allah! We will not say to you what the Children of Israel said to Musa, i" So go you and your Lord and fight you two, we are sitting right here" ^ [5:24].

Al-Anfal (5 - 8) (Part-9) Rather, go you and Your Lord and fight, we will be fighting along with you both. By He Who has sent you with Truth! If you decide to take us to Birk-ul-Ghimad, we will fight along with you until you reach it. The Messenger of Allah soid good words to Al-Miqdad and invoked Allah for his benefit. The Messenger of Allah again said. tGive me your opinion, O people wanting to hear from the Ansar. This is because the majority of the people with him then were the Ansar. When the Ansar gave the Prophet Sg their pledge of obedience at Al- Aqabah, they proclaimed, O Allah s

Messenger! We are not bound by this pledge unless, and until, you arrive in our land. When you have arrived in our area, you are under our protection, and we shall protect you in the same manner we protect our children and wives. The Messenger of Allah ^ﷺ feared that the Ansar might think that they are not obliged to support him except from his enemies who attack Al-Madinah, not to march with him to an enemy in other areas. When the Prophet said this, Sa'd bin Mu'adh asked him, O Allah's Messenger! Is it us whom you meant? The Prophet answered in the positive. Sa'd said, We have faith and believed in you, testified that what you brought is the truth, and gave you our pledges and promises of allegiance and obedience. Therefore, march, O Allah's Messenger, for what Allah has commanded you. Verily, by He Who has sent you in Truth, if you decided to cross this sea (the Red Sea), we will follow you in it, and none among us would stay behind. We do not dislike that we meet our enemy tomorrow. Verily, we are patient in war, fierce in battle. May Allah make you witness what makes your eyes pleased with us. Therefore, march with us with the blessing of Allah. The Messenger of Allah was pleased with what Sa'd said and was encouraged by it. He proclaimed, *ftl J&' jS 2 V^j 2 2>; JU f> Js\$\$* March with the blessing of Allah and receive the good news. For Allah has indeed promised me one of the two camps (confiscating the caravan or defeating the Quraysh army). By Allah! It is as if I am

Al-Anfi (9 - 10) (Part-9) (Remember) when you sought help of your Lord and He answered you until, 4* #&& then verily, Allah is severe in punishment that Ibn Mas'ud said, I was a witness to something that Al-Miqdad bin Al-Aswad did, that I would like more than almost anything else to have been the one who did it. Al-Miqdad came to the Prophet while he was invoking Allah against the idolators and proclaimed, *We will not say as the people of Musa said, So go you and your Lord and fight you two. Rather, we will fight to your right, to your left, before you and behind you. I saw the Prophet's face beaming with pleasure because of what Al-Miqdad said to him. * Al-Bukhan next narrated from Ibn Abbas that on the day of Badr, the Prophet said, *jU " .Li !JL3 i ill** iliiii "O Allah! I invoke You for Your covenant and promise (victory). O Allah! If You decide so (cause our defeat), You will not be worshipped. Abu Bakr held the Prophet's hand and said, Prophet jg went out proclaiming, .fe cr^ Enough. The "Their multitude will be put to flight, and they will show their backs. An-Nasa'i also collected this Hadith. * Allah's statement, iwith a thousand of the angels Murdifi^ means, they follow each other in succession, according to Harun bin Hubayrah who narrated this from Ibn Abbas about, Al-Bdri 7 :335. * Fath Al-Bari 7 :335 and An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :477*

266 Tafstr Ibt Kathir 4Murdifi\$y\ meaning each behind the other in succession. Ali bin Abi Talhah Al-Walibi reported that Ibn Abbas said, Allah supported His Prophet ^ﷺ and the believers with a thousand angels, five hundred under the leadership of Jibril on one side and five hundred under the leadership of Mikail on another side." 121 Imams Abu Jalar bin Jarir

I Ji 2)' J*t 4-i He [Hatib] participated in Badr. How do you know that Allah has not looked at the people of Badr and vroclaimed, 'Do whatever you want, for I have forgiven you.'

268 Tafsir Ibt Kathir them (without you). But (He lets you fight) in order to test some of you with others. But those who are killed in the way of Allah, He will never let their deeds be lost. He will guide them and set right their state. And admit them to Paradise which He has made known to them.}il] [47:4-6] and, *% \pxoM# & j:eV>&& if 44 iAnd so are the days (good and not so good), that We give to men by turns, that Allah may test those who believe, and that He may take martyrs from among you.

And Allah likes not the wrongdoers. And that Allah may test (or purify) the believers (from sins) and destroy the disbelievers. [3:140-141] These are points of wisdom for which Allah has legislated performing Jihad, by the hands of the believers against the disbelievers. Allah used to destroy the previous nations that denied the Prophets, using various disasters that encompassed these rebellious nations. For instance, Allah destroyed the people of Nuh with the flood, Ad with the wind, Thamud with the scream, the people of Lut with an earthquake and the people of Shu'ayb by the Day of the Shadow. After Allah sent Musa and destroyed his enemy Fir'aun and his soldiers by drowning, He sent down the Tawrah to him in which He legislated fighting against the disbelievers, and this legislation remained in the successive Laws. Allah said, 'And indeed We gave Musa - after We had destroyed the generations of old - the Scripture as an enlightenment.' [28:43] It is more humiliating for the disbeliever and more comforting to the hearts of the faithful that the believers kill the disbelievers by their own hands. Allah said to the believers of this Ummah, 'That is, they will recognize their places, as they did in the worldly life'

Al-Anfal (9 - 10) (Part-9) Fight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them, and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of a believing people. [9: 14] This is why killing the disbelievers of Quraysh by the hand of their enemies, whom they used to despise, was more humiliating to the disbelievers and comforting to the hearts of the party of faith. Abu Jahl, for instance, was killed in battle and this was more humiliating for him than dying in his bed, or from lightning, wind, or similar afflictions. Also, Abu Lahab died from a terrible disease [that caused him to stink] and none of his relatives could bear approaching him. They had to wash him with water by sprinkling it from a distance, then threw stones over his corpse, until it was buried under them! Allah said next, 'Verily, Allah is All-Mighty the might is His, His Messengers and the believers, both in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said in another Ayah, 'We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe, in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will stand forth (Day of Resurrection). [40:51] Allah said next, 'All-Wise. in that He legislated fighting the disbeliever, even though He is able to destroy them and bring their demise by His will and power, all praise and honor is due to Him. (Remember) when He covered you with a slumber as a security from Him, and He caused water (rain) to descend on

you - Tafsir Ibn Kathir you from the sky, to clean you thereby and to remove from you the Rijs (whispering or dirt) of Shaytan, and to strengthen your hearts, and make you firm thereby.' 412. (Remember) when your Lord revealed to the angels, "Verily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed. I will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved, so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes." 413. This is because they defied and disobeyed Allah and His Messenger. And whoever defies and disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, Allah is severe in punishment.' 414. This is (the torment), so taste it; and surely, for the disbelievers is the torment of the Fire.' Slumber overcomes Muslims Allah reminds the believers of the slumber that He sent down on them as security from the fear they suffered from, because of the multitude of their enemy and the sparseness of their forces. They were given the same favor during the battle of Uhud, which Allah described, 'Then after the distress, He sent down security for you. Slumber overtook a party of you, while another party was thinking about themselves.' [3:154] Abu Talhah said,

I was among those who were overcome by slumber during (the battle of) Uhud. The sword fell from my hand several times, and I kept picking it up again, several times. I also saw the Companions heads nodding while in the rear guard. Al-Hafiz Abu Yala narrated that Ali said, Only Al-Miqdad had a horse during Badr, and at some point, I found that all of us fell asleep, except the Messenger of Allah ﷺ - He was praying under a tree and crying until dawn. Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, Slumber during battle is security from Allah, but during prayer, it is from Shaytan. * Qatadah said, Slumber affects the head, while sleep affects the *J * Musnad Abu Yala 1 :242. * At-Tabari 13:419.

Al-Anfili (11 - 14) (Part-9) heart. Slumber overcame the believers on the day of Uhud, and this incident is very well-known. As for this Ayah (8:11), it is describing the battle of Badr, indicating that slumber also overcame the believers during Badr. Therefore, it appears that this will occur for the believers, whenever they are in distress, so that their hearts feel safe and sure of Allah's aid, rewards, favor and mercy from Allah with them. Allah said in another Ayah, $\text{c}^{\wedge}\text{C}^{\wedge}\text{i}$ Verily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is relief.} (94:5-6) In the Sahih, it is recorded that on the day of Badr, while he was in the bunker with Abu Bakr, the Messenger ﷺ and Abu Bakr were invoking Allah. Suddenly, slumber overcame the Messenger and he woke up smiling and declared, i Good news, O Abu Bakr! This is Jibril with dust on his shoulders ."" He left the shade while reciting Allah's statement, iTheir multitude will be put to flight, and they will show their backs.} [54:45] Rain fall** on the Eve of Badr Allah said next, iand He caused rain to descend on you from the sky.} Ali bin Abi Jahhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, When the Prophet arrived at Badr, he made camp. At the time, there was a sandy piece of land between the idolaters and the water (the wells at Badr). Muslims felt weak and the Shaytan cast *** Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1664. ' Fath Al-Bari 7 :364

frustration into their hearts. He whispered to them, You claim that you are Allah's supporters and that His Messenger is among you! However, the idolaters have taken over the water resource from you, while you pray needing purity. Allah sent down heavy rain, allowing the Muslims to drink and use it for purity. Allah also removed Shaytan's whisper and made the sand firm when rain fell on it, and the Muslims walked on the sand along with their animals, until they reached the enemy. Allah supported His Prophet and the believers with a thousand angels on one side, five hundred under the command of Jibril and another five hundred under the command of Mikail on another side. An even a better narration is that collected by Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, author of Al-Maghazi, may Allah have mercy upon him. Ibn Ishaq narrated that, Yazid bin Ru'man narrated to him that, Thawab bin Az-Zubayr said, Allah sent rain down from the sky on a sandy valley. That rain made the area where the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and his Companions camped firmer so that it did not hinder their movement. Meanwhile, the part that the Quraysh were camping on became difficult to move in. Mujahid said, Allah sent down the rain on the believers before slumber overtook them, and the rain settled the dust, made the ground firmer, made them feel at ease and their feet firmer. Allah said next, i to clean you thereby} using it after answering the call of nature or needing to wash oneself, and this involves cleansing what is on the outside. } and to remove from you the Rijz of Shaytan,} such as his whispers and evil thoughts, this involves sinner purification, whereas Allah's statement about the residents of Paradise, 1,1 At-Tabari 13:423. Al-Waqidi in Al-Maghazi 1 :54 At-Tabari 13:425.

Al-Anfal (11 - 14) (Part-9) iTheir garments will be of fine green silk, and gold embroidery. They will be adorned with bracelets of silver} [76:21] involves outer appearance, i.e. and their Lord will give them a pure drink.} [76:21] that purifies the anger, envy and hatred that they might have felt. This is the inner purity. Next, Allah said, iand to strengthen your hearts,} with patience and to encourage you to fight the enemies, and this is inner courage, iand make your feet firm thereby}, this involves outer courage. Allah knows best. Allah commands the Angels to fight and support the Believers Allah said next, i{X \$2 \$ X u-y. i(Remember) when your Lord revealed to the angels, "Verily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed."} This is a hidden favor that Allah has made known to the believers, so that they thank Him and are grateful to Him for it. Allah, glorified, exalted, blessed and praised be He, has revealed to the angels -whom He sent to support His Prophet, religion and believing group - to make the believers firmer. Allah's statement, i{asffZ &}.} il will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved.} means, you - angels - support the believers, strengthen their (battle) front against their enemies, thus, implementing My command to you. I will cast fear, disgrace and humiliation over those who defied My command and denied My Messenger,

i p fe* pi ac'M& \sp&} so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes,} strike them on their foreheads to tear them apart and over the necks to cut them off, and cut off their limbs, hands and feet. It was said that, iover the necks refers to striking the forehead, or the neck, according to Ad-Dahhak and Atiyyah Al-Awfi. In support of the latter, Allah commanded the believers, * >'V-Mel (il& Pfi \tP P} 4So, when you meet (in fight Jihad in Allah's cause) those who disbelieve, smite (their) necks till when you have killed and wounded many of them, then bind a bond firmly (on them, take them as captives).} [47:4] Ar-Rabi bin Anas said, In the aftermath of Badr, the people used to recognize whomever the angels killed from those whom they killed, by the wounds over their necks, fingers and toes, because those parts had a mark as if they were branded by fire. Allah said, i p p iand smite over all their fingers and toes.} Ibn Jarir commented that this Ayah commands, O believers! Strike every limb and finger on the hands and feet of your (disbelieving) enemies. Al-Awfi reported, that Ibn Abbas said about the battle of Badr that Abu Jahl said, Do not kill them (the Muslims), but capture them so that you make known to them what they did, their ridiculing your religion and shunning Al-Lat and Al-'Uzza (two idols). Allah then sent down to the angels, S \p: oJ' \p& \$} i p. pi 4^*^' (1) At-Tabari 13:431.

Al-Anfal (14 - 16) (Part-9) iVerily, I am with you, so keep firm those who have believed. I will cast terror into the hearts of those who have disbelieved, so strike them over the necks, and smite over all their fingers and toes.} In that battle, Abu Jahl (may Allah curse him) was killed along with sixty-nine men. Tjubah bin Abu Mui't was captured and then killed, thus bring the death toll of the pagans to seventy, iThis is because they defied and disobeyed Allah and His Messenger.} joining the camp that defied Allah and His Messenger so not including themselves in the camp of Allah's Law and faith in Him. Allah said, jo < >} iAnd whoever defies and disobeys Allah and His Messenger, then verily, Allah is severe in punishment.} for He will crush whoever defies and disobeys Him. Nothing ever escapes Allah's grasp nor can anything ever stand against His anger. Blessed and exalted He is, there is no true deity or Lord except Him. iThis is (the torment), so taste it; and surely, for the disbelievers is the torment of the Fire.} This Ayah addresses the disbeliever, saying, taste this torment and punishment in this life and know that the torment of the Fire in the Hereafter is for the disbelievers. 'J4 q \p: 04} r4<- 415 . O you who believe! When you meet those who disbelieve, in a battlefield, never turn your backs

to them.} 416. And whoever turns his back to them on such a day - unless it be a stratagem of war, or to retreat to a troop (of his

own) - he indeed has drawn upon himself wrath from Allah. And his abode is Hell, and worst indeed is that destination!} Fleeing from Battle is prohibited, and its Punishment Allah said, while warning against fleeing from the battlefield and threatening those who do it with the Fire, 'j# Zi 6, rpn y; 40 you who believe! When you meet those who disbelieve, in a battlefield,} when you get near the enemy and march towards them, inever turn your backs to them . do not run away from battle and leave your fellow Muslims behind, 4J&i \ iAnd whoever turns his back to them on such a day - unless it be a stratagem ofwar . . The Ayah says, whoever flees from the enemy by way of planning to pretend that he is afraid of the enemy, so that they follow him and he takes the chance and returns to kill the enemy, then there is no sin on him. This is the explanation of Said bin Jubayr and As-Suddi.111 Ad-Dahhak also commented, Whoever went ahead of his fellow Muslims to investigate the strength of the enemy and make use of it, 4or to retreat to a troop (of his own)}, meaning he leaves from here to another troop of Muslims to assist them or be assisted by them. So that is allowed for him, or even during the battle if he flees from his brigade to the commander. Or going to the grand Imam, would also fall under this permission. Umar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him, said about Abu Ubayd when he was fighting on the bridge in the land of the Persians, because of the many Zoroastrian soldiers, If he retreated to me then I would be as a troop for him. This is how it was reported by Muhammad bin Sirin from m At-Tabari 13:436-437.

't Umar. In the report of Abu Tlthman An-Nahdi from Umar, he said: When Abu TJbayd was fighting, Umar said, O people! We are your troop. Mujahid said that Umar said, We are the troop of every

in Tafsir Ibn Kathfr *(They are:) Joining others in worship with Allah, magic taking life which Allah has forbid- den, except for a just cause (according to Isla- mic law), consuming Riba, consuming an orphan's wealth, fleeing the battlefield at the time offighting, and false ac- cusation to chaste wo- men, who never even think of anything touch- ing chastity and are good believers. This is why Allah said here, 4feSx} ihe indeed has drawn upon himself...}, and returned with, jit iwrath from Allah. And his abode...}, destination, and dwelling place on the Day ofReturn, nr UESiK ^ gCMps~3iJZ'& 2dl dirfjil * " "yj 4is He//, and worst indeed is that destination!} & & # h a <#;^ jT i*; ai^^ if ^ at fes. t* iA detf i^TK 417. You killed them not, but Allah killed them. And you threw not when you did throw, but Allah threw, that He might test the believers by a fair trialfrom Him. Verily, Allah is All- *** Fath Al-Bari 5 : 462 and Muslim 1 :92

invoked Allah humbly and expressing his neediness before Allah. He then threw a handful of sand at the disbelievers and said, Humiliated be their faces.* He then commanded his Companions to start fighting with sincerity and they did. Allah made this handful of sand enter the eyes of the idolaters, each one of them were struck by some of it and it distracted them making each of them busy. Allah said, itSj S" T j} iAnd you threw not when you did throw, but Allah threw.} Therefore, it is Allah Who made the sand reach their eyes and busied them with it, not you (O Muhammad) sg. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Muhammad bin JaTar bin Az-Zubayr narrated to him that TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr said about Allah s statement, 4^ yf. A'M 'i'- ithat He might test the believers by a fair trialfrom Him.} So that the believers know Allah s favor for them by giving them victory over their enemy, even though their enemy was

numerous, while they were few. They should thus know His right and express gratitude for His favor on them. Similar was said by Ibn Jarir. It is stated in a Hadith, "Every trial (from Allah) is a favor for us." [2] Allah said next, "And if you cease (to do wrong), it will be better for you, and if you return (to the attack), so shall We return, and your forces will be of no avail to you, however numerous they be; and verily, Allah is with the believers." The Response to the Disbelievers Who ask for a Judgement Allah says to the disbeliever, "If you ask for a judgement, you invoked Allah for victory, judgement and a decision between you and your believing nemesis, and you got what you asked for. Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others reported from Az-Zuhri from Abdullah bin Thabit bin Sa'ad who said that Abu Jahl said on the day of Badr, O Allah! Whichever of the two camps {pagans and Muslims} severed the relation of the womb and brought us

281 Siirah 8. Al-Anfal (19) (Part-9) "This (is the fact) and surely Allah weakens the deceitful plots of the disbelievers." This is more good news, aside from the victory that the believers gained. Allah informed them that He will weaken the plots of the disbelievers in the future, degrade them and make everything they have perish and be destroyed, all praise and thanks are due to Allah. (O disbelievers) if you ask for a judgement, now has the judgement come unto you; and if you cease (to do wrong), it will be better for you, and if you return (to the attack), so shall We return, and your forces will be of no avail to you, however numerous they be; and verily, Allah is with the believers." The Response to the Disbelievers Who ask for a Judgement Allah says to the disbeliever, "If you ask for a judgement, you invoked Allah for victory, judgement and a decision between you and your believing nemesis, and you got what you asked for. Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others reported from Az-Zuhri from Abdullah bin Thabit bin Sa'ad who said that Abu Jahl said on the day of Badr, O Allah! Whichever of the two camps {pagans and Muslims} severed the relation of the womb and brought us

what is not familiar, then destroy him this day." This Ayah was

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2152–2212]

later on revealed, "If you ask for a judgement, then now has the judgement come unto you," until the end of the Ayah) Imam

Those among us who severed the relations of the womb and brought forth what we do not recognize, then destroy him this day. * This was also recorded by An-Nasa'i in the Book of Tafsir (of his Sunan) and Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak, and he said, It is Sahih according to the criteria of the Two Shaykhs, and they did not record it. * Similar statements were reported from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Yazid bin Ru'man and several others. As-Suddi commented, Before the idolaters left Makkah for Badr, they clung to the curtains covering the Ka'bah and supplicated to Allah for victory, O Allah! Give victory to the exalted among the two armies, the most honored among the two groups, and the most righteous among the two tribes. Allah revealed the Ayah, "If you ask for a judgement, then now has the judgement come unto you." Allah says here, "I accepted your supplication and Muhammad gained the victory. Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said; This is Allah the Most High's answer to their supplication; 'And (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this is indeed the truth from you..." [8:32] Allah said next, "and if you cease... from your disbelief and rejection of Allah and His Messenger" it will be better for you}, in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said, &V o0 |l * Ahmad 5:531 * An-Nasa'i in Al-Kubra 6 :350 and Al-Hakim 2 :328 At-Jabari 13:453.

Al-Anfal (20 - 23) (Part-9) "and if you return, so shall We return... This is similar to another Ayah, "but if you return (to sins), We shall return (to Our punishment)." (17:8) meaning, "if you persist in your disbelief and misguidance, We shall repeat the defeat that you suffered, and your forces will be of no avail to you, however numerous they be..." for even if you gather whatever forces you can, then know

that those whom Allah is with cannot be defeated, \$ji} iand verily, Allah is with the believers.} in reference to the Prophet s group, the side of the chosen Messenger jg. m 2b&& % feZ St i&J *u\ if i* oftif & e&S & fc fe 'if # % 'i 120. O you who believe! Obey Allah and His Messenger, and turn not away from him while you are hearing.} 121. And be not like those who say: "We have heard," but they hear not.} 422. Verily, the worst of living creatures with Allah are the deaf and the dumb (the disbelievers), who understand not.} 423. Had Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen; and even if He had made them listen, they would but have turned away with aversion.} The Command to obey Allah and His Messenger^ Allah commands His believing servants to obey Him and His Messenger 3g and warns them against defying him and

284 Tafsir lbtt Katlur imitating the disbelievers who reject him. Allah said, iand turn not away from him...}, neither refrain from obeying him or following his commands nor indulge in what he forbade, iwhile you are hearing.} after you gained knowledge of his Message, iAnd be not like those who say: "We have heard," but tlwy hear not.} Ibn Ishaq said that this Ayah refers to the hypocrites, who pretend to hear and obey, while in fact they do neither. 111 Allah declares that these are the most wicked creatures among the Children of Adam, iVerily, the worst of living creatures with Allah are the deaf} who do not hear the truth. iand the dumb} who cannot comprehend it, iioho understand not.} These indeed are the most wicked creatures, for eveiy creature except them abide by the way that Allah created in them. These people were created to worship Allah, but instead disbelieved. This is why Allah equated them to animals, when He said, i'faj j ij> => jd\ iAnd the example of those who disbelieve is as that of him wlto shouts to those that hear nothing but calls and cries.} [2:171], and, 4\$ fa? git m At-Tabari 13 :458

Al-Anfdl (23 - 24) (Part-9) ijhey are like cattle, nay even more astray ; those! They are the heedless ones.} [7:179] It was also said that the Ayah (8:22) refers to some of the pagans of Quraysh from the tribe of Bani Abd Ad-Dar, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Ibn Jarir. 1 11 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that this Ayah refers to hypocrites, as we stated. There is no contradiction here, because both disbelievers and hypocrites are devoid of sound comprehension, in addition to having lost the intention to do good. Allah states here that such are those who neither have sound understanding nor good intentions, even if they have some type of reason, l iil' p 'jj} 4Had Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen.} He would have helped them understand. However, this did not happen because there is no goodness in such people, for Allah knows that, ieven if He had made them listen...} and allowed them to understand, ithey would but have turned...}, intentionally and out of stubbornness, even after they comprehend, iwith aversion.}, to the truth. &\$& k q 4 \p: l&> & * P' 424. O you who believe! Answer Allah and (His) Messenger wheti he (the Messenger) calls you to that which will give you life, and know that Allah comes between a person and his heart. And verily to Him you shall (all) be gathered.} (M At-Tabari 13:460.

286 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir The Command to answer and obey Allah and His Messenger jg Al-Bukhfiri said, "^Answer), obey, Q) ithat which will give you life> that which will make your affairs good. Al-Bukhari went on to narrate that Abu Said bin Al- Mu'alla said, I was praying when the Prophet jgj passed by and called me, but I did not answer him until I finished the prayer. He said, :iiJl Jju S'jZfc jf kiUli U" *What prevented you from answering me? Has not Allah said: a lit k w 40 you who believe! Answer Allah and

(His) Messenger when he calls you to that which will give you life)?' He then said: 'Z will teach you the greatest Surah in the Qur'an before I leave. When he was about to leave, I mentioned what he said to me. He said, 'All the praises and thanks are to Allah, the Lord of all that exists...' [1:1-6]. Surely, it is the seven oft-repeated verses.' Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Muhammad bin Jafar bin Az-Zubayr said that Urwah bin Az-Zubayr explained this Ayah, Q lit&% ip: \vk) 1,1 Fath Al-B&ri 8:158.

Al-Anfdl (24) (Part-9) 40 you who believe! Answer Allah and (His) Messenger when he calls you to that which will give you life, ^ Answer when called to war (Jihad) with which Allah gives you might after meekness, and strength after weakness, and shields you from the enemy who oppressed you. [1 Allah comes in between a Person and His Heart Allah said, 4.* ^& at& Utj" iand know that Allah comes in between a person and his hearty Ibn Abbas commented, Allah prevents the believer from disbelief and the disbeliever from faith. ,2)

Al-Anfdl (25) (Part-9) Therefore, such Fitnah will not be restricted to the sinners and evildoers. Rather, it will reach the others if the sins are not stopped and prevented. Imam

290 Tafoir Ibn Katlur iYour wealth and your children are only a trial (Fitnah).. \$> (64 :15). Therefore, when you seek refuge, seek it with Allah from the Fitnah that causes misguidance. Ibn Jarir collected this Hadith. [1] The view that the warning in this Ayah addresses the Companions and all others is true, even though the speech in the Ayah was directed at the Companions. There are Hadiths that warn against Fitnah in general, thus providing the correctness of this explanation. Similarly there will be a separate book in which this subject will be discussed, Allah willing, as also is the case with the Imams, there being a number of writings about this. Of the most precise things that have been mentioned under this topic, is what was recorded by Imam

1fSj fji JLIS yj* (i" J^ j 0LSo la'af-l *. j,n: "i ^ jJ *AjiU ^y> (jl*- JUJl Ijiwl Ijl l\$li ulj &?*> Ij JI& {Ji^j j"

292 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir tl&Sli&S 'A- staeu IjL. I j!"t;teM0^>-^ O / 1/ #/ >/ /** > < " / . t ^ J iji_J3^JJ^-^I Ij 1 V JaSCjjbliJSj^J LxLjUJ, q ljlj fjp 'j^= j2 \j^-*AliV*& 'VjUiJUjjci& &iSj)ULL^jiiJli l_^!l_si^j cryJvJl <&"" >. r; *>^ *' .y/'.i^#\ " . ^ I-- pJbjl^" jjK -JP L*_J j"J ,^ fc 'Lii 11 J? l'A-- ijl ^j jr^i. *They a)/// be stricken as the people, but they loill end up with Allah's forgiveness and pleasure .s 111 Imam

you might be grateful. Reminding Muslims of Their previous State of Weakness and Subjugation which changed into Might and Triumph Allah, the Exalted, reminds His believing servants of His blessings and favors on them. They were few and He made them many, weak and fearful and He provided them with strength and victory. They were meek and poor, and He granted them sustenance and livelihood. He ordered them to be grateful to Him, and they obeyed Him and implemented what He commanded. When the believers were still in Makkah they were few, practicing their religion in secret, oppressed, fearing that pagans, fire worshippers or Romans might kidnap them from the various parts of Allah's earth, for they were all enemies of the Muslims, especially since Muslims were few and weak. Later on, Allah permitted the believers to migrate to Al-Madlnah, where He allowed them to settle in a safe resort. Allah made the people of Al-Madlnah their allies, giving them refuge and support during Badr and other battles. They helped the Migrants with their wealth and gave up their lives in

obedience of Allah and His Messenger Qatadah bin Di'amah As-Sadusi commented, / A . \ iAnd remember when you were few and were reckoned weak in the land,} Arabs were the weakest of the weak, had the toughest life, the emptiest stomachs, the barest skin and the most obvious misguidance. Those who lived among them lived in misery; those who died went to the Fire. They were being eaten up, but unable to eat up others! By Allah! We do not know of a people on the face of the earth at that time who had a worse life than them. When Allah brought Islam, He made it dominant on the earth, thus bringing provisions and leadership for them over the necks of people. It is through Islam that Allah granted all what you see, so thank Him for His favors, for your Lord is One Who bestows favors and likes praise. Verily, those who thank Allah enjoy even more bounties

from Him. 11 ' Q1 ^ it j V l K yt fc> 4\$ZZJ % "i* 'it llii , #! 427. O you who believe! Betray not Allah and His Messenger, nor betray knowingly your Amanat (things entrusted to you)}. 428. And know that your possessions and your children are but a trial and that surely, with Allah is a mighty reward.} Reason behind revealing This Ayah, and the prohibition of Betrayal The Two Sahihs mention the story of Hatib bin Abi Balta'ah. In the year of the victory of Makkah he wrote to the Quraysh alerting them that the Messenger of Allah ig intended to march towards them. Allah informed His Messenger of this, and he sent a Companion to retrieve the letter that Hatib sent, and then he summoned him. He admitted to what he did. T Jmar bin Al-Khattab stood up and said, O Allah s Messenger! Should I cut off his head, for he has betrayed Allah, His Messenger and the believers? The Prophet jg said, U 1 : dlSi jjj JaI L_ ^ip)1 iliajJu Uj 1 1 j-b ji [i l^J Jjyii. jii ijLf "Leave him! He participated in Badr. How do you know that Allah has not looked at those who participated in Badr and said, Do whatever you want, for I have forgiven you.n However, it appears that this Ayah is more general, even if it was revealed about a specific incident. * Such rulings are dealt with by their indications, not the specific reasons behind revealing them, according to the majority of scholars. Betrayal includes both minor and major sins, as well those that affect others. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on the Ayah, Tabari 13:478. He is saying this here because he mentioned two unauthentic stories in that regard . Additionally , in the case of Hatib , the Ayah revealed was Al- Mumtahinah 60 : 1 as recorded by Al-Hakim and others

inor betray your Amdnat} The Amanah refers to the actions that Allah has entrusted the servants with, such as and including what He ordained. Therefore, Allah says here, 4nor betray...}, do not abandon the obligations. ' Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd commented, Allah forbade you from betraying Him and His Messenger, as hypocrites do. 12 Allah said, T3 ((And know that your possessions and your children are but a trial.} from Him to you. He grants these to you so that He knows which of you will be grateful and obedient to Him, or become busy with and dedicated to them instead of Him. Allah said in another Ayah, %h xi\} ((Your wealth and your children are only a trial, whereas Allah! With Him is a great reward.} [64:15], Jttj \$& 4And We shall make a trial of you with evil and with good.} [21:35], 40 you who believe! Let not your properties or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah . And whosoever does that, then they are the losers.^[63:9], and, At-Tabari 13:485. Tabari 13:483.

40 you who believe! Verily, among your wives and your children there are enemies for you (who may stop you from the obedience of Allah); therefore beware of them!} [64:14] Allah said next, 4tLki% i'x*& 4And that surely with Allah is a mighty reward.} Therefore, Allah s reward, favor and Paradise

are better for you than wealth and children. Certainly, among the wealth and children there might be enemies for you and much of them avail nothing. With Allah alone is the decision and sovereignty in this life and the Hereafter, and He gives tremendous rewards on the Day of Resurrection. In the Sahih, there is a Hadith in which the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "There are three qualities for which whomever has them, he will have tasted the sweetness of faith. (They are:) whoever Allah and His Messenger are dearer to him than anyone else, whoever loves a person for Allah's sake alone, and whoever prefers to be thrown in fire rather than revert to disbelief, after Allah has saved him from it." Therefore, loving the Messenger of Allah ﷺ comes before loving children, wealth and oneself. In the Sahih, it is confirmed that he ﷺ said, "By Him in Whose Hand is my soul! None of you will have faith unless I become dearer to him than himself, his family, his wealth and all people in > Sfr-. *** Muslim 1 :66. Al-Bdri 1 :75.

to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you (from your home, Makkah); they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the best of plotters.} The Makkans plot to kill the Prophet imprison or expel Him from Makkah Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said, iLiyuthbituka} means to imprison you. 111 As-Suddi said, Ithbat is to confine or to shackle. 121 Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar, the author of Al- Maghazi, reported from Abdullah bin Abi Najih, from Mujahid, from Ibn Abbas, Some of the chiefs of the various tribes of Quraysh gathered in Dar An-Nadwah (their conference area) and Iblls (Shaytan) met them in the shape of an eminent old man. When they saw him, they asked, Who are you? He said, An old man from Najd. I heard that you are having a meeting, and I wished to attend your meeting. You will benefit from my opinion and advice. They said, Agreed, come in. He entered with them. Iblls said, You have to think about this man (Muhammad)! By Allah, he will soon overwhelm you with his matter (religion). One of them said, Imprison him, restrained in chains, until he dies just like the poets before him all died, such as Zuhayr and An-Nabighah! Verily, he is a poet like they were. The old man from Najd, the enemy of Allah, commented, By Allah! This is not a good idea. His Lord will

release him from his prison to his companions, who will liberate him from your hands. They will protect him from you and they might expel you from your land. They said. This old man said the truth. Therefore, seek an opinion other than this one. Another one of them said, Expel him from your land, so that you are free from his trouble! If he leaves your land, you will not be bothered by what he does or where he goes, as long as he is not among you to bring you troubles, he will be with someone else. The old man from Najd replied, *By Allah! This At-Tabari 13:492. (2) At-Tabari 13:491.

Al-Anfal (30) (Part-9) is not a good opinion. Have you forgotten his sweet talk and eloquency, as well as, how his speech captures the hearts? By Allah! This way, he will collect even more followers among Arabs, who will gather against you and attack you in your own land, expel you and kill your chiefs. They said, He has said the truth, by Allah! Therefore, seek an opinion other than this one. Abu Jahl, may Allah curse him, spoke next, *By Allah! I have an idea that no one else has suggested yet, and I see no better opinion for you. Choose a strong, socially elevated young man from each tribe, and give each one of them a sharp sword. Then they would all strike Muhammad at the same time with their swords and kill him. Hence, his blood would be shed by all tribes. This way, his tribe, Banu Hashim, would realize that they cannot wage war against all of the Quraysh tribes and would be forced to agree to accept the blood money; we would have brought comfort to ourselves and stopped him from bothering us. The old man from Najd commented, *By Allah! This man has expressed the best opinion, and I do not support any other opinion. They quickly ended their meeting and started preparing for the implementation of this plan. Jibril came to the Prophet ﷺ and commanded him not to sleep in his bed that night and conveyed to him the news of their plot. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ did not sleep in his house that night, and Allah gave him permission to migrate. After the Messenger migrated to Al-Madinah, Allah revealed to him Surat Al-Anfal reminding him of His favors and the bounties He gave him, %& im } \& U\$ 4 Pi >& i And (remember) when the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you (from Makkah); they were plotting and Allah too was plotting ; and Allah is the best of plotters.> Allah replied to the pagans statement that they should await the death of the Prophet ﷺ, just as the poets before him perished, as they claimed,

300 Tafafr Ibn Kathfr tl Ji- O;^ ft i Or do they say: "He is a poet! We axvait far him some calamity by time!" } [52:30] |1! As-Suddi narrated a similar story. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Muhammad bin Ja'far bin Az-Zubayr, from Urwah bin Az-Zubayr who commented on Allah s statement, jy. "jJj iii 'faSj 'ojfazfayp i...they were plotting and Allah too tuas plotting, and Allah is the best of plotters.} I (Allah) plotted against them with My sure planning, and I saved you (O Muhammad) from them. 121 U^" ijji ji* Uiil ILls y L. iC jj ijHi j-i fyy} U o*j' y> 4 J-iii 'jJLj ilj Kjffai ^ i'j ii' liS h;.*J Liii) .iLLJi ^ iit 431. Aw/ when Our Aydt are recited to them, they say: "We have heard (the Qur an); if we wish we can say the like of this. This is nothing but the tales of the ancients. } 432. And (remember) when they said: "O Allah! If this (the Qur an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the skv/ or bring on us a painful torment. } 433 . And Allah would not punish them ivhile you (Muhammad 5fe) are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah s) forgiveness.} The Quraysh claimed They can produce Something similar to the Qur an Allah describes the disbelief, transgression, rebellion, as well as misguided statements that the pagans of Quraysh used to Sirah Ibn Hisham 1 :480-482. This story as narrated here is not authentic 121 Sirah Ibn Hisham 2 :325

utter when they heard Allah's Ayat being recited to them, 4'xi Ji* ijiy 4 We have heard (the Qur'an); if we wish we can say the like of this."} They boasted with their words, but not with their actions. They were challenged several times to bring even one chapter like the Qur'an, and they had no way to meet this challenge. They only boasted in order to deceive themselves and those who followed their falsehood. It was said that An-Nadr bin Al-Harith, may Allah curse him, was the one who said this, according to Sa'Id bin Jubayr, As-Suddi, Ibn Jurayj and others. An-Nadr visited Persia and learned the stories of some Persian kings, such as Rustum and Isphandiyar. When he went back to Makkah, He found that the Prophet was sent from Allah and reciting the Qur'an to the people. Whenever the Prophet would leave an audience in which An-Nadr was sitting, An-Nadr began narrating to them the stories that he learned in Persia, proclaiming afterwards, Who, by Allah, has better tales to narrate, I or Muhammad? When Allah allowed the Muslims to capture An-Nadr in Badr, the Messenger of Allah j&s commanded that his head be cut off before him, and that was done, all thanks are due to Allah. The meaning of, 4 ...tales of the ancients meaning that the Prophet jg has plagiarized and learned books of ancient people,- and this is what he narrated to people, as they claimed. This is the pure falsehood that Allah mentioned in another Ayah, 4And they say: "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down :, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon." Say: "It (this Qur'an) has been sent down by Him (Allah) Who knows the secret of the heavens and the earth. Truly, He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} [25:5-6] for those who repent and return to Him, He accepts repentance from them and forgives them.

The Idolaters ask for Allah's Judgment and Torment! Allah said, Si iljifr ly, iij' y, ill ijilt yij is# ji iAnd (remember) when they said: O Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment. } This is indicative of the pagans enormous ignorance, denial, stubbornness and transgression. They should have said, O Allah! If this is the truth from You, then guide us to it and help us follow it. However, they brought Allah's judgment on themselves and asked for His punishment. Allah said in other Ayat, 4\$ "< >- '-* hUj ' 33 VjiJ jjiL \$ %} they ask you to hasten on the torment (for them), and had it not been for a term appointed, the torment would certainly have come to them. And surely, it will come upon them suddenly while they perceive not!} [29:53], -tf. 35 u J-f Gy ijjO> A'They say: Our Lord! Hasten to us Qittand (our record of good and bad deeds so that we may see it) before the Day of Reckoning!"} [38:16], and, 4A questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall. Upon the disbelievers, which none can avert. From Allah, the Lord of the ways of ascent.} [70:1-3] The ignorant ones in ancient times said similar things. The people of Shu'ayb said to him, Si S Si&} 4 So cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!"}[26:187] while the pagans of Quraysh said.

Al-Anfal (31 - 33) (Part-9 \ l 2)1 ^& U. ft- <\$"0 A//fl/t/ // f/j/s (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment. Shu*bah said from Abdul-Hamid that Anas bin Malik said that it was Abu Jahl bin Hish&m who uttered this statement. Oil } .122)1 i"0 Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment." > So Allah revealed this Ayah, \$And Allah would not punish them while you are among them, nor will He punish them while they seek (Allah's) forgiveness

304 Tafsir Ibtī Kathr obedience, O Allah, there is no partner with You except a partner who is with You, You own Him but he does not own! They also used to say, O Allah, Your forgiveness, Your forgiveness. Allah revealed this verse; fit 4Atid Allah would not punish them while you are among them...y Ibn Abbas commented, They had two safety shelters: the Prophet jg, and their seeking forgiveness (from Allah). The Prophet 2g went away, and only seeking forgiveness remained. 111

Al-Anfdl (34 - 35) (Part-9 Al-Hakim, Its chain is Sahih and they did not record it. 111 >' tit "' ;' * ,3? l*J (*r4" *) > j-v W ^Sj^ 'Jj kX t*J 'n , tL> v 'Jsji <(34 . And why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Har- am, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those who have Taqwa, but most of them know 435. Their Saldh at the House was nothing but Mukd' and Tasdiyah. Therefore taste the punishment because you used to disbelieve. The Idolaters deserved Allah s Torment alter Their Atrocities Allah states that the idolaters deserved the torment, but He did not torment them in honor of the Prophet residing among them. After Allah allowed the Prophet s , to migrate away from them, He sent His torment upon them on the day of Badr. During that battle, the chief pagans were killed, or captured. Allah also directed them to seek forgiveness for the m Al-Hakim 4 :261

sins, Shirk and wickedness they indulged in. If it was not for the fact that there were some weak Muslims living among the Makkan pagans, those Muslims who invoked Allah for His forgiveness, Allah would have sent down to them the torment that could never be averted. Allah did not do that on account of the weak, ill-treated, and oppressed believers living among them, as He reiterated about the day at Al-Hudaybiyyah, iJWy Vj jy. O* pfeyi-y yjl } Aill jju :S' : r i " *? O v itf;ci C& G j^ ji Cf iThey are the ones who disbelieved and hindered you from Al- Masjid Al-Hardm (at Makkah) and detained the sacrificial animals from reaching their place of sacrifice. Had there not been believing men and believing women whom you did not know, that you may kill them and on whose account a sin would have been committed by you without (your) knowledge, that Allah might bring into His mercy whom He wills if they (the believers and the disbelievers) had been apart, We verily, would have punished those ofthem who disbelieved with painful torment.} [48:25] Allah said here, ol Q6. &&^ ii"1 j & v!% Cj} iAnd why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Hardm, and they are not its guardians? Hone can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd, but most ofthem know not.} Allah asks, why would not He torment them while they are stopping Muslims from going to Al-Masjid Al-Hardm, thus hindering the believers, its own people, from praying and performing Tawafin it? Allah said, si tjfc, cj} iAnd they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd,} meaning, the Prophet jgg and his Companions are the true

Al-Anfal (34 - 35) (Part-9) dwellers (or worthy maintainers) of Al-Masjid Al-Haram, not the pagans. Allah said in other Ayah, iXf- & -\$ M c5 tt !\$*S ol St -Ji *K ii3lt ;0J is nof for the polytheists, to maintain the Masjids ofAllah, while they witness disbelief against themselves. The works of such are in vain and in the Fire shall they abide. The Masjids ofAllah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Saldh, and give the Zakah and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance [9:17-18], and, 4 iig *ii ^ jrpjj ft ="j o "f a greater (transgression) with Allah is to prevent mankind from following the way of Allah, to disbelieve in Him, to prevent access to Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah), and to drive out its inhabitants, [2:217]. Urwah, As-Suddi and

Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Allah's statement, 45,53! -Ji 4SuJ ii> iNone can be its guardians except those who have Taqwd,\$ refers to Muhammad and his Companions, may Allah be pleased with them all. Mujahid explained that this Ayah is about the Mujahidin [in Allah's cause], whomever and wherever they may be. Allah then mentioned the practice of the pagans next to Al- Masjid Al-Haram and the respect they observed in its vicinity, ih+Zj jLs ftkz at IS# iTheir Saldh (prayer) at the House was nothing but Mukd' and Tasdiyah.} Abdullah bin Umar, Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Abu Raja Al-Utardi, Muhammad bin Ka'b Al-Qurazi,

SQp Tafsir Ibn Katlur Hujr bin Anbas, Nubayt bin Sharit, Qatadah and Abdur- Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this part of the Ayah refers to whistling.' Mujahid added that the pagans used to place their fingers in their mouth (while whistling).²¹ Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, AThcir Salat at the House was nothing but Muka and Tasdiyah The Quraysh used to perform Tawaf (encircling the Ka bah) while naked, whistling and clapping their hands, for Muka means whistling , while, Tasdiyah means clapping the hands. This meaning was also reported from Ibn Abbas, by Ali bin Abi Talhah and Al- Awfi. Similar was recorded from Ibn Umar, Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Abu Salamah bin Abdur-Rahman, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah, Atiyyah Al- Awfi, Hujr bin Anbas and Ibn Abza. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Umar explained the Ayah, i\J==*i jL^ ^ l iTheir Salat at the House ions nothing but Muka' and Tasdiyah .} Muka means \whistling , while, Tasdiyah means clapping the hands. Said bin Jubayr and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd said that, = iand Tasdiyah}, means, they hindered from the path of Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored.³ Allah said, ATherefore taste the punishment because you used to disbelieve.} This refers to the death and capture that they suffered during the battle of Badr, according to Ad-Dahhak, Ibn Jurayj and Muhammad bin Ishaq.⁴ ' At-Tabari 13:522, 526. At-Tabari 13:525. |3) At-Tabari 13:527. At-Tabari 13:528.

o/3 pj jJl.j Jj^p Ji- IjjuaJ JjkJCj. IfjiS' 6^ " Sf J^- 4 T r ?U; 4 , => ,ur ijff jig; 436. Verily, those who disbelieve spend their wealth to hinder (men) from the path of Allah, and so will they continue to spend it; but in the end it will become an anguish for them. Then they will be overcome. And those who disbelieve will be gathered unto Hell.\$ 437. In order that Allah may distinguish the wicked from the good, and put the wicked one over another, heap them together and cast them into Hell. Those! it is they who are the losers The Disbelievers spend Their Wealth to hinder Others from Allah's Path, but this will only cause Them Grief Muhammad bin Ishaq narrated that Az-Zuhri, Muhammad bin Yahya bin Hibban, Asim bin Umar bin Qatadah, and Al- Husayn bin Abdur-Rahman bin Amr bin Said bin Mu adh said, The Quraysh suffered defeat at Badr and their forces went back to Makkah, while Abu Sufyan went back with the caravan intact. This is when Abdullah bin Abi Rabl'ah, Ikninah bin Abi Jahl, Safwan bin Umayyah and other men from Quraysh who lost their fathers, sons or brothers in Badr, went to Abu Sufyan bin Harb. They said to him, and to those among the Quraysh who had wealth in that caravan, O people of Quraysh! Muhammad has grieved you and killed the chiefs among you. Therefore, help us with this wealth so that we can fight him, it may be that we will avenge our losses. They agreed. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, This Ayah was revealed about them, according to Ibn Abbas, iVerily, those who disbelieve spend their wealth ..> until, it they who are the losers.y Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al- m At-Tabari 13:532.

310 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Hakam bin TJaynah, Qatadah, As-Suddi and Ibn Abza said that this Ayah was revealed about Abu Sufyan and his spending money in Uhud to fight the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. Ad-Dahhak said that this Ayah was revealed about the idolaters of Badr. In any case, the Ayah is general, even though there was a specific incident that accompanied its revelation. Allah states here that the disbelievers spend their wealth to hinder from the path of truth. However, by doing that, their money will be spent and then will become a source of grief and anguish for them, availing them nothing in the least. They seek to extinguish the Light of Allah and make their word higher than the word of truth. However, Allah will complete His Light, even though the disbelievers hate it. He will give aid to His religion, make His Word dominant, and His religion will prevail above all religions. This is the disgrace that the disbelievers will taste in this life; and in the Hereafter, they will taste the torment of the Fire. Whoever among them lives long, will witness with his eyes and hear with his ears what causes grief to him. Those among them who are killed or die will be returned to eternal disgrace and the everlasting punishment. This is why Allah said, *It is so that they will continue to spend it; but in the end it will become an anguish for them. Then they will be overcome. And those who disbelieve will be gathered unto Hell.* Allah said, *in order that Allah may distinguish the wicked from the good.*, meaning recognize the difference between the people of happiness and the people of misery, according to Ibn Abbas, as Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from him. 'Allah Tabari 13:530-531. At-Tabari 13:533. 3| At-Tabari 13:534.

Al-Anfal (37 - 40) (Part-9) distinguishes between those believers who obey Him and fight His disbelieving enemies and those who disobey Him. Allah said in another Ayah, *if you do not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good. Nor will Allah disclose to you the secrets of the Unseen.* [3:179], and, *Do you think that you will enter Paradise before Allah (tests) those of you who fought (in His cause) and (also) tests those who are the patient?* [3:142]. Therefore, the Ayah (8:37) means, *We tried you with combatant disbelievers whom We made able to spend money in fighting you, in order that Allah may distinguish the wicked from the good, and put the wicked one over another, heap them together} put in a pile on top of each other, and cast them into Hell. Those! It is they who are the losers.* [8:37], in this life and the Hereafter. *Say to those who have disbelieved, if they cease, their past will be forgiven. But if they return (thereto), then the examples of those (punished) before them have already preceded (as a warning).* 139. And fight them until there is no more Fitnah, and the

Al-Anfal (38 - 40) (Part-9) *And if they return,} and remain on their ways, then the examples of those (punished) before them have already preceded. [8:38] meaning, Our way with the nations of old is that when they disbelieve and rebel, We send down to them immediate torment and punishment. The Order to fight to eradicate Shirk and Kufr Allah said, And fight them until there is no more Fitnah, and the religion will all be for Allah alone.*

314 Tafsir Ibt Kathir agree to what he is saying, he asked him, What do you say about Ali and Uthman? Ibn Umar replied, What do I say about Ali and Uthman! As for Uthman, Allah has forgiven him, but you hate that Allah forgives him. As for Ali, he is the cousin of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and his son-in-law, 11 ' and he pointed with his hand saying, And this is his house over there. Said bin Jubayr said,

Ibn Umar came to us and was asked, What do you say about fighting during Fitnah? Ibn Umar said, Do you know what Fitnah refers to? Muhammad jg was fighting against the idolators, and at that time, attending (or residing with) the idolators was a Fitnah (trial in religion). It is nothing like what you are doing, fighting to gain leadership! '2 ' All these narrations were collected by Al- Bukhari, may Allah the Exalted grant him His mercy. Ad- Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said about the Ayah, \$Andfight them until there is no more Fitnah... So that there is no more Shirk. '3 ' Similar was said by Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ar-Rabl bin Anas, As- Suddi, Muqatil bin Hayyan and Zayd bin Aslam. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that he was informed from Az-Zuhri, from Urwah bin Az-Zubayr and other scholars that 4*i 'op v iuntil there is no more Fitnah^ the Fitnah mentioned here means, until no Muslim is persecuted so that he abandons his religion.'4 ' Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas said about Allah s statement, 4fk iand the religion (worship) will all befor Allah alone. > So that Tawhid is practiced in sincerity with Allah. '5 Al- Hasan, Qatadah and Ibn Jurayj said, Al-Bari 8 : 160 Al-Bari 8 :160.Tabari 13:538. 141 Ibn AbiHatim 5:1701. (5 ' Ibn Abi Hatim 5:1701.

315Suralt 8. Al-Anfal (38 - 40) (Part-9) iik iand the religion will all be for Allah alone So that La ilaha illa- llah is proclaimed. ' Muhammad bin Ishaq also commented on this Ayah, So that Tawhid is practiced in sincerity towards Allah, without Shirk, all the while shunning all rivals who (are being worshipped) besides Him. ' Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said about, iand the religion will all befor Allah alone> So that there is no more Kufr (disbelief) with your religion remains. 13' There is a Hadith collected in the Two Sahihs that testifies to this explanation. The Messenger of Allah jg said, "/ was commanded to fight against the people until they proclaim, There is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah.' If and when they say it, they will preserve their blood and wealth from me, except for its right (Islamic penal code), and their reckoning is with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored ," ' Also, in the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abu Musa Al- Ash'ari said, The Messenger of Allah jg was asked about a man who fights because he is courageous, in prejudice with his people, or to show off. Which of these is for the cause of Allah? He said, *J*J 3* J11 J. <&' QS ojzj JJli If 1Whoever fights so that Allah s Word is the supreme, is in the cause ofAllah, the Exalted and Most Honored.v') Allah said next, At-Tabari 13:538-539. Sirah Ibn Hisham 2 :327 ' At-Tabari 13:539. ' FathAl-Bari 1 :95 and Muslim 1:53. Al-Bukhari nos: 123, 2810, 3126 and 7458

iBut if they ceased, and desist from their Kufr as a result ofyour fighting them, even though you do not know the true reasons why they did so, Hj iit 4then certainly, Allah is All-Seer ofwhat they do.\$ Allah said in similar Ayah, ijte ijas4\$ 4But if they repent and perform the Saldh, and give Zakdh, then leave their way freef [9:5], 4< **!' j 4 ...then they are your brethren in religion . \$> [9:1 1], and, 4 o'jj* "% / j]T 3/jj V^ f {And fight them until there is no more Fitnalt and the religion (worship) is for Allah (alone). But if they cease, let there be no transgression except against the wrongdoers . [2:193] It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah m said to Usamah bin Zayd when he overpowered a man with his sword, after that man proclaimed that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah; 3 V ii] % ?Sii ill i jii u Ju; Haw you killed him after he proclaimed, Id Ildha Illalldh'? What would you do with regard to 'La Ildha Illalldh' on the Day ofResurrection . Usamah said, O Allah s Messenger! He only said it to save himself. The Messenger jfe replied, h?aJL5 ji- c-Sii Did you cut his heart open ?" The Messenger^ kept repeating, fa Jj]l ilj % ill Whatwould you do with regard to La Ildha Illalldh on the Day

ik iverily, one-fifth of it is assigned to Allah\$ is inclusive [of the Messenger s share], just as the following Ayah is inclusive [of Allah owning whatever is on the earth also], j Cj 4 U fs& iT Allah belongs all that is in the heavens and on the earth\$[2:284]. ,1) So He addressed the share of Allah and the share of His Messenger 2g in the same statement. Ibrahim An-Nakha i, Al-Hasan bin Muhammad bin Al- Hanifiyyah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ash-Sha'bi, Ata bin Abi Rabah, Abdullah bin Buraydah, Qatadah, Mughlrah and several others, all said that the share designated for Allah and the Messenger is one and the same.¹² Supporting this is what Imam Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi recorded, with a Sahlh chain of narrators, that Abdullah bin Shaqxq said that a man from Bilqln said, I came to the Prophet sgg when he was in Wadi Al-Qura inspecting a horse. I asked, 'O Allah s Messenger! What about the Ghanimah? He said, j l j > 4|D ^Allah's share is one fifth andfour-fifths arefor the army. I asked, *None of them has more right to it than anyone else? He said, u>-l "No. Even ifyou remove an arrow that pierced your flank, you have no more right to it tlwn your

ijA-JljJ f^==Ut Sr **il' jj-iiit fklj Lilli ijlill * ^iJL* -24+i Vjiin iif (jffl JliLjl ^ j iV 4:><;,U Lq 'if -<>- f-- ' - ' i42. (And remember) when you (the Muslim army) were on the near side of the valley, and they on the farther side, and the caravan on the ground lower than you. Even ifyou had made a mutual appointment to meet, you would certainly have failed in the appointment, but (you met) that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained (in His knowledge), so that those who were to be destroyed (for rejecting the faith) might be destroyed after a clear evidence, and those who were to live (believers) might live after a clear evidence. And surely, Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} Some Details ofthe Battle ofBadr Allah describes Yawm Al-Furqan, (i.e. the day of Badr), 4Clif ii" i(And remember) when you (the Muslim army) were on the near side of the valley,} camping in the closest entrance of the valley towards Al- Madlnah, iand they}, the idolators, who were camped, hZii} ion thefarther side}, from Al-Madlnah, towards Makkah. iand the caravan}, that was under the command ofAbu Sufyan, with the wealth that it contained, 0= 3} ion the ground lower than you}, closer to the sea, 0^

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not have met them, ill ibut (you met) that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained,} Allah had decreed that He would bring gloiy to Islam and its people, while disgracing Shirk and its people. You [the companions] had no knowledge this would happen, but it was out of Allah s compassion that He did that. ' In a Hadlth, Ka b bin Malik said, The Messenger of Allah jg and the Muslims marched to intercept the Quraysh caravan, but Allah made them meet their (armed) enemy without appointment. '21 Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Yazid bin Ruwman narrated to him that Urwah bin Az-Zubayr said, Upon approaching Badr, the Messenger of Allah sg sent Ali bin Abi Talib, Sa d bin Abi Waqqas, Az-Zubayr bin Al- Awwam and several other Companions to spy the pagans. They captured two boys, a servant of Bani Said bin A1- As and a servant of Bani Al-Hajjaj, while they were bringing water for Quraysh. So they brought them to the Messenger of Allah jg, but found him praying. The Companions started interrogating the boys, asking them to whom they belonged. Both of them said that they were employees bringing water for Quraysh (army). The Componions were upset with that answer, since they thought that the boys belonged to Abu Sufyan (who was commanding the caravan). So they beat the two boys vehemently, who said finally that they belonged to Abu Sufyan. Thereupon companions left them alone. When the Prophet jg ended the prayer, he said, Ibn HishSm 2 :328. ' At-Tabari 13:566.

tJ-iA M! i ijij ^s ijij> J* jy.rA "When they tell you the truth you beat them, but when they lie you let than go? They have said the truth, by Allalt! They belong to the Quraysh. (addressing to the boys He said:) Tell me the neivs about Quraysh. " The two boys said, They are behind this hill that you see, on the far side of the valley. The Messenger of Allah jg asked, pin *How many are they? " They said, They are many. He asked, eHow many? 11 They said, We do not know the precise number. He asked, A" *How many camels do they slaughter every day? They said, Nine or ten a day. The Messenger of Allah said, MV l ".*...ll jZ Li "They are betweai nine-hundred and a thousand.* He asked again, ^ bi r+i 'Which chiefs of Quraysh are accompanying the army?*' They said, TJtbah bin Rabl'ah, Shaybah bin Rabl'ah, Abu Al- Bakhtari bin Hisham, Hakim bin Hizfim, Nawfal bin Khuwaylid, Al-Harith bin Amir bin Nawfal, Tu'aymah bin Adi bin Nawfal, An-Nadr bin Al-Harith, Zam ah bin Al-Aswad, Abu Jahl bin Hisham, Umayyah bin Khalaf, Nablh and Munabbih sons of Al-Hajjaj, Suhayl bin Amr and Amr bin Abd Wadd. The Messenger of Allah^ said to the people, 1L&JuS p^lij oJjl iSLi ;Jlat 'This is Makkahl She has brought you her most precious sons

(its chiefs)!* w Allah said, if i^iJ if iSo that those who were to be destroyed might be destroyed after a clear evidence.} [8:42] Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, So that those who disbelieve do so after witnessing clear evidence, proof and lessons, and those who believe do so after witnessing the same. * This is a sound explanation. Allah says, He made you meet your enemy in one area without appointment, so that He gives you victory over them. This way, He will raise the word of truth above falsehood, so that the matter is made clear, the proof unequivocal and the evidence plain. Then there will be no more plea or doubt for anyone. Then, those destined to destruction by persisting in disbelief do so with evidence, aware that they are misguided and that proof has been established against them, 4dr o* inrt 4and those who were to live might live}, those who wish to believe do so, Rafter a clear evidence}, and proof. Verily, faith is the life of the heart, as Allah said, 4os&4 </y %&Z l? 'Jr if ils he who was dead (without faith by ignorance and disbelief) and We gave him life (by knowledge and faith) and set for him a light (of belief) whereby he can walk among men ...} [6:122]. Allah said next, iyz&^j} iAnd surely, Allah is All-Hearer}, of your invocation, humility and requests for His help, ** Ibn Hisham

2 :268 Although this version is not authentic, no. 1779 of Muslim , and 948 of Musnad Ahmad are witnesses for it. * At-Tabari 13:568.

4All-Knower} meaning; about you, and you deserve victory over your rebellious, disbelieving enemies. o & 4 jj; it -4 iis f; ^t ^A it tfv J*t v Jij 'iyu* fpi "ili ij -XfejUp ^Lli 443. (And remember) when Allah showed them to you as few in your dream; if He had shown them to you as many, you would surely have been discouraged, and you would surely have disputed in making a decision. But Allah saved (you). Certainly, He is the All-Knower of that is in the breasts.} 444. And (remember) when you met. He showed them to you as few in your eyes and He made you appear as few in their eyes, so that Allah might accomplish a matter already ordained, and to Allah return all matters (for decision).} Allah made each Group look few in the Bye of the Other Mujahid said, In a dream, Allah showed the Prophet the enemy as few. The Prophet jg conveyed this news to his Companions and their resolve strengthened. Similar was said by Ibn Ishaq and several others. Allah said, 4If He had shown them to you as many, you would surely, have been discouraged,} you would have cowardly abstained from meeting them and fell in dispute among yourselves, 4j& Sat 4But Allah saved}, from all this, when He made you see them as few, At-Jabari 13:570. At-Tabari 13:570.

jLic fj>\} 4Certainly , He is the All-Knower of that is in the breasts.} [8:43]. Allah knows what the heart and the inner-self conceal, Jj& j\$Z} iAllah knows the fraud of the eyes, and all that the breasts conceal [40:19]. Allah s statement, m - w si" iAnd (remember) when you met, He slwdd them to you as few in your eyes} demonstrates Allah s compassion towards the believers. Allah made them see few disbelievers in their eyes, so that they would be encouraged and feel eager to meet them. Abu Ishaq As-Subail said, that Abu Tj Baydah said that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, They were made to seem few in our eyes during Badr, so that I said to a man who was next to me, Do you think they are seventy? He said, Rather, they are a hundred. However, when we captured one of them, we asked him and he said, *We were a thousand. 1 11 Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded it. Allah said next, ti iand He made you appear as few in their eyes,} Allah said, it ^ ij> iAnd (remember) when you met. He showed them to you...}, He encouraged each of the two groups against the other, according to Ikrimah, as recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. 121 This statement has a Sahih chain of narrators. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Yahya bin Abbad bin Abdullah bin Az-Zubayr narrated to him that his father said about Allah s statement, Tabari 13:572. 121 Ibn Abi Hatim 5:1710.

J) ugaifes *at "iasa f/ iflf A//fl/i mig/ tf p>; j.ssj.w* \y accomplish a matter al- _>":b i ready ordained, In order for the war t , ' v\ ' >"< to start between i them - s that He ijj^ would have revenge aSainst those whom He decided to have J^SoIsaKoits^lfesOX^ljoJ^* revenge (pagans), and ~ grant and complete ojl His favor upon those tessi- "e decided * E; ant -r = ^ " favor to. His supporters. 111 The "\' \> ". ' " meaning of this, is Cp that Allah encouraged isC lj"ijyL^== ' each BrouP against /,<-> >/>.,sv . >> the other and made iUjiVy '~rJ -u-yj Jjfv^j J J ('-4-6i yj them look few in each ^ ' <\ ther s eyes > so that //>'a ; , ' ^ they were ea^er to meet them. This <*&* << . "<?*>"V occurred before the J battle started, but when it started and Allah supported the believers with a thousand angels in succession, the disbelieving group saw the believers double their number. Allah said, j gS" 4 j 3 Ji)> v JjS? Cs-J 4 i'l w^L (iTltere has already been a sign for you (O jews) in the two armies that met (in combat, the battle

of Badr). One was fighting in the cause of Allah, and as for the other, (they) were disbelievers. They (disbelievers) saw them (believers) with their I 1 ' Ibn Hisham 2 :328 and Ibn Abi Hatim 5 :1710.

own eyes twice their number. And Allah supports with His aid whom He wills. Verily, in this is a lesson for those who understand.) [3:13] This is how we combine these two Ayat, and certainly, each one of them is true, all the thanks are due to Allah and all the favors are from Him. C2fc> ii' 445. O you who believe! When you meet (an enemy) force, take a firm stand against them and remember Allah much, so that you may be successful. 446. And obey Allah and His Messenger, and do not dispute (with one another) lest you lose courage and your strength departs, and be patient. Surely, Allah is with the patients.) Maimers of War Allah instructs His faithful servants in the manners of fighting and methods of courage when meeting the enemy in battle, 4\ & 2J t'H Cfe> 40 you who believe! When you meet (an enemy) force, take a firm stand against them In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Abdullah bin Abi Awfa said that during one battle, Allah s Messenger ^ waited until the sun declined, then stood among the people and said. 4)1 \j)L\j ijJLajt #UJ \ jJj I V , ll U" i &Ji SI \fiSk\j "0 people! Do not wish to face the enemy (in a battle) and ask Allah to save you (from calamities). But if you should face the enemy, then be patient and let it be known to you that Paradise is under the shadows of the swords . He then stood and said, iv-^UJLJl jiJt (. JjU jltl" "*. l'ic y u-

Al-Anfdl (45 - 46) (Part-10 "0 Allah! Revealer of the (Holy) Book, Mover of the clouds, and Defeater of the Confederates, defeat them and grant us victory over them - ' The Command for Endurance when the Enemy Engaging Allah commands endurance upon meeting the enemy in battle and ordains patience while fighting them. Muslims are not allowed to run or shy away, or show cowardice in battle. They are commanded to remember Allah while in that condition and never neglect His remembrance. They should rather invoke Him for support, trust in Him and seek victoiy over their enemies from Him. They are required to obey Allah and His Messenger jfe in such circumstances adhering to what He commanded them, and abstaining from what He forbade them. They are required to avoid disputing with each other, for this might lead to their defeat and failure, ilest your strength departs}, so that your strength, endurance and courage do not depart from you, iand be patient. Surely, Allah is with the patients.} In their courage, and obedience to Allah and His Messenger, the Companions reached a level never seen before by any nation or generation before them, or any nation that will ever come. Through the blessing of the Messenger ^ and their obedience to what he commanded, the Companions were able to open the hearts, as well as, the various eastern and western parts of the world in a rather short time. This occurred even though they were few, compared to the armies of the various nations at that time. For example, the Romans, Persians, Turks, Slavs, Berbers, Ethiopians, Sudanese tribes, the Copts and the rest of the Children of Adam. They defeated all of these nations, until Allah s Word became the highest and His religion became dominant above all religions. The Islamic state spread i1 ' Fath Al-B&ri 6:140 and Muslim 3 :1362.

over the eastern and western parts of the world in less than thirty years. May Allah grant them His pleasure, as well as, be pleased with them all, and may He gather us among them, for He is the Most Generous, and Giving. J*' & '&JJ '))) ^ a* \$;^#% ifju c r--/! 41 3lij Je- Cjtiitii " j-lili Jy- ",i j.j_1 iiij ii(illl ^ y **' i*' > JO \$3?*_ _> jJi? 447 . And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah; and Allah is Muhft (encompassing and

thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.) i48. And (remember) when Shaytan made their (evil) deeds seem fair to them and said, "No one of mankind can overcome you this day (of the battle of Badr) and verily, I am your neighbor (for each and every help). But when the two forces came in sight of each other, he ran away and said "Verily, I have nothing to do with you. Verily, I see what you see not. Verily, I fear Allah for Allah is severe in punishment.") 449. When the hypocrites and those in whose hearts was a disease (of disbelief) said : "These people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion." But whoever puts his trust in Allah, then surely, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.) The Idolators leave Makkah, heading for Badr After Allah commanded the believers to fight in His cause sincerely and to be mindful of Him, He commanded not to imitate the idolators, who went out of their homes i boastfully to suppress the truth, i and to be seen of men), boasting arrogantly with people. When

Abu Jahl was told that the caravan escaped safely, so they should return to Makkah, he commented, No, by Allah! We will not go back until we proceed to the well of Badr, slaughter camels, drink alcohol and female singers sing to us. This way, the Arabs will always talk about our stance and what we did on that day. However, all of this came back to haunt Abu Jahl, because when they proceeded to the well of Badr, they brought themselves to death; and in the aftermath of Badr, they were thrown in the well of Badr, dead, disgraced, humiliated, despised and miserable in an everlasting, eternal torment. This is why Allah said here, i and Allah is Muhit (encompassing and thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.} He knows how and what they came for, and this is why He made them taste the worst punishment. ' Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi commented on Allah s statement, Uiyj i And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men,} They were the idolators who fought against the Messenger of Allah sg at Badr. ' Muhammad bin Ka*b said, When the Quraysh left Makkah towards Badr, they brought female singers and drums along. Allah revealed this verse, ii'j Wj*- oA*- i And be not like those who come out of their homes boastfully and to be seen of men, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah; and Allah is Muhit (encompassing and thoroughly comprehending) all that they do.} Ibn Hisham 2 :329. Tabari 14:8-9.

Tafsir Ibn Kathir Shaytan makes Evil seem fair and deceives the Idolators Allah said next, X OiS usdif ait * Je^ i And (remember) when Shaytan made their (evil) deeds seem fair to them and said, "No one of mankind can overcome you today and verily, I am your neighbor."} Shaytan, may Allah curse him, made the idolators purpose for marching seem fair to them. He made them think that no other people could defeat them that day.' ' He also ruled out the possibility that their enemies, the tribe of Bani Bakr, would attack Makkah, saying, I am your neighbor. Shaytan appeared to them in the shape of Suraqah bin Malik bin Ju'shum, the chief of Bani Mudlij, so that, as Allah described them, i He [Shaytan] makes promises to them, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan s promises are nothing but deceptions [4: 120). Ibn Jurayj said that Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, (8:48) On the day of Badr, Shaytan, as well as, his flag holder and soldiers, accompanied the idolators. He whispered to the hearts of the idolators, None can defeat you today! I am your neighbor. When they met the Muslims and Shaytan witnessed the angels coming to their aid, J&,} i he ran away}, he went away in flight while proclaiming. 4, Verily, I see what you see not.} ^ All bin Abi Talhah said, that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah, At-Jabari 14:11. At-Tabari 14:9.

4 % OIJ fj?' r^- 1 vi "5^ <"No one of mankind can overcome you today and verily, I am your neighbor'} Shaytan, as well as, his devil army and flag holders, came on the day of Badr in the shape of a Suraqah bin Malik bin Ju'shum, man from Bani Mudlij, Shaytan said to idolaters, None will defeat you this day, and I will help you. When the two armies stood face to face, the Messenger of Allah jg took a handful of sand and threw it at the faces of the idolaters, causing them to retreat. Jibril, peace be upon him, came towards Shaytan, but when Shaytan, while holding the hand of a Mushrik man, saw him, he withdrew his hand and ran away with his soldiers. That man asked him, O Suraqah! You claimed that you are our neighbor?* He said, j iilj o_tP V l> >! 4Verily, I see what you see not. Verily, I fear Allah Jbr Allah is severe in punishment} Shaytan said this when he saw the angels. The Position of the Hypocrites in Badr Allah said next, iWhen the hypocrites and those in whose hearts was a disease (of disbelief) said : "These people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion."} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented, When the two armies drew closer to each other, Allah made the Muslims look few in the eyes of the idolaters and the idolaters look few in the eyes of the Muslims. The idolaters said, iThese people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion.} because they thought that Muslims were so few. They believed, without doubt, that they would defeat the Muslims. Allah said, At-Tabari 14:7.

4%~==*- Srif iBut whoever puts his trust in Allah, then surely, Allah is All- Mighty, All-Wise.) il] Qatadah commented, They saw a group of believers who came in defense of Allah s religion. We were informed that when he saw Muhammad j and his Companions, Abu Jahl said, By Allah! After this day, they will never worship Allah! He said this in viciousness and transgression. Amir Ash-Sha'bi said, Some people from Makkah were considering embracing Islam, but when they went with the idolaters to Badr and saw how few the Muslims were, they said, %) iThese people (Muslims) are deceived by their religion .) Allah said next, 4i""& iBut whoever puts his trust in Allah), and relies on His grace, 4*? ithen surely, Allah is All-Mighty), and verily, those who take His side [in the dispute] are never overwhelmed, for His side is mighty, powerful and His authority is All-Great, 4U^> iAll-Wise) in all His actions, for He places everything in its rightful place, giving victory to those who deserve it and defeat to those who deserve it. \\ * ' mJL" > s > *' Ji'if f \ Cj\$ \ ^ JJf ii' u-i llj i 450. And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve (at death); they smite their faces and Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 4 :78 At-Jabari 14:14. At-Jabari 14:13.

Al-Anfdl (50 - 51) (Part-10 their backs, (saying): "Taste the punishment of the blazing Fire."} 451. "This is because of that which your hands forwarded. And verily, Allah is not unjust to His servants."} The Angels smite the Disbelievers upon capturing Their Souls Allah says, if you witnessed the angels capturing the souls of the disbelievers, you would witness a tremendous, terrible, momentous and awful matter, 4they smite their faces and their backs}, saying to them, 4"Taste the punishment of the blazing Fire. } Ibn Jurayj said that Mujahid said that, 4and their backs}, refers to their back sides, as happened on the day of Badr. Ibn Jurayj also reported from Ibn Abbas, When the idolaters faced the Muslims [in Badr], the Muslims smote their faces with swords. When they gave flight, the angels smote their rear ends. Although these Ayat are describing Badr, they are general in the case of every disbeliever. This is why Allah did not make His statement here restrictive to the disbelievers at Badr, 8^-; fj} 4And if you could see when the angels take away the souls of those who disbelieve (at death); they smite their faces and their backs,} In Surat Al-Qital (or Muhammad chapter 47) there is a similar Ayah, as well as in

Surat Al-An'am, 4p=a-j) Ipi-C , >>* J Tijj 'ff} 4And if you could but see when the wrongdoers are in the At-Tabari 14:16.

agonies of death, while the angels are stretching forth their hands (saying) : "Deliver your souls!"} [6:93] The angels stretch their hands and smite the disbelievers by Allah's command, since their souls refuse to leave their bodies, so they are taken out by force. This occurs when the angels give them the news of torment and Allah's anger. There is a Hadith narrated from Al-Bara that when the angel of death attends the disbeliever at the time of death, he comes to him in a terrifying and disgusting shape, saying, Get out, O wicked soul, to fierce hot wind, boiling water and a shadow of black smoke. The disbeliever's soul then scatters throughout his body, but the angels retrieve it, just as a needle is retrieved from wet wool. In this case, veins and nerve cells will be still attached to the soul.' Allah states here that angels bring news of the torment of the Fire to the disbelievers. Allah said next, lurfji XLj o2f>} }This is because of that which your hands forwarded.} meaning, this punishment is the recompense of the evil deeds that you have committed in the life of the world. This is your reckoning from Allah for your deeds, 4 Jill Silt \$j} iAnd verily, Allah is not unjust to His servants.} Certainly, Allah does not wrong any of His creatures, for He is the Just, who never puts anything in an inappropriate place. Honored, Glorified, Exalted and Praised be He, the All-Rich, Worthy of all praise.

Al-Anfal (50 - 51) (Part-10) S UlSSli&S ut am" X, 4c /.' .*, ^ > -J .' "5 ">' i ',' / 3fA4* <^j A^Ci l Therefore, do not commit injustice against each other. O My servants! It is your deeds that I am keeping count of, so whoever found something good, let him praise Allah for it. Whoever found other than that, has only himself to blame. This is why Allah said, "A b", jc J2> jiji-li -ult Cili> (i-4^ iji. &f ! f i52. Similar to the behavior of the people of Fir'awn, and of those before them - they rejected the Ayat of Allah, so Allah punished them for their sins. Verily, Allah is All-Strong, severe in punishment.} Allah says. The behavior of these rebellious disbelievers against what I sent you with, O Muhammad, is similar to the behavior of earlier disbelieving nations. So We behaved with them according to Our Dat, that is, Our behavior [or custom] and way, as We did with them with what We often do and decide concerning their likes, the denying people of Fir'awn and the earlier nations who rejected the Messengers and disbelieved in Our Ayat, irrj*& iso Allah punished them for their sins.} 3V) . , . > - < ,/' > "i I 1 * Muslim 4 :1994.

Because of their sins, Allah destroyed them iVerily, Allah is All-Strong, severe in punishment\$ none can resist Him or escape His grasp. -CSl> ^ it- (5 siT >' ^ (ity vA'i i+ij c 4'* '-4-*^= 4'* tv-^j . That is so because Allah will never change a grace which He has bestowed on a people until they change what is in themselves. And verily, Allah is All-Hearer, All-Knower.} 454. Similar to the behavior of the people of Fir'axon, and those before them. They belied the Ayat of their Lord, so We destroyed them for their sins, and We drowned the people of Fir'awn for they were all wrongdoers .} Allah affirms His perfect justice and fairness in His decisions, for He decided that He will not change a bounty that He has granted someone, except on account of an evil that they committed. Allah said in another Ayah, u Ji Cj / i lj* yl ill j'J iijJ ^ ii\ l> b-A" , " sjjj 4: " -J'-> # yuo iVerily, Allah will not change the (good) condition of a people as long as they do not change their state (of goodness) themselves. But when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning it back, and they will find besides Him no protector.} [13:111 Allah said next, 4Similar to the behavior of the people of Fir'awn,} meaning, He punished

Fir'awn and his kind, those who denied His Ayat. Allah destroyed them because of their sins, and took away the favors that He granted them, such as gardens, springs, plants, treasures and pleasant dwellings, as well as all of the delights that they enjoyed. Allah did not wrong them,

Al-Anfdl (55 - 57) (Part-10 but it is they who wronged themselves. r "V isy'S" 5-J' ji' i-c ji 0* -*+? -0"- [**^* \djil-j V J => j . Verily, the worst of living creatures before Allah are those who disbelieve, - so they shall not believe.} 456. They are those with whom you made a covenant, but they break their covenant every time and they do not have Taqwdf 457. So if you gain the mastery over them in war, then disperse those who are behind them, so that they may learn a lesson.} Striking Hard against Those Who disbelieve and break the Covenants Allah states here that the worst moving creatures on the face of the earth are those who disbelieve, who do not embrace the faith, and break promises whenever they make a covenant, even when they vow to keep them, }and they do not have Taqid} meaning they do not fear Allah

regarding any of the sins they commit.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2212-2239]

4So ifyou gain the mastery over them in zvar}, ifyou defeat them and have victory over them in war, V-if*} 4then disperse those who are behind them,} by severely punishing [the captured people] according to Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ad-Dahhak, As-Suddi, Ata Al- Khurasani and Ibn Uyaynah. * This Ayah commands punishing them harshly and inflicting casualties on them. This way, other enemies, Arabs and non-Arabs, will be afraid and take a lesson from their end, m At-Tabari 14:23-24.

iso that they may learn a lesson. As-Suddi commented, They might be careful not to break treaties, so that they do not meet the same end. 44 y ii 2C"r f} or. 0 i58. If you fear treachery from any people, throw back (their covenant) to them (so as to be) on equal terms. Certainly Allah likes not the treacherous.} make a heading, Allah says to His Prophet 5H, ilf you fear from any people}, with whom you have a treaty of peace, i^} itreachery}, and betrayal of peace treaties and agreements that you have conducted with them. iX0\ &} ithen throw back (their covenant) to them}, meaning their treaty of peace. ion equal terms}, informing them that you are severing the treaty. This way, you will be on equal terms, in that, you and they will be aware that a state of war exists between you and that the bilateral peace treaty is null and void, iU-\$\$ 44 'J 4^ iCertainly Allah likes not the treacherous.} This even includes treachery against the disbelievers. Imam

343Suraji 8. Al-Anfal (59 - 60) (Part-10 man riding on his animal said, AUahu Akbar (Allah is the Great), AUahu AkbarI Be honest and stay away from betrayal. The Messenger of Allah si said, till: v'j LiU Su jiy > }4\^L- *Whoever has a treaty of peace with a people, then he should not untie any part of it or tie it harder until the treaty reaches its appointed term. Or, he should declare the treaty null and void so that they are both on equal terms. When Mu'awiyah was informed of the Prophet s statement, he retreated. They found that man to be 'Amr bin Anbasah, may Allah be pleased with him. ' This Hadthh was also collected by Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi, Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi, An-Nasal and Ibn Hibban in his Sahih. At-Tirmidhi said, Hasan Sahth. ^ "y lyi U (V+I V lyji jClic Sj} **? **<*,*; O . . < ' if ^ , - i ,f" , *#> V c Jj*' JJc ^ ^ O* .far- 459. And let not those who disbelieve think that they can outstrip

(escape from the punishment). Verily, they will never be able to save themselves (from Allah's punishment).} 460. And make ready against them all you can of power, including steeds of war to threaten the enemy of Allah and your enemy, and others besides them, whom you may not know but whom Allah does know. And whatever you shall spend in the cause of Allah shall be repaid unto you, and you shall not be treated unjustly.} Making Preparations for War to strike Fear in the Hearts of the Enemies of Allah Allah says to His Prophet ﷺ, in this Ayah, *** Ahmad 4:111. ' Abu Dawud At-Tayfisi : 157, Abu Dawud 3:190, At-Tirmidhi 5 -.203 , An-Nasal 5 :223 and Ibn Hibban 7 :182

4'y~ 4f/jose who disbelieve think that they can outstrip}, Do not think that such disbelievers have escaped Us or that We are unable to grasp them. Rather, they are under the power of Our ability and in the grasp of Our will; they will never escape Us. Allah also said, ^ o' OK iJl Ojli ujjll ('7 iOr think those who do evil deeds that they can outstrip Us (escape Our punishment)? Evil is that which they judge!} [29:4], && fife tjyVf 4 iConsider not that the disbelievers can escape in the land. Their abode shall be the Fire, and worst indeed is that destination .} [24:57], and, fi% ZU& (Ml 4 iLet not the free disposal (and affluence) of the disbelievers throughout the land deceive you. A brief enjoyment ; then their ultimate abode is Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.} [3:196-197] Allah commands

Al-Anfdl (59 - 60) (Part-10) Si *)\ 5jiii Si " Verily, Power is shooting! Power is shooting .s1 ' collected this HadlthJ2 Imam Malik recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 3=4 ij ^iJi Cli Ojj J^515 ^ J*-> j^ ^ * * ifLt j> ui ji > t?? ^ ?* J^-" Ji . * "-d I tf4" Jdjaj tfjl oils- O-ilS > (t3^ ,>? ^o> j!j "J ol^j- ijfr' ^> igU.j ^ (J-r3^^ dlISj d oLL> dlta jIS <. j-> jl 1445 j>-55 34 % Vj J 34 45 &~5i> 4* ,4 jv *' Jlij5 '3^ "Horses are kept for one of three purposes ; for some people they are a source of reward, for some others they are a means of shelter, and for some others they are a source of sin . The one for whom they are a source of reward, is he who keeps a horse for Allah's cause (Jihad) tying it with a long tether on a meadow or in a garden . The result is that whatever it eats from the area of the meadow or the garden where it is tied, will be counted as good deeds for his benefit; and if it should break its rope and jump over one or two hillocks then all its dung and its footmarks will be written as good deeds for him . If it passes by a river and drinks water from it, even though he had no intention of watering it, then he will get the reward for its drinking. Therefore, this type of horse is a source of good deeds for him . As for the man who tied his horse maintaining self - sufficiency and abstinence from begging, all the "while not forgetting Allah's right concerning the neck and back of his horse, then it is a means of shelter for him. And a man who tied a horse for the sake of pride, pretense and showing enmity for Muslims, then this type of horse is a source of sins. 4:156. ' Muslim 3 : 1522

When Allah's Messenger ﷺ was asked about donkeys, he replied, ";iu3i UjUJi ivi .ii ^ Jii jjii u> Nothing has been revealed to me from Allah about them except these unique, comprehensive Ayat 'fj-i)" fci- jji jISZ jIUfr iThen anyone who does an atom's weight of good, shall see it. And anyone who does an atom's weight of evil, shall see it.^s (99:7-8j,,m

Al-Anfdl (59 - 60) (Part-10) Resurrection, (that is) reward, and the spoils of war. n' 11 Allah said next, ito threaten}, or to strike fear, ithe enemy of Allah and your enemy}, the disbelievers, Ji iand others besides them}, such as Bani Qurayzah, according to Mujahid,121 or Persians, according to As-Suddi.13 ' Muqatil bin Hayyan and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah refers to hypocrites, 141 as supported by Allah's statement, vi^ } 4And among the Bedouins around you, some are

hypocrites, and so are some among the people of Al-Madtnah who persist in hypocrisy; you know them not, We know them.} [9:101]. Allah said next, 4And whatever you shall spend in the cause of Allah shall be repaid to you, and you shall not be treated unjustly.} Allah says, whatever you spend on Jihad will be repaid to you in full. We also mentioned Allah's statement, JtSi gi cSS&& ifm 4 ifj fe* ifi 4The parable of those who spend their wealth in the way of Allah, is Al-Bari 6:66 Jabari 14:36. Jabari 14:36. Tabari 14:36.

Al-Anfal (61 - 63) (Part-10) }But if they incline}, and seek, to peace}, if they resort to reconciliation, and seek a treaty of non-hostility, 4l/oi/ also incline to it}, and accept offers of peace from them. This is why when the pagans inclined to peace in the year of Hudaibiyah and sought cessation of hostilities for nine years, between them and the Messenger of Allah he accepted this from them, as well as, accepting other terms of peace they brought forth. Abdullah bin Al-Imam

350 Tahir Ibn Kathir iHe it is Who has supported you with His help and with the believers. And He has united their hearts. The Ayah says, it is Allah who gathered the believers hearts, believing, obeying, aiding and supporting you - O Muhammad, ZM Z f j iat ft ilf you had spent all that is in the earth, you could not have united their hearts.} because of the enmity and hatred that existed between them. Before Islam, there were many wars between the Ansar tribes of Aws and Khazraj, and there were many causes to stir unrest between them. However, Allah ended all that evil with the light of faith, 'oK ^ if*** . it - JZX. if iAnd remember Allah's favor on you, for you were enemies one to another, but He united your hearts, so that, by His grace, you became brethren, and you were on the brink of a pit of Fire, and He saved you from it. Thus Allah makes His Ayat clear to you, that you may be guided.} [3:103] In the Two Sahths, it is recorded that when the Messenger of Allah jg gave a speech to the Ansar about the division of war booty collected in the battle of Hunayn, he said to them, Vj V; r*V\$ jtiiVi u" "O Ansar! Did I not find you misguided and Allah guided you by me, poor and Allah enriched you by me, and divided and Allah united you by me?' Every question the Prophet jg asked them, they said, Truly, the favor is from Allah and His Messenger. 111 Allah said. iBut Allah has united them. Certainly He is All-Mighty, All-Wise. Fath Al-Bdri 7 :644 and Muslim 2 :738

Al-Anfal (64 - 66) (Part-10) He is the Most Formidable, and the hopes of those who have trust in Him, never end unanswered; Allah is All-Wise in all of His decisions and actions. tfjf oj; osu i^u 2 -; j&. 4 46# ittf '-iii- cjsif 'J p" ij" Si oi^j OjJijl tjtLw f&i J 0[j 0[CjU l liu j\ > iU (>^=C; oU uli" . O Prophet! Allah is sufficient for you and for the believers who follow you.) 465. O Prophet! Urge the believers to fight. If there are twenty steadfast persons among you, they will overcome two hundred, and if there be a hundred steadfast persons they will overcome a thousand of those who disbelieve, because they (the disbelievers) are people who do not understand.) 466. Now Allah has lightened your (task), for He knows that there is weakness in you. So if there are of you a hundred steadfast persons, they shall overcome two hundred, and if there are a thousand of you, they shall overcome two thousand by the leave of Allah. And Allah is with the patient.) Encouraging Believers to fight in Jihad; the Good News that a Few Muslims can overcome a Superior Enemy Force Allah encourages His Prophet and the believers to fight and struggle against the enemy, and wage war against their forces. Allah affirms that He will suffice, aid, support, and help the believers against their enemies, even if their enemies are numerous and have sufficient supplies, while the believers are few. Allah said, 4&i' 40 Prophet! Urge

the believers to fight), encouraged and called them to fight. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to encourage the Companions to fight when they faced the enemy. On the day of Badr when the idolaters came with their forces and supplies,

He said, The hope that I might be one of its dwellers. The Prophet ﷺ said, If it be from one of its people.

Al-Anfal (64 - 66) (Part-10 revealed, pi JZ .!> ilf there are twenty steadfast persons among you, they will overcome two hundred...} it became difficult for the

Were it not a previous ordinance from Allah...}, In the Preserved Book, that war spoils and prisoners of war will be made allowed for you, I would have touched you for what you took}, because of the captives. &L} 4a severe torment.} Allah, the Exalted said next, 4So enjoy what you have gotten of booty in war, lawful and good}." Al- Awfi also reported this statement from Ibn Abbas. 11 * A similar statement was collected from Abu Hurayrah, Ibn Mas'ud, Said bin Jubayr, Ata , Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Qatadah and Al-A mash. * They all stated that, }Were it not a previous ordinance from Allah..} refers to allowing the spoils of war for this Ummah. Supporting this view is what the Two Sahih's recorded that Jabir bin Abdullah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, ^ 'di? p C_lap{" P'j d Cj&j d 4-j 4_r-VJl d\ d\ i)\Sj tipllll j "/" have been given five things which were not given to any Prophet before me. (They are :) Allah made me victorious by awe, (by His frightening my enemies) for a distance of one month's journey. The earth has been made a place for praying and a purifier for me. The booty has been made lawful for me, yet it = At-Jabari 14:65. At-Jabari 14:65-69.

was not lawful for any- one else before me. I have been given the right of intercession (on the Day of Resurrection). Every Prophet used to be sent to his people only, but I have been sent to all mankind. Al-A mash narrated that Abu Salih said that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, 9 xJjJ' "War booty was never allowed for any among mankind except us." [Abu Hurayrah said:] This is why Allah the Most High said, 4So enjoy what you have gotten of booty in war, lawful and good.y The

Al-Anfdl (70 - 71) (Part-10) decides, he can accept a ransom for them, as in the case of the prisoners of Badr, or exchange them for Muslim prisoners. The Messenger ﷺ exchanged a woman and her daughter who were captured by Salamah bin Al-Akwa , for exchange of some Muslims who were captured by the idolaters, or if he decides he can take the prisoner as a captive. l*-i liji- 4 (i*. oi iJ I-V' If-ti^ Jj ii' 'jiLi- Jii jjj jy* ii'j -ip' ix iifj 470. O Prophet! Say to the captives that are in your hands : "If Allah knows any good in your hearts , He will give you something better than what has been taken from you, and He will forgive you, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful/> 471. But if they intend to betray you, they indeed betrayed Allah before. So He gave (you) power over them. And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise Pagan Prisoners at Badr were promised better than what They lost, if They become Righteous in the Future Muhammad bin Ishaq reported that Abdullah bin Abbas said that before the battle of Badr, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, p-JJ if-lA V Ij>-j>- \ JiS lit zjb If 'j li&b " l X X , , 'I "*" * f r , i Jr. Crt lit - ^-t Ol i jC-:\ 'J, ^ "/" have come to know that some people from Bani Hashim and others were forced to accompany the pagans, although they had no desire to fight us. Therefore, whoever meets any of them (Bani Hashim), do not kill him. Whoever meets Abu Al- Bukhtari bin Hashim, should not kill him. Whoever meets Al- Abbas bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, let him not kill him, for he was forced to come (with

the pagan army). Abu Hudhayfah bin 'Utbah said, Shall we kill our fathers, children, brothers and tribesmen (from Quraysh), and leave Al- Abbas? By Allah! If I meet him, I will kill him with the sword.

o j j j j j Y ! Y 'No, by Allah! Do not leave any Dirham of it. And from Yunus Biklar, from Muhammad bin Ishaq, from Yazid bin Ruwman, from Urwah, from Az-Zuhri that several people said to him, The Quraysh sent to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ concerning ransoming their prisoners, and each tribe paid what was required for their prisoners. Al- Abbas said, O Allah's Messenger! I became a Muslim before. The Messenger of Allah said, eu ia i% Jii ty jji us Jin 61 40^' 6? crJ'j *j4i J; *rO^' tri J 1 ,j;* * * ~m T* * * ^ knows if you are Muslim! If what you are claiming is true, then Allah will compensate you. As for your outward appearance, it was against us. Therefore, ransom yourself, as well as, your nephews Nawfal bin Al-Harith bin 'Abdul- Muttalib and 'Aqil bin Abu Tlib bin 'Abdul-Muttalib, and also your ally 'Utbah bin 'Amr, from Bani Al-Harith bin Fihir." Al- Abbas said, I do not have that (money), O Allah's Messenger! The Messenger ﷺ said. iJla { jj : I4J cJUi jjiM fj cjt JiiS ^JJI JUJI *?l 4lfS-j jJiil J "S (_jjj) JUJI Lifi ' What about the wealth that you and Umm Al-Fadl buried, and you said to her, 'If I am killed in this battle, then this money that I buried is for my children Al-Fadl, Abdullah and Quthm?" Al- Abbas said, *By Allah, O Allah's Messenger! I know that you are Allah's Messenger, for this is a thing that none except Umm Al-Fadl and I knew. However, O Allah's Messenger! Could you count towards my ransom the twenty Uwqiyah (pertaining to a weight) that you took from me (in the battle)? The Messenger of Allah said, ill* Juj Jit i'i. bi Y"Al-Bori 7:373.

"No, for that was money that Allah made as loar spoils for us from you. So Al- Abbas ransomed himself, his two nephews and an ally, and Allah revealed this verse, jy-t ii'i jiiy f --C.; .iJ 40 Prophet! Say to the captives that are in your hands: "If Allah knows any good in your hearts, He will give you something better than what has been taken from you, and He will forgive you, and Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."4 [8:70] Al- Abbas commented, After I became

Al-Anfdl (70 - 71) (Part-10 was distributed. * Al-Bukhari also collected this Hadith in several places of his Sahih ' with an abridged chain, in a manner indicating his approval of it. Allah said, TOr1 Oi *#> iBut if they intend to betray you, they indeed betrayed Allah before meaning, l oIj4 4But if they intend to betray you) in contradiction to what they declare to you by words. 4& oi 4they indeed betrayed Allah before), the battle of Badr by committing disbelief in Him, 4So He gave (you) power over them), causing them to be captured in Badr, 4Zg. is \$&) 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.) He is Ever Aware of his actions and All-Wise in what He decides. ijji* igjllj ^ (vf *> *"" o^jtt ivj't: Jt C ojlj jfo tlj' 0-ju Cj j^uj ^=CU" ju)i 4 ojj 472. Verily, those who believed, and emigrated and strove hard and fought with their property and their lives in the cause of Allah as well as those who gave (them) asylum and help, - [1 * Al-Bayhaqi 6 :356. 2| Al-Bukhari : 42 1 , 3049 and 3165. The abridged chain is part of the one quoted by Al-Bayhaqi , that chain is itself used by Al-Bukhari in other places of his Sahih.

these are (all) allies to one another. And as to those who believed but did not emigrate, you owe no duty of protection to them until they emigrate, but if they seek your help in religion, it is your duty to help them except against a people with whom you have a treaty of mutual alliance; and Allah is the All-Seer of what you do.} The Muhajirin and Al-Ansar are the Supporters of One Another Here Allah mentions the types of believers, dividing them into the Muhajirin, who left their homes and estates, emigrating to

give support to Allah and His Messenger to establish His religion. They gave up their wealth and themselves in this cause. There are also the Ansar, the

Al-Anfdl (72) (Part-10 Only Ahmad collected this HadithJ Allah praised the Muhajirin and the Ansar in several Ayat of His Book and His Messenger^ (also praised them too). Allah said, " *** iii(,>&Vfj Jt oy~f)A frij ALP i "; *- * I l_4^ p-* -**-*!-> iAttd the foremost to embrace Islam of the Muhajirun and the Ansar and also those who followed them exactly. Allah is well- pleased with them as they are well-pleased with Him. He has prepared for them gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise).>[9:100] A'6-^&& 4 \$ 'S# ^} AAllah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar whofollowed him in the time ofdistress.} [9:117], and, Si i> &< Ji S?' ^ Oi c i\$J JW C/J() {Jjoyjiitf jU jiljiy Sit S'? jij 4fc> lyj t-i ti "i> j^l iS 4(And f/iere is a/so a s/wre in this booty) for the poor Muhajirin, who were expelled from their homes and their property, seeking bounties from Allah and (His) good pleasure, and helping Allah and His Messenger. Such are indeed the truthful. And those who, before them, had homes (in Al-Madinah) and adopted the faith, love those who emigrate to them, and have no jealousy in their breasts far that which they have been given, and give them (emigrants) preference over themselves even though they were in need of that} [59:8-9]. The best comment on Allah s statement, i#} "jj} A...and have no jealousy in their breasts for that which they have been given} 4:363.

is that it means, they do not envy the Muhajirin for the rewards that Allah gave them for their emigration. These Ayat indicate that the Muhajirin are better in grade than the Ansar, and there is a consensus on this ruling among the scholars. The BelieversWho did not emigrate did not yet receive the Benefits of Wilayah Allah said, iS*- itsr- JI JQ 1* isit'c ! *' iAnd as to those who believed but did not emigrate, yon owe no duty ofprotection to them until they emigrate, [8:72]. This is the third category of believers, those who believed, but did not perform Hijrah and instead remained in their areas. They do not have any share in the war booty or in the fifth [designated for Allah and His Messenger, the relatives of the Prophet the orphans, the poor and the wayfarer], unless they attend battle. Imam

Al-Anfdl (73) (Part-10) to, then accept it and turn away from them. Call them to embrace Islam, and if they agree, accept itfrom them and turn awayfrom them . Then call them to leave their area and come to areas in which the Muhajirin reside. Make known to them that if they do this, they will have the rights, as well as, the duties of the Muhajirin. If they refuse and decide to remain in their area, make known to them that they will be just like Muslim bedouins, and that Allah's law applies to them just as it does to all believers. However, they will not have a share in the war booty or Fat' (booty without war), unless they performt jihad along with Muslims . If they refuse all of this, then call them to pay the Jizyah, and if they accept, then take it from them and turn away from them. If they refuse all these [three] options, then trust in Allah and fight them. Muslim collected this HadithJ21 Allah said next. 4But if they seek your help in religion it is your duty to help them.} Allah commands, if these bedouins, who did not perform Hijrah, ask you to aid them against their enemy, then aid them. It is incumbent on you to aid them in this case, because they are your brothers in Islam, unless they ask you to aid them against disbelievers with whom you have a fixed- term treaty of peace. In that case, do not betray your treaties or break your promises with those whom you have treaties of peace. This was reported from Ibn Abbas. 131 Jfjii Joai iL3j1 'ctM 473. And those who disbelieve are allies ofone another, (and) if you (Muslims)

do not do so (protect one another), there will be Fitnah on the earth, and great corruption. 5:352. 3 : 1357.Tabari 14:83.

Me Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Disbelievers are Allies of Each Other; the

474. And those who believed, and emigrated and strove hard in the cause of Allah (Al-Jihad), as well as those who gave (them) asylum and aid - these are the believers in truth, for them is forgiveness and a generous provision.} 475. And those who believed afterwards, and emigrated and strove hard along with you, they are of you. But kindred by blood are nearer to one another (regarding inheritance) in the decree ordained by Allah. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} Believers in Truth After Allah affirmed the ruling of loyalty and protection between the believers in this life, He then mentioned their destination in the Hereafter. Allah also affirmed the faith of the believers, just as mentioned in the beginning of this Surah, and that He will reward them with forgiveness and by erasing their sins, if they have any. He also promised them honorable provisions that are abundant, pure, everlasting and eternal; provisions that never end or run out, nor will they ever cause boredom, for they are delightful and come in great varieties. Allah then mentioned that those who follow the path of the believers in faith and performing good deeds, will be with them in the Hereafter. Just as Allah said, 4And the foremost to embrace Islam...} (9:100), until the end of the Ayah. He also said, 4fa M J iAnd those who came after them ...} (59:10). A Hadith that is in the Two Sahih, which is Mutawatir and has several authentic chains of narrations, mentions that the Messenger of Allah said,

One will be in the company of those whom he loves. d Another Hadith states, "He who loves a people is one of them", and in another narration, he said, "r" >~D * ...will be gathered with them (on the Day of Resurrection) Inheritance is for Designated Degrees of Relatives Allah said, 4 u-? *But kindred by blood are nearer to one another (regarding inheritance) in the decree ordained by Allah}, meaning, in Allah's decision. This Ayah encompasses all relatives, not only the degrees of relatives who do not have a fixed, designated share in the inheritance, as some people claim and use this Ayah to argue. According to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and several others,¹³ this Ayah abrogated inheriting from those with whom one had ties of treaties or brotherhood, as was the case in the beginning of Islam. So it applies to all relatives, and as for those who do not inherit, then this is supported by the Hadith, . . X " " j l J A4>- .1; "Indeed Allah had allotted every right to the one who deserves it, so there may be no will for an heir.*¹⁴ Therefore, this Ayah also includes those who have a fixed share of inheritance. Allah knows best.

Module 13

Surah 9: At-Tawbah

Surah 9: At-Tawbah

PDF pages 2240–2426

Which Was Revealed in Al-Madinah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2240–2256]

Jr cma* \M e&m rWM M ^ 'a?f J Art i c\j 4-*Jj\Jfjit zfyryjj ^ ^d)\> \ di. ;->< .fr .> 1 "' '>'> *i . \<>" o)j oV" *jj j}^Zo\\$zS['-u3 > >>,?x > xx >^ r^TTf V ' -T> . *xi X". "" ; ' m iy~ *J Sj' Ji, viA" ""' bi '4r# CA fMr \p% 2# ^jft 4 > ^x., *<, tj, ,> i ji *u\ Alii x'- ' 42 . Freedom from (all) obligations (is declared) from Allah and His Mes- senger (sij to those of the Mushrikin (idola- ters), with whom you made a treaty 42. So travel freely (0 Mushrikin) for four months (as you will) throughout the land, but know that you cannot escape (from the punish- ment of) Allah; and Al- lah will disgrace the disbelievers .>

Why there is no Basmalah in the Beginning of This Surah This honorable Surah (chapter 9) was one of the last Surahs to be revealed to the Messenger of Allah 3g.

iThey ask you for a legal verdict. Say: "Allah directs (thus) about Al-Kaldlah.">(4: 176] while the last Surah to be revealed was Bar& ah. „{1] The Basmalah was not mentioned in the beginning of this Surah because the Companions did not write it in the complete copy of the Qur an (Mushaf) they collected, following the Commander of the faithful, TJthman bin Affan, may Allah be pleased with him. The first part of this honorable Surah was revealed to the Messenger of Allah jg when he returned from the battle of Tabok, during the Hajj season, which the Prophet lj thought about attending. But he remembered that the idolaters would still attend that Hajj, as was usual in past years, and that they perform Tawafaround the House while naked. He disliked to associate with them and sent Abu Bakr As-Siddlq, may Allah be pleased with him, to lead Hajj that year and show the people their rituals, commanding him to inform the idolaters that they would not be allowed to participate in Hajj after that season. He commanded him to proclaim, 4'jslAy\$M iFreedomfrom (all) obligations (is declared)from Allah and His Messenger (M)---\$, to the people. When Abu Bakr had left, the Messenger jj sent Ali bin Abu Talib to be the one to deliver this news to the idolaters on behalf of the Messenger jgg, for he was the Messenger s cousin. We will mention this stoiy later. Publicizing the Disavowal ofthe Idolaters Allah said. iFreedom from obligations from Allah and His Messenger is a declaration of freedom from all obligations from Allah and His Messenger 3g , ijt^ i-ji oKjV' 4 Si ^-4^ Sil HI Fath Al-B&ri8 :167 . This Surahwas commonly called Bara ah.

ito those of the Mushrikin, with whom you made a treaty. So travel freely (Mushrikin) for four months (as you will) throughout the land^ [9:1-2]. This Ayah refers to idolaters who had indefinite treaties and those, whose treaties with

43. And a declaration from Allah and His Messenger to mankind on the greatest day of Hajj that Allah is free from obligations to the Mushrikm and so is His Messenger. So ifyou repent, it is better for you, but if you turn away, then know that you cannot escape Allah. And give tidings of a painful tormentfor

those who disbelieve.} Allah says, this is a declaration, ifrom Allah and His Messenger}, and a preface warning to the people, ion the greatest day of Hajj}, the day of Sacrifice, the best and most apparent day of the Hajj rituals, during which the largest gathering confers. ithat Allah is free from (all) obligations to the Mushrik and so is His Messenger.} also free from all obligations to them. Allah next invites the idolators to repent, iSo ifyou repent}, from the misguidance and Shirk you indulge in, ofi '&} iit is better for you, but if you turn away}, and persist on your ways, ithen know that you cannot escape Allah} Rather, Allah is capable over you, and you are all in His grasp, under His power and will, iAnd give tidings of a painful torment for those who disbelieve}

earning them disgrace and affliction in this life and the torment of chains and barbed iron bars in the Hereafter. Al- Bukhari recorded that Abu Hurayrah said, Abu Bakr sent me during that Hajj with those dispatched on the day of Sacrifice to declare in Mina that no Mushrik will be allowed to attend Hajj after that year, nor will a naked person be allowed to perform Tawaf." Humayd said, The Prophet then sent Ali bin Abi Talib and commanded him to announce Bara'ah. Abu Hurayrah said, Ali publicized Bara'ah with us to the gathering in Mina on the day of Sacrifice, declaring that no Mushrik shall perform Hajj after that year, nor shall a naked person perform Tawaf around the House. 1 11

374 Tafsir Ibn Kathir 4i\ J JtJ; d 015 ^y iTake this section from the beginning of Bara'ah and proclaim to the people on the day of the Sacrifice while they are gathered at Mina that no disbeliever will enter Paradise, no idolator will be permitted to perform Hajj after the year, there will be no Tawaf while naked, and whoever has a covenant with Allah's Messenger, then it shall be valid until the time of its expiration ." Ali rode the camel of Allah s Messenger % named Al- Adba until he caught up with Abu Bakr in route. When Abu Bakr saw him he said, Are you here as a commander or a follower. Ali replied, A follower. They continued on. Abu Bakr lead the people in Hajj while the Arabs were camping in their normal locations from Jahiliyyah. On the day of Sacrifice, 'Ali bin Abi Talib stood and proclaimed, O people! No disbeliever will be admitted into Paradise, no idolator will be permitted to perform Hajj next year, there shall be no Tawaf while naked, and whoever has a covenant with Allah s Messenger gg, then it shall be valid until its time of expiration. So no idolator performed Hajj after that year, Tawaf around the House while naked ceased. Then they returned to Allah s Messenger jg. So this was the declaration of innocence, whoever among the idolators had no treaty, then he had a treaty of peace for one year, if he had a particular treaty, then it was valid until its date of expiration. ,11 1\$ C2p ! & \$ ifcs j fc; j* f zgzst & pi# 44. Except those of the Mushrikin with whom you have a treaty, and who have not subsequently failed you in aught, nor have supported anyone against you. So fulfill their treaty for them until the end of their term. Surely, Allah loves those who I 1 *

At-Tawbah (4 - 5) (Part-10 have Taqwa.} Existing Peace Treaties remained valid until the End of Their Term This is an exception regulating the longest extent of time for those who have a general treaty - with out time mentioned - to four months. They would have four months to travel the lands in search of sanctuary for themselves wherever they wish. Those whose treaty mentioned a specific limited term, then the longest it would extend was to the point of its agreed upon termination date. Hadiths in this regard proceeded. So anyone who had a treaty with Allah s Messenger gg, it lasted until its specific termination date. However, those in this category were required to refrain from breaking the terms of the agreement with Muslims and from helping non-Muslims against Muslims. This is the type whose

peace agreement with Muslims was carried out to its end. Allah encouraged honoring such peace treaties, saying. 41)1 6] 4Surely, Allah loves those who have Taqwa} [9:4], who keep their promises. I#w* ^ ijbk %Htga lit a sj tsc yum ijwt ijs 4^ jt. 45. So when the Sacred Months have passed, then fight the Mushrikin wherever you find them, and capture them and besiege them, and lie in wait for them in each and every ambush. But if they repent and perform the Saldh, and give the Zakdh, then leave their way free. Verily, Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is the Ayah of the Sword Mujahid, Amr bin Shu'ayb, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Qat&dah, As-Suddi and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that

376 Tafstr Ibn Kathir the four months mentioned in this Ayah are the four-month grace period mentioned in the earlier Ayah ^So travel freely forfour months throughout the land.) Allah said next, <&ii satp;So when the Sacred Months have passed...), meaning, TJpon the end of the four months during which We prohibited you from lighting the idolaters, and which is the grace period We gave them, then fight and kill the idolaters wherever you may find them. Allah s statement next, itthen fight the Mushrikin wherever you find them), means, on the earth in general, except for the Sacred Area, for Allah said, 4f*J^*'* f > * (S*- Jifo vf) iAnd fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-Haram, unless they fight you there. But if they attack you, then fight them.)([2:l91] Allah said here. iand capture them), executing some and keeping some prisoners, as iand besiege them, and lie in wait for them in each and every ambush), do not wait until you find them. Rather, seek and besiege them in their areas and forts, gather intelligence about them in the various roads and fairways so that what is made wide looks ever smaller to them. This way, they will have no choice, but to die or embrace Islam, i U-j jjCc. iit 0} 'jlj tyLstj lj"l3 ujj^ m At-Jabari 14:136-137.

At-Tawbah (5 - 6) (Part-10) 4But if they repent and perform the Salah, and give the Zakdh, then leave their way free. Verily, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq used this and other honorable Ayat as proof for fighting those who refrained from paying the Zakdh. These Ayat allowed fighting people unless, and until, they embrace Islam and implement its rulings and obligations. Allah mentioned the most important aspects of Islam here, including what is less important. Surely, the highest elements of Islam after the Two Testimonials, are the prayer, which is the right of Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, then the Zakdh, which benefits the poor and needy. These are the most honorable acts that creatures perform, and this is why Allah often mentions the prayer and Zakdh together. In the Two Sahihs, it is recorded that Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah said, j jvj lii vj ^i i if i ji- JJJlf ji / have been commanded to fight the people until they testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger ofAllah, establish the prayer and pay the Zakdh. t 1 ' 1 This honorable Ayah (9:5) was called the Ayah of the Sword, about which Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said, It abrogated every agreement of peace between the Prophet jg and any idolator, every treaty, and every term. Al- Awfi said that Ibn Abbas commented: No idolator had any more treaty or promise of safety ever since Surah Bara ah was revealed. The four months, in addition to, all peace treaties conducted before Bara ah was revealed and announced had ended by the tenth of the month of Rabi Al-Akhir. |2 > Aitl ^Iii _LLi . ' jSfLji J S pi 46. And if anyone of the Mushrikin seeks your protection then Fath Al-Bari 1 :95 and Muslim 1 :53. At-Tabari 14:133.

3Z Tafsir Ibn Kathir grant him protection so that he may hear the Word of Allah (the Qur'an) and then escort him to where he can be secure, that is because they are men who know not.} Idolators are granted Safe Passage If They seek It Allah said to His Prophet, peace be upon him, iAnd if anyone of the Mushrikin}, whom you were commanded to fight and We allowed you their blood and property, iX>&} i seeks your protection}, asked you for safe passage, then accept his request until he hears the Words of Allah, the Qur'an. Recite the Qur'an to him and mention a good part of the religion with which you establish Allah's proof against him, i g 2} i and then escort him to where he can be secure} and safe, until he goes back to his land, his home, and area of safety, fsA* i\$&m i that is because they are men who know not.} The Ayah says, *We legislated giving such people safe passage so that they may learn about the religion of Allah, so that Allah's call will spread among His servants. Ibn Abi Najih narrated that Mujahid said that this Ayah, Refers to someone who comes to you to hear what you say and what was revealed to you (O Muhammad). Therefore, he is safe until he comes to you, hears Allah's Words and then proceeds to the safe area where he came from. * The Messenger of Allah used to thereafter grant safe passage to those who came to him for guidance or to deliver a message. On the day of Hudaibiyyah, several emissaries from Quraysh came to him, such as Tjrwah bin Mas'ud, Mikraz bin Hafsa, Suhayl bin Amr and several others. They came mediating between him and the Quraysh pagans. They witnessed the iil At-Tabari 14:139.

great respect the Muslims had for the Prophet which astonished them, for they never before saw such respect for anyone, kings nor czars. They went back to their people and conveyed this news to them; this, among other reasons, was one reason that most of them accepted the guidance. When Musaylimah the Liar sent an emissary to the Messenger of Allah, he jg asked him, Do you testify that Musaylimah is a messenger from Allah?" He said, Yes. The Messenger of Allah said, y\fe\&y \y&4 '\olj0Zftu \ftaijj ^\ft ===S\ilJ ift ftj ijila.e- vL; ft y ft)\Mv> "/ would have cut off your head, if it was not that emissaries are not killed.^ l] That man, Ibn An-Nawwahah, was later beheaded when Abdullah bin Mas'ud was the governor of Al-Kufah. When it became known that he still testified that Musaylimah was a messenger from Allah, Ibn Mas'ud summoned him and said to him, You are not delivering a message now! He commanded that Ibn An-Nawwahah be decapitated, may Allah curse him and deprive him of His mercy. In summary, those who come m Ibn Hisham 4:247.

380 Tafsir Ibn Kathir from a land at war with Muslims to the area of Islam, delivering a message, for business transactions, to negotiate a peace treaty, to pay the Jizyah, to offer an end to hostilities, and so forth, and request safe passage from Muslim leaders or their deputies, should be granted safe passage, as long as they remain in Muslim areas, until they go back to their land and sanctuary. Hjj; jaxfx. jit it atk p yaa a ^t 47. How can there be a covenant with Allah and with His Messenger for the Mushrikin except those with whom you made a covenant near Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah)? So long as they are true to you, stand you true to them. Verily, Allah loves those who have Taqwa.\$ Affirming the Disavowal of the Idolators Allah mentions the wisdom in dissolving all obligations to the idolators and giving them a four month period of safety, after which they will meet the sharp sword wherever they are found. 4How can there be a covenant for the Mushrikin?^, a safe resort and refuge, while they persist in Shirk with Allah, and disbelief in Him and His Messenger, ' lit ^it i except those with whom you made a covenant near Al-Masjid Al-Haram\$, on the day of Hudaibiyyah. Allah said in another Ayah [concerning the day of Hudaibiyyah], M p. ol 6j& ilitj u^jt^ txr 4They are the ones who disbelieved

and hindered you from Al- Masjid Al-Hardm and detained the sacrificial animals, from reaching their place of sacrifice .4 [48:25] Allah said next,

At-Tawbah (7) (Part-10) {So long as they are true to you, stand you true to them.}, if they keep the terms of the treaties you conducted with them, including peace between you and them for ten years, then stand you true to them. Verily, Allah loves those who have Taqwd The Messenger of Allah and the Muslims preserved the terms of the treaty with the people of Makkah from the month of Dhul-Qa'dah in the sixth year [of Hijrah], until the Quraysh broke it and helped their allies, Banu Bakr, against Khuza'ah, the allies of Allah s Messenger jg. Aided by the Quraysh, Banu Bakr killed some of Bani Khuza'ah in the Sacred Area! The Messenger of Allah sg led an invasion army in the month of Ramadan, of the eighth year, and Allah opened the Sacred Area for him to rule over them, all thanks are due to Allah. The Messenger of Allah jg freed the Quraysh who embraced Islam after they were overpowered and defeated. These numbered around two thousands, and they were referred to by the name Tulaqa afterwards. Those among them who remained in disbelief and ran away from Allah s Messenger were sent promises of safe refuge for four months, during which they were allowed to move about freely. They included Safwan bin Umayyah, Ikrimah bin Abi Jahl and many others. Allah later on guided them to Islam, and they became excellent believers. Surely, Allah is worthy of all praise for all His actions and decrees. cfe ^==^ \ r&> S =>} 48. How? When if you are overpowered by them, they regard not the ties, either of kinship, (III) or of covenant (Dhimmah)? With their mouths they please you, but their hearts are averse to you, and most of them are rebellious.} Allah encourages the believers to show enmity to the idolaters and to dissociate from them, affirming that they do not deserve to enjoy a covenant of peace, because of their Shirk in Allah and disbelief in Allah s Messenger jg. If these disbelievers have a chance to defeat Muslims, they will cause

<\$But if they repent, perform the Saldh...} \$ *" 4 oi 4 412. But if they violate their oaths after their covenant, and attack your religion with disapproval and criticism, then fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief- for surely, their oaths are nothing to them - so that they may stop (evil actions).} The Oaths of the Leaders of Disbelief mean nothing to Them Allah says, if the idolators with whom you conducted peace treaties for an appointed term break ^their oaths meaning, terms of their treaties, and covenants iand attack your religion...} with disapproval and criticism, it is because of this that one who curses the Messenger, peace be upon him, or attacks the religion of Islam by way of criticism and disapproval, they are to be fought. This is why Allah said afterwards, then fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief - for surely, their oaths are nothing to them - so that they may stop.} so that they may refrain from the disbelief, rebellion and the transgression they indulge in. Qatadah and others said that the leaders of disbelief were Abu Jahl, Tjtbah and Shaybah, Umayyah bin Khalaf, and he went on to mention several others. Al-A mash narrated from Zayd bin Wahb from Hudhayfah; The people of this Ayah were never fought again. 111 A similar statement was reported from Ali bin Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him. However, this Ayah is general, even though the specific reason behind revealing it was the idolators of Quraysh. So this Ayah generally applies to At-Tabari 14:156.

them and others as well, Allah knows best. Al-Walld bin Muslim said that Safwan bin Amr narrated that Abdur- Rahman bin Jubayr bin Nufayr said that when Abu Bakr sent an army to Ash- Sham, he advised them, You will find some people with shaved heads. Therefore, strike the swords upon the parts that

contain the devil, for by Allah, it is better to me to kill one of these people than to kill seventy other men. This is because Allah said, itlien fight (you) against the leaders of disbelief Ibn Abi Hatim collected itj ggaj 'A<\ e&m ;jLg\$ i 0 4iSj OuLla)' ^ j>\) -Ult jtkelj j&sW ,vij JIAJII^ y> 41 ir 4 <\$ &5 46 - fif -u^" r?j 46 j 41 4 ; 413. Will you not fight a people who have violated their oaths and intended to expel the Messenger while they did attack you first? Do you fear them? Allah has more right that you should fear Him if you are believers.} m Ibn Abi Hatim 6 :1761

At-Tawbah (13 - 15) (Part-10 414. Fight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of believing people , 415. And remove the anger of their (believers') hearts. Allah accepts the repentance of whom He wills. Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.}

Encouragement to fight the Disbelievers, and some

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2256–2265]

Benefits of fighting Them These Ayat encourage, direct and recommend fighting against the idolators who break the terms of their covenants, those who tried to expel the Messenger jg from Makkah. Allah said in other Ayat, Jr y -ay * y 4And (remember) wheti the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expell you; they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the best of those who plot. (8:30), 3 'f \j 4 ...and have driven out the Messenger and yourselves (from your homeland) because you believe in Allah your Lord!} [60:1], and, 4And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land.} (17:76) Allah s statement, 4while they did attack you first}, refers to the battle of Badr when the idolators marched to protect their caravan. When they knew that their caravan escaped safely, they still went ahead with their intent to fight Muslims out of arrogance, as we mentioned before. It was also said that these Ayat refer to the idolators breaking the peace agreement with Muslims and

386 Tafstr Ibtt Kathfr aiding Bani Bakr, their allies, against Khuza'ah, the ally of the Messenger of Allah jg. This is why the Messenger of Allah marched to Makkah in the year of the victory, thus conquering it, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. Allah said, ^ oi&&\&) 4Do you fear them? Allah has more right that you should fear Him if you are believers .> Allah says here, Do not fear idolaters, but fear Me instead, for I am worthy of being feared by the servants due to My might and punishment. In My Hand lies the matter; whatever I will occurs, and whatever I do not will does not occur. Allah next said, while ordering the believers and explaining the wisdom of ordaining Jihad against them, all the while able to destroy their enemies with a command from Him, - * > > '-&J ^ iFight against them so that Allah will punish them by your hands, and disgrace them and give you victory over them, and heal the breasts of believing people.) This Ayah includes all believers, even though Mujahid, Ikrimah and As-Suddi said that it refers to Khuza'ah. 11 Concerning the believers, Allah said; iand remove the anger of their hearts), then 4Allah accepts the repentance of whom He wills), from His servants, i'fi \$s) iAllah is All-Knoioing), in what benefits His servants, [ii At-Tabari 14 :161

At-Tawbah (13 - 16) (Part-10 4All-Wise}, in His actions and statements, whether narrative or legislative. Allah does what He wills, decides what He wills, and He is the Just Who never wrongs any.

Not even the weight of an atom of good or evil is ever neglected with Him, but rather, He compensates for it in this life and the Hereafter. 426. Do you think that you shall be left alone while Allah has not yet tested those among you who have striven hard and fought, and have not taken Walijah besides Allah and His Messenger, and the believers. Allah is well-acquainted with what you do.} Among the Wisdom of Jihad is to test the Muslims Allah said, 4Do you think}, O believers that We will leave you untested with matters that make apparent those who have pure, good intent from those who have false intent? This is why Allah said next, 'jj M jlj 0\$ tl)j} Awhile Allah has not yet tested those among you who have striven hard and fought and have not taken Walijah besides Allah and His Messenger, and the believers...}, meaning, supporters and confidants. Rather, they are sincere for Allah and His Messenger jg inwardly and outwardly. Allah also said; " 1\$& Saj v ft tssr. J %% J CS3 (\$&} 40c*riO iAlif-Ldm-Mim . Do people think that they will be left alone because they say: "We believe," and will not be tested. And We indeed tested those who were before them. And Allah will certainly make known those who are true, and will certainly make known those who are liars . . .} [29: 1-3],

j&j (~t b^t f iii Jju Oj iLJ' ijli-jC J 4D0 you 1/rinfc that you will enter Paradise before Allah tests those of you who fought (in His cause) and (also) tests those who are patient?}[3:142], and, iijif u i:- ^&v&&S Si && iAlldlt mil not leave the believers in the state in which you are now, until He distinguishes the wicked from the good}[3:179]. In summary, since Allah legislated Jihad for His servants, He explained that the wisdom behind doing so includes testing His servants, distinguishing between those who obey Him and those who disobey Him. Allah, the Exalted, is the All-Knower of what occurred, what will occur, and the true essence of what might occur had He decided it. Therefore, Allah knows everything before it occurs and how it will occur, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, nor a Lord except Him. Truly, there is none who can avert Allah's judgment and decision. iCf ^ '4Pt ^ /So & Z \$ Ap & Sj lyjs ill iblj 4JJ* ' =*\$ u*j *jL^' A."# .ifil7. It is not for the Mushrikin, to maintain the Masjids of Allah, while they witness against themselves of disbelief. The works of such are in vain and in Fire shall they abide.} 418. The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day; perform the Salah, and give Zakat and fear none but Allah. It is they who are on true guidance.} It is not for Idolaters to maintain the Masjids of Allah Allah says that it is not fitting that those who associate others with Allah in worship should maintain the Masjids of Allah that were built in His Name alone without partners. Those who read the Ayah, Masjid AUdh , said that it refers to Al-Masjid Al-Haram, the most honored Masjid on the earth,

which was built, from the first day, for the purpose of worshipping Allah alone without partners. It was built by Khalil Ar-Rahman (the Prophet Ibrahim) peace be upon him. The idolaters do this while they themselves testify to their disbelief with their statements and actions. As-Suddi said, If you ask a Christian, What is your religion? , He will tell you he is a Christian. If you ask a Jew about his religion, he will say he is a Jew, and the same for a Sabt and a Mushriki |11 4The works of such are in vain>, because of their Shirk, and in Fire shall they abide.} Allah said in another Ayah, Hi Vl Cj} ipjZA & vi ,oQi 4And why should not Allah punish them while they hinder (men) from Al-Masjid Al-Haram, and they are not its guardians? None can be its guardians except those with Taqwa, but most of them know "ot.^[8:34]. Believers are the True Maintainers of the Masjids Allah said, ft& Z&yz'JJA Cl[] 4The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day.} Therefore, Allah testifies to the faith of those who maintain the Masjids. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Amr bin

MaymQn Al-Awdi said, I met the Companions of the Prophet igj and they were saying, The Masjids are the Houses of Allah on the earth. It is a promise from Allah that He is generous to those who visit Him in the Masjids., Allah said next, m At-Tabari 14:165.

390 Tafsir Ibn Kathir {perform the Saldh}, one of the major acts of worship practiced by the body, {and give the Zakah}, which is the best act that benefits other people. {and fear none but Allah}, they fear only Allah, the Exalted, and none else, {It is they who are on true guidance.} Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said about Allah s statement, sff ft^Z ft =Q} {The Masjids of Allah shall be maintained only by those who believe in Allah and the Last Day;} He who singles out Allah (in worship), has faith in the Last Day. [And he said]; He who believes in what Allah has revealed, {perform the Salah}, establishes the five daily prayers, {andfear none but Allah.}, worships Allah alone, {u.f~^ Si \j& ^ {it may be they who are on true guidance.} Allah says, It is they who are the successful ones in truth. Similarly, Allah said to His Prophet Lily &{*} {It may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud}[17:79\.

Allah says here, Your Lord (O Muhammad) shall grant you a station of praise, that is, the intercession (on the Day of Resurrection).' Every might in the Qur an means shall . fUj gtt ill \$ 4 ip: \$(J-P 4 IjPw If:) > jikcl j^-illj y <-" -***-> t Jil 5) Ijil Ijj pi 419. Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims and the maintenance of Al-Masjid Al-Haram as equal to the worth of those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, and strive hard and fight in the cause of Allah? They are not equal before Allah. And Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers. 420. Those who believed and emigrated and strove hard and fought in Allah's cause with their wealth and their lives, arefar higher in degree with Allah. They are the successful 421. Their Lord gives them glad tidings of mercy from Him, At-Tabari 14:167.

and His being pleased (with them), and of Gardens (Paradise) for them wherein are everlasting delights.} ill. They will dwell therein forever. Verily, with Allah is a great reward .} Providing Pilgrims with Water and maintaining the Sacred Masjid are not equal to Faith and Jihad In his Tafsir, Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas explained this Ayah : The idolators said, Maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram and providing water for pilgrims are better than embracing the faith and performing Jihad. They used to boast and show off among the people because they claimed, they were the people and maintainers of Al-Masjid Al-Haram. Allah mentioned their arrogance and rejection (of the faith), saying to *the people of Al-Haram , who were idolators, ilndeed My Ayat used to be recited to you, but you used to turn back on your heels (denying them, and refusing to listen to them with hatred). In pride, talking evil about it (the Qur'an) by night.} (23:66-67]. They used to boast about being those who maintained the Sacred Sanctuary, italking about it by night}. They used to talk about this by night while shunning die Qur an and the Prophet Allah declared that faith and Jihad with the Prophet are better than the idolators maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram and providing water for pilgrims. These actions - maintaining and serving Allah s House - will not benefit them with Allah because they associate others with Him. Allah the Exalted said, ivJfA pjil -at' ju} iThey are not equal before Allah. And Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers.} those who claimed they are the maintainers of the House. Allah described them with injustice, on account of their Shirk,

393Sura}i 9. At-Taivbah (19 - 22) (Part-10) and thus, their maintaining the Masjid will not avail them. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This Ayah was revealed about Al- Abbas bin Abdul-Muttalib, for when he was captured in the battle of Badr, he said, If you rushed before us to embrace Islam, perform Hijrah and Jihad, we were maintaining Al-Masjid Al-Haram, providing water for the pilgrims and setting the indebted free. Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, said, as 4Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims), until, iand Allah guides not those people who are the wrongdoers). Allah says, All these actions were performed while committing Shirk, and I do not accept the {good deeds} that are performed while in a state of Shirk. Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim said,

Allah is more righteous than what you have said. TImaradmonished them, Do not raise your voices next to the Minbarof the Messenger of Allah, and as it was a Friday, he said, but after we pray the Friday prayer, we will go to the Prophet mand ask him. This verse was revealed, X}&gi iiL 4Do you consider the providing of drinking water to the pilgrims and the maintenance ofAl-Masjid Al-Hardm}, until, 4\$ V} 4They are not equal before Allah. \$ fci/i \$ \pL int, * if & 4 if . O you who believe! Take not as supporters your fathers and your brothers if they prefer disbelief to belief. And whoever ofyou befriends them, then he is one of the wrongdoers.} 424. Say: If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your spouses, your kindred, the wealth that you have gained, the commerce in which you fear a decline, and the dwellings in which you delight are dearer to you than Allah and His Messenger, and striving hard and fighting in His cause, then wait until Allah brings about His decision (torment). And Allah guides not the people who are rebellious.}

The Prohibition of taking the Idolators as Supporters,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2265–2269]

even with Relatives Allah commands shunning the disbelievers, even if they are one s parents or children, and prohibits taking them as supporters if they choose disbelief instead of faith. Allah warns, [il Muslim no. 1879.

jtj 'kk o! y-' S* ^W ? Z&b'A'j *-4 iYou will notfind any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even though they were theirfathers or their sons or their brothers or their kindred (people) . For such He has written (predetermined) faith in their hearts, and strengthened them with a Ruh (proof, light and true guidance)from Himself. And He will admit them to Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow) (58:221 Al-Hafiz Al-Bayhaqi recorded that Abdullah bin Shawdhab said, The father of Abu Ubaydah bin Al-Jarrah was repeatedly praising the idols to his son on the day of Badr, and Abu Ubaydah kept avoiding him. When Al-Jarrah persisted, his son Abu Ubaydah headed towards him and killed him. Allah revealed this Ayah in his case, Sll iYou will notfind any people who believe in Allah and the Last Day, making friendship with those who oppose Allah and His Messenger.')[58-22] Allah commanded His Messenger jg to warn those who prefer their family, relatives or tribe to Allah, His Messenger and Jihad in His cause. pAj & 4 iSay : If your fathers, your sons, your brothers, your wives, your kindred, the wealth that you have gained>, amassed and collected. MX#2 4the commerce in which you fear a decline, and the dwellings in which you delighfy, and prefer and love because they are comfortable and good. If hi Al-Bayhaqi 9 :27. This is a Mursal narration.

396 Tafsir ton Kathir all these things, 4 'At-jj& ilk (&=4[z^\) \$are dearer to you than Allah and His Messenger, and striving hard and fighting in His cause, then wait...) for what will befall you of Allah s punishment and torment. g; SXf_ Y ii(j Allah brings about His decision. And Allah guides not the people who are rebellious.) Imam

^ js" " ^ [f %&-C ==ti1 > ><' ^c > -i t ^_44Lu ' J ' 4 > -< > ^i > *.f ? ^jir^-1ij ^^==6>. ii' ^j\^___3'j ix S^&plr&JJ Ti_^j p&s 4^y ijii j =vAi "/> <' '<' 4^ H 9^ f>-> /*== Cj p^S \$? JS i^jUp i 'j>"- J" oiiitjtf Jj& ^ d 4 ii :KS^J' iT> \$5 * ^ k " C # { < iJf/ <> .,~"y >*-#'-> . Truly, Allah has given you victory on many battlefields, and on the day of Hunayn (battle) when you re- joiced at your great II number, but it availed you naught and the earth, vast as it is, was straitened far you, then you turned back in flight}. . Then Allah did send down His Sakinah (tranquillity) on His Messenger, and on the believers, and sent down farces (angels) which you saw not, and punished the disbelievers. Such is the recompense of disbelievers}. . Then after that Allah will accept the repentance of whom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful .} The Outcome of Victory by Way of the Unseen Aid Ibn Jurayj reported from Mujahid that this was the first Ayah of Bara ah in which Allah, the Exalted, reminds the believers how He favored and blessed them by giving them victory in many battles with His Messenger Allah

mentioned that victoiy comes from Him, by His aid and decree, not because of their numbers or adequate supplies, whether the triumphs are few or many. On the day of Hunayn, the Muslims were proud because of their large number, which did not avail them in the least; they retreated and fled from battle. Only a few of them remained with the Messenger of Allah jgAllah then sent down His aid and support to His Messenger jgand the believers who remained with him, so that they were aware that victory is from Allah alone and through His aid, even if the victorious were few. Many a small group overcame a larger opposition by Allah s leave, and Allah is ever with those who are patient. We will explain this subject in detail below, Allah willing. The Battle of Hunayn

The battle of Hunayn occurred after the victoiy of Makkah,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2269–2277]

in the month of Shawwal of the eighth year of Hijrah. After the Prophet m conquered Makkah and things settled, most of its people embraced Islam and he set them free. News came to the Messenger of Allah that the tribe of Hawazin were gathering their forces to fight him, under the command of Malik bin Awf An-Nadri, as well as, the entire tribe of Thaqlf, the tribes of Banu Jusham, Banu Sa d bin Bakr, a few people of Awza from Banu Hilal and some people from Bani Amr bin Amir and Awf bin Amir. They brought their women, children, sheep and camels along, in addition to their armed forces and adequate supplies. The Messenger of Allah 3g marched to meet them with the army that he brought to conquer Makkah, ten thousand from the Muhajirin, the Ansar and various Arab tribes. Along with them came the Tulaqa numbering two thousand men. The Messenger ^ took them along to meet the enemy. The two armies met in Humayn, a valley between Makkah and At-Ta if. The battle started in the early part of the morning, when the Huwazin forces, who were lying in ambush, descended on the valley when the Muslims entered. Muslims were suddenly struck by the ambush, the arrows descended on them and the swords struck them. The Huwazin commander ordered them to descend and attack the

Muslims as one block, and when they did that, the Muslims retreated in haste, just as Allah described them. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ remained firm in

At-Tawbah (25 - 27) (Part-10) his position while riding his mule, Ash-Shahba . He was leading his mule towards the enemy, while his uncle Al- Abbas was holding its right-hand rope and (his cousin) Abu Sufyan bin Al- Harith bin Abdul-Muttalib was holding the left rope. They tried to hold the mule back so it would not run faster toward the enemy. Meanwhile, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was declaring his name aloud and saying, O servants of Allah! Come back to me! I am the Messenger of Allah! He repeated these words, O Allah! I am the Prophet, not lying! I am the son of Abdul-Muttalib! There remained between a hundred and eighty Companions with the Prophet ﷺ. These included Abu Bakr, Umar, Al- Abbas, Ali, Al-Fadl bin Abbas, Abu Sufyan bin Al-Harith, Ayman the son of Umm Ayman and Usamah bin Zayd. There were many other Companions, may Allah be pleased with them. The Prophet ﷺ commanded his uncle Al- Abbas, whose voice was rather loud, to call at the top of his voice, O Companions of the Samurah (tree) referring to the Muhajirin and Ansar who gave their pledge under the tree during the pledge of Ridwan, not to run away and retreat. He also called, O Companions of Surat Al-Baqarah. Upon hearing that, those heralded started saying, Here we are! Here we are! Muslims started returning in the direction of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. If the camel of one of them did not obey him (as the people were rushing to the other direction in flight) he would wear his shield and descend from his camel and rush to the side of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ on foot. When a large crowd gathered around the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, he commanded them to fight in sincerity and took a handful of sand and threw it in the faces of the disbelievers, after supplicating to Allah, O Allah! Fulfill Your promise to me! Then he threw that handful of sand which entered the eyes and mouth of all the disbelievers, thus distracting them from fighting, and they retreated in defeat. The Muslims pursued the enemy, killing

and capturing them. The rest of the

And on the believers who remained with him, and sent down forces which you saw not, this refers to angels. Imam Abu Ja'far bin Jarir (At-Tabari) said that Al-Qasim narrated to them, that Al-Hasan bin Arafah said that Al- Mutamir bin Sulayman said from Awf bin Abi Jamillah Al- Arabi who said that he heard Abdur-Rahman, the freed slave of Ibn Barathan saying, A man who participated in Hunayn with the idolaters narrated to me, When we met the Messenger of Allah and his Companions on the day of Hunayn, they did not remain in battle more than the time it takes to milk a sheep! When we defeated them, we pursued them until we ended at the rider of the white mule, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ. At that time, men with white handsome faces intercepted us and said: Disgraced be the faces! Go back. So we ran away, but they followed us. That was the end for us. Allah said, Then after that Allah will accept the repentance of whom He wills. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful. Allah forgave the rest of Huwazin when they embraced Islam and went to the Prophet ﷺ, before he arrived at Makkah in the Ji'ranah area. This occurred twenty days after the battle of Hunayn. The Messenger gave them the choice between taking those who were prisoner or the war spoils they lost, and they chose the former. The Prophet ﷺ released six thousand prisoners to them, but divided the war spoils between the victors, such as some of the Tulaqa , so that their hearts would be inclined towards Islam. He gave each of them a hundred camels, and the same to Malik bin Awf An-Nasri whom he appointed chief of his people

(Huwazin) as he was before. Malik bin Awf said a poem in which he praised the Messenger of Allah { for his generosity and extraordinary courage.Tabari 14:186.

faA l j& * l2* tp: <</i(\%& l I' S.1 , V/* . . * < > <^ *' * >?. -. / Ail' 0| >* Ail I n^lw 4*^ >-i> op *.iL^ a us#"&&\%& && 'i \&s ff ;kj 0^ !>!*" s~='J' Ih/ <^i\$^ ir, 4"'^ cti r*J 428. O you who believe! Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram after this year; and if you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you if He wills, out of His bounty. Surely, Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} 429. Fight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, nor forbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture, until they pay the Jizyah with willing submission, and feel themselves subdued.} Idolators are no longer allowed into Al-Masjid Al-Haram Allah commands His believing servants, who are pure in religion and person, to expel the idolators who are filthy in the religious sense, from Al-Masjid Al-Haram. After the revelation of this Ayah, idolators were no longer allowed to go near the Masjid. This Ayah was revealed in the ninth year of Hijrah. The Messenger of Allah sent Ali in the company of Abu Bakr that year to publicize to the idolators that no Mushrik will be allowed to perform Hajj after that year, nor a naked person allowed to perform Tawaf around the House. Allah completed this decree, made it a legislative ruling, as well as, a fact of reality. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Jabir bin Abdullah commented on the Ayah, VJt \%Z% Z* SJSJf >[] 40 you who believe! Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram after this year} Unless it was a servant or one of the people of Dhimmah." Imam Abu Amr Al-Awza i said, Umar bin Abdul- Aziz wrote 111 Abdur-Razzaq 2:271.

(to his governors) to prevent Jews and Christians from entering the Masjids of Muslims, and he followed his order with Allah s statement, 4Verily, the Mushrikin are impure. Ata said, All of the Sacred Area [the Haram] is considered a Masjid, for Allah said, \$So let them not come near Al-Masjid Al-Haram (at Makkah) after this year.} This Ayah indicates that idolators are impure and that the believers are pure. In the Sahth is the following, "The believer does not become impure.^ Allah said, ift "->>-" AY > - iand if you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you, out of His bounty. Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, The people said, Our markets will be closed, our commerce disrupted, and what we earned will vanish. So Allah revealed this verse, ot&% o\ f iand if you fear poverty, Allah will enrich you, out of His bounty from other resources, iifHe wills}, until, ft} i...and feel themselves subdued.} This Ayah means, this will be your compensation for the Al-Bari3:150.

closed markets that you feared would result. Therefore, Allah compensated them for the losses they incurred because they severed ties with idolators, by the Jizyah they earned from the People of the Book. 1 11 Similar statements were reported from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak and others. Allah said, 4'(& si! 6\$ 4Surely, Allah is All-Knowing}, in what benefits you, 4All-Wise}, in His orders and prohibitions, for He is All-Perfect in His actions and statements, All-Just in His creations and decisions, Blessed and Hallowed be He. This is why Allah compensated Muslims for their losses by the amount of Jizyah that they took from the people of Dhimmah. The Order to fight People of the Scriptures until They give the Jizyah Allah said, ii' Vj "3j Jit . o* +&\$ LhjI 02 Ue. dtY-Jt 4fKS- 4Fighl against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, nor forbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who

acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture, until they pay the Jizyah with willing submission, and feel themselves subdued.} Therefore, when People of the Scriptures disbelieved in Muhammad ﷺ, they had no beneficial faith in any Messenger or what the Messengers brought. Rather, they followed their religions because this conformed with their ideas, lusts and the ways of their forefathers, not because they are Allah's Law and Tabari 14:197. Tabari 14:193-196.

At-Tawbah (28 - 29) (Part-10) religion. Had they been true believers in their religions, that faith would have directed them to believe in Muhammad ﷺ, because all Prophets gave the good news of Muhammad's advent and commanded them to obey and follow him. Yet when he was sent, they disbelieved in him, even though he is the mightiest of all Messengers. Therefore, they do not follow the religion of earlier Prophets because these religions came from Allah, but because these suit their desires and lusts. Therefore, their claimed faith in an earlier Prophet will not benefit them because they disbelieved in the master, the mightiest, the last and most perfect of all Prophets. Hence Allah's statement, *وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا بِاللَّهِ وَآتَمُوا بِرِجَالِهِ الْمُرْسَلِينَ* Fight against those who believe not in Allah, nor in the Last Day, nor forbid that which has been forbidden by Allah and His Messenger, and those who acknowledge not the religion of truth among the People of the Scripture,} This honorable Ayah was revealed with the order to fight the People of the Book, after the pagans were defeated, the people entered Allah's religion in large numbers, and the Arabian Peninsula was secured under the Muslims' control. Allah commanded His Messenger ﷺ to fight the People of the Scriptures, Jews and Christians, on the ninth year of Hijrah, and he prepared his army to fight the Romans and called the people to Jihad announcing his intent and destination. The Messenger ﷺ sent his intent to various Arab areas around Al-Madīnah to gather forces, and he collected an army of thirty thousand. Some people from Al-Madīnah and some hypocrites, in and around it, lagged behind, for that year was a year of drought and intense heat. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ marched, heading towards Ash-Sham to fight the Romans until he reached Tabuk, where he set camp for about twenty days next to its water resources. He then prayed to Allah for a decision and went back to Al-Madīnah because it was a hard year and the people were weak, as we will mention, Allah willing. Paying Jizyah is a Sign of Kufr and Disgrace Allah said,

until they pay the Jizyah), if they do not choose to embrace Islam, with willing submission in defeat and subservience. and feel themselves subdued.), disgraced, humiliated and belittled. Therefore,

In the Name of Allah, Most Gracious, Most Merciful. This is a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2277–2284]

document to the servant of Allah Umar, the Leader of the faithful, from the Christians of such and such city. When you (Muslims) came to us we requested safety for ourselves, children, property and followers of our religion. We made a condition on ourselves that we will neither erect in our areas a monastery, church, or a sanctuary for a monk, nor restore any place of worship that needs restoration nor use any of them for the purpose of enmity against Muslims. We will not I 4:1707.

At-Tawbah (28 - 29) -10) prevent any Muslim from resting in our churches whether they come by day or night, and we will open the doors (of our houses of worship] for the wayfarer and passerby. Those Muslims who come as guests, will enjoy boarding and food for three days. We will not allow a spy

against Muslims into our churches and homes or hide deceit [or betrayal] against Muslims. We will not teach our children the Qur'an, publicize practices of Shirk, invite anyone to Shirk or prevent any of our fellows from embracing Islam, if they choose to do so. We will respect Muslims, move from the places we sit in if they choose to sit in them. We will not imitate their clothing, caps, turbahs, sandals, hairstyles, speech, nicknames and title names, or ride on saddles, hang swords on the shoulders, collect weapons of any kind or carry these weapons. We will not encrypt our stamps in Arabic, or sell liquor. We will have the front of our hair cut, wear our customary clothes wherever we are, wear belts around our waist, refrain from erecting crosses on the outside of our churches and demonstrating them and our books in public in Muslim fairways and markets. We will not sound the bells in our churches, except discretely, or raise our voices while reciting our holy books inside our churches in the presence of Muslims, nor raise our voices [with prayer] at our funerals, or light torches in funeral processions in the fairways of Muslims, or their markets. We will not bury our dead next to Muslim dead, or buy servants who were captured by Muslims. We will be guides for Muslims and refrain from breaching their privacy in their homes.' When I gave this document to Umar, he added to it, *We will not beat any Muslim. These are the conditions that we set against ourselves and followers of our religion in return for safety and protection. If we break any of these promises that we set for your benefit against ourselves, then our Dhimmah (promise of protection) is broken and you are allowed to do with us what you are allowed of people of defiance and rebellion. 33 via # (t J4 is J3 " I #&& Luyl [i] Al-Muhalld, by Ibn Hazm 7:346

(Jjj Uj A fl&& ?&Z 4 ;s 4^ ^n H v" 430. And the Jews say: "Uzayr (Ezra) is the son of Allah/" and the Christians say: "The Messiah is the son of Allah." That is their saying ivith their mouths, resembling the saying of those who disbelieved aforetime. May Allah fight tltem, how they are deluded awayfrom the truth!} 431. They (Jews and Christians) took titeir rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah, and (they also took as their Lord) the Messialt, son of Maryam, while they were commanded to worship none but One God, none has the right to be worshipped but He. Praise and hallowed be He above what they associate (with Him)."} Fighting the Jews and Christians is legislated because They are Idolaters and Disbelievers Allah the Exalted encourages the believers to fight the polytheists, disbelieving Jews and Christians, who uttered this terrible statement and utter lies against Allah, the Exalted. As for the Jews, they claimed that Uzayr was the son of God, Allah is free of what they attribute to Him. As for the misguidance of Christians over Isa, it is obvious. This is why Allah declared both groups to be liars, it+i)t >-\$5 ^Ji/) iThat is their saying with their mouths}, but they have no proof that supports their claim, other than lies and fabrications, 4&&} ^.resembling}, imitating, 445 ot &} 4the saying of those who disbelieved aforetime.} They imitate the previous nations who fell into misguidance just as Jews and Christians did, 453 J4&Z} 4may Allah fight them}, Ibn Abbas said, May Allah curse them.

SiiraJt 9. At-Tawbah (30 - 31) (Part-10, 409 }how they are deluded awayfrom the truth!} how they deviate from truth, when it is apparent, exchanging it for misguidance. Allah said next, i'fZp jt A iThey took their rabbis and their monks to be their lords besides Allah, and the Messiah, son ofMaryam} [9:31]. Imam

J) Ur (Mm worship except Him. yMU*& ^ ^ ww f uJl'T.w.^raN, ,^ tt , .." >' &&****>***" *~" ,t mv***** m^ v^ |n1 _jt rLo<\$S-rh~ , ' extinguish Allah s Light i" , '< *'ji^L. \j,/i\jL& wif/i tfier mouths, but rry^~J 11^ wm not allow ex- cept that His Light '~ ^ * <?'- should be perfected even though the disbelievers J*H\cs ^&-'ek^= <^r hate (it).} f . ,;XT7?r <^,tr-f . It is He Who has senf His Messenger with 1^,1Vt^A^j guidance and the reli- ^ ~ v I''*-' ' *''\ '-* gion o/ truth, to wafce it frp > 4SI0H ial^=> superior over all reli- = "~ " gions even though the idolators hate (it).} People of the Scriptures try to extinguish the Light of Islam Allah says, the disbelieving idolators and People of the Scriptures want to, 4# jy \& {extinguish the Light of Allah}. They try through argument and lies to extinguish the guidance and religion of truth that the Messenger of Allah W, was sent with. Their example is the example of he who wants to extinguish the light of the sun or the moon by blowing at them! Indeed, such a personmU never accomplish what he sought. Likewise, the light of what the

Messenger ^ was sent with will certainly shine and spread. Allah replied to the idolators desire and hope, jij J iil Ai/o/i w"7/ not allow except that His Light should be perfected even though the disbelievers (Kafirun) hate (it)} [9 :32], [Linguistincally] a Kafir is the person who covers something. For instance, night is called Kafiran [covering] because it covers things [with darkness]. The farmer is called Kafiran, because he covers seeds in the ground. Allah said in an Ayah, i AC jt&rc c#} ithereof the growth is pleasing to the [Kujfdr} tillers}{57:20}, Islam is the Religion That will dominate over all Other Religions Allah said next, Cfi;j J jij y>} ilt is He Who has sent His Messenger with guidance and the religion oftruth.} Guidance refers to the true narrations, beneficial faith and true religion that the Messenger came with, religion of truth refers to the righteous, legal deeds that bring about benefit in this life and the Hereafter. ito make it (Islam) superior over all religions} It is recorded in the Sahth that the Messenger ofAllah jg said, ^ ^ J Sji oJ" "Allah made the eastern and western parts of the earth draw nearfar me [to see], and the rule ofmy Ummah will extend as far as I Imam

iGsi vj&^ *'' &~^ \$'S u ^ ft i.1 ijj f^X * >-& ^ '> > ^' aThis matter (Islam) will keep spreading as far as the " dax, reach , until Allah will not leave a house made of mud or hair but will make this religion enter it, while bringing might to a mighty person (a Muslim) and humiliation to a disgraced person \who rejects Islam). Might with which AMh elevates Islam (and its people) and disgrace with which Allali humiliates disbelief (and its people)J Tamim Ad-Dari [who was a Christian sav I have come to know the meaning of this Hadith in my oJn people Those who became Muslims among them acquired goodness, honor and might. Disgrace, humiliation and Jizyah befell those who remained disbelievers. j &&P^ ^ ^Jps fo \< & " ^ O you who believe! Verily, there are many of the Alfoar (rabbis) and the Ruhban (monks) who devour the wealth of mankind in falsehood, and hinder (them)from the way ofAllah. And those who hoard up gold and silver and spend them not in the way ofAllah, announce unto them a painful torment.} 435 On the Day when that will be heated in the fire of Hell and with it will be branded their foreheads, their backs, (and it will be said unto them:) This is the treasure which you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste of what you used to hoard."}

Warning against Corrupt Scholars and Misguided

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2284–2346]

Worshippers As-Suddi said that the Ahbdr are Jewish rabbis, while the I1 ! Ahmad 4 :103 .

They sell the religion in return for worldly gains, using their positions and status among people to illegally devour their property. For instance, the Jews were respected by the people of Jahiliyyah and collected gifts, taxes and presents from them. When Allah sent His Messenger *sg*, the Jews persisted in their misguidance, disbelief and rebellion, hoping to keep their status and position. However, Allah extinguished all this and took it away from them with the light of Prophethood and instead gave them disgrace and degradation, and they incurred the anger of Allah, the Exalted. Allah said next, *4*and hinder (them) from the way of Allah.} Therefore, they illegally devour people's property and hinder them from following the truth. They also confuse truth with falsehood and pretend before their ignorant followers that they call to righteousness. The true reality is that they call to the Fire and will not find any helpers on the Day of Resurrection. Torment of Those Who hoard Gold and Silver Allah said, *i*And those who hoard [Kanz] gold and silver and spend them not in the way of Allah, announce unto them a painful torment.} [9 :34]. This is the third category of leaders, for people rely on their scholars, worshippers and the wealthy among them. When these categories of people become corrupt, the society in general becomes corrupt. Ibn Al-Mubarak once said, What corrupted the religion, except kings and wicked Ahbar and Ruhban." As for Kanz, it refers to the wealth on which Zakah has not been paid, according to Malik, who narrated this from Abdullah bin Dinar from Ibn Umar. 111

He repeated this statement thrice, and this Hadith was hard on the Companions of the Messenger of Allah *fg*, who said, What type of wealth should we use? Umar said, I will find out for you, and he asked, O Allah's Messenger! Your statement was hard for your Companions. They asked, What wealth should we use? The Prophet *fg* answered, *Jr;? cji* | CLlJo*

which you hoarded for yourselves. Now taste of what you used to hoard. } These words will be said to them as a way of admonishing, criticizing and mocking them. Allah also said; *i*Theti pour over his head the torment of boiling water. "Taste you (this)! Verily, you were (pretending to be) the mighty, the generous! } [44:48-49]. There is a saying that goes, He who covets a thing and prefers it to Allah's obedience, will be punished with it. Because hoarding money was better to these people than Allah's pleasure, they were punished with it. For instance, Abu Lahab, may Allah curse him, was especially active in defying the Messenger of Allah and his wife was helping him in this regard. Therefore, on the Day of Resurrection, she will help in punishing him, for there will be a twisted rope of palm fiber on her neck. She will be gathering wood from the Fire and throwing it on him so that his torment is made harder by the hand of someone whom he used to care for in this life. Likewise, money was precious to those who hoarded it in this life. Therefore, money will produce the worst harm for them in the Hereafter, when it will be heated in the Fire of Jahannam, whose heat is quiet sufficient, and their forehead, sides and back will be branded with it. Imam Abu JaTar Ibn Jarir recorded that Thawban said that the Messenger of Allah *fg* used to declare, *Jlilj -Jyjj iloil *} jli \ fs IjlL h) oi aLaL JljJ fj iLul kS'j, ^jjj ii fs ui :jfti ?a J{ li -=* J~- Lf* "Whoever leaves a treasure behind (on which he did not pay the Zakat), then on the Day of Resurrection his wealth will be made like a bald-headed poisonous male snake with two black spots over the eyes. The snake will follow him, and he will say, Woe to you! Who are you?' The snake will say, *7* am your treasure that you left behind,' and will keep following him until the man gives it his hand; the snake will devour it and then

418 Tafsir Tbn Kathir devour his whole body ." Ibn Hibban also collected this Hadith in his Sahih. Part of this Hadith was also collected in the Two Sahih from Abu Hurayrah. 111 In his Sahih,

At-Tawbah (35 - 36) (Part-10) (in a year), so was it ordained by Allah on the Day when He created the heavens and the earth; of them four are sacred. That is the right religion, so wrong not yourselves therein, and fight against the Mushrikin idolaters collectively as they fight against you collectively. But know that Allah is with those who have Taqwa. \$ The Year consists of Twelve Months Imam

this the (Sacred) Tcrwn?" We said, Yes. He said, - ju ojM i\ ^ jijfc^ "iii ^ ili ^jb iff ?vLit; > iff 4-ijj 4-A: 'A> : N ^ J J*b Vi^' r^i a Verily! Your blood, property and honor are sacred to one another like the sanctity of this day of yours, in this month of yours and in this city of yours. Verily, you will meet your Lord and He will question you about your actions. Behold! Do not revert to misguidance after me by striking the necks of one another. Have I conveyed? It is incumbent upon those who are present to inform those who are absent, because those who are absent might comprehend (what I have said) better than some who are present. In Al-Bukhari and Muslim collected this Hadith. In a small book collected by Shaykh Alam ad-Din As-Sakhawi, entitled, Al-Mashhad fi Asma Al-Ayam wash-Shuhur, he mentioned that Muharram is so named because it is a sacred month. To me, it was so named to emphasize its sacredness. This is because the Arabs would switch it around. One year they would say it was a sacred month, the following year they would say that it was not. The author said, ...and Safar is so named because they used to leave their homes during that month for fighting and traveling. When saying Safar a place, it means to leave it... Rabi' Al-Awwal is called that because they used to do Irtib in it, that is to maintain one's property... and Rabi' Al-Akhir, was so named for the same reasons. Jumada is called that because the water would dry up (Jamud) then.... They say Jumada Al-Uwla and Al-Awwal, or Jumada Al-Akhar or Al-Akhirah. Rajab comes from Tarfib, meaning to honor. Shaban because the tribes would separate and return to their homes. Ramadan was so named because of the severity of the Ramda - that is - the heat, and they say that the branch Ramadat when it is thirsty... And the 5:37. 121 Path Al-Bari 8 :175 , 6 :338 and 10:10 and Muslim 3 :1305

saying that it is a Name of Allah is a mistake, for there is no proof or support for that... The Sacred Months Allah said, of them four are sacred. The Arabs used to consider these months sacred during the time of Jahiliyyah, except for a group of them called Al-Basl, who held eight months of the year to be sacred as way of exaggeration in religion. The Prophet (s) said, jLoj Three are in succession; Dhul-Qa'dah, Dhul-Hijjah and Muharram, and (the fourth is) Rajab [of (the tribe of) Mudar which comes between Jumada (Ath-Thani)] and Sha'ban.

The Prophet (s) said Rajab of Mudar to attest to the custom of Mudar, in saying that Rajab is the month that is between Jumada and Sha'ban, not as the tribe of Rabi'ah thought, that it is between Sha'ban and Shawwal, which is Ramadan in the present calendar. The four Sacred Months were made four, three in succession and one alone, so that the Hajj and Umrah are performed with ease. Dhul-Qa'dah, the month before the Hajj month, was made sacred because they refrained from fighting during that month. Dhul-Hijjah, the next month, was made sacred because it is the month of Hajj, during which they performed Hajj rituals. Muharram, which comes next, was made sacred so that they are able to go back to their areas in safety [after performing Hajj]. Rajab, in the middle of the lunar year, was made sacred so that those coming from the farthest areas of Arabia are able to perform Umrah and visit the House and then

go back to their areas safely. Allah said next, iThat is the right religion that is the Straight Law, requiring implementing Allah s order concerning the months that He made sacred and their true count as it was originally written by

Allah. Allah said, i'^sC* Irtf, iA iso wrong not yourselves therein) during these Sacred Months, for sin in them is worse than sin in other months. Likewise, sins in the Sacred City are written multiplied, ifj c CA A V? Aj) i . . .and whoever inclines to evil actions therein (in Makkah) or to do wrong, him We shall cause to taste from a painful torment [22:25]. Similarly, sin in general is worse during the Sacred Months Ali bin Abi Talhah narrated that Ibn Abbas said, Allah s statement, i\$ jc* jjfi!' & 6)^ iVerily, the number ofmonths with Allah...), is connected to {fwasjiSAs 4so wrong not yourselves therein), In all (twelve) months. Allah then chose four out of these months and made them sacred, emphasizing their sanctity, making sinning in them greater, in addition to, multiplying rewards of righteous deeds during them. ' Qatadah said about Allah s statement, iso wrong not yourselves therein), Injustice during the Sacred Months is worse and graver than injustice in other months. Verily, injustice is always wrong, but Allah makes things graver than others as He will. He also said, Allah has chosen some of His creation above others. He chose Messengers from angels and from men. He also chose His Speech above all speech, the Masajid above other areas of the earth, Ramadan and the Sacred Months above all months, Friday above the other days and Laylatul-Qadr (The Night of Decree) above all nights. Therefore, sanctify what Allah has sanctified, for doing so is the practice of people ofunderstanding and comprehension." m At-Tabari 14 :238

At-Tawbah (36) (Part-10) Fighting in the Sacred Months Allah said, iisr \&&} iandfight against the idolators collectively}, all ofyou, p&L^} ias theyfight against you collectively.}, all ofthem, iBut know that Allah is ivith those ipho have Taqwd}, and know that initiating battle during the Sacred Months is forbidden. Allah said in other Ayat, V %& 'j&% * \pz iS 40 you who believe! Violate not the sanctity of the symbols of Allah, nor of the sacred month.} (5:2), 4The Sacred Month is for the Sacred Month, and for the prohibited things, there is the law of equality (Qisds). Then whoever transgresses the prohibition against you, you transgress likewise against him} [2:194], and, iThen when the Sacred Months have passed, kill the idolators...} (9:5). As for Allah s statement, pM 1sr 4And fight against the idolators collectively as they fight against you collectively}, it includes permission for the believers to fight the idolators in the Sacred Month, if the idolators initiate hostilities therein. Allah said in other Ayat,

424 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir J (ggaa&s 'Mr sai'Su j-4 Jk ;SJsd i J^iijjCi -*"J^ijfJy J\ L*_jijjll_lj ll_jtL'jic-^k==4X^j i ^ ia, '\ -I - Jv^" *""J *J. >-?>/'< " it |L> A ij/Alot'T^'j tjt ="',yjf \^Ajjiipfy 3^ " -*^52 ^ iJr""^J^'<^^^== \Tlw Sacred Month is for the Sacred Month, and for the prohibited things, there is the law of equality (Qisas)} [2:194], and, m "iffy p t, &Z & ip \$And fight not with them at Al-Masjid Al-Hardn, unless they (first) fight you there. But if they attack you, then kill them> [2:191]. As for the Messenger of Allah 36 laying siege to At-Ta if until the Sacred Month started, it was a continuation of the battle against Hawazin and their allies from Thaqif. They started the fighting and gathered then-men for the purpose of conducting war. The Messenger of Allah 3g marched to meet them and when they took refuge in At-Ta if, the Prophet jg laid siege to them so that they descend from their forts, but they inflicted casualties on Muslims. The siege continued for about forty days, during which a Sacred Month began, and the siege continued for several days in that month. The Messenger jg broke the siege

and went back (to Makkah). So fighting that carries over into it [the Sacred Month] is not the same as initiating warfare during it, Allah knows best. %%% ifc T 4 i< 3&-JI 4 ifj-ii 't ii[] > i ^ pj^- !* lit pj"- U li.

437. The postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief: thereby the disbelievers are led astray, for they make it lawful one year and forbid it another year in order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah, and make such forbidden ones lawful. The evil of their deeds is made fair-seeming to them. And Allah guides not the people who disbelieve.} Admonishing the Preference of Opinion in a Religious Matter Allah admonishes the idolators for choosing their wicked opinions over Allah's Law. They changed Allah's legislation based upon their vain desires, allowing what Allah prohibited and prohibiting what Allah allowed. They thought that three consecutive sacred months were rather long for them to remain without fighting, for they were full of anger and rage. This is why before Islam they innovated a change in the Sacred Month of Muharram, delaying it to the month of Safar. Therefore, they allowed fighting in the Sacred Month and made the non-sacred month sacred, to make the Sacred Months in a year four, as Allah decided! Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah's statement, 4>^=iK 4 iThe postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief}, Junadah bin Awf bin Umayyah Al-Kinani, known as Abu Thumamah, used to attend the Hajj season every year and declare, Abu Thumamah is never rejected nor refuted!, and he used to treat Safar as sacred for people one year [and un-sanctify Muharram] and treat Muharram as sacred another year [and un-sanctify Safar in that year]. This is why Allah said, 4 2)ie postponing (of a Sacred Month) is indeed an addition to disbelief.} Allah says, They allow Muharram one year and make it sacred

another year. ' Al-'Awfi narrated a similar statement from Ibn Abbas.¹² Layth bin Abi Sulaym narrated that Mujahid said, There was a man from Bani Kinanah who would attend the Hajj season every year riding his donkey. He would proclaim, O people! I am never rejected, denied or refuted in what I say. We made this coming Muharram sacred, and Safar not! The following year he would come again and declare the same words then say, *We made this coming Safar sacred and delayed Muharram (revoked its sanctity). This is the meaning of Allah's statement, in order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah, to four months. Allah says, They allow what Allah disallowed by delaying the Sacred Month. 1 3 The idolators used to allow Muharram one year and sanctify Safar in its place. They would continue the months of the year according to their normal count and names. The next year they would sanctify Muharram and continue the year, Safar, Rabi', until the end of the year. \$They make it lawful one year and forbid it another year in order to adjust the number of months forbidden by Allah, and make such forbidden ones lawful.) Therefore, they would still sanctify four months every year, but would one year sanctify the third from the three consecutive Sacred Months, Muharram, and postpone and delay it another year to Safar. In his book of Sirah, Im&m Muhammad bin Ishaq presented a very useful beneficial discussion on this matter. He said; The first to start the practice of overlooking the sanctity of months for the Arabs, thus allowing what Allah sanctified of them and sanctifying what Allah allowed of them, was Al-Qalammas. He was Hudhayfah bin Abd Fuqaym bin Adi bin At-Tabari 14:245. ' At-Tabari 14:246. ' At-Tabari 14:246.

At-Tawbah (37) (Part-10 Amr bin Thalabah bin Al-Harith bin Malik bin Kinanah bin Khuzaymah bin Mudrikah bin Ilyas bin Mudar bin Nizar bin Ma'dd bin Adnan. His son Abbad maintained this practice,

then after him his son Qala bin Abbad did the same, Then his son Umayyah bin Qala', then his son Awf bin Umayyah, then his son Abu Thumamah Junadah bin Awf. He was the last one of his sons (to continue this practice) before Islam. The Arabs used to gather around him when Haft finished, and he would stand and give them a speech in which he sanctifies Rajab, Dhul-Qa dah and Dhul-Hijjah. He would defer the sanctity of Muharram to Safar one year and uphold its sanctity another year, so as to appear upholding the number (of Sacred Months) Allah made sacred. Therefore, he would allow what Allah prohibited and prohibit what Allah allowed. , Allah knows best. Ijgfl JI ZZ& ft i H\$ C IP'. 'Il - jgi\ 4 TgSt qlf ^ iLiCP \j. O you who believe! What is the matter with you, that when you are asked to march forth in the cause of Allah, you cling heavily to the earth? Are you pleased with the life of this world rather than the Hereafter? But little is the enjoyment of the life of this world compared to the Hereafter. . Ifyou march not forth, He will punish you with a painful torment and will replace you by another people; and you cannot harm Him at all, and Allah is able to do all things. Admonishing clinging to Life rather than rushing to perform Jihad Allah admonishes those who lagged behind the Messenger of Allah in the battle of Tabuk, at a time when fruits were ripe and shades tempting in the intense and terrible heat, ijt j Xi lij# U \ X I 1 * Ibn Hisham 1 :45.

428 Tafsir Ibn Kalhir you who believe! What is the matter with you, that when you are asked to march forth in the cause of Allah}, ifyou are called to perform Jihad in the cause of Allah, ji iyou cling heavily to the earth?}, reclining to remain in peace, shade and ripe fruits. iAre you pleased with the life of this world rather than the Hereafter?}, why do you do this, is it because you prefer this life instead of the Hereafter? Allah next diminishes the eagerness for this worldly life and increases it for the Hereafter, little is the enjoyment of the life of this world compared to the Hereafter.} Imam

Abdul-'Aziz bin Marwan was dying he said, *Bring the shroud I will be covered with so that I inspect it. When it was placed before him, he looked at it and said, Is this what I will end up with from this life? He then turned his back and cried, while saying, Woe to you, O life! Your abundance is truly little, your little is short lived, we were deceived by you. Allah warns those who do not join Jihad, p&syXu Iji W ilf you march not forth, He will punish you with a painful torment Ibn Abbas said, Allah s Messenger jg called some Arabs to mobilize, but they lagged behind and Allah withheld rain from coming down on them, and this was their torment. * Allah said, iand will replace you by another people}, who will give aid to His Prophet O, and establish his religion. Allah said in another Ayah, Q& -3 2 iAnd if you turn away (from the obedience to Allah), He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} [47 :38] > -i >< iand you cannot harm Him at all}, you can never harm Allah when you lag behind and stay away from joining Jihad, iand Allah is able to do all things.} He is able to destroy the enemies without your help. o. h 3^ it St ^ Hi jjJi at Y ii jdS at ^)2Lilt I\ f k =s t 1 ' At-Tabari 14:255.

430 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir 440. Ifyou help him (Muhammad j&) not (it does not matter), for Allah did indeed help him when the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two; when they were both in the cave, he said to his companion : "Be not sad (or afraid), surely, Allah is with us." Then Allah sent down His Sakinah (calmness, tranquillity, peace) upon him, and strengthened him with forces (angels) which you saw not, and made the word of those who disbelieved the lowermost, while the Word ofAllah that became the uppermost; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.} Allah supports.His Prophet^ Allah said, 4ffyou help him not}, ifyou do not support His Prophet jg, then it does not matter, for Allah will help,

support, suffice and protect him, just as He did, 4J3 Sjf s&i iwhen the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two;} During the year of the Hijrah, the idolators tried to kill, imprison or expel the Prophet jg, who escaped with his friend and Companion, Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhafah, to the cave of Thawr. They remained in the cave for three days so that the pagans who were sent in their pursuit, returned (to Makkah), and they proceed to Al-Madlnah. While in the cave, Abu Bakr was afraid the pagans might discover them for fear that some harm might touch the Messenger The Prophet jg kept reassuring him and strengthening his resolve, saying, iiiii jisu Jilt u d l;" "O Abu Bakr! What do you think about two, with Allah as their third? [I] Imam

At-Tawbah (40) (Part-10) them looks down at his feet, he will see us. He said, < Jit fciivb Li i Cl U" iO Abu Bakr! What do you think about two with Allah as their third?*" This is recorded in the Two SahthsP This is why Allah said, iThen Allah sent down His Sakinah upon him> sent His aid and triumph to His Messenger jg, or they say it refers to Abu Bakr, iand strengthened him with forces which you saw not}, the angels, 4\$K ji 1^=6 fcjSs- iand made the word of those who disbelieved the lowermost while the Word ofAllah that became the uppermost;} Ibn Abbas commented, The word of those who disbelieved , is Shirk, while, The Word of Allah is La. ilaha illalldh. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu MQsa Al-Ash ari said, The Messenger of Allah jg was asked about a man who fights because of courage, or out of rage for his honor, or to show off. Whom among them is in the cause of Allah? The Prophet said, <*' ^& diii& jit bM jits *He who fights so that Allah's Word is superior, then he fights in Allah's cause.* Allah said next, 4& iand Allah is All-Mighty}, in His revenge and taking retribution, He is the Most Formidable and those who seek refuge with Him and take shelter by adhering to what He instructs sure never *** Ahmad 1 :4. * FatfiAl-Bari 7:11 and Muslim 4 :1854 At-Tabari 14:261. I4 * Fath Al-Bari 1 : 286 and Muslim 3 :1512.

\U flap jA \j L_4jjlilij. Aj^N^j^Ur^jl^IS^5 L Llt u -^'-itatLlS'V |tr <***Z*'*< *s Jj'yjUo yKcddj'j '.> 4lu.^iy.^ ^ dp dSy. made to suffer injustice, 4All-Wise}, in His statements and ac- tions. [- "-j MLjJj lilli. \$ Jrh 4 (&\$J oi p z p& 4ik^ . March forth, whether you are light or heavy, and strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause of Allah. This is better for you, ifyou but knew.} Jihad is required in all Conditions Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from his father from Abu Ad-Duha, Muslim bin Subayh, who said This Ayah, lilj \ -J} 4March forth, whether you are light or heavy} was the first part to be revealed from Surah Bara ah. [11 Mu'tamir bin Sulayman narrated that his father said, Hadrami claimed that he was told that some people used to declare that they will not gain sin (if they lag behind the forces of Jihad} because they are ill or old. This Ayah was revealed, 4^j ft m At-Tabari 14:270.

At-Tawbah (41) (Part-10) iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy . Allah commanded mass mobilization together with the Messenger of Allah sg for the battle of Tabuk, to fight the disbelieving, People of the Book, the Romans, Allah s enemies. Allah ordained that the believers all march forth with the Messenger jg regardless whether they felt active, lazy, at ease or had difficult circumstances, iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy^ Ali bin Zayd narrated that Anas said that Abu Talhah commented (on this Ayah), Whether you are old or young, Allah did not leave an excuse for anyone. Abu Talhah marched to Ash-Sham and fought until he was killed. In another narration, Abu Talhah recited Surah Bara ah until he reached this Ayah, 4 '=Ay\ ^ iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy, and strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause ofAllah .} He then said, I see that Allah had called us

to mobilize whether we are old or young. O my children! Prepare my supplies. His children said, *May Allah grant you His mercy! You conducted Jihad along with the Messenger of Allah jg until he died, then with Abu Bakr until he died, then with TJmar until he died. Let us perform Jihad in your place. Abu Talhah refused and he went to the sea [under the command of Mu'awiyah] where he died. They could not find an island to buiy him on until nine days later, during which his body did not deteriorate or change and they buried him on the island.¹² As-Suddi said, lili iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy}, whether you are rich, poor, strong, or weak. A man came forward, and he was fat, complained, and asked for permission to stay behind [from Tabari 14:266 > Ibn Abi HStim 6:1802.

JViad\, but the Prophet jgg refused. Then this Ayah, iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy} was revealed, and it became hard on the people. So Allah abrogated it with this Ayah, .-r, t" 4 &- 4 !> ", 4There is no blame on those who are weak or ill or whofind no resources to spend, if they are sincere and true (in duty) to Allah and His Messenger} (9:91]. Ibn Jarir said that Hibban bin Zayd Ash-Sharabi narrated to him, We mobilized our forces with Safw&n bin Amr, who was the governor of Hims towards the city of Ephsos appointed to the Jerajima Christian expatriates (in Syria). I saw among the army an old, yet active man, whose eyebrows had sunk over his eyes (from old age), from the residents of Damascus, riding on his animal. I said to him, O uncle! Allah has given you an excuse (to lag behind). He said, O my nephew! Allah has mobilized us whether we are light or heavy. Verily, those whom Allah loves, He tests them. Then to Allah is their return and eternal dwelling. Allah tests from His servants whoever thanks (Him) and observes patience and remembrance of Him, all the while worshipping Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, and worshipping none else. Next, Allah encourages spending in His cause and striving with one's life in His pleasure and the pleasure of His Messenger jg. 4 4p% Ja 4p&jp&\ } iand strive hard with your wealth and your lives in the cause of Allah. This is better for you, if you but knew.} Allah says, this is better for you in this life and the Hereafter. You might spend small amounts, but Allah will reward you the property of your enemy in this life, as well as, the honor that He will keep for you in the Hereafter. The m At-Jabari 14:264.

JU Uj aJia J! ' u>-J! a1>-x ol oU^j OJ ^ ***=* J Oi promised the Mujahid in His cause that if He brings death to him, He will enter him into Paradise. Or, He will return him to his house with whatever reward and war spoils he earns ."ll) So Allah said; ytj J Js-*j j~" S*J ijihdd is ordained for you (

436 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Why Hypocrites would not join in Jihad Allah admonishes those who lagged behind and did not join the Prophet jg for the battle of TabCik, those who asked the Prophet for permission to remain behind, falsely pretending to have legitimate reasons to do so, 4Had it been a near gain}, booty right in front of them, according to Ibn Abbas, iand an easy journey}, travel for only a short distance, <&\$} ithey would have follmved you.} But, 4&\^ , '&',} ithe distance was long for them}, to Ash-Sham, iand they would swear by Allah}, when you return to them, ipZ. S-yL O&Jl)} ilf we only could, we would certainly have come forth with you}, had not there been a valid excuse, we would have gone out with you, idjJZi j&j iThey destroy themselves, and Allah knows that they are liars.} V jXdj lyl JL+5 p, Jit \12} ol " ? ' ' li 443. Mai/ Allah forgive you. Why did you grant them leave, until those who told the truth were manifest to you, and you had known the liars?}

444. Those who believe in Allah and the Last Day, would not ask your leave to be exempted from fighting with their properties and their lives; and Allah is the All-Knower of those who have Taqwd.}

445. It is only those who believe not in Allah and the Last Day and whose hearts are in doubt that ask your leave. So in their doubts they waver. Moderately criticizing the Prophet[^] for allowing the Hypocrites to stay behind Ibn Abi Hatim recorded that Awn said, Have you heard criticism softer than this, starting with forgiveness before criticism, 4P s\$ p,dxU&& } 4May Allah forgive you . Why did you grant them leave . >? m Muwarriq Al-ljli and others said similarly. * Qatadah said, Allah criticized him as you read here, then later revealed to him the permission to allow them to lag behind if he wants, in Surat An-Niir, ip* p; p;bj f# 4So if they ask your permission for some affairs of theirs, give permission to whom you will of them} [24:62]. Ata Al-Khurasani said similarly. Mujahid said, This Ayah was revealed about some people who said, Ask permission from the Messenger of Allah [to stay behind], and whether he agrees, or disagrees, remain behind! '4 * Allah said, 4t4-> pj' 4 ...until those who told the truth were manifest to you}, in reference to valid excuses, 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 6:1805.Tabari 14:274.Tabari 14:273.Tabari 14:273.

jjj & rz \$ tf &jji \4& ph ! \$& ti u& ji t 2f 4#Z*^ JS6 \$: E\$f jfcS& 446. And if they had intended to march out, certainly, they would have made some preparation for it; but Allah was averse to their being sent forth, so He made them lag behind, and it was said (to them): "Sit among those who sit (at home). } 447. Had they marched out with you, they would have added to you nothing except disorder, and they would have hurried about in your midst (spreading corruption) and sowing sedition among you - and there are some among you who would have listened to them. And Allah is the All-Knower of the wrongdoers.} Exposing Hypocrites Allah said, iAnd if they had intended to march out,}, with you to participate in Jihdd iiZ % \&i} 4icertainly, they would have made some preparationfor it} they would have prepared for such task, 5ii &j} ibut Allah was averse to their being sentforth} All&h hated that they should go with you. 4so He made them lag behind, and stay away (from Jihad\, iand it was said (to them): "Sit you among those who sit (at home)" } as a part of what was decreed for them [not that He legislated that they stay behind]. Allah then explained why He disliked

that they march with the believers, saying, \$Had they marched out with you, they would have added to you nothing except disorder}, because they are cowards and failures, iand they would have hurried about in your midst' sowing sedition among you} They would have rushed to spread false stories, hatred and discord among you, , && iand there are some among you who would have listened to them.} who would have obeyed them, given preference to their speech and words and asked them for advice, unaware of the true reality of these hypocrites. This might have caused corruption and great evil between the believers. Muhammad bin Ishaq said, Those who sought permission (from the Messenger to lag behind) included some of the chiefs, such as Abdullah bin Ubayy bin Salul and Al-Jadd bin Qays, who were masters of their people. Allah also made them lag behind because He knew that if they went along with the Messenger sg they would sow sedition in his army. I 1 There were some in the Prophet s army who liked these chiefs and were ready to obey them, because they considered them honorable, iand there are some among you wlv would have listened to them} (9:47]. Allah next reminds of His perfect knowledge, saying,Tabari 14:277. This narration is not authentic, it has been left here because it was the only one mentioned for the explanation

%%\$?f\ ? v m 0) f- %z *tv\$} fy hi ? ra# 4ff 15^^ i!=fi if JT^f! * ' { ? # If. ft fetj puB legrg] 4(i{ftu} atp of) uotsjaan tptm dvcnv patunf anvq fnq p\noai datp 'Ud)Sfi utatp apvtu pvi[api ft itana puv ! uaistj

uiaig apoui navi/ paaput pinom afq 'utatp ut pooS fiuvfo uoiotoi qvpy pvjqt &Cf 4^ iffy 4/1 f .. "" rff\ l8S :9l i suvfi aw datp paaput puy uappiqjcf auaoi /hip qaiifni fvip oj fjaoau dpitviJaa pinotn /hip '(puom atp of) patutpau auacn /hip ft)tig\$> <% D*/< 0 if\ TTT ;vfiy jbjuijs ux pres qBjiv jou ptp Xatp qSnoqj U3A3 pgqojBux Xaq; peq auop 3ABq pjnoM Xaqj jeqM Supeoipui 4'uapjostp fdaaxa 8ui -tpou nod o) pappv anvtf ppiom datp 'nod tpini Ino patpjvm datp pup} if r??\ 'tf ? 9f\$ ^ sb qons jnaao p|no/a } i Moq pajjnaoo 3ABq pinoM SuxqpfriB jx puB jnaoo [[ia\ }Bq/A pajjnoDO }Bq/v\ SAVOuq 3H ?eqj sXbs qBqv 4-suaopSuojoin atp fo J3niou)j -UV *P si my puy> ^n fe~-T vC raj rr\ nr~Cr^~^ Z*S'> ' "" 'SJf J. " Of 'Z'X < 'Si s-y ' rrvr-Tr-^^Cr^~iV rr)es ^V ^\$ ^ Cnea? ^ (Ol-Wd) (8f - ZW TjvqnwLW '6PiIW

At-Tawbah (48 - 49) (Part-10) put me not into trial. Surely, they have fallen into trial. And verily, Hell is surrounding the disbelievers.} Allah says, some hypocrites say to you, O Muhammad \$jg, 44&*} 4Grant me leave}, to stay behind, iand put me not into trial.}, if I go with you and see the women of the Romans. Allah, the Exalted, replied, jJt 4\$} iSurely, they have fallen into trial} because of the statement they uttered. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Az-Zuhri, Yazid bin Ruwman, Abdullah bin Abi Bakr, Asim bin Qatadah and several others that they said, The Messenger of Allah said to Al-Jadd bin Qays from Bani Salimah, - , . 4 , - . ^ J fUJl i?- C dll "WomW you like tofight the yellow ones (Romans) this year? He said, O Allah s Messenger! Give me permission (to remain behind) and do not cause Fitnah for me. By Allah! My people know that there is not a man who is more fond of women than 1. I fear that if I see the women of the yellow ones, I would not be patient. The Messenger of Allah jg turned away from him and said, , , , f oJil '/' give you permission ." In Al-Jadd s case, this Ayah was revealed, 4And among them is he who says: "Grant me leave and put me not into trial. } Therefore, Allah says that the Fitnah that he fell into because of not joining the Messenger of Allah 4g (in Jihad) and preferring his safety to the safety of the Messenger is worse than the Fitnah that he falsely claimed to fear."111 It wasTabari 14:287.

444 os0 tS53^ IZrgi&-J o0 4but if a calamity overtakes you, they say: "YJe took our precaution beforehand,"), they say, we took precautions when we did not join him, 4and they turn away rejoicing.)' Allah directed His Prophet jg to reply to the perfect enmity they have towards him, 4\$) 4Say), to them, 4Nothing shall ever happen to us except what Allah has ordainedfar us.) for we are under His control and decree, 4&3y y) 4He is our Mawld.), Master and protector, 4And in Allah let the believers put their trust) [9:51], and we trust in Him. Verily, He is sufficient for us and what an excellent guardian. iit J j\$C 'Vi\ ji 3) li'fa \$ &\$" j* (^~==**" ^i Vi sfa oi ^* ^y J Vi Sjiii Vj Jyfc VJ / . 452. Say: "Do yow ioaif ybr ms (anything) except one of the two best things; while we await far you either that Allah will afflict you with a punishmentfrom Himself or at our hands. So wait, we too are waiting with you") 453. Say: "Spend willingly or unwillingly, it will not be

reason behind not accepting their charity from them, A % 4except that they disbelieved in Allah and in His Messenger.} and the deeds are accepted if they are preceded with faith, # # %} iand that they came not to the Saldh except in a lazy state.} Therefore, they neither have good intention nor eagerness to perform the acts [of faith], J V. cJJuIt ^ Az ^ A iOjijp tj^ A ! *- Vi^ ol Cj} 2jAj4 Vj j'^=> V) ijLii)' iAnd nothing prevents their contributions from being accepted from them except that they disbelieved in Allah and in His Messenger, and that they came not to the Saldh (the prayer except in a lazy state,

and that they offer not contributions but unwillingly.} The Truthful, to whom the Truth was revealed, Muhammad, peace be upon him, said that Allah does not stop giving rewards until you (believers) stop performing good deeds, and that Allah is Tayyib [Good and Pure] and only accepts what is Tayyib. This is why Allah does not accept charity or good

448 Tafsir Ibt Kathir deeds from the people described in these Ayat, because He only accepts it from those who have Taqwa. erf ysn 4 ^ 'it q^ % q&t^ %} 455. So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you; in reality Allah's plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.} Allah says to His Messenger sg, iSo let not their wealth nor their children amaze you...} In similar Ayat, Allah said, - c sr- A j dLy x- xV ipj x*j | *(ix Wi IXJ llii. u i<&le 4And strain not your eyes in longing for the things We have given far enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them thereby. But the provision (good reward in the Hereafter) of your Lord is better and more lasting} [20:131], and, tAi y S 4 fi fed f"s4jy JU' jx .4f /li iDo they think that in wealth and children with which We enlarge them. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.} [23:55-56]. Allah said next, iQ%\ -gw 4 ^ it i,;q> iin reality Allah s plan is to punish them with these things in the life of this world,} by taking the Zakah due on their money from them and spending it in Allah s cause, according to the meaning given by Al-Hasan Al-Basri. HI At-Tabari 14:296.

At-Tawbah (55 - 57) (Part-10) Allah s statement, 4and that their souls shall depart while they are disbelievers means, so that when Allah brings death to them, they will still be disbelievers, to make matters worse for them and the torment more severe. We seek refuge from such an end, which includes being led astray gradually by these things which they have. ijji } o> . They swear by Allah that they are truly ofyou while they are not ofyou, but they are a people (hypocrites) who are afraid (that you may kill them).} i57. Should they find a refuge, or caves, or a place of concealment, they ivould turn straightway thereto with a sivift rush.} Exposing Hypocrites Fright and Fear Allah describes to His Prophet jg the fright, fear, anxiety and nervousness of the hypocrites, 4They swear by Allah that they are truly ofyou}, swearing a sure oath, iwhile they are not ofyou}, in reality, ibut they are a people who are afraid}, and this is what made them swear.)} 4Should they find a refuge}, such as a fort in which they hide and fortify themselves,

At-Tawbah (58 - 59) (Part-10) 4And ofthem}, among the hypocrites, {who accuse you} or question your integrity, {concerning}, division of, {c&lSti} {the alms}, when you divide them. They question your fairness, even though it is they who deserve that their integrity be questioned. The hypocrites do not do this in defense of the religion, but to gain more for themselves. This is why, {If they are given} meaning, from the Zakdh, Jf) \ >} {They are pleased, but if they are not given thereof, behold! They are enraged!} (9:58), angry for themselves. Qatadah commented on Allah s statement, {And ofthem are some who accuse you concerning the alms.} Allah says, Some of them question your integrity in the matter of distribution of the alms. We were told that a bedouin man, who had recently embraced Islam, came to the Prophet 5, when he was dividing some gold and silver, and said to him, O Muhammad! Even though Allah commanded you to divide in fairness, you have not done so. The Prophet of Allah 3^ said, id* jji ^jji ii ifs Woe to you! Who would befair to you after me then?n The Prophet of Allah^ said next, ^ ^ oCil 'jt |JLi

"Beware of this man and his likes! There are similar persons in my Ummah who recite the Qur'an, but the Qur'an will not go beyond their throat. If they rise (against Muslims rulers) then kill them, if they rise, kill them, then if they rise kill them. We were also told that the Prophet of Allah ﷺ used to say, "jili Of 1*jJ 'ij U-i U jJj By He in Whose Hand is my life! I do not give or withhold anything; I am only a keeper.s 111 This statement from Qatadah is similar to the Hadith that the Two Shaykhs narrated from Abu Saïd about the story of Dhul-Khuwaysirah, whose name was Hurqus. Hurqus protested against the Prophet's division of the war spoils of Hunayn, saying, Be fair, for you have not been fair! The Prophet ﷺ said, JjLP-l jsi jU u! -^ a "/ would have become a loser and a failure if I was not fair! The Messenger ﷺ said after that man left, jt jyy 04-^* ly e.UiJl "Among the offspring of this man will be some with whose prayer, when one of you sees it, would belittle his prayer, and his fast as compared to their fast. They will be renegades from the religion, just like an arrow goes through the game's body. Wherever you find them, kill them, for verily, they are the worst dead people under the cover of the sky. Allah said next, while directing such people to what is more beneficial for them than their behavior, ji& 4f 1ipj feu 41 C j% & 4Would that they were content with what Allah and His Tabari 14:302. Al-B&ri 12 : 302 and Muslim 2 :744

Messenger gave them and had said: "Allah is sufficient for us. Allah will give us of His bounty, and so will His Messenger (from alms). We implore Allah (to enrich us)."} This honorable Ayah contains a gracious type of conduct and an honorable secret. Allah listed; contentment with what He and His Messenger ﷺ give, trusting in Allah alone - by saying; iand they had said: Allah is sufficient for us}, and hoping in Allah alone, and He made these the indications of obedience to the Messenger ﷺ, adhering to his commands, avoiding his prohibitions, believing his narrations and following his footsteps. vty 'Mo M Q fi'. Jib\$ Jc*-' s b O' 460. As-Sadaqat (i.e., Zakah) are only for the Fttqara and Al- Masdkin and those employed to collect (the funds); and to attract the hearts of those who have been inclined (towards Islam); and to free the captives; and for those in debt; and for Allah's cause, and for Ibn As-Sabit; a duty imposed by Allah. And Allah is AU-Knower, All-Wise.} Expenditures of Zakah (Alms) After Allah mentioned the protest that the ignorant hypocrites mentioned to the Prophet ﷺ about the distribution of alms. He stated that it is He who divided the alms, explained its rulings and decided in its division; He did not delegate this decision to anyone else. Allah mentioned the expenditures of Zakah in this Ayah, starting with the Fuqara' (the poor) because they have more need than the other categories, since their need is pressing and precarious. It was reported that Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Ibn Zayd and several others said that the Fatr is a graceful person who does not ask anyone for anything, while the Miskin is the one who follows after people, begging. Qatadah said, The Fatr is the ill person, while the Miskin. is physically fit. ' We will now mention the Tabari 14:305-306. At-Tabari 14:306.

Hadiths about each of these eight categories The Fuqara (Poor) Ibn Umar said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, V "77ie alms should not be given to the wealthy and the physically fit."

At-Tawbah (60) (Part-10) discard Al-Mu allafatu Quffibuhum There are several types of Al-Mu allafatu Qulubuhum. There are those who are given alms to embrace Islam. For instance, the Prophet of Allah gave something to Safwan bin Umayyah from the war spoils of Hunayn, even though he attended it

while a Mushrik. Safwan said, He kept giving me until he became the dearest person to me after he had been the most hated person to me. '21 Imam

some of his peers might embrace Islam, while others are given to collect alms from surrounding areas, or to defend Muslim outposts. Allah knows best. The Riqab Al-Hasan Al-Basri, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Umar bin Abdul- Aziz, Said bin Jubayr, An-Nakhal, Az-Zuhri and Ibn Zayd said Riqab means those slaves who make an agreement with the master to pay a certain ransom for their freedom. 111 Similar was reported from Abu Musa Al-Ash'ari. Ibn Abbas and Al-Hasan said, It is allowed to use Zakah funds to buy the freedom of slaves, indicating that Riqab has more general meanings than merely giving money to slaves to buy their freedom or one's buying a slave and freeing him on an individual basis. A Hadith states that for every limb [of the servant] freed, Allah frees a limb of the one who freed him from slavery, even a sexual organ for a sexual organ, for the reward is equitable to the deed, 'ply iAtid you will be requited nothing except Jbr what you used to do.) [37:39] Virtue of freeing Slaves In the Musnad, there is a Hadith from Al-Bara bin Azib that a man asked, O Allah's Messenger! Direct me to an action that draws me closer to Paradise and away from the Fire. The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, siiij in .i.'U "Emancipate the person and free the neck (slave). The man asked, O Allah's Messenger! Are they not one and the same? He said, - O j i t J l i l) 1 t : No, you emancipate a person by freeing him on your own, but Tabari 14:317. Tabari 14:316.

At-Tawbah (60) (Part-10) you untie a neck (slave) by helping in its priced Al-Gharimun (the Indebted) There are several types of indebted persons. They include those who incur expenses in solving disputes between people, those who guarantee a loan that became due, causing financial strain to them, and those whose funds do not sufficiently cover their debts. It also includes those who indulged in a sin and repented from it. These types have a right to a part of alms (designated for Al-Gharimun). Qablah bin Mukhariq Al-Hilali said, I carried a debt [resolving a dispute between people] and went to the Messenger of Allah asking him to help pay it. The Messenger said, G J j j \alli *iXuai\ li-Jii y.>- "Be patient until some alms are brought to us so that we give it to you." He then said, c.,l~ L*- ^ j] m-j U d dU *iLLJl If* \s\X* :JS j\ - jLs, j* Ul^* JtliJl jl] : j jXj ** y ly Jili - iJtlp^ iSijl. : JI* j(- Jls- If* lilji t/ 5* * J ciLi Sill *L"L- .> ." SjlLlJl j* Vyf Li aO Qabisah! Begging is only allowed for three: a man who incurred debts solving disputes, so he is allowed to beg until he collects its amount and then stops. A man who was afflicted by a disaster that consumed his wealth, he is allowed to beg until he collects what suffices for his livelihood. And a man who was overcome by poverty, that three wise relatives of his stand up and proclaim, 'So-and-so was overcome by poverty.' This man is allowed to beg until he collects what sustains his livelihood. Other than these cases, begging is an unlawful amount that one *** Ahmad 4 :299

458 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir illegally devours ."

cases: those employed to collect it, one who bought a charity item with his money, a Gharim (debtor), a fighter in the cause of Allah, or a poor man who gets a part of the Zakah so he gives it as a gift to a rich man. o' 11 Allah's statement, 4a duty imposed by Allah means, a decision, decree and division ordained by Allah, 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise knowledgeable of all things outwardly and inwardly and what benefits His servants, 4UAll-Wise}, in all what he declares, does, legislates and decides, there is no true deity or lord except Him. A p-\$ ji 5a \$ && p\$ "3j iA*" 461 . And among them are men who

annoy the Prophet and say: "He is (lending his) ear (to every news)." Say: "He listens to what is best for you; he believes in Allah; has faith in the believers; and is a mercy to those of you who believe." But those who annoy Allah's Messenger, will have a painful torment.} Hypocrites annoy the Prophet & Allah says, some hypocrites bother the Messenger of Allah by questioning his character, saying, 4he is (lending his) ear}, to those who say anything about us; he believes whoever talks to him. Therefore, if we went to him and swore, he would believe us. Similar was reported from Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah. 2 ' Allah said, Abu Dawud 2 :288 and Ibn Majah 1 :590. ' Al-Tabari 14:326. This narration is Mursal.

iSay: "He listens to what is best for you }, he knows who is saying the truth and who is lying, ihe believes in Allah; has faith in the believers}, he believes the believers, -4' 3-jj} iand is a mercy to those of you who believe }, and a proof against the disbelievers, ft 3 4A> \$Ajd 4But those who annoy Allah's Messenger, will have a painful torment.} g \j . % }>3a f. (3 . They swear by Allah to you (Muslims) in order to please you, but it is more fitting that they should please Allah and His Messenger, if they are believers.} 463. Know that whoever opposes and shows hostility to Allah and His Messenger, certainly for him will be the fire of Hell to abide therein. That is the extreme disgrace.} Hypocrites revert to lies to please people. Qatadah said about Allah's statement,

iThey swear by Allah to you (Muslims) in order to please you. A hypocrite man said, By Allah! They (hypocrites) are our chiefs and masters. If what Muhammad says is true, they are worse than donkeys. A Muslim man heard him and declared, By Allah! What Muhammad says is true and you are worse than a donkey! The Muslim man conveyed what happened to the Prophet who summoned the hypocrite and asked him, jji Js &J. u" aWhat made you say what you said"? That man invoked curses on himself and swore by Allah that he never said that. Meanwhile, the Muslim man said, O Allah! Assert the truth of the truthful and expose the lies of the liar. Allah revealed this Verse. Allah's statement, 4Know that whoever opposes and shows hostility to Allah and His Messenger, means, have they not come to know and realize that those who defy, oppose, wage war and reject Allah, thus becoming on one side while Allah and His Messenger are on another side, 'J4r ji 'A 4certainly for him will be the fire of Hell to abide therein}, in a humiliating torment, *_jt djf>} iThat is the extreme disgrace}9:63), that is the greatest disgrace and the tremendous misery. 464. The hypocrites fear lest a Surah should be revealed about them, showing them what is in their hearts. Say: "(Go ahead and) mock! But certainly Allah will bring to light all that you fear."} At-Tabari 14:329.

The Hypocrites fear Public Exposure of Their Secrets. Mujahid said, The hypocrites would say something to each other then declare, We wish that Allah does not expose this secret of ours, 111 There is a similar Ayah to this one, that is, Allah's statement, iif CXu ^Ji Q 'ojyfj iit j C SfL Ajfc. ;'IS pL iAnd when they come to you, they greet you with a greeting wherewith Allah greets you not, and say within themselves: Why should Allah punish us not for what we say?" Hell will be sufficient for them; they will burn therein. And worst indeed is that destination!) [58:8] Allah said in this Ayah, i/ >< * - it iSay : "(Go ahead and) mock! But certainly Allah will bring to light all that you fear. He will expose and explain your reality to His Messenger by through revelation. Allah said in other Ayat, &rAJJ % A* > iOr do those in whose hearts is a disease (of hypocrisy), think that Allah will not bring to light all their hidden ill-wills?) (47:291, until. iBut surely, you will know them by the tone of their speech!)[47:30].

This is why, according to Qatadah, this Surah is called Al- Fadiah (the Exposing), because it exposed the hypocrites. 121 Afjj yty j" 4^j Jy o* v-ili a) SIS Ji V At-Jabari 14:331. At-Tabari 14:332.

At-Tawbah (65 - 66) (Part-10) 465. If you ask them (about this), they declare: „We were only talking idly and joking." Say: 'Was it at Allah, and His Aydt and His Messenger that you were mocking?' 466. Make no excuse; you disbelieved after you had believed. If We pardon some of you, We will punish others among you because they were criminals.} The Hypocrites rely on False, Misguided Excuses Abdullah bin Umar said, During the battle of Tabuk, a man was sitting in a gathering and said, have never seen like these reciters of ours! They have the hungriest stomachs, the most lying tongues and are the most cowardice in battle. A man in the Masjid said, You lie. You are a hypocrite, and I will surely inform the Messenger of Allah, This statement was conveyed to the Messenger of Allah sg and also a part of the Qur an was revealed about it. Abdullah bin 'Umar said, I have seen that man afterwards holding onto the shoulders of the Messenger s camel while stones were falling on him, declaring, O Allah s Messenger! We were only engaged in idle talk and jesting, while the Messenger of Allah sg was reciting, 4& Z"Was it at Allah, and His Aydt and His Messenger that you were mocking?" [9:65]. „x| Allah said, 4Make no excuse; you disbelieved after you had believed.} on account of your statement and mocking, mli j&s & JZ 0\} 4If We pardon some of you, We will punish others among you} for not all of you will be forgiven, some will have to taste the torment, 4because they were criminals}, they were criminals because of this (i) At-Tabari 14:333.

terrible, sinful statement. 467. The hypocrites, men and women, are one from another; they enjoin evil, and forbid the good, and they close their hands. They have forgotten Allah, so He has forgotten them. Verily, the hypocrites are the rebellious.} 468. Allah has promised the hypocrites - men and women - and the disbelievers, the fire of Hell; therein shall they abide. It will suffice them. Allah has cursed them and for them is the lasting torment. Other Characteristics of Hypocrites Allah admonishes the hypocrites who, unlike the believers, who enjoin righteousness and forbid evil, 4(4: ^ ofiafoj j 4they enjoin evil, and forbid the good, and they close their hands4, from spending in Allah s cause, \y^} 4They have forgotten Allah}, they have forgotten the remembrance of Allah, 4so He has forgotten them.}, by treating them as if He has forgotten them. Allah also, Xty.M 'J-j Jjj} 4And it will be said: This Day We will forget you as you forgot the meeting of this Day of yours} [45:34] Allah said, 4by~j.1' jUiUl' -^fo} 4 Verily, the hypocrites are the rebellious}

the rebellious from the way of truth who embrace the wicked way, 4Allah has promised the hypocrites - men and women - and the disbelievers, the fire of Hell}, on account of their evil doing mentioned here, iQ. 4therein shall they abide.}, for eternity, they and the disbelievers, 4It will suffice them.}, as a torment, iAllah has cursed them}, He expelled and banished them [from His mercy], iand for them is the lasting torment.} l&LX %fa S3 'fas * &\$?} faj J-fa* fal dfa jpx fak falL\ pi ci (H^" iXf- 469. Like those before you: they were mightier than you in power, and more abundant in wealth and children. They had enjoyed their portion (a while), so enjoy your portion (a while) as those before you enjoyed their portion (a while); and you

IpIjj < jJu jh-1j ~j~ 1 4 Jj j (" r* S-^ii cjt-4' 1 "oj>~1~>-jj ^ : Jli ?vlkjl Uy He in Whose Hand is my sow// You will follow the traditions of those who were before you a hand span for a hand- span and forearm's length for forearm's length, and an arm's length for an arm's length. And even if they enter the

den of a lizard, you will also enter it." They asked, Who, O Allah's Messenger, the People of the Book? He said, "I know else?" ^ This Hadith is similar to another Hadith collected in the Sahih. Jijij fSj gy fy^U oi t}f O0j {+\$1 fit a j\$F . Has not the story reached them of those before them? - The people of Nuh/Ad, Thamiid, the people of Ibrahim, the dwellers of Madyan and the overturned cities; to them came their Messengers with clear proofs. So it was not Allah Who wronged them, but they used to wrong themselves. Advising the Hypocrites to learn a Lesson from Those before Them Allah advises the hypocrites who reject the Messengers, 4.Z-& &, iity iHas not the story reached them of those before them?} have you (hypocrites) not learned the end of the nations before you who rejected the Messengers, 4The people of Nuh}, and the flood that drowned the entire population of the earth, except those who believed in Allah's servant and Messenger Nuh, peace be upon him, m Aj-Tabari 14:342.

and 'Ad}, who perished with the barren wind when they rejected Hud, peace be upon him, 4and Thamud}, who were overtaken by the Sayhah (awful city) when they denied Salih, peace be upon him, and killed the camel, and the people of Ibrahim}, over whom He gave Ibrahim victory and the aid of clear miracles. Allah destroyed their king Nimrod, son of Canaan, son of Koch from Canaan, may Allah curse him, and the dwellers of Madyan}, the people of Shu'ayb, peace be upon him, who were destroyed by the earthquake and the torment of the day of the Shade, and the overturned cities}, the people of Lut who used to live in Madyan. Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd He destroyed the overturned cities [53:53], meaning the people of the overturned cities in reference to Sadum [Sodom], their major city. Allah destroyed them all because they rejected Allah's Prophet Lut, peace be upon him, and because they committed the sin that none before them had committed [homosexuality] <&2\$ p4iii ito them came their Messengers with clear proofs.}, and unequivocal evidence, 4So it was not Allah Who wronged them}, when He destroyed them, for He established the proofs against them by sending

At-Tawbah (70 - 71) (Part-10) the Messengers and dissipating the doubts, rtf 4but they used to wrong themselves on account of their denying the Messengers and defying the Truth; this is why they earned the end, torment and punishment, that they did. j > rojl fa V & Si la^ w Sjfc tf 471. The believers, men and women, are supporters of one another; they enjoin good, and forbid evil ; they perform the Salah, and give the Zakah, and obey Allah and His Messenger. Allah will have His mercy on them. Surely, Allah is All- Mighty, All-Wise.} Qualities of Faithful Believers After Allah mentioned the evil characteristics of the hypocrites, He then mentioned the good qualities of the believers, iof. fa. oUVtf iThe believers, men and women, are supporters of one another;} they help and aid each other. Surely, an authentic Hadith states, ^ -j J (1)UJ IS i < 77ie believer to the believer is just like a building, its parts support each other. and the Prophet jg crossed his fingers together. 1 1 In the Sahih it is recorded, yS-" d ^PI-C The example of the believers in the compassion and mercy they FathAl-Bdri 10:464.

472. Allah has promised the believers - men and women, - Gardens under which rivers flow to dwell therein forever, and beautiful mansions in gardens of Adn (Eden; Paradise). But the greatest bliss is the good pleasure of Allah. That is the supreme success.) GoodNews for the Believers of Eternal Delight Allah describes the joys and eternal delight He has prepared for the believers, men and women in, i'Q, 'Jr*'^ Oi ct/P iGardens under which rivers flow to dwell therein forever for eternity, and beautiful mansions), built beautifully in good surroundings. In the Two SahDis, it is recorded that Abu Musa, Abdullah bin Qays Al-Ash'ari said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, Sm* "Sj V] Ji VMM f\$\\ Two

gardens, their pots and whatever is in them are made of gold, and two gardens, their pots and whatever is in them are made of silver. Only the Veil of Pride of Allah's Face separates the people from gazing at Him, in the garden of Eden. 1 He also narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg said, j. %s 5* jifij jjJj j* !>!" Liijy p Jji V For the believer in Paradise there is a tent like a hollow pearl which is sixty miles high in the sky, and in the tent the believer will have (so large) a family that he visits them all and some of them would not be able to see the others ." The Two Sahths collected this Hadith.^ It is recorded in the ^ FathAl-B&ri8 :49 1 and Muslim 1 :163. Al-B&ri 8 :44 1 and Muslim 4 :2182

Abu Hurayrah said, that the Messenger of Allah sg said. :Jli ?il_.^Jl Uj ill J^-j L Jj ill \jLj ijj. j Jllj lij ty ll 'jjS if y-jVj J^J Jf 'j 1^ IL; i iffd 1J -Jr'fi J*f" iff you invoke Allah for Salah (blessings) on me, then also invoke Him to grant me Al-Wasilah ." He was asked, What is Al-Wasdah, O Allah s Messenger? He said, iThe highest grade in Paradise, it will be for only one man, and I hope I am that man.* The Musnad. contains a Hadith from Sa d bin Mujahid At- Ta I, that Abu Al-Mudillah said, that Abu Hurayrah said, We said, O Allah s Messenger! Talk to us about Paradise, what isAl-Bari6:\4. Ahmad 2:256.

At-Tawbah (72) (Part-10) it built of? He said, yj lajLJu-j dlUl l i Sj > s v_r*! 7_> ^ Jliij Y j*jCJ tfU-Jb "iLi "^\ brick of gold and a brick of silver. Its mortar is from musk, its gravel is pearls and rubies. Its sand is saffron. Whoever enters it will enjoy the delights, will never be hopeless, and will live forever and will not die. His clothes will never decay nor will his youth ever end Allah said next, iBut the greatest bliss is the good pleasure of Allah\9:72\, meaning, Allah s pleasure is more grand, greater and better than the delight the believers will be enjoying [in Paradise). Imam Malik narrated, that Zayd bin Aslam said that Ata bin Yasar said that Abu Said Al-Khudri said that the Messenger of Allah said, Hjj I jjijals "1! U Lj dyi* j yp jl# y'j ^ ^ y 7 & Uj : ofjjCj Ja . kiiiJb J> yi |*^dapf Yl ! y* |JL Ja U Uxlp-i ^ <!M j* tCs* Qo 4o ^ '-ofyS oJLaj Ja^wl "Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, will say to the people of Paradise, 'O residents of Paradise! They will say, 'Labbayka (here we are!), our Lord, and Sa'dayk (we are happy at your service!) and all the good is in Your Hand.' He will ask them, Are you pleased?' They will say, 'Why would not we be pleased, O Lord, while You have given us what You have not given any other of your creation?' He will say, 'Should I give you what is better than all this? They will say, 'O Lord! What is better than all this?' He will say, 7 will grant you My pleasure and will never afterwards be angry with you. ^ Ahmad 2:304.

tfeSlgUJr " a 6 lA*j ^ubi^i^>=jJ&il^ij)isl^j i jIsa LW ^i^iJ^ Ojj 4Jlla^ie- (>. ^Uj > > *> .*< ," <.\J\"< s -^JiK I ".v" ; rf The Two Sahihs collected the Hadtth of Malik. 4 ?if .'It jli =i)l J^i. ^Jl ("!?* -tli?) Lni^ll'j ^^* Jij i> ^ij i_,3(i c it l"J ^-1 ^A" a jU^il iS Vi \$2 /"r V 1^" if 1 , *< 1^* *i" L)J" .4M" ui at te ^ h " Lleftj aiiT 4q 1 c& 'tfj \$5 uj 'wi j^ i| A 473. O Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelie- vers and the hypocrites, and be harsh against them, their abode is Hell, - and worst indeed is that destination.} 474. They swear by Allah that they said nothing (bad), but really they said the word of disbelief, and they disbelieved after accepting Islam, and they resolved that (plot) which they were unable to carry out, and they could not find any cause to do so except that Allah and His Messenger had enriched them of His bounty. If then they repent, it will be better for them, but if they turn away ; Allah will punish them with a painful torment in this worldly life and in the Hereafter. And there is none for them on earth as a

protector or a helper.} The Order for Jihad against the Disbelievers and Hypocrites Allah commanded His Messenger jg to strive hard against the Fath Al-B&ri 1 1 :423 and Muslim 4 :2176.

disbelievers and the hypocrites and to be harsh against them. Allah also commanded him to be merciful with the believers who followed him, informing him that the destination of the disbelievers and hypocrites is the Fire in the Hereafter. Ibn Mas*ud commented on Allah s statement, jU =Jt 4Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites} With the hand, or at least have a stern face with them. Ibn Abbas said, Allah commanded the Prophet to fight the disbelievers with the sword, to strive against the hypocrites with the tongue and annulled lenient treatment of them. Ad-Dahhak commented, Perform Jih&d against the disbelievers with the sword and be harsh with the hypocrites with words, and this is the Jihad performed against them. * Similar was said by Muqatil and Ar-Rabl . * Al-Hasan and Qatadah said, Striving against them includes establishing the (Islamic Penal) Law of equality against them. In combining these statements, we could say that Allah causes punishment of the disbelievers and hypocrites with all of these methods in various conditions and situations, and Allah knows best.

what is available to them - so they mock at them (believers);

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2352–2385]

Allah will throw back their mockery on them, and they shall Al-B&ri 1 :1 11 and Muslim 1 :78.

482 Tafsir Ibt Kathir have a painful torment.} Hypocritesdefame BelieversWhogivethe Little Charity They can afford Among the traits of the hypocrites is that they will not leave anyone without defaming and ridiculing him in all circumstances even those who give away charity. If, for instance, someone gives away a large amount, the hypocrites say that he is showing off. If someone gives away a small amount they say that Allah stands not in need of this man s charity.

j!;^ "None besides you!* Abdur-Rahman bin Awf said, 1 will give a hundred Uqiyah of gold as a charity. Umar bin Al-Khattab said to him, Are you crazy? Abdur-Rahman said, 1 am not crazy. Umar said, Have you given what you said would give? Abdur-Rahman said, Yes. I have eight thousand [Dirhams], four thousand I give as a loan to my Lord and four thousand I keep for myself. The Messenger of Allah jg said, U_ij oSLlif LLi kIU iul djC *May Allah bless youfarwhat you keptandwhatyou gave away*. However, the hypocrites defamed him, *By Allah! Abdur- Rahman gave what he gave just to show off. They lied, for Abdur-Rahman willingly gave that money, and Allah revealed about his innocence and the innocence of the fellow who was poor and brought only a Sa of dates. Allah said in His Book, s | ot iTlwse who defame such of the believers who give clwrity voluntarily> (9:79). ,1 > A similar story was narrated from Mujahid and several others. Ibn Ishaq said, Among the believers who gave away chanty were Abdur-Rahman bin Awf who gave four thousand Dirhams and Asim bin Adi from Bani Ajlan. This occurred after the Messenger of Allah gg encouraged and called for paying chanty. Abdur-Rahman bin Awf stood and gave away four thousand Dirhams. Asim bin Adi also stood and gave a hundred Wasaq of dates, but some people defamed them, saying, They are showing off. As for the person who gave the little that he could afford, he was Abu Aql, from Bani Anlf Al- Arashi, who was an ally of Bani Amr bin Awf. He brought a Sa of dates and added it to the charity. They laughed at him, saying, Allah does not need the Sa' ofAbu Aql. 121

J Allah said, [^]j k*.~ -.1 4|"rJ 'jy* jnH j-V' -Ay-JJ ^Xj iso they mock at them / >t' ' '<*>'{' (believers); Allah will G*-* lJ^r" 4 * -> throw back their mockery on them^ &\$&h^\\kaA^SL& Lebukin," '. hem fo ly^> VCT their evil actions and defaming the ^ > r-*V " f-"-" believers. Truly, the Lr r reward, or I/'V \ a>:< 1 i*- >* it ft -*<* :k*>:- punishment, is equitable to the ijJbiU'v*L^uill action. Allah treated ! people are treated, to aid the bel everE in Q) prepared a painful TV< "L" -l:-"i": '! i\\ -.r torment in the Hereafter for the aJjioS^l hypocrites, for the ^ ^ /r"/{ .> - i-iMtt'l.t recompense is similar || to th/deed 480. Whether you (O Muhammad s&) oslc forgiveness for them (hypocrites) or ask not forgiveness for them - (and even) ifyou ask seventy times for their forgiveness - Allah will not forgive them because they have disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger. And Allah guides not those people who are rebellious.> The Prohibition of asking for Forgiveness for Hypocrites Allah says to His Prophet j that hypocrites are not worthy of seeking forgiveness for them and that if he asks Allah to forgive them seventy times, Allah will not forgive them. The number seventy here was mentioned to close the door on this subject.

At-Tawbah (80 - 81) (Part-10) for Arabs use this number when they exaggerate, not that they actually mean seventy or more than seventy. Ash-Shahi said that when Abdullah bin Ubayy was dying, his son went to the Prophet jg and said to him, My father has died, I wish you could attend him and pray the funeral prayer for him. The Prophet jg said, i> " What is your name? He said, Al-Hubab bin Abdullah. The Prophet said, jkcli vIjUAJI jl J 4l1jLp Rather, you are 'Abdullah bin 'Abdullah, for Al-Hubab is a devil's name . The Prophet went along with him, attended his father s funeral, gave him his shirt as a shroud and prayed the funeral prayer for him. He was asked, Would you pray on him, when he is a hypocrite? He said, \$ hj&Sj 4% : Jli ii !)1 b "Allah said,4 .. (and even) if you ask seventy times for their forgiveness. Verily, I will ask Allah to forgive them seventy times and seventy more and seventy more. * Similar narrations were collected from TJrwah bin Az-Zubayr, Mujahid, Qatadah bin Di'amah and Ibn Jarir.121 481. Those who stayed away (from Tabiik expedition) rejoiced in their staying behind the Messenger of Allah ; they hated to At-Tabari 14:396 l2 ' At-Tabari 14:396-397. Even though this Hadith is Mursal, it has several witnesses and chains of narration which make it sound . The basis of it is also mentioned in Al-Bukh&ri (46704 and 4671). Refer also to the Tafsir of Ibn Kathlr under the commentary on Ayah (9:84).

486 Tafsir IbtI Kathir strive and fight with their properties and their lives in the cause of Allah, and they said: "March not forth in the heat." Say: "The fire of Hell is more intense in heat;" if only they could understand!} 482. So let them laugh a little and (they will) cry much as a recompense of what they used to earn (by committing sins).} Hypocrites rejoice because They remained behind from Tabuk! Allah admonishes the hypocrites who lagged behind from the battle of Tabuk with the Companions of the Messenger of Allah jg, rejoicing that they remained behind after the Messenger jg departed for the battle, i*g. J 4they hated to strive and fight}, along with the Messenger g, 4ioith their properties and their lives in the cause of Allah, and they said}, to each other, 4"March not forth in the heat."} Tabuk occurred at a time when the heat was intense and the fruits and shades became delightful. This is why they said, i 4 4 March not forth in the heat } Allah said to His Messenger i&, 4Say} to them, 4"The fire of Hell...}, which will be your destination because of your disobedience, \% 4".. is more intense in heat; }, than the heat that you sought to

They said, O Allah's Messenger! This fire alone is enough. He said, Crrr?

At-Tcncvbah (83) (Part-10 hypocrites), and they ask your permission to go out (to fight), say: Never shall you go out with me nor fight an enemy with me; you were pleased to sit (inactive) on the first occasion, then you sit (ncnv) with those ivho lag behind. Hypocrites are barred from participating in Jihad Allah commands His Messenger, peace be upon him, 41/Allah brings you back), from this battle, Aft 4to a party of them} in reference to the twelve (hypocrite) men, according to Qatadah , 4and they ask your permission to go out}, with you to another battle, if.f ^ di* J A*) 4say: "Never shall you go out with me nor fight an enemy with me... } as an admonishment and punishment for them. Allah mentioned the reason for this decision, A.Yu'# 4 You were pleased to sit (inactive) on the first occasion .. ." } Allah said in a similar Ayah, 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance), as they refused to believe therein for the first time.} (6 :110) The recompense of an evil deed includes being directed to follow it with another evil deed, while the reward of a good deed includes being directed to another good deed after it. For instance, Allah said concerning the Umrah of Hudaybiyyah, Tabari 14 :404.

i&jXh 4zm iSi -\$is iThose who lagged behind will say, when you set forth to take the spoils.>[48:15) Allah said next, 4"...then you sit (now) with those who lag behind."} in reference to the men who lagged behind from [Tabiik) battle, according to Ibn Abbas. iylij !i^ ("iJf*& fS" 484. And never (O Muhammad j&) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies, nor stand at his grave. Certainly they disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger, and died while they were Fasiquun .} The Prohibition of Prayer for the Funeral of Hypocrites Allah commands His Messenger ^ to disown the hypocrites, to abstain from praying the funeral prayer when any of them dies, from standing next to his grave to seek Allah s forgiveness for him, or to invoke Allah for his benefit. This is because hypocrites disbelieved in Allah and His Messenger jg and died as such. This ruling applies to all those who are known to be hypocrites, even though it was revealed about the specific case of Abdullah bin Ubayy bin SalQl, the chief hypocrite. Al- Bukhari recorded that Ibn Umar said, When Abdullah bin Ubayy died, his son, Abdullah bin Abdullah, came to the Messenger of Allah jg and asked him to give him his shirt to shroud his father in, and the Messenger did that. He also asked that the Prophet^ offer his father s funeral prayer, and Allah s Messenger jg stood up to offer the funeral prayer. Umar took hold of the Prophet s robe and said, O Allah s Messenger! Are you going to offer his funeral prayer even though your Lord has forbidden you to do so? Allah s Messenger jg said, m At-Jabari 14:404.

: Jlii iul lj'fs- U5j" "/" have been given the choice, for Allah says fp& ^ oip lip iWhether you ask forgiveness for them (hypocrites), or do not ask for forgiveness for them. Even though you ask for their forgiveness seventy times, Allah will not forgive them.} j.i: " P a Verily, I will ask [for forgiveness for him] more than seventy timesK Umar said, *He is a hypocrite! So Allah s Messenger jg offered the funeral prayer and on that Allah revealed this Verse, if 'ij Cl ols p A- si' 4And never (O Muhammad) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies, nor stand at his grave.y*^ Umar bin Al-Khattab narrated a similar narration.¹² In this narration, Umar said, The Prophet jg offered his funeral prayer, walked with the funeral procession and stood on his grave until he was buried. I was amazed at my daring to talk like this to the Messenger of Allah jg, while Allah and His Messenger jg have better knowledge. By jg Allah, soon afterwards, these two Ayat were revealed, 4Q &p if p, 4And never (O

Muhammad (ﷺ) pray (funeral prayer) for any of them (hypocrites) who dies.} Ever since this revelation came, the Prophet (ﷺ) never offered the funeral prayer for any hypocrite nor stood on his grave until Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, brought death to him.

492 Tafsir Ibn Kathir r-J & anfas & gsm T 2jJijJU_il;;J^y,54i. V. > ^ t> ^ ^ "k/ L*->} >' A**.X**+ ' ("*> pr ^/J L^jj . And let not their wealth or their children amaze you. Allah only wants to punish them with these things in this world, and that their souls shall depart (die) while they are disbelievers.} We mentioned before

the explanation of a similar Ayah, all the thanks and praises are due to Allah. i *l" ol *Jy* cJ I} ijji i 3^ Ijl# tjj JjiaJ' 4 \$' ^ * TJ>^* d yJ"J ^ |y ^i o\ jjij Sj4^r9^y*x J_p l^k=d|4t \jffjol\j^* -(rijs^ ii_y J ^,\$j 1 . And when a Surah is revealed, enjoining them to believe in Allah and to strive hard and fight along with His Messenger, the wealthy among them ask your leave to exempt them and say, "Leave us (behind), we would be with those who sit (at home)."} 487. They are content to be with those who sit behind. Their hearts are sealed up, so they understand not.} Admonishing Those Who did not join the Jihad Allah chastises and admonishes those who stayed away from Jihad and refrained from performing it, even though they had the supplies, means and ability to join it. They asked the

Messenger^ for permission to stay behind, saying, 4U&& 4 Leave us (behind), we would be with those who sit (at home)) thus accepting for themselves the shame of lagging behind with women, after the army had left. If war starts, such people are the most cowardice, but when it is safe, they are the most boastful among men. Allah described them in another Ayah, liji opl Si cA SAi 4III. ill \$\$\$ 4Then when fear comes, you will see them looking to you, their eyes revolving like (those of) one over whom hovers death; but when the fear departs, they will smite you with sharp tongues.}[33:9\ their tongues direct their harsh words against you, when it is safe to do so. In battle, however, they are the most cowardice among men. Allah said in another Ayah, oVj JLzj)' vjj, SSca SSS' bji Sj, vji SL/S itli. .VjLp ijS ojP' iri St joJ' jS yyS 3 Op 4^ P*- S&S ijfi jft _P' !>_>& 'iji jpi iThose who believe say: "1Why is not a Surah sent down (for us)? But when a decisive Surah (explaining and ordering things) is sent down, and fighting is mentioned therein, you will see those in whose hearts is a disease looking at you with a look of one fainting to death. But it was better for them. Obedience (to Allah) and good words (were better for them). And when the matter is resolved on, then if they had been true to Allah, it would have been better for them.) [47:20-21] Allah said next, 4'rr & iTheir hearts are sealed up) because of their staying away from Jihad and from accompanying the Messenger (ﷺ) in Allah's cause,

(o>" so they understand not.) they neither understand what benefits them so that they perform it nor what hurts them so that they avoid it. 1/3 p uJJj a \pn j_^j(^ Vi iff & sfX ^ iiii jll jti liifjjV 4#^ Bid the Messenger and those who believed with him strove hard and fought with their wealth and their lives. Such are they for whom are the good things, and it is they who will be successful.) i89. For them Allah has prepared Gardens (Paradise) under which rivers flow, to dwell therein forever. That is the supreme success.) After Allah mentioned the sins of the hypocrites, He praised the faithful believers and described their reward in the Hereafter, ! C m iBut the Messenger and those who believed with him strove hard and fought) until the end of these two Ayat [9:88-89). This describes the qualities, as well as, the reward of faithful believers. Allah said, iSuch are they for whom are the good things), in the Hereafter, in the gardens of Al-Firdaws and the high grades. iil I J-ijA ->^Vi SaiIUi &-j) v'-i* At u ="

i90. And those who made excuses from the bedouins came asking your permission to exempt them (from the battle), and those who had lied to Allah and His Messenger sat at home (without asking the permission for it); a painful torment will seize those of them who disbelieve.) Allah describes here the condition of the bedouins who lived

around Al-Madinah, who asked for permission to remain behind from Jihad when they came to the Messenger to explain to him their weakness and inability to join the fighting. Ad-Dahhak said that Ibn Abbas said that they were those who had valid excuses, for Allah said next. 4and those who had lied to Allah and His Messenger sat at home, and did not ask for permission for it; and Allah warned them of painful punishment, 4a painful torment will seize those of them who disbelieve.} \$g c \$ % \$&% gaaji \$J} gljll t ^ #< C IA4 % > 491. There is no blame on those who are weak or ill or who find no resources to spend, if they are sincere and true (in duty) to Allah and His Messenger. No means (of complaint) can there be against the doers of good. And Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 492. Nor (is there blame) on those who came to you to be provided with mounts, when you said: "I can find no mounts for you," they turned back, with their eyes overflowing with tears of grief that they could not find anything to spend.} 493. The means (of complaint) is only against those who are rich, and yet ask exemption. They are content to be with (the women) who sit behind (at home) and Allah has sealed up their hearts so that they know not (what they are losing).} Legitimate Excuses for staying away from Jihad Allah mentions here the valid excuses that permit one to stay away from fighting. He first mentions the excuses that remain with a person, the weakness in the body that disallows

one from Jihad, such as blindness, limping, and so forth. He then mentions the excuses that are not permanent, such as an illness that would prevent one from fighting in the cause of Allah, or poverty that prevents preparing for Jihad. There is no sin in these cases if they remain behind, providing that when they remain behind, they do not spread malice or try to discourage

At-Tawbah (93 - 94) (Part-11) ^ iSSaljiis T-T SSBP iSjC. b\jjj5p=iJ J k K-r ^ ^ "*" *^ !y'==,*j*b pfi(irrc :. -t- 1 f < i <<*S01L pZ\$K "Some people have remained behind you in Al-Madinah ; and you never spent anything, crossed a valley, or afflicted hardship on an enemy, but they were sharing the reward with you ." He then recited the Ayah, Z V dJi iNor (is there blame) on those who came to you to be provided with mounts, when you said: "I can find no mounts for you." V 1 This Hadith has a basis in the Two Sahihs from Anas, the Messenger of Allah said, J(*-^** p-^J VI I jy- 1 p-j j UjIj li \jt\ji\ oJu j jl> Some people have remained behind in Al-Madinah and you never crossed a valley or marched forth, but they were with you . They said, While they are still at Al-Madinah? He said, a 9 *h "*" ' ' m J-Wl j".,g j**J" "Yes, as they have been held back by a (legd) excuse. Then, Allah criticized those who seek permission to remain 111 Ibn Abi Hatim 6:1863. I2 ' Path Al-B&ri 7 :732 and Muslim : 1911.

At-Tawbah (94 - 96) (Part-11) 4Allah has already informed us of the news concerning you. Allah has exposed your news to us, 4Allah and His Messenger will observe your deeds.) your actions will be made public to people in this life, 4'o& 2? ^ dl f) 4In the aid you will be brought back to the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen, then He (Allah) will inform you of what you used to do.) Allah will inform you of your deeds, whether they were good or evil, and will recompense you for them. Allah said that the hypocrites will swear to the believers in apology, so that the believers turn away from them without admonishing them. Therefore, Allah ordered disgracing them by turning away from them, for

they are,)Rijs) meaning, impure inwardly and in their creed. Their destination in the end will be Jahannam, fSJf VjiC K\%) 4a recompense for that which they used to earn.) of sins and evil deeds. Allah said that if the believers forgive the hypocrites when they swear to them, 4certainly Allah is not pleased with the people who are Fasiqin.) who rebel against the obedience of Allah and His Messenger Sg. Fisq\ means, deviation . % &&& t i & \$

497. The bedouins are the worst in disbelief and hypocrisy, and more likely to not know the limits which Allah has revealed to His Messenger. And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise. 498. And of the bedouins there are some who look upon what they spend (in Allah's cause) as a fine and watch for calamities for you, on them be the calamity of evil. And Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} 499. And of the bedouins there are some who believe in Allah and the Last Day, and look upon what they spend (in Allah s cause) as means of nearness to Allah, and a cause of receiving the Messenger's hwoctions . Indeed these (expenditures) are a means of nearness for them. Allah will admit them to His mercy. Certainly Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} The Bedouins are the Worst in Disbelief and Hypocrisy Allah states that there are disbelievers, hypocrites and believers among the bedouins. He also states that the disbelief and hypocrisy of the bedouins is worse and deeper than the disbelief and hypocrisy of others. They are the most likely of being ignorant of the commandments that Allah has revealed to His Messenger jg. Al-A mash narrated that Ibrahim said, A bedouin man sat next to Zayd bin Sawhan while he was speaking to his friends. Zayd had lost his hand during the battle of Nahawand. The bedouin man said, Tty Allah! I like your speech. However, your hand causes me suspicion. Zayd said, Why are you suspicious because of my hand, it is the left hand [that is cut]? The bedouin man said, Tty Allah! I do not know which hand they cut off (for committing theft), is it the right or the left? Zayd bin Sawhan said, Allah has said the truth, &#\$ Z& <\$ ** Hi 4The bedouins are the worst in disbelief and hypocrisy, and more likely to not know the limits which Allah has revealed to His Messenger.} ^ Imam Ahmad narrated that Ibn Abbas said that the Messenger of Allah said, m At-Tabari 14:429.

JlUl. . l l j*j ijle- jliJl j*-" ir "He who lives in the desert becomes hard-hearted, he zuho follows the game becomes heedless, and he who associates with the rulers falls into FitnahJ 11 Abu Dawud, At-Tirmidhi and An-Nasa i collected this Hadith. At-Tirmidhi said, Hasan Gharib.^ The Prophet once had to give a bedouin man many gifts because of what he gave him as a gift, until the bedouin became satisfied. The Prophet s& said, ^S j\ JouJi j\ ji JA V! Jji M ji JlsJb "/ almost decided not to accept a gift except from someone from Quraysh, Thaqafi, the Ansar or Daius. n|3 This is because these people lived in cities, Makkah, At- Ta if, Al-Madlnah and Yemen, and therefore, their conduct and manners are nicer than that of the hard-hearted bedouins. Allah said next, 4And Allah is All-Knower, All-Wise.} Allah knows those who deserve to be taught faith and knowledge, He wisely distributes knowledge or ignorance, faith or disbelief and hypocrisy between His servants. He is never questioned as to what He does, for He is the All-Knower, All- Wise. Allah also said that among bedouins are those, c & i iuho look upon what they spend}, in the cause of Allah, ias a fine}, as a loss and a burden, \$& 20& iand ivatch for calamities for you}, awaiting afflictions and 1:357. Abu Dawud 3 :278 , TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi 6 :532 and An-Nasal 7 :195 131 An-NasSl 6:280.

502 Tafsir IbtI Kathfr Y-r smmm disasters to strike yi*/ . ^ *. > >-"f * \j^ajj(yrf ' i 0^SK v5-L>-*ft? >" (H "*" # !">.< si<-i .% ">t s' *-s ". y" "rj_^.o i yjr^ls**"j>-'6.) ilj"Lu you, 4o" item be the

calamity of evil}, evil will touch them instead, - y" 4And Allah is All- Hearer, All-Knower.} Allah hears the invocation of His servants and knows who deserves victory, who deserve failure. Allah s said; ^LjS. 6 -tj\$J \$i m f's' 'X < '*K > . > &y**J 411' XJ> 4And o/ the bedouins there are some who be- lieve in Allah and the Last Day, and look upon what they spend (in Allah's cause) as means of nearness to Allah, and a cause of receiving the Messenger's invocations This is the type of praiseworthy bedouins. They give charity in Allah s cause as way of achieving nearness to Allah and seeking the Messenger s invocation for their benefit, 4's ' s < tss .s \t"> ' 1A\ sl^ijObiJwa)-Vi-Ljto 4il' l)> &Zte Zt&IJS0i*,y4#& ilndeed these are a means ofnearnessfar them.} they will attain what they sought, ijt -4 i> ?< fi c ;>{, ">/lly& Oj^ rA^t-j Jj -Oil > 4-U X; iAlldh will admit them to His mercy. Certainly Allah is Oft- Forgiving, Most Merciful.}

(*T* it OjSjVf 5y_ Jf^ jyJ' Ijil t,j ilfiVf \Z\~ . iSj~jfS y^T ^ X-4> *lfr i^ijj 4200 . And the foremost to embrace Islam of the Muhdjirin and the Ansar and also those who fallowed them exactly (in faith). Allah is well-pleased with them as they are well-pleased with Him. He has prepared far them Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell therein forever. That is the supreme success. Virtues ofthe Muhajirin, AnsarandThoseWho followed Them in Faith Allah mentions that He is pleased foremost with the Muhdjirin, Ansar and those who followed them in faith, and that they are well-pleased with Him, for He has prepared for them the gardens ofdelight and eternal joy. Ash-Shahi said that, <&%U&&U S&V(sfuZIS" iTheforemost Muhdjirin and Ansar} are those who conducted the pledge of Ar-Ridwan in the year of Hudaybiyyah . Abu Milsa Al-Ash ari, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Muhammad bin Sirin, Al- Hasan and Qatadah said that they are thosewho performed the prayer towards the two Qiblahs with the Messenger of Allah (first toward Jerusalem and later toward the Ka bah\p^ Allah, the Most Great, stated that He is pleased foremost with the Muhajirin, the Ansar and those who followed their lead with excellence. Therefore, woe to those who dislike or curse them, or dislike or curse any ofthem, especially their master after the Messenger, the best and most righteous among them, the Siddiq (the great truthful one) and the grand Khalifah, Abu Bakr bin Abi Quhafah, may Allah be pleased with him. The failure group, the Rafidah (a sect of Shiites), are the enemies of the best Companions, they hate and curse them, we seek refuge with Allah from such evil. This indicates that the minds of these people are twisted and their hearts turned upside m AMabaii 14:435. At-Tabari 14:436, 437, 439.

504 Tafsir Ibtt Kathfr down, for where are they in relation to believing in the Qur an? They curse those whom Allah stated He is pleased with! As for the followers of the Sunnah, they Eire pleased with those whom Allah is pleased with, curse whomever Allah and His Messenger Sg curse, and give their loyalty to Allah s friends and show enmity to the enemies of Allah. They are followers not innovators, imitating (the Sunnah] they do not initiate it on their own. They are indeed the party of Allah, the successful, and Allah s faithful servants. ^u -j 4&< 1A? Stj -i i: G f -iHr4 (*+***> Cj ilOl. And among the bedouins around you, some are hypocrites, and so are some among the people of Al-Madmah who persist in hypocrisy; you know them not, We know them. We shall punish them twice, and thereafter they shall be brought back to a great (horrible) torment.} Hypocrites among the Bedouins and Residents of Al-Madinah Allah informs His Messenger, peace be upon him, that among the bedouins around Al-Madlnah there are hypocrites and in Al-Madlnah itself, those, iwho persist in hypocrisy;} meaning they insisted on hypocrisy and continued in it Allah s statement, j* ")} iyou know them not. We know them}, does not contradict His other statement, j jJj} iHad We willed, We could have shown them to you, and

you should have known them by their marks; but surely, you will know them by the tone of their speech!}[47:30], because the latter Ayah describes them by their characteristics, not that the Messenger knows all those who

have doubts and hypocrisy. The Messenger jg knew that some of those who associated with him from the people of Al- Madinah were hypocrites, and he used to see them day and night [but did not know who they were exactly]. We mentioned before in the explanation of, i...and they resolved that (plot) which they were unable to carry out...\$[9:74] that the Prophet jg informed Hudhayfah of the names of fourteen or fifteen hypocrites. This knowledge is specific in this case, not that the Messenger of Allah jg was informed of all their names, and Allah knows best. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ma'mar said that Qatadah commented on this Ayah (9:101), What is the matter with some people who claim to have knowledge about other people, saying, So-and-so is in Paradise and so-and-so is in the Fire. If you ask any of these people about himself, he would say, I do not know (if I will end up in Paradise or the Fire)! Verily, you have more knowledge of yourself than other people. You have assumed a job that even the Prophets before you refrained from assuming. Allah s Prophet Nuh said, 4 i iAnd what knowledge have I of what they used to do? \$[26: 112] Allah s Prophet Shu'ayb said, iViat which is left by Allah for you (after giving the rights of the people) is better for you, if you are believers. And / am not a guardian over you \$[\ 1 :86], while Allah said to His Prophet jg, iyou know them not, We know them .^ Mujahid said about Allah s statement, m Abdur-Razzaq 2 :285.

4We shall punish them twice}, By killing and capture. In another narration he said, By hunger and torment in the grave, 5* ft iand thereafter they shall be brought back to a great (horrible) torment.} Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, The torment in this life strikes their wealth and offspring, and he recited this Ayah, 40it 4^ & Lj, a %} 4So let not their wealth nor their children amaze you ; Allah only wants to punish them with these things in the life of this world.} [9:55] These afflictions torment them, but will bring reward for the believers. As for the torment in the Hereafter, it is in the Fire, iff*- '{ } 2"f o) c3 ial^ IjLb- ofjJ\}} 4102. And (there are) others who have acknowledged their sins, they have mixed a deed that was righteous with another that was evil. Perhaps Allah will turn unto them in forgiveness. Surely, Allah is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} Some Believers stayed away from Battle because They were Lazy After Allah explained the characteristics of the hypocrites who stayed away from battle because they sought to avoid it out of denial and doubt, He then mentioned the disobedient who stayed away from Jihad due to laziness and preferring comfort, even though they truly believed. Al-Tabari 14:442. ^ Al-Tabari 14:444.

ih/h 4And others who have acknowledged their sins,} These people admitted their error to themselves and their Lord. They had performed good deeds before, as well as, this evil deed that they committed. For them there was forgiveness and pardon of Allah. This Ayah is general, covering all sinners who combine good and evil deeds, thus becoming partly impure, even though it was revealed about some people in specific. Ibn Abbas said that, }And (there are) others}, refers to Abu Lubabah and some of his friends who stayed away from the battle of Tabuk and the Messenger of Allah jg. When the Messenger of Allah jg returned from that battle, this group, Abu Lubabah and five, seven or nine with him, tied themselves to the pillars of the Masjid and refused to let anyone untie them except the Messenger

of Allah sg. When this Ayah was revealed, j, ~v Tp-r-V-H u Jir-'v? iAnd (there are) others who have acknowledged their sins,} the Messenger of Allah jg untied them and pardoned them. 111

to a city, built with bricks made of gold and silver. We met some men zolto, part of their bodies were as handsome as you ever saw and the part as ugly as you ever saw. The two (angels) ordered these men to go to a river and submerge themselves in it; they did that and came back to us, and the ugliness went away from them, thus becoming the most beautiful form. The two said to me, 'This is the garden of Eden, and this is your residence in it. The two said, 'As for the men who had part of their body handsome and part ugly, they have mixed a deed that was righteous with another tfmt was evil. Allah has pardoned them. ^

At-Tawbah (103 - 104) (Part-11) iTake Sadaqah from their wealth.} Abu Bakr As-Siddiq and other Companions refuted this ill comprehension and fought against them until they paid the Zakah to the Khalfah, just as they used to pay it to the Messenger of Allah jg. As-Siddiq said, By Allah! If they abstain from paying a bridle that they used to pay to the Messenger of Allah I will fight them for refraining from paying it. Allah s statement, ifr-y iand Salli for them}, means, supplicate for them, and ask Allah to forgive them. In the Sahih,

Do deeds! Allah will see your deeds, and (so will) His Messenger and the believers. And you will be brought back to the AU-Knower of the unseen and the seen. Then He will inform you of what you used to do.

Warning the Disobedient Mujahid said that this Ayah carries a warning^ ' from Allah to those who defy His orders. Their deeds will be shown to Allah, Blessed and Most Honored, and to the Messenger and the believers. This will certainly occur on the Day of Resurrection, just as Allah said, }That Day shall you be brought to Judgement, not a secret of you will be hidden .} (69:18], \$0 iThe Day when all the secrets will be examined.}\86:9], and, ^And that which is in the breasts (of men) shall be made known.} [100:10] Allah might also expose some deeds to the people in this life.

512 Tafsir Ibn Katlur time of his life with good deeds, so that if he dies while doing it, he will enter Paradise. However, he changes and commits evil deeds, one might commit evil deeds for some time in his life, so that if he dies while doing them he will enter the Fire. However, he changes and performs good deeds. If Allah wants the good of a servant He employs him before he dies ." He was asked, How would Allah employ him, O Allah s Messenger? He said, "He directs him to perform good deeds and takes his life in that condition .n Only Imam Ahmad collected this Hadlth. 4106. And others are made to await for Allah's Decree, whether He will punish them or will forgive them. And Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise. Delaying the Decision about the Three Companions Who stayed away from the Battle of Tabuk Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak and several others said that those mentioned in the Ayah are the three who were made to wait to know if their repentance was accepted; Mararah bin Ar-Rabl , Ka*b bin Malik and Hilal bin Umayyah. Some Companions stayed behind from the battle of Tabuk due to laziness, preferring comfort, ease, ripe fruits and shade. They did not lag behind because of hypocrisy or doubts. Some of them tied themselves to the pillars (of the Masjid) like Abu Lubabah and several of his friends did. Some of them did not do that, and they are the three mentioned here. Those who tied

themselves received their pardon before these three men whose pardon was delayed, until this Ayah was revealed, 4Alldh hasforgiven the Prophet, the Muhdjirtn and theAnsar. m Ahmad 3 : 120

r^ T i msm ^ jv^I^i^Ll4S1lj I^UiJli ill ; > < i^" { * ^ t'w t . c . ^ * " j-t n'-s ^- ul^J U-j^u-3 jl ^ 'A ^ r'U'i i'r.f' ^jj'< lit &. i# &f > 4#5c tin^xx iAnd the three who stayed behind, until for them the earth, vast as it is, was straitened ...^ We will mention the Hadith about this story from Ka b bin Malik. Allah said, He will punish them or will forgive them.} meaning, they are at Allah s mercy, if He wills, He pardons them or punishes them. However, Allah s mercy comes before His anger, iiL - iX i fj> iAnd Allah is All-Knowing, All-Wise.} [9:106] Allah knows those who deserve the punishment and those who deserve the pardon. He is All-Wise in His actions and statements, there is no deity worthy of worship nor Lord besides Him. Xr J*. XjSA X?. j="J XX XsJ'j}) % l&3i; j5 " fez & ^ -X^ - is-i i~j p*-3 J o; ifjiii' u~*l jL ,*.li liSl *_j i.fXx&Xu% il07. And as for those who put up a Masjid by way of harm At-Tabari 14:465-466.

and disbeliefand to disunite the believers and as an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger aforetime, they will indeed swear that their intention is nothing but good. Allah bears witness that they are certainly liars. \$108. Never stand you therein. Verily, the Masjid whose foundation was laidfrom the first day on Taqwa is more worthy that you stand therein (to pray). In it are men who love to clean and purify thettselves . And Allah loves those who make themselves clean and pure.} MasjidAd-Dirarand MasjidAt-Taqwa

The reason behind revealing these honorable Aydt is that

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2385–2397]

before the Messenger of Allah jg migrated to Al-Madlnah, there was a man from Al-Khazraj called Abu Amir Ar-Rahib (the Monk). This man embraced Christianity before Islam and read the Scriptures. During the time of Jahiliyyah, Abu Amir was known for being a worshipper and being a notable person among Al-Khazraj. When the Messenger of Allah jgg arrived at Al-Madlnah after the Hijrah, the Muslims gathered around him and the word of Islam was triumphant on the day of Badr, causing Abu Amir, the cursed one, to choke on his own saliva and announce his enmity to Islam. He fled from Al-Madlnah to the idolators of Quraysh in Makkah to support them in the war against the Messenger of Allah jgj. The Quraysh united their forces and the bedouins who joined them for the battle of Uhud, during which Allah tested the Muslims, but the good end is always for the pious and righteous people. The rebellious Abu Amir dug many holes in the ground between the two camps, into one ofwhich the Messenger sg fell, injuring his face and breaking one of his right lower teeth. He also sustained a head injury. Before the fighting started, Abu Amir approached his people among the Ansar and tried to convince them to support and agree with him. When they recognized him, they said, "May Allah never burden an eye by seeing you, O Fasiq one, O enemy of Allah! They cursed him and he went back declaring, By Allah! Evil has touched my people after I left. The Messenger of Allah called Abu Amir to Allah and recited the Qur an to him before his flight to Makkah, but he refused to embrace Islam and rebelled. The Messenger jg invoked Allah

At-Taivbah (107 - 108) (Part-11 that Abu Amir die as an outcast in an alien land, and his invocation came true. After the battle of Uhud was finished, Abu Amir realized that the Messenger's call was still rising and gaining momentum, so he went to Heraclius, the emperor of Rome, asking for his aid against the Prophet ﷺ. Heraclius gave him promises and Abu Amir remained with him. He also wrote to several of his people in Al-Madīnah, who embraced hypocrisy, promising and insinuating to them that he will lead an army to fight the Messenger of Allah ﷺ to defeat him and his call. He ordered them to establish a stronghold where he could send his emissaries and to serve as an outpost when he joins them later on. These hypocrites built a Masjid next to the Masjid in Quba, and they finished building it before the Messenger ﷺ went to Tabuk. They went to the Messenger ﷺ inviting him to pray in their Masjid so that it would be a proof that the Messenger ﷺ approved of their Masjid. They told him that they built the Masjid for the weak and ill persons on rainy nights. However, Allah prevented His Messenger ﷺ from praying in that Masjid. He ﷺ said to them, "4 (j l j IS) IfZlj Jct tjs- U|D "" we come back from our travel, Allah willing." When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ came back from Tabuk and was approximately one or two days away from Al-Madīnah, Jibril came down to him with the news about Masjid Ad-Dirar and the disbelief and division between the believers, who were in Masjid Quba (which was built on piety from the first day), that Masjid Ad-Dirar was meant to achieve. Therefore, the Messenger of Allah ﷺ sent some people to Masjid Ad-Dirar to bring it down before he reached Al-Madīnah. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah (9:107), They are some people of the Ansar to whom Abu Amir said, Build a Masjid and prepare whatever you can of power and weapons, for I am headed towards Caesar, emperor of Rome, to bring Roman soldiers with whom I will expel Muhammad and his companions. When they built their Masjid, they went to the Prophet ﷺ and said to him, We finished building our Masjid and we would like you pray in it and invoke Allah for us for His blessings. Allah revealed this verse,

iNever stand you therein}, until, 4 . . . wrongdoers} (11 Allah said next, 4they will indeed swearK those who built it, 4iP"" ! ' Vij\ o/^ ithat their intention is nothing but good.} by building this Masjid we sought the good and the comfort of the people. Allah replied, 4Allah bears witness that they are certainly liars for they only built it to harm Masjid Quba, and out of disbelief in Allah, and to divide the believers. They made it an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, such as Abu Amir the Fasiq who used to be called Ar- Rahib, may Allah curse him! Allah said, 4Never stand you therein}, prohibiting His Prophet and his Ummah from ever standing in it in prayer. Virtues of Masjid Quba Allah encouraged His Prophet ﷺ to pray in Masjid Quba which, from the first day, was built on Taqwa, obedience to Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, for gathering the word of the believers and as an outpost and a fort for Islam and its people. This is why Allah the Exalted said, 4Verily, the Masjid whose foundation was laid from the first day on Taqwa is more worthy that you stand therein (to I1 !

At-Tawbah (107 -108) (Part-11 pray).} in reference to the Masjid of Quba. An authentic Hadith records that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, iOne prayer in Masjid Quba' is just like an ' Umrah. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to visit Masjid Quba while riding and walking Imam

Wudu perfectly and preserve themselves from impure things. Imam

At-Tawbah (109 - 111) (Part-11) disbelief and causing division among the believers, and as an outpost for those who warred against Allah and His Messenger ﷺ. The latter built their Masjid on the edge of a

steep hole, into the fire of Hell. And Allah guides not the people who are the wrongdoers.}, Allah does not bring aright the works of those who commit mischief. Jabir bin Abdullah said, I saw the Masjid that was built to cause harm with smoke rising up from it, during the time of the Messenger of Allah jg. fl! Allah s statement, 4 ^ 'ft iThe building which they built will never cease to be a cause of doubt in their hearts} and hypocrisy. Because of this awful action that they committed, they inherited hypocrisy in their hearts, just as those who worshipped the calf were inclined to adoring it. Allah said next, 4unless their hearts are cut to pieces.} until they die, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Zayd bin Aslam, As-Suddi, Habib bin Abi Thabit, Ad-Dahhak, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam and several other scholars ofthe Salad.121 4.\$- Stfft \$And Allah is All-Knowing,} of the actions of His creation, 4 - &= -} iAll-Wise.} in compensating them for their good or evil actions. 4 jdlylS J 4 .. tsjJk \$jt} Cr-J iPiP \ ipe- IJcj \$Laj SjiSj p jrpTabari 14:493.Tabari 14:495-497.

4222 . Verily, Allah has purchased of the believers their lives and their properties for (the price) that theirs shall be the Paradise. They fight in Allah's cause, so they kill and are killed. It is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an. And who is truer to his covenant than Allah? Then rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.} Allah has purchased the Souls and Wealth of the Mujahidin in Return for Paradise Allah states that He has compensated His believing servants for their lives and wealth - if they give them up in His cause - with Paradise. This demonstrates Allah s favor, generosity and bounty, for He has accepted the good that He already owns and bestowed, as a price from His faithful servants. Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah commented, By Allah! Allah has purchased them and raised their worth. 111 Shimr bin Atiyyah said, There is not a

At-Tawbah (111 - 112) (Part-11) igggjggii 'W. in My Cause and belief rtilJjjJ.oya iy-' r*,w I * (> . :c JLrJ^ eLs^Ljfc -* **' '\Ai\ZC5fei^=* j 4i\j !p Jp'-JaU 0 ^J>_>*-"-ib__U^ri y_^XjciJOi^^-1-^)J ^^==^ - ^ -i n >? , ^ .1; ^-i;s -l *-:- Swl "_?^j>-4^ia i j> {yw-ju> g--- in My Messengers.' He u"7/ eif/jer be admitted to Paradise if he dies, or compensated by Allah, either with a reward or booty if He returns him to the home which he departedfrom." [I] Allah s statement, iPpo & * i5 > 41t is a promise in truth which is binding on Him in the Tawrah and the Injil and the Qur'an .} affirms this promise and informs us that Allah has decreed this for His Most Honorable Self, and revealed it to His Messengers in His Glorious Books, the Tawrah that He sent down to Musa, the Injil that He sent down to Isa, and the Qur an that was sent down to Muhammad, may Allah s peace and blessings be on them all. Allah said next, <&, Zsj iAnd who is truer to his covenant than Allah?} affirming that He never breaks a promise. Allah said in similar statements, i^i-jp-p S* ZPf} iAnd who is truer in statement than Allah?} \4:87], and, I1 ' Fath Al-Bari 6 :254 and Muslim 3 :1496

\$ oi ij iAnd whose words can be truer than those ofAllah?}[4:122]. Allah said next, 4.*Jf**' jyR .ij fXf, tSjjJt [fejJJt} iThen rejoice in the bargain which you have concluded. That is the supreme success.}, meaning, let those who fulfill the terms of this contract and uphold this covenant receive the good news of great success and everlasting delight. j ajJfiZlI by4=if SjiLift iSjliii 4112. Those who repent, who worship (Him), who praise (Him), who fast, who bow down, who prostrate themselves, who enjoin good andforbid evil, and who observe the limits set by Alldh. And give glad tidings to the believers.} This is the description of the believers from whom Allah has purchased their souls and wealth, who

have these beautiful and honorable qualities. 4who repent} from all sins and shun all evils, 4o/^ii} 4who worship}, their Lord and preserve the acts of worship that include statements and actions. Praising Allah is among the best statements. This is why Allah said next, 4ojJudl} iwho praise (Him)}. Fasting is among the best actions, involving abstaining from the delights of food, drink and sexual intercourse, this is the meaning hereby, 4&4&\} 4As-Sd'ihun (who fast)} [9:112]. Allah also described the Prophet s wives that they are.

iSa'ihdt} [66:5], meaning, they fast. As for prostrating and bowing down, they are acts of the prayer, iwho bow down, who prostrate themselves, These believers also benefit Allah s creation and direct them to His obedience by ordaining righteousness and forbidding evil. They have knowledge about what should be performed and what should be shunned. This includes abiding by Allah s limits in knowledge and action, meaning, what He allowed and what He prohibited. Therefore, they worship the True Lord and advise creation. This is why Allah said next, \$And give glad tidings to the believers.} since faith includes all of this, and the supreme success is for those who have faith. b Juo Ji 04? 4^ j!> ! w -i ii b. It is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the Mushrikin, even though they be of kin, after it has become clear to them that they are the dwellers of the Fire (because they died in a state of disbelief).} 4124. And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he [Ibrahim] had made to him (his father). But when it became clear to him [Ibrahim] that he (his father) is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him. Verily, Ibrahim was Awwah and forbearing.} The Prohibition of supplicating for Polytheists Imam

Abi Umayyah present. The Prophet jfa said, > 4 ^ dU <"! lb l "Jl Ji ^{t cO uncle! Say, 'La ilaha illa-llah, a word concerning which I will plea for you with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored." Abu Jahl and Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah said, O Abu Talib! Would you leave the religion of Abdul-Muttalib? Abu Talib said, Rather, I will remain on the religion of Abdul-Muttalib.

iili- p u Sv "/ will invoke Allah for forgiveness for you, as long as I am not prohibited from doing so. This verse was revealed, ^ Jt 4^ \y^=* Aj J 5-*"" dyJJ Jjii) it is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah s forgiveness for the Mushrikin, even though they be of kin, after it has become clear to them that they are the dwellers of the Fire.)> Concerning Abu Talib, this Ayah was revealed, 4 O 'Sfr. (i O' tfjVr V iVerily, you guide not whom you like, but Allah guides whom He wills} [28:56]. (11 This Hadith is recorded in the Two Sahths. |2) Ibn Jarir recorded that Sulayman bin Buraydah said that his father said, When the Prophet ^ came to Makkah, he went to a grave, sat next to it, started talking and then stood up with tears in his eyes. We said, O Allah s Messenger! We saw what you did. He said, jili J . i ijtj j. ^0 ^ Ahmad 5 :433. ^ Fath Al-Bari 8 :192 and Muslim 1 :54

At-Tawbah (113 - 114) (Part-11) "/ asked my Lord for permission to visit the grave of my mother and He gave me permission. I asked for His permission to invoke Him for forgiveness for her, but He did not give me permission ." We never saw him more tearful than on that day. ' Al- Awfi narrated from Ibn Abbas about Allah s statement, j j C deft \ O 4/f is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah's forgiveness for the Mushrikin} The Prophet gg wanted to invoke Allah for forgiveness for his mother, but Allah did not allow him. The Prophet sg said, jj "!" J-ii !>!" Ibrahim, Allah's Khalil, invoked Allah for his father ." Allah revealed, 4 Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father's forgiveness was only because of a promise he [Ibrahim] had made to him (his father)}. Ali bin Abi

Talhah narrated that Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, They used to invoke Allah for them (pagans) until this Ayah was revealed. They then refrained from invoking Allah to forgive the dead among them, but were not stopped from invoking Allah for the living among them until they die. Allah sent this Ayah, 4And Ibrahim's invoking (of Allah) for his father s forgiveness zoos only...} [9:1 14], '3 ' Allah said next, m At-Jabari 6:489. ' At-Tabari 14:512. Although this Hadith is weak, there are similar narrations that serve as witnesses for it. See Sahih Sunan At- Tirmidhi no . 2477 '3| At-Jabari 14:513.

when it became clear to him [Ibrahim] that he (his father) is an enemy of Allah, he dissociated himself from him [9:114], Ibn Abbas commented, Ibrahim kept asking Allah to forgive his father until he died, when he realized that he died as an enemy to Allah, he disassociated himself from him. In another narration, he said, When his father died he realized that he died as an enemy of Allah. 111 Similar was said by Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and several others.121 TJBayd bin Umayr and Said bin Jubayr said, Ibrahim will disown his father on

the Day of Resurrection, but he will meet his father and see

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2397–2402]

dust and fatigue on his face. He will say, 'O Ibrahim! I disobeyed you, but today, I will not disobey you. Ibrahim will say, O Lord! You promised me that You will not disgrace me on the Day they are resurrected. What more disgrace than witnessing my father being disgraced? He will be told, Look behind you, where he will see a bloody hyena - for his father will have been transformed into that - and it will be dragged from its feet and thrown in the Fire. 131 Allah s statement, i Verily, Ibrahim was Aivwah and wasforbearing. means, he invoked Allah always, according to Abdullah bin Mas*Qd.141 Several narrations report this from Ibn Mas ud. 151 It was also said that, Awwah , means, who invokes Allah with humility , merciful , *who believes with certainty , who praises (Allah) , and so forth. iii i) - djfci H ilu j" j-4i. K/f} &^ " ffeJ 13IS 4- & 2 # k & iU5. And Allah will never lead a people astray after He has guided them until He makes clear to them what they should avoid. Verily, Allah is the All-Knower of everything.} At-Tabari 14:519. (2 > At-Tabari 14:518-519. AMabari 14:521. At-Tabari 14:523-524. At-Tabari 14:524.

4116. Indeed to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, He gives life and He causes death. And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.} Recompense comes after Proof is established Allah describes His Honorable Self and just judgment in that He does not lead a people astray but after the Message comes to them, so that the proof is established against them. For instance, Allah said, j > 4And as for Thamud, We showed and made clear to them the path of truth ...} [41:17]. Mujahid commented on Allah s saying; 4And Allah will never lead a people astray after He has guided them} Allah the Mighty and Sublime is clarifying to the believers about not seeking forgiveness for the idolators in particular, and in general, it is an exhortation to beware of disobeying Him, and encouragement to obey Him. So either do or suffer. Ibn Jarir commented, Allah says that He would not direct you to misguidance, so that you invoke Him for forgiveness for your dead idolators, after He gave you guidance and directed you to believe in Him and in His Messenger jg! First, He will inform you of what you should avoid, so that you avoid it. Before He informs you that this action is not allowed, you would not have disobeyed Him and fallen into what He prohibited for you [if you indulge

in this action]. Therefore, in this case, He will not allow you to be misguided. Verily, guidance or misguidance occurs after commands and prohibitions are established. As for those who were neither commanded nor prohibited, they can neither be obedient nor disobedient in doing what they were neither ordered nor prohibited from doing. 121 Tabari 14:537. [2! At-Tabari 14:536.

Allah said, indeed to Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth, He gives life and He causes death. And besides Allah you have neither any protector nor any helper.> Ibn Jarir commented, This is an encouragement from Allah for His believing servants to fight the idolators and chiefs of disbelief. It is also a command for them to trust in Allah's aid, for He is the Owner of the heavens and earth, and not to fear His enemies. Verily, they have no protector besides Allah, nor a supporter other than Him. M li 4117. Allah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress (Tabuk expedition), after the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated (from the right path), but He accepted their repentance. Certainly, He is unto them full of kindness. Most Merciful Battle of Tabuk Mujahid and several others said, This Ayah was revealed concerning the battle of Tabuk. They left for that battle during a period of distress. It was a year with little rain, intense heat and scarcity of supplies and water. * Qatadah said, They went to Ash-Sham during the year of the battle of Tabuk at a time when the heat was intense. Allah knew how hard things were, and they suffered great hardship. We were told that two men used to divide a date between themselves. Some of them would take turns in sucking on a date and drinking water, then give it to another man to suck on. Allah forgave them and allowed them to come back from that battle. Ibn Jarir At-Tabari 14:538. At-Tabari 14:540. At-Tabari 14:541.

reported that Abdullah bin Abbas said that Umar bin Al-Khattab was reminded of the battle of distress (Tabuk) and Umar said, We went with the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) in the intense heat for Tabuk. We camped at a place in which we were stricken so hard by thirst that we thought that our necks would be severed. One of us used to go out in search of water and did not return until he feared that his neck would be severed. One would slaughter his camel, squeeze its intestines and drink its content, placing whatever was left on his kidney. Abu Bakr As-Siddiq said, O Allah's Messenger! Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored, has always accepted your invocation, so invoke Allah for us. The Prophet (ﷺ) said, 'Would you like me to do that?' Abu Bakr said, *Yes. The Prophet (ﷺ) raised his hands and did not put them down until rain fell from the sky in abundance. It rained and then stopped raining for a while, then rained again, so they filled their containers. We went out to see where the rain reached and found that it did not rain beyond our camp. 111 Ibn Jarir said about Allah's statement, Jj "j*~if\$ js iil ^>\ iAllah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress,) meaning With regards to expenditures, transportation, supplies and water, gjj ^=* m) Rafter the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated,) away from the truth, thus falling prey to doubting the Messenger's religion because of the distress and hardships they suffered during their travel and battle, iL# ') 4but He accepted their repentance.) He directed them to repent to their Lord and renew their m At-Jabari 14:539.

the battle of Tabuk with the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ). Ka*b bin

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2402–2426]

Malik said, I did not remain behind Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) in any battle that he fought except the battle of Tabuk. I failed to take part in the battle of Badr, but Allah did not admonish anyone who did not participate in it, for in fact, Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) had gone out in search of the caravan of Quraysh, until Allah made the Muslims and their enemies meet without any appointment. I witnessed the night of Al-Aqabah pledge with Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) when we pledged for Islam, and I would not exchange it for the Badr Battle, even though the Badr Battle is more popular among the people than the Aqabah pledge. As for my news of this battle of Tabuk, I was never stronger or wealthier than I was when I remained behind Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) in that battle. By Allah, never had I two she-camels before, but I did at the time of that battle. Whenever Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) wanted to go to a battle, he used to hide his intention by referring to different battles, until it was the time of that battle (of Tabuk) which Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) fought in intense heat, facing a long journey, the desert, and the great number of enemy soldiers. So the Prophet (ﷺ) clearly announced the destination to the Muslims, so that they could prepare for their battle, and he told them about his intent. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) was accompanied by such a large number of Muslims that they could not be listed in a book by name, nor registered. Ka'b added, Any man who intended not to attend the battle would think that the matter would remain hidden, unless Allah revealed it through divine revelation. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) fought that battle at a time when the fruits had ripened and the shade was pleasant, and I found myself inclined towards that. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and his Companions prepared for the battle and I started to go out in order to get myself ready along with them, but I returned without doing anything. I would say to myself, can I do that if I want. So I kept on delaying it every now and then until the people were prepared, and Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) and the Muslims along with him, departed. But I had not prepared anything for my departure. I said, I will prepare myself (for departure) one or two days after him, and then join them. In the morning following their departure, I went out to get myself ready but returned having

done nothing. Then again, the next morning, I went out to get ready but returned without doing anything. Such was the case with me until they hurried away and I missed the battle. Even then I intended to depart to catch up to them. I wish I had done so! But such was not the case. So, after the departure of Allah's Messenger (ﷺ), whenever I went out and walked among the people (who remained behind), it grieved me that I could see none around me, but one accused of hypocrisy or one of those weak men whom Allah had excused. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) did not remember me until he reached Tabuk. So while he was sitting among the people in Tabuk, he said, "What did Ka'b bin Malik do?" A man from Banu Salimah said, O Allah's Messenger! He has been stopped by his two Burdah (garments) and looking at his own flanks with pride. Mu'adh bin Jabal said, What a bad thing you have said! By Allah! O Allah's Messenger! We know nothing about him but that which is good. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) kept silent. Ka'b bin Malik added, When I heard that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) was on his way back to Al-Madinah, I was overcome by concern and began to think of false excuses. I said to myself, How can I escape from his anger tomorrow? I started looking for advice from wise members of my family in this matter. When it was said that Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) had approached (Al-Madinah) all evil and false excuses abandoned my mind and I knew well that I could never come out of this problem by forging a false statement. Then I decided firmly to speak the truth. Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) arrived in the morning, and whenever he returned from a journey, he used to visit the Masjid first, and offer a two Rak'ah prayer, then sit for the people. So when he had done all that (this time), those who failed to join the

battle came and started offering (false) excuses and taking oaths before him. They were over eighty men. Allah's Messenger ﷺ accepted the excuses they expressed outwardly, asked for Allah's forgiveness for them and left the secrets of their hearts for Allah to judge. Then I came to him, and when I greeted him, he smiled a smile of an angry person and then said,

Come So I came walking until I sat before him. He said to me, Did I stop you from joining us? Had you not purchased an animal for carrying you? I answered, Yes, O Allah's Messenger! By Allah, if I were sitting before any person from among the people of the world other than you, I would have escaped from his anger with an excuse. By Allah, I have been bestowed with the power of speaking fluently and eloquently, but by Allah, I knew well that if I tell you a lie today to seek your favor, Allah would surely make you angry with me in the near future. But if I tell you the truth, though you will get angry because of it, I hope for Allah's forgiveness. By Allah, I had never been stronger or wealthier than I was when I remained behind you. Allah's Messenger said, "As regards to this man, he has surely told the truth. So get up until Allah decides your case. I got up, and many men of Banu Salimah followed me and said to me, *By Allah, we never witnessed you commit any sin before this! Surely, you failed to offer an excuse to Allah's Messenger ﷺ like the others who did not join him. The invocation of Allah's Messenger to Allah to forgive you would have been sufficient for your sin. By Allah, they continued blaming me so much that I intended to return (to the Prophet ﷺ) and accuse myself of having told a lie, but I said to them, Is there anybody else who has met the same end as I have? They replied, Yes, there are two men who have said the same thing as you have, and to both of them was given the same order as given to you. I said, Who are they? They replied, Murarah bin Ar-Rabf Al-Amiri and Hilal bin Umayyah Al-Waqifi. They mentioned to me two pious men who had attended the battle of Badr and in whom there was an example for me. So I did not change my mind when they mentioned them to me. Allah's Messenger ﷺ forbade all the Muslims from talking to us, the three aforesaid persons, out of all those who remained behind for that battle. So we kept away from the people and they changed their attitude towards us until the very land (where I

534 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir lived) appeared strange to me as if I did not know it. We remained in that condition for fifty nights. As for my two companions, they remained in their houses and kept on weeping, but I was the youngest and the firmest of them. So I would go out and attend the prayer along with the Muslims and roam the markets, but none would talk to me. I would come to Allah's Messenger ﷺ and greet him while he was sitting in his gathering after the prayer, and I would wonder whether he even moved his lips in return of my greeting or not. Then I would offer my prayer near him and look at him carefully. When I was busy with my prayer, he would turn his face towards me, but when I turned my face to him, he would turn his face away from me. When this harsh attitude and boycott of the people continued for a long time, I walked until I scaled the wall of the garden of Abu Qatadah who was my cousin and the dearest person to me. I offered my greeting to him. By Allah, he did not return my greetings. I said, O Abu Qatadah! I beseech you by Allah! Do you know that I love Allah and His Messenger? He kept quiet. I asked him again, beseeching him by Allah, but he remained silent. I asked him again in the Name of Allah and he said, Allah and His Messenger know better. Thereupon my eyes flowed with tears and I returned and jumped over the wall. While I was walking in the market of Al-Madlnah, suddenly I saw that a Nabatean from Ash-Sham came to sell his grains in Al-Madlnah, saying, Who will lead me to Ka'b bin Malik? The people began to point (me) out for him, until he

came to me and handed me a letter from the king of Ghassan (who ruled Syria for Caesar), for I knew how to read and write. In that letter, the following was written: To proceed, I have been informed that your friend (the Prophet) has treated you harshly. Anyhow, Allah does not make you live in a place where you feel inferior and your right is lost. So, join us, and we will console you. When I read it, I said to myself, This is also a sort of test. I took the letter to the oven and made a fire burning it. When forty out of the fifty nights elapsed, behold! There came to me a messenger of Allah's Messenger saying Allah's Messenger orders you to keep away from your wife. I said, Should I divorce her; or else what should I do? He said, No, only keep aloof from her and do not mingle with her.

At-Tawbah (118 - 119) (Part-11) The Prophet ﷺ sent the same message to my two fellows. I said to my wife, Go to your parents and remain with them until Allah gives His verdict in this matter. Ka'b added, The wife of Hilal bin Umayyah came to Allah's Messenger ﷺ and said, O Allah's Messenger! Hilal bin Umayyah is a helpless old man who has no servant to attend on him. Do you dislike that I should serve him? He said, v'] jfij 'No (you can serve him), but he should not come near you [sexually. She said, *By Allah! He has no desire for anything. By Allah, he has never ceased weeping since his case began until this day of his. On that, some of my family members said to me, Will you also ask Allah's Messenger to permit your wife (to serve you) as he has permitted the wife of Hilal bin Umayyah to serve him? I said, *By Allah, I will not ask permission of Allah's Messenger ﷺ regarding her, for I do not know what Allah's Messenger ﷺ would say if I asked him to permit her (to serve me) while I am a young man. We remained in that state for ten more nights, until the period of fifty nights was completed, starting from the time when Allah's Messenger ﷺ prohibited the people from talking to us. When I had finished the Fajr prayer on the fiftieth morning on the roof of one of our houses, while sitting in the condition in which Allah described (in the Qur'an): my very soul seemed straitened to me and even the earth seemed narrow to me for all its spaciousness. There I heard the voice of a man who had ascended the mountain of Sal' calling with his loudest voice, O Kah bin Malik! Be happy (by receiving good tidings). I fell down in prostration before Allah, realizing that relief has come with His forgiveness for us. Allah's Messenger ﷺ announced the acceptance of our repentance by Allah after Fajr prayer. The people went out to congratulate us. Some bearers of good news went to my two companions, a horseman came to me in haste, while a man from Banu Aslam came running and ascended the mountain and his voice was swifter than the horse. When the man whose voice I had heard, came to me conveying the good news, I took off my garments and dressed him with them; and by Allah, I owned no other than them on that day. Then I borrowed two

-A >*.1 it iSis; c. ^ iSd tSj & > S Si i^ Cje % di % & u KE ^ ot tjs 4i|jS^Jt t it ijiSt ip; \$s ;jL4i' 4Allah has forgiven the Prophet, the Muhajirin and the Ansar who followed him in the time of distress, after the hearts of a party of them had nearly deviated, but He accepted their repentance. Certainly, He is unto them full of kindness, Most Merciful. And the three who stayed behind, until for them the earth, vast as it is, was straitened and their souls were straitened to them, and they perceived that there is no fleeing from Allah, and no refuge but with Him. Then, He forgave them, that they might beg for His pardon. Verily, Allah is the Otte Who forgives and accepts repentance, Most Merciful. O you who believe! Have Taqzvd of Allah, and be with those who are true (in words and deeds).} Ka'b said; By Allah! Allah has never bestowed upon me, apart from His guiding me to Islam, a greater blessing than the fact that I did not tell a lie to Allah's Messenger ﷺ which would have caused me to perish, just as

those who had told a lie have perished. Allah described those who told lies with the worst descriptions He ever attributed to anyone. Allah said, *ijr^i frl fi* (* oy)n~*} < -3 5> iffLAJZi &t- C* * Ufo if y 2*i pr iThey will swear by Allah to you when you return to than, that you may turn aioay from them. So turn away from them. Surely, they are Rijs (impure), and Hell is their dwelling place - a recompense for that which they used to earn . They swear to you that you may be pleased with them, but if you are pleased with than, certainly Allah is not pleased with the people who are rebellious.} Ka'b added, We, the three persons, differed altogether from those whose excuses Allah s Messenger sg accepted when they swore to him. He took their pledge and asked Allah to forgive them, but Allah s Messenger left our case pending until Allah*

538 Tafsfr Ibtt Kathir gave us Hisjudgement about it. As for that Allah said, "i!#. m > iAnd (He didforgive also) the three who stayed behind...}

What Allah said does not discuss our failure to take part in the battle, but to the deferment of making a decision by the Prophet about our case, in contrast to the case of those who had taken an oath before him, and he excused them by accepting their excuses. This is an authentic Hadith collected in the Two Sahlhs (Al- Bukhari and Muslim) and as such, its authenticity is agreed upon. ' This Hadith contains the explanation of this honorable Ayah in the best, most comprehensive way. Similar explanation was given by several among the Salaf. For instance, Al-A mash narrated from Abu Sufyan, from Jabir bin Abdullah about Allah s statement, *ityr iAnd (He didforgive also) the three who stayed behind...} They are Ka b bin Malik, Hilal bin Umayyah and Murarah bin Ar-Rabl , all of them from the Ansar. The Order to speak the Truth Allah sent His relief from the distress and grief that struck these three men, because Muslims ignored them for fifty days and nights, until they themselves, and the earth - vast as it is - were straitened for them. As vast as the earth is, its ways and paths were closed for them, and they did not know what action to take. They were patient for Allah s sake and awaited humbly for His decree. They remained firm, until Allah sent His relief to them since they told the Messenger of Allah 3g the truth about why they remained behind, declaring that they did not have an excuse for doing so. They were requited for this period, then Allah forgave them. Therefore, the consequence of being truthful was better for them, for they gained forgiveness. Hence Allah s statement next, *x * Ahmad 3:456. * Fath Al-Bari 8 :193 and Muslim 4 :2121Tabaii 14:544.*

you who believe! Have Taqwa of Allah, and be with those who are true The Ayah says, adhere to and always say the truth so that you become among its people and be saved from destruction. Allah will make a way for you out of your concerns and a refuge. Imam

At-Tawbah (120 - 121) (Part-11 his (righteous) deeds in the most perfect manner to be lost v;^ Sj2 Sf> 4 |yV^s" U i&i 4121 . Neither do they spend any contribution - small or great - nor cross a valley, but is written to their credit that Allah may recompense them with the best ofwhat they used to do.} Allah said next, *iNeithr do they spend}, in reference to the fighters in Allah s cause, 41i^=* Vj Ijki- ua} iany contribution - small or great -}, with regards to its amount, 4^i'j inor cross a valley}, while marching towards the enemy, ip^ ibut is written to their credit}, for these actions that they take [and which are under their control], ithat Allah may recompense them with the best of what they used to do.} Certainly, the Leader of the faithful, TJthman bin Aflan, may Allah be pleased with him, acquired a tremendous*

share of the virtues mentioned in this honorable Ayah. He spent large amounts and tremendous wealth on this battle (Tabak). Abdullah, the son of Imam

Allah the Exalted here explains His order to Muslims to march forth with the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} for the battle of Tabuk. We should first mention that a group of the Salaf said that marching along with the Messenger ^{sg}, when he went to battle, was at first obliged on all Muslims, because, as they say, Allah said, 4'^ : i) iMarch forth, whether you are light or heavy> [9:41], and, 4It was not becoming of the people of Al-Madinah and the bedouins of the neighborhood...} [9:120]. However, they said, Allah abrogated this ruling (9:41 and 9:120) when He revealed this Ayah, [9:122]. However, we could say that this Ayah explains Allah's order to participate in battle on all Arab neighborhoods, that at least a group of every tribe should march for Jihad. Those who went with the Messenger ^{sg} would gain instructions and studies in the revelation that came down to him, and warn their people about that battle when they returned to them. This way, the group that went with the Prophet ^{sg} will achieve both goals [Jihad and learning the revelation from the Prophet ^{sg}]. After the Prophet ^{sg}, a group of every tribe or neighborhood should seek religious knowledge or perform Jihad, for in this case, Jihad is required from at least a part of each Muslim community. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas about the Ayah, 4Arid it is not (proper) for the believers to go out (to fight - Jihad) all together.} The believers should not all go to battle and leave the Prophet ^{sg} alone, 40/every troop of them, a party only should go forth in the expeditions that the Prophet ^{sg} sent. When these armies returned to the Prophet, ^{sg} who in the meantime received

544 Tafstr Ibn Kathir revealed parts of the Qur'an from Allah, the group who remained with the Prophet ^{sg} would have learned that revelation from him. They would say, Allah has revealed some parts of the Qur'an to your Prophet and we learned it. So they learned from them what Allah revealed to His Prophet ^{sg} in their absence, while the Prophet ^{sg} sent some other men into military expeditions. Hence Allah's statement, ithat they may get instructions in religion,} so that they learn what Allah has revealed to their Prophet ^{sg} and teach the armies when they return, 4so that they may beware.} 1 ^ Mujahid said, This Ayah was revealed about some of the Companions of the Prophet ^{sg} who went to the desert and were helped by its residents, had a good rainy year and called whomever they met to guidance. The people said to them, *We see that you left your companions and came to us. They felt bad in themselves because of this and they all came back from the desert to the Prophet ^{sg}. Allah said, & ot 'J 40/every troop of them, a party only should go forth,} those who seek righteousness [such as to spread the call of Islam, while others remain behind], ithat they may get instructions in (Islamic) religion,} and learn what Allah has revealed, 4and that they may warn their people}, when those who went forth returned to them, , u iso that they may beware (ofevil).} "l2] At-Tabari 14:565. Tabari 14:566.

Qatadah said about this Ayah, It is about when the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} sent an army; Allah commanded them to go into battle, while another group remained with the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} to gain instructions in the religion. Another group returns to its own people to call them (to Allah) and warn them against Allah's punishment of those who were before them. It was also said that this verse, ^ Kb 4And it is not (proper) for the believers to go out all together.} is not about joining Jihad. They say that the Messenger of Allah invoked Allah against Mudar to try them with years of famine, and their lands were struck by famine. The various tribes among them started to come, entire tribes at a time, to

Al-Madlnah, because of the hardship they faced and they would falsely claim that they are Muslims. This caused hardship for the Companions of the Messenger jg and Allah revealed to him that they are not believers. The Messenger of Allah jg sent them back to their tribes and warned their people not to repeat what they did. Hence Allah s statement, 1^ '\$> tJj T V iSSSP 'Wi soJJbAjj'j 4 cJj' l* o^jTabari 14:568.

and that they may warn their people when they return to them,} 3 5m fa. jiLJf y> 4123. O you who believe! Fight those of the disbelievers who are close to you, and let them find harshness in you; and know that Allah is with those who have Taqwd.} The Order for Jihad against the Disbelievers, the Closest, then the Farthest Areas Allah commands the believers to fight the disbelievers, the closest in area to the Islamic state, then the farthest. This is

why the Messenger of Allah started fighting the idolaters in the Arabian Peninsula. When he finished with them and Allah gave him control over Makkah, Al-Madlnah, At-Ta if, Yemen, Yamamah, Hajr, Khaybar, Hadramawt and other Arab provinces, and the various Arab tribes entered Islam in large crowds, he then started fighting the People of the Scriptures. He began preparations to fight the Romans who were the closest in area to the Arabian Peninsula, and as such, had the most right to be called to Islam, especially since they were from the People of the Scriptures. The Prophet jg marched until he reached TabOk and went back because of the extreme hardship, little rain and little supplies. This battle occurred on the ninth year after his Hijrah. In the tenth year, the Messenger of Allah was busy with the Farewell Hajj. The Messenger died eighty-one days after he returned from that Hajj, Allah chose him for what He had prepared for him [in Paradise). After his death, his executor, friend, and Khalifah, Abu Bakr As-Siddiq, may Allah be pleased with him, became the leader. At that time, the religion came under attack and would have been defeated, if it had not been for the fact that Allah gave the religion firmness through Abu Bakr, who established its basis and made its foundations firm. He brought those who strayed from the religion back to it, and made those who reverted from Islam return. He took the Zakah from the evil people who did not want to pay it, and explained the truth to those who were unaware of it. On behalf of the

At-Tawbah (123) (Part-11) Prophet sH, Abu Bakr delivered what he was entrusted with. Then, he started preparing the Islamic armies to fight the Roman cross worshippers, and the Persian fire worshippers. By the blessing of his mission, Allah opened the lands for him and brought down Caesar and Kisra and those who obeyed them among the servants. Abu Bakr spent their treasures in the cause of Allah, just as the Messenger of Allah jg had foretold would happen. This mission continued after Abu Bakr at the hands of he whom Abu Bakr chose to be his successor, Al-FarOq, the Martyr of the Mihrab} 1 ^ Abu Hafs, TJmar bin Al-Khattab, may Allah be pleased with him. With Umar, Allah humiliated the disbelievers, suppressed the tyrants and hypocrites, and opened the eastern and western parts of the world. The treasures of various countries were brought to Umar from near and far provinces, and he divided them according to the legitimate and accepted method. TJmar then died as a martyr after he lived a praise worthy life. Then, the Companions among the Muhajirin and Ansar agreed to chose after TJmar, TJthman bin Affan, Leader of the faithful and Martyr of the House, may Allah be pleased with him. During TJthman s reign, Islam wore its widest garment and Allah s unequivocal proof was established in various parts of the world over the necks of the servants. Islam appeared in the eastern

and western parts of the world and Allah's Word was elevated and His religion apparent. The pure religion reached its deepest aims against Allah's enemies, and whenever Muslims overcame an Ummah, they moved to the next one, and then the next one, crushing the tyrannical evil doers. They did this in reverence to Allah's statement, "O you who believe! Fight those of the disbelievers who are close to you," Allah said next, "Place of worship, where a Zoroastrian disbeliever assassinated Tamar while he was leading the Muslims in prayer."

548 Tafsir Ibn Kathir and let them find harshness in you}, meaning, let the disbelievers find harshness in you against them in battle. The complete believer is he who is kind to his believing brother, and harsh with his disbelieving enemy. Allah said in other Ayah, "Allah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him; humble towards the believers, stern towards the disbelievers..." [5:54], "Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah. And those who are with him are severe against the disbelievers, and merciful among themselves." [48:29], and, "Prophet! Strive hard against the disbelievers and the hypocrites, and be harsh against them." [9:73] Allah said, "And know that Allah is with those who have Taqwa," meaning, fight the disbelievers and trust in Allah knowing that Allah is with you if you fear and obey Him. This was the case in the first three blessed generations of Islam, the best members of this Ummah. Since they were firm on the religion and reached an unsurpassed level of obedience to Allah, they consistently prevailed over their enemies. During that era, victories were abundant, and enemies were ever more in a state of utter loss and degradation. However, after the turmoil began, desires and divisions became prevalent between various Muslim kings, the enemies were eager to attack the outposts of Islam and marched into its territory without much opposition. Then, the Muslim kings were too busy with their enmity for each other. The disbelievers then marched to the capital cities of the Islamic states, after gaining control over many of its areas, in addition to entire Islamic lands. Verily, ownership of all affairs is with Allah in the beginning and in the end. Whenever a just

Muslim king stood up and obeyed Allah's orders, all the while trusting in Allah, Allah helped him regain control over some Muslim lands and took back from the enemy what was compatible to his obedience and support to Allah. We ask Allah to help the Muslims gain control over the forelocks of His disbeliever enemies and to raise high the word of Muslims over all lands. Verily, Allah is Most Generous, Most Giving. "Which of you has had his faith increased by it? As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add Doubt to their Doubt; and they die while they are disbelievers." Faith of the Believers increases, while Hypocrites increase in Doubts and Suspicion Allah said, "And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say: 'Which of you has had his faith increased by it?' As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. 4124. And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say: 'Which of you has had his faith increased by it?' They say to each other, 'Who among you had his faith increased by this Surah [from the Quran]?' Allah the Exalted said, 'As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice.' This Ayah is one of the mightiest evidences that faith

550 Tafsir Ibn Kathir increases and decreases, as is the belief of most of the Salaf and later generations of scholars and Imams. Many scholars said that there is a consensus on this ruling. We explained this subject in detail in the beginning of the explanation of Sahih Al-Bukhari, may Allah grant him His

mercy. Allah said next, iBut as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add Rijs to their Rijs the Surah increases them in doubt, and brings more suspicion on top of the doubts and suspicion that they had before. Allah said in another Ayah, iAnd We send down in the Qur an that which is a healing^ [17:82], and, j-0* Jij% '4 v oii'j A C iSay: "It is for those who believe, a guide and a healing. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness (deafness) in their ears, and it (the Qur an) is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away (so they neither listen nor understand)".^[41:44] This indicates the misery of the hypocrites and disbelievers, since, what should bring guidance to their hearts is instead a cause of misguidance and destruction for them. Similarly, those who get upset by a type of food, for instance, will be upset and anxious even more if they are fed that food! ^ V } ^ } ^^ JL\$& uj** d! lw- t* bjj TJ s ofU! V (a* jnstj pr> -ml 4126 . See they not that they are put in trial once or twice every year? Yet, they turn not in repentance, nor do they learn a lesson (from it).}

4.127. And whenever there comes down a Surah, they look at one another (saying): "Does any one see you? Then they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts because they are a people that understand not.} Hypocrites suffer Afflictions Allah says, do not these hypocrites see. ithat they are put in trial}, being tested, 4; fi% V Y^ jJ& 4once or twice every year? Yet, they turn not in repentance, nor do they learn a lesson.} They neither repent from their previous sins nor learn a lesson for the future. Mujahid said that hypocrites are tested with drought and hunger. Allah said; pp J] P* uA ^ ^p} ii }% ft 'g. 4And whenever there comes down a Surah, they look at one another (saying) : Does any one see you?" Then they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts because they are a people that understand not.} This describes the hypocrites that when a Surah is revealed to the Messenger of Allah 5, 4uj & P&b 4they look at one another}, they turn their heads, right and left, saying, 4 Does any one see you? Then they turn away...} turning away from, and shunning the truth. This is the description of hypocrites in this life, for they do not remain m At-Tabari 14:580.

552 Tafsir Ibt Kathir where the truth is being declared, neither accepting nor understanding it, just as Allah said in other Ayat, vs-* Ji iThen what is wrong with them that they turn away from admonition? As if they were ivild donkeys. Fleeing from a lion>[74:49-51], and, ^)^ 'fJ o* r" iMki OfJjl J Li iSo what is the matter with those who disbelieve that they hasten to hear from you . (Sitting) in groups on the right and on the left.}[70:36-37], This Ayah also means, what is the matter with these people who turn away from you to the right and to the left, to escape from truth and revert to falsehood? Allah s statement, JL f * -v" * S>\ 4Hi iThen they turn away. Allah has turned their hearts (from Truthfy is similar to, iSo when they turned away, Allah turned their hearts awau.} [61:5]. Allah said next, A + ' i */ v oj*** V p> erVf ibecause they are a people that understand not.} They neither understand Allah s Word nor attempt to comprehend it nor want it. Rather, they are too busy, turning away from it. This is why they ended up in this condition. *nA ?& y * *' < :Af if w yj 4228. Verily, there Ims come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is eager for you ; for the believers [he is] full of pity, kind, and merciful .}

\$129. But if they turn away, say: "Allah is sufficient for me. There is no God but He, in Him I put my trust and He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne. } The Advent of the Prophet jg is a Great Bounty from Allah Allah reminds the believers that He has sent to them a Messenger from among themselves, from

their kind, speaking their language. Ibrahim, peace be upon him, said, 4Our Lord! Send among them a Messenger of their own.} [2: 129] Allah said, (ipj i] O* &} ilndeed, Allah conferred a greatfavor on the believers when He sent among them a Messengerfrom among themselves.}[3: 164] Allah said here, fo jj&} 4Verily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves.} meaning, from among you, speaking your language. Ja far bin Abu Talib said to An-Najashi (the king of Ethiopia), and Al-Mughlrah bin Shu'bah said to the emissary of Kisra, Allah has sent to us a Messenger from among us, whose family lineage, description, early days, truth and honestywe know. Allah said, , 4'j - j iltgrieveshim thatyou should receiveany injury or difficulty.} Whatever would cause hardship to his Ummah or be difficult for them, then it grieves him. Similarly, there is the Hadith reported through many routes that the Prophet said, fl /_) I L "/ was sent with the easy Hanifiyah [monotheism] way .s|21 Ahmad 1 :202 and 5 :291 * Ahmad 5:266. This is a weak narration, but there are supportin witnesses for it

An authentic HadLith mentions, jijji iii *Verily, this religion is easy" and its Law is all easy, lenient and perfect. It is easy for those whom Allah the Exalted makes it easy, n 111 iHe is eager for you), that you gain guidance and acquire benefits in this life and the Hereafter. Imam

4then say: Allah is sufficient for me. There is no God but He, Allah is sufficient for me, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, and in Him I put my trust. Similarly, Allah said, i(He alone is) the Lord of the east and the west; there is no God but He. So take Him alone as a guardian.* (73:9). Allah said next, 4^\$ j^j iand He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne* [9:129]. He is the King and Creator of all things, and He is the Lord of the Mighty Throne (Arsh) , which is above all creation; all that is in and between the heavens and earths is under the Throne [Arsh) and subservient to Allah s power. His knowledge encompasses all things, and His decision will certainly come to pass over all matters. He is the guardian of all things. Imam

Module 14

Surah 10: Yunus

Surah 10: Yunus

PDF pages 2427–2538

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2427]

Opening The Tafsir of Surah Yunus (Chapter - 10)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2427–2433]

sg" P^ In the Name of Allah, the Most Beneficent, the Most Merciful 33E t.a iSSsaieT^ till-*>-0> i\ajvj-jJitij o' c4%Z j#! Upp'^\ ppp-ppppppp/ppp&yp^ lAp/P\pLC opAjP ,_i ji i4C ii; i\$> 3 l os^ afrf 0\$*gH J J'v 3 X j& J-Ult ojl jvi ji^TJ -Xlj j-Lrf> | 4-. r, 'x* oi 41. Alif-Ldm-Rd. These are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an) Al- Hakim.} 42 . /s if a wonder for mankind that We have sent Our revelation to a man from among them- selves (saying) : Warn mankind, and give good news to those who be- lieve that they shall have with their Lord the re- wards of their good deeds? (But) the disbe- lievers say: "This is in- deed an evident sorcerer!"} The isolated letters in the beginning of this Surah, as well as in others, have been previously discussed at the beginning of

558 Talsir Ibn Kathir Surat Al-Baqarah. Allah said: i+gs i(cir. iThese are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an) Al-Hakim .} This indicates that these are verses of the Qur'an, in which the wisdom of judgment is clear. The Messenger cannot be but a Human Being Allah rebukes the attitude of the disbelievers with the words tf\} ils it a wonder for mankind. .^ [1 They have always found it strange that Allah would send Messengers to them from among mankind. Allah also tells us about other people from previous nations who said, iShall mere men guide us?} (64:6) HQd and Salih said to their people: i&i \$> a%fc J " iDo you wonder that there has come to you a reminder from your Lord through a man from among you.} (7:63) Allah also told us what the disbelievers from Quraysh said: iHas he made the gods into one God? Verily, this is a curious thing!} (38:5) Ad-Dahhak reported Ibn Abbas that he said: When Allah sent Muhammad^ as a Messenger, most of the Arabs denied him and his message and said: Allah is greater than sending a human Messenger like Muhammad. Ibn Abbas said, So Allah revealed: Tabari 15:13. * Note : In Ayah 7 :63 this statement is made by Nut (not \$alih , as erroneously mentioned by Ibn Kathir), and Had said the same to his people, in Ayah 7 :69.)

Yunus (2 - 3) (Part-11) ils it a wonder for mankind . Allah s statement; i that they shall have with their Lord the rewards of their good deeds} Scholars have differed over the meaning of the reward for the good deeds in this Ayah: i* f2 a \p: j} i and give good news to those who believe that they shall have with their Lord the rewards of their good deeds.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah, Eternal happiness has been written for them."121 Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: It is the good reward for what they have done. Mujahid said: It is their good deeds - their prayers, fasting,

charity, and glorification. He then said, And Muhammad %% will intercede for them. 131 Allah said: i(But) the disbelievers say: "This is indeed an evident sorcerer!" } This means that the disbelievers said this although Allah has sent a Messenger from among themselves to them, a mein of their own race as a bearer of good news and as a wamer. But they are the liars in saying that. 32 #3 } y jM&&& gfa oi i3. "Surely your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and the earth in six Days and then rose over (Istawd) the Throne, arranging the affair [of all things]. No intercessor (can plead with Him) except after He permits. That is Allah, your Lord; At-Tabari 15:13. At-Tabari 15:15. At-Tabari 15:14.

so worship Him (alone). Then, will you not remember?} Allah is the Creator Who arranges the Affairs of the Universe Allah tells us that He is the Lord of the entire existence. He tells us that He created the heavens and the earth in six days. It was said: Like these days (meaning our worldly days). It was also said: Every day is like a thousand years of what we reckon. Later, this will be discussed further. iand then rose over (Istawa) the Throne.} The Throne is the greatest of the creatures and is like a ceiling for them. Allah s statement: 4arranging the affair [of all things], means that He controls the affairs ofthe creatures. * \ 4 }j> ; > 4Not even the weight of a speck of dust escapes His Knowledge in the heavens or in the earth .} (34:3) No affair distract Him from other affairs. No matter troubles Him. The persistent requests of His creatures do not annoy Him. He governs big things as He governs small things everywhere, on the mountains, in the oceans, in populated areas, or in wastelands. U *>' jf}i\ 4 ^ Cj} 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is duefrom Allah.} (11:6) 4% % /Hi 4 %"n " 2 4Not a leaffalls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} (6:59)

Ad-Darawardi narrated from Sa d bin Ishaq bin Ka'b bin 'Ujrah that he said: When this Ayah was revealed, iSurely, your Lord is Allah Who created the heavens and tire earth^ they met a great caravan whom they thought should be Arabs. They said to them: Who are you? They replied: We are Jinns. We left Al-Madlnah because of this Ayah This was recorded by Ibn Abi Hatim. Allah said: 3. Jt CltNo intercessor (can plead with Him) except after He permits.} This is similar to what is in the following Ayah / r * # 1/ y\ iWho is he that can intercede with Him except with His permission?} (2:255) and, SEj Jll ill oifc jwm o; pr iAnd there are many angels in tire heavens, whose intercession will avail nothing except after Allah has given leave for whom He wills and is pleased with.>(53:26), and; it 4& 4[Z* lllllf %} intercession with Him profits not except for him whom He permits.^(34:23). Allah then said: iThat is Allah, your Lord; so worship Him (alone). Then, will you not remember?} meaning worship Him alone with no partners. iThen will you not remember?} meaning O idolators, you

meaning, the reward will be with justice and complete recompense. 4^j>& !\$? ii, SJ l&j 4Bwf those who disbelieved will have a drink of boiling fluids and painful torment because they used to disbelieve.} meaning, because of their disbelief they will be punished on

the Day of Resurrection by different forms of torment, such as

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2433–2438]

fierce hot winds, boiling water, and the shadow of black smoke. 477n's is so/ Then let them taste it; a boiling fluid and dirty wound discharges. And other (torments) of similar kind all together!} (38:57-58)

Jly''' 'rt . jllAi 477i/s is the Hell which the criminals denied. They will go between it (Hell) and the fierce boiling water!} (55:43-44) /A %& & 4a stt 45. It is He Who made the sun a shining thing and the moon as a light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning. Allah did not create this but in truth. He explains the Ayat in detail for people who have knowledge.} 46. Verily, in the alternation of the night and the day and in all that Allah has created in the heavens and the earth are Ayat for those who have Taqwa.} Everything is a Witness to the Power of Allah. Allah tells us about the signs He created that are indicative of His complete power and great might. He made the rays that come forth from the bright sun as the source of light, and made the beams that come forth from the moon as light. He made them of two different natures so they would not be

confused with one another. Allah made the dominion of the sun in the daytime and the moon in the night. He ordained phases for the moon, where it starts small then its light increases until it completes a full moon. Then it begins to decrease until it returns to its first phase at the conclusion of the month. Allah said: J LI\$ Jll!> V 36 fyZ J&S iAnd the moon, We have measured for it mansions (to traverse) till it returns like the old dried curved date stalk. It is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.} (36:39-40) And He said: iAnd the sun and the moon for counting And in this Ayah He said: iand measured} that is the moon, Allah said: iAtid measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and the reckoning."} The days are revealed by the action of the sun, and the months and the years by the moon. Allah then stated i'j ill! jii. &} 4Allah did not create this but in truth.} He didn't create that for amusement but with great wisdom and perfect reasoning. With a similar meaning, Allah said: iAnd We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between them without purpose! That is the consideration of

Yunus (5 - 6) (Part-11) those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelieve from the Fire!} (38:27) He also said: 4"Did you think that We had created you in play (without any purpose), and that you would not be brought back to Us?" So Exalted be Allah, the True King: None has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!} [23:115-116] Allah said: iHe explains the Ayat in detail for people who have knowledge.} In other words, He explained the signs and proofs for people who know. Allah farther stated: * ** <* * < \ 'r^- 4^ iVerily, in the alternation of the night and the day} The day and the night alternate, when one arrives, the other goes, and so on, with no errors. This is similar to the meaning indicated in the following Ayat }He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly. ..}. 4'J3 AjX j\U } 4It is not for the sun to overtake the moon.} [36:40], and 4&Z J4' J3S 4(He is the) Cleaver of the daybreak. He has appointed the night for resting}. [6:96] Allah continued: ijfSAj vS 43

Js tism tm >"^f .1 >/ '>. l^-t>,'f'l^ "" " > ?"? aujuj.l)I * -> p4^' (jHjS'jJCa p-tj " ""f "\t'f?<<'> "\T'y"- \s- <'>.>> ' O-gJ >** w*-r^C"t'^ ,^iVOVfc="j-". "/w"4i6' Tafsir Ibt Kathir * &&!\$! ^ " all that Allah has created in the heavens and the earth> meaning the signs that indicate His greatness. This is similar to Allah's statements: te&Xgoi s /< F &Jov yll ijJ. ,>; iAnd how many a sign in the heavens and the earth..." [12:105], J l"U *&%^ ^ u; h>. ^ o6- <"Sfly: "Be/iofd a/1 that is in the heavens and the earth," but neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who believe not.}[10:101] m \z#" iSee they not what is before them and what is behind them, of the heaven and the earthy [34:9]. "IMV(j;H \$. 4S& 4Verily, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and in the alternation of night and day, there are indeed signs

for men of understanding.} [3:190] means intelligent men. Allah said here. iAyd for those who have Taqwa.} meaning fear Allah s punishment, wrath and torment.

U\$> Y i. 4jI?~5^ ! ^=* *j^ . Verily, those who hope not for their meeting with Us, but are pleased and satisfied with the life of the present world, and those who are heedless ofOur Aydt,} {8. Those, their abode will be the Fire, because of what they used to earn.} TheAbode ofThoseWho deny the Hour is Hell-Fire Allah describes the state of the wretched who disbelieved in the meeting with Allah on the Day of Resurrection and did not look forward to it, who were well-pleased with the life of this world and at rest in it. Al-Hasan said: "They adorned it and praised it until they were well pleased with it. Whereas they were heedless of Allah s signs in the universe, they did not contemplate them. They were also heedless of Allah s Laws, for they didn t abide by them. Their abode on the Day of Return is Fire, a reward for what they have earned in their worldly life from among their sins and crimes. That is beside their disbelief in Allah, His Messenger and the Last Day. <&&& A . Verily, those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, their Lord will guide them through their faith; under them will flow rivers in the Gardens ofdelight (Paradise).} 410. Their way of request therein will be: "Glory to You, O Allah!" and "Salam" (peace, safety from evil) will be their greetings therein! And the close of their request will be: "All praise is due to Allah, the Lord ofall that exists."} The Good Reward is for the People of Faith and Good Deeds In these two Ayat, Allah promises the happy blessings for those who believed in Allah and His Messengers. And for those

568 Tafstr Ibn Kathir that have complied with what they were commanded to follow. The promise is that He will guide them because of their faith, or it may mean through their faith. As to the first interpretation, the meaning is that Allah will guide them on

the Day of Resurrection to the straight path until they pass

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2438–2448]

into Paradise because of their faith in this world. The other meaning is that their faith will assist them on the Day of Resurrection as Mujahid said: iTheir Lord will guide them through their faiths meaning Their faith will be a light in which they will walk. 111 k ssM i >. I-*** iTheir way of request therein will be: "Glory to You, O Allah! And Salam (peace, safety from evil) will be their greetings therein! And the close of their request will be: "All praise is due to Allah, the Lord ofall that exists) meaning this is the condition of the people of Paradise. This is similar to what is found in the following Ayat. iTheir greeting on the Day they shall meet Him will be "Salam [Peace]!) [33:44], a. iu% %# SJX 'i) iNo Laghw (dirty, false, evil vain talk) will they hear therein, nor any sinful speech. But only the saying of: Salam! Salam!!") [56:25-26], i(It will be said to them): "Salam - a Word from the Lord, Most Merciful.) [36:58], CM At-Tabari 15:28.

4And angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you)! 4 [13:23-24) In Allah s statement, 4And the close of their request will be: All praise is due to Allah, the Lord ofall that exists."4 There is an indication that Allah Almighty is the Praised One always, the Worshipped at all times. This is why He praised Himself at the beginning and the duration of His creation. He also praised Himself in the beginning of His Book and the beginning of its revelation.

Allah said: 4AU the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has sent down to His servant the Book (the Qur'an).> [18:1], oy1 - J ifjii aL ai Xl 4AU praise is due to Allah, Who (alone) created the heavens and the earth, [6:1], and many other citations with this meaning. The Ayah also indicates that Allah is the Praised One in this world and in the Hereafter and in all situations. In a Hadith recorded by Muslim: L US iUjI Jjif jit The people of Paradise will be inspired to glorify Allah and praise Him as they instinctively breath . [1 This will be their nature because of the increasing bounties of Allah upon them. These bounties are repeated and brought back again and increased with no limit or termination. So praise be to Allah for there is no God but He and no Lord save He. V o# j' ^i lit & -at 4 m Muslim 4:2181

ill. And were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good then they would have been ruined. So We leave those who expect not their meeting with Us, in their trespasses, wandering blindly in distraction.} Allah does not respond to the Requests for Evil like He does with the Requests for Good Allah tells us about His Forbearance and Benevolence with His servants. He does not respond to them when they pray with evil intentions against themselves, their wealth or their children during times of grief or anger. He knows that they do not truly intend evil for themselves so He doesn't respond to them. This is in reality kindness and mercy. On the other hand. He responds to them when they pray for themselves, wealth and money, with good, blessing and growth. Allah has said, iAnd were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good then they would have been ruined.} This means that if He had responded to all of their evil requests, He would have destroyed them. However, people should avoid praying for evil as much as they can. Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded in his Musnad that Jabir said, Allah's Messenger^ said: "Do not pray against yourselves, do not pray against your children, do not pray against your wealth, for your prayer may coincide with a time of response from Allah and Allah will respond to you. This Hadlth was also recorded by Abu Dawud.111 This is giinilflr to what is understood from the following Ayah: ij&i Abu Dawud 2 :185.

Yunus (11 - 12) (Part-11 4And man invokes (Allah) for evil as he invokes (Allah) for good.>[17: 11] In regard to the interpretation of this Ayah, iAnd were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil as He hastens for them the good> Mujahid said: It is the man saying to his son or money when he is angry, O Allah don't bless him (or it) and curse him (or it). Should Allah respond to this man in this request as He responds to him with good, He would destroy them. <&-^&& o*ra i jinif 4* ^^ C -4 Gil i 422. And when harm touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him! Thus it is made foir seeming to the wasteful that which they used to do.} Man remembers Allah at Times of Adversity and forgets Him at Times of Prosperity Allah tells us about man and how he becomes annoyed and worried when he is touched with distress. icpfr&J jjj Jill ibut when evil touches him, then he has recourse to long supplications.^[41:51] Long supplications also means many supplications. When man suffers adversity he becomes worried and anxious. So he supplicates more. He prays to Allah to lift and remove the adversity. He prays while standing, sitting or laying down. When Allah removes his adversity and lifts his distress, he turns away and becomes arrogant. He goes on as if nothing were wrong with him before. G1I m At-Tabari 15:34.

4He passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him!} Allah then criticized and condemned those who have these qualities or act this way, so He said: iThus it is made fair seeming to the wasteful that which they used to do.} But those on whom Allah has bestowed good guidance and support are an exception. iExcept those who have patience believe and do righteous good deeds.} [11:11]

The Prophet said: tty l\ .3 iUi 3 Jii ^ V ^ji l/il^ yt a"-Si si> jJi) i"j yfz* op jr oHow wonderful is the case of a believer ; there is good for him in everything and this is not the case with anyone except a believer. If prosperity attends him, he expresses gratitude to Allah, and that is good for him. And if adversity befalls him, he endures it patiently and that is also good for him."in 413. And indeed, We destroyed generations before you when they did wrong, while their Messengers came to them with clear proofs, but they were not such as to believe! Thus do We requite the people who are criminals.} 414. Then We made you successors after them, generations after generations in the land, that We might see how you would toork.} Muslim 4 :2295

The Admonition held in the Destruction of the Previous Generations Allah tells us about what happened to past generations when they belied the Messengers and the clear signs and proofs the latter brought to them. Allah then made this nation successors after them. He sent to them a Messenger to test their obedience to Him and following His Messenger.

ji aS'^jTjdfc_ ^oC3\ rfs f. > *fc. i ^ // i< *^ " , " * . "? > ; < * V '4 vl'-v .1' OjLJjCa3"^ajOj3' jj|^=^Jb -uil Ji^jtCj-^= ^JJj^c^i- ts&s&KP " . jf-' T'-i.-r. ioorJt.>(10:14) Then he said: Son of the mother of TJmar, you have been appointed as Khalfah, so look at what you will do! About not fearing the blame of blamers, that is Allah's will. About becoming a martyr, how can TJmar reach that when the Muslims are in support of him? ^uo: 3 10 lira 'oyrs. * x m fel 3 4 3 C % gi oi 2 ^BLj 41 wJ!. 2#y> "/ /"<^ "/ > */" - j" <- tJj C->.-ag t"i ["r-=^ OjwJ jji j^Cyal 3* /-yti U ail its. ji Ji dp^-r4" 415. And when Our clear Ayat are recited unto them, those who hope not for their meeting with Us, say: "Bring us a Qur'an other than this, or change it." Say: "It is not for me to change it on my own accord; I only follow that which is revealed unto me. Verily, I fear the torment of the Great Day (the Day of Resurrection) if I were to disobey my Lord. } 416. Say: "If Allah had so willed, I should not have recited it to you nor would He have made it known to you. Verily, I [i] Af-Tabari 15:39.

have stayed among you a lifetime before this. Have you then no sense?'ft Obstinacy of the Chiefs of the Quraysh Allah tells us about the obstinacy of the disbelievers of the Quraysh, who were opposed to the message and denied Allah. When the Messenger \$g read to them from the Book of Allah and His clear evidence they said to him: Bring a Qur'an other than this. They wanted the Prophet jg to take back this Book and bring them another book of a different style or change it to a different form. So Allah said to His Prophet jg: 4Say : It is not for me to change it on my own accordft This means that it is not up to me to do such a thing. I am but a servant who receives commands. I am a Messenger conveying from Allah. c <-& Zfy. 6 oft 41 only follow that which is revealed unto me. Verily, I fear the torment of the Great Day (the Day of Resurrection) if I were to disobey my Lordft The Evidence of the Truthfulness of the Qur'an Muhammad sg then argued with supporting evidence to the truthfulness of what he had brought them: 4Say: If Allah had so willed, I should not have recited it to you nor would He have made it known to you ...'ft This indicates that he brought this only with the permission and will of Allah for

him to do so. The proof of this was that he had not fabricated it himself and that they were incapable of refuting it, and that they should be fully aware of his truthfulness and honesty since he grew up among them, until Allah sent the Message to him. The Prophet was never criticized for anything or held in contempt. So he said.

576 Tafsir Ibn Kathir iVerily, I have stayed among you a lifetime before this. Have you then no sense?} Which meant don t you have brains with which you may distinguish the truth from falsehood? When Heraclius, the Roman king, asked Abu Sufyan and those who were in his company about the Prophet jg, he said: Have you ever accused him of telling lies before his claim? Abu Sufyan replied: No. Abu Sufyan was then the head of the disbelievers and the leader of the idolators, but he still admitted the truth. This is a clear and irrefutable testimony since it came from the enemy. Heraclius then said: I wondered how a person who does not tell a lie about others could ever tell a lie about Allah. Ja'far bin Abu Talib said to An-Najashi, the king of Ethiopia: Allah has sent to us a Messenger that we know his truthfulness, ancestral lineage, and honesty. He stayed among us before the prophethood for forty years. 417. So who does more wrong than he who forges a lie against Allah or denies His Ayat? Surely, the criminals will never be successful'.} Allah says that no one is more wrong, unjust and arrogant than he who invented a lie against Allah, forged claims about Allah, or claimed that Allah has sent a message to him but his claim was not true. No one is more of a criminal or has committed greater wrong than such a person. Liars cannot be confused with Prophets. Anyone who claims such a thing, whether lying or telling the truth, will necessarily be supported by Allah with proofs and signs of his falsehood or truthfulness. The difference between Muhammad jg and Musaylamah the liar, was clearer to those who met both of them than the difference between forenoon and midnight when it is extremely dark. Those who are clear-sighted can distinguish via signs and proofs between the truthfulness of Muhammad sg and theAl-B&ri8:82. 1 :202.

falsehood ofMusaylamah the liar, Sajah and Al-Aswad Al- Ansi. Abdullah bin Salam said: When Allah s Messenger \$&, arrived at Al-Madinah, people were scared away and I was one ofthem. But when I saw him, I realized that his face could never be the face of a liar. The first thing I heard from him was his statement: jm *jL ijLsAj ijH\ i"ij u;" "0 people, spread the greetings ofpeace, feed others, be dutiful to your relatives and offer prayers in the night when others are asleep so that you will enter Paradise in peace . " [1 ' When Dimam bin Thalabah came to Allah s Messenger jg and asked him in the presence of his people - Banu Sa d bin Bakr: Who raised this heaven? He replied, "Allah*). He asked: And who erected these mountains? He replied, "4jI" "AJ/a/i". He asked: Who spread out this earth? He replied, uAllahn. Then he asked: I ask you in the name of the One, Who raised the heavens, erected the mountains, and spread out this earth, has Allah sent you as a Messenger to all mankind? He said, *iBy Allah, Yes J Then Dimam asked him about Salah, Zakah, Hajj and fasting. With every question he swore by Allah and with every response the Prophet swore also. Dimam then said: You indeed are telling the truth. By the One Who sent you with the truth I will not increase or decrease from what you have told me. This man was content with the few responses of the Prophet jg. He was convinced of the Prophet s truthfulness by the signs that he saw and witnessed. It was narrated that Amr bin A1- As went to Musaylamah. Amr was not a Muslim at that time and he was a friend of Musaylamah. Musaylamah said: Woe unto you Amr. What was revealed unto your friend - meaning Allah s Messenger jg- during

this period? Amr replied: I heard his companions 5:451. ' See Zad Al-Ma ad 3:647, and its source is in Al-Bukhari no. 63, and Muslim no . 12 , and others

reading a short but great Surah. He asked, And what was that? He recited: 4By Al-'Asr (the time). Verily, man is in loss.} [103:1-2] until the end of the Surah. Musaylamah thought for a while and then said: Something similar to that was also revealed to me. Amr asked: And

what is it?" He then recited: "O Wabr, O Wabii You are only

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2448–2449]

two ears and a breast. The rest of you is hollow. What do you think, Amr? Amr then said: By Allah, you know that I know that you are a liar. 111 This was a statement made by an idolator in judgment of Musaylamah. He knew Muhammad 3 and his truthfulness. He also knew Musaylamah and his tendency toward falsehood and lying. People who think and have insight know even better. Allah said: j/c jis di 4 pj (fd 4 1 4*&\$ z JL 4And who does more aggression and wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or rejects His Ayat.} [6:21] 4So who does more wrong than he who Jorge a lie against Allah or denies His Ayat? Surely, the criminals will never be successful!} [10:17] No one is more unjust than he who belies the truth which the Messengers have brought supported with evidence and proof. J" jiil Y \$ dxf ot tfij ijfcZZ Vx^j sr CJ m Al-Biddiyah wan-Nihayah 6 :326 .

Yunus (18 - 19) (Part-11) }18. And they worship besides Allah things that harm them not, nor profit them, and they say: "These are our intercessors with Allah." Say : Do you inform Allah of that which He knows not in the heavens and on the earth?" Glorified and Exalted is He above all that which they associate as partners (with Him)!} 419. Mankind were but one community, then they differed (later); and had not it been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, it would have been settled between them

regarding what they differed.}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2449–2475]

What do the Idolators believe about Their Gods? Allah reproaches the idolators that worshipped others beside Allah, thinking that those gods would intercede for them before Allah. Allah states that these gods do not harm or benefit. They don t have any authority over anything, nor do they own anything. These gods can never do what the idolators had claimed about them. That is why Allah said: 4 4p v tL& & 4Say: 'Do you inform Allah of that which He knows not in the heavens and on the earth?'} Ibn Jarir said: This means, Are you telling Allah about what may not happen in the heavens and earth? Allah then announced that His Glorious Self is far above their Shirk and Kufr by saying: iGlorified and Exalted is He above all that which they associate as partners (with Him)!}^ Shirk isNew Allah then tells us that Shirk was new among mankind. It was not in existence in the beginning. He tells us that people were believers in one religion and that religion was Islam. Ibn Abbas said: There were ten centuries between Adam and m At-Tabari 15:46.

Noh. They were all on Islam. Then differences among people took place. They worshipped idols and rivals. So Allah sent extensive evidence and irrefutable proof with His Messengers. ' 1 /*<"/ f + /.f/ * / \

So that those who were to be destroyed (for rejecting the faith) might be destroyed after a clear evidence, and those who were to live might live after a clear evidence.}[8:42] Allah's statement: 4" 'i&f iAnd had not it been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord...} means that if Allah had not decreed He would not punish anyone until the evidence is established against them. And also that if He had not given creatures a respite until a defined term had passed, He would have judged among them in what they disputed. Then He would have caused the believers to be happy and delighted and the disbelievers to be miserable and wretched. a C\ jii 4\$ oi k\:& 3% 'it 420. And they say: "How is it that not a sign is sent down on him from his Lord?" Say: "The Unseen belongs only to Allah, so wait you, verily, I am with you among those who wait."} The Idolators requested a Miracle These stubborn, lying disbelievers said, Why would not a sign be revealed to Muhammad horn his Lord. They meant a sign such as given to Salih. Allah sent the she-camel to Thamud. They wanted Allah to change the mount of As-Safa into gold or remove the mountains of Makkah and replace them with gardens and rivers. Allah is capable of doing all of that, but He is All-Wise in His actions and statements. Allah 11 Al-Biddiyah wan-Nihayah 1 :101 , and he said,

Yunus (20) (Part-11 said: i*ii Iji CK iSfa '* ij* '*fl (J-V- >(, 4A-f} li-tlel) icLliij j; , - ;V . iBlessed be He Wlw, if He wills, will assign you better than (all) that - Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise) and will assign you palaces (in Paradise) . Nay, they deny the Hour, and far those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire.}[25:10-11] He also said: ^ ' If? L *u iAtid nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people ofold denied them.} (17:59] Allah's way of dealing with His creatures is that He would give to them if they asked things from Him. But if they then didn't believe He would expedite punishment for them. When Allah's Messenger 0 was given the choice of Allah giving the people what they requested but if they didn't believe they would be punished, or that their request would not be answered immediately, Allah's Messenger0 chose the latter. Allah guided His Prophet jg to answer their question by saying: iSay : "The Unseen belongs only to Allah..."} This Ayah means that the matter in its entirety is for Allah. He is well aware of the outcome of all matters. 4"...so wait you, verily, I am with you among those who wait."} If you would not believe unless you witness that which you asked for, then wait for Allah's judgement for me, as well as for yourselves. Nonetheless, they had witnessed some of the signs and miracles of the Prophet 0, which were even greater than what they had asked for. In their presence, the Prophet0 pointed to the moon when it was full and it split into two parts.

Yunus (20 - 21) (Part-11) iimm TU SSS9SS ^ i/ K (* + JauJ Ijily ^>*(J ^W-J /U/O/oLaii&\JJu^od ^ its -? obvious magic!'}[6:7] Such people don't deserve to have their requests answered, for there is no benefit in answering them. These people are obstinate and stubborn as a result of their corruption and immorality. Therefore Allah told His Messenger jgj to say: oj 41 4So laaif you, verily, I am with you among tlwse who wait.} juo ^ ^uy Uii ,C. >;< ,A-* W p W Si it j" bcc r* SSS /3& /if 4 U^ < ->-\$-; J"? (*ri ijT ji P"" (tiirJ ^ fr^ CVi 'ij Ui OJ i* ULiji jJ ,/jli li 05-^ "if ij > i^i C% ii^if gsJM a j^f jf^ ^f 4 -i cl ,5242 422. And when We let mankind taste mercy after some adversity has afflicted them, behold! They take to plotting against Our Aydt! Say: "Allah is more swift in planning! Certainly, Our messengers (angels) record all of that which you plot.} 422 . He it is Who enables you to travel through land and sea,

till when you are in the ships, and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they are glad therein, then comes a stormy wind and the waves come to them from all sides, and they think that they are encircled therein. Then they invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (alone), (saying) : "If You (Allah) deliver us from this, we shall truly, be of the grateful. i23. But when He delivers them, behold! They rebel (disobey Allah) in the earth wrongfully. O mankind! Your rebellion is only against yourselves, - a brief enjoyment of this worldly life, then (in the end) unto Us is your return, and We shall inform you of that which you used to do. Man changes when He receives Mercy after Times of Distress Allah tells us that when He makes men feel His mercy after being afflicted with distress, ~j iThey take to plotting against Our Aydt.\$ The coming of mercy after distress is like the coming of ease after hardship, fertility after aridity, and rain after drought. Mujahid said that man s attitude indicates a mockery and belying of blessings.^ ' The meaning here is similar to Allah s statement: ji *} '! tilej J-iAnd when harm touches man, he invokes Us, lying on his side, or sitting or standing. 10:12)

jill JI* Ij UfotA I (Jl5 ^jA liti Sj ^ *j" x y ji p" : Jli Lafj . . jTVSvJlj IS "<__^_^^ ^IS illii IJSj "A//fl/i said; "This morning, some of My servants have become believers and some disbelievers in Me. He who said: We have had this rainfall due to the grace and mercy of Allah' is a believer in Me and a disbeliever in the stars. And he who said we have had this rainfall due to the rising of such and such star' is a disbeliever in Me and a believer in the stars. 111 The Ayah iSay : "Allah is more swift in planning!"} means that Allah is more capable of gradually seizing them with punishment, while granting them concession of a delay until the criminals think that they would not be punished. But in reality they are in periods of respite, then they will be taken suddenly. The noble writers (meaning the angels who write the deeds) will write everything that they do and keep count of their deeds. Then they will present it before the All-Knowing of the seen and unseen worlds. The Lord will then reward them for the significant deeds and even the seemingly insignificant that may be as tiny as a spot on a date pit. Allah further states: 4/3'j 4He it is Who enables you to travel through land and sea...} which means that He preserves you and maintains you with His care and watching. iTill when you are in the ships, and they sail with them with a favorable wind, and they are glad therein...} meaning smoothly and calmly; m Fath Al-Bari2 :607 .

586 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4then comes (these ships)} 4a stormy wind} iand the waves come to them from all sides,} i-^ti iand they think that they are encircled therein} meaning that are going to be destroyed. 4i\$ 2 S iThen they invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (alone)} meaning that in this situation they would not invoke an idol or statue besides Allah. They would single Him out alone for their supplications and prayers. This is similar to Allah s statement: se JS j# i jitp: fy} 4And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him (Allah alone). But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away (from Him). And man is ever ungrateful.} [17:67] And in this Surah, He says: 4*ti& ly, laulii 'j 2i(I & iThey invoke Allah, making their faith pure for Him (saying): If You (Allah) deliver us from this (situation)."} 4 We shall truly, be of the grateful. } This means that we will not ascribe others as partners with You. We will later worship You alone as we are praying to You here and now. Allah states; 4fi#

Yunus (21 - 23) (Part-11) 4But when He delivers them> from that distress, 4^' 4 Sjv. (U 4behold! They rebel (disobey Allah) in the earth wrongfully...} meaning: they returned as if they had never

experienced any difficulties and had never promised Him anything. So Allah said: 4fe* p \$ =>} 4He passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched Wwi/^(10:12] Allah then said: 4&&& ffeSqsM 40 mankind! Your rebellion (disobedience to Allah) is only against yourselves,} it is you yourselves that will taste the evil consequence of this transgression. You will not harm anyone else with it, as comes in the Hadith, 4)1 U CjJI) I Jmj " ^* "77iere is mo sin that is more worthy that Allah hasten punishment for in this world - on top of the punishment that Allah has in store for it in the Hereafter - than oppression and cutting the ties of the womb ."[11 Allah s statement: 4Q% &} 4a brief enjoyment of this worldly life...} means that you only have a short enjoyment in this low and abased worldly life. 4then (in the end) unto Us is your return...} meaning your goal and final destination. ll* Abu D&wud 5 :208.

and We shall inform you of all your deeds. Then we shall recompense you for them. So let him who finds good (in his record) praise Allah, and let him who finds other than that blame no one but himself. ffl e* oG .4, sm u V* t# & qja <&> & p ^ ji & 4 S2 *^^ >4 i: 45 tofcS 424. Verily, the parable of the life of the world is as the water which We send down from the sky; so by it arises the intermingled produce of the earth of which men and cattle eat until when the earth is clad in its adornments and is beautified, and its people think that they have all the powers of disposal over it, Our command reaches it by night or by day and We make it like a clean-mown harvest, as if it had not flourished yesterday! Thus do We explain the Ayat in detail for the people who reflect.} 425. Allah calls to the Abode of Peace (Paradise) and guides whom He wills to the straight path.} The Parable ofthis Life Allah the Almighty has set an example of the similitude of the life of this world, its glitter and the swiftness of its passage, likening it to the plant and vegetation that Allah brings out from the earth. This plant grows from the water that comes down from the sky. These plants are food for people, such as fruits and other different types and kinds of foods. Some other kinds are food for cattle such as clover plants (i.e. green fodder for the cattle) and herbage etc. juntil when the earth is clad in its adornments ,} 4and is beautified 4 meaning, it became good by what grows on its hills such as blooming flowers of different shapes and colors. i'W

and its people think... those who planted it and put it in the ground, &&& ithat they have all the powers ofdisposal over ify to cultivate it and harvest it. But while they were in that frame of mind, a thunderbolt or a severe, cold storm came to it. It dried its leaves and spoiled its fruits. Allah said: 4^ (ft jt yd0 iOur command reaches it by night or by day and We make it like a clean-mown harvest it became dry after it was green and flourishing. O' \$ <*" 4as if it had notflourished yesterdayfy as if nothing existed there before. Qatadah said: As if it had not flourished; as if it was never blessed. Such are things after they perish, they are as if they had never existed. Similarly, the Hadith, wfj J- : iJ Jlij jfbl ^ UjjJl^ Lljp xit aj ii, j (Jp w ojd jjJj ji : is jii; "A person who led the most prosperous life in this world loill be brought up and dipped once in the Fire. He will then be asked: 'Have you ever found any good or comfort? He will reply: 'No.' And a person who had experienced extreme adversity in this world will be brought up and dipped once in the bliss (of Paradise). Then he will be asked: 'Did you ever face any hardship or misery?' He will reply : 'No.'s Allah said about those who were destroyed: 4So they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes; as if they had never lived there.^[1 1:67-68] *** Muslim 4:2162.

Allah then said: 91 J-il do We explain the Ayat...) We do explain the proofs, and evidences, in detail ifor the people who reflect.) so they may take a lesson from this example in the swift vanishing of this world from its people while they are deceived by it. They would trust this world and its promises, and then it unexpectedly turns away from them. This world, in its nature, runs away from those who seek it but seeks those who run away from it. Allah mentioned the parable of this world and the plants of the earth in several Ayat in His Noble Book. He said in Surat Al-Kahf. fvili ui'i' Jllit till)! & 4!T Gill Xyi5 fX CjjjAj) \$& ia' ajjjl tLu iAnd putforward to them the example of the life of this world it is like the water (rain) which We send down from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter. And Allah is able to do everything.) (18:45) He also gave similar examples in both Surat Az-Zumar [39:21] and Surat Al-Hadid (57:20). Invitation to the Everlasting Gifts that do not vanish Allah said: /> dl 'y-j? '*)) 4And Allah calls to the Abode ofPeace) When Allah mentioned the swiftness of this world and its termination. He invited people to Paradise and encouraged them to seek it. He called it the Abode of Peace. It is the Abode of Peace because it is free from defects and miseries. So Allah said:

Yunus (24 - 25) (Part-11) iAUah calls to the Home ofPeace and guides whom He wills to the straight path> It was narrated that Jabir bin Abdullah said: Allah s Messenger sSgj came out one day and said to us: Jyu ^ P: Jij** dfe flU^ oJij UJI ivlllli jip ijplj niljl liwl : Jlii tisU s liJi ii^{ jij ii& p44j 1 4^y * tjly^ ' JjjU-f ij^; iUi l; cJi; i*Uji 4dtj jilJi} tdJUJi Ji ,l ' J 1&J 1 jis fV^j' yj '/' fame seen in my sleep that it was as if fibril was at my head and Mikd il at my leg. They were saying to each other: Give an example for him.' He said: 'Listen, your ear may listen. And fathom, your heart may fathom. The parable of you and your Ummah is that of a king who has built a house on his land. He arranged a banquet in it. Then he sent a messenger to invite the people to his food. Some accepted the invitation and others did not. Allah is the King and the land is Islam, the house is Paradise and you Muhammad are the Messenger. Whosoever responds to your call enters Islam. And whosoever enters Islam enters Paradise. And whosoever enters Paradise eatsfrom if." Ibn Jarir recorded this Hadith. It was also reported that Abu Ad-Darda said that Allah s Messenger jg said: jW >- jUdlL * Vj d oJilJg jfijP Jt'j\$ tk "r&j J !>&" i# I *Two angels descend every day in which the sun rises and say that which all Allah's creatures would hear except Jinn and humans: O people! Come to your Lord! Anything little and sufficient is better Hum a lot but distractive And He sent this down in the Qur an when He said: IM At-Jabari 15:61.

ijni Ji \ l%} i"Allah calls to the Abode ofPeace .} Ibn Abi Hatim and Ibn Jarir recorded this.' X> o&,) aJjA \l. <' "i. >' >> -AJ &>. (U 4*. For those who have done good is tlte best, and even more. Neither darkness nor dust nor any humiliating disgrace shall cover their faces. They are the dwellers of Paradise, they will abide therein forever.} The Reward of the Good-Doers Allah states that by having faith and performing righteous deeds - will be rewarded with a good reward in the Hereafter. Allah said: vi^r 4- fri ils there any reward for good other than good?}(55:60) Then Allah said: iand even more.} the reward on the good deeds multiplied ten times to seven hundred times and even more on top of that. This reward *** At-Tabari 15 :60, andAhmad 5 : 197. those who do good in this world -

includes what Allah will give them in Paradise, such as the palaces, Al-Hur (virgins of Paradise), and His pleasure upon them. He will give them what He has hidden for them of the delight of the eye. He will grant them on top of all of that and even better, the honor of looking at His Noble Face. This is the

increase that is greater than anything that had been given. They will not deserve that because of their deeds, but rather, they will receive it by the grace of Allah and His mercy. The explanation that this refers to looking at Allah's Noble Face was narrated from Abu Bakr, Hudhayfah bin Al-Yaman, Abdullah bin Abbas, Said bin Al-Musayyib, Abdur-Rahman bin Abu Layla, Abdur-Rahman bin Sabit, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Amir bin Sa'ad, Ata, Ad-Dahhak, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Ishaq, and others from the earlier and later scholars. * There are many Hadiths that contain the same interpretation. Among these Hadiths is what Imam

Yunus (27) (Part-11) similar evil, without any increase and will cover them} meaning that their faces will be covered and overtaken by humiliation because of their sins and their fear from these sins. Similarly Allah said: iAnd you will see them brought forward to it, (Hell) made humble by disgrace.^[42:45] He also said: /Ji fc-Z ili at up* 'M 4Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror. (They will be) hastening forward with necks outstretched, their heads raised up (towards the sky).}[14:42 - 43] Allah then said: 4^d "\$ 4No defender will they havefrom Allah.} meaning, there will be no protectors to prevent them from punishment as Allah said: JI^xi> V d iek 40n that Day man will say: "Where (is the refuge) to flee?" No! There is no refuge! Unto your Lord (alone) will be the place ofrest that Day.}[75:10-12] Allah's statement: iTheirfaces will be covered as it were.. .} means that their faces will be dark in the Hereafter. This is similar to His statement: *> >- V ^ /V b*jj" j*> >> x : -it rfc S>>-* <(" ' " fj JJ*' W" yrJ J>~ tyri fJir

596 Tafsir Ibrt Kathir iOn the Day (the Day of Resurrection) when some faces will become white and some faces will become black; as for those whose faces will become black (to them will be said) : "Did you reject faith after accepting it? Then taste the torment (in Hell) for rejecting faith." And for those whose faces will become white, they will be in Allah's mercy (Paradise), therein they shall dwellforever>[3:106-107] He also said: (if ">>- ^ vt-jj -t "> 'V j*-4 -fry. wr iSome faces that Day will be bright, laughing, rejoicing at good news (of Paradise) . And other faces that Day will be dust-stained.\$[80:38-40] ok\$ Y j&Cs (t 4 I'ijSS& pr tf iX ^& ^ k Ji G& c&J 12 J, \$ \% 42S. And the Day whereon We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who did set partners in worship with Us: "Stop at your place! You and your partners." Then We shall separate them, and their partners shall say: "It was not us that you used to worship."} 429. "So sufficient is Allah as a witness between us and you that we indeed knew nothing ofyour worship of us."} 430. There! Every person will know (exactly) what he had earned before and they will be brought back to Allah, their rightful Mawla (Lord), and their invented false deities will vanishfrom them.} The gods of the Idolaters will claim Innocence from them on the Day ofResurrection Allah said: iAnd the Day whereon We shall gather them Allah will gather together all the creatures of earth, human

Yunus (28 - 30) (Part-U) and Jinn, righteous and rebellious. He said in another Ayah: We shall gather them all together so as to leave tiot one of them behind.>(18:47) X jSSfc i i< ii.# *> 4^ien We s/w// say fo those who did associate partners: ",Stop at your place! You and your partners.) He then will command the idolaters to stay where they are and not to move from their destined places so they would be separated from the place of the believers. Similarly, Allah said: 4(11 will be said): "And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day (from the believers).){36:59} Allah also said: 4 fry. fjk '(yfi) 4And on

the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated (the believers will be separated from the disbelievers). [30: 14] In the same Surah, [Ar-Rtim], Allah said: / -J- . V fry? 40n that Day men shall be divided.) [30:43] means, they shall be divided in two. This is what will take place when Allah Almighty will come for Final Judgement. The believers intercede to Allah so the Final Judgement may come and they get rid of that state. The Prophet sg said, s , , , . ^jS fjS (jJ J Oh the Day of Resurrection, we will be in a visible place above the [other] people.^ Allah tells us here what He is going to command the idolators and their idols to do on the Day of Resurrection (J| Ahmad 3 :346.

Yunus (30 - 31) (Part-11) both good and evil. Similarly, Allah said: il&Z 4The Day when all the secrets will be examined.) [86:9], fj* ^ iOn that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward (of deeds), and what he left behind.^ [75:13], and 4;;J^&\$ \jJl" ii; %&> 4...and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring out for him a book which he will find wide open. (It will be said to him): "Read your book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day") (17:13-14] Then Allah said, iand they will be brought back to Allah, their rightful Mawla.) AH affairs and matters will be brought back to Allah, the Judge, the All-Just. He will judge everyone, and then admit the people of Paradise in Paradise and the people of Hell to Hell. 4and will vanish from them) meaning what the idolaters worshipped, iwhat they invented) what they worshipped besides Allah that they invented. 431. Say: "Who provides for you from the sky and the earth? Or who owns hearing and sight? And who brings out the living from the dead and brings out the dead from the living? And

who disposes of the affairs?" They will say: "Allah." Say: "Will you not then be afraid (of Allah's punishment)?" } 432. Such is Allah, your Lord in truth. So after the truth, what else can there be, save error? How then are you turned away? } 433 . Thus is the Word of your Lord justified against those who rebel (disobey Allah), that they will not believe. } The Idolators recognize Allah s Tawhid in Lordship and the Evidence is established against Them through this Recognition. Allah argues that the idolators recognition of Allah s Oneness in Lordship is an evidence against them, for which they should admit and recognize the Oneness in divinity and worship. So Allah said: 4^% 0 4Say: "Who provides for you from the sky and the earth?" } meaning, who is He Who sends down water from the sky and splits the earth with His power and will and allows things to grow from it, * *^&} 4Is there a god, besides Allah? } [27:62] [Who provides;] ijpja Cy 4Grains. And grapes and clover plants. And olives and date palms. And gardens dense with many trees. And fruits and herbage> [80:27-31] 4fay o] tiJji jil; 4"Who is he that can provide for you if He should withhold His provision? } [67:21] Allah s statement,

HCvj|j iOr who owns hearing and sight? } means that Allah is the One who granted you the power of sight and hearing. If He willed otherwise, He would remove these gifts and deprive you of them. Similarly, Allah said: iSay it is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing and seeing. } [67:23] Allah also said: ifA pza 53 ii iSay: "Tell me, if Allah took away your hearing and your sight, } [6:46] Then Allah said: * S*& iAnd who brings out the living from the dead and brings out the dead from the living? } by His great power and grace. s? wi iAnd who disposes of the affairs? } In Whose Hand is the dominion of eveiything? Who protects all, while against Whom there is no protector? Who is the One who judges with none reversing His judgement? Who is the One that is not questioned about what He does while they will be questioned? 4 j* /Wf iWhosoever is in the heavens and on earth begs of Him . Every day He is (engaged) in some affair! } \55:29) The upper and lower kingdoms and what is

in them both, including the angels, humans, and Jinn are in desperate need of Him. They are His servants and are under His control. jJillj} iThey will say: "Allah } they say this knowingly and they

admit it. jfc} iSay: 'Will you not then be afraid (ofAllah's punishment)?' meaning, don t you fear Him when you worship others because ofyour ignorance and false opinions? Allah then said: %& jjS> iSuch is Allah your Lord in truth.} This Lord that you admitted is the One Who does all this, is your Lord and the True Deity that deserves to be worshipped alone. &U\$X 'jZtC} ^So after the truth, what else can there be, save error?} any one worshipped other than Him is false, for there is no God but Allah, He Has no partners. " * 'M 4How then are you turned away?} How then can you turn away from His worship to worship others while you know that He is the Lord that has created eveiything, the One who controls and governs everything? Allah then said: ^} 4Thus is the Word ofyour Lord justified against those who rebel,} These idolators disbelieved and continued to practice their Shirk, and worship others beside Allah. But they knew that He is the Creator, the Sustainer and the only One of authority and control in this universe, the One Who sent His Messengers to single Him out for all worship. As they disbelieved and were persistent in their Shirk, Allah s Word proved true and was justified that they would be miserable inhabitants of the Fire. Allah said: 4They will say: "Yes, but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} [39:71]

Yunus (34 - 36) (Part-11) dSHifi Y 'r ^ 'M OSLA^io opu> (fejyjuuuj -JLp jy_^-jlpLjJSAi" ^i\^l \$?*} ijfakjA^ {j._" . />V, > " >.,^ ^ ..< >.^ - t>^> ~1lh . .Ol(^"IjCO ^&J*&S^y rr^%cr3.> ^ S;j. m!>'C < >* .-<*&"< 'r-f'-i'-vr: ' >-" ? Si ijr ^^ "o; > jfr & i fc y jELt \$fjo^& jis 'f jj2i 4*JI Ji u* iii J _.' --I ., ,1, > o^i; ,>"" i ""i >^t: N * \$ g J &1 H jl # a & ol V'l * VI >#ig c; f #H Ss < v *J6 l[& Uj *k\ o^ lili 4\$j#S . Say: "Is there of your partners one that originates the creation and then repeats it?" Say: "Allah originates the creation and then He repeats it. Then how are you deluded away (from the truth)?" } 435. Say: "Is there of your partners one that guides to the truth?" Say: "It is Allah Who guides to the truth. Is then He Who guides to the truth more worthy to be followed, or he who finds not guidance (himself) unless he is guided? Then, what is the matter with you? How judge you?" } 436. And most of them follow nothing but conjecture. Certainly, conjecture can be of no avail against the truth. Surely, Allah is All-Aware ofwhat they do.} This invalidates and falsifies their claims for committing Shirk with Allah and worshipping different idols and rivals. iks? iSay: "Is there ofyour partners one that originates the creation

and then repeats it?" } meaning, who is the one who started the creation of these heavens and earth and created sill the creatures in them? Who can place the planets and the stars in their positions? Who can then repeat the process of the creation? iSay: "Allah"} It is He Who does this. He does it by Himself, alone without partners. i"Then how are you deluded away (from the truth)?" } How is it that you are so misled from the right path to falsehood? 44 JI Or. & ot j> iSay: "Is there ofyour partners one that guides to the truth?" Say: " It is Allah who guides to the truth.. .} You know that your deities are incapable of guiding those who are astray. It is Allah alone Who guides the misled and confused ones and turns the hearts from the wrong path to the right path. It is Allah, none has the right to be worshipped but He. ^ ^ ifi (ft ^ *** ils then He Who guides to the truth more worthy to be followed, or he who finds not guidance (hitnself) unless he is guided?} Will the servant then follow the one who guides to the truth so that he may see after he was blind, or follow one who doesn t guide to anything except towards

blindness and muteness? Allah said that Ibrahim said: Sfj Vj * C s> 40 my father! Why do you worship that which hears not, sees not and cannot avail you in anything?} (19:42] And said to his people

Yunus (36 - 37 (Part-11 iWorship you that which you (yourselves) carve? While Allah has created you and what you make!} [37: 95-96] Also, there are many Ayat in this regard. Allah then said: iThen, what is the matter with you? How judge you?}

What is the matter with you? What has happened to your

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2475–2494]

mind? How did you make Allah s creatures equal to Him? What kind of judgement did you make to turn away from Allah and worship this or that? Why did you not worship the Lord - Glorified be He, the True King, the Judge and the One Who guides to the truth? Why didn t you call upon Him alone and turn towards Him? Allah then explained that they did not follow their own religion out of evidence and proof. The fact is that they were following mere conjecture and imagination. But conjecture is in no way a substitute for the truth. At the end of this Ayah. He said. 4Allah is All-Aware ofwhat they do.} This is both a threat and a promise of severe punishment. Allah said that He would reward them for their actions with a complete reward. 437. And this Qur'an is not such as could ever be produced by other than Allah but it is a confirmation of (the revelation) which was before it, and a full explanation of the Book - wherein there is no doubt -from the Lord ofall that exists.} 438. Or do they say: "He has forged it?" Say: "Bring then a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you can besides Allah, ifyou are truthful!"} 439. Nay, they have belied the knowledge whereof they could

606 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir not comprehend and what has not yet been fulfilled. Thus those before them did belie. Then see what was the end of the wrongdoers!) 440. And of them there are some who believe therein; and of than there are some who believe not therein, and your Lord is All-Aware of the mischief-makers.) The Qur an is the True, Inimitable Word ofAllah and It is a Miracle The Qur an has a miraculous nature that cannot be imitated. No one can produce anything similar to the Qur an, nor ten Surahs or even one Surah like it. The eloquence, clarity, precision and grace of the Qur an cannot be but from Allah. The great and abundant principles and meanings within the Qur an - which are of great benefit in this world and for the Hereafter - cannot be but from Allah. There is nothing like His High Self and Attributes or like His sayings and actions. Therefore His Words are not like the words of His creatures. This is why Allah said: i&AH o' O'O*"^ ob l*jf iAnd this Qur'an is not such as could ever be produced by other than Allah) meaning, a book like this cannot be but from Allah. This is not similar to the speech uttered by humans. 5 jofZ gfif) ibut it is a confirmation of(the revelation) which was before it,) Such as previous revelations and Books. The Qur an confirms these books and is a witness to them. It shows the changes, perversions and corruption that have taken place within these Books. Then Allah said, iand a full explanation of the Book - wherein there is no doubt - from the Lord of all that exists.) That is, fully and truly explaining and detailing the rules and the lawful and the unlawful. With this complete and more than sufficient explanation, the Qur'an leaves no doubt that it

is from Allah, the Lord of all that exists. Allah says, ft o) U & V JXLX # \f% jiXA j\$b 3 i,j\ >& \$} iOr do they say: "He has forged it? Say: "Bring then a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you

can besides Allah, if you are truthful!" } If you argue, claim and doubt whether this is from Allah then you uttered a lie and blasphemy, and you say it is from Muhammad - Muhammad 3 , however is a man like you, and since he came as you claim with this Qur an - then you produce a Surah like one of its Surahs. Produce something of the same nature and seek help and support with all the power you have from humans and Jinns. This is the third stage, Allah challenged them and called them to produce a counterpart of the Qur an if they were truthful in their claim that it was simply from Muhammad jg. Allah even suggested that they seek help from anyone they chose. But He told them that they would not be able to do it. They would have no way of doing so. Allah said: *jij , 0% v #81 ui jl* i)t ol SJii ^ f} |*T-iSay* : "If the mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur an, they could not produce the like thereof, even if they helped one another." } [17:88] Then He reduced the number for them to ten Surahs similar to it, in the beginning of Surah Hud, Allah said: **"< ojj ot cr4 " yU Ji fly ^ o' iOr* they say, "He forged it." Say: "Bring you then ten forged Surah like unto it, and call whomsoever you can, other tlmn Allah, if you speak the truth! } [11:13] In this Surah He went even further to challenge them to produce only one Surah like unto the Qur an. So He said: *ft oju 4jxx # \pj saX f}*

iOr do they say: "He has forged it?" Say: "Bring that a Surah like unto it, and call upon whomsoever you can besides Allah, if you are truthful!" } (10:38) He also challenged them in Surat Al-Baqarah, a Madinite Surah, to produce one Surah similar to it. He stated in that Surah that they would never be capable of doing so, saying: *ij&i ijiuIS Jj ij&3 iBut* if you do it not, and you can never do it, then fear the Fire (Hell).>[2:24] It should be noted here that eloquence was a part of the nature and character of the Arabs. Arabic poetry including Al- Mu'allaqat - the oldest complete collection of the most eloquent ancient Arabic poems - was considered to be the best in the literary arts. However Allah sent down to them something whose style none were familiar with, and no one is equal in stature to imitate. So those who believed among them, believed because of what they knew and felt in the Book, including its beauty, elegance, benefit, and fluency. They became the most knowledgeable of the Qur an and its best in adhering to it. The same thing happened to the magicians during Fir awn s time. They were knowledgeable of the arts of sorcery, however, when Musa performed his miracles, they knew that it must have come through someone that was supported and guided by Allah. They knew that no human could perform such acts without the permission of Allah. Similarly, isa was sent at the time of scholarly medicine and during the advancement in the treatment of patients. He healed the blind, lepers and raised the dead to life by Allah s leave. What Isa was able to do was such that no form of treatment or medicine could reproduce. As a result, those who believed in him knew that he was Allah s servant and His Messenger. Similarly, in the Sahih, Allah s Messenger jfe said, *ij* jS ^ Ir? \ !>? Is? Iri liu o jl J-jli 5ii oU-jl G-j !Lj\ ^jJi h's i*There was never a Prophet but he was given signs by which the people would recognize him, and that which I was given is

609Surali 10. Yunus (37 - 40) (Part-11 revelation that Allah revealed, so I hope that I will have the most followers among them .n' Allah then said: *Uj ijU)4 j?" ihlay*, they have belied the knowledge whereof they could not comprehend and what has not yet been fulfilled.} They did not believe in the Qur an and they have not yet grasped it or comprehended it. *4 pih. i*Atid what has not yet been fulfilled.} They have not attained the guidance and the true religion. So they belied it out of ignorance and foolishness. *i*Those before them did belie.} meaning, the past nations, *!l i*Theti see what was the end of the wrongdoers!} Look at how we Destroyed them because they denied Our Messengers in their

wickedness, pride, stubbornness and ignorance. So beware you who deny the message that the same end will befall you. Allah's statement, 4- * ji.y> j iAnd of them there are some who believe therein ;} means that among those you were sent to, O Muhammad, are people who will believe in this Qur'an, follow you and benefit from what has been sent to you. 44 V ^&>} iand of them there are some who believe not therein,} but dies as a disbeliever and will be resurrected as such. tiltjj} 4And your Lord is All-Aware of the mischiefmakers.} Al-Bari 8:619.

He best knows those who deserve guidance, so He guides them, and those who deserve to go astray, He allows to go astray. Allah is, however, the Just who is never unjust. He gives everyone what they deserve. All Glory is His, the Exalted. There is no God but He. pj 4& 4S3T&& % SpJ fiZ fa u*^ % i j oJit Jib o' fa> (tyij V ii' ol . And i/ they belie you, say: "For me are my deeds and for you are your deeds! You are innocent of what I do, and I am innocent of what you do!"} 442. And among them are some who listen to you, but can you make the deaf to hear - even though they apprehend not?} 443. And among them are some who look at you, but can you guide the blind - even though they see not?} 444. Truly, Allah wrongs not mankind in aught; but mankind wrong themselves.} imaz TU ^ ^-5 / , * . > /f < / sSS \ ^ ^ >< "*" > .< uMiP0

The Command to be Free and Clear from the Idolaters Allah said to His Prophet jg: If these idolaters belie you, then be clear from them and their deeds. iSay: "For me are my deeds and far you are your deeds! } Similarly, Allah said: iSay: "O you disbelievers! I worship not that which you worship."^[109:1-2] to the end of the Surah. Ibrahim Al-Khalil (the Friend) and his followers said to the idolaters among their people: y_H Ji 6/iL "SL. } iVerily, we are free from you and whatever you worship besides Allah} [60:4] Allah then said: 4And among them are some who listen to you,} They listen to your beautiful talk and to the Glorious Qur'an. They listen to your truthful, eloquent and authentic Hadiths that are useful to the hearts, the bodies and their faith. This is indeed a great benefit and is sufficient. But guiding the people to the truth is not up to you or to them. You cannot make the deaf hear. Therefore you cannot guide these people except if Allah wishes. iAnd among them are some who look at you,} They look at you and at what Allah has given you in terms of dignity, noble personality and great conduct. There is in all of this clear evidence of your prophethood to those who have reason and insight. Other people also look but they do not receive guidance like them. Believers look at you with respect and dignity while disbelievers regard you with contempt. 4h>-* yi lijl ify}

4And when they see you, they treat you only in mockery.)[25:41] Then Allah announces that He is never unjust with anyone. He guides whomever He wills and opens the eyes of the blind, makes the deaf hear and removes neglect from the hearts. At the same time He lets others go astray, moving away from faith. He does all of that yet He is always Just, for He is the Ruler and has full authority over His kingdom. He does whatever He wills without any restrictions. No one can question Him as to what He does while he will question everyone else. He is Omniscient, All-Wise, and All-Just. So Allah said: s Wo& v ith) iTruly, Allah wrongs not mankind in aught; but mankind wrong themselves.) In the Hadith narrated by Abu Dharr, he states that the Prophet related that His Lord, Exalted and High is He, said: ^ ^ Ji pwi JI l&b V "O My servant! I have prohibited oppression for Myself and made it prohibited for you, so do not oppress one another..." Until He said at the end of the Hadith: \js- XZ-j clftljJ (J ^ t'cjc V l Jib "O My servants! It is but your deeds that I reckon for you and then recompense you for. So let him who

finds good (in the Hereafter) praise Allah. And let him who finds other than that blame no one but himself.",1! The complete version was recorded by Muslim. ^& tjar yt ^ sc, \js }\$ & 445. And on the Day when He shall gather them together, (it will be) its if they had not stayed (in the life of this world and I 1 * Muslim 4 :1994.

graves) but an hour of a day. They will recognize each other. Ruined indeed will be those who denied the meeting with Allah and were not guided.> The Feeling of Brevity toward the Worldly Life at the Gathering on the Day of Resurrection To remind people of the establishment of the Hour and their resurrection from their graves to the gathering for the Day of Judgment, Allah says: 4And on the Day when He shall gather (resurrect) them.} Similarly Allah said: 4On the Day when they will see that (torment) with which they are promised (threatened, it will be) as if they had not stayed more twn an hour in a sitgle day.>[46:35] Allah also said: iThe Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning.} [79:46] (-^ ihj*i j] OjIjii tL j&1 4The Day when the Trumpet will be blown (the second blowing) : that Day, We shall gather the criminals, blue eyed. They will speak in a very low voice to each other (saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten (days)." We know very well what they will say, when the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day!"} [20:102-104] and. ti\ ft** ffJT iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, the criminals will swear that they stayed not but an hour.>[30:55] These all are evidence of the brevity of the worldly life

compared to the Hereafter. Allah said: f ly> btJ yii J-1-* - ufj^ pi ^ j *i V 1 0> 4He (Allah) will say: "What number of years did you stay on earth? They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account." He (Allah) will say: "You stayed not but a little, if you had only known!"} [23:112-124] Alldh then said: 4pr5 iThey will recognize each other} The children will know their parents and relatives will recognize one another. They will know them just like they used to know them during the life in this world. However, on that Day everyone will be busy with himself. Allah then said: iThen, when the Trumpet is blown , there will be no kinship among f/iem.\$>[23:101] Allah also said: Xf 4 4And no friend will ask a friend (about his condition) .}[70:10] Allah then said: '- j\$ &k &} iRuined indeed will be those who denied the meeting with Allah and were not guided.} This is similar to the Ayah: 4Woe that Day to the deniers.}[77:15] Woe to them because they will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. That is indeed the great loss. There is no loss greater than the loss of one who will be taken away from his dear ones on the Day of Grief and Regret. *& -v r

. Whether We show you some of what We promise them (the torment), or We cause you to die - still unto Us is their return, and moreover Allah is Witness over what they used to do.} 447. And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes, the matter will be judged between them with justice, and they will not be wronged.} The Criminals will certainly be avenged - whether in This World or in the Hereafter Allah said to His Messenger 0/. ^)j} 4Whether We show you some of what We promise them (the torment),} We shall avenge them in your lifetime so your eye will be delighted. 4Or We cause you to die - still unto Us is their return,} Allah will then be the Witness watching over their actions for you. Allah then said, 4And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes,} Mujahid said: This will be on the Day of Resurrection.' ithe matter will be judged

between them with justice,} is similar to the Ayah: iAnd the earth ivill shine with the light of its Lord (Allah),} [39:69] (il Al-Tabari 15:99.

So every nation will be presented before Allah in the presence of its Messenger and the Book of its deeds. All good and evil deeds will be witnessed upon them. Their guardian angels will be witnesses too. The nations will be brought forth, one by one. Our noble Ummah, while it is the last of the nations, is the first one on the Day of Resurrection to be questioned and judged. This was stated by Allah s Messenger ^ in a Hadxth recorded by both Al-Bukhari and Muslim. Allah s Messenger afe said: "We are the last, the first on the Day ofResurrection . We will be judged before the rest of the creatures ." [I1 His Ummah attains the honor of precedence only by the honor of its Messenger jg, may Allah s peace and blesings be upon him forever, until the Day ofJudgement. Ji l&liiyjjC-J Vj *e\h l1 it lj[J"3 jil ill! jLi 'Jr. 4 c ill \$ J- Ilu ui / / < ^ // " > " <" **S ^V "J/ L*j oj^ (J-* Ijijj uyJJ j 448. And they say: "When will be this promise (the torment or the Day ofResurrection) , ifyou speak the truth?"} 449. Say: "I have no power over any harm or profitfor myself except wltat Allah may will. For every Ummah, there is a term appointed; when their term comes, neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment). } 450. Say: "Tell me, if His torment should come to you by night or by day, which portion thereof would the criminals hasten on? } 451. Is it then that when it has actually befallen, you will believe in it? What! Now (you believe)? And you used (aforetime) to hasten it on!"} Fath Al-Bari 6 : 595 , and Muslim 2 :585

Yunus (48 - 52) (Part-11 452. Then it will be said to them who wronged themselves: "Taste you the everlasting torment! Are you recompensed (aught) save what you used to earn?"} The Deniers of the Day ofResurrection wish to hasten itsComing and their Response Allah told us about the idolaters who reject faith through their demand that the punishment be hastened, inquiring about the time of punishment. The response to such question is not inherently beneficial, yet they inquired anyway. Allah said: iTlwse who believe not therein seek to hasten it, while those who believe are fearful of it, and know that it is the very truth.} [42:18] They know that it is the truth for it is definitely going to happen. It is going to take place even if they have no idea when it will occur. This is why Allah instructed His Messenger jg to answer them saying: % \% y \$} \$Say : "I have no power over any harm or profit to myself."} [10:49, 7:188] I will not say except what He has taught me. I also have no authority over anything that Allah has not shown to me. I am Allah s servant and His Messenger to you. I was told that the Hour is going to come, but He has not told me when it will occur. But, ^&} iFor every Utnmah, there is a term appointed;} meaning that for every generation or community there is a set term appointed for them. When the end of that term approaches, ;neither can they delay it nor can they advance it an hour (or a moment).}

Yunus (53 - 54) (Part-11) J) ii"is "< assas A"f3*\$iA&S Si*^a^S"Sk ifiiiittSMJ&tf0'oJZ . *r-" . -5f y* + * . \$ 5 at 477ie Day w/en they will be pushed down by force to the fire of Hell, with a horrible, forceful pushing. This is the Fire that you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste you therein its heat and whether you are patient of it or im- patient of it, it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you used to do.} [52:13-16) 4 \$ %& o } \ 4 cJ&i yyi y ji> scat 4 oxiv 4* \$i53i lit; a' 4^ . . And they ask you to inform them (saying): "Is it true?" Say : "Yes! By my Lord! It is the very truth! And you cannot escape it!"} 454. And if every person who had wronged, possessed all that is on the earth and

sought to ransom himself therewith (it will not be accepted), and they would feel in their hearts regret when they see the torment, and they will be judged with justice, and no wrong will be done unto them.} The Resurrection is Real Allah said that they ask you to inform them (saying):

Yunus (55 - 58) (Part-11) belongs to Allah. No doubt, surely, Allah's promise is true. But most of them know not.} 456. It is He Who gives life, and causes death, and to Him you (all) shall return.} Allah is the Owner of the heavens and earth. His promise is true and is indeed going to be fulfilled. He is the One Who gives life and causes death. To Him is the return of everyone, and He is the One who has the power over that, and the One Who knows everything about every creature; its deterioration, and where every speck of it has gone, be it land, oceans or otherwise. 4 d tSij fij a; fi-K % j.m \$ > Y * ^ o' > <. * +
 ""// if 457. O mankind! There has come to you good advice from your Lord, and a cure for that which is in your breasts, - a guidance and a mercy for the believers.} 458. Say: "In the bounty of Allah, and in His mercy; therein let them rejoice." That is better than what (the wealth) they amass.} The Qur'an is an Admonition, Cure, Mercy and Guidance Allah confers a great favor on His creatures in what He has sent down of the Gracious Qur'an to His Noble Messenger He said: It diftp , 3fC d J-di \$ } 40 mankind! There has come to you good advice from your Lord.} A warning and a shield from shameful deeds. 4j/ x^ 4 d, & } 4 and a cure for that which is in your breasts,} A cure from suspicion and doubts. The Qur'an removes all the filth and Shirk from the hearts. 4a guidance and a mercy} The guidance and the mercy from

Yunus (59 - 60) (Part-11) bin Zayd bin Aslam and others said: This Ayah was revealed to criticize the idolaters for what they used to make lawful and unlawful. Like the Bahirah J * Sd ibah^ and WasUah. ^ As Allah said: ^ JI , * ^ y * Iji U-j 4Ami they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. \$[6:136] Imam

What Allah has given you is lawful. Allah's Forearm is stronger than your forearm, and Allah's knife is sharper than your knife And he mentioned the Hadith in its complete form, and the chain for this Hadith is a strong, good chain. Allah criticized those who make lawful what Allah has made unlawful or vice versa. This is because they are based on mere desires and false opinions that are not supported with evidence or proof. Allah then warned them with a promise of

the Day of Resurrection. He asked:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2494–2538]

{And what think those who invent a lie against Allah, on the Day of Resurrection?} What do they think will happen to them when they return Us on the Day of Resurrection? Ibn Jarir said that Ally's statement: {Truly, Allah is full of bounty to mankind,} indicated that the bounty is in postponing their Punishment in this world. 121 I (Ibn Kathir) say, the meaning could be that the Grace for people is in the good benefits that He made permissible for them in this world or in their r^jjgjon also has not prohibited them except what is haj^il to them in their world and the Hereafter. i&z J {but most of them are ungrateful.} So they/prohibited what Allah has bestowed upon them and made it ^ narrow upon themselves. They made some thing lawful and others unlawful. The idolaters committed these actions when they set laws for themselves. And so did the R le Qf the Book when they invented innovations in

their relief 77 On. &JT- 'll ii, iji2 Cj 4 ojfe cr- 4 V_> J?ji\ ,) yji ffyJ 111 Afimad 3:473, 4:136. At-Jabari 15:113. . M & V>*i M

461 . Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, but We are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord (so much as) the weight of a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not what is less than that or what is greater than that but is (written) in a Clear Record.} Everything Small or Large is within the Knowledge of Allah Allah informed His Prophet jfe that He knows and is well acquainted with all of the affairs and conditions of him and his Ummah and all of creation and its creatures at all times - during every hour and second. Nothing slips or escapes from His knowledge and observation, not even anything the weight of a speck of dust within the heavens or earth, or anything that is smaller or larger than that. Everything is in a manifest Book, as Allah said: . <" .M *- v. 4And with Him are the keys of the Ghayb (all that is hidden and unseen), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is in the land and in the sea; not a leaf falls, but He knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.>(6:59) He stated that He is Well-Aware of the movement of the trees and other inanimate objects. He is also Well-Aware of all grazing beasts. He said: ft% 4 >> o;O iThere is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are communities like you.} (6:38) He also said: uj"jV> 4 4And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due

Jr rn Ejv , !&&&&&0ju %\$%^d AdSffi0isflyzity JofjVf> (j*J iui> mm3 %^from Alldh.}(U:6) If this is His knowledge of the movement of these things, then what about His knowledge of the movement of the creatures that are commanded to worship Him? Allah said: t /{*// .o, > ^ IffippiS cfj)t 4And puf your irusf in file Almighty, the Most Merciful, Who sees you when you stand up, and your movements among those who fall prostrate>(26:217-219) That is why Allah said: i[IjjJi (jii i sjtwu 1?) ji ii. ijb dj tj 0 . < > .4 4Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, nor you do any deed, butWe are Witness thereofwhen you are doing it.} meaning, *We are watching and hearing you when you engage in that thing. When Jibril asked the Prophet jg about Ihsan, he said: oly |"J Oii ^U^ ill JuiJ of "Jf is that you worship Allah as if you are seeing Him. But since you do not see Him, be certain that He is watching you." f| Muslim 1 :37

-j Jii ibji Ol 5j2t viN jj V J^ST 05 iS? ^ . Behold! The Awliyd' of Allah, no fear shall come upon them nor shall they grieve 463. Those who believed, and have Taqwa.} 464. For them is good news, in the life of the present world, and in the Hereafter. No change can there be in the Words of Allah. This is indeed the supreme success> Identifyingthe Awliyd* ofAllah Allah tells us that His Awliya (friends and allies) are those who believe and have Taqwa of Allah as He defined them. Every pious. God-fearing person is a friend of Allah, therefore, 4-0 ino fear shall come upon them\$ from the future horrors they will face in the Hereafter. inor shall they grieve over anything left behind in this world. Ibn Jarir recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Allah s Messenger said: tdti i ^Li; iSc* "ii jeW Among the servants of Allah there will be those whom the Prophets and the martyrs will considerfortunate". It was said: Who are these, O Messenger of Allah, so we may love them? He said: he ij* jj J'3^ ff hi Jt fj* p-6 ^iUl lij IS) jjiUw N "jji "These are people who loved one another for the sake of Allah without any other interest like money or kinship. Their faces will be light, upon platforms of light. They shall have no fear (on that Day) when fear shall come upon people. Nor shall they

grieve when others grieve." Then he recited: ,\T , (*% - "3 *i' "t!j' iBehold!! Verily, the Awliyd' (friends and allies) of Allah, no fear shall come upon them nor shall they grieve.}^ The True Dream is a Form of Good News Ibn Jarir narrated from Tjbadah bin As-Samit that he [recited] to Allah s Messenger jg: iiU^ CSif 4 #31W iFor them is good news, in the life of the present world, and in the Hereafter.} [and said,] We know the good news of the Hereafter, it is Paradise. But what is the good news in this world? He said: S' l*A ifi *A -J iS~y ***!' - 'Si tS'Jl 8 jjr 1 ' Cri KA AaA *It is the good dream that a servant may see or it is seen about him. This dream is one part from forty-four or seventy parts of Prophethood .'" Imam

Yunus (62 - 64) (Part-11) he said. O ^ Jr 5*^5 04 tye 04. * * jh jUa-^J l y> UJ)i "ilJS ijf i 1\$ j ^~*Uls liiJi 4I) l^j j~ Vj I'jjQj i ;jLU (^p uThe good dream that comes as a good news for the believer is a part of forty-nine parts of prophethood . So if anyone of you has a good dream, he should narrate it to others. But if he has a dream that he dislikes, then it is from Shaytan to make him sad. He should blow to his left three times, and say : "Allahu Akbar," and should not mention it to anyone."s And it was also said, The good news here is the glad tidings the angels bring to the believer at the time of death. They bring him the good news of Paradise and forgiveness. Similarly, Allah said: UP% \j& p3 & Vj* i+j 'Spj zjfZJz u ppj iVerily, those who say: Our Lord is Allah (alone)," and then they stand straight and firm, on them the angels will descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the glad tidings of Paradise which you have been promised! We have been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. Therein you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and therein you shall have (all) for which you ask. An entertainment from (Allah), the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful/> (41:30-32) In the Hadith narrated by Al-Bara , the Prophet 3g said: : lyiii o*?. ISI jl St &*** OUi* fi- *- oUJjj cLj! j*J KgS When death approaches the believer, angels with white faces (M Ahmad 5 :219.

and white clothes come to him and say: "O good soul! Come out to comfort and provision and a Lord who is not angry." The soul then comes out of his mouth like a drop of water pouring out of a water skinM Their good news in the Hereafter is as Allah said: iThe greatest terror (on the Day of Resurrection) will not grieve them, and the angels will meet them, (with the greeting:) "This is your Day which you were promised."} (21:103), and. V? 6 & fir' >*r*dy rpjV 'Aj {J.Y 2&& fe U ~ 'Jr\$ f.'Ax iOn the Day you shall see the believing men and the believing women - their light running forward before them and by their right hands. Glad tidings for you this Day! Gardens under which rivers flow (Paradise), to dwell therein forever! Truly, this is the great success!}[57:12) Allah then said: 4No change can there be in the Words of Allah.} meaning, this promise doesn't change or breach or fall short. It is decreed and firm, and going to happen undoubtedly. iThis is indeed the supreme success.} P A ^ 'Jh CL *. A A PPP ^j} Oi CjM Jj- 5! bj OfjVt^ CA) ^ i =a&p& 45 a u* v. 4%90& k jV&i 4:287.

Yunus (65 - 67) -11 4.65. Do not grieve over their speech, for all power and honor belong to Allah. He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} 466. Behold! Verily, to Allah belongs whosoever is in the heavens and whosoever is in the earth. And those who worship and invoke others besides Allah, in fact they fallow not the partners, they fallow only a conjecture and they do nothing but lie.} 467. He it is Who has appointed for you the night that you may rest therein, and the day to make things visible (to you). Verily, in this are Ayatfar a people who listen (those who think deeply).} All Might and Honor is for Allah He Alone has Full Authority within the Universe Allah said to His Messenger jg, 4-&&A %} 4Do

not grave} because of the remarks of these idolaters, and depend on Allah and ask for His help. Put your trust in Him. 41 3j*Jl 4For all power and honor belong to Allah.} All might and honor belong to Him, His Messenger jg and the believers. 4*f&yzx& 4He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower.} He hears the utterances of His servants and knows their affairs. Allah then stated that to Him is the dominion of the heavens and earth. But the idolaters worship idols, that own nothing and can neither harm nor benefit anyone. They have no evidence to base their worship on them. They only follow their own conjecture, lies, and ultimately - falsehood. Allah then informed us that He is the One Who made the night for His servants to rest therein from weariness and exhaustion. 4And the day to make things visible (to you).} bright and clear for them to seek livelihood and to travel to

fulfill their needs. 2 j'A9\$MA k iVerily, in this are Ayat for a people who listen. Those who hear these proofs and take a lesson from them. These Ayat can lead them to realize the greatness of their Creator and Sustainer. 4 ta&ft j, uj^ o. c & a &&& 0\$ \$ \$\$\$&\$ 'j &A < >)}& oj < *"" C,\X& i&J 2 fa? J> - is n if .If j5)i 4 V c U & 4:kUf , 468. They say: Allah has begotten a son." Glory is to Him! He is Rich (free of all needs). His is all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth. No warrant have you for this. Do you say against Allah what you know not> 469. Say: Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah will never be successful."} 470. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} Allah is FarAbove taking a Wife or having Children Allah criticizes those who claim that He has, 4 ...begotten a son. Glory is to Him! He is Rich (Free of all needs).} He is Greater than that and above it. He is Self-Sufficient, free of want or need of anything. Everything else is in desperate need of Him, 4UoV" 4 u; vyli)' ^_X 4His is all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth.} So how can He have a son from what He has created? Everything and everyone belongs to Him and is His servant. 4'H g&L oj , ="xe 4^

Yunus (68 - 70) (Part-11) 4No warrant have you for this Meaning, you have no proof for the lies and falsehood that you claim, V C jj! Je 4Do you say against Allah wltw you know not.} This is a severe threat and a firm warning. Similarly, Allah threatened and said: iij oj jtiZj llli aSI 'a.\s iyfjf JLici iii J ujJu ty J JOl Jjtfj Jvjtj |Uj*j 4iJ 41. 4 6* >^ ,.V,Ulj jjliil' jyj 44C SvtiS 4A"d they say: "The Most Gracious has begotten a son." Indeed you have brought forth a terribly evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins, tlmt they ascribe a son to the Most Gracious. But it is not suitable for the Most Gracious that He should beget a son . There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Gracious as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has counted them a full counting. And everyone of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection.} (19:88-95) Then Allah warned the liars that fabricated the claim that He has begotten a son. He warned that they will not succeed, never prospering in this world or in the Hereafter. In this world Allah will lead them, step-by-step, to their ruin. He will give them respite and put up with them for a while. He will allow them to have little enjoyment, ft 4then in the end We shall oblige them to (enter) a great torment.>(31:24) As Allah said here: 4(A brief) enjoyment in this world!} meaning, only a short period,

tw{Jj iiSiKa djJ^iJ} iiZ *J) ji ^ illr^'^j^l < _<< *> ** ". >*' //>'.<">#?^ >-" fl UU^UQjul(j. 4^j^j^iij>.Os3 < t ^ -5 *^f ^- *j>\yKj ^j^t*joy-jk Jj=Jjo_>! J'i 4fi^ 4"nd tfien unto Us will be their return} on the Day of Resurrection; s* Z&& Z&J % 4s& ij^=" iij iThen We shall make them taste the

severest torment because they used to disbelieve.} meaning, We shall make them taste the painful punishment because of their Kufr and lies about Allah. 3s gy W '%&\$. Jjb. & 0 jfe ^ jS cj>#* " Jba ^Jj 4 a&3 v; cii ! a2& j_J' >-a^ - 4 o*j *j!^" vie 4' cJ 4f:43^ at j^t ^"s^ liss 472. And recite to them the news ofNiih. When he said to his people: "O my people , if my stay (with you), and my reminding (you) of the Aydt ofAllah is hard on you, then I put my trust in Allah . So devise your plot, you and your partners, and let not your plot be in confusion for you. Then pass your sentence on me and give me no respite.} 472. "But if you turn away, then no reward have I asked of you, my reward is only from All&h, and I have been commanded to be of the Muslims."}

Yunus (71 - 73) (Part-11) 473. They denied him, but We delivered him, and those with him in the ship, and We made them generations, replacing one after another, while We drowned those who belied Our Ayat. Then see what was the end of those who were warned.} The Story ofNuh and His People Allah instructed His Prophet jgjij, saying: 4And recite to them} relate to the disbelievers of the Quraysh who belied you and rejected you, 4the news ofNuh} meaning, his story and news with his people who belied him. Tell them how Allah destroyed them and caused every last one ofthem all to drown. Let this be a lesson for your people, lest they will be destroyed like them. 4When he said to his people : "O my people, ifmy stay (with you), and my reminding (you) of the Ayat ofAllah is hard on you, then I put my trust in Allah."} Meaning, If you find that it is too much of an offense that I should live among you and preach to you the revelation of Allah and His signs and proofs, then I do not care what you think, and I will not stop inviting you. devise your plot, you and your partners}, get together with all ofyour deities (idols and statues) thatyou callupon beside Allah, 4and let not your plot be in confusion for you} meaning, an d do not be confused about this, rather come and let us settle this together ifyou claim thatyou are truthful, 4i> & 4and give me no respite.} T)o not give me respite even for one hour. Whatever you can do, go ahead and do it. I do not care, and 1 do not fear you, because you are not standing on

i: Jtj% % \$\$p m 6' 4When his Lord said to him, "Submit (be a Muslim)!" He said, I have submitted myself (as a Muslim) to the Lord of all that exists." And this was enjoined by Ibrahim upon his sons and by Ya'qub (saying), "O my sons! Allah has chosen far you the (true) religion, then die not except as Muslims."^(2:131- 132) Yusuf said: \$My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Guardian in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim, and join me with the righteous.^{12:101) MQsa said: Cj[pC p' 4 40 my people! If you have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him ifyou are Muslims. 10:84) The magicians said: iyj !/L4 UJe yS iOur Lord! pour out on us patience, and cause us to die as Muslims.>(7:126) Bilqls said: iMy Lord! Verily, I have wronged myself, and I submit (I have become Muslim) together with Sulayman to Allah, the Lord of all that exists (27:44) Allah said: 41 bM ^ bj 4Verily, We did send down the Tawrdh, therein was guidance and light, by which the Prophets, judgedfar the Jews.>(5:44)

Tafkir Ibn Kathir He also said: ^ ^ ti2C\$8 -i & t0**^ iAni when 1 (Allah) inspired Al-Hawdriyyln to believe in Me and My Messenger, they said: We believe. And bear whness that we are Muslims. } (5:11 1) The lastofthe Messengers and the leader ofmankind 3g said: \$\$ Ja;ls 5 4r ^ k 4Verily, mu Saldh, my sacrifice, my living, and my dying are for Allah, the Lord of all that exists. He has no partner. And of

this I have been commanded, and I am the first of the Muslims.} (6:162-163) meaning, from this Ummah. He & said, in an authentic HadUh. .1.13 & ^ "We, the Prophets are brothers with (the same father but) different mothers. Our religion is the same, meaning, we should worship Allah alone without partners while having different laws. The Evil GoalandEnd ofCriminals Allah said: iThey denied him, but \Ne delivered him, and those with him} meaning on his religion, iin the (Fulk) ship } Fulk refers to the ark, and, &&>} made them generations replacing one after another} on earth, U Al-Bari6 :550

Sarah 10. Yunus (73 - 74) (Part-11) 639 Awhile We drowned those who belied OurAyat. Then see what was the end of those who were warned.} meaning O Muhammad, see how We saved the believers and destroyed the deniers! ui lAiiCJ, is? ^ j+%S Ot bS"! 474. Then after him We sent Messengers to their people. They brought them clear proofs, but they would not believe what they had already rejected beforehand. Thus We seal the hearts of the transgressors.} Meaning; Then after Nuh We sent Messengers to their people. They brought them clear proofs, and evidences of the truth that they came with. 4But they would not believe what they had already rejected beforehand} meaning the nations did not believe what their Messengers brought to them because they already rejected it from the beginning. Allah said: i&a,#4 4And We shall turn their hearts and their eyes away (from guidance).} (6:110) He then said here, 4Thus We seal the hearts of the transgressors.} This means that as Allah has set seals on the hearts of those people, such that they would not believe since they previously rejected faith, He would also set seals on the hearts of the people that are like them, who will come after them. They would not believe until they see the severe torment. This means that Allah destroyed the nations after NOh. He destroyed the nations that rejected the Messengers and saved those who believed from among them. From the time of Adam to Nfth, people followed Islam. Then they invented the worship of idols. So Allah sent NUh to them. That is why the believers will say to him on the Day of

Resurrection, You are the first Messenger Allah sent to the people of the earth. Ibn Abbas said: There were ten generations between Adam and Nuh, and all of them were following Islam. 111 Allah also said: 4Andhow many generations haveWe destroyed afterNuh!) (17: 17) This was a serious warning to the Arab pagans, who rejected the leader and last of the Messengers and Prophets. If the people before them who rejected their Messengers had received this much punishment, then what did they think will happen to them since they perpetrated even greater sins than others before them? ' / -5 *- * f l"j5 i ji Jli UC* o) ijlli Coifr ,3"jt ftStr ilU fcfr:& os& & *S %& Q 4 & aj j 475. Then after them We sent Musa and Harun to Fir'awn and his chiefs with Our Aydt. But they behaved arrogantly and were a people who were criminals .) 476. So when came to them the truth from Us, they said: "This is indeed clear magic.") 477 . Musa said: "Say you (this) about the truth when it has come to you? Is this magic? But the magicians will never be successful.") 478. They said: "Have you come to us to turn us away from that wefound ourfathersfollowing, and that you two may have greatness in the land? We are not going to believe you two!) The Story ofMusa and Fira wn Allah said: 4Then after them We sent) meaning ofter these Messengers, Al-Bidayah wan-Nih&yah 1:101, and he said , "

642 Tafstr Ibn Kathir i...in the land, We are not going to believe you two!"} . 1333 JjI t \$1 * U fry jis ij\$ / Sat ij| ol a% V^=* *#~^ { . 40^r 479. And Fir'awn said: "Bring me every well- versed sorcerer." 180. And when the sorcerers came, Musa said to them : "Cast down what you want to cast!"} 181 . Then when they had cast down, Musa said: "What you have brought is sorcery, Allah will surely make

it of no effect. Verily, Allah does not set right the work of the evildoers.} i82. "And Allah will establish and make apparent the truth by His Words, however much the criminals may hate (it)."} Between Musa and the Magicians Allah mentioned the story of the magicians and MQsa in Surat Al-A'raf (there is a commentary on it in that Surah), this Surah, Surat Ta Ha, and in Surat Ash-Shu'ara Fir'awn, may Allah s curse be upon him, wanted to deceive the people and impress them with the tricks of the magicians in direct opposition to the plain truth that MUsa brought. The result was the exact opposite and he therefore didn't attain his goal. The signs of the Lord prevailed in that public festival. j* j, JU lytillij ffrj*! Js &&*&&&&0

4 lyy yjl 4i4"d the sorcerers fell down prostrate. They said : We believe in the Lord of all that exists - the Lord of Musa and Hdrun."}(7:120-122) Fir'awn thought that he would achieve victory through the magicians over the Messenger sent by Allah, the All-Knower of all hidden things. But he failed, lost Paradise and was deserving of the Hellfire. C Iry cffi <^ ^ Fir'awn said: Bring me every well-versed sorcerer." And when the sorcerers came, Musa said to them : Cast down what you want to cast! } They stood in line after they received the promise of Fir'awn to become closer to him and obtain a generous reward. Musa wanted them to begin. He wanted the people to see what the magicians had made, then he would come with the truth after that to triumph over their falsehood. 41 Ji d !> Jj' J & J Cl iThey said: O Musa! Either you throw first or we be the first to throw?" [Musa] said : Nay, throw you (first)!" } When the magicians cast their spells they bewitched the eyes of the people through their display of mighty sorcery. At that time, ^ tii ***? -4 *> jtr*. C cd iift. & VJ \ , Uj '&> C m 4Musd conceived fear in himself. We (Allah) said: Fear not! Surely, you will have the upper hand. And throw that which is in your right hand! It will swallow up that which they have made. That which they have made is only a magician's trick, and the magician will never be successful, to whatever amount (of skill) he may attain. } (20:67-69) Upon that, Musa said:

644 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4What you have brought is sorcery, Allah will surely make it of no effect. Verily, Allah does not set right the work of the evildoers. And Allah will establish and make apparent the truth by His Words, however much the criminals may hate (it).} lfs Xfek J X+fe'j oi Jy oi S* . But none believed in Musa except the offspring of his people, because of the fear of Fir'awn and his chiefs, lest they should persecute them; and verily, Fir'awn was an arrogant tyrant on the earth, he was indeed one of the transgressors.} Only a Few Youth from Fir'awn's People believed in Musa Allah tells us that despite all the clear signs and irrefutable evidence Musa came with, only a few offspring from Fir'awn's followers believed in him. They were even scared that Fir'awn and his followers would force them to return to Kufr (disbelief). Fir'awn was an evil tyrant and extremely arrogant. His people feared him and his power too much. Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: a y>- 3* **!> oi 'Jl o*' ^ } 4But none believed in Musa except the offspring of his people because of the fear of Fir'awn and his chiefs, lest they should persecute them.} The offspring that believed in Musa from Fir'awn's people, other than Banu Israel, were few. Among them were Fir'awn's wife, the believer who was hiding his faith, Fir'awn's treasurer, and his wife. The Children of Israel, however, themselves believed in Musa, all of them. They were glad to see him coming. They knew of his description and the news of his advent from their previous Books. They knew that Allah was going to save them through IM At-Tabari 15:164.

him from the capture of Fir'awn and give them power over him. So when this knowledge reached Fir'awn he was very wary. But his caution and weariness didn't help him one bit. When Musa arrived, Fir'awn subjected them to great harm, and ^M 4 They said: "We (Children of Israel) suffered troubles before you came to us, and since you have come to us." He said: "It may be that your Lord will destroy your enemy and make you successors on the earth, so that He may see how you flcf?>[7:129] The fact that all of the Children of Israel became believers is evidenced by the following Ayat. ft<> ft 4& &s Ujj 484. And Musa said: "O my people! If you have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him if you are Muslims."} 485. They said: "In Allah we put our trust. Our Lord! Make us not a trial for the folk who are wrongdoers."} 486. "And save us by Your mercy from the disbelieving folk."} Musa encouraged His People to put Their Trust in Allah Allah told us that Milsa said to the Children of Israel: 4o^ ft oi & ft\ : ft 4 40 my people! If you have believed in Allah, then put your trust in Him if you are Muslims.} Allah is sufficient for those who put their trust in Him. 4fe^ J\$} 4Is not Allah sufficient for His servant?}(39:36) 4fc#& & } 4And whosoever puts his trust in Allah, then He will suffice him.}(65:3) Allah combines worship and reliance in many places. He said:

646 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4So worship Him and put your trust in Him.^ (11:123) iSay: "He is the Most Gracious (Allah), in Him we believe, and in Him we put our trust..>(67:29) and :i|s % i[ai v *a5(He a/ one is) the Lord of the east and the west; none has the right to be worshipped but He. So take Him (alone) as a protector.>(73:9) And Allah commanded the believers to say many times in their Salah _j JL-jo jlljtYou (Alone) we worship, and You (Alone) we ask for help (for each and everything).^ (1:5) The Children of Israel complied with this command and said: 4J&, 'J Cj \$ } iln Allah we put our trust. Our Lord! Make us not a trial for the folk who are wrongdoers.} This means don't give them victory over us so that they rule us. So they might not think that they have authority over us because they were following the truth and we were falsehood. This might be a deceiving trial for them. This meaning was reported from Abu Mijliz and Abu Ad-Duha, 111 Abdur-Razzaq, in a narration from Mujahid, said, ? 4& iiOSH > iOur Lord! Make us not a trial for the folk who are wrongdoers} meaning, Do not give them authority over us so they might make us fall into Fitnah. 12 Allah's statement: Tabari 15:169. Abdur-Razzaq 2 :297

{And save us by Your mercy} means save us through Your mercy and beneficence ifrom the disbelieving folk.} meaning, from those who denied the truth and covered it. We truly have believed in You and put our trust in You. tjLiir . And We revealed to Musa and his brother (saying): "Provide dwellings for your people in Egypt, and make your dwellings as places for your worship, and perform the Saldh, and give glad tidings to the believers."} They were commanded to pray inside Their Homes Allah tells us why He saved the Children of Israel from Fir'awn and his people. He tells us how he saved them. Allah commanded Mtsa and his brother HarQn to take houses for their people in Egypt, iand make your dwellings as places for your worship,} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, while interpreting this Ayah: The Children of Israel said to MQsa, We cannot offer our prayers in public in front of Fir'awn's people. So Allah permitted them to pray in their houses. They were commanded to build their houses in the direction of the Qiblah. Mujahid commented, iUfMS!"> iand make your dwellings as places for your worship,} When Banu Israel feared that Fir'awn might kill them in their gatherings at their temples, they were commanded to take their houses as places of worship. The houses

should be facing the Qiblah and the prayer could be in secret. 121 This was stated by Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak as well.131Tabari 15:174. 121 Ibid.Tabari 15:173.

6M Tafstr Ibn Kathir - / > < ". * J > * y Vy ? o Ui % #' Tje Gj liljpp "i* - jit G js .^jjVf v'ii' j Vj U -ji . 'j L^ - ^jjcj . ~ * ..wt V <<# \$ & X '* & - * i 488. And Musa said: Our Lord! You have indeed bestowed on Fir'awn and his chiefs splendor and wealth in the life of this world, our Lord! That they may lead men astray from Your path. Our Lord! Destroy their wealth, and harden their hearts, so that they will not believe until they see the painful torment. "4 489. Allah said: "Verily, the invocation of you both is accepted. So you both keep to the straight way, and follow not the path of those who know not." \$ Musa supplicated against Fir'awn and His Chiefs Allah mentioned what Musa said when he prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs after they refused to accept the truth. They continued to go astray and be haughty and arrogant. Musa said: i & j 'fc ? j, o # C 40ur Lord! You have indeed bestowed on Fir'awn and his chiefs splendor and pleasure of this worldly life. r \, . - Ail JAJi > < - ' * tV >> / > < . "> 'AX'. \$ > .. if "xTx ^

and wealth} plentiful and abundant. Allah's statement, Jz '0/ Qjlf i^Lt } iin the li/e of this world, Our Lord! That they may lead men astray from Your path.} was read with the word *LiyadiM and Liyudillu. The first is with a Fathah over the Yd, meaning that You have given them that while You know they would not believe in what You have sent me with to them. You did that so they would gradually be drawn away from the truth. As Allah said: i that We may test them thereby.} {20:131} and (72:17). Others read the word with a Dammah over the Yd. (i.e. Liyudillu) This makes the Ayah mean: You have given them that so whoever You willed from among Your creatures will be tried. Those whom You wish to misguide would think that You have given them that because You loved them and You cared about them. i "Our Lord! Destroy their wealth/" Ibn Abbas and Mujahid said: They asked Allah to destroy their wealth. Ad-Dahhak, Abu Al- Aliyah and Ar-Rabfa bin Anas said: Allah made their wealth into engraved stones as it was before. About Allah's statement, } and harden their hearts} Ibn Abbas said, Harden their hearts means put a seal on them. ^uili iy- " | l * At-Jabaii 15:181. 2 | At-Tabari 15:180. ' At-Tabari 15:181.

so that they will not believe until they see the painful torment This prayer was from Musa because he was angry for the sake of Allah and His religion. He prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs when he was certain that there was no good in them. Similarly, NQh prayed and said: i My Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers on the earth! If You leave them, they will mislead Your servants, and they will beget none but wicked disbelievers.} (71:26-27) HarQn said Amin to his brother's prayer. And Allah answered Musa's prayer. Allah said: i Verily, the invocation of you both is accepted.} in destroying Fir'awn's people. i Verily I have answered your prayers (both of you). So you both keep to the straight way} So as I have answered your prayer, you should remain steadfast on My command. Ibn Jurayj narrated that Ibn Abbas said about this Ayah: Be steadfast and follow My command. ' 'ft K I* M T?i Ji' i yj&JT % U i&i dzc xsM \% v \% \ nr. ju 490. And We took the Children of Israel across the sea, and Fir'awn with his hosts followed them in oppression and enmity, till when drowning overtook him, he (Fir'awn) said: ", I believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the (i) Al-Tabari 15:187,

Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims."} 191 . Now (you believe) while you refused to believe before and you were one of the mischief-makers.} 192. So this day We shall deliver you (dead)

body (out from the sea) that you may be a sign to those who come after you! And verily, many among mankind are heedless of Our Aydt.} The Children of Israel were saved and Fir'awn's People drowned Allah tells us how He caused Fir'awn and his soldiers to drown. The Children of Israel left Egypt in the company of Musa. It was said that there were six hundred thousand soldiers, plus offspring. They borrowed a lot of ornaments from the Coptics and took that with them. Fir'awn became very angry with them. So he sent heralds to all the cities to send their soldiers. He embarked, following behind them, filled with great pride and with massive armies. Allah wanted this to happen for He had a plan for them. No one that had any authority or power remained behind in Fir'awn's kingdom. They were all together and caught the Children of Israel at sunrise. iijsv^ ju gcyi iga} AAnd when the two hosts met each other, the companions of Musa said: "We are sure to be overtaken."} (26:61) They said that because when they got to the seashore Fir'awn was behind them. The two groups met face to face. The people with Musa kept asking, How can we be saved today? Musa replied, I have been commanded to come this way. MQsa said: Oit~- tp '&} iNay, verily, with me is my Lord. He will guide me.} (26:62) It had been so difficult, but it suddenly became easy. Allah commanded him to strike the ocean with his staff. He did and the sea was cleft asunder, each part stood like a mighty mountain. The sea was split into twelve paths, each route for each Israelite tribe. Allah then commanded the wind and the path was dry for them.

1 4 4^* jii 4And strike a dry path for them in the sea, fearing neither to be overtaken [by Fir'awn] nor being afraid (of drowning in the sea).>(20:77) The water in between the paths appeared as windows and every tribe was able to see the other so they would not think that others were destroyed. The Children of Israel crossed the sea. When the last one crossed, Fir'awn and his soldiers had arrived at the edge of the other shore. They were one hundred thousand black horses in addition to horsemen of other colors. When Fir'awn saw the sea he was frightened. He wanted to turn back, but it was too late. Allah's decree prevailed and the prayer of Musa was answered. Jibril came on a war stallion. He passed by Fir'awn's horse. Jibril's horse whinnied at Fir'awn's and then Jibril rushed into the sea, and Fir'awn did the same behind him. Fir'awn no longer had any control over matters. He wanted to sound strong before his chiefs, so he said: The Children of Israel do not have more right in the sea. So they rushed into the sea. Mlkall was behind their army pushing them all to join. When they all were in the sea and the first of them was about to emerge on the other side, Allah, the All-Powerful, commanded the sea to strand them. The sea closed over them and none was saved. The waves took them up and down. The waves accumulated above Fir'awn and he was overwhelmed by the stupors of death. While in this state, he said: i# 3ZC 3\$ % 'A 'v J3 41 believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He (Allah) in Whom the Children of Israel believe, and I am one of the Muslims He believed at a time when he couldn't benefit from his faith. & \$ % Ct tx 4dill!* jui-j 4 oii- Jti Jjf\ pill dii dt ijt> CJ pp-Vl 4So when they saw Our punishment, they said : "We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him

as (His) partners. Then their faith could not avail them when they saw Our punishment. (Like) this has been the way of Allah in dealing with His servants. And there the disbelievers lost utterly (when Our torment covered them).>(40:84-85) Therefore Allah said, as a response to Fir'awn, Z&%^} iNow (you believe) while you refused to believe before?} do you say that just now when you have disobeyed Allah before that. 4And you were one of the mischief-makers.} You were among the makers of mischief on

the earth who misled the people. and We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day of Resurrection, they will not be helped.} (28:41) These facts about Fir'awn and his status at that time were among the secrets of the Unseen that Allah revealed to His Messenger, Muhammad Similarly

654 Tafstr Ibn Kathir sea) that you may be a sign to those who come after you!} Ibn Abbas and others from among the Salaf have said: Some of the Children of Israel doubted the death of Fir'awn so Allah commanded the sea to throw his body - whole, without a soul - with his known armor plate. The body was thrown to a high place on the land so that the Children of Israel could confirm his death and destruction. ' That is why Allah said, 4" So this day We shall deliver your.."} meaning that We will put your body on a high place on the earth. Mujahid said, i&H} iyour (dead) body} means, your physical body. '2' 4**Mi <^J&} ithat you may be a sign to those who come after you!} meaning, so that might be a proof of your death and destruction for the Children of Israel. That also stood as a proof that Allah is All-Powerful, in Whose control are all the creatures. Nothing can bear His anger. Fir'awn and his people were destroyed on the day of 'Ashura , as recorded by Al-Bukhari, Ibn Abbas said, When the Prophet jH arrived at Al-Madinah, the Jews fasted the day of Ashurd . So he asked, iJLA U " "What is this day that you are fasting?" They responded This is the day in which MUsa was victorious over Fir'awn. So the Prophet said, "Yom have more right to Musa than they, so fast if.*" Tabari 15:196. At-Tabari 15:197. Al-B&ri 8 :198

V. | ffM fJA* lilj 493. And indeed We settled the Children of Israel in an honorable dwelling place, and provided them with good things, and they differed not until the knowledge came to them . Verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection in that in which they used to differ The Establishment of the Children of Israel in the Land and Their Provision from the Good Things In these Ayat, Allah tells us about all the worldly and religious gifts which He bestowed upon the Children of Israel. Allah s statement, honorable dwelling place means in Egypt and Syria, around Jerusalem, as it was said by some. When Allah destroyed Fir'awn and his soldiers, the Mosaic State took control of all of Egypt as Allah said: \y\ => Cj /iyj \$And We made the people who were considered weak to inherit the eastern parts of the land and the western parts thereof which We have blessed. And the fair Word of your Lord was fulfilled for the Children of Israel, because of their endurance. And We destroyed completely all the great works and buildings which Fir'awn and his people erected. 7:137) He said in other Ayat iSo, We expelled them from gardens and springs. Treasures, and every kind of honorable place. Thus, and We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.M26-.57 -59) He also said:

iHow many of gardens and springs that they left behind...} (44 :25-27) They then continued with Musa, to seek Jerusalem - the land of Ibrahim, the friend of Allah. There were giant people in Jerusalem. The Children of Israel refrained from fighting them. So Allah expelled them into the wilderness for forty years. During this time in the wilderness, first Harun died and then Musa. Yusha' bin Nun led after them. Allah supported them to conquer Jerusalem and rule it for a period of time. His statement, y , at iand provided them with good things means from the lawful, pure and useful provision that is good in nature and in Law. Then Allah said: iand they differed not until the knowledge came to them.} There should be no reason for them to have any disputes among them since Allah has sent them knowledge and explained different matters and issues to them. It has been mentioned in a Hadith, 'a\\ jl j t ^>-1 jji ^' , " | ar* , j" * , ' , I ' mS(I ' ' SS * / ' iji U^t l **ji jTer'J T'*' or* OrfrO fl i til I j O 9 jtwl 9 i vThe Jews

separated into seventy-one sects, and the Christians separated into seventy-two sects, and this Ummah will separate into seventy-three sects, one of which is in Paradise, seventy-two in the Fire ." They asked, Who are they O Messenger of Allah!? He replied; f iThose upon what I and my Companions are upon ." It was recorded by Al-Hakim in his Mustadrak with this wording. 11 So here Allah said, 111 Al-Hakim 1:129.

4pr*> iVerily your Lord will judge between them Here the meaning is, to distinguish between them {the Day ofResurrection in that which they used to differ.} juJ u&j ot C.Z.^=0' Ojlju -idt tL2 ijLi i)f} "L\ oijL lyjfT V> Oi ^ '^5 oi *J' jj> ^ pjfe ***" C^J' Si oi 15 .# Jfc- 494. So i/ you are in doubt concerning that which We foree revealed unto you, then ask those who are reading the Book before you. Verily, the truth has come to you from your Lord. So be not of those who doubt (it).} 495. And be not one of those who belie the Ayat of Allah, for then you shall be one of the losers.} 496. Truly, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe.} 497. Even ifevery sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} Previousbooks Attest to the Truth ofthe Qur an Allah said: 4^pj ikffi 4 (** * \fj& fJOjMi (jiif -C^jrVf Jj-J' {Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom they find written of with them in the Tawrdh and the Injtl.}(7:157) They are as certain of this as they are about who their children are, yet they hide it and distort it. They did not believe in it despite its clear evidence. Therefore Allah said: JJlf

{Truly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not be- lieve. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} meaning they would not believe in a way that they might benefit from that belief. This is when they believe at a time one may not be able to benefit from his belief. An example is when MQsa prayed against Fir'awn and his chiefs, saying: J4& \$ jJ* e> !w & ifjVf 36\$ {Our Lord! Destroy their wealth, and harden their hearts, so that they will not believe until they see the painful tortnent.}[10:88) And Allah said: \$Ml j;j\A-ftl 'Ss'i'" faji 'X > " & 'XZ-n&'g& .; ^ j# u\$0 j)> ,&u-i &s;^ tts j 't {And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they would not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most of them behave ignorantly.} (6:111) Allah then said:

Suraih 10. Yunus (98) (Part-11) 659 498. Was there any town (community) that believed (after seeing the punishment), and its faith (at that moment) saved it (from the punishment)?- except the people ofYunus; when they believed, We removedfrom them the torment of disgrace in the life of the (present) world, and permitted them to enjoy for a while}. Belief at the Time of Punishment did not help except with the People ofYunus Allah asked, did any town from the previous nations, believe in its entirety when they received the Messengers? All of the Messengers thatWe sent before you, O Muhammad, were denied by their people or the majority oftheir people. Allah said, 'ii ')\$ " l* J iAlas for mankind! There never came a Messenger to them but they used to mock at him>(36:30) ^ J Jrv oj (**!" cs, uS C jSfS} iLikewise, no Messenger came to those before them but they said: "A sorcerer or a madman!"} (51:52) and tyj\$ if Eifcll 'J) J! jijj 4 Jt 0-!\$ 4And similarly, We sent not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: "We found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeedfollow theirfootsteps. }{43:23) As found in the authentic Hadith, ** * j >/ Aha iThe Prophets were displayed before me. There was a Prophet who passed with a group of people, and a Prophet who passed with only one man, a Prophet with two men, and a Prophet

660 Tafstr Ibn Kathir with no one.t'11 Then he mentioned the multitude of followers that Musa had, peace be upon him, then that he saw his nation of people filling from the west to the east. The point is that between MQsa and Yunus, there was no nation, in its entirety, that believed except the people of Yunus, the people of Naynawa (Nineveh). And they only believed because they feared that the torment from which their Messenger warned them, might strike them. They actually witnessed its signs. So they cried to Allah and asked for help. They engaged in humility in invoking Him. They brought their children and cattle and asked Allah to lift the torment from which their Prophet had warned them. As a result, Allah sent His mercy and removed the scourge from them and gave them respite. Allah said: oft&if 4 ^ 'oj jsj \$ 4Except the people of Yunus; when they believed, We removed from them the torment of disgrace in the life of the world, and permitted them to enjoyfor a while.} In interpreting this Ayah, Qatadah said: No town has denied the truth and then believed when they saw the scourge, and then their belief benefited them, with the exception of the people of Yunus. When they lost their Prophet and they thought that the scourge was close upon them, Allah sent through their hearts the desire to repent. So they wore woolen fabrics and they separated each animal from its offspring. They then cried out to Allah for forty nights. When Allah saw the truth in their hearts and that they were sincere in their repentance and regrets, He removed the scourge from them. Qatadah said: It was mentioned that the people of Yunus were in Naynawa, the land of Mosul. ,2) This was also reported from Ibn Mas*ud, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and others from the Salaf. if- J-tli cAil CLf- cgyVi 4 f cfy icj ai Al-Bari 10:224. At-Tabari 15:207. At-Tabari 15:208-210.

* OX ^j^i 499. And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. So, will you then compel mankind, until they become believers.} 4100. It is notfor any person to believe, except by the leave of Allah, and He will put the Rijs on those who do not reason.} It is not Part ofAllah s Decree to compel Belief Allah said: 4\$J :tt. yf} 4And had your Lord willed} meaning O Muhammad, if it had been the will ofyour Lord, He would make all the people of the earth believe in what you have brought to them. But Allah has wisdom in what He does. Similarly, Allah said: viU -ib tlCj 'Jj If.'j iil O&j jG. j)} iLst*^&& And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree. Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (His saying) "Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together.}" (11:118-119) He also said, 4^?\$ u'CJ' "Ll4 jj jt j-tjt pi\} 4Have not then those who believed yet known that had Allah willed, He could have guided all mankind?} (13:31) Therefore, Allah said: 4S-& \p> Sti} 4So, will you then compel mankind} and force them to believe.

iupoti those who do not reason meaning, Allah s proofs and evidences, and He is the Just in all matters, guiding whom He wills to guide, and leadingwhom He wills astray. J3 fvojy; g c; ^ lit; } ^ pz jl SB# - HU " !> .61 jL ^ - S & iujiT j c -rjtj 44 4102. Say: "Behold all that is in the heavens and the earth." But neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who do not believe.} 4102. Then do they wait save for the likes of the days of men who passed away before them? Say: "Waif then, I am waiting with you among those who wait.}" 4103. Then We save Our Messengers and those who believe! Thus it is incumbent upon Us to save the believers.} The Command to reflect upon the Creation of the Heavens and the Earth Allah, the Exalted, guides His servants to reflect upon His blessings. What Allah has created in the heavens and the earth is part of the clear signs for those who possess correct understanding. From that which is

in the heavens are the luminous stars, the firmaments, the moving planetary bodies, the sun and the moon. This also includes the night and day, their alternating, and their merging so that one is long and the other is short. Then they alternate (through the year) so that the long one becomes short and the short one becomes long. Likewise, from the signs in the heavens is the rising of the sun, its vastness, its beauty and its adornment. Also, whatever rain that Allah sends down from the heavens, thereby bringing the earth to life after its death, and causing various types of fruits, crops, flowers and plants to grow, is from its signs. Whatever Allah creates in the earth from the various species of beasts, with their differing colors and benefits (for man), are signs. The mountains, plains, deserts, civilizations, structures and barren lands of the earth are signs. Then there are the wonders of the sea and its waves. Yet, it still has been made subservient and submissive to those who travel upon its surface. It carries their ships, allowing them to traverse upon

Yunus (105 - 707) (Part-11 6* ^ TT\ ^ ^T<) I *iL'.. o\^j ^ K * // ^ > // < > idJLd&< L^J44Maj3j;^b_/j jLJ^ j^aU^tqfojs0 it SM" ^ iYour Lord has written - - ^^ , < ^ ;>: < >' /- v'-i*coC1^iJj^S &>^i"i<-SiiX prl^' J,\$2" (prescribed) mercy for Himself) [6:54] i j^oi ^Ult fe \$) * >* ' / ,?f "M"f >/<' ojxjj jull juti 56 ^ tij' lat JlxS Cr^J Cyi^ " #' ii ^ & ^ cfc i.Jii(dt ^ X> U_i"- <^jll i m fyS "ij dfc -iS^a> Vj tiLij V U 41 '\ \ s& >> Ici 4 im ^)j j* taJ 4^} % * A*> Jh. Jf) tiK6 oi "LJ {j* .4 4104. Say:"0 peupit: ij you are in doubt about my religion - I will never worship those whom you worship besides Allah, rather, I will worship Alldlt, the One Who cause you to die. And I was commanded to be one of the believers.) 4105. And (I was commanded), ",Direct your face toward the Hanif(monotheism) religion, and not be one of the idolaters.") 4106. "And do not invoke besides Allah what will not benefit you nor harm you. For ifyou did, you would certainly be one of the wrongdoers ") 4107. And if Allah touches you with harm, there is none who can lift it but He. And if He intends good for you, then none can repel His favor which He causes to reach whom He wills among His servants. And He is the Pardoning, the Merciful.)

harm only come from Allah alone and no one shares with His power over these things. Therefore, He is the One Who deserves to be worshipped alone, without ascription of partners. Concerning His statement, iAndHe is the Pardoning, the Merciful . This means that He is forgiving and merciful towards those who turn to Him in repentance, regardless of what sin the person has committed. Even if the person associated a partner with Allah, verily Allah would forgive him if he repented from i r. Q} itxJS \$} 4*- 410S. Say: "O people! Now the truth has come to you fromyour Lord. So whoever receives guidance, he does so far the good of hitnself. And whoever goes astray, he does so at his own loss. And Iam not set over you as a guardian.} il09. And fallow what is revealed to you, and be patient until Allah givesjudgment. And He is the best of thejudges .} Allah, the Exalted, commands His Messenger jgg to inform the people that that which he has brought them from Allah is the truth. It is a message concerning which there is no doubt or suspicion. Therefore, whoever is guided by it and follows it, then he only benefits himself by doing so. Likewise, whoever is misguided away from this message, then he will suffer theconsequences against his own self. iAnd Iam not set over you as a guardian} This means, am not a guardian over you in order for you to become believers. I am only a wamer to you and guidance belongs to Allah, the Exalted. Concerning Allah s statement. ijjj jut c g%}

^And follow what has been revealed to you, and be patient^ This means, Adhere to that which Allah has revealed to you, and inspired you with, and be patient with the opposition that you meet from the

people. iuntil Allah gives judgment This means, Until Allah judges between you and them. iAnd He is the best ofjudges. > This means that He is the best of those who pass judgment, due to His Justice and His wisdom. This is the EndofVolume Four. m' Volume Five begins with Surah Hud

Module 15

Surah 11: Hud

Surah 11: Hud

PDF pages 2557–2673

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2557]

Opening The TafslrofSurahHud (Chapter - 11)

Which was Revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2557–2569]

SurahHudmade the Prophet s Hair turn Gray Abu Isa

18 TafsTr Ibtt Kathtr 42. (Saying worship none but Allah. Verily, I (Muhammad) am unto you from Him a wamer and a bringer of glad tidings.) 43 . And (commanding you): "Seek the forgive- ness of your Lord, and turn to Him in repen- tance, thatHe may grant yougoodenjoyment,fora term appointed, and be- stow His aboundinggrace to every owner of grace. But if you turn away, then I fear for you the tormentofaGreatDay . 44. To Allah is your return, and He is able to do all things."} The Qur an and its Call to (worship) Allah Alone A discussion concerning the letters of the alphabet (which appear at the beginning of some chapters of the Qur an) has already preceded at the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. That discussion is sufficient without any need for repetition here. Concerning Allah s statement, iThe Ayat whereofare perfect and then explained in detail} This means perfect in its wording, detailed in its meaning. Thus, it is complete in its form and its meaning. This interpretation was reported from Mujahid and Qatadah, and Ibn Jarir [At-Tabari] preferred it. r tn mm*1 \a I."L m \$km, CJt At-Tabari 15:227.

Concerning the meaning of Allah s statement. ifrom One (Allah), Who is All-Wise, Well-Acquainted This means that it (the Qur an) is from Allah, Who is Most Wise in His statements and His Laws, and Most Aware of the final outcome of matters. \ ^ i(Saying) worship none but Allah .} This means that this Qur an descended, perfect and detailed, with the purpose of Allah s worship alone, without any partners. This is similar to the statement of Allah, the Exalted, v)%V %4 A \il t iAnd We did not send any Messenger before you but We revealed to him (saying): There is no God but I, so worship Me.} [21:25) It is similar to Allah s statement, ^OjiAlt it 4 CJL Ijij} iAnd verily, We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Taghiit (callingfalse deities./ >[16:36] In reference to Allah s statement, iVerily, I am unto you from Him a wamer and a bringer of glad tidings.) This means, Verily, I am unto you a warner of the punishment if you oppose Him (Allah), and a bringer of the good news of reward ifyou obey Him. This meaning has been recorded in the authentic Hadith which states that the Messenger of Allah jjg ascended mount As-Safa and called out to his near relatives of the Quraysh tribe. When they gathered around him, he said, M \$ Yj\ ! U-ij* - people of Quraysh, if I informed you that a cavalry was

20 Tafsir Ibn Kathir going to attack you in the morning, would you not believe me?" They replied, We have not found you to be a liar. He said, Verily I am a Warner unto you before a severe punishment. ¹¹¹ Concerning His statement, ⁴ And (commanding you) : 'Seek the forgiveness of your Lord, and turn to Him in repentance, that He may grant you good enjoyment, for a term appointed, and bestow His abounding grace to every owner of grace. This means, I am commanding you to seek forgiveness from previous sins and to turn to Allah from future sins, and thereafter you abide by that. ⁴ that He may grant you good enjoyment, This is in reference to this worldly life. ⁴ for a term appointed, and bestow His abounding grace to every owner of grace. This refers to the Hereafter, according to Qatadah ²¹ This is like the statement of Allah, [^] Whoever works righteousness - whether male or female - while a true believer, verily to him We will give a good life. ^[16:97] Concerning Allah's statement, ⁴ ^{jg} ^{fk} 'iy ' Dala il An-Nubuwwah, 2 :181 , similar wording with Al-Bukhari no. 4971 , and Muslim no. 208. At-Tabari 15:231.

But if you turn away, then I fear for you the torment of a Great Day.} This is a severe threat for whoever turns away from the commandments of Allah, the Exalted, and rejects His Messengers. Verily, the punishment will afflict such a person on the Day of Resurrection and there will be no escape from it. } To Allah is your return,} This means your return on the Day of Judgement. && and He is able to do all things.} This means that He is capable of doing whatever He wishes, whether it be goodness towards His Awliya (friends and allies), or vengeance upon His enemies. This also includes His ability to repeat the creation of His creatures on the Day of Resurrection. This section encourages fear, just as the previous section encourages hope. ^{G cp Spz ow -31p AWi pi oil 'jji }} 5- No doubt! They did fold up their breasts, that they may hide from Him. Surely, even when they cover themselves with their garments. He knows what they conceal and what they reveal. Verily, He is the All-Knower of the (innermost secrets) of the breasts. } Allah is Aware of All Things Ibn Abbas said, They used to dislike facing the sky with their private parts, particularly during sexual relations. Therefore, Allah revealed this verse.

up- mean? He said, The man used to have sex with his woman, but he would be shy, or he used to have answering the call of nature (in an open space) but, he would be shy. Therefore, this verse, ⁴ No doubt! They did fold up their breasts,} was revealed. ¹¹¹ In another wording of this narration, Ibn Abbas said, There were people who used to be shy to remove their clothes while answering the call of nature in an open space and thus be naked exposed to the sky. They were also ashamed of having sexual relations with their women due to fear of being exposed towards the sky. Thus, this was revealed concerning them. Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn Abbas said that ⁴ they cover themselves} means that they cover their heads. ^{131 46}. And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposit. All is in a Clear Book.} Allah is Responsible for the Provisions of All Creatures Allah, the Exalted, informs that He is responsible for the provisions of all the creatures that dwell in the earth, whether they are small, large, sea-dwelling or land-dwelling. He knows their place of dwelling and their place of deposit. This means that He knows where their journeying will end in the earth and where they will seek shelter when they wish to nest. This place of nesting is also considered their place of deposit. Ali bin Abi Talhah and others reported from Ibn Abbas that he said concerning the statement, Al-Bidri 8 :200 ¹²¹ Ibid. ¹³¹ Ibid.

4And He knows its dwelling place} that it means where it resides. In reference to the statement, iand its deposit.} he (Ibn Abbas) said it means where it will die. Allah informs us that all of this is written in a Book with Allah that explains it in detail. This is similar to Allah s statement. Vj j 0> Cj} iThere is not a moving creature on earth, nor a bird that flies with its two wings, but are communities like you. We have neglected nothing in the Book, then unto their Lord they (all) shall be gathered.} [6:38], and 65 ^ V & Y^} 40jS? 4% off.% yij 4#&& 4 % l+lii VI iAnd with Him are the keys of the Ghayb (all that is hidden and unseen), none knows them but He. And He knows whatever there is in the land and in the sea ; not a leaffalls, but he knows it. There is not a grain in the darkness of the earth nor anything fresh or dry, but is written in a Clear Record.} [6:59] Cjfc s j ii ' 4 j. 4jJI ft.j} ii & bt ^oft. Vt kL C y/iZ& 4 OKK gX V[tfc 47. And He it is Who has created the heavens and the earth in six Days and His Throne was over the water, that He might try you, which ofyou is the best in deeds. But ifyou were to say m At-Tabari 15:241.

You shall indeed be raised up after death,

25Surali 11. Hud (7-8) (Part-12) Bukhari and

worship Him and not associate anything with Him as a partner. Allah did not create this creation (of the heavens and the earth) out of mere frivolity. This is similar to His statement. iAnd We created not the heaven and the earth and all that is between thetn without purpose! That is the consideration of those who disbelieve! Then woe to those who disbelievefrom the Fire!) (38 :27) Allah the Exalted, said, v 20 & #2 -i 4) pj tZpjSLfli ti\$% 'A iDid you think that We created you in play (without any purpose), and that you would not be brought bade to Us? So Exalted is Allah, the True King : there is no Cod but He, the Lord of the Supreme Throne!) (23 : 1 15- 1 16] Allah, the Exalted, said, iAnd I (Allah) created not the Jinn and mankind except that they should worshipMe (Alone).) 51 :56) Concerning the statement of Allah, ithat He might try you,) It means so that He (Allah) may test you. Concerning the statement, &m iwhich ofyou is the best in deeds.) It is important to note here that Allah did not say, Which of you has done the most deeds. Rather, He said, Best in deeds. A deed cannot be considered a good deed until it is done sincerely for Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, and it must be in accordance with the legislation of the Messenger of Allah

Hud (7-8) (Part-12) Whenever a deed lacks one of these conditions, then it is null and void. The Polytheists hasten their Torment by arguing against Resurrection after Death Concerning Allah s statement, iBut if you were to say to them: "You shall indeed be raised up after death. } Allah, the Exalted, is saying, O Muhammad, if you were to inform these polytheists that Allah is going to resurrect them after their death, just as He created them originally (they would still reject). Even though they know that Allah, the Exalted, is the One Who created the heavens and the earth, just as He said, Om iAtid ifyou ask them who created them, they will surely say: "Allah.' >(43:87) Allah says, oyliiri iAnd if you were to ask them : "Who has created the heavens and the earth and subjected the sun and the moon?" They will surely reply: "Allah."} [29:61] Even after their awareness of this (Allah s creating), they still reject the resurrection and the promised return on the Day of Judgement. Yet, in reference to ability, the resurrection is easier (for Allah to perform) than the original creation. As Allah said, j c s,' > cm? xi'*' iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it (after it has

perished); and this is easier for Him.} [30:27] Allah also said, -h jfcs% } iThe creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only

as (the creation and resurrection of) a single person.} [31:28] Concerning the statement, n TSi L[] iThis is nothing but obvious magic.} The polytheists say this due to their disbelief and obstinacy. They say, We do not believe your claim that resurrection will occur. They also say, He (Muhammad) only says this (resurrection of the dead) because he is bewitched, and he wants you to follow him in what his bewitchment tells him. Concerning Allah's statement, 3.1 yZR 1 4And if We delay the torment for them till a determined term,} Allah, the Exalted, is saying If We delay the torment and the destruction of these polytheists until a appointed time and a period determined, and We promise them a specific time period (of life), they would still say, in rejection and haste; iWhat keeps it back?} They mean by this, What delays this torment from overtaking us? Both rejection and doubt are their very nature. Therefore, they have no escape or refuge from the torment. The Meanings of the Word Ummah The word Ummah is used in the Qur'an and Sunnah with a number of different meanings. Sometimes when it is used it means a specified period of time. An example is the statement of Allah, the Exalted, in this verse, ijixZ > 3,1 d\} itill a determined Ummah (term),} This is also the meaning in the statement of Allah in Surah YQsuf, z'M C& a iThen the man who was released, now after Ummah (some time) remembered.} (12:45]

Surah U . Hud (7-8) (Part-12) 29 The word Ummah is also used to refer to the Imam (leader) who is followed. An example of this is in the statement of Allah, ot\$ A> bff- A 4Verily, Ibrahim was an Ummah, obedient to Allah, Hanif, and he was not of those who were polytheists.} [16:120] The word Ummah is also used to mean religion and religious creed. This is as Allah mentions concerning the polytheists, that they said, '< l)6 Eitl; liJUj iVerily, we found our fathers following a certain way and religion, and we will indeed follow their footsteps.} [43:23] The word Ummah is also used to mean a group (of people). This is as Allah says, UT; SI' UJjAnd when he arrived at the water (well) of Madyan, he found there a group of men watering (their flocks) . [28:23] Allah also said, & !4 i #5d sk=, 4 gi;Q} 4And verily. We have sent among every Ummah a Messenger (proclaiming): Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid Tdghiit."} (16:36) Allah also said, 4And for every Ummah there is a Messenger; when their Messenger comes, the matter will be judged between them with justice, and they will not be wronged.} [10:47]

The meaning of Ummah here is those people who have had a

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2569–2578]

Messenger sent among them. The meaning of Ummah in this context includes the believers and the disbelievers among them. This is like what has been recorded in Sahih Muslim, "3&l irS N p 0^ 'ij 4: i#" ^ c"i

&*.i& ttt tg&iiViP % He in Whose Hand * my" "*" is T"" ' '*'^ > "> ' one 0/ ffitis Ummah, whether he be a Jew or \ ^ \ 's_ " '-U Christian, who hears of ^ me and does not believe vOjJjy^CfjCX\ in me, except that he '. Av-V-" \ "u "f wi// enter the Hell- V^cyJ'oVJoP^criv^ycJ^l yjre n(l) In reference to the W. > .<.,4 Ummah of followers, v sijXju*sU\ then they are those Q&j&4}&rrj3"Z(&i Z. "ho believe ln "

>!,. r r,-.- C", , . v Messengers, as Allah said, j&iJUiaiSSciSOsta-j^ d % & 1 *Yom (the followers of <, .t, - ^ ",.1. ProPhet Muhammad) are Cp^/r-'j the best Ummah ever hi ij raised up for mankind.) Prophet si said, "77ien / will say, My Ummah (followers), my Ummah! The word Ummah is also used to mean a sect or party. An example of this usage is in the statement of Allah, 1 A& iAnd of the people ofMusa there is an Ummah who lead (the men) with truth and established justice therewith .) [7:159] Likewise is His statement, it\$A ff\ rf) ^ Muslim 1 :134. Muslim 1:183.

Hud (9-11) (Part-12) 4A party of the People of the Scripture stand for the right.} [3 :113] .t y ` > r ' ' - ' ^oOj * I4I2*/ (w" L> {/'/ " Af #>< <* Vi *u c*^> iif il i.l >*<{'- jx * ' " ?/ " ! QIiLmJI yAA AL j -Lju tluu 4 *" ^ C .'^halt ijLij 49. And ifWe gme man a taste 0/ mercy /rom Us, and then withdraw itfrom him, verily, he is despairing, ungrateful.} 410. But ifWe let him tastegood (favor) after evil (poverty and harm) has touched him, he is sure to say: "Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is exultant and boastful (ungrateful to Allah).} ill. Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds: those, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward (Paradise).} The changing of Man's Attitude in Happiness and Hardship Allah, the Exalted, informs about mankind and the blameworthy characteristics that he possesses, except for those believing servants upon whom Allah has bestowed His mercy. Allah explains that when any hardship befalls man, after he has experienced blessings, he is disheartened and he despairs of any good in the future. He denies and rejects (the bounties of) his previous condition. Thus, he behaves as if he has never seen any good and he loses all hope for relief (from his situation). Likewise, if any blessing befalls him after displeasure, ix 3J&} ihe is sure to say, "Ills have departedfrom me."} This means that he will claim that no harm or calamity will afflict him after this (blessing). i'f*\$ Aft iSurely, he is exultant and boastfid (ungratefid to Allah).} This means that he is pleased with what he has in his hand and ungrateful (to Allah). At the same time he is boastful

towards others. Allah, the Exalted, then says, 4Except those ivho shoio patience^ meaning, those who show patience during times of hardship and adversity. In reference to Allah s statement, iand do righteous good deeds This means that they perform the good deeds in times of ease and good health. Concerning the statement, ithose, theirs will be forgiveness) meaning, that they will be forgiven due to the calamities that afflicted them. Concerning Allah s statement, iand a great reward.) This great reward is due to them because of what they sent forth (of good deeds) in their times of ease. This is similar to what is mentioned in the Hadith, V; ij 4jJ ij p % ppji i !;J1 oUlki {jA If; CP iil I NJ 1liJ ijp- "Bt/ He in Whose Hand is my soul! No worry, calamity, distress, illness, or grief strikes a believer, even the prick of a thorn, except tlwt Allah will expiate his sins for him because of In the Sahih it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, hp i| i yf. oil 'j) iuS ji'fLjj i !;ju ^\jt jj- p-S/ kllii ir~^j d Ijp 015 pi* *P" oLil jjj i*J lp". pii m Ahmad 3 :4.

Hud (12-14) (Part-12) iBy He in Whose Hand is my soul! Allah does not decree any matter for the believer except tluit it is good for him . If any blessing befalls him, he is thankful (to Allah) and that is good for him. If any harm comes to him, he is patient and that is also good for him. This is (a bounty) exclusively for the believer, n111 For this reason, Allah, the Exalted, says, I.;. il',ill i 'tl . <> "if' ul -) s^^)} 4 - T 4By Al-'Asr (the time). Verily, man is in loss. Except those ivho believe and do righteous good deeds. And recommend one another to the truth and recommend one another to patience .} [103:1-3] Allah also says, 4 Verily 412. So perchance you may give up a part of what is revealed unto

you, and that your breast feels straitened for it because they say, "Why has not a treasure been sent down unto him, or an angel come with him? But you are only a wamer. And Allah is a Guardian over all things." 413. Or they say, "He forged it. Say: "Bring you then ten forged Surahs like unto it, and call whomsoever you can, other than Allah, if you speak the truth!" 414. If then they answer you not, know then that it is sent down with the knowledge of Allah and that there is no god 111 MusUm 4:2295.

34 Tafstr Ibn Kathir besides Him! Will you then be Muslims The Messenger sgr grieving by the Statements of the Polytheists, and His Gratification This statement of Allah, the Exalted, to His Messenger jg comforted the worries that the polytheists were causing him due to their statements directed towards him. This is just as Allah says about them. ^ j\y*}\ ui" ac gJc IX % ') bx,4 \$2 jl iAnd they say: "Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets. Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him?" Or; "(why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?" And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched [25:7-8] Thus, Allah commanded His Messenger and guided him to not let these statements of theirs grieve his heart. Allah directed him sg; to not let these statements prevent him, or deter him from calling them to Allah, both day and night. This is as Allah said, C ty-Jl^ iln indeed. We know that your breast is straitened at what they say> [15:97] Allah says in this verse, iSo perchance you may give up a part of what is revealed unto you, and that your breast feels straitened for it because they say...) The meaning here is that he (the Prophet jgj) may be compelled to give up the Message due to what they (the polytheists) say about him. However, Allah goes on to explain: You (Muhammad) are only a wamer and you have an example in your brothers of the Messengers who came before you. For

Hud (15-16) (Part-12) verily, the previous Messengers were rejected and harmed, yet they were patient until the help of Allah came to them. An Explanation concerning the Miracle of the Qur an Then Allah, the Exalted, explains the miracle of the Qur an, and that no one is able to produce its like, or even bring ten chapters, or one chapter like it. The reason for this is that the Speech of the Lord of all that exists is not like the speech of the created beings, just as His attributes are not like the attributes of the creation. Nothing resembles His existence. Exalted is He, the Most Holy, and the Sublime. There is no deity worthy of worship except He and there is no true Lord other than He. Then Allah goes on to say, ilf then they answer you not,} Meaning, that if they do not come with a reply to that which you have challenged them with (to the reproduction of ten chapters like the Qur an), then know that it is due to their inability to do so. Know (that this is a proof) that this is the speech revealed from Allah. It contains His knowledge, His commands and His prohibitions. Then Allah continues by saying, # 3 iand that there is no God besides Him! Will you then be Muslims?} m&z eft of. Wlwsoever desires the life of the world and its glitter, to them We shall pay in full (the wages of) their deeds therein, and they wilt have no diminution therein .} 416. They are those for whom there is nothing in the Hereafter but Fire, and Vain are , thendeeds they did therein. And of no effect is that which they used to do.} ...

Whoever wants the Worldly Life, then He will have no Share of the Hereafter Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said concerning this verse, Verily those who show off, will be given their reward for their good deeds in this life. This will be so that they are not wronged, even the amount equivalent to the size of the speck on a date-stone. Ibn Abbas continued saying, Therefore, whoever does a good deed seeking to acquire worldly gain - like fasting, prayer, or standing for prayer at night - and he does so in order to

acquire worldly benefit, then Allah says, Give him the reward of that which he sought in the worldly life, and his deed that he did is wasted because he was only seeking the life of this world. In the Hereafter he will be of the losers. A similar narration has been reported from Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and many others. Anas bin Malik and Al-Hasan both said, This verse was revealed concerning the Jews and the Christians. t3* Mujahid and others said, This verse was revealed concerning the people who perform deeds to be seen. 14 ' Qatadah said, Whoever s concern, intention and goal is this worldly life, then Allah will reward him for his good deeds in this life. Then, when reaches the next life, he will not have any good deeds that will be rewarded. However, concerning the believer, he will be rewarded for his good deeds in this life and in the Hereafter as well. 151 Allah, the Exalted, says, l If f'-f'!- A bW b Cfj A U** ^ jLif AiXj J? Cj 0* Hj&j JuS 'XA -i %j yijJ ijipij Jau Jp L i3i* AAS ^Whoever desires the quick-passing (transitory enjoyment of thisTabari 15:263.Tabari 15:264, 265. At-Tabari 15:265. At-Tabari 15:266. |s| At-Tabari 15:264.

Hud (17) (Part-12) world), We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have ap- pointed for him Hell; he will burn therein dis- graced and rejected. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer - then such are the ones whose striv- ing shall be appreciated. On each - these as well as those - We bestow from the bounties ofyour Lord. And the bounties of your Lord can never be forbidden. See how We prefer one above an- other, and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in intricacy.} [17:18-21] rrr sgyjssa -"V ^ y' AJj s_jky_ ^ dl JWISjL^y Allah, the Exalted, says. j% -#" C# /i? /' k"*/ . ^ . Stt ^y \$ ^Mfaosoeuer desires the reward of the Hereafter, We giue him increase in his reward, and whosoeuer desires the reward of this world, We give him thereof, and he has no portion in the Hereafter.} [42:20] iL"yj l fy j ji 4-^T yj? Crt> o; jltf! 4^ ^ t^-zy j; -it 3jt*Jd vitjljl 417. Gm they who rely on a clear prooffrom their Lord, and

38 Tafslr Ibn Kathir whom a witness from Him recites (follows) it; and before it, came the Book of Musa, a guidance and a mercy, they believe therein, but those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place. So be not in doubt about it. Verily, it is the truth from your Lord, but most of mankind believe not.} The OneWho believes in the Qur an is upon Clear Proof from His Lord Allah, the Exalted, informs of the condition of the believers who are upon the natural religion of Allah, which He made inherent in His creatures. This is based upon their confession to Him that there is none worthy of worship except He. This is similar to Allah s statement, Jjbi jjK iSo set you your face towards the religion, Hantfan. Allah's Fitrah with which He has created mankind.}^ [30:30], In the Two Sahihs it is recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said, jiiijj VS j\ ^j\j.W i jt 1 jJji 3fy *Every child is bom upon the Fitrah, but his parents make him a Jew, Christian, or Magian. This is just as the calf that is bom whole. Have you noticed any calves that are bom mutilated?"[2) In Sahih

The meaning of this Ayah is, “Dedicate yourself to the natural

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2578–2609]

religion ofAllah which He made for humanity. Fath Al-Bari3 :290 , and Muslim 4 :2047

Hud (17) (Part-12 their religion . They made unlawful for them what I had made lawful for them and they commanded them to associate partners with Me, concerning which no authority has been revealed . " 11 Therefore, the believer is one who remains upon this Fitrah. Concerning Allah's statement, 4^ >, &} and whom a witness from Him recites (follows) it;} This means that a witness comes to him from Allah. That witness is the pure, perfect and magnificent legislation that Allah revealed to the Prophets. These legislations were finalized with the legislation (Shari'ah) of Muhammad s . The believer has the natural disposition that bears witness to (the truth of) the general legislation, and accepts that specific laws are taken from the general legislation. The Fitrah accepts the Shari'ah and believes in it. For this reason Allah, the Exalted, says. %U& m 4Can they who rely on a clear proof from their Lord, and whom a witness from Him recites (follows) it;} This clear proof which is recited is the Qur'an, which Jibril conveyed to the Prophet H and the Prophet Muhammad conveyed it to his Ummah. Then Allah says, 4&J- <& &> } 4and before it, came the Book of Musa,} This means that before the Qur'an, there was the Book of Musa, the Tawrah. tq} 4a guidance and a mercy} This means that Allah, the Exalted, revealed it to that Ummah as a leader for them and a guide for them to follow, as a mercy from Allah upon them. Therefore, whoever believed in it with true faith, then it would lead him to believe in the Qur'an as well. For this reason Allah said, 4'?'> m Muslim 4:2197.

ithey believe therein Then Allah, the Exalted, threatens those who reject the Qur'an, or any part of it, by saying, oi ibid those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place. This is directed towards everyone on the face of the earth who disbelieves in the Qur'an, whether they are idolators, disbelievers, People of the Scripture, or other sects from the descendants of Adam. This applies to all whom the Qur'an reaches, regardless of their differences in color, appearance, or nationality. As Allah says, ithat I may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} [6:19] Allah, the Exalted, said, iiZJ: 4I sj-ut <&> iSay: O mankind! Verily, I am sent to you all as the Messenger of Allah."} Allah says, i tMy 'ey 'j } ibid those of the sects that reject it, the Fire will be their promised meeting place.} In SahXh

Hud (17) (Part-12) Every Hadith is confirmed by the Qur'an Ayyub As-Sakhtiyani reported from Said bin Jubayr that he said, I did not hear any Hadith of the Prophet substantiated as he stated it, except that I found its confirmation in the Qur'an. (The narrator said, Or he said, I found its verification in the Qur'an.) Thus, it reached me that

the Prophet said, & 'n ' SJ cJi * ^ j lb "There is no one of this Ummah, whether he be a Jew or Christian, who hears of me and does not believe in me, except that he will enter the Hellfire. Therefore, I said, Where is its verification in the Book of Allah? Most of what I have heard reported from the Messenger of Allah I have found its verification in the Qur'an. Then I found this verse, ^ 'j&k fix} ibut those of the sects that reject it (the Qur'an), the Fire will be their promised meeting place. And this means from all religions. Then Allah says, iSo be not in doubt about it. Verily, it is the truth from your Lord,} This means that the Qur'an is the truth from Allah and there is no doubt or suspicion concerning it. This is as Allah says. 4Alif Lam Mim . The revelations of the Book in which there is no doubt, is from the Lord of all that exists!}[32:1-2\ Allah, the Exalted, says, 4*j bf,t m At-Tabari 15:280.

iAlifLam Mim. Tins is the Book in which there is no doubt.} [2 : 1-2] The Ayah; ibut most of mankind believe not.} is similar to Allah's statement, \ij} 4And most of mankind will not believe even if you

desire it eagerly.}[12:103] Likewise, Allah says, 4A frfr" o6 V-j" i.g\$' - j <> lu\$} iAnd ifyou obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far awayfrom Allah's path.} Allah also says, % IV VI^ indeed Iblis did prove true his thought about them : and theyfollowed him, all except a group of true believers.^[34:20] \$ 5fl 35} frAA oj-L-m Je "ii *Li) yt j- j jc OIT Uj cr"jV l 4 UfA \y& IfJJy -ill !y^=* iyK " li ^ ;\3j1 ^ "iil oJj pr^ pH- V iS"; U^ Jij ft ^XrA ^ V - J"A irirVl ij 41S. And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah. Such will be brought before their Lord, and the witnesses will say,"These are the ones who lied against their Lord!" No doubt! The curse ofAllah is on the wrongdoers.} 419. Those who hinder (others)from the path ofAllah, and seek a crookedness therein, while they are disbelievers in the Hereafter.} 420. By no means will they escape on earth, nor have they

43Surah VL Hud (18-22) (Part-12) protectors besides Allah! Their torment will be doubled! They could not bear to listen and they used not to see (the truth).} }21. They are those who have lost their own selves, and that which they invented eluded them.} 422 . Certainly, they are those who will be the greatest losers in the Hereafter.} Those Who invent Lies against Allah and hinder Others from His Path are the Greatest Losers Allah, the Exalted, explains the condition of those who lie against Him and that their scandal in the Hereafter will be presented before the heads of creation (for testimony) from the angels, Messengers, Prophets and the rest of mankind and Jinns. This is just as Imam

iThese are the ones who lied against their Lord! No doubt! The curse ofAllah is on the wrongdoers}. |11 Both

stare in horror.}[14:42] In the Two Sahlhs it is recorded that the Prophet jg said, „Jliy 2.1 !>[" ^Verily Allah gives respite to the oppressor until He seizes him, then he will not be able to escape Him.n111 For this reason Allah says, jvi iTheir torment will be doubled!} This means that the torment will be doubled upon them, because Allah gave them hearing, vision and hearts, but these things did not benefit them. Rather, they were deaf from hearing the truth and blinded away from following it. This is just as Allah has mentioned concerning them when they enter into the Hellfire. Allah says, A- j) iplij} 4And they will say: "Had we but listened or used our intelligence, we would not have been among the dwellers of the blazing Fire!"} Allah also says, iThose who disbelieved and hinder (men) from the path of Allah, for them We will add torment to the torment.}[16:88] For this reason they will be punished for every command that they abandoned and every prohibition that they indulged in. Then Allah continues by saying, -Lai XfrfA. iThey are those who have lost their own selves, and that which they invented eluded them.} They lost themselves, meaning that they be made to enter a blazing Fire, where they will be punished, and its torment will not be lifted from them for even the blinking of an eye. This is as Allah said, HI Path. Al-Bari 8 :205 , and Muslim 4 :1997

iWhenever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire.>[17:97] Concerning the statement, jz\$ ieluded them.* meaning that it has left them. 'y\ => U^ ithat luhich they invented - besides Allah, such as rivals and idols. Yet, these things did not avail them in the slightest. In fact, these things actually caused them great harm. This is as Allah says, 4 -i U-jff 'y\$ P IP' "- 4And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.^[46:6] Allah says, 4 ^ j iWhen those who were followed disown those who followed (them), and they see the torment, then all their relations loill be cut offfrom them .\${2:166] Likewise, there are many other verses that prove this loss of theirs and their destruction. For this reason Allah says, -JL ^ n >> 7 dj_r- 4 |*f (W iCertainly,

they are those who will be the greatest losers in the Hereafter. [11:22] In this verse Allah informs about the direction of their end. He explains that they are the greatest losers among mankind in their transaction for the abode of the Hereafter. That is because they exchanged the highest levels (of Paradise) for the lowest levels (of Hell) and they substituted the pleasure of Gardens (of Paradise) for the fierce boiling water (of Hell). They exchanged the drink of sealed nectar with the fierce hot wind, boiling water, and a shade of black smoke. They chose food from the filth of dirty wounds instead of wide-eyed lovely

Hud (23-24) (Part-12 maidens. They preferred Hdwyah (a pit in Hell) instead of lofty castles. They chose the anger of Allah and His punishment over nearness to Him and the blessing of gazing at Him. Therefore, it is no injustice that such people should be the greatest losers in the Hereafter. i* j \$1 \$ k Ji 423. Verily, those who believe and do righteous good deeds, and humble themselves before their Lord, they will be the dwellers of Paradise to dwell therein forever. 424. The likeness of the two parties is as the blind and the deaf and the seer and the hearer. Are they equal when compared? Will you not then take heed?} Rewarding the People of Faith When Allah, the Exalted, mentioned the condition of the wretched, He also commended the people of delight (the believers). They are those who believe and work righteous deeds. Thus, their hearts believed and their limbs worked righteous deeds, both in statements and actions. This includes their performance of deeds of obedience and their abandonment of evils. In this way they are the inheritors of Gardens (of Paradise), which contain lofty rooms and seats arranged in rows. Therein they will find bunches of fruit near to them, elevated couches, fair and beautiful wives, various types of fruit, desired kinds of food and delicious drinks. They also will be allowed to see the Creator of the heavens and the earth and they will be in this state of pleasure forever. They will not die, nor will they grow old. They will not experience sickness, nor will they sleep. They will not have excrement, nor will they spit or snot. Their sweat will be the perfume of musk. The Parable of the Believers and the Disbelievers Then, Allah, the Exalted, makes a parable of the disbelievers and the believers. He says,

iThe likeness of the two parties This refers to those disbelievers whom Allah first described as wretched, and then those believers whom He described with delightfulness. The first group is like one who is blind and deaf, while the second group is like he who sees and hears. Thus, the disbeliever is blind from the truth in this life and in the Hereafter. He is not guided to goodness, nor does he recognize it. He is deaf from hearing the proofs, thus he does not hear that which would benefit him. As Allah says, 4^+-^ ! pfi iHad Allah known of any good in them, He would indeed have made them listen . \$[8:23] The believer is smart, bright and clever. He sees the truth and distinguishes between the truth and falsehood. Thus, he follows the good and abandons the evil. He hears and distinguishes between the proof and scepticism. Therefore, falsehood does not overcome him. Are these two types of people alike? iWill you not then take heed?\$ This statement means, Will you not consider, so that you may distinguish between these two categories of people. This is as Allah mentions in another verse, iLiJi > _ kiLja t 4Not equal are the dwellers of the Fire and the dwellers of the Paradise. It is the dwellers of Paradise that will be successful>[59:20] Allah also says, % jJl* X> X> ciJLW? X) utyli Cji\$ ojI oj. j ije "tU & i>\ eJjH\ X Q.& XI j3 0; i&j fig.&

Hud (25-27) (Part-12 Jr m imam 4Not alike are the blind and the seeing. Nor are (alike) darkness and light. Nor are (alike) the shade and the sun's heat. Nor are (alike) the living and the dead. Verily, Allah makes whom He wills to hear, but you cannot make hear those who are in graves. You are only a Warner. Verily, We have sent you with the truth, a bearer of glad tidings and a Warner. And there never was a nation but a Warner had passed among them.) [35:19- 24] -&j} ^^ ft 4] at v>. *{ sM &&&OG \% v" & c p c; // / ->^ ./<"/V . >*/x" "- L XPj4 . .And indeed We sent Nuh to his people (and he said): I have come to you as a plain Warner."} 426. "That you worship none but Allah; surely, I fear for you the torment of a painful Day."} 427. The chiefs who disbelieved among his people said: "We see you but a man like ourselves, nor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking. And we do not see in you any merit above us, in fact we think you are liars. }

50 Tafslr Ibn Kathir The Story of Nuh and His Conversation with His People Allah, the Exalted, informs about Prophet Nuh. He was the first Messenger whom Allah sent to the people of the earth who were polytheists involved in worshipping idols. Allah mentions that he (Nuh) said to his people, AS? yj 4!^ H have come to you as a plain Warner.} meaning, to openly warn you against facing Allah's punishment if you continue worshipping other than Allah. Thus, Nuh said, 4 Si' "j AThat you worship none but Allah;} This can also be seen in his statement, A?S -ty. ' & SO surely, I fear for you the torment of a painful Day.} This means, If you all continue doing this, then Allah will punish you with a severe punishment in the Hereafter. Then Allah says, A*ify oi lift 5' \$&} iThe chiefs who disbelieved among his people said;} The word chiefs (Al-Mala'u) here means the leaders and the heads of the disbelievers. They said, {fS Y) 0} 4We see you but a man like ourselves,} This means, You are not an angel. You are only a human being, so how can revelation come to you over us? We do not see anyone following you except the lowliest people among us, like the merchants, weavers and similar people. No people of nobility, or rulers among us follow you. These people who follow you are not known for their intelligence, wit, or sharp thinking. Rather, you merely invited them (to this Islam) and they responded to your call and followed you (ignorantly). This is the meaning of their statement, AS arf fS n Sjly C,}

Hud (25-27) (Part-12) inor do we see any follow you but the meanest among us and they (too) followed you without thinking. The statement, without thinking, means that they merely followed the first thing that came to their minds. Concerning the statement, ot Cj} 4And we do not see in you any merit above us, in fact we think you are liars. In this they are saying, We do not see that you [and your followers] have any virtuous status above us in your physical appearance, your character, your provisions, or your condition, since you accepted this (new) religion of yours. in fact we think you are liars.} This means, We think you are lying about that which you are claiming for yourselves of righteousness, piety, worship and happiness in the abode of the Hereafter when you arrive there. This was the response of the disbelievers to Nuh and his followers. This is a proof of their ignorance and their deficiency in knowledge and intelligence. For verily, the truth is not to be rejected because of the lowly status of those who follow it. Verily, the truth is correct in itself, regardless of whether its followers are of low status, or nobility. Actually, the reality concerning which there is no doubt, is that the followers of the truth are the noble ones, even though they may be poor. On the other hand, those who reject the truth are the lowly wretches, even though they may be wealthy. Thus, we see that usually the weakest of people are the ones who follow the truth, while the nobility and high-class people usually are opposed to the truth. This is as Allah says, Lay JI\$ VJ j'Si ^ Uu-Ji U iAnd similarly, We sent

not a wamer before you to any town (people) but the luxurious ones among them said: We found our fathers following a cerain way and religion, and we will indeed follow their footsteps."}[43:23] When Heraclius, the emperor of Rome, asked Abu Sufyan

Sakhr bin Harb about the qualities of the Prophet jg, he said to him, Are his followers the noble people, or the weak? Abu Sufyan said, They are the weakest of them. Then Heraclius said, They (weak ones) are the followers of the Messengers. Concerning their statement, (ifi) iwithout thinking.) In reality this is not objectionable, or something derogatory, because the truth when it is made clear, does not leave room for second-guessing, or excessive thinking. Rather, it is mandatory that it should be followed and this is the condition of every pious, intelligent person. No one continues doubtfully pondering the truth (after it is made clear) except one who is ignorant and excessively critical. The Messengers - Allah s peace and blessings be upon them all - only delivered what was obvious and clear. Concerning Allah s statement, 4And we do not see in you any merit above us,) They did not see this (the virtue of accepting Islam) because they were blind from the truth. They could not see, nor could they hear. Rather, they were wavering in their skepticism. They were wandering blindly in the darkneses of their ignorance. They, in reality, were the slanderers and liars, lowly and despicable. Therefore, in the Hereafter they will be the greatest losers. (Jj Cj* C-3 oj Jbp & 2k")28. He said: O my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord, and a mercy (prophethood) has come to me from Him, but that (mercy) has been obscured from your sight. Shall we compel you (to accept) it when you have a strong hatred for it?) hi Fath Al-Bari 1 :42

Hud (29-30) (Part-12 The Response of Nuh Allah says, informing about the response of Nflh to his people, 4Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord,} Bayyinah means certainty, a clear matter, and truthful prophethood. That is the greatest mercy from Allah upon him (Nuh) and them (his people). ibut that (mercy) has been obscured from your sight.} Obscured from your sight in this verse means, it was hidden from you and you are not guided to it. Thus, you [people] did not know its importance so you hastily rejected and denied it. iShall we compel you (to accept) it} This means, Should we force you to accept it, while you actually detest it. p-fr'i iy- * i Zj *i' j*- V', (sj^ VC V ^ j] \$ Oi O* tiji | '*rJ 429. And O my people! I ask of you no wealth for it, my reward is from none but Allah. I am not going to drive away those who have believed. Surely, they are going to meet tlieir Lord, but I see that you are a people that are ignorant.} 430. And O my people! Who will help me against Allah, if I drove them away? Will you not then give a thought?} Nuh says to his people, I do not ask you for any wealth in return for my sincere advice to you. Wealth (Mai) here means, payment that I take from you. Nah means, I am only seeking the reward from Allah, the Mighty and Sublime. Concerning the statement, aft ti Zj} 41 am not going to drive away those who have believed.}

This alludes to the fact that they (the disbelievers) requested Nuh to disassociate himself from the believers, because they were averse to them and felt themselves too important to sit with them. This is similar to the request of disbelievers to the seal of the Messengers sjg to disassociate himself from a group of the people who were considered weak in their social status. They wanted the Prophet jg to sit with them in a special gathering of the elite. Therefore, Allah revealed, / ^ / ip/ - / ,*/ \ _Jj Ojfrjj "jjf 4And turn not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and afternoon Allah also says, iif 02 , /ill O' 477i"s We have tried some of them with others, that they might say : "Is it these (poor believers) whom

Allah has favored from among us?" Does not Allah know best those who are grateful?} 6:53] Ctk\$ %^ V; Vj < I jxe j\$3 jjS 431 . Am/ I do not say to you that with me are the treasures of Allah, nor that I know the Ghayb; nor do I say I am an angel, and I do not say of those whom your eyes look down upon that Allah will not bestow any good on them. Allah knows what is in their inner selves. In that case, I should, indeed be one of the wrongdoers.)> Nuh is informing them that he is a Messenger from Allah, calling to the worship of Allah alone, without any partners and he is doing this by the permission of Allah. At the same time, he is not asking them for any reward for this work. He invites whomever he meets, whether of nobility or low class. Therefore, whoever responds favorably, then he has achieved salvation. He also explains that he has no power to manipulate the hidden treasures of Allah, nor does he have any knowledge of the Unseen, except what Allah has allowed him to know. Likewise,

Jr am TTfl mm ^I* i #/" y ^ "" ^ "C (*r^J"614ii '^ Vj Jy^V)^ L*j *_l_i 1^ > ""*?/? - - ^ / >/ i <./ V>///> tlp Sji>-j & ZsJXj!S l0^ - * - - tit--' << . IOjd^^pp he is not an angel, rather, he is merely a human Messenger aided with miracles. Nuh goes on to say, I do not say about these people whom you (disbelievers) detest and look down upon, that Allah will not reward them for their deeds. Allah knows best what is in their souls. If they are believers in their hearts, as their condition appears to be outwardly, then they will have a good reward. If anyone behaves evilly with them after they have believed, then he is a wrongdoer who speaks what he has no knowledge of. Si 4- 4 V4 IL 1\$ CKp \$ *& & 3 j OjJ o). i^wu "S t*j itl o) i# * jSS|i Jtt ,4; .. They said: O Niih! You have disputed with us, and much have you prolonged the dispute with us, now bring upon us what you threaten us with, if you are of the truthful."} 433. He said: "Only Allah will bring it (the punishment) on you, if He wills, and then you will escape not."} 434. "And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, if Allah's will is to keep you astray. He is your Lord! and to Him you shall return."}

The People's Request of Nuh to bring the Torment and His Response to Them Allah, the Exalted, informs that the people of Nuh sought to hasten Allah's vengeance, torment, anger and the trial (His punishment). This is based on their saying, iG'L o'li- \ji} iThey said: O Nuh! You have disputed with us and much have you prolonged the dispute with us..."} They meant by this, You (Nuh) have argued with us long enough, and we are still not going to follow you. now bring upon us what you threaten us with,} What he (Nuh) promised is referring to the vengeance and torment (from Allah). They were actually saying, Supplicate against us however you wish, and let whatever you have supplicated come to us. itS4 iil * pJ)i Jli ^ i ...if you are of the truthful." (In reply to this,) He said: "Only Allah will bring it (the punishment) on you, if He wills, and then you will escape not."^>(1 1:32-33] This means, It is only Allah Who can punish you and hasten your punishment for you. He is the One from Whom nothing escapes. of 4p jfJ si 4^# i'} }And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, if Allah's will is to keep you astray.} This means: something that could be useful to you (in acceptance) of my preaching to you, warning you and advising you. ipP ol ij.% of o\} iif Allah's will is to keep you astray.} This means: your deception and your ultimate destruction.

iHe is your Lord! and to Him you shall return .} He is the Owner of the finality of all matters. He is the Controller, the Judge, the Most Just and He does not do any injustice. Unto Him belongs the creation and the command. He is the Originator and the Repeater (of the creation). He is the Owner of this life and the Hereafter. 4- r : 1 "3j-! jJ} 435. Or they (the pagans of Makkah) say: He has fabricated it." Say:

"If I have fabricated it, upon me be my crimes, but I am innocent of (all) those crimes which you commit.} An Interruption to verify the Truthfulness of the Prophet jg This is presented in the middle of the story to affirm the story itself. It is as if Allah, the Exalted, is saying to Muhammad 3g, Or do these obstinate disbelievers say that he fabricated this and invented it himself? iSay: "If I have fabricated it, upon me be my crimes..."} This means: such sin would be mine alone. ibut I am innocent of (all) those crimes which you commit.} This story is not invented, or fabricated falsely. Because he (the Prophet) knows better the punishment of Allah for one who lies on Allah. tV 3* & S& cs & 4p CT i C jil. jj V) niyi ^ *jJ J gy j', CfJ' j Vj o) ii* / U ="j a cr 436. And it was revealed to Nuh: "None of your people will believe except those who have believed already. So be not sad because of what they used to do.}

437. "And construct the ship under Our Eyes and with Our revelation, and address Me not on behalf of those who did wrong; they are surely to be drowned."} }38. And as he was constructing the ship, whenever the chiefs of his people passed by him, they mocked at him. He said: "If you mock at us, so do we mock at you likewise for your mocking."} 439. "And you will know who it is on whom will come a torment that will cover him with disgrace and on whom will fall a lasting torment."} The Revelation to Nuh concerning what would happen to the People and the Command to prepare for It Allah, the Exalted, sent revelation to Nuh when his people hastened the vengeance and punishment of Allah upon themselves. Then, Nuh supplicated against them, as Allah mentioned, when He said; > jji v \$} 4My Lord! Leave not one of the disbelievers inhabiting the earth!} [71:26] And he said, &Jj} 4Then he invoked his Lord (saying) : "I have been overcome, so help (me)"/^[54:10] At this point Allah revealed to him, 4None of your people will believe except those who have believed already.} Therefore, do not grieve over them and do not be concerned with their affair. 4And construct the ship.} The word Fulk here means ship.

Hud (35-39) (Part-12) funder Our Eyes} This means under Our vision. iand with Our revelation,} This means, We will teach you (Nuh) what to do. pri 4 iand address Me not on behalf of those who did wrong; they are surely to be drowned.} Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned from the Tawrah, Allah commanded him (Nuh) to make it (the ship) from Indian oak wood. Then He commanded him to make its length eighty cubits and its width fifty cubits. Allah then commanded him to coat its interior and exterior with tar and to make it with a slanted bow to part the water (as it sailed). Its height was thirty cubits into the sky. It had three levels and each level was ten cubits high. The lowest level was for the animals, both tame and wild, the second level was for the human beings and the highest level was for the birds. Its door was in the center of it and it had a cover on top of it that covered the entire ship. 111 Concerning Allah's statement, iAnd as he was constructing the ship, whenever the chiefs of his people passed by him, they mocked at him.} This means that they teased him and rejected his threat that they would drown (in the forthcoming flood). iHe said: If you mock at us, so do we mock at you likewise..."} This is a severe threat and a serious warning. t j-) 111 This narration is clearly from the Isra Uiyat (stories of the Jews and Christians) and thus cannot be relied upon totally unless there is support for it from the authentic Hadiths of the Prophet jg.

forth. And We caused springs to gush forth from the earth. So the waters (of the heaven and the earth) met for a matter predestined. And We carried him on a (ship) made of planks and nails. Floating under Our Eyes: a reward for him who had been rejected!}[54: 11-14] In reference to Allah's statement, iand

the oven gushed forth.} It is related from Ibn Abbas that he said, At-Tannur is the face of the earth. 111 This verse means that the face of the earth became gushing water springs. This continued until the water gushed forth from the Tananir, which are places of fire. Therefore, water even gushed from the places where fire normally would be. This is the opinion of the majority of the Salaf (predecessors) and the scholars of the Khalaf (later generations). At this point, Allah commanded Nuh to select one pair from every kind of creature possessing a soul, and load them on the ship. Some said that this included other creatures as well, such as pairs of plants, male and female. It has also been said that the first of the birds to enter the ship was the parrot, and the last of the animals to enter was the donkey. Concerning Allah's statement, *And your family - except him against whom the Word has already gone forth* This means, Load your family upon the ship. This is referring to the members of his household and his relatives, except him against whom the Word has already gone forth, for they did not believe in Allah. Among them was the son of Nuh, Yam, who went in hermitage. Among them was the wife of Nuh who was a disbeliever in Allah and His Messenger. Concerning Allah's statement, *And those who believe.* from your people. m At-Tabari 15:318.

And none believed with hint, except a few. This means that only a very small number believed, even after the long period of time that he (Nuh) was among them - nine hundred and fifty years. It is reported from Ibn Abbas that he said, They were eighty people including their women." vj iIlj oJ== Sri 4 c-j'iSpj 4 VI 4' ^ Ol J j4' V Jli t S' or; 4^" 41 Jli i Si 5Cj XrJ 4 443 . And he said : "Embark therein : in the Name of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage. Surely, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} <\$42. So it (the ship) sailed with them amidst waves like mountains, and Nuh called out to his son, who had separated himself (apart) "O my son! Embark with us and be not with the disbelievers."} i43. The son replied: "I will betake myself to some mountain, it will save me from the water." Nuh said: "This day there is no savior from the decree of Allah except him on whom He has mercy." And waves came in between them, so he (the son) was among the drowned.} The riding upon the Ship and Its sailing through the huge Waves Allah, the Exalted, says concerning Nuh, that he said to those whom he was commanded to carry them with him in the ship, 4Embark therein: in the Name, of Allah will be its (moving) course and its (resting) anchorage.} This means that its sailing upon the surface of the water, the Tabari 15:326.

Hud (41-43) (Part-12) end of its journeying and its anchoring, would all be with the Name of Allah. Abu Raja Al-Tjaridi recited it, In the Name of Allah, Who will be the One Who moves its course, and rests its anchor. 111 Allah, the Exalted, said. Jr csl"J, 4And when you have embarked on the ship, you and whoever is with you, then say: ",All the praises and thanks are to Allah, Who has saved us from the people who are wrongdoers. And say: My Lord! Cause me to land at a blessed landing place, for You are the Best of those who bring to land."^[23:28-29] For this reason, it is preferred to mention the Name of Allah (Bismillah) at the beginning of all affairs. The Name of Allah should be mentioned when boarding a ship, or when mounting an animal. This is as Allah, the Exalted, says, 3 40 * % 3%, <\$ 4And Who has created all the pairs and has appointed for you ships and cattle on which you ride, in order that you may mount on their backs.^[43:12-13] This practice (mentioning Allah's Name) has been encouraged in the Sunnah and is considered a preferred act. A discussion concerning this is forthcoming in the explanation of Surat Az- Zukhruf (43), if Allah wills. In reference to Allah's statement, *Surely, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful* Such statement is suitable while mentioning (His)

vengeance upon the disbelievers by drowning all of them. Therefore, he (Nuh) mentions that His Lord is Oft Forgiving, Most Merciful. (i| At-Jabari 15:328.

64 Tafstr Ibn Kathir This is similar to Allah s statement, 4^ iSurely, your Lord is swift in retribution, and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} [7:167] He also says, .Ajj i-i oi_j u]_j4 4B"i verily, your Lord is full offorgiveness for mankind inspite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment.} [13:6] Likewise, there are many other verses that combine Allah s mercy and His vengeance. Concerning Allah s statement, 4jl^J? g? 4 At ajf 4So it sailed with them amidst waves like mountains,} This means that the ship sailed with them upon the surface of the water, which had completely covered the earth until it encompassed the tops of the mountains and even rose over them by a height offifteen cubits. Itwas also said that the waves rose over the mountains by a height of eighty miles. Yet, this ship continued to move upon the water, sailing by the permission of Allah. It moved under His shade, His help, His protection and His blessing. This is as Allah, the Exalted, said, i{|}3# S3x& ' <& a6& iVerily, when the water rose beyond its limits, We carried you in the ship. That We might make it an admonition far you and it might be retained by the retaining ears.}[69:1 1-12] Allah also said, 4And We carried him on a (ship) made of planks and nails, floating under Our Eyes: a reward far him who had been rejected! And indeed, We have left this as a sign . Then is there any that will remember (or receive admonition)?}[54:13-15]

The Story ofthe drowning ofNuh s DisbelievingSon Allah continues the story, saying, it#& iand Niih called out to his son,) This was the fourth son of NOh. His name was Yam and he was a disbeliever. His father, Nuh, called him at the time of boarding the ship, that he might believe and embark with them. If he did so, he would be saved from drowning like the other disbelievers. iThe son replied: "I will betake myself to some mountain, it will save mefrom the water.") He believed, in his ignorance, that the flood would not reach the tops of the mountains and that if he clung to the top of a mountain, he would be saved from drowning. His father, Nuh, said to him, 4U-J cs *!&/m jyS V) iThis day there is no saviorfrom the decree ofAllah except him on whom He has mercy.) This means that nothing will be saved today from the command of Allah. ile iAnd waves came in between them, so he (the son) was among the drowned.) JsVt itlii ^ ,if. 444. And it was said: O earth! Swallow up your water, and O sky! Withhold (your rain). And the water was made to subside and the decree was fulfilled. And it rested on (Mount) Judi, and it was said: "Away with the people who are wrongdoing!")

The End ofthe Flood Allah, the Exalted, informs that when the people of the earth were all drowned, except for the people on the ship, He commanded the earth to swallow its water, which had sprang from it and gathered upon it. Then He commanded the sky to cease raining. iAnd the water was made to subside This means that it (the water) began to decrease. i'N iand the decree was fulfilled> This means that all of those who disbelieved in Allah were removed from the people of the earth. Not a single one of them remained upon the earth. iAnd it (the ship) rested> This is referring to the ship and those who were in it. 'Pf ion (Mount) Judi Mujahid said, Judi is a mountain in Al- Jazirah (Northwest Mesopotamia) where the mountains sought to tower above each other on the day of the drowning. On that day of destruction, all the mountains sought to be higher (to avoid being overcome by the water). However, this mountain (Judi) humbled itself for Allah, the Mighty and Sublime, and therefore it was not drowned. This is why Nuh s ship anchored upon it. 111 Qatadah said, The ship rested upon it

(Mount Judi) for a month before they (the people) came down from it. Qatadah also said, Allah made Nuh's ship remain on Mount Judi in the land of Al-Jazirah, as a lesson and a sign. 12 ' Even the early generations of this Ummah saw it. How many ships are there that have come after it and have been destroyed and became dust? At-Tabari 15:337. Tabari 15:338.

Surah VL Hud (45-47) (Part-12 and it was said: Away with the people who are wrongdoing!") means destruction and loss for them. The term away with here implies being far away from the mercy of Allah. For verily, they were destroyed to the last of them, and none of them survived. j* JU" TLj Q> tj) all ^ S; ,2i Jli i 4 ^ J Q 7 jli " i1 ; St j Si 4^ . And Niih called upon his Lord and said, "O my Lord! Verily, my son is of my family! And certainly, Your promise is true, and You are the Most Just of the judges.") 446. He said: "O Nuh! Surely, he is not of your family; verily, his work is unrighteous, so ask not of Me that of which you have no knowledge! I admonish you, lest you should be one of the ignorant,") 447. Nuh said: "O my Lord! I seek refuge with You from asking You that of which I have no knowledge. And unless You forgive me and have mercy on me, I would indeed be one of the losers.") A Return to the Story of the Son of Nuh and mentioning what transpired between Nuh and Allah concerning Him This was a request for information and an inquiry from Nuh concerning the circumstances of his son's drowning. 4 and said, O my Lord! Verily, my son is of my family!") This means, Verily, You promised to save my family and Your promise is the truth that does not fail. Therefore, how can he (my son) be drowned and You are the Most Just of the judges?" 4^ S; J4 'A iUi Js"

68 Tahir Ibn Kathir 4 He (Allah) said: O Niih! Surely, he is not of your family..." } This means, He (your son) is not of those whom I promised to save. I only promised you that I would save those of your family who believe. For this reason Allah said, and your family except him against whom the Word has already gone forth. [11:40] Thus, for his son, it had already been decreed that he would be drowned due to his disbelief and his opposition to his father, the Prophet of Allah, Nuh peace be upon him. Concerning Allah's statement, A Surely, he is not of your family; } meaning that he (Nuh's son) was not among those whom Allah promised to save. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ibn Abbas said, He was the son of Niih, but he opposed him in deeds and intention. Ikrimah said in some of the modes of recitation it said here, Verily, he (Nuh's son) worked deeds that were not righteous. & Ja^ b 448. It was said: "O Nuh! Come down (from the ship) with peace from Us and blessings on you and on the people who are with you (and on some of their offspring), but (there will be other) people to whom We shall grant their pleasures (for a time), but in the end a painful torment will reach them from Us." } The Command to descend from the Ship with Peace and Blessings Allah, the Exalted, informs of what was said to Nuh when the ship anchored on Mount Judi, peace be upon him, peace m At-Tabari 15 :343

were sent upon him and the believers with him. This salutation was also for every believer from his progeny until

the Day of Resurrection. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, "Every

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2609–2673]

male and female believer until the Day of Resurrection is included in this salutation of peace. Likewise, every male and female disbeliever until the Day of Resurrection is included in this promise of torment

and pleasure.¹¹¹ Muhammad bin Ishaq said, When Allah wanted to stop the flood, He sent a wind upon the face of the earth that caused the water to be still. Then the springs of the earth were closed off from the great flooding and the pouring (rain) from the sky halted. Allah, the Exalted, says, iAnd it was said: "O earth! Swallow up your water... [11:44] Thus, the water began decreasing and subsiding until the ship settled on Mount Judi. The People of the Tawrah (the Jews) claim that this occurred during the seventh month (of the year) and it lasted for seventeen nights. Then, on the first day of the tenth month, he (Nuh) saw the mountain tops. Then after forty more days, Nuh opened the small window in the roof of the ship and he sent a raven out to see what the water had done. However, the raven did not return to him Then, he sent a pigeon out but it returned to him without finding any place (land) to put its two feet down. He extended his hand out of the ship and the pigeon grabbed his hand so that Nuh could pull it back into the ship. Then, after seven more days passed, he sent the pigeon out again to investigate for him. The pigeon returned in the evening with a leaf from an olive tree in its mouth. From this, Nuh knew that the water had decreased from the face of the earth. He remained in the ship for seven more days before he sent the pigeon out again. This time the pigeon did not return to him, so he knew that the earth had appeared. Thus, a year was completed from the time that Allah sent the flood, until the time of Nuh sending the pigeon. The first day of the first month of the second year began when the face of the earth appeared and land became m At-Tabari 15:353.

Hud (50-52) (Part-12 that it occurred, as if he witnessed it himself. iwhich We reveal unto you;} This means, We teach it to (Muhammad) as revelation from Us to you. you i neither you nor your people knew it before this.} This means that neither you (Muhammad jfi) nor anyone of your people, have any knowledge of this. This is so that no one who rejects you can say that you learned it from him. Rather, it was Allah Who informed you of it in conformity with the true situation (of the story), just as the Books of the Prophets who were before you testify to. Therefore, you should be patient with the rejection of your people and their harming you. For verily, We shall help you and surround you with Our aid. Then, We will make the (good) end for you and those who follow you in this life and the Hereafter. This is what We did with the Messengers when We helped them against their enemies. 41*-*** Lij \j>^} 4 Verily , We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe.} Allah also said, GjQ S)T ii? 4And, verily, Our Word luis gone forth of old for Our servants, the Messengers, that they verily, would be made triumphant>(37:171-172] Then, Allah says, Ji juli) 4So be patient. Surely, the (good) end is for those who have Taqiva.} V.) 41 4 -AAC U ii' jli \j, fc. yti isk 4 r-,1 g j&J y^ & ^ pZ>

450. And to the 'Ad (people We sent) their brother Hud. He said, "O my people! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him . Certainly, you do nothing but invent lies!} 451 . "O my people I ask of you no reward for it (the Message). My reward is only from Him Wlw created me. Will you not then understand?"} 452. "And O my people! Ask forgiveness of your Lord and then repent to Him, He will send you (from the sky) abundant rain, and add strength to your strength, so do not turn away as crininals. } The Story of Prophet Hud and the People of 'Ad Allah, the Exalted, says, 4And} This is an introductory to what is implied: Verily, We sent. 4to the 'Ad (people) their brother Hiid.} Hud came to them commanding them to worship Allah alone, without any associates. He forbade them from worshipping the idols which they made up, inventing names as gods. He informed them that he did not want any reward from them for his sincere advising and conveying of Allah s Message. He only sought his reward from Allah, the One Who created him. 4&Z *&} 4Will you not then understand?} Someone

has come calling you to what will benefit your situation in this life and the Hereafter without asking for any wage (from them). Then he commanded them to seek the forgiveness of the One Who is capable of expiating previous sins. He also commanded them to repent for that which they may do in the future. Whoever has these characteristics, Allah will make his sustenance easy for him, grant him ease in his affairs and guard over his situation. For this reason Allah says, -j}

73 Surah VL Hud (53-56) (Part-12 4He will send you (from the sky) abundant rain, 453. They said: "O Hud! No evidence have you brought us, and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying! And we are not believers in you."} 454. All that we say is that some of our gods (false deities) have seized you with evil (madness). He said: 1 call Allah to witness and bear you witness that / am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship, > 455. Besides Him (Allah) . So plot against me, all of you, and give me no respite."} 456. 1 put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock. Verily, my Lord is on the straight path (the truth).} The Conversation between (the People of) 'Ad and Hud Allah, the Exalted, informs that they said to their Prophet, 4^ C} 4No evidence have you brought us.} This means that they claimed that Hud had not brought them any proof or evidence for what he claimed. 4-Ms & +!'* S* &j} 4and we shall not leave our gods for your (mere) saying!} They were saying how could his mere statement, Leave these gods, be sufficient proof for them to leave their idols? t St 4and we are not believers in you.} This means that they did not believe what he was saying was

74 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iAll that we say is that some of our gods have seized you with evil.} They were saying, We think that some of our idols have afflicted you with madness and insanity in your intellect because you are trying to stop them from being worshipped and defame them. oi lij ?!Jy-; Ji 4He said: I call Allah to witness and bear you witness, that I am free from that which you ascribe as partners in worship besides Him (Allah) .>[1 1:54-55] Here, he is saying, Verily, I am innocent of all of the rivals and idols (that you associate with Allah). iSo plot against me, all of you,} you and your gods if they are true. iand give me no respite.} the blinking of an eye. Then, Allah says, S* ck ^ jf)\$ jcm 41 put my trust in Allah, my Lord and your Lord! There is not a moving creature but He has the grasp of its forelock.} Every creature is under His (Allah s) power and His authority. He is the Best Judge, the Most Just, Who does not do any injustice in His ruling. For verily. He is upon the straight path. Verily, this argument contains a far-reaching proof and absolute evidence of the truthfulness of what Hud had come to them with. It also proves the falsehood of them worshipping idols that could not benefit nor harm them. Rather, these idols were inanimate objects that could not hear, see, befriend, or make enmity. The only One Who is worthy of having worship directed solely towards Him is Allah alone, without any partners. He is the One in Whose Hand is the sovereignty and

Jj tta cjjJtSsLAjjj^f p oJ^r^U-j \5jj4j \$ 9Xr*^P*~ ^sc. y&tA;t)J / - i. *' fc\$ #50(bjJtijtjl* juIjL*juVj He is in control of all things. There is nothing except that it is under His ownership, power and authority. Thus, there is no deity worthy of worship except Him and there is no Lord other than Him. di- j u < M& 4b Uy aj \$\$['ft jj iL * Vi^ :t C3; %& . t \$ 'fZ \pa uM 6 o4 #1 i<' - t'.-l' i"- / " " ** ^ ^ yjl!j [jJUi> jlfi dllij , jijf' 4 5*~i b 'J-'J |^y 4 IA^j *K yl^ j;^ ^ G'ii .ji ia2 vl& & h\ 4 . -?j" 457. So if you turn away, still I have conveyed the Message with which I was sent to you. My Lord will make another people succeed you, and you will not harm Him in the least. Surely, my Lord is Guardian over all

things. 458. And when Our commandment came, We saved Hud and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us, and We saved them from a severe torment.} 459. Such were [the people of] Ad. They rejected the Ayat of their Lord and disobeyed His Messengers, and followed the command of every proud, obstinate (oppressor of the truth from their leaders).}

76 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr 460. And they were pursued by a curse in this world and (so they will be) on the Day of Resurrection. No doubt! Verily, Ad disbelieved in their Lord. So away with 'Ad, the people of Hud> Hud says to them, If you turn away from that which I have brought to you in reference to worship of Allah, Who is your Lord alone, without any partners, then the proof has been established against you. This is because I have conveyed the Message of Allah to you, which He has sent me with. Lj j 4 My Lord will make another people succeed you,} This refers to a group of people who will worship Allah alone, without associating anything with Him. This also implies that the polytheists do not bother Allah and they do not harm Him in the least with their disbelief. To the contrary, their disbelief merely harms their own selves. 4jLo- ^ i Surely, my Lord is Guardian over all things.} This means that Allah is a Witness and Guardian over the statements of His servants and their actions. He will give them due recompense for their actions. If they do good deeds. He will reward them with good. If they do evil, He will punish them with evil. The Destruction of the People of Ad and the Salvation of Those among Them Who believed 4& it 4 And when Our commandment came,} This is referring to the barren wind with which Allah destroyed them, to the very last of them. The mercy and kindness of Allah, the Exalted saved Hud and his followers from this terrible punishment. JL * /,<' f > S* Mi' Tp-rj y*d% yf i Such were Ad (people). They rejected the Ayat of their Lord This means they disbelieved in the proofs and revelations (of

(in Arabia). They lived after the people of Ad, so Allah sent to them, 4 their brother Salih. ^ He (Salih) commanded them to worship Allah alone. He said to them, \$SP&& i He brought you forth from the earth This means: He began your creation from it (the earth). From it He created your father, Adam. iftt \$ 4 and settled you therein,} This means: He made you prosperous in the earth. You are settled in it and you treasure it. 4 then ask forgiveness} This is in reference to your previous sins. && i and turn to Him in repentance.} This is in reference to the future. VO1 OJ 4 Certainly, my Lord is Near (to all by His knowledge), Responsive.} This is similar to Allah's statement, lit t-JjJl 4 And when My servants ask you concerning Me, then (answer them), I am indeed Near (to them by My knowledge). I respond to the invocations of the supplicant when he calls on Me.} [2:186] -Mi 1* Txî iy* ii - i - - <' *>, . ">*/J "; /. < * <. >>" : "r .< * J "'< >\ r . > > . TTîey saiW: "O Sail!/?/ You have been among us as a figure of good hope until this! Do you (now) forbid us the worship of what our fathers have worshipped? But we are really in grave

*S doubt as to that to which you invite us."} 463. He said: "O my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord, and there has come to me a mercy from Him, who then can help me against Allah, if I were to disobey Him? Then you increase me not but in loss."} The Conversation between Salih and the People of Thamud Allah, the Exalted, mentions what transpired in the discussion between Salih and his people. Allah informs of their ignorance and obstinacy in their statement, Jj 1 iLi 4 You have been among us as a figure of good hope till this!} They were saying in this, We had hope in your strong intellect before you began saying what you have said. si: 4 Do you (now) forbid us the worship of what

our fathers have worshipped?} what those who were before us were upon. ii" ob.j \j} 4But we are really in grave doubt as to that xuhich you invite us.} This alludes to the great amount of doubt that they had. 44-3m oj jf-iO fyk &} 4He said : "O my people! Tell me, if I have a clear proof from my Lord..."} In reference to what He (Allah) has sent me with to you, I am upon conviction and sure evidence. u*-* *-r-J <-< > 4and there has come to me a mercy from Him, who then can help me against Allah, if I were to disobey Him?} and abandon calling you to the truth and the worship of Allah alone. If I did so, you would not be able to bring me any

tJ1 &?'*.- TTt /& / > > .> "/ , < / ci--* *J irZj^f.uP jU .? > -i'* >>*/" ' > > " ^ > ^iSiSa '^- benefit, nor increase ^li-U J^=>" Lajjjj j"^=jta^i^cu_!JHL-AjyL"j ^ ^ k J_5JxSvla A^jll 4-*s"p-t-i ^S,J-? ^'(vr;^bj ^ ci\ji jlljU-iiC-V i_j\i ' 't' "<' jJU^ me 4^-ii "f in loss.} This means loss and ruin. <'! ijli ."jjjt J^= tijjjs i-j'l ("fe=tl X> jilf Je)> V, ^ i-" 'V.v</ vU* liU (*^=V /*-*- ^ -U-j CiJJ'j LUi .. 1J ""^S /*-"" lid-^ bj? C . J-?ui ca> ' *i >*-""^ .] . jf^4' Gyift j* iitj \f > jDj ipC-JU3* rfsii j IJ4& v>< :;bj+-> o; Vi ir* oV) jif i";-rr-" iv^=> AS' . "And O my people! This she-camel of Allah is a sign to you, so leave her to graze in Allah's land, and touch her not with evil, lest a near torment should seize you."} . But they slaughtered her. So he said: "Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. This is a promise (a threat) that will not be belied. } . So when Our commandment came. We saved Salih and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us, and from the disgrace of that Day. Verily, your Lord - He is the All-Strong, the All-Mighty.} 467 . And As-Sayhah (awful cry) overtook the wrongdoers, so

they lay (dead), prostrate in their homes.}468. As if they had never lived there. No doubt! Verily, Thamud disbelieved in their Lord. So away with Thamud!) A discussion of this story has already preceded in Surat Al- A'raf and it is sufficient without having to be repeated here. Allah is the Giver of success. j 3J & \b otM S:t SHj) V 4jL tri *?! ^ Of**- ! Au ow d>*% ^ 'iv -jo* d! <& <&" iiV.\$3 jju 'yT, M Jlii 3* #ii' cS*b ^ Si 469. And verily, there came Our messengers to Ibrahim with the glad tidings. They said : "Saldman (greetings or peace!)" He answered, Salamun (greetings or peace!)," and he hastened to entertain them with a roasted calf.) 470. But when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them, and conceived a fear of them. They said: "Fear not, we have been sent against the people of Lilt.") 471. And his wife was standing (there), and she laughed. But We gave her glad tidings of Ishaq, and after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.) 472. She said (in astonishment): 'Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband an old man? Verily, this is a strange thing!") 473. They said: "Do you wonder at the decree of Allah? The mercy of Allah and His blessings be on you, O the family [of Ibrahim]. Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All- Glorious.") The Coming of the Angels to Ibrahim and Their Glad Tidings to Him of Ishaq and Ya qub Allah, the Exalted, says, 4liij 4And verily, there came Our messengers) The word messengers here means angels.

ito Ibrahim with the glad tidings.} It has been said that the word the glad tidings means, Receive the glad tidings of Ishaq. Others have said that it means, The destruction of the people of Prophet Lut. The proof of the correctness of the first view is in Allah s statement, 4 4/- \$ [f- iThen when the fear had gone away from (the mind of) Ibrahim, and the glad tidings had readied him, he began to plead with Us for the people of Lut.}[11 :74) Jli iThey said: "Salaman." He answered, "Salamun. } This means, Upon you. The scholars of explanation have said, Ibrahim s reply of Salamun was better than that with which they had greeted him with, because the subjective case (Salamun instead of Salaman) alludes to affirmation

and eternity. & J iand he hastened to entertain them with a roasted calf.} This means that he (Ibrahim) left with haste in order to bring them food, as a host. The food that he brought was a calf. The word Hanidh means roasted upon heated stones. This meaning has been reported from Ibn Abbas, Qatadah and others. This is as Allah has said in another verse. rijli iThen he turned to his household, and brought out a roasted calf. And placed it before them (saying): "Will you not eat?") [51 :26-27] This verse contains many aspects of the etiquettes of hosting guests. IU At-Tabari 15:384, 385.

Silrah 11. Hud (69-73) (Part-12 y pr:*' \$*} 4Bi when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them,} This means that he felt estranged from them. 4* J'-\$" iand conceived a fear of them.} This is because angels are not concerned with food. They do not desire it, nor do they eat it. Therefore, when Ibrahim saw them reject the food that he had brought them, without tasting any of it at all, he felt a mistrust of them. 4 * {& jZ-j\j} iand conceived a fear of them.} As-Suddi said, When Allah sent the angels to the people of Lut, they set out walking in the form of young men, until they came to Ibrahim and they were hosted by him. When Ibrahim saw them, he rushed to host them. 4 v yi*' -ill {[}] iThen he tamed to his household, and brought out a roasted calf.}\51:26] He slaughtered it (the calf), roasted it on hot stones and brought it to them. Then, he sat down with them, when he placed it before them, (saying): Will you not eat? They said, O Ibrahim! Verily, we do not eat food without a price. Ibrahim then said, Verily, this food has a price. They said, What is its price? He said, You must mention the Name of Allah over it before eating it and praise Allah upon finishing it. Jibril then looked at MikaTl and said, This man has the right that his Lord should take him as an intimate friend. 4(U^=c &\ 44 v .J\ \Z&} iBut when he saw their hands went not towards it (the meal), he mistrusted them,} When Ibrahim saw that they were not eating, he became scared and frightened by them. Then, when Sarah looked and saw that he was honoring them, she began to serve them and she was laughing. She said, What amazing guests we have.

4 Tafsir Ibn Kathlr We serve them ourselves, showing them respect and they do not eat our food. Then, concerning Allah s statement about the angels, 4GZ v \&) 4They said: Fear not,") They were saying, Do not be afraid of us. Verily, we are angels sent to the people of Lut in order to destroy them. Then, Sarah laughed in delight of the good news of their destruction. This is because they had caused much corruption and their disbelief was severe. For this reason, she was rewarded with the glad tidings of a son, even after her despair. Concerning Allah s statement, vy-i ?jj 4Mr iand after Ishaq, of Ya'qub.) This means that the son that she was going to have would have a son (her grandson) who would succeed him and beget many children. For verily, Ya'qub was the son of Ishaq, just as Allah says in Surat Al-Baqarah, jSm ij!\j tS-Cu jj-AjLu b A-XJ Jfi ojllf CjjAjo 4 0 ft ft l 4 4] (jIM ft J *' jj r-' ft 40r were you witnesses when death approached Ya'qub? When he said unto his sons, "What will you worship after me? They said, "We shall worship your God, the God of your fathers, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Ishaq, One God, and to him we submit.") [2:133] From this point in this verse there is an evidence for those who say that Isma'il was the son of Ibrahim who was to be sacrificed. It could not have been Ishaq, because the glad tidings were given that he would have a son bom to him named Ya'qub. So how could Ibrahim be commanded to sacrifice him when he was a small child and there had not been born to him a child yet, named Ya'qub, who was promised? The promise of Allah is true and there is no m At-Tabari 15 :389

Surah VL Hud (69-73) (Part-U) 85 breaking of Allah's promise. Therefore, it is not possible that Ibrahim was to sacrifice this child (Ishaq) with the condition being as it was. This makes it clear that Ismail was the son that was to be sacrificed and this is the best, most correct and clearest evidence of that. And all praise is due to Allah. 4J: ^ bV, 111;\$ iShe said (in astonishment): Woe unto me! Shall I bear a child while I am an old woman, and here is my husband an old man?"} Allah speaks of her statement in this verse, just as He spoke of her action in another verse. / U y f I^ * / // y / / iThen his wife came forward with a loud voice: she smote her face, and said: "A barren old woman!"}[5\29] This was the custom of the women in their speech and actions when they were expressing amazement. 4Then said: Do you wonder at the decree ofAllah?"} This means that the angels were saying to her, Do not be amazed at the command of Allah, for verily, whenever He wants something, He merely says Be and it is. So do not be amazed at this, even though you are old and barren and your husband is a very old man. Verily, Allah is able to do whatever He wills. m if%^ ji'& #&& iThe mercy of Allah and His blessing be on you, O the family (of Ibrahim). Surely, He (Allah) is All-Praiseworthy, All- Glorious.} This means that He is the Most Praiseworthy in all of His actions and statements. He is praised and glorified in His Attributes and His Self. For this reason, it is confirmed in the two Sahihs that they (the Prophet's Companions) said, Verily, we already know how to greet you with Salam (peace), but how do we send Salah (prayer) upon you, O Messenger of Allah? He 3^ said,

h** J* JP* r^ 'Ah olLi" LIS' jl pj JI oLii iiji',j Ji JU 0; ui jIa; 4 ^ ^ ^ x / , ^ JL^ " . 1 1 j\ Say, O Allah, send prayers upon Muham- mad and the family of Muhammad, just as You have sent prayers upon Ibrahim and the family of Ibrahim. And bless Muhammad and the fa- mily ofMuhammad, just as You have blessed the family of Ibrahim. Trtdy, You are the All- Praiseworthy, All- Glorious ."s111 tr- mm . ""< >\s ' ,1 IJLAs, * JjHC-ljiJ "AjJ \$v**c ' X. c AiKAK's-JbiUAi&pJu A^j * ^ t**/ * .I*' ">i ^ *i WJtSQ? ,Xc'(vf"prl-*^*U03 1JCaJ5j\cji jit? Ld-L) >*W- litjj ijUl*c~_ulijJ\i Jj J villii (jltliiJ y*yi Ji^ \$ ^ Si :j d4. c&2 pf p*j> ^ K cs> J* L>\Yc. jlpj'i j |3^^ *^r Ji / Ui" o { } } . 474. Then zohen the fear had gone away from (the mind of) Ibrahim, and the glad tidings had readied him, he began to plead with Us (Our messengers) for the people of Lilt.} 475. Verily, Ibrahim was, withwut doubt, forbearing, used to invoke Allah with humility, and was repentant.} 476. O Ibrahim! Forsake this. Indeed, the commandment of your Lord has gone forth. Verily, there will come a torment for them which cannot be turned back. } [1 ' Path Al-Bari 6 :469 , and Muslim 1 :305

87Surah U. Hud (74-76) (Part-12) The Dispute ofIbrahim over the People ofLut Allah, the Exalted, informs of what happened after the fright of Ibrahim left him and he felt no more fear of the angels when they refused to eat. After this, they gave him the glad tidings of the birth of a son and the destruction of the people of Lut. When they told him of this, he spoke to them as Said bin Jubayr narrated concerning this verse. Said said: When Jibril and the other angels who were with him came to Ibrahim, they said, &&& iVerily, we are going to destroy the people of this town .> Ibrahim said to them, Will you destroy a town that has three hundred believers in it? They said, No. He then said, Will you destroy a town that has two hundred believers in it? They said, No. He said, Will you destroy a town that has forty believers in it? They said, No. He then said, Thirty? They still replied, No. This continued until he said, Five? They said, No. Then he said, What do you think if there is one Muslim man in the town, would you destroy it? They said, No. With this, Ibrahim jg said, ta ^ yu tSJ iBut there is Lut in it. They said: "We know better who is there. We will verily, save him and his family except his

wife."} Therefore, Ibrahim remained silent and his soul was at rest.¹¹¹ Concerning Allah's statement, verily, Ibrahim was, without doubt, forbearing, used to invoke Allah with humility, and was repentant (to Allah).} [11:751 This is a commendation for Ibrahim because of these beautiful characteristics Then Allah says, *wa-Idha* 'il 'Ji m At-Tabari 15:403.

\$0 Ibrahim! Forsake this. Indeed, the commandment of your Lord has gone forth.} This means the decree was settled concerning them and the Word was already given that they should be destroyed. The evil torment was coming to them, that cannot be averted from wicked people. *A*ji* ,*"Vj fj; 1* Jlij jrj: Oil* . 'jSiU j\$3 OjIL* ; iylT j4 jy^ " && !# & jdi S\$ cgz 4 t & 4.*^ C 5&J "5|S v^-* 477. And when Our messengers came to Lut, he was grieved on account of them and was concerned for them. He said: "This is a distressful day."} 478. And his people came rushing towards him, and since aforetime they used to commit crimes, he said: "O my people! Here are my daughters, they are purer for you. So have Taqwa of Allah and disgrace me not with regard to my guests! Is there not among you a single right-minded man?"} 479. They said: "Surely, you know that we have no need of your daughters, and indeed you know well what we want!"} The Coining of the Angels to Lut, His Grief, and His Discussion with His People Allah, the Exalted, informs about the coming of His messenger angels. After they informed Ibrahim of their mission to destroy the people of Lut, they left him and set out to destroy Lut's people that very night. After leaving Ibrahim, they came to Lut. Some say that they came to him while he was on a piece of land that belonged to him. Others say that they came to him while he was in his home. They approached him while they were in the most handsome of forms. They appeared in the forms of young men with handsome faces. This was a test from Allah that contained much wisdom and a firm evidence. Their appearance saddened him (Lot) and he felt grief in his soul because of them. He was afraid that if he did not host them as his guests, someone else of his people

Hud (77-79) (Part-12) would host them and harm them. 4He said: "This is a distressful day."} Ibn Abbas and others said that this means, A severe test for him. This was because he knew that he would have to defend them and it would cause great problems for him. Qatadah said, They came to him while he was on a piece of land that belonged to him. They requested him to host them. He agreed, but he was shy of them and he walked in front of them. On the way to his home he said to them in attempt to convince them to go away, By Allah, I do not know any people on the face of the earth more wicked and disgusting than these people of this town. Then he walked on a little further. Then he repeated the same statement to them. He continued doing this until he had repeated the same thing four times. Then Qatadah said, They were ordered not to destroy them until their Prophet testified against them of this. 121 Concerning Allah's statement, *irushing toivards him.*} meaning, they made haste and rushed due to their delight of this (new young men). Concerning the statement, *qA*-*; \i^ m }* and since aforetime they used to commit crimes.} This means that this did not cease being their behavior until they were seized (by Allah's torment) and they were still in the same condition. *i f j cA }* He said: "O my people! Here are my daughters (the women of the nation), they are purer for you..."} This was his attempt to direct them to their women, for verily Tabari 15:411. Tabari 15:408.

the Prophet is like a father for his nation. Therefore, he tries to guide them to that which is better for them in this life and the Hereafter. This is similar to his statement to them in another verse, *? p 'Jt pi* 4Go you in unto the males of the nation, and leave those whom Allah has created for you to be your

wives? Nay, you are a trespassing people! :165-166] Allah said in another verse, uiii digp r) \$ 4They (the people of the city) said: Did we not forbid you from entertaining any of the 'A/flwfnP'X15:70] This means, Didn't we forbid you from hosting men (male) guests? rfjG J) pr) id 'ji ~df>. 4[hut] said: "These (the girls of the nation) are my daughters, if you must act (so)." Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.>(15:71-72] Then, Allah said, in this noble verse, ip iHere are my daughters, they are purer for you. Mujahid said, Actually, they were not his daughters, but they were from among his nation. Every Prophet is like a father to his nation. 111 A similar statement has been reported from Qatadah and others. 121 Concerning the statement, 4So have Taqwa of Allah and disgrace me not with regard to my guests!} At-Jabari 15:414. At-Tabari 15:413.

91Surah IT Hud (80-81) (Part-12) This means, Accept what I command you by limiting the fulfillment of your desires to your women. & *S\$> Us there not among you a single right-minded man?} This means, Is there not a good man among you who will accept what I am enjoining upon you and abandon what I have forbidden for you? iThey said: "Surely you know that we have no need of your daughters .. ." } This means, Verily, you know that we do not want our women, nor do we desire them. 4ijz& 4and indeed you know well what we want!} This means, We only want males and you know that. So what need is there for you to continue speaking to us about this? 'Ash dp S-i ty. Pf!> 4^ sj* ii j" 4 J ji H} ^ CT ' (*^"* prZ. He said: "Would that I had strength to overpower you, or that I could betake myself to some powerful support." } 481. They (messengers) said: "O Liit! Verily, we are the messengers from your Lord! They shall not reach you! So travel with your family in a part of the night, and let not any of you look back; but your wife (will remain behind), verily, the punishment which will afflict them, will afflict her. Indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near?" } Lut s Inability, His Desire for Strength and the Angels' Informing Him of the Reality Allah, the Exalted says that Lut was threatening them with his statement, 4 3

4Would that I had strength (men) to overpower you,} meaning, I would surely have made an example of you and done (harm) to you from myself and my family. In this regard, there is a Hadith which is reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said, iSjk jil i 4ui vJ-j Jri IjJ (J? & l/i ill aMay Allah's mercy be upon Lut, for verily, he betook himself to a powerful support -[meaning Allah, the Mighty and Sublime.] Allah did not send any Prophet after him, except amidst [an influential family] among his people With this, the angels informed him that they were the messengers of Allah sent to them. They also told him that his people would not be able to reach him (with any harm). iThey (messengers said): O Lilt! Verily, we are the messengers from your Lord! They shall not reach you!} They commanded him to travel with his family during the last part of night and that he should follow them from behind. In this way it would be as though he were driving his family (as a cattle herder). li and let not any of you look back;} This means, If you hear the sound of what (torment) befalls them (the people of the village), do not rush towards that disturbing noise. Rather, continue leaving. ^} ibut your wife,} Most of the scholars said that this means that she would not travel at night and she did not go with Lot. Rather, she stayed in her house and was destroyed. Others said that it means that she looked back (during the travel). This later group says that she left with them and when she heard the inevitable destruction, she turned and looked back. When hi At-Tirmidhi no . 3 116

Hud (82-83) (Part-12) she looked she said, O my people! Thus, a stone came down from the sky and killed her. Then they (the angels) brought close to him the destruction of his people as good news for him, because he said to them, Destroy them in this very hour. They replied, indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near?} They were saying this while Luts people were standing at his door. They tried to rush his door from all sides and Lut was standing at the door repelling them, deterring them and trying to prevent them from what they were doing. Yet, they would not listen to him. Instead, they threatened him and sought to intimidate him. At this point, Jibril came out to them and struck them in their faces with his wing. This blow blinded their eyes and they retreated, unable to see their way. This is as Allah said, 4A,j^j qUe 'jijJj l-'llii if- tjij'j 4And they indeed sought to shame his guest (asking to commit sodomy with than). So We blinded their eyes (saying), Then taste you My torment and My warnings."^[54:37] *aT) j A Lfio Ji Ji&jQj 482. So when Our commandment came, We turned them upside down, and rained on them stones of clay, in an array.} 483. Marked from your Lord; and they are not ever far from the wrongdoers.} The Town of Lut s People is overturned and Their Destruction Allah, the Exalted, says, H J\ a} 4So when Our commandment came,} This happened at sunrise.

4We [turned it]...} The city ofSadum (Sodom) iupside down,} This is similar to Allah s statement, 4So there covered than that which did cover (torment with stones).}53:54] This means, We rained upon it with stones made of SijjU." SijjU is a Persian word meaning stones made of clay. This definition has been mentioned by Ibn Abbas and others. 111 Some of the scholars said that it (SijjU) derived from the word Sang, which means a stone. Some others said it means Wakil, which is clay. In another verse Allah says, ithe stones of clay,} This means clay made into strong, hard stone. Some of the scholars said it means baked clay. Al- Bukhari said, SijjU means that which is big and strong. Concerning Allah s statement, 4in an array.} Some of the scholars said that Mandud means the stones were arranged in the heavens and prepared for that (destruction). Others said, 4in an array.} This word means that some of them (the stones) followed others in their descent upon the people of Lut. Concerning the statement, i^y^} 4^Marked meaning the stones were marked and sealed, all of them having the names of their victims written on them. Qatadah and Ikrimah both said, Musdwwamah means each m At-Tabari 15:434.

Surah YL Hud (84) (Part-12) 95 stone was encompassed by a sprinkling of red coloring. The commentators have mentioned that it (the shower of stones) descended upon the people of the town and upon the various villages around it. One of them would be speaking with some people when a stone would strike him from the sky and kill him while he was among the people. Thus, the stones followed them, striking the people in the entire land until they destroyed them all. Not a single one ofthem remained. Concerning Allah s statement, ot Jt iand they are not everfarfrom the wrongdoers.} This means that this vengeance (of Allah) is not far from similar wrongdoers. Verily, it has been reported in a Hadith of the Sunan collections, from Ibn Abbas, which he attributed to the Prophet %, "Whoever you find doing the deed of Lut's people [homosexuality] , then kill the doer and the one who allows it to be done to him (both partners)."f21 4 'S', CAm oCl Xj\j {Zssae& xi\ 3'3 3U"J' 484. And to the Madyan people (We sent) their brother Shu'ayb. He said: "O my people! Worship Allah, you have no other god but Him, and give not short measure or weight. I see you in prosperity and verily, I fear for you the torment of a Day encompassing."}

The Story of the People of Madyan and the Call of Shu'ayb Allah, the Exalted, says, We sent a Messenger to the people of Madyan. They were a tribe of Arabs who lived between the land of the Al-Hijaz and Ash-Sham, close to the land of Ma'an. 1,1 At-Jabari 15:438. Abu Dawud no.4462, At-Tirmidhi no.1456 and Ibn Majah, no.

Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr Their land was known by the name of their tribe and was thus, called Madyan. Allah sent unto them the Prophet Shu'ayb and he was of the noblest of them in lineage. For this reason, Allah said, 4their brother Shu'ayb.} Shu'ayb commanded them to worship Allah alone without associating any partners with him. He also prohibited them from cheating in their weights and measures (for business transactions). 41 see you in prosperity meaning, in your livelihood and your provisions. And verily, I fear that you will be deprived of this bounty that you are enjoying by violating Allah's prohibitions. ^ oCl Zi}j} 4and verily, I fear for you the torment of a Day encompassing.} This means the abode of the Hereafter. . if > / X > < 485. "And O my people! Give full measure and weight in justice and reduce not the things that are due to the people, and do not commit mischief in the land, causing corruption."}

486. "That which is left by Allah is better for you, if you are believers. And I am not a guardian over you."4 First, he (Shu'ayb) prohibited them from cheating in business by decreasing the weights whenever they gave (products) to people. He commanded them to give just measure and weight whether they were giving or receiving (in transactions). He also forbade them from causing mischief and corruption in the land. This was due to their practice of highway robbery along the roads. Abu Ja'far bin Jarir said, ip iThat which is left by Allah (after giving the rights of the people) is better for you,} This means what you gain from your successful business dealings in which you have given just measure, is better for you than wrongfully taking the wealth of the people. Ibn Jarir said that this statement has been reported from Ibn Abbas and I say it is similar to Allah's statement, ifyLLj ^ jsSay : "Not equal are Khabith (all that is evil) and Tayyib (all that is good), even though the abundance of Khabith may please you. H5:100J Allah then says, 4M* ia 4And I am not a guardian over you.} This means a watcher over you people. In other words, Do this for Allah and not to be seen by the people. L* Uyi ili Ajl jl A p *. \ \ > } i jluk 487. They said: "O Shu'ayb! Does your Salah command you that we give up what our fathers used to worship, or that we give up doing what we like with our property? Verily, you are the forbearer, right-minded!"121 At-Tabari 15:447. ^ They said this sarcastically.

The Response of Shu'ayb's People They said to Shu'ayb, in mockery, iDoes your Salah} Al-A'mash said, This means your reading. XSt C& o\ 4command you that we give up what our fathers used to worship, meaning the idols and statues. Li IS) Jjiu J jfy ior that we give up doing what we like with our property?\$ This means, Should we abandon our practice of lightening the scales because of your statement? This is our wealth and we will do with it as we please. Al-Hasan said concerning Allah's statement, C& ol di&b iDoes your Salah command you that we give up what our fathers used to worship,^>[1 1:87] By Allah, this means that his prayer commanded them to abandon what their fathers used to worship. ^ * At-Thawri said concerning Allah's statement, Li o' jfy 4or that we give up doing what we like with our property?} They were speaking in reference to the paying of Zakah (charity). iVerily, you are the forbearer right-minded!} Ibn Abbas, Maymun bin Mihran, Ibn Jurayj, Ibn Aslam,

and Ibn Jarir all said, These enemies of Allah were only saying this in mockery. May Allah disfigure them and curse them ll] At-Tabari 15:451.

Hud (88) (Part-12) from ever receiving His mercy. And verily, He did so. ' ol Oyt Lf t * liyy jjj jj j* fjZ Je o " oj cJs> idt C^Ai* b> J C o', ii t jj 488. He said: "O my people! Tell me if I have a clear evidence from my Lord and He has given me a good sustenance from Himself (shall I corrupt it by mixing it with the unlawfully earned money). I wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you. I only desire reform to the best of my power. And my guidance cannot come except from Allah, in Him I put my trust and unto Him I repent." } Shu'ayb s Refutation of His People He said to them: Do you see O my people, that if I 4 &' >.\$} i have a clear evidence from my Lord} meaning, upon clear guidance in that which I am calling to. 4&Z% 4%} 4and He has given me a good sustenance from Himself.} It has been said that he meant the prophethood. It has also been said that he meant the lawful provisions. It seems that the verse carries both meanings. Ath-Thawri said, ihi Z j} 3 4y1 %} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid you.} meaning, do not forbid you from something and at the same time I contradict my prohibitions in secret behind your backs, doing what I have forbidden. This is similar to what Qatadah said concerning Allah s statement, 4& Z di 34%} 41 wish not, in contradiction to you, to do that which I forbid m At-Tabari 15:453.

you .> He is saving. 1 do not forbid you all from something while I do it myself. 111 \$1 only desire reform to the best of my power.} This means, In that which I command and forbid you, I only want to correct your affair as much as I am able. 4And my guidance cannot come This means, In whatever I intend that agrees with the truth. iexcept from Allah, in Him 1 put my trust} This means in all of my affairs. iand unto Him I repent.} meaning; I return. This has been said by Mujahid and others. 489. "And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you to suffer the fate similar to that of the people of Nuh or of Hiid or of Salih, and the people of Liit are not far off from you! } 490. "And ask forgiveness of your Lord and turn unto Him in repentance. Verily, my Lord is Most Merciful, Most Loving. } He (Shu'ayb) said to them, U** pZ/k 4And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you} This means, Do not let your hatred and enmity of me cause you to persist in your corruption and disbelief. If you continue Tabari 15:453. Tabari 15:454.

this way, you will suffer the same vengeance and torment that overcame Nuh s people, Hud s people, Salih s people and Lut s people. Qatadah said, 4And O my people! Let not my Shiqaq cause you^ He is saying, T)o not be influenced by your differing with me. "111 As-Suddi said, This means your enmity of me should not lead you to continue in misguidance and disbelief, or else you will be afflicted by what afflicted them. Concerning His statement, iand the people of Lilt are not far off from you!} It has been said that this refers to the period of time. Qatadah said, This means that they were only destroyed before you yesterday. It has also been said that it refers to place. Actually, the verse carries both meanings. 4And ask forgiveness of your Lord from the previous sins. 4and turn unto Him in repentance.} In whatever evil actions yo> may encounter in the future. Concerning his statement, iVerily, my Lord is Most Merrj^i Mosf Loving> to those who repent. , Cj A ij ^^ Jjrf \ ojUjj Uj of 'fL>\ 491. They said: O Shu'ayb! We do not understand much of what you say, and we see you weak among us. Were it not for your family, you would have been stoned, and you are not m At-Tabari 15:455.

powerful against us."} 492. He said: "O my people! Is then my family of more weight with you than Allah? And you have cast Him away behind your backs. Verily, my Lord is surrounding all that you do."} The Response of Shu'ayb s People They said, <il e&& 40 Shu'ayb! We do not understand} This means that we do not comprehend. 4^} 4much} most of what you say . Ath-Thawri said, He (Shu'ayb) was called the orator of the Prophets. |11 As-Suddi said, 4and we see you weak among us.} They meant, You are only one person. Abu Rawq said, They meant. You are despised, because your tribe is not upon your religion. 4Were it not for your family, you would have been stoned,} This means, your people. Were it not for their powerful position over the people of Madyan, they would have stoned him to death. Some said that this means with rocks. It has also been said that this means that they would have cursed and insulted him verbally. ^_/_>" j-L '^j} 4and you are not powerful ag. ms* us-^ This means, You have no position of power oC'er us- Shu'ayb s Refutation of His People 4-ii Sj 4He said: "O my people! Is then my family of more weight with you than Allah?" } m At-Tabari 15:458.

Hud (93-95) (Part-12) \w> Ulj 5 i \$ \$ JaL_i /> " -' ' " * " , < / -V '^ "< < * J-A-T^L-Jl-Xp^rfU^^ ^ JjaA hh_3llm %te2f\2ki4\ f^l s^r* J. 'yQ&jy^j * * > *") Wj*- :.1"K < \ ' - n -m? m&m \, He says: You would leave me alone out of respect for my people but not out of respect for the greatness of the Lord, the Most Blessed and Exalted? Does not your awe of Allah prevent you from harming His Prophet? Indeed you have placed the fear of Allah, 4behind your backs.\$> This means that you have thrown it behind you. You do not obey it, nor do you respect it. 4- L^ SjLL*j KL> jj C j\fy 4Verity, my Lord is surrounding all that you do.} This means that He knows all of your actions and He will reward you according to them. ' -r* J tj\it j4 kj> J^lt j\ a5lC ,^t IjtLti jyCj u|Jb C*- l!2> ! ty! v^i-J -=""4 41 0-i^" j . V.k^A*^r 4 j^iulU i^jji jujl J til 4-*^ oj4 CT 1ju| \i. 493 . "And O my people! Act according to your ability, and I am acting. You will come to know who it is on whom descends the torment that will cover him with ignominy, and who is a liar! And watch you! Verily, I too am watching with you."} 494. And when Our commandment came, We saved Shu'ayb

and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us . And As- Sayhah (atvful cry) seized the wrongdoers, and they lay (Jathimin) in their homes.} 495. As if they had never lived there! So away with Madyan just as Thamild went away! } Shu'ayb s threatening of His People When the Prophet of Allah, Shu'ayb, despaired of their response to him, he said, O my people, 4Act according to your ability,} This means, Act according to your current ways. This is actually a severe threat. 4I am acting.} according to my way. 4You will come to know who it is on whom descends the torment that will cover him with ignominy, and who is a liar!} meaning, between me and you. 4And watch you!} This means to wait. 4I too am watching with you.} Allah then says, 4And what Our commandment came, We saved Shu'ayb and those who believed with him by a mercy from Us. And As- Sayhah (awful cry) seized the wrongdoers, and they lay (Jathimin) in their homes.} His saying Jathimin means extinct and lifeless without any movement. Here Allah mentions that a loud cry (Sayhah) came to them. In Surat Al-A raf He says a severe quake (Rajfah)

came to them. In Surat Ash-Shu'ara , He said it was a torment of a cloudy day. They were one nation upon which all of these punishments were gathered on the day of their destruction. In each context, Allah only mentioned that which was suitable. In Surat Al-A raf when they said, ip: 4We shall certainly drive you out, O Shu'ayb, and those who have believed with you from our town.4(7:88] In this verse it

was suitable to mention a tremor, or quake (Rajfah). The earth in which they practiced their wrongdoing and they wanted to expel their Prophet from it, shook them. Here, due to their disrespectful manners in speaking to their Prophet, Allah mentioned the awful cry (Sayhah) which overcame them and killed them. In Surat Ash-Shu'ara when they said, 4 i>) \ij l'. iSo cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!}[26:187] Allah said in response, 0^ joj Jf .iljc pijij 4So the torment of the day of Shadow seized them . Indeed that was the torment of a Great Day.}[26:189] This is from the intricate secrets and to Allah belongs all praise and much bounty forever. Concerning the statement, 4kS3j3ai?> iAs if they had never lived there!} This means it was as if they had not lived in their homes before that. 4*a cr \z 4So away with Madyan as just as Thamud went away!} They (Thamud) were their neighbors and they did not live far from the homes of the people of Madyan. They were similar in their disbelief and their highway robbery. They were also both Arabs.

Hud (96-99) (Part-12) Allah also said, j& Jii , \$vj lit JUi , T> o^, Q3 4'i 4 i[4Bwf Fir'awn belied and disobeyed. Then he turned his back, striving (against Allah). Then he gathered (his people) and cried aloud. Saying: I am your lord, most high. So Allah, seized him with exemplary punishment for his last and first transgression . Verily, in this is an instructive admonition for whosoever fears Allah.^[79:21-26] Allah also said, jjy5' J4-/J dll fx (&) 4He will go ahead of his people on the Day of Resurrection, and will lead them into the Fire, and evil indeed is the place to which they are led.} This will be the condition of those who were followed. They will have a great share of the punishment on the Day of Resurrection. This is as Allah says, 4#^ -i Jpj JLi iFor each one there is double (torment), but you know not.} [7:38] Allah also says that the disbelievers will say while they are in the Hellfire, &&& C l\ i"Our Lord! Verily, we obeyed our chiefs and our great ones, and they misled us from the (right) way. Our Lord! Give them double torment."} [33:67-68] Concerning the statement, iThey were pursued by a curse in this (deceiving life of this world) and (so they will be pursued by a curse) on the Day of Resurrection.} meaning, *We have made them to be followed by something more than the punishment of the Fire and that is their being cursed in this life.

4-5' %>' s*i }yj} iand on the Day of Resurrection , evil is the gift granted.} Mujahid said, Another curse will be added to them on the Day of Resurrection, so these are two curses. Ali bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, ievil indeed is the gift granted.} The curse of this life and the Hereafter. * Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah both said the same thing. * This is similar to Allah's statement, iXL a. j d}. iid* (&) ; p-* fyj GiK }And We made them leaders inviting to the Fire: and on the Day of Resurrection, they will not be helped. And We made a curse to follow them in this world, and on the Day of Resurrection, they will be among the despised.>[28:41-42] Allah also says, > ?' 1 it? iThe Fire, they are exposed to it, morning and afternoon. And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): "Cause Fir'awn's people to enter the severest torment!"}[40:46] f.l& C dAj C /i\ ^ lij%\$ it 6& y.& u ilOO. That is some of the news of the (population of) towns which We relate unto you; of them, some are (still) standing, Af-Tabari 15:468. Al-Tabari 15:469. Al-Tabari 15:469, 470.

Surah VL Hud (100-101) (Part-12) 109 and some have been (already) reaped.} 4101. We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves. So their gods whom they call upon besides Allah, profited them naught when there came the command of your Lord, nor did they add aught to them but destruction .> The Lesson taken from the Destroyed Towns When Allah mentioned the story of the Prophets and what

happened with them and their nations - how He destroyed the disbelievers and saved the believers - He goes on to say, \$ Stm 4That is some of the news of the (population of) towns meaning, news of them 4%p & } iwhich We relate unto you; of them, some are (still) standing,} This means still remaining. iand some have been (already) reaped.} This means totally destroyed. 4We wronged them not,} This means, When We destroyed them. &j&} 4but they wronged themselves.} their rejecting their Messengers and disbelieving in them. 4So their gods, profited them [not]...} This is referring to their idols that they used to worship and invoke. io* Oi}

no Tafstr Ibn Kathir iother than Allah naughty the idols did not benefit them, nor did they save them when Allah s com- mand came for their destruction. X > i' i //V Jf- inor did they add aught to them but destruction .y Mujahid, Qatadah and others said, This means loss. Because

the reason for their destruction and their ruin was that they followed those false gods. Therefore, they were losers in this life and the Hereafter. jiJ Ti', J ii6Sjy >-jj o', u 4202. Such is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.y It is as though Allah is saying, Just as We have destroyed these wicked generations who rejected their Messengers, We will do the same to any who are like them. U} iVerily, His punishment is painful (and) severe.y In the Two Sahlhs, it is recorded that Abu Musa said that the Messenger of Allah =gz said, rrr > - tf 'i' >?"v. :r J' .i}\ ^JUi *'. > r 'u' ^ f#*- At-Tabari 15:473.

Surah TL Hud (103-105) (Part-12) 111 lij L/>- <*>* j) * Verily, Allah gives respite to a wrongdoer until He seizes him and he cannot escape ." Then the Messenger of Allah sg recited, 4^ J*j ii _> Ji5 iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the towns while they are doing wrong . ,! l ft J5. left vUi ^ Jiui 4 l\} Jir* /*% *J ofc j ^ ^? 4:.t '*' JUa 4103. Indeed in that (there) is a sure lesson for those who fear the torment of the Hereafter. That is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, and that is a Day when all will be present.} 4104. And We delay it onlyfor a term (already) fixed.} 4105. On the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah's) leave. Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.} The Destruction of the Towns is a Proof of the Establishment ofthe Hour (Judgement) Allah, the Exalted, is saying that in the destruction of the disbelievers and the salvation of the believers by us is, 4'i^} 4a sure lesson}. This means an admonition and lesson concerning the truthfulness of that which We are promised in the Hereafter. }m car 4 iJx OijVerily, We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those who believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses will standforth.^(40:51) [i] Fath Al-Bari 8 :205 , and Muslim 4 : 1997

112 Tafsir Ibt Kathir Allah, the Exalted, also says, iSo their Lord revealed to them: "Truly, We shall destroy the wrongdoers.} [14:13] Concerning Allah s statement, iThat is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, This means the first of them and the last of them. This is similar to Allah s statement, 4And We shall gather them all together so as to leave not one of them behind [18:47] iand that is a Day when all will be present.} This means a day that is great. The angels will be present, the Messengers will gather and all of the creation will be gathered with their families. The humans, Jinns, birds, wild beasts and domesticated riding animals will all be gathered. Then the Most Just, Who does not wrong anyone even an atom s weight, will judge between them and He will increase their good deeds in reward. Concerning the statement, iAnd We delay it onlyfor a term (already) fixed.} This

means for a fixed period of time than cannot be increased or decreased. Then He says, iOn the Day when it comes, no person shall speak except by His (Allah's) leave.} This means that on the Day of Judgement no one will speak except with the permission of Allah. This is similar to another verse, which says,

4<>>'4 3% -,>> 24 Z vi y> 4they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (AlloH) allows, and he will speak what is right.} [78:38] Allah also says, llvi'Jl 4And all the voices will be humbled for the Most Gracious (Allah).} [20:108] In the Hadith about the intercession, which is recorded in the Two Sahihs, the Messenger of Allah jg said, Ip-Jjl lS 1 Vj -Oj; Vj" 8No one will speak on that day except the Messengers, and the call of the Messengers will be, "O Allah, save us, save Concerning Allah s statement, J Or" iSome among them will be wretclted and (others) blessed.} This means that from the people of the gathering (on Judgement Day), some will be miserable and some will be happy. This is as Allah said, 4j j &J 03 j ji}} iWhen a party will be in Paradise and a party in the blazing Fire} [42:7] Al-Hafiz Abu Yala recorded in his Musnad on the authority of Ibn Umar that Umar said, When this verse was revealed, 4X0) 4) 4Some among them will be wretched and (others) blessed.} I asked the Prophet jg, O Messenger of Allah, will there be a sign for us to know (which party we are from)? Will it be because of something that a person did, or something that he did not do? He said. J jl>- l"j V0- U ji Ji Al-Bari 2 :34 1 , and Muslim 1 :169

c0 'Umar, it will be due to something that he did and the pens wrote it down. But every easy deed was created for its purpose (to be carried out) ." ,I) Then Allah explains the situation of the wretched people and the happy people. He, the Exalted, says, C Ijj ^ A 0\$ a 3& #:h%& c vi joVtj 4106. As for those who are wretched, they will be in the Fire, in it they will experience Zafir and Shahiq .. They will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills. Verily, your Lord is the doer ofwhatsoever He intends (or wills). The Condition of the Wretched People and their Destination Allah, the Exalted, says, &QA> iin it they will experience Zafir and Shahiq.} Ibn Abbas said, Az-Zafir is a sound in the throat and Ash- Shahiq is a sound in the chest. This means that their exhaling will be Zafir and their inhaling will Shahiq. * This will be due to the torment that they will be experiencing. We seek refuge with Allah from such evil. ij&'j exp-" C ^^} iThey will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure,} Imam Abu Jafar bin Jarir said, It was from the customs of the Arabs that when they wanted to describe something that would last forever, they would say, This is as enduring as the heavens and the earth. Or, It will last as until the night and day separate. They would say, As long as talkers at night continue to chat. They meant by these statements the I 1 * At-Tirmidhi no. 31 1 1 Af-Tabari 15:480.

Hud (106-107) (Part-12) condition of eternity. Therefore, Allah addressed them in a manner that they were familiar with among themselves. Thus, He said, & IJjt 4They will dwell therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure The literal meaning is also intended with; for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure. This is due to the fact that there will be heavens and earth in the life of the next world, just as Allah said, 4On the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens [14:48] For this reason, Al-Hasan Al-Basri said concerning the statement of Allah, 4the heavens and the earth endure.} Allah is referring to a heaven other than this heaven (which we see now) and an earth other than this earth. That (new) heaven and earth will be eternal. Concerning Allah s

statement, 4LJ, G & %\ #j& C 4except as your Lord wills. Verily, your Lord is the doer of whatsoever He intends.} This is similar to His statement, 4The Fire be your dwelling place, you will dwell therein forever, except as Allah may will. Certainly your Lord is All- Wise, All-Knowing.} [6:128] It has been said that the exception mentioned in this verse refers to the disobedient among the people of Tawhid. It is these whom Allah will bring out of the Fire by the intercessionJabari 15:481.

of the interceders. Those who will be allowed to intercede are the angels, the Prophets and the believers. They will intercede even on behalf of those who committed major sins. Then, the generous mercy of Allah will remove from the Fire those who have never done any good, except for saying La ilaha illatldh one day of their life. This has been mentioned in numerous authentic reports from the Messenger of Allah including narrations from Anas bin Malik, Jabir bin Abdullah, Abu Sa'id Al-Khudri, Abu Hurayrah and other Companions. No one remains in the Fire after this fined intercession, except those who will remain there forever without escape. This is the opinion held by many of the scholars, both past and present, concerning the explanation of this verse. Hit U V) U IJj cyji aZ)S Jp ojji 4 J il08. And those who are blessed, they will be in Paradise, abiding therein for all the time that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills : a gift without an end.} The Condition of the Happy People and their Destination Allah, the Exalted, says, 'S fiat iAnd those who are blessed.} These are the followers of the Messengers. 4^they will be in Paradise,} This means that their final abode will be Paradise. jJfL} ^abiding thereinfor all the time} This means that they will remain there forever. & c vj } 4that the heavens and the earth endure, except as your Lord wills :}

The meaning of the exception that is made here is that the condition of eternal pleasure that they will experience therein is something that is not mandatory by itself. Rather, it is something that is dependent upon the will of Allah. Unto Him belongs the favor of immortality upon them. For this reason they are inspired to glorify and praise Him, just as they are inspired to breathe. 1 11 Ad-Dahhak and Al-Hasan Al-Basri both said, It is about the right of the disobedient people of Tawhid who were in the Fire and then brought out of it. Then Allah finished this statement by saying, 4/ft? ia gift without an end.} This means that it will never be cut off. This has been mentioned by Mujahid, Ibn Abbas, Abu Al- Aliyah and others. ' This has been mentioned so that the suspicious person will not doubt after the mention of the will of Allah. Someone may think that the mention of Allah s will here means that the pleasure of Paradise may end or change. To the contrary, it has been decreed that this pleasure will truly be forever and will never end. Likewise, Allah has clarified here that the eternal torment of the people of the Fire in Hell also is due to His will. He explains that He punishes them due to His justness and wisdom. This is why He says, ^Verily, your Lord is the doer ofwhatsoever He intends.} Similarly, Allah says, il (Uj ji? ft 4He cannot be questioned as to what He does, while they will be questioned.>[21 :23] Here, Allah soothes the hearts and affirms the intent, by His saying, 4/ft? ivLft 4a gift without an end.} It has been recorded in the Two Sahihs that the Messenger ofAllah jg said. 4:2181. AMabari 15:490.

>>- < -> - MT>|' ij5 tf; id </ cri^ SJ.t-* "jj 'r jAJL. u'ji cjiiii^ aUJi is & ul ?U !&jl Jif U :Jli;^i !jlljl Uj "o^> Death will be brought in the farm of a hand- some ram (on the Day of Judgement) and it will be slaughtered between Paradise and the Hellfire. Then, it will be said, O people of Paradise! Eter- nity and no death! O people of Hellfire! Eter- nity and no death!"tll] In the Safylfy it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg\$ said, l\ ! Jil U :JUjb "*" * t ** * * * s i xixi i^Xju ji jl t)jj i Ixl i lj~ />* t)l OJj t ixl

\j*j4j 1j. .j.j l)1 Oij "ix'l "Jf u// fee said, O people of Paradise, verily you will live and you will never die. You will remain young and you will never grow old. You will remain healthy and you will never become ill. You will be happy and you will never grieve . [2 12] Jj Ji pASVj'* -*r . w*" j| ujxw-j u t* ^ju cj o*" jay Ji *- v^ ="i' t?*" AjJJ Jj (4 & yf Qj Q Jf ftf ("t? >%3 ojd? Fath Al-B&ri 8 :282 , and Muslim 4 :2188 Muslim 4:2182.

4%j^- 4109. So be not in doubt as to what these people (pagans and polytheists) worship. They worship nothing but what their fathers worshipped before (them). And verily, We shall repay them in full their portion without diminution.} 4110. Indeed, We gave the Book to Musa, but differences arose therein, and had it not been for a Word that had gone forth before from your Lord, the case would have been judged between them, and indeed they are in grave doubt concerning it (this Qur'an).} 4111. And verily, to each of them your Lord will repay their works in full. Surely, He is All-Aware of what they do.} Associating Partners with Allah is no doubt Misguidance Allah, the Exalted, says, 4X& zz IL: j, %} 4So be not in doubt as to what these people worship.} This refers to the polytheists. Verily, what they are doing is falsehood, ignorance and misguidance. Verily, they are only worshipping what their fathers worshipped before. This means that they have no support for their Shirk. They are only mimicking their fathers in ignorance. Therefore, Allah will give them due recompense for that and He will punish them with a punishment the likes of which none can give besides Him. If they did any good deeds, then Allah will reward them for those good works in this life, before the life of the Hereafter. Concerning Allah's statement, JL "V 4And verily, We shall repay them in full their portion without diminution.} Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, We will pay them in full their portion of punishment without diminution. l 11 Then, Allah mentions that He gave Mtisa the Book, but the people [i] At-Tabari 15:492.

differed concerning it. Some believed in it and some disbelieved in it. Therefore, you, Muhammad, have an example in the Prophets who came before you. So do not grieve or be upset by their denial of you. J ot y&} i and had it not been for a Word [Kalitnah] that had gone forth before from your Lord, the case would have been judged between them,} Ibn Jarir said, If it were not that the punishment had already been delayed until an appointed time, then Allah would have decided the matter between you now. The word Kalimah carries the meaning that Allah will not punish anyone until the proof has been established against him and a Messenger has been sent to him. 111 This is similar to Allah's statement, iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).} (17: 15) For verily, Allah says in another verse, C Jfjfc j3j 0& Jtjo.c& 4 "&> 4And had it not been for a Word that went forth before from your Lord, and a term determined, (their punishment) must necessarily have come (in this world). So bear patiently what they say.}[20:129-130] Then, Allah informs that He will gather the early generations and the later generations from all of the nations. He will then reward them based upon their deeds. If they did good deeds, their reward will be good, and if they did evil deeds, their reward will be bad. Allah says, oJL*; Ui lily & yf op} 4And verily, to each of them your Lord will repay their works in full. Surely, He is All-Aware of what they do.} This means that He is All-Knower of all of their deeds. This includes their honorable deeds and their despicable deeds. m At-Tabari 15:493.

their small deeds and their great deeds. There are many different modes of recitation for this verse, yet all of their meanings agree with what we have mentioned. This is similar to Allah's statement, 4# y-. 6%o0)And surely, all - everyone of them will be brought before us. M36:321 Ji v; kl% *; c, V j13 ,v ojj

(V l*. ,t'^ tr 4312. So stand (ask Allah to make) you firm and straight as you are commanded and those who him in repentance with you, and transgress not. Verily, He is All-Seer of what you do.) 4313. And incline not toward those who do wrong, lest the Fire should touch you, and you have no protectors other than Allah, nor would you then be helped.) TheCommand to Stand Firm and Straight Allah, the Exalted, commands His Messenger jfa, and His believing servants to be firm and to always be upright. This is of the greatest aid for gaining victory over the enemy and confronting the opposition. Allah also forbids transgression, which is to exceed the bounds (of what is allowed). Verily, transgression causes destruction to its practitioner, even if the transgression was directed against a polytheist. Then, Allah informs that He is All-Seer of the actions of His servants. He is not unaware of anything and nothing is hidden from Him. Concerning Allah s statement, 4i i 'M JI iAnd incline not toward those who do wrong,) AH bin Abi Talhah said that Ibn Abbas said, Do not compromise with them. Ibn Jarir said that Ibn Abbas said, Do not side with those who do wrong. ,I1 This is a good statement. This means, Do not seek assistance from m At-Jabari 15:501.

Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan and others said, This means the night prayer (Ishd)." Ibn Al-Mubarak reported from Mubarak bin Fadal that Al-Hasan said, iand in some hours of the night. This means the evening (Maghrib and late night ("Isht) prayers. The Messenger of Allah jg said, ojLLJlj :jdll UJj lli" *They are the approach of the night: Maghrib and Isha' The same was said by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka b, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak (that this means the Maghrib and Isha prayers). It should be noted that this verse was revealed before the five daily prayers were made obligatory during the night of Isr& (the Prophet s night journey to Jerusalem). At that time there were only two obligatory prayers: a prayer before sunrise and a prayer before sunset. During the late night another prayer (Tahajjud) was also made obligatory upon the Prophet jg and his nation. Later, this obligation was abrogated for his nation and remained obligatory upon him jg. Finally, this obligation was abrogated for the Prophet jg as well, according to one opinion. Allah knows best. The Good Deeds wipe away the Evil Deeds Concerning Allah s statement, iVerily, the good deeds remove the evil deeds . This is saying that the performance of good deeds is an expiation of previous sins. This has been mentioned in a Hadith recorded by Imam Ahmad and the Sunan Compilers, that the Commander of the faithful, Ali bin Abi Talib, said, Whenever I used to hear a narration from the Messenger of Allah (jg), Allah would cause me to benefit by it however He willed. If anyone informed me of any statement that he said, I would make him swear (by Allah) that the Prophet jg said it. If he swore by Allah, then I would believe him. Abu Bakr once told me - and Abu Bakr was truthful - that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say,

"J 'jm. & J_;jJ j4ii^ u" "There is not any

Surah VL Hud (114-115) (Part-12). 125 aThe five daily prayers, Jumu'ah (Friday prayer) to Jumu'ah and (the fast of) Ramadan to Ramadan are expiations for whatever sins were committed between them, as long as you stay awayfrom the major sins.

iShe probably was a woman whose husband is away (fighting) in the path ofAllah. Then a verse of Qur an was revealed, ky& iAnd perform the Saldh, at the two ends of the day and in some hours of the night. Verily, the good deeds remove the evil deeds.} The man then said, O Messenger of Allah! Is this verse only for me, or does it apply to all of the people in general? Umar then struck the man on his chest with his hand and said, No, rather it is for all of the people in general. Then the Messenger of

Allah said, . "' - ' , . 'jaS "'Umar has spoken the truth .s1 U 4 iSJSk%\$ Oi oiiifUX >< =* c %% \j\ t rffSvrLL I *' \A it. v-ttT 4116. If only there had been among the generations before you persons having wisdom, prohibiting (others) from Fasad (corruption) in the earth, except a few of those whom We saved from among them! Those who did wrong pursued the enjoyment of good things of (this worldly) life, and were criminals.} 4117. And your Lord would never destroy the towns wrongfully, while their people were doers of good.} There must be a Group of People Who forbid Lewdness Allah, the Exalted, says that there should have been a group of wise people present among the past generations who called to good and forbade the evil and corruption that took place among them in the land. His statement, m Ahmad 1 :245 4 'M 'ffr

except a few} This means that there were only a small number of people present among them who were of this caliber. They were those whom Allah saved at the sudden striking of His vengeance, when His anger was let loose. For this reason Allah commanded this noble Ummah (followers of Muhammad ﷺ) to always have among them those who command the good and forbid the evil. This is as Allah says, s' i-: 4 Let there arise out of you a group of people inviting to all that is good, enjoining righteousness and forbidding evil. And it is they who are the success/z</.^ [3:104] It is related in a Hadith that the Prophet ﷺ said, aUI tjjJu ph \ \jj lit "Verily, whenever a group of people see an evil and they do not change it, it is likely that Allah will cover them with (His) punishment. Thus, Allah says, cM d&X 4SZ% oi o \ u <& } if only there had been among the generations before you persons having wisdom, prohibiting (others) from the Fasad in the earth, - except a few of those whom We saved from among them!} Concerning the statement, Z ijlti gj} iThose who did wrong pursued the enjoyment of good things of (this worldly) life,} This means that they continued in their ways of disobedience and evils and they did not heed the protesting of those righteous people, until the torment suddenly seized them. 111 Ibn Majah 2 :1327.

tr" oaa!i* ojl^jj j OjH5i^>^) ->"^p" ^ri} *hfc j(j"J 1 \$Sj 2i2 ^\$jtfj5&jL^JiJ^ti ^ iand. were criminals.} llj^cAp'yij\$ji4* > lliijJ' "- ^ > i" /i". thi< ^ < <.-r> -' /*r> lzj^LJtfJLi\$[0! &ty Then, Allah informs that he does not destroy any town, except that it has wronged itself. No correctional punishment or torment comes to any town, except that its people were wrong-doers. This is as Allah says, ijik ^t'lAk CJ} ilz& iWe wronged them not, but they wronged themselves.} (11:101] Allah also says, Mb lu^ iAnd your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) servants.} [41:46] ^fyj & J |rtrj & V[.U'^ohi; jjly_ jj ill J.QI jil liuj ;IS jjj^ f; , o; *- obuV c-llj l\$iiil 4HS. And if your Lord had so willed, He could surely have made mankind one Ummah, but they will not cease to disagree.} ill9. Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy, and for that did He create them. And the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (His saying): Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."} Allah has not made Faith universally accepted Allah, the Exalted, informs that He is able to make all of mankind one nation upon belief, or disbelief. This is just as He said,

129 Surah VL Hud (118-119) (Part-12 OfjVf 4 '(jft 4 And had your Lord willed, those on earth would have believed, all of them together. (10:99] Allah goes on to say, O' VI V>^ they will not cease to disagree. Except him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy,) This means that people will always differ in religions, creeds, beliefs, opinions and sects. Concerning Allah's statement, jUy o iExcept him on whom your Lord has bestowed His mercy,) This means that those who have received the mercy of

Allah by following the Messengers are excluded from this. They are those who adhere to what they are commanded in the religion by the Messengers of Allah. That has always been their characteristic until the coming of the finality of the Prophets and Messengers (Muhammad ﷺ). Those who received Allah's mercy are those who followed him, believed in him and supported him. Therefore, they succeeded by achieving happiness in this life and the Hereafter. They are the Saved Sect mentioned in the Hadith recorded in the Musnad and Sunan collections of Hadith. The routes of transmission of this Hadith all strengthen each other (in authenticity). In these narrations the Prophet ﷺ said, "يَوْمَ يَفْتَلِكُ أَهْلُ يَهُودٍ عَلَى أَسْوَاقِهِمْ سَبْعِينَ مِائَةً أُمَّةً وَنَحْنُ إِحْدَى الْيَوْمَ يَفْتَلِكُ أَهْلُ نَحْرَيْنَ سَبْعِينَ مِائَةً أُمَّةً وَنَحْنُ إِحْدَى الْيَوْمَ يَفْتَلِكُ أَهْلُ قَوْمِ مُحَمَّدٍ سَبْعِينَ مِائَةً أُمَّةً وَنَحْنُ إِحْدَى" A J\$ & jt 4** J Verily, the Jews split into seventy-one sects, and the Christians split into seventy-two sects, and this nation (of Muslims) will split into seventy-three sects. All of them will be in the Fire except one sect. They (the Companions) said, Who are they (the Saved Sect)? Messenger of Allah? He said,

230 Tafstr Ibn Kathir lit U& "77ie sect that is upon what my Companions and I are upon" 111

Sitrah 11, H d (120) (Part-12) 232 upon whoever I wish. I will fill each one of you. However, the Paradise will always have more bounties, to such an extent that Allah will create more creatures to dwell in it and enjoy its extra bounties. The Hellfire will continue saying, 'Are there anymore (to enter me),' until the Lord of might places His Foot over it. Then it (Hell) will say, "Enough, enough, but Your might!" 4120. And all that We relate to you of the news of the Messengers is in order that We may make strong and firm your heart thereby. And in this has come to you the truth, as well as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. The Conclusion Allali, the Exalted, is saying, We relate all of these stories to you (Muhammad) concerning what happened with the Messengers who came before you with their nations. This is an explanation of what transpired in their arguments and disputes and how the Prophets were all rejected and harmed. These stories also explain how Allah helped His party of believers and disgraced His enemies, the disbelievers. We relate all of this to you (Muhammad) in order to make your heart firm and so that you may take an example from your brothers who passed before you of the Messengers. Concerning Allah's statement, 4 And in this has come to you the truth, This is referring to this Surah itself. This was said by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and a group of the Salaf and it is the correct view. This means, This comprehensive Surah contains the stories of the Prophets and how Allah saved them, and the believers along with them and how He destroyed the disbelievers. There has come to you (Muhammad) stories of Fath Al-Bari 13 :444 and Muslim 4 :2186.

unseen of the heavens and the earth and that unto Him is the final return. He explains that everyone who does a deed. He will give them their deed (reward for it) on the Day of Reckoning. Unto Him belongs the creation and the command. Then He, the Exalted, commands that He should be worshipped and relied upon, for verily, He is sufficient for whoever trusts and turns to Him. Concerning His statement, u* diZj } And your Lord is not unaware of what you do. } This means, The lies (of the disbeliever^) against you O Muhammad are not hidden from Him. He is the All-Knower of the conditions of His creatures and He will give them the getfeet ^ocopipwrte for tLMtr ,*fc"5ds in. tt" Hfe aqd the Hfieaffoi. Wle wilLaadynu iflikd) and phrty over the disbelievers in this life and in the Hereafter.

Module 16

Surah 12: Yusuf, Surah 13: Ar-Rad

Surah 12: Yusuf

PDF pages 2674–2769

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2674]

Opening The Tafstr of Surah Yusuf (Chapter - 12)

Which was revealed in Makkah

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2674–2722]

-Sg" In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful, ijaju ^ ^-L"J l^X Ol"l* Aty Cjt :a oij .J-iJ' lx!* LJ*>.y tj ,j^l "itllx 41. Alif-Ldm-Rd. These are the verses of the Book that is clear.} 42. Verily, We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'an in order that you may understand .} 43. We relate unto you the best of stories through Our revelations unto you, of this Qur'an. And before this, you were among those who kneio nothing about it.} Qualities ofthe Qur an In the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah we talked about the separate letters, Allah said, 0* These are the verses of the Book} in reference to the Clear Qur an that is plain and apparent, and explains, clarifies and makes known the unclear matters. Allah said next, T b*^x 4Verily, I've have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'an in order that you may understand.} The Arabic language is the most eloquent, plain, deep and expressive of the meanings that might arise in one s mind. Therefore, the most honorable Book, was revealed in the most

Yusuf (1-3) (Part-12) honorable language, to the most honorable Prophet and Messenger sfe, delivered by the most honorable angel, in the most honorable land on earth, and its revelation started during the most honorable month of the year, Ramadan. Therefore, the Qur an is perfect in every respect. So Allah said, Lo AWe relate unto you the best of stories through Our revelations unto you, of this Qur'mt.} Reasonbehind revealing Ayah (12:3) On the reason behind revealing Ayah (12:3), Ibn Jarir At- Tabari recorded that Abdullah bin Abbas said, They said, '6, Allah s Messenger! Why not narrate to us stories? 1" Later on, this Ayah was revealed, J vitu "(I've relate unto you the best ofstories . . , There is a Hadith that is relevant upon mentioning this honorable Ayah, which praises the Qur an and demonstrates that it is sufficient from needing all books besides it. Imam

236 Tafstr Ibn Kathir tofollow me. s Imam

Yusuf (4-5) (Part-12) eleven, and the sun and the moon represent his father and mother. This explanation was collected from Ibn Abbas, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah, Sufyan Ath-Thawri and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Yusuf's vision became a reality forty years later, or as some say, eighty years, when Yusuf raised his parents to the throne while his brothers were before him. 4 Vi*- J* ,3t" Cri*J Jt J* J'b A iand they fell down before him prostrate. And he said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My Lord has made it come true!"} [I] % Si < J \ji &m S X Y 45. He (the father) said: "O my son! Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they should arrange a plot

against you. Verily, Shaytan is to man an open enemy!"} Ya'qub orders Yusuf to hide His Vision to avoid Shaytan's Plots Allah narrates the reply Ya'qub gave his son Yusuf when he narrated to him the vision that he saw, which indicated that his brothers would be under his authority. They would be subjugated to Yusuf's authority to such an extent that they would prostrate before him in respect, honor and appreciation. Ya'qub feared that if Yusuf narrated his vision to any of his brothers, they would envy him and conspire evil plots against him. This is why Ya'qub said to Yusuf, 4'^T 4'Relate not your vision to your brothers, lest they should arrange a plot against you.} This Ayah means, They might arrange a plot against you that causes your demise. In the Sunnah, there is a confirmed Hadith that states, ' At-Tabari 15:557.

138 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Vj i l j i SjLLJ J* l ,4Yl 'fcjjii LfiU "/fl"i/ of you saw a vision that he likes, let him narrate it. If he saw a dream that he dislikes, let him turn on his other side, blow to his left thrice, seek refuge with Allah from its evil and not tell it to anyone. Verily, it will not harm him in this case."111 In another Hadith that Imam Ahmad and collectors of the Sunan collected, Mu'awiyah bin Haydah Al-Qushayri said that the Messenger of Allah jfe said, ' jre' lip l* jib I "The dream is tied to a bird's leg, as long as it is not interpreted. If it is interpreted, it comes true."121 Therefore, one should hide the prospects or the coming of a bounty until it comes into existence and becomes known. The Prophet said, I iji fS jp i elSai "Earn help for fulfilling needs by being discrete, for every owner of a blessing is envied. JI* ifj Jup; at iaQui eTJ f jLic. liUj 0^ Jj at Qy]& T i6. "Thus will your Lord choose you and teach you the interpretation of dreams (and other things) and perfect His favor on you and on the offspring of Ya'qub, as He perfected it on your fathers, Ibrahim and Ishaq aforetime! Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise."} Interpretation of Yusuf's Vision Allah says that Ya'qub said to his son Yusuf, Just as Allah chose you to see the eleven stars, the sun and the moon 4:1772. Ahmad 4 :10, Abu Dawud 5 :283 Ibn Majah 2 :1288. At-Tabari 20:94.

iThus will your Lord choose you? designate and assign you to be a Prophet from Him, {and teach you the interpretation of Ahadith?}. Mujahid and several other scholars said that this part of the Ayah is in reference to the interpreting of dreams. ' He said next, {and perfect His favor on you?}, by His Message and revelation to you. This is why Ya'qub said afterwards, {as He perfected it aforetime on your fathers, Ibrahim...?, Allah's intimate friend, ie&lff {and Ishaq?, Ibrahim's son, {Verily, your Lord is All-Knowing, All-Wise.? Allah knows best whom to choose for His Messages. j j jtf lj"jl jl '- Ly. A ij} i t XLAc. (jA Hi bJj 4 LjLy ijiiij jffi jli ', Cj **JU; J* VffhA'j j^C.1 iZjj ^ ' oi 47 . Verily, in Yusuf and his brethren there were Ayat for those who ask. 48. When they said: "Truly, Yusuf and his brother are dearer, to our father than we, while we are Usbah (a group). Really) our father is in a plain error. } 49. "Kill Yusuf or cast him out to some (other) land, so that At-Jabari 15:560.

the favor of your father may be given to you alone, and after that you will be righteous folk."} iLO. One from among them said: "Kill not Yusuf, but if you must do something, throw him down to the bottom of a well; he will be picked up by some caravan of travelers. } There are Lessons to draw from the Story of Yusuf Allah says that there are Ayat, lessons and wisdom to learn from the story of Yusuf and his brothers, for those who ask about their story and seek its knowledge. Surely, their story is unique and is worthy of being narrated. 4) ill v*J yu iWhen they said: "Truly, Yusuf and his brother are dearer to our father than we..." } They swore, according to their false thoughts, that Yusuf and his brother

Binyamin (Benjamin), Yusuf's full brother, 4' & \L G3 idearer to our father than we, while we are Usbah.} meaning, a group. Therefore, they thought, how can he love these two more than the group, J l[} iReally, our father is in a plain error.} because he preferred them and loved them more than us. ife '4-JP&aV& } Kill Yusuf or cast him out to some (other) land, so that the favor of your father may be given to you alone,} They said, Remove Yusuf, who competes with you for your father's love, from in front of your father's face so that his favor is yours alone. Either kill Yusuf or banish him to a distant land so that you are rid of his trouble and you alone enjoy the love of your father. and after that you will be righteous folk.}, thus intending repentance before committing the sin,

Yusuf(7-10) (Part-12) 33" ti} 40nefrom among them said...} Qatadah and Muhammad bin Ishaq said that he was the oldest among them and his name was Rubll (Reuben). 11 ' As- Suddi said that his name was Yahudha (Judah). Mujahid said that it was Shamtin (Simeon) who said, 4K.Hl not Yusuf,}, do not let your enmity and hatred towards him reach this level, of murder. However, their plot to kill Yusuf would not have succeeded, because Allah the Exalted willed that Yusuf fulfill a mission that must be fulfilled and complete; he would receive Allah's revelation and become His Prophet. Allah willed Yusuf to be a powerful man in Egypt and govern it. Consequently, Allah did not allow them to persist in their intent against Yusuf, through Rubll's words and his advice to them that if they must do something, they should throw him down to the bottom of a well, 4he will be picked up by some caravan} of travelers passing by. This way, he said, you will rid yourselves of this bother without having to kill him, if you must do something,} meaning, if you still insist on getting rid of him. Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar said, They agreed to a particularly vicious crime that involved cutting the relation of the womb, undutiful treatment of parents, and harshness towards the young, helpless and sinless. It was also harsh towards the old and Ayeak who have the rights of being respected, honored and appreciated, as well as, being honored with Allah and having parental rights on their offspring. They sought to separate the beloved father, who had reached old age and his bones became weak, yet had a high status with Allah, from his beloved young son, in spite of his weakness, tender age and his need of his Tabari 15:564-565.

J iiSSil- rri tSsijiNS, father's compassion - < > > > I? ijllj ij, Q\jl5iloolt !#"\$ Jjjijli^ js*ajjd i0o0> >.S'\ \:.\ *>*J[', ' '<&*'\ . ""r J1S jjJailsJ and kindness. May Allah forgive them, and indeed. He is the Most Merciful among those who have mercy, for they intended to carry out a grave error. Ibn Abi Hatim collected this state- ment, from the route of Salamah bin Al-Fadl from Muhammad bin Ishaq. ol* \ji\j V liU L litis * V 'j' I Ilj i & iis 12; jj-ji V /) tyj ill. They said: "O our father! Why do you not trust us with Yusuf though we are indeed his well-wishers? } il2. "Send him with us tomorrow to enjoy himself and play, and verily, we will take care of him. } Yusuf's Brothers ask for Their Father's Permission to take Yusuf with Them When Yusuf's brothers agreed to take him and throw him down the well, taking the advice of their elder brother Rubll, they went to their father Ya'qub, peace be upon him. They said to him, Why is it that you, 4\$0_j j Jj Cjj iJu*y jc bslj ^} i do not trust us with Yusuf though we are indeed his well- wishers?}. They started executing their plan by this introductory

Yusuf (13-14) (Part-12) statement, even though they really intended its opposite, out of envy towards Yusuf for being loved by his father. They said, iSend him with us) tomorrow so that we all enjoy ourselves and play. ' Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and As-Suddi said similarly. Yusuf's brothers said next, ii and verily, we iwill take care of him.), we will protect him and ensure his safety for you. 'w'cSyUii il* o' ijU-

لج .jj 0* ^ jli i f <>\ J[4ijJI ^ ijtf 413. He (Ya'qub) said: "Truly, it saddens me that you should take him away. I fear lest a wolf should devour him, while you are careless of him.") 414. They said : "If a wolf devours him, while we are 'Usbah (a group), then surely, we are the losers.") Ya'qub's Answer to Their Request Allah narrates to us that His Prophet Ya'qub said to his children, in response to their request that he send Yusuf with them to the desert to tend their cattle, (Truly, it saddens me that you should take him away.) He said that it was hard on him that he be separated from Yusuf for the duration of their trip, until they came back. This demonstrates the deep love that Ya'qub had for his son, because he saw in Yusuf great goodness and exalted qualities with regards to conduct and physical attractiveness associated with the rank of prophethood. May Allah's peace and blessings be on him. Prophet Ya'qub's statement next, Tabari 15:570. Tabari 15:571.

I fear lest a wolf should devour him, while you are careless of him.} He said to them, I fear that you might be careless with him while you are tending the cattle and shepherding, then a wolf might come and eat him while you are unaware. They heard these words from his mouth and used them in their response for what they did afterwards. They also gave a spontaneous reply for their father's statement, saying, 4o_J!y 1"J i. 0 v-jJI ilf a wolf devours him, while we are an Usbah, then surely, we are the losers.} They said, If a wolf should attack and devour him while we are all around him in a strong group, then indeed we are the losers and weak. to hA&& & A-f. O',1 *!; H I*- 415. So, when they took him away, they all agreed to throw him down to the bottom of the well, and We revealed to him "Indeed, you shall (one day) inform them of this their affair, when they know (you) not."} Yusuf is thrown in a Well Allah says that when Yusuf's brothers took him from his father, after they requested him to permit that, J \yj?lj} 4they all agreed to throw him down to the bottom of the well,} This part of the Ayah magnifies their crime, in that it mentions that they all agreed to throw him to the bottom of the well. This was their intent, yet when they took him from his father, they pretended otherwise, so that his father sends him with a good heart and feeling at ease and comfortable with his decision. It was reported that Ya'qub, peace be upon him, embraced Yusuf, kissed him and supplicated to Allah for him when he sent him with his brothers. As-Suddi said that the time spent between pretending to be well-wishers and harming Yusuf was no longer than their straying far from their

Yusuf (16-18) (Part-12 father's eyes. They then started abusing Yusuf verbally, by cursing, and harming him by beating. When they reached the well that they agreed to throw him in, they tied him with rope and lowered him down. When Yusuf would beg one of them, he would smack and curse him. When he tried to hold to the sides of the well, they struck his hand and then cut the rope when he was only half the distance from the bottom of the well. He fell into the water and was submerged. However, he was able to ascend a stone that was in the well and stood on it.' Allah said next, and We revealed to him : "Indeed, you shall (one day) inform them of this their affair, when they know (you) not."} In this Ayah, Allah mentions His mercy and compassion and His compensation and relief that He sends in times of distress. Allah revealed to Yusuf, during that distressful time, in order to comfort his heart and strengthen his resolve, TDo not be saddened by what you have suffered. Surely, you will have a way out of this distress and a good end, for Allah will aid you against them, elevate your rank and raise your grade. Later on, you will remind them of what they did to you, {when they know not.} Ibn Abbas commented on this Ayah, You will remind them of this evil action against you, while they are unaware of your identity and unable to recognize you. JI'vCMAL-* lli==> jij Li Lj 4 " \$6If 1>\ pZ\p c#: \$ jg 416.

Allah's statement, 4So they hid him as merchandise}, is in reference to Yusuf's brothers, who hid the news that he was their brother. Yusuf hid this news for fear that his brothers might kill him and preferred to be sold instead. Consequently, Yusuf's brothers told the water drawer about him and that man said to his companions, 4What good news! Here is a boy.}, a slave whom we can sell. Therefore, Yusuf's own brothers sold him. Allah's statement, 4And Allah was the All-Knower of what they did.} states that Allah knew what Yusuf's brothers, and those who bought him, did. He was able to stop them and prevent them from committing their actions, but out of His perfect wisdom He decreed otherwise. He let them do what they did, so that His decision prevails and His appointed destiny rules, 4Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of the all that exists!} [7:54] This reminds Allah's Messenger Muhammad (jg, that Allah (I) At-Tabari 16:6.

Yusuf (19-20) (Part-12) has perfect knowledge in the persecution that his people committed against him and that He is able to stop them. However, He decided to give them respite, then give Muhammad the victory and make him prevail over them, just as He gave Yusuf victory and made him prevail over his brothers. Allah said next, 4And they sold him for a Bakhs price, -for a few Dirhams} in reference to Yusuf's brothers selling him for a little price, according to Mujahid and Ikrimah. Bakhs means decreased, just as Allah the Exalted said in another Ayah J Yj Llit ishalla have no fear, either of a Bakhs (a decrease in the reward of his good deeds) or a Rahaq (an increase in the punishment for his sins).} [72:13] meaning that Yusuf's brothers exchanged him for a miserably low price. Yet, he was so insignificant to them that had the caravan people wanted him for free, they would have given him for free to them! Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Ad-Dahhak said that, }And they sold him}, is in reference to Yusuf's brothers. * They sold Yusuf for the lowest price, as indicated by Allah's statement next, ^jj} for a few Dirhams}, twenty Dirhams, according to Abdullah bin Mas'ud. * Similar was said by Ibn Abbas, Nawf Al-Bucali, As-Suddi, Qatadah and Atiyah Al-Awfi, who added that they divided the Dirhams among themselves, each getting two Dirhams. Ad-Dahhak commented on Allah's statement, m At-Jabari 16:12. * At-Jabari 16:14-17. At-Jabari 16:12. * At-Jabari 16:14.

Yusuf (21-22) (Part-12) He also ordered his wife to be kind to Yusuf and had good hopes for his future, because of his firm righteous behavior. He said to his wife, iMake his stay comfortable, maybe he will profit us or we shall adopt him as a son.} The man who bought Yusuf was the minister of Egypt at the time, and his title was Aziz. Abu Ishaq narrated that Abu Ubaydah said that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, Three had the most insight: the Aziz of Egypt, who said to his wife, iMake his stay comfortable...}, the woman who said to her father, iO my father! Hire him..., [28:26] and Abu Bakr As-Siddiq when he appointed Umar bin Al-Khattab to be the Khalifah after him, may Allah be pleased with them both. Allah said next that just as He saved Yusuf from his brothers, iThus did I've establish Yusuf in the land}, in reference to Egypt, iThus We might teach him the interpretation of events.} the interpretation of dreams, according to Mujahid and As-Suddi.12 Allah said next, iThus Allah has full power and control over His affairs,} if He wills something, then there is no averting His decision, nor can it ever be stopped or contradicted. Rather, Allah has full power over everything and everyone else. Said bin Jubayr said while commenting on Allah's statement, 1,1 At-Tabari 16:19. At-Tabari 16:20.

4And Allah has full power and control over His affairs,} He does what ever He wills. ' Allah said, ii&*JAbut most of men know not.} meaning, have no knowledge of Allah s wisdom with regards to His creation, compassion and doing what He wills. Allah said next, 4And when he attained}, in reference to Prophet Yusuf, peace be upon him, ii } i his full manhood}, sound in mind and perfect in body, &C} 4We gave him wisdom and knowledge}, which is the prophethood that Allah sent him with for the people he lived among, 4thus We reward the doers of good.} because Yusuf used to do good in the obedience of Allah the Exalted. jCH JLS cji cJUj .4. .Vu-j ,aJ*i _j> fff&&& 4^ * fke A 423. And she, in whose house he was, sought to seduce him (to do an evil act), and she closed the doors and said: Come on, O you." He said: "I seek refuge in Allah! Truly, he is my Rabb! He made my living in a great comfort! Verily, the wrongdoers will never be successful."} Wife of the Aziz loves Yusuf and plots against him Allah states that the wife of the Aziz of Egypt, in whose house Yusuf resided and whose husband recommended that she takes care of him and be generous to him, tried to seduce Yusuf! She called him to do an evil act with her, because she loved him very much. Yusuf was very handsome, filled with m At-Tabari 16:21.

153Sarah 12. Yusuf (24) (Part-12) manhood and beauty. She beautified herself for him, closed the doors and called him, iatid (she) said: "Come on, O you."} But he categorically refused her call, 4(>^ (if 4He said: "I seek refuge in Allah! Truly, he is my Rabb! He made my living in a great comfort!")} as they used to call the chief and master a Rabb , Yusuf said to her, your husband is my master who provided me with comfortable living and was kind to me, so I will never betray him by committing immoral sins with his wife, ^ V %} 4 Verily, the wrongdoers will never be successful.} This was said by Mujahid, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others. The scholars differ in their recitation of, 4Hayta Laka}, whereby Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several other scholars said that it means that she was calling him to herself.¹¹¹ Al-Bukhari said; Ikrimah said that, 4-zZ^ *Hayta Laka'} means, come on, O you , in the Aramaic language. Al-Bukhari collected this statement from Ikrimah without a chain of narration.¹²¹ Other scholars read it with the meaning, I am ready for you . Ibn Abbas, Abu Abdur-Rahman As-Sulami, Abu Wa il, Ikrimah and Qatadah were reported to have read this part of the Ayah this way and explained it in the manner we mentioned, as am ready for you . ifj S' */. ' o1 VP ll* ^ij} Tabari 16:27. Al-Bari 8:214.

Yusuf (25-29) (Part-12) d^y>'k.~ TTA \ /- ^ x * - S' S "S . s"" >-j *->] j_ Jli- 1-11 Q.faxIUj j3j\$AA&' t /XjXj-b = -fj^Cjtr.W JI LIX-Jj X b^Air?XllLtXahj Xgi iXtiXXO&Ao'-^xJXXjxiX 4 :^H"A^X> ilr4 C-i li j^i,xx"jxs >?,<.< " 'i > ^ . <- {^k~, J.Cip 3ij }vXLJJ (.gyifcL.' IJCa i\$X"lAXtA'XAg_X'ii_j_A-J ^^ means, Just as We showed him the evidence that turned him away from that sin, We save him from all types of evil and illegal sexual activity in all his affairs, because, 4c\$-4Xj' l"iCj Cjtf'ff iSurely, he was one of Our Mukhlasiin servants.} meaning, chosen, purified, designated, appointed and righteous. May Allah s peace and blessings be on him. > s < ' s' .s" V ^ util LiA'i)/ J liJu Lilj> 5- " ' iaSJ cr* *!>? b cJfc % i oA J v! t . / >> - /A * - ** i < ^ < / c v ^ :/" / -A- * ,t IjM Ut -1* ,*<"; "< ^- o\ J* -1-4 J Jpijj l li'If s" <- < "f //*/ -/ < 2 < " *i > > ^ ^ , j 1 -.*' / /> / *C 'ys<. U r rv , "jrv5_A^ ' jj y\ -A* jo olj 'X* (f- j jA w pt* iX-T" Si Sf~ = Ji ,ij] JLi y-o Ui j* ["X-J bj 4 . OVi-blji.' C.V^ = lAjiJ tiytil 'ij 425. So f/iey raced toif/i one another to the door, and she tore his shirt from the back. They both found her master (i.e. her husband) at the door. She said: What is the recompense (punishment) for him who intended an evil design against your wife, except that he be put in prison or a painful torment?"} Tabari 16:49.

4.26. He [Yiisuf] said: "It was she that sought to seduce me;" and a witness of her household bore witness (saying) : "If it be that his shirt is torn from the front, then her tale is true and he is a liar!" } 427. "But if it be that his shirt is torn from the back, then she has told a lie and he is speaking the truth! } 428. So when he (her husband) saw his [Yusufs] shirt torn at the back, he (her husband) said: "Surely, it is a plot of you women! Certainly mighty is your plot!" } 429. "O Yusuf ! Turn away from this! (O woman!) Ask forgiveness for your sin, verily, you were of the sinful." } Allah says that Yusuf and the wife of the Aziz raced to the door, Yusuf running away from her and her running after him to bring him back to the room. She caught up with him " held on to his shirt from the back, tearing it so temptingly that it fell off Yusuf's back. Yusuf continued running from her, with her in pursuit. However, they found her master, her husband, at the front door. This is when she responded by deceit and evil plots, trying to exonerate herself and implicate him, saying, 4 & ail %\ if C } 4 What is the recompense (punishment) for him who intended an evil design against your wife. . . ? }, in reference to illegal sexual intercourse, 4 except that he be put in prison } 4 % 4 or a painful torment? } tormented severely with painful beating. Yusuf did not stand idle, but he declared the truth and exonerated himself from the betrayal she accused him of, 4 ti > 4 He [Yiisuf] said }, in truth and honesty,

Yusuf (25-29) (Part-12 it was she that sought to seduce me }, and mentioned that she pursued him and pulled him towards her until she tore his shirt. dX 4 l+ul ji lt< l^Lj } 4 And a witness of her household bore witness (saying): "If it be that his shirt is torn from the front...", not from the back, 4 then her tale is true } that he tried to commit an illegal sexual act with her. Had he called her to have sex with him and she refused, she would have pushed him away from her and tore his shirt from the front, y^jSSb.'. i ' " > > - t'V. cit j*j ot ob ol 4 But if it be that his shirt is torn from the back, then she has told a lie and he is speaking the truth! } Had Yusuf run away from her, and this is what truly happened, and she set in his pursuit, she would have held to his shirt from the back to bring him back to her, thus tearing his shirt from the back. There is a difference of opinion over the age and gender of the witness mentioned here. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Ibn Abbas said that, 4 '-+1 o*Ui jL^ j } i and a witness of her household bore witness } was a bearded man, meaning an adult male. Ath-Thawri reported that J&bir said that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Ibn Abbas said, He was from the king's entourage. Mujaljid, Tkrimah, Al-IJasari, Qatadah, As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Isl>&q and others said that the witness was a young adult male. Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4 ti+i a*uS jLq~j } 4 and a witness of her household bore witness }

758 Tafsir Ibn Katir He was a babe in the cradle. Similar was reported from Abu Hurayrah, Hilal bin Yasaf, Al-Hasan, Said bin Jubayr and Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim, that the witness was a young boy who lived in the Aziz's house. 121 Ibn Jarir At-Tabari preferred this view. Allah's statement, iy, -V3 \$ So when he saw his [Yusufs] shirt torn at the back, } indicates that when her husband became certain that Yusuf was telling the truth and that his wife was lying when she heralded the accusation of betrayal at Yusuf, in , * i he said: "Surely, it is a plot of you women!..." } He said, This false accusation and staining the young man's reputation is but a plot of many that you, women, have, ^ Certainly mighty is your plot! } The Aziz ordered Yusuf, peace be upon him, to be discrete about what happened, if jff\ 40 Yusuf ! Turn away from this! }, do not mention to anyone what has happened, 4 And ask forgiveness for your sin, } addressing his wife. The Aziz was an easy man, or gave excuse to his wife because she saw in Yusuf an appeal she could not resist. He said to her, Ask forgiveness for your sin, the evil desire that

you wanted to satisfy with this young man, and then inventing false accusations about him, At-Tabari 16:56 l2] Af-Tabari 16:54-55.

Jr tr* .jzc&vjx iverily, you were of the ;r< ^ * s'' ' %' - < ^jH-Ca u aji iiJtjjs6p > >?.o '+f''s < ' ' \'-p'rj^ \j-2> f4j l lo-Cx.sj*e * < *jj*a)u-j tei^" i4s4jUo ^*^b>^*^ P.^vr.-u\E^j)sCiu by-^b cJib(jltjj^dc-lljlliO'jLSboboCL^Lbj *jL-JJzjJ r*- * j .U^r4 <&. Id x?b Sp ^-4>? 3r-i j-^l> S ^ t , C2 Sp c^ ' , 'T'' "li' >* .; t* *J" ^V > L^J-* * >* Gi 5j S u 4? &> 436 : *A A~^ c* /*JX> "j 4-i ^ -ZJ ,v'< S ij ^ p^j r%o^a-X^ b_5vbj it di& yj jf ./ * < * , ** ' * } ms sjp 0/4 A^! * & U\ f3, ixp i Vi jLQi yh\ > %1 Ifijg& Jpd% Jj vl^g #0)Vfi' 430. A"rf women in the city said: The wife of the Aziz is seeking to seduce iter (stave) young num, indeed she loves him violently; verily, we see her in plain error."} 432 . So when she heard of their accusation, she sent for them and prepared a banquet for them; she gave each one of them a knife, and she said [to Yusuf]: "Come out before them." Tlten, when they sazu him, they exalted him (at his beauty) and (in their astonishment) cut their hands. They said: "How perfect is Allah! No man is this! This is none other than a noble angel! } , 432. She said: "This is he (the young man) about whom you did blame me, and I did seek to seduce him, but he refused. And nozo if he refuses to obey my order, he shall certainly beI sinful.} -yJ 1 J" O6- 4^ -#" JjLrf ^ Sji 11^ C>- LjA" ^ . '1 . . i I Os .TvYn

cast into prison, and will be one of those who are disgraced."} . He said: O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me. Unless You turn away their plot from me, I will feel inclined towards them and be one of the ignorant."} 434. So his Lord answered his invocation and turned away from him their plot. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All- Knower.} The News reaches Women in the City, Who also plot against Yusuf Allah states that the news of what happened between the wife of the Aziz and Yusuf spread in the city, that is, Egypt, and people talked about it, 4And women in the city said...}, such as women of chiefs and princes said, while admonishing and criticizing the wife of the Aziz, o6 tilsij 4The wife of the Aziz is seeking to seduce her (slave) young man,}, she is luring her servant to have sex with her, it 1} {indeed she loves him violently;}, her love for him filled her heart and engulfed it, 4verily , ive see her in plain error.}, by loving him and trying to seduce him. 4So when she heard of their accusation,} especially their statement, indeed she loves him violently. Muhammad bin Ishaq commented, They heard of Yusufs beauty and wanted to see him, so they said these words in order to get a look at him. This is when,

cy.\$} ishe sent for them}, invited them to her house, ji OXcl)} iand prepared a banquetfor them.} Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, As-Suddi and several others commented that she prepared a sitting room which had couches, pillows [to recline on] and food that requires knives to cut, such as citron. 1 11 This is why Allah said next, Irr-t y iand she gave each one of them a knife}, as a part of her plan of revenge for their plot to see Yusuf, iand she said [to Yusuf]: "Come out before them."}, for she had asked him to stay somewhere else in the house, i\S} iThen, when} he went out and, & &f} ithey saw him, they exalted him} they thought highly of him and were astonished at what they saw. They started cutting their hands in amazement at his beauty, while thinking that they were cutting the citron with their knives. Therefore, they injured their hands with the knives they were holding, according to several reports of TafsirP Others said that after they ate and felt comfortable, and after having placed citron in front of them, giving each one of them a knife, the wife of the Aziz asked them, Would you

like to see Yusuf They said, Yes. So she sent for him to come in front of them and when they saw him, they started cutting At-Tabari 16:71-72. At-Tabari 16:76-78.

O my Lord! Prison is dearer to me than that to which they invite me...

said, ;iUp li; Olij fi*! ;dj" YJ " Y dk ^ p4^*i 4* " 1 liUj tj"Jj o Cy 9 li! y-T*****-^ jji** ijtol jJLo Y ii.i.A t J \,rt7 jj t*-ip tiill olit ^J :JUi JUj>-_j '_-,'-4 oli oi\l i*~"j cJteit t< "lile- c i Qli il jSi jj "Allah will give shade to seven, on the Day when there will be no shade but His : A just ruler, a youth who Iws been brought up in the worship of Allah, a man whose heart is attached to the Masjid, from the time he goes out of the Masjid until he gets back to it, two persons who love each other onlyfor Allah's sake and they meet and part in Allah's cause only, a man who gives charitable gifts so secretly that his left hand does not know what his right hand has given, a man who refuses the call of a charming woman of noble birth for illicit intercourse with her and says: "I am afraid of Allah, and a person who remembers Allah in seclusion and his eyes are then flooded with tears oij/t i 435. Then it occurred to them, after they had seen the proofs (ofhis innocence), to imprison him for a time> Yusuf is imprisoned without Justification Allah says, Then it occurred to them that it would be in their interest to imprison Yusuf for a time, even after they were convinced of his innocence and saw the proofs of his truth, honesty and chastity. It appears, and Allah knows best, that they imprisoned him after the news of what happened spread. They wanted to pretend that Yusuf was the one who tried to seduce the Aziz s wife and that they punished him with imprisonment. This is why when the Pharaoh asked YUsuf to leave jail a long time afterwards, he refused to leave until his innocence was ascertained and the allegation of his betrayal was refuted. When this was successfully achieved, Al-Bari 2 :168, Muslim 2 :715.

YQsuf left the prison with his honor intact, peace be upon him. Zsr\$ Jlij ti[tljJ J15 jCli U&Z%4A #t & j-J-1 And there entered with him two young men in the prison. One of them said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) pressing wine." The other said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) carrying bread on my head and birds were eating thereof." (They said): "Inform us of the interpretation of this. Verily, ive think you are one of the doers ofgood."} Two Jail Mates askYusufto interpret their Dreams Qatadah said, One of them was the king s distiller and the other was his baker. I 11 Each of these two men had a dream and asked Yusuf to interpret it for them. vfj lL J jj .4-f* > err z*}"jy i wv lL" c_v'j (**> oj-tfi 'i fy %A oiy (Lie *i> ,jj iJJ'j ,j< 4l\> J U U JiYUuj r*. y ,j;0' _/^=1 (j;Ol Jcj 437. He said: "No food will come to you as your provision, but I will inform its interpretation before it comes. This is of that which my Lord has taught me. Verily, I have abandoned the religion of a people that believe not in Allah and are disbelievers in the Hereafter."} 438. "And I have fallowed the religion of my fathers, - Ibrahim, Ishaq and Ya'qub and never could we attribute any partners whatsoever to Allah. This isfrom the grace ofAllah to us and to mankind, but most men thank not.} Yusuf calls His Jail Mates to Tawhid even before He interprets Their Dreams YQsuf, peace be upon him, told the two men that he has knowledge in the interpretation of whatever they saw in their m At-fabari 16:95.

worthy of worship except Allah alone without partners, 4 iis from the grace of Allah to us\$, He has' revealed it to us andj ordained it on us, 4and to mankind,^, to whom He has sent us as callers to Tawhid, ibut most men thank not.\$ they do not admit Allah s favor and blessing of send- ing the Messengers to them, but rather, \M iHave changed the blessings ofAllah into disbelief, and caused their people to dwell in the house ofdestructionf (14:28] as r i* mgm >. < Iff s't-i'ivs.i' - .ujt "4ii*j * _jy>- a i

C,XLzffiv 1\$) r-f .. ^c _ - .Jlij."l J) ***" J t 3L W, 432 c a J 5- 4.0: o^ii vl^ vj o] ^Lii oj^&\$ pfe&y^ itLil vi ^ V c>;UJl (^ *i?:i "Ij^ V(ljj_i 439. "O too companions of the prison! Are many different lords (gods) better or Allah, the One, the Irresistible?"} 440. "You do not worship besides Him but only names which you have named (forged) - you and your fathers - for which Allah has sent down no authority. The command is for none but Allah . He has commanded that you worship none but Him

168 Tafsir Ibn Kathir that is the straight religion, but most men know not."} Prophet Yusuf went on calling his two prison companions to worship Allah alone, without partners, and to reject whatever is being worshipped instead of Him like the idols, which were worshipped by the people of the two men, Yusuf said, i'j&R j'ia 4 iAre many different lords (gods) better or Allah, the One, the Irresistible?} to Whose grace and infinite kingdom everything and everyone has submitted in humiliation. Prophet Yusuf explained to them next that it is because of their ignorance that they worship false deities and give them names, for these names were forged and are being transferred from one generation to the next generation. They have no proof or authority that supports this practice, hence his statement to them, ot Ki *' 4/'^ ifor ivhich Allah has sent down no authority or proof and evidence. He then affirmed that the judgement, decision, will and kingdom are all for Allah alone, and He has commanded all of His servants to worship none but Him. He said, ithat is the straight religion, This, Tawhld of Allah and directing all acts of worship at Him alone in sincerity, that I am calling you to is the right, straight religion that Allah has ordained and for which He has revealed what He wills of proofs and evidences, ibut most men know not.}, and this is why most of them are idolators, vZi&JSj j5j fcj} iAnd most of mankind will not believe even if you eagerly desire it.} [12:103) When Yusuf finished calling them, he started interpreting their

dreams for them, os Di SkJ3 41^^ Jg & 4 ll'J -lj A-i tS rA> 441 . "O two companions of the prison! As for one of you, he will pour out winefor his master to drink; and as for the other, he will be crucified and birds will eatfrom his head. Thus is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire."} The Interpretation ofthe Dreams Yusuf said, 4 -"- ,*jj a Ul ^y^j} 40 two companions of the prison! As far one of you, he will pour out winefor his master to drink;} to the man who saw in a dream that he was pressing wine. He did not direct this speech at him, however, so that to lessen the grief of the other person. This is why he made his statement indirect, 4*Uj ^ iand as far the other, he will be crucified and birds will eat from his head.} which is the interpretation of the other man s dream in which he saw himself carrying bread above his head. Yusuf told them that the decision about their matter has already been taken and it shall come to pass. This is because the dream! is tied to a bird s leg, as long as it is not truthfully interpreted. If it is interpreted, then it becomes a reality. Ath-Thawri said that Imarah bin Al-Qa qa narrated that Ibrahim said that Abdullah bin MasTkd said, When they said what they said to him, and he explained their dreams to them, they replied, *We did not see anything at all. This is when he said, 4:ifrj 4j [&>} 477ius is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire.y At-Tabari 16 : 108

The understanding in this is that he who claims that he saw a dream and was given its interpretation, then he will be tied to its interpretation, and Allah has the best knowledge. There is an honorable Hadith that Imam Ahmad collected from Mu'awiyah bin Haydah that the Prophet jg said. U jS\}t JjLj The dream is tied to a bird's leg, as long as it is not interpreted. If it is interpreted, it becomes a reality.^ (1)

*- H414 gG /jl ifi i j)J *} ^ vLi 442. And he said to the one whom he knew to be saved: Mention me to your king." But Shaytan made him forget to mention it to his master. So [Yiisuf] stayed in prison a few (more) years.} Yusuf asks the King s Distiller to mention Him to the King YQsuf knew that the distiller would be saved. So discretely, so that the other man s suspicion that he would be crucified would not intensify, he said, 4-&fj y.^k=^>\} iMention me to your King.} asking him to mention his story to the king. That man forgot Yusufs request and did not mention his story to the king, a plot from the devil, so that Allah s Prophet would not leave the prison. This is the correct meaning of, cfc; .I ' 4But Shaytan made him forget to mention it to his master.} that it refers to the man who was saved. As was said by Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ishaq and several others.¹² ' As for, a few years , or, Bida in Arabic, it means between three and nine, Ahmad 4:10. At-Tabari 16:113.

u\ tmm > -- > my s ".s \$.s <, >.* \ ' . ' iuJUj VM .> >>".i -" <'J"J J 4JL-J ja))JkijTJL*o>*17bO(jCr;;i^jiO)fr;Jr' ,_* > \j liU'J Or- ut* ^Lb ' < s c .? ' <> * '? 1'\&\< i" according to Muj&hid and Qatadah.^ * Wahb bin Munabbih saitjl, AyyOb suffered froijn the illness for seven years, YQsuf remained in prison for seven years and Bukhtanassar (Nebuchadnezzar - Chaldean king of Babylon) was tormented for seven years. p is} Xi\ ip' Sil ="t i}^f " r-e -* ^ y>- J uJU%fr 4# fcw C54 jji; Ci^U f~ o) 'J 4 5^^ r> &Jk& '?-> mM c& 4' \$j o ; yjj-i; grJ- j U-il ^j(Q;1 ^ Jfi J#J o-at Ji^\$ * I^j^ ip* . (Jll i Ju; ^ ^ \$;SjK1j CU XU V) z4pJS 4 "jL fJwai- G Gj Sc . 0jP[> i ii i * Ss f SSA4 "4 *i s cS& 3*p > - . - Xv^'^Wi iA" 443. And the king (ofEgypt) said: Verily, I saw (in a dream) seven fat cows, whom seven lean ones were devouring, and seven green ears of com, and (seven) others dry. O notables! Al-Tabari 16:115. Al-Tabari 16:114.

Explain to me my dream, if it be that you can interpret dreams. 444. They said: "Mixed up false dreams and we are not skilled in the interpretation ofdreams. > 445. Then the man who was released, now at length remembered and said: "I will tell you its interpretation, so send me forth. } 446. (He said): "O Yusuf, the man of truth! Explain to us seven fat cows whom seven lean ones were devouring, and seven green ears of com, and (seven) others dry, that I may return to the people, and that they may know. } 447. [Yusuf] said: "For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual and that which you reap you shall leave it in the ears, (all) except a little of it which you may eat. } 448. "Then will come after that, seven hard (years), which will devour ivhat you have laid by in advancefor than, (all) except a little of that which you have guarded (stored). } 449. "Then thereafter will come a year in which people will have abundant rain and in which they will press (ivine and oil) } The Dream ofthe King ofEgypt The King of Egypt had a dream that Allah the Exalted made a reason for Yusufs release from prison, with his honor and reputation preserved. When the king had this dream, he was astonished and fearful and sought its interpretation. He gathered the priests, the chiefs of his state and the princes and told them what he had seen in a dream, asking them to interpret it for him. They did not know its interpretation and as an excuse, they said, 4 jJ 1^J\} 4Mixed up false dreams}, which you saw, iUth (iVr jyii Cj} 4and we are not skilled in the interpretation ofdreams.} They said, had your dream been a vision rather than a mixed up false dream, we would not have known its

interpretation. The man who was saved from the two, who were Yusufs companions in prison, remembered. Shaytan plotted to make him forget the request of Yusuf, to mentijon his story to the king. Now, years later, he remembered after forgetfulness and said to the king and his entourage, 41 will tell

you its interpretation, he interpretation of this dream, 4s0 send me forth. to the prison, to Yusuf, the man of truth. |So they sent him, and he said to Yusuf, 40 Yusuf, the man of truth! Explain to us..} and mentioned the king's dream to him. Yusuf's Interpretation of the King's Dream This is when Yusuf, peace be upon him, told the interpretation of the dream, without criticizing the man for forgetting his request that he had made to him. Neither did he make a precondition that he be released before explaining the meaning. Rather, he said, 4Q> Jyt&} 4For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual} you will receive the usual amount of rain and fertility for seven consecutive years. He interpreted the cows to be years, es, ext because cows till the land that produce fruits and vegetables; which represent the green ears of corn in the dream. He n recommended what they should do during these fertile years, 4and that (the harvest) which you reap you shall leave it in the ears, (all) except a little of it which you may eat.} He said, Whatever you harvest during those seven years, leave it in the ears so as to preserve it better. This help the harvest stay healthy longer, except the amount you need to eat, which should not be substantial. Stay a from extravagance, so that you use what remains of {the will that .way the

harvest during the seven years of drought that will follow the seven fertile years. This was represented by the seven lean cows that eat the seven fat cows. During the seven years of drought, they will eat from the harvest they collected during the seven fertile years, as represented by the dry ears of corn in the dream. Yusuf told them that during these years, the remaining ears will not produce anything and whatever they try to plant, will not produce any harvest, so he said, xb j -4 c\$\\ iwhich will devour what you have laid by in advance far them, (all) except a little of that which you have guarded (stored). He delivered the good news to them that after the consecutive years of drought, there will come a fertile year, during which people will receive rain and the land will produce in abundance. The people will then press wine and oil as usual. JL> L d&j Jli jl}j} ij ifQi. c Jli Jj Ctr-l) 'J& 0* "Sj 13 jpJl j3l Y 2i')t) ^ y /jJj .aJu 4> AJfJ ^ Yj, ybV J-)l 6^ Xt 450. And the king said: "Bring him to me. But when the messenger came to him, [Yusuf] said: "Return to your king and ask him, What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, my Lord (Allah) is Well-Aware of their plot." } 451. (The king) said (to the women): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yusuf?" The women said: "Allah forbid! No evil know we against him!" The wife of the Aziz said: Now the truth is manifest (to all)', it was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful. } 452. [Then Yusuf said: "I asked for this inquiry] in order that he may know that I betrayed him not in (his) absence." And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers.} 453. "And I free not myself (from the blame). Verily, the self is

inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His mercy (upon whom He wills). Verily, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."} The King investigates what happened between the Wife of the Aziz, the Women in the City, and Yusuf Allah narrates to us that when the king was conveyed the interpretation of his dream, he liked Yusuf's interpretation and felt sure that it was true. He realized the virtue of Prophet Yusuf, recognized his knowledge in the interpretation of dreams and valued his good conduct with his subjects in his country. The king said, iBring him to me.} Release him from prison and bring him to me. When the king's emissary came to Yusuf and conveyed the news of his imminent release, Yusuf refused to leave the prison until the king and his subjects declare his innocence and the integrity of his honor, denouncing the false accusation that the wife of the Aziz made against him. He wanted them to know that sending him to prison was an act of injustice and aggression, not that he

committed an offense that warranted it. He said, iRetum to your lord (i.e. king...) The Sunnah of our Prophet ^ praised Prophet Yusuf asserted his virtues, honor, elevated rank and patience, Allah s peace and blessings be on him. The Musnad and Two Sahihis recorded that Abu Hurayrah said that Messenger ofAllah 5 said, I'Ve are more liable to be in doubt than Ibrahim when he saidU and pay the the \$My Lord! Show me how You give life to the dead...} ii-J l yyU\ j /jSj jJl -Ul 11

VjeijJi cirV may send His meraj on Lilt! He wished to have poioerful support! If I were to stay in prison for such a long time as Yusuf did, I would have accepted the offer. n In another narration collected by Ahmad from Abu Hurayrah,

guilty of this, for by Allah, we never knew him to do evil. This; is when, 4The wife of the Aziz said: "Now the truth has Hashasa . . ." } or the truth is manifest to all, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and others. Hashasa also means, became clear and plain , iit was I who sought to seduce him, and he is surely of the truthful.] when he said, was she that sought to seduce me.} \ >\$} 4in order that he may know that I betrayed him not in (Ids) absence. She said, I admit this against myself so that my husband knows that I did not betray him in his absence and that adultery did not occur. I tried to seduce this young man arid he refused, and I am admitting this so that he knows I am innocent, Cj aZ \$ 1%} 4And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers. And I free not myself (from the blame).} She said, I do not exonerate myself from blame, because the soul wishes and lusts, and this is what made me seduce him, for, 4Verily, the (human) self is inclined to evil, except when my Lord bestows His mercy (upon whom He wills).} whom Allah the Exalted wills to grant them immunity, fj i 16:138.

4Verily, my Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} This is the most viable and suitable understanding for the continuity of the stoiy and the meanings of Arabic speech. Al- Mawardi mentioned this in his Tafsir, in support of it, it was also preferred by Imam Abu Al- Abbas Ibn Taymiyyah who wrote about it in detail in a separate work. It was said YUsuf peace be upon him is the one who said, iin order that he (the 'Aziz) may know that I betrayed him not with his wife, \$in (his) absence).} until the end of Ayah (53) He said, sent back the emissary, so that the king would investigate my innocence and the Aziz be certain that, jii# 41 betrayed him not}, with his wife, 4o\$ffi Y ill iin (his) absence. And, verily, Allah guides not the plot of the betrayers.} This is the only explanation presented by Ibn Jarir At-Tabari and Ibn Abi Hatim, but the first view is stronger and more obvious because it is a continuation of what the wife of the Aziz said in the presence of the king. Yusuf was not present at all during this time, for he was released later on and brought to the king by his order. # :f -J S3 4 454. And the king said : "Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person. Then, when he spoke to him, he said: "Verily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted."} 455. [Yiisuf] said: "Set me over the storehouses of the land; I will indeed guard them with full knowledge."}

YusufsRankwith the King ofEgypt Allah states that when he became aware of YUsufs innocence and his innocense of what he was accused of, the king said, jfo} 4Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person.}, That I may make him among my close aids and associates, iThen, when he spoke to him}, when the king spoke to YUsufand further recognized his virtues, great ability, brilliance, good conduct and perfect mannerism, he said to him, iVerily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted.} The king said to Yusuf, You have assumed an exalted status with us and are indeed fully trusted. Yusuf, peace be upon him said, iSet me over the storehouses of the land; 1 will indeed guard them with full

knowledge.} YUusuf praised himself, for this is allowed when one's abilities are unknown and there is a need to do so. He said that he is, iHafiz}, an honest guard, 4p } 4 Alim}, having knowledge and wisdom about the job he is to be entrusted with. Prophet Yusuf asked the king to appoint him as minister of finance for the land, responsible for the harvest storehouses, in which they would collect produce for the years of drought which he told them will come. He wanted to be the guard, so that he could dispense the harvest in the wisest, best and most beneficial way. The king accepted YUusuf's offer, for he was eager to draw YUusuf close to him and to honor him. So

emm &\$y tjiySj J4 ^fdjt^cryy^j>^ ftlJa^j*Vs^y oyC^j&j\y~a\yS)) oj^Gi,\$^bjb l^ --**<-j*- jjo^ ijJl/S-d] alii4^ .:-J oyjJeYljs^f-3s\$ sjUiujS 2ii^' ijfc \$ ^ o .1)UjJj^=uIjli-I lillJ-- 4A"d We make not to be lost the reward of the good doers. And verily, the reward of the Here- after is better for those who believed and had Taqwa .} Allah states that what He has prepared for His Prophet Yusuf, peace be upon him, in the Hereafter is much greater, substantial and honored than the authority He gave him in this life. Allah said about His Prophet Sulaymān (Solomon), peace be upon him, _jji> liljJ jS Cjlliic lici^> ti& kxt "f ol> 4 V- cA*J i" "This is Our gift, so spend or withhold, no account will be asked of you." And verily, for him is a near access to Us, and a good (final) rehim (Paradise).} [38:39-40] Yusuf, peace be upon him, was appointed minister of finance by Ar-Rayyan bin Al-Walid, king of Egypt at the time, instead of the Aziz who bought him and the husband of she who tried to seduce him. The king of Egypt embraced Islam at the hands of Yusuf, peace be upon him, according to Mujahid. * ."m. >"* I -I' . S' V* > " 'tf i'T, r>"vV (* >+*- *-b A (*A> Mir > " _"> m-jTi, .j; - m^A 1 li[Vjtr*i '\$~4 si rr^i 'jtlJ

458. And YUusuf's brethren came and they entered unto him, and he recognized them, but they recognized him not.} 459. And when he furnished them with their provisions, he said: "Bring me a brother of yours from your father. See you not that I give full measure, and that I am the best of the hosts?"} 460. "But if you bring him not to me, there shall be no measure (of corn) for you with me, nor shall you come near me."} 461. They said: "We shall try to get permission (for him) from his father, and verily, we shall do it. } 462. And [Yusuf] told his servants to put their money into their bags, so that they might know it when they go back to their people; in order that they might come again.} Yusuf's Brothers travel to Egypt As-Suddi, Muhammad bin Isji'fiq and several others said that

the reason why YQusuf's brothers went to Egypt, is that after

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2722–2763]

Yusuf became minister of Egypt and the seven years of abundance passed, then came the seven years of drought that struck all areas of Egypt. The drought also reached the area of Kana'an (Canaan), where Prophet Ya'qub, peace be upon him, and his children resided. Prophet YQusuf efficiently guarded the people's harvest and collected it, and what he collected became a great fortune for the people. This also permitted Yusuf to give gifts to the people who sought his aid from various areas who came to buy food and provisions for their families. Yusuf would not give a family man more than whatever a camel could carry, as annual provisions for them. YQusuf himself did not fill his stomach from this food, nor did the king and his aids eat except one meal a day. By doing so, the people could sustain themselves with what they had for the remainder of the seven years. Indeed, YQusuf was a mercy from Allah sent to the people of Egypt. YOsuf's brothers were among those who came to Egypt to buy food supplies, by the order of

their father: They knew that the Aziz of Egypt was selling food to people who need it for a low price, so they took some merchandise from their land with them to exchange it for food. They were ten, because Ya'qOb

peace be upon him kept his son and YQsuFs brother Binyamin with him. Binyamin was the dearest of his sons to him after YQsuf. When Prophet YusuFs brothers entered on him in his court and the center of his authority, he knew them the minute he saw them. However, they did not recognize him because they got rid of him when he was still young, and sold him to a caravan of travelers while unaware of their destination. They could not have imagined that YQsuf would end up being a minister, and this is why they did not recognize him, while he did recognize them. As-Suddi said that Yusuf started talking to his brothers and asked them, What brought you to my land? They said, O, Aziz, we came to buy provisions. He asked them, You might be spies. They said, Allah forbids. He asked them, Where are you from? They said, From the area of Kana'an, and our father is Allah s Prophet Ya'qub. He asked them, Does he have other children besides you? They said, Yes, we were twelve brothers. Our youngest died in the desert, and he used to be the dearest to his father. His full brother is alive and his father kept him, so that his closeness compensates him for losing our youngest brother (who died). YQsuf ordered that his brothers be honored and allowed to remain, i<e &j} 4And when he furnished them with their provisions,} according to their needs and gave them what they wanted to buy, he said to them, Bring me your brother from your father s side whom you mentioned, so that I know that jrou have told me the truth. He continued, %jp jj4 4See you not that I give full measure, and that I am the best of the hosts?} encouraging them to return to him. He then threatened them, (3\$ yi c jyfe) 4But if you bring him not to me, there shall be no measure (of com) for you with me. }

He threatened them that if the next time they come without Binyamin with them, they will not be allowed to buy the food that they need, Is v 'oy V> 4 ...tior shall you come near me." They said: "We shall try to get permission (for him) from his father, and verily, we shall do it." } They said, We will try our best to bring him with us, so that we spare no effort to prove to you that we are truthful in what we told you about ourselves. Allah said, 4And [Yiisuf] told his servants}, or his slaves, 4to put their money}, or the merchandise they brought with them to exchange for food, iinto their bags,}, while they were unaware, 4^L*fj_ J&} iin order that they might come again.} It was said that Yusuf did this because he feared that his brothers might not have any more merchandise they could bring with them to exchange for food. Ji tss jjK % C\k (j dl ji- ijti Jj * j'"& iff. ji JS 463. So, when they returned to their father, they said: "O our father! No more measure of grain shall we get (unless we take our brother). So send our brother with us, and we shall get our measure and tndy, we will guard him." } 464. He said: "Can I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yusuf] to you aforetime? But Allah is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful oft f wse whos how mercy. }

Yusufs Brothers ask Ya'qub s Permission to send Their Brother Binyamin with Them to Egypt Allah says that when they went back to their father, tt litii >>> ithcy said: "O our father! No more measure of grain shall we get..." } after this time, unless you send our brother Binyamin with us. So send him with us, and we shall get our measure and we shall certainly guard him. Some scholars read this Ayah in a way that means, and he shall get his ration. They said, iand truly, we will guard him.}, do not fear for his safety, for he will be returned back to you. This is what they said to Ya'qOb about their brother

Yusuf, T A La i Send him with us tomorrmo to enjoy himself and play, and verily, we will take care ofhim. } [12:12] This is why Prophet Ya'qub said to them, iCan I entrust him to you except as I entrusted his brother [Yusuf] to you aforetime?} He asked them, Will you do to him except what you did to his brother Yusuf before, when you took him away from me and separated me from him? (Uyl yu Oiii- iBut Allah is the Best to guard, and He is the Most Merciful of those who shoiv mercy.) Ya'qub said, Allah has the most mercy with me among all those who show mercy, He is compassionate with me for my old age, feebleness and eagerness for my son. I invoke Allan to return him to me, and to allow him and I to be together;! for surely, He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy.

as&m nr mm V, Os Iddiftji\$3u I *jijli iyOiUJj^cru^i'jv^jiy>_jUail>-_^rtilijj Kil't-tiI* ,1| ' -> ,-' f > - - , > i^jfe=as^^r^jki < j Jdrjy*- j~*Jls_j ^ -ftvt L)j"> >.<" : " i^ci l2j^ i^VJ j^j, olj .U . ..rt> - A1a cAT l OH foj. olj <%* -Aa? J^" a'ajjj C0 feJ ii j^, ^-- ri.- . >.;; "- >, ~o/J ^o" Cs*- r=*~ % . it? o' ^ J&j if f* d6 iif Jli ^+2j>* "jif" lili 465. And when they opened their bags, they found their money had been returned to them. They said: 0 our father! What (more) can we desire? This, our money has been returned to us; so we shall get (more) food for our fa- mily, and we shall guard our brother and add one more measure ofa camel's load. This quantity is easy (for the king to give). } 466. He [Ya'qub] said: 1 will not send him with you until you swear a solemn oath to me in Allah's Name, that you will bring him back to me unless you are yourselves surrounded (by enemies), And when they had sworn their solemn oath, he said: "Allah is the Witness to what we lutve said."} They find TheirMoney returned to Their Bags Allah says, when Yusuf's brothers opened their bags, they found their merchandise inside them, for Yusuf had ordered his servants to return it to their bags. When they found then- merchandise in their bags, 4j 6 ts \$6}

Yusuf (65-66) (Part-13) }They said: O our father! What (more) can we desire?..."}, what more can we ask for, 4This, our money has been returned to us;} Qatadah commented (that they said), What more can we ask for, our merchandise was returned to us and the Aziz Jias given us the sufficient load we wanted? ' They said next, I 4so we shall get (more) food for our family,}, if you send our brother with us the next time we go to buy food for our family, ? 3\$ gfl iij} iand we shall guard our brother and add one more measure ofa camel's load.} since YQsuf, peace be upon him, gave each man a camel s load of com. 4^ & =. &> } iThis quantity is easy (for the king to give).} They said these words to make their case more appealing, saying that taking their brother with them is worth this gain; 4ji* dSi yje o' 4He [Ya'qub (Jacob)] said: "1 will not send him with you until\ you swear a solemn oath to me in Allah's Name..."}, until you swear by Allah with the strongest oath, iu J ji JjftZ} ithat you will bring him back to me unless you are yourselves surrounded (by enemies)}, unlessyouwere all overwhelmed andwereunable to rescue him, 4-H-fLV *>" tji} iAtid when they had sworn their solemn oath}, he affirmed it further, saying,Tabari 16:162.

& b& 4Allah is the Witness to what we have said.} Ibn Ishaq commented, Ya'qQb did that because he had no choice but to send them to bring necessaiy food supplies for their survival. So he sent Binyamin with them. 467. And he said: "O my sons! Do not enter by one gate, but alter by different gates, and I cannot avail you against Allah at all. Verily, the decision rests only with Allah. In Him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him."} 468. And when they entered according to their father's advice, it did not avail them in the least against (the will of) Allah; it ivas but a need of Ya'qub's

inner self which he discharged. And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him, but most men know not.} Ya'qub orders His Children to enter Egypt from Different Gates Allah says that Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ordered his children, when he sent Binyamin with them to Egypt, to enter from different gates rather than all of them entering from one gate. Ibn 'Abbas, Muhammad bin Ka'b, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak Qatadah, As-Suddi and several others said that he feared the evil eye for them, because they were handsome and looked beautiful and graceful. He feared that people might direct the evil eye at them, because the evil eye truly harms, by Allah's decree, and brings down the mighty warrior-rider from his horse. He next said, *ot\$ viSi* (1 and I cannot avail you against Allah at all.) *m At-Jabari 16:164.*

this precaution will not resist Allah's decision and appointed decree. Verily, whatever Allah wills, cannot be resisted or stopped, *ili j* 'ju4 ill* f'ojjpfjii jyLii a&j cJ&y ik ^ f ^ J* ^ # " > -M 4*"Verily, the decision rests only with Allah. In Him, I put my trust and let all those that trust, put their trust in Him. And when they entered according to their father's advice, it did not avail them in the least against (the will of) Allah ; it was but a need of Ya'qub's inner self which he discharged.}, as a precaution against the evil eye, *Cl .j* jJ 4*And verily, he was endowed with knowledge because We had taught him,} he had knowledge that he implemented, according to Qatadah and Ath-Thawri.¹¹¹ Ibn Jarir said that this part of the Ayah means, he has knowledge that We taught him, *4&C Y '&}* but most men know not.[^] , *2) \y= KL> J.6Z-*, *yj AJJ ul ii\ ju cufC jc IJZ" Cjj}* 469. And when they went in before Yusuf, he took his brother (Binyamin) to himself and said: Verily, I am your brother, so grieve not for what they used to do."} Yusuf comforts Binyamin Allah states that when Yusuf's brothers went in before him along with his full brother Binyamin, he invited them to a place of honor as privileged guests. He granted them gifts and generous hospitality and kindness. He met his brother in confidence and told him the story of what happened to him and that he was in fact his brother. He said to him, *At-Tabari 16:168. 121 Ibid.*

'J) I grieve not) nor feel sad for what they did to me. He ordered Binyamin to hide the news from them and to refrain from telling them that the Aziz is his brother Yusuf. He plotted with him to keep him in Egypt enjoying honor and great hospitality. *A 4\$^ \$ 'f g, 4 oilyi . '** iAJ A* lit; i i-fc yw^ .* So to/ICTt / iefiimished them forth with their provisions, he put the bowl in his brother's bag. Then a crier cried: O you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!") 471. They, turning towards them, said: "What is it that you have lost?") 472. They said: "We have lost the bowl of the king and for him who produces it is (the reward of) a camel load; and I will be bound by it.") Yusuf had His Golden Bowl placed in Binyamin's Bag; a Plot to keep Him in Egypt After Yusuf supplied them with their provisions, he ordered some of his servants to place his silver bowl (in Binyamin's bag), according to the majority of scholars. Some scholars said that the king's bowl was made from gold. Ibn Zayd added that the king used it to drink from, and later, measured food grains with it since food became scarce in that time, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhik and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd. ¹²¹ Shu'bah said that Abu Bishr narrated that Said bin Jubayr said that Ibn Abbas said that the king's bowl was made from silver and he used it to drink with. ¹³ Yusuf had the bowl placed in Binyamin's bag while they were unaware, and then had someone herald, *,| At-Tabari 16:172. At-Tabari 16:173. At-Tabari 16:176.*

J ttt m\$m ' -tf-r-"" .i-~ fiv Y (j 4 ji 2 j ":Hit \P\$b&jit3p iS-U.aJ j . X.fl fl) 1j)li JLAA^ -^, uji jJfjji--p4 >./ llcj3d SSaailu 40* you (in) the caravan! Surely, you are thieves!) They looked at the man who was

heralding this statement and asked him, JiAju ij!\i tv^^yip IjU^ jf Jjj'jfT, (4-^ii> Jcjj3 J_j^ Iujitbo^Uuii,jyfa gdj&L }&j ol'S* (-5j4^=\3>"J -jj4 -Lii ir 4 W // ^ t/ /*/ > J1'uIl4!i *,l *,\ .All4^-- , . !*, 4op' i" "What is it that you have lost?" They said: "We have lost the bowl of tlte king..."), which he used to measure food grains, 4y^& *i it iand for him who produces it is a camel load;), as a reward, i -^j **t iand I will be bound by it.), as assurance of delivery of the reward. A&A Hi lju ;,vrfjciFL* \ Cj jej'ii j Ju2j Hi; u j3j "iG Jpf yp p> 4 Pj ji y ui tjSf -liU'-jiT A J *Wj jp .Wj 4:* > Lk_i itiJ o* Ilij < p)i yJJ 4 *ti-5 ji-tj H 4 >-P? ^=- A . They said: "By Allah! Indeed you know that we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!") 474. They said: "What then shall be the penalty ofhim, ifyou are (proved to be) liars.") 475. They [Yusufs brothers] said: "His penalty should be that

192 Tafsir Ibtî Katlur he, in whose bag it is found, should be held for the punishment (of the crime). Thus we punish the wrongdoers!" . So he [Yusuf] began (the search) in their bags before the bag of his brother. Then he brought it out of his brother's bag. Thus did We plan for Yusuf. He could not take his brother by the law of the king (as a slave), except that Allah willed it. We raise to degrees whom We will, but over all those endowed with knoioledge is the All-Knowing (Allah). After Yusufs servants accused his brothers of theft, they said, iBy Allah ! Indeed you bww that we came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!) Ever since you knew us, you, due to our good conduct, became certain that, \t Cj 4 1J4 ILL. iioe came not to make mischief in the land, and we are no thieves!) They said, Theft is not in our character, as you came to know. Yusufs men said, >) 'iWhat then shall be the penalty ofhim), in reference to the thief, if it came out that he is one ofyou, iifyou are (proved to be) liars?) They asked them, What should be the thieves punishment if he is one ofyou? 4 4 jJ,& \)H) 4They said "His penalty should be that he, in whose bag it is found, should be held for the punishment. Thus ive punish the wrongdoers!") This was the law of Prophet Ibrahim, peace be upon him, that the thief be given as a slave to the victim of theft. This is what Yusuf wanted, and this is why he started with their bags first before his brother s bag, to perfect the plot, 4*~ y)

Yusuf (73- 6) (Part- 13) iThen he brought it out ofhis brother s bag .) Therefore, Yusuf took Binyamin as a slave according to their judgement and the law which they believed in. So Allah said; iThus did We plan for Yusuf.) and this is a good plot that Allah likes and prefers, because it seeks a certain benefit using wisdom and the benefit of all. Allah said next, iHe could not take his brother by the law of the king,) as a captive, for this was not the law of king of Egypt, according to Ad-Dahhak and several other scholars. 1,1 Allah only allowed Yusuf to take his brother as a captive after his brothers agreed to this judgement beforehand, and he knew that this was their law. This is why Allah praised him when He said, 4We raise to degrees whom We will,) just as He said in another Ayah, 4f -^ gri) iAllah will exalt in degree those of you who believe.) [58:11] Allah said next, 4i-Jf Jyj) ibut over all those endowed with knowledge is the All-' Knowing Al-Hasan commented, There is no knowledgeable person, but there is another person with more knowledge until it ends at Allah the Exalted and Most Honored. 121 In addition, Abdur- Razzaq recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, We were with Ibn 'Abbas when he narrated an amazing Hadith. A man in tjhe audience said, All praise is to Allah! There is an all-knowing above every person endowed with knowledge. Ibn Abbas responded, Worse it is that which you said! Allah is the All- At-Tabari 16:188. At-Tabari 16:193.

beforehand, meaning Yusuf, peace be upon him! Allah said, 4 'HJi these things did Yusuf keep in himself meaning the statement that he said afterwards, IL iiij jJL 4Vow are in an evil situation, and Allah is the Best Knower of that which you describe!} Yusuf said this to himself and did not utter it aloud, thus intending to hide what he wanted to say to himself even before he said it. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said about Allah's statement, 4 *^r*> * ** iBut these things did Yusuf keep in himself He kept in himself [his statement next], q ft% \= . * iYou are in an evil situation, and Allah is the Best Knower of that which you describe!}. u q ca& (242. a a k \$\$ fry "S] id. j*q ji-ll J *it itC jli |v|Ji c_"iKj 478. They said: "O 'Aziz! Verily, he has an old father (who will grieve for him); so take one of us in his place. Indeed we think that you are one of the doers of good."} 479. He said: "Allah forbid, that we should take anyone but him with whom we found our property. Indeed (if we did so); we should be wrongdoers."} Yusuf's Brothers offer taking One of Them instead of Binyamin as a Slave, Yusuf rejects the Offer When it was decided that Binyamin was to be taken and kept with Yusuf according to the law they adhered by, Yusuf's brothers started requesting clemency and raising compassion in his heart for them, 4 Cl 0A k&R

iThey said, "O Aziz! Verily, he has an old father..."} who loves him very much and is comforted by his presence from the son that he lost, 4jAit ==v. bji4 XAA} iso take one of us in his place.}, instead of Binyamin to remain with you, ije dS j indeed toe think that you are one of the doers of good.}, the good doers, just, and accepting fairness, 4- ji-'d J "ii jli^ iHe said: "Allah forbid, that toe should take anyone but him with whom we found our property..."}, according to the judgement that you gave for his punishment, id jS lit %} ^ lii T o s&sm Vi S^C' 'jWjJk-ju \ |-.^ =3J If > > d.-. "/// / -* ' Aj " viiljj Ijli i ^jAA 4 444 ^ 'S~*J f.'A o)>~j^Jla0dxJ^AL^ ljv jjs j^i "'jL-LJi G-"kf.^ al 441jCilD\ju\$ JG ip- aj Aiilj i f- indeed, we should be wrongdoers.}, if we take an innocent man instead of the guilty man. lit s> ft dj L4 pi JS Lii ** b^iGI ji^; jl G)i '4 <- 4"- qS\ ffi 4 i-dpi jei Jy Allt ji Liip t*j \ du4j Ipjii 44-i 41 4* .A*, _/w- 4 At1 ' (!&=. Ji i;>i 4Sij :*t;Svu4. u; o; c & jj fi uui 44b

480. So, when they despaired of him, they consulted in private. The eldest among them said: "Know you not that your father did take an oath from you in Allah's Name, and before this you did fail in your duty with Yusuf Therefore I will not leave this land until my father permits me, or Allah decides my case and He is the Best of the judges. 481 . "Return to your father and say, O our father! Verily, your son has stolen, and toe testify not except according to what toe know, and we could not know the Unseen!y 482. "And ask (the people of) the town where we have been, and the caravan in which we rehmed; and indeed we are telling the truth."y Yusuf's Brothers consult Each Other in Confidence; the Advice Their Eldest Brother gave Them Allah narrates to us that Yusuf's brothers were desperate because they could not secure the release of their brother Binyamin, even though they had given a promise and sworn to their father to bring him back. They were unable to fulfill their promise to their father, so, 4in private, away from people's eyes, 4\S#y 4they consultedy, among themselves, 4The eldest among them saidy, and his name, as we mentioned, was Rubll, or Yahudha. He was the one among them who recommended throwing Yusuf into a well, rather than killing him. So Rubll said to them, at 4Know you not that your father did take an oath from you in Allah's Name,y that you will return Binyamin to him? However, you were not able to fulfill this promise and, before you caused Yusuf to be lost from his father,

198 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ^\$} {Therefore I will not leave this land}, I will not leave Egypt, {until my father permits me,} allows me to go back to him while he is pleased with me, O ii> 'fi \$} {or Allah decides my case^ by using the sword, or, they says; by allowing me to secure the release of my brother, {turn %} {and He is the Best of the judges.}, He next ordered them to narrate to their father what happened so that they could present their excuse about that happened to Binyamin and as claim their innocence before him. Rftbll said to them (to say to their father), {and we could not know the Unseen!} or, we did not know that your son had committed theft, according to Qatadah and Ikrimah.' Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that it means, Sve did not know that Binyamin stole something that belonged to the king, we only stated the punishment of the thief, {And ask (the people of) the town where we have been,}, in reference to Egypt,'2 ' according to Qatadah,'3 ' or another town. {and the caravan in which we returned.}, about our truthfulness, honesty, protection and sincere guardianship, lj} At-Tabari 16:211-212. ' At-Tabari 16:210. ' At-Tabari 16:212.

Yusuf (83-86) (Part-13 iand indeed we are telling the truth.) in what we have told you, that Binyaml n stole and was takei as a captive as compensation for his theft. J-* S-& oJp c djjj JLjiJI ojG jl Ui/>- . viijj ^=: ly^jj "iilS i^Ul ji" ^ U ' iJCil Ol jte iA'ot^i3 ' 483. He [Ya'qub] said: "Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is most fitting (for me). May be Allah will bring them (back) all to me. Truly, He! Only He is All-Knowing, All-Wise."} 484. And he turned away from them and said: "Alas, my grief for Yusuf!" And he lost his sight because of the sorrow that he was suppressing.} 485. They said: "By Allah! You will never cease remembering Yusuf until you become weak with old age, or until you be of the dead. } He said: "I only complain of my grief and sorrow to Allah, and I know from Allah that which you know not."} Allah s Prophet Ya'qub receives the Grievous News Allah s Prophet Ya'qub repeated to his children the same words he said to them when they brought false blood on Yusuf shirt, 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is most fitting (for me).} Muhammad bin Ishaq said, When they went back to Ya'qOb and told him what happened, he did not believe them and thought that this was a repetition of what they did to Yusuf. So he said, 4U: p o l& 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something.

So patience is mostfitting {for me).} Some said that since this new development came after what they did before [to Yusuf], they were given the same judgement to this later incident that was given to them when they did what they did [to Yusuf]. Therefore, Ya'qub s statement here is befitting, iUr cl & 4Nay, but your own selves have beguiled you into something. So patience is mostfitting (for me).} He then begged Allah to bring back his three sons: Yusuf, Binyamin and Rubil to him. Rubil had remained in Egypt awaiting Allah s decision about his case, either his father s permission ordering him to go back home, or to secure the release of his brother in confidence. This is why Ya'qub said. iijdi jfy ^L; J dSf ji} iMay be Allah will bring them (back) all to me. Truly, He! Only He is All-Knowing,}, in my distress, i the All-Wise}, in His decisions and the decree and preordainment He appoints. Allah said next, \j} \$And he turned away from them and said: "Alas, my grieffer Yusuf! } He turned away from his children and remembered his old grief for YCisuf, iiji &k} 4Alas, my grieffer Yusuf!} The new grief, losing Binyamin and Rubil, renewed his old sadness that he kept to himself. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ath-Thawri said that Sufyan Al-TJsfuri said that Said bin Jubayr said, Only this nation [the following of Prophet m At-Tabari 16:214.

Muhammad ^{sg} were given Al-Istirja P Have you not heard thj statement of Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ji-* ojil' ilLle d* ^d>^ 4"Alas, my grieffor Yusuf !" And he lost his sight because of the sorrow that he was suppressing,)? Ya'qab suppressed his sorrow and did not complain to created being, according to Qatadah and other scholars. 3 ' Acl- Dahhak also commented, Ya'qub was aggrieved, sorrowful and sad. 4 Ya'qub's children felt pity for him and said, while feelirj; sorrow and compassion. > > ji 4By Allah! You will never cease remembering Yusuf), you will keqp remembering Yusuf, 4&Z A) iuntil you become zoeak with old age,), until your strength leaves you, L> this4pr until you be of the dead They said, ifyou continue like we fear foryou that you might die of grief, 4A x*Aj >. 4He said: "I only complain ofmy griefand sorrozv to Allah.")'Wh they stud these words to him, Ya'qub said, iziA-j A- 41 only complain of my grief and sorrow) for the afflictions tl struck me, 4A 4to Allah,) alone, Hat Saying: To Allah we belongand to Him shall be our return. 2' Abdur-Razzaq 2 :227 At-Tabari 16:216.Tabari 16:218.

202 Tafslr Ibn Kathir tii&M Ttl isauip ^ { > ' !:<!' . t" <>> ? s""!*" .i*" *-":!J d&}ty\5\$ 4'*sstftsijti \$&Cip\$J6\$<<^ksJi!k==oU l/wuoLJ "yju ' i* ^j'-.- *;[jl ol^Uj^ " ?-^f*^= != ^\>^y!j j 'J U^^ i&> 4and 1 know from Allah that which you know not.} I anticipate from Allah each and every type of goodness. Ibn Abbas commented on

the meaning of, i'opz 1\zjs&iM} land I know from Allah that which you know not.} The vision that Yusuf saw is truthful and Allah will certainly make it come true. 111 " ! 2 3 & > Cfi \y-\$* Vj i-^rl) ijtiij 0 Oi S^i Y fj\ \$ f\$ Yl J>\ ! X <\$ \) IJ& '^-. il * ji^uj jS3' 1J s*j^ *r>* ^J> U*i> \US ^ fti,iiliili 4S7. "O my sons/ Go you and inquire about Yusuf and his brother, and never give up hope ofAllSh s mercy. Certainly no one despairs of Allah s mercy, except the people who disbelieve."} 488. Then, when they entered unto him, they said: "O Aziz! A hard time has hit us and our family, and we have brought but poor capital, so pay us fill measure and be charitable to us. Truly, AllSh does reward the charitable. } HI At-Tabari 16:227.

Yusuf(87-88) (Part-13 Ya'qub orders His Children to inquire about Yusuf and His Brother Allah states that Ya'qub, peace be upon him, ordered his children to go back and inquire about the news of Yusuf and his brother Binyamin, in a good manner, not as spies. He encouraged them, delivered to them the good news and ordered them not to despair of Allah s mercy. He ordered them to never give up hope in Allah, nor to ever discontinue trusting in Him for what they seek to accomplish. He said to them that only the disbelieving people despair of Allah s mercy. Yusuf's Brothers stand before Him Allah said next. iThen, when they entered unto him), when they went back Egypt and entered upon YOsuf, OS&X [ithey said: O Aziz! A hard time has hit us and our family..."), because of severe droughts and the scarcity of food. iand we have brought but poor capital,) means, *we brought money for the food we want to buy, but) it is not substantial, according to Mujahid, Al-Hasan and several others. Allah said that they said next, 4so pay us full measure) meaning, in return for the little money we brought, give us the full measure that you gave us before. Ibn Mas'Od read this Ayah in a way that means, So give the full load on our animals and be charitable with us. * Ibn Jurayj commented, So be charitable to us by returning our brother to us. * And when Sufyan bin TJaynah was asked if * l * At-Tabari 16:238. * Ibid. * At-Tabari 16:243.

the Sadaqah (charity) was prohibited for any Prophet before our Prophet jg, he said, Have you not heard the Ayah, i3 i ' j Q ojU 4so pay us full measure and be charitable to us. Truly, Allah does rezvard the charitable.} Ibn Janr At-Tabari collected this statement. ^& dSti9a t.&te\$ i\ 'i ill' di>% Jwj Or-i O' Q 4* iill ai fiOj JLiY. '4 Jii -V . L => oij U_i ii' a2 iltS ipij 4: r^"%P& J- & 489. He said: "Do you knoiv what you did with Yusuf and his brother, when you were ignorant?"} 490. They said: "Are you indeed YBsuf?" He said: "I am Yusuf , and this is my brother. Allah has indeed been gracious to us. He ivho has Taqzva, and is patient, then surely, Allah makes not the rezvard of the gooddoers to be lost."} 491. They said: "By Allah! Indeed Allah has preferred you above us, and ive certainly have been sinners."} 492. He said: "No reproach on you this day; may Allah forgive you, and He is the Most Mercifl of those who shoiv mercy!" Yusuf reveals His True Identity to His Brothers and forgives Them Allah says, when Yusuf's brothers told him about the afflictions and hardship, and shortages in food they suffered from in the aftermath of the drought that struck them, and he remembered his father s grief for losing his two children, he felt compassion, pity and mercy for his father and brothers. He felt this way, especially since he was enjoying kingship, authority and power, so he cried and revealed his true identity to them when he asked them. At-Tabari 16:242.

Yusuf (89-92) (Part-13 \$Do you knoio ivhat you did with Yusuf and his brother, when you were ignorant meaning, when you separated between Yusuf and his brother, i & Si> 4iohen you iverc ignorant?} He said, What made you do this is your ignorance of the tremendous sin you were about to commit. It appears, and Allah knows best, that Yusuf revealed his identity to his brothers only then by Allah s command, just as he hid his identity from them in the first two meetings, by Allah s command. When the affliction became harder, Allah sent His relief from that affliction, just as He said He does, v/ *> ~ 4 i i~t s-& c ^ w. c 4 Verily, along with every hardship is relief. Verily, along with every hardship is reliefs94:5-6) This is when they said to Yusuf, 4Are you indeed Yusuf?}, in amazement, because they had meeting him for more than two years while unaware of who! really was. Yet, he knew who they were and hid this news from them. Therefore, they asked in astonishment, ijf\ iii; jaa 36 3AA dZfr been he omfn 4Arc you indeed Yusuf? He said : "I am Yusuf, and this is my brother. .." Yusuf said next, 4 iii 4Allah has indeed been gracious to us.} by gathering us together after being separated all this time, blti ivJ' jjA Y ill' TAA tfc1 iCJk i\ 4 Verily, he who has Taqwa, and is patient, then surely, Allah makes not the reward of the gooddoers to be lost." They said: "By Allah! Indeed Allah has preferred you above us."} They affirmed Yusuf's virtue above them, being blessed with

beauty, conduct, richness, kingship, authority and, above all, prophethood. They admitted their error and acknowledged that they made a mistake against him, 4He said: No reproach on you this day."} He said to them, There will be no blame for you today or admonishment, and I will not remind you after today of your error against me. He then multiplied his generosity by invoking Allah for them for mercy, imay Allah forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy!} ' S} ^ \\\} A# ol Vjj jxLJ,y4 ji ft iljj 493 . "Go with this shirt of mine, and cast it over the face of my father, his vision will return, and bring to me all your family } 494. And when the caravan departed, their father said: I do indeed sense the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me not senile) " } 495. They said: By Allah! Certainly, you are in your old Dalai (error)." Ya'qub finds the Scent of Yusuf in his Shirt! YOsuf said, Take this shirt of mine, 4'h?> cX cjt }Lj Je _\$%} 4and cast it over the face of my father, his vision will return}, because

Ya'qub had lost his sight from excessive crying, 4^X\ 4and bring to me all yourfamily.} all the children ofYa'qOb. 4And when the caravan departed} from Egypt,

ittheir father said...}, Ya'qub, peace be upon him, said to the children who remained with him, il do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me not senile.}, except that you might think me senile because of {old age. Abdur-Razzaq narrated that Ibn Abbas said, When the caravan departed (from Egypt], a wind started blowing and brought the scent ofYUsufs shirt to Ya'qub. He said, il do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf , if only you think me not senile.} He found his scent from a distance of eight days awayI Similar was also reported through Sufyan Ath-Thawri and Shu'bah and others reported it from Abu Sinan.121 Ya'qub said to them, ijtg. ol H}} iifonly you think me not senile.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ata, Qatadah and Said bin Jubayr commented, If only you think me not a fool! 131 Mujahid and Al-Hasan stud that it means, If only you think me not old. Their answer to him was, &\} iCertainly, you are in your old Dalai.} meaning, in your old error, according to Ibn Abbas.151 Qatadah commented, They meant that, because of your love for YQsuf you will never forget him. So they uttered a harsh word to their father that they should never have uttered to 111 Abdur-Razzaq 2:329.Jabari 16:250.Tabari 16:253. At-Jabari 16:255.Jabari 16:257.

20S Tafsir Ibn KathTr him, nor to a Prophet of Allah. Similar was said by As- Suddi and others. 121 \$ Cli p^ pj'1 Jli LiJ W jjjE ;u jl Qi)s> Jp 3b T L u ipu y u i ;^ Then, when the bearer of the good news arrived, he cast it (the shirt) over his face, and his vision returned. He said: "Did I not say to you, 7 know from Allah that which you know not? " } 497. They said: "O ourfather! Askforgiveness (from Allah) for our sins, indeed toe have been sinners. } 498. He said: "1 will ask my Lord for forgiveness for you, verily, He! Only He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Mercifid." } Yahudha bringsYusufs Shirt and Good News Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said; igood news} means information. Mujahid and As-Suddi said that the bearer of good news was Yahudha, son of Ya'qub.131 As-Suddi added, He brought it (Yusufs shirt) because it was he who brought Yusufs shirt stained with the false blood. So he liked to erase that error with this good act, by bringing Yusufs shirt and placing it on his father s face. His father s sight was restored to him. 14 ' Ya'qub said to his children, 4^4 Y U p iDid I not say to you, 7 know from Allah that which you know not?'} , that I know that Allah will return Yusuf to me and that. 4iy-c o"Tabari 16:257. 121 Ibid.Tabari 16:258. * At-Tabari 16:259.

Y IV - /- > ijLi ^ ^j\ ^ol\xu.plLib jjj jJ^AiZ bLli V_u>- J5ja__)^*- > iijj j \)j-*)J?j-*)l,Je _j^ jj "Liioj. Wd*--Ai JjjIjIjsOubjJISj Ijwjtj .dj -Aijli>-4-> yj\$\$.^^_dJLiJj; ^y^%b%44yj\j^>^ vj-wJ' dJl i1uw^is fjpuo> '-^ ^> yv.y="1Uj i 4f do indeed feel the smell of Yusuf, if only you think me iu)t senile.} Yusufs Brothers feel Sorry ana Regretful This is when Yusufs brothers said to their father, with humble- ness, \ l U Ji Av ojiial.. y> M. 4J 4"0 our father! Ask forgiveness (from Alhlh) for our sins, indeed toe have been sinners. He said: "/ toil/ osfc yiy Lord for forgiveness for you, verily, He! Only He is the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. } and He forgives those who repent to Him. Abdullah bin Mas*ud, Ibrahim At-Taymi, Amr bin Qays, Ibn Jurayj and several others said that Prophet Ya'qub delayed fulfilling their request until the latter part of the night.^ . ' iti _r-^ JUj *oi *-f ff. b^-j '- l. "' WW -1* br* ui eri*J j^ v*y /A cf j-AA Je *L\ o' f*i bt ^ ffj "Vj ot JI O. 0 *^ - li>- Jj > ft :t ti Jltf j;\ c -i -44i> 499. Then, when they came in before Yusuf, he took his At-Tabari 16 :262

210 Tafsir Ibn Kathir parents to himself and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allah wills, in security."} 4100. And he raised his parents to the Arsh and they fell down before him prostrate. And he said: "O my father! This is the interpretation of my dream aforetime! My Lord has made it come true! He was indeed good to me, when He took me out of the prison, and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin life, after Shaytan had sown enmity between me and my brothers. Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He wills. Truly, He! Only He is the All-Knowing, the All-Wise.} Yusuf welcomes His Parents; His Dream comes True Allah states that Ya'qub went to Yusuf in Egypt. Yusuf had asked his brothers to bring all of their family, and they all departed their area and left Kana'an to Egypt. When Yusuf received news of their approach to Egypt, he went out to receive them. The king ordered the princes and notable people to go out in the receiving party with Yusuf to meet Allah's Prophet Ya'qub, peace be upon him. It is said that the king also went out with them to meet Ya'qub. Yusuf said to his family, after they entered unto him and he took them to himself, and said: "Enter Egypt, if Allah wills, in security."} He said to them, enter Egypt, meaning, reside in Egypt, and added, if Allah wills, in security, in reference to the hardship and famine that they suffered. Allah said next, and he took his parents to himself} As-Suddi and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that his parents were his father and maternal aunt, as his mother had died long ago. Muhammad bin Ishaq and Ibn At-Tabari 16:267. At-Tabari 16:269.

Jarir At-Tabari said, His father and mother were both alive. Ibn Jarir added, There is no evidence that his mother had died before then. Rather, the apparent words of the Qur'an testify that she was alive. This opinion has the apparent and suitable meaning that this story testifies to. Allah said next, } ' ' ' } 4 And he raised his parents to the Arsh^ he raised them to his bedstead where he sat, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several others.12 ' Allah said, ife. a\$%} 4 and they fell down before him prostrate.} Yusuf's parents and brothers prostrated before him, and they were eleven men, "as was said: 4 And he said: O my father! This is the Ta'wil (interpretation) of my dream aforetime..."}, in reference to the dream that he narrated to his father before, 4 & 1 41 saw (in a dream) eleven stars...} In the laws of these and previous Prophets, it was allowed for the people to prostrate before the men of authority, when they met them. This practice was allowed in the law of Adam until the law of Isa, peace be upon them, but was later prohibited in our law. Islam made prostration exclusively for Allah Alone, the Exalted and Most Honored. The implication of this statement was collected from Qatadah and other scholars.'3' When Mu'adh bin Jabal visited the Sham area,'4 ' he found them prostrating before their priests. When he returned (to Al-Tabari 16:267. ' Ibid. Tabari 16:269. ' Greater Syria, which now comprises Syria, Lebanon, Palestine and Jordan

iHe was indeed good to me, when He took me out of the prison, and brought you (all here) out of the bedouin life,} out of the desert, for they lived a bedouin life and raised cattle, according to Ibn Jurayj and others. ' He also said that they used to live in the Arava, Ghur area of Palestine, Greater Syria. Yusuf said next, d J L d j j h l > i after Shaytan had sown enmity between me and my brothers. Certainly, my Lord is the Most Courteous and Kind unto whom He wills.} for when Allah wills something, He brings forth its reasons and elements of existence, then wills it into existence and makes it easy to attain, i Truly, He! Only He is the All-Knowing.} what benefits servants, i the All-Wise.} in His statements, actions, decrees, preordained-ment and what He chooses and wills. in His <(707 . My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on me of the] sovereignty, and taught me something of the interpretation of.

dreams - the (Only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are my Wali in this world and in the Hereafter. Cause me to die as a Muslim, and join me with the righteous."} Yusuf begs Allah to die as a Muslim. This is the invocation of Yusuf, the truthful one, to his Lord the Exalted and Most Honored. He invoked Allah after His favor was complete on him by being reunited with his parents and brothers, after He had bestowed on him prophethood and kingship. He begged his Lord the Exalted and Ever High, that At-Tabari 16:276.

Yusuf (102-104) (Part-13 the unseen incidents of the past, O Muhammad, in which We reveal to you.) and inform you of, O Muhammad, because it carries a lesson, for you to draw from and a reminder to those who defy you. Allah said next, i.e. {You were not (present) with them}, you did not witness their conference nor saw them, in which they arranged their plan together, well, to throw Yusuf into the well (while) they were plotting against him. We taught you all this through Our Revelation which We sent down to you. Allah said in other Ayat, i.e. {You were not with them, when they cast lots with their pens..} and, {And you were not on the western side, when We made clear to Musa the commandment...} [28:44] until, i.e. {And you were not at the side of the Tur when We called.} [28:46] Allah also said, i.e. {And you were not a dweller among the people of Madyan reciting Our verses to them.} [28:45] Allah states that Muhammad is His Messenger and that He has taught him the news of what occurred in the past, which

carry lessons for people to draw from, so that they acquire their safety in their religious affairs as well as their worldly affairs. Yet, most people did not and will not believe, so Allah said, {And most of mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly.} Allah said in similar Ayat, {And if you obey most of those on the earth, they will mislead you far away from Allah's path} [6:116], and, {Verily, in this is an Ayah, yet most of them are not believers.} [26:8] Allah said next, {And no reward you ask of them for it;} Allah says, You, O Muhammad, do not ask them in return for this advice and your call to all that is good and righteous, for any price or compensation for delivering it. Rather, you do so seeking Allah's Face and to deliver good and sincere advice to His creatures, in which (the Qur'an) is no less than a Reminder unto the Alamm (men and Jinn)} with which they remember, receive guidance and save themselves in this life and the Hereafter. {And how many a sign in the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom.} 1106. And most of them believe not in Allah except that they

attribute partners unto Him.} 107. Do they then feel secure from the coming against them of the covering veil of the torment of Allah, or of the coming against them of the (Final) Hour, all of a sudden while they perceive not? People neglect to ponder the Signs before them. Allah states that most people do not think about His signs and proofs of His Oneness that He created in the heavens and earth. Allah created brilliant stars and rotating heavenly objects and planets, - all made subservient. There are many plots of fertile land next to each other on earth, and gardens, solid mountains, lively oceans, with their waves smashing against each other, and spacious deserts. There are many live creatures and others that have died; and animals, plants and fruits that are similar in shape, but different in taste, scent, color and attributes. All praise is due to Allah the One and Only, Who created all types of creations, Who Alone will remain and last forever. It is He Who is unique in His Names and Attributes. Allah said next, {And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him.} Ibn Abbas commented,

They have a part of faith, for when they are asked, Who created the heavens? Who created the earth? Who created the mountains? They say, Allah did. Yet, they associate others with Him in worship. 111 Similar is said by Mujahid, Ata, Ikrimah, Ash-Sha'i, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam.¹²¹ In the Sahih, it is recorded that during the Hajj season, the idolaters used to say in their Talbiyah: Here we rush to Your service. You have no partners with You, except a partner with You whom You own but he owns not! Allah said in another Ayah, At-Tabari 16:292. Ibid. Muslim 2:843.

Verily, joining others in worship with Allah is a great Zultn (wrong) indeed.> [31:131 This indeed is the greatest type of Shirk, associating others with Allah in worship. It is recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abdullah bin Mas'ad said, I said, O Allah's Messenger! What is the greatest sin? He said, if "That you call a rival to Allah while He alone created you." 11 Al-Hasan Al-Basri commented on Allah's statement, "And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him." This is the hypocrite; if he performs good deeds, he does so to show off with the people, and he is an idolator while doing this. Al-Hasan was referring to Allah's statement, "And most of them believe not in Allah except that they attribute partners unto Him." In a Hadith, from Ibn Umar collected by At-Tirmidhi who said Al-BQri 8:350, Muslim 1:90.

it was Hasan, the Prophet's son said, "He who swears by other than Allah, commits Shirk." 11 Imam Ahmad, Abu Dawud and other scholars of Hadith narrated that Abdullah bin Mas'ad said that the Messenger of Allah said, "Swearing by other than Allah, by the Ruq'ah, by the Tamim and by the Tiwala is all acts of Shirk." In another narration collected by Ahmad and Abu Dawud,

the Prophet said, "Verily, the Tiwala [omen] is Shirk; everyone might feel a glimpse of it, but Allah dissipates it with Tawakkul." Allah said next, "Do they then feel secure from the coming against them of the covering veil of the torment of Allah?" Allah asks, "Do these idolaters who associate others with Allah in the worship, feel secure from the coming of an encompassing torment from where they perceive not?" Allah said in other Ayat, "And they feel secure from the coming of the torment of Allah." 33:17-18 Ahmad 1:381, Abu Dawud 4:212, Ibn Majah 2:1167. Ar-Ruq'ah is the act of reciting incantations, charm etc., the lawful type is done with Qur'an. At-Tamim is the act of putting an amulet around the necks of children to save them from the effects of evil eye. At-Tiwala is a kind of bewitchment done by those who claim they can cause a woman to be more loved by her husband or vice versa. Reliance on and trust in Him * Ahmad 1:389, Abu Dawud 4:230.

Do then those who devise evil plots feel secure that Allah will not sink them into the earth, or that the torment will not seize them from directions they perceive not? Or that He may catch them in the midst of their going to and from, so that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)? Or that He may catch them with gradual roasting (of their wealth and health)? Truly, Your Lord is indeed full of kindness, Most Merciful. 4 [16:45-47] and, "The people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were

asleep? Or, did the people of the towns then feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing? Did they then feel secure against the plan of Allah? None feels secure from the plan of Allah except the people who are the losers. [7:97-99] s IV*' " f / ^ < // > / / // #4 * >: u uj *'" JI j. *" 4108. Say "This is my ivay; I invite unto Allah with sure knowledge, I and whosoever follows me. And Glorified and Exalted be Allah. And I am not of the idolators."4 The Messenger sWay Allah orders His Messenger jg to say to mankind and the Jinns that this is his way, meaning, his method, path and Sunnah, concentrating on calling to the testimony that there is no deity worthy ofworship except Allah alone without partners. The Messenger ggg calls to this testimonial with sure knowledge, certainty and firm evidence. He calls to this way, and those who followed him call to what Allah s Messenger called to with sure knowledge, certainty and evidence, whether logical or

religious evidence, 4And Glorified and Exalted be Allah. This part of the Ayah means, I glorify, honor, revere and praise Allah from having a partner, equal, rival, parent, son, wife, minister or advisor. All praise and honor be to Allah! glorified He is from all that they attribute to Him, oj+ua V ort \ vby1^ "ju 4jJ ^ ^ iThe seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him, and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgivingf [17:44] ufjVf4 >' a#' 4-^ oi^ ot &\$ JS1 ijisi a; / #\$.+s > *; 4109. And We sent not before you (as Messengers) any but men unto whom We revealed, from among the people of townships. Have they not traveled in the land and seen what was the end of those who were before them? And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who have Taqwa . Do you not then understand All ofthe Prophets are Humans andMen Allah states that He only sent Prophets and Messengers from among men and not from among women, as this Ayah clearly states. Allah did not reveal religious and legislative laws to any woman from among the daughters of Adam. This is the belief of Ahlus-Sunnah wal-Jama'ah. Shaykh Abu Al-Hasan, Ali bin Isma'il Al-Ash ari mentioned that it is the view of Ahlus Sunnah wal-Jama ah, that there were no female Prophets, bu there were truthful believers from among women. Allah mentions the most honorable of the truthful female believers Maryam, the daughter of Imran, when He said, U = Vj ^Jj\^ n Z2?^

if oUJ: 4The Messiah [Isa], son ofMaryam (Mary), was no more than a Messenger; many were the Messengers that passed away before him. His mother was a Siddiqah [truthful believer]. They both used to eatfood.) [5:75] Therefore, the best description Allah gave her is Siddiqah. Had she been a Prophet, Allah would have mentioned this fact when He was praising her qualities and honor. Therefore, Maiy was a truthful believer according to the words of the Qur an. All Prophets wereHumans not Angels Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, Zj) 4And We sent not before you (as Messengers) any but men) They were not from among the residents of the heaven (angels), as you claimed. 111 This statement of Ibn Abbas is supported by Allah s statements, Ot CUM Ujf 4And We never sent before you any of the Messengers, but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets), (25:20) ^ Cj &U: V iJa && Zj) 4And We did not create them with bodies that ate not food, nor were they immortals. Then We fulfilled to them the promise. So We saved them and those whom We willed, but We destroyed extravagants), (21:8-9] and. 4&i cA ZZ X C\$) 4Say: "/am not a new thing among the Messengers.") [46:9] m Ad-DurrAl-Mcmthur 4 :595

Allah said next, ifrom among the people of townships}, meaning, from among the people of cities, not that they were sent among the bedouins who are some of the harshest and roughest of all people. Drawing Lessons from the Incidents of the Past Allah said next, iHave they not traveled in the land}, meaning, Have not these people who rejected you, O Muhammad, traveled in the land, 4-+i& CjJ' Jii \$and seen what was the end of those who were before them?} that is, the earlier nations that rejected the Messengers, and

how Allah destroyed them. A similar end is awaiting all

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2763–2769]

disbelievers. Allah said in another Ayah, iHave they not traveled through the land, and lurve they hearts wherewith to understand?} [22:46] When they hear this statement, they should realize that Allah destroyed the disbelievers and saved the believers, and this is His way with His creation. This is why Allah said, y%} \$And verily, the home of the Hereafter is the bestfor those who have Taqiva.} Allah says, Just as We saved the faithful in this life, We also wrote safety for them in the Hereafter, which is far better for them than the life of the present world. Allah said in another Ayah, 4 r ill! j"4-b (VrjAL. ijuliliJI 4Verily , We will indeed make victorious Our Messengers and those wlv believe in this world's life and on the Day when the witnesses

224 Tafstr Ibn Kathir rJl T iA &SM&L dnijJJJ4=iVlyij[j>-i j'4Jt_j ^ '^~fr' c-Ot(j s1, ; ? > '>--' #55* < > *>, -' * > -' * 1 | ' ', ^ ^ > " t' i^oiLJu-3\Lij jvXjs^jC^Sj^Cjau' w|xOrr*? jvt^ ^W-j"i LjXj^v.vjl tr iul^ jtijUo ^_-lJVii_ijX ("pA^j3<_ K'jtt} |Vp s > > ;:K '^" sy* * +> s from the people who are criminals \$> will stand forth (i.e. Day of Resurrection). The Day when their ex- cuses will be of no profit to the wrongdoers Theirs will be the curse, and theirs will be the evil abode (in Hellfire).) [40:51-52] rjj; ^u; 4 &.> (Vs*^!>?* ^~=> -U ff " jfrf& 4110. (They were reprieved) until, ivhen the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied, then came to them Our help, and xohomsoever We willed were rescued. And Our punishment cannot be warded off Allah's Prophets are aided by Victory in Times of Distress and Need Allah states that He sends His aid and support to His Messengers, peace be upon them, when distress and hardship surround them and they eagerly await Allah s aid. Allah said in another Ayah, < 4 . and were so shaken that even the Messenger and those who believed along with him said, "When (will come) the help of Allah?") [2:2 14] As for saying of Allah,

help ofAllah is nearly2:214] Ibn Jurayj also narrated that Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Urwah narrated to him that Aishah did not agree to this and rejected it. She said, Nothing that Allah has promised Muhammad, peace be upon him, but Muhammad knew for certainty that it shall come, until he died. However, the Messengers were tried with trials until they thought that those believers, who were with them, did not fully support them. Ibn Abi Mulaykah said that Urwah narrated that Aishah recited this Ayah this way, jj f+S and they thought that they were betrayed. Therefore, there is another way of reciting this word, and there is a difference of opinion about its meaning. We narrated the meaning that Ibn Abbas gave. Ibn Mas'ud said, as Sufyan Ath-Thawri narrated from him, that he read the Ayah this way, iu titil, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied. Abdullah commented that this is the recitation that you dislike. Ibn Abbas also commented on the Ayah, iuntil, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied^ When the Messengers gave up

hope that their people would accept their messages, and their people thought that their Messengers had not said the truth to them, Allah's victory came then, and whomsoever We willed were rescued. Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Ibrahim bin Abi Hamzah [Hurrah] Al-Jazari said, A young man from Quraysh asked [il At-Tabari 16:307.

Said bin Jubayr O, Abu Abdullah! How do you read this word, for when I pass by it, I wish I had not read this Surah, until, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied. . . } He said, Yes, it means, when the Messengers gave up hope that their people will believe in them and those to whom the Messengers were sent thought that the Messengers were not truthful. Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim commented, I have not seen someone who is called to knowledge and is lazy accepting the invitation, until today! If you traveled to Yemen just to get this explanation, it will still be worth it. Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Muslim bin Yasar asked Said bin Jubayr about the same Ayah and he gave the same response. Muslim stood up and embraced Said bin Jubayr, saying, May Allah relieve a distress from you as you relieved a distress from me! This was reported from Said bin Jubayr through various chains of narration. This is also the Tafsir that Mujahid bin Jabr and several other Salaf scholars gave for this Ayah. However, some scholars said that the Ayah, and thought that they were denied}, is in reference to the believers who followed the Messengers, while some said it is in reference to the disbelievers among the Messengers nation. In the latter case, the meaning becomes: and the disbelievers thought that the Messengers were not given a true promise of victory. Ibn Jarir At-Tabari narrated that Tamim bin Hadhlam said, I heard Abdullah bin Mas'ud comment on this Ayah, until, when the Messengers gave up hope} that their people will believe in them, and their people thought when the respite was long, that the Messengers were not given a true promise. (1 * At-Tabari 16:303. * At-Tabari 16:304.

vJXMi li-W iJji ^ j2^ >?yi "<> J-.r"A,J eft t-M' 421 ? . Indeed in their stories, there is a lesson for men of understanding. It (the Qur'an) is not a forged statement but a confirmation of that which was before it and a detailed explanation of everything and a guide and a mercy for the people who believe .) A Lesson for Men Who have Understanding Allah states here that the stories of the Messengers and their nations and how we saved the believers and destroyed the disbelievers are, a lesson for men of understanding), who have sound minds, is not a forged statement Allah says here that this Qur'an could not have been forged; it truly came from Allah, if it were but a confirmation of that which was before it) in reference to the previously revealed Divine Books, by which this Qur'an testifies to the true parts that remain in them and denies and refutes the forged parts that were added, changed and falsified by people. The Qur'an accepts or abrogates whatever Allah wills of these Books, and a detailed explanation of everything) Meaning the allowed, the prohibited, the preferred and the disliked matters. The Qur'an deals with the acts of worship, the obligatory and recommended matters, forbids the unlawful and discourages from the disliked. The Qur'an contains major facts regarding the existence and about matters of the future in general terms or in detail. The Qur'an tells us about the Lord, the Exalted and Most Honored, and about His Names

and Attributes and teaches us that Allah is glorified from being similar in any way to the creation. Hence, the Qur'an is, a guide and a mercy for the people who believe with which their hearts are directed from misguidance to guidance and from deviation to conformance, and with which

they seek the mercy of the Lord of all creation in this life and on the Day of Return. We ask Allah the Most Great to make us among this group in the life of the present world and in the Hereafter, on the Day when those who are successful will have faces that radiate with light, while those whose faces are dark will end up with the losing deal.

Surah 13: Ar-Rad

PDF pages 2770–2846

The Tafsir of Surat Ar-Ra'd

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2770–2833]

(Chapter -13) Which was revealed in Makkah sg"P *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. V Jf\ cgbj 3\$ Ji Hi jJ c4>: Ji; p\ 42. Alif Lam Mim Ra. These are the verses of the Book (the Qur'an), and that which has been revealed unto you from your Lord is the truth, but most men believe not.) The Qur'an is Allah's Kalam (Speech) We talked before, in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah (chapter 2) about the meaning of the letters that appear in the beginnings of some chapters in the Qur'an. We stated that every Surah that starts with separate letters, affirms that the Qur'an is miraculous and is an evidence that it is a revelation from Allah, and that there is no doubt or denying in this fact. This is why Allah said next, ii&\ HC\$) iThese are the verses of the Book), the Qur'an, which Allah described afterwards, iHi ~is&j) iand that which has been revealed unto you), O Muhammad, <&S0x) ifrom your Lord is the truth,) Allah said next, &) ibut most men believe not.) just as He said in another Ayah,

Ar-Ra'd (1-2) (Part-13) " ^.>"- u^/iAj_> >> ** < ""[^ / x " "< Oi^-,_)^j^} jjj> ^' c- (OJ_lj *Jja -- \" ' \" .*' ' T> -* * i' * * < Jom^jF'V " }**j ii r 0 Ijl#^ _\$j o;^' j"~^==^ -# ^Awd most o/ mankind will not believe even if you desire it eagerly. [12:103] Allah declares that even sifter this clear, plain and unequivocal explanation (the; Qur'an), most men will still not believe, due to their rebellion, stubbornness and hypocrisy. j> ju vlj^' y Sify 7^ Jfi <>&2 Y fe pi * j4 _ . Allah is He Who raised the heavens without any pillars that you can see. Then, He rose above (Istawa) the Arsh [Throne]. He has subjected the sun and the moon, each running (its course) for a term appointed. He manages and regulates all affairs; He explains the Ayat in detail, that you may believe with certainty iti the meeting with your Lord .}> Clarifying Allah's Perfect Ability Allah mentions His perfect ability and infinite authority, since it is He Who has raised the heavens without pillars by His permission and order. He, by His leave, order and power, has elevated the heavens high above the earth, distant and far away from reach. The heaven nearest to the present world encompasses the earth from all directions, and is also high

above it from every direction. The distance between the first heaven and the earth is five hundred years from every direction, and its thickness is also five hundred years. The second heaven surrounds the first heaven from every direction, encompassing everything that the latter carries, with a thickness also of five hundred years and a distance between them of five hundred years. The same is also true about the third, the fourth, the fifth, the sixth and the seventh heavens. Allah said, it is Allah who has created seven heavens and of the earth the like thereof [65 :12 Allah said next, i..without any pillars that you can see.\$ meaning, there are pillars, but you cannot see them, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, and several other scholars. Iyas bin Mu'awiyah said, The heaven is like a dome over the earth, meaning, without pillars. Similar was reported from Qatadah, and this meaning is better for

this part of the Ayah,¹⁴ especially since Allah said in another Ayah, o' 4H; withholds the heaven from falling on the earth except by His permission.[^][22 :65] Therefore, Allah s statement, *** This comes from an authentic narration from Ibn Mas*ud. See Al- 'Ulu (Mukhtasir) p. 103. and Al-Majma' 1 :86. There is also a weak narration attributed to the Prophet saying the same. It was recorded by At-Tirmidhi 2:525, as well as others. At-Tabari 16:324. Ibid. * At-Tabari 16:325.

i..that you can see}, affirms that there are no pillars. Rather, the heaven is elevated (above the earth) without pillars, as you see. This meaning best affirms Allah s ability and power. Al-Istawa", Rising above the Throne Allah said next, iThen, He rose above (Istawa) the Throne.} We explained the meaning of the Istawa in Surat Al-A'raf (7:54), and stated that it should be accepted as it is without altering, equating, annulling its meaning, or attempts to explain its true nature. Allah is glorified and praised from all that they attribute to Him. Allah subjected the Sun and the Moon to rotate continuously Allah said, ifei '\$ \$He has subjected the sun and the moon, each running (its course) for a term appointed.} It was said that the sun and the moon continue their course until they cease doing so upon the commencement of the Final Hour, as Allah stated, 'J {And the sun runs on its fixed course for a term (appointed) .}[36:38] It was also said that the meaning is: until they settle under the Throne of Allah after passing the other side of the earth. So when they, and the rest of the planetary bodies reach there, they are at the furthest distance from the Throne. Because according to the correct view, which the texts prove, it is shaped like a domb, under which is all of the creation. It is not circular like the celestial bodies, because it has pillars by which it is carried. 111 This fact is clear to those who I 1 ! See Surat Gh&fir40 :7.

correctly understand the Ayat and authentic Hadiths. All the (praise is due to) Allah and all the favors are from Him. Allah mentioned the sun and the moon here because they are among the brightest seven heavenly objects. Therefore, if Allah subjected these to His power, then it is clear that He has also subjected all other heavenly objects. Allah said in other Ayat, iProstrate yourselves not to the sun nor to the moon, but prostrate yourselves to Allah Who created them, ifyou (really) worship Him .} [41:37] and, iitm M m 4A 0^ &15 ^if; 4!mUX& iAnd (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord ofall that exists!} (7 :54 Allah s statement next, {He explains the Ayat in detail, that you may believe with certainty in the Meeting with your Lord.} means, He explains the signs and clear evidences that testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him. These evidences prove that He will resurrect creation if He wills, just as He started it. jj 4 jty jJ'^ of* ^* J Sifj (uij ot j,k 43. And it is He Who spread out the earth, and placed therein firm mountains and rivers and of every kind offruit He made

Zawjayn Ithnayn (two in pairs). He brings the night as a cover over the day. Verily, in these things, there are Ayat (signs) for people who reflect.} 44 . And in the earth are neighboring tracts, and gardens of vines, and green crops (fields), and date palms, growing into two or threefrom a single stem root, or otherwise, waiered with the same water; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat. Verily, in these things there are Ayat (signs) for the people who understand.} Allah's Signs on the Barth After Allah mentioned the higher worlds, He started asserting His power, wisdom and control over the lower parts of the world. Allah said, %} 4And it is He Who spread out the earth} made it spacious in length and width. Allah has placed on the earth firm mountains and made rivers, springs and water

streams run through it, so that the various kinds of fruits and plants of every color, shape, taste and scent are watered with this water, 4s ^ sSrJJ <^=> Oi} iand of every kind offruit He made Zawjayn Ithnayn.}, two types from every kind of fruit, 4#f jit 4He brings the night as a cover over the day.} Allah made the day and night pursue each other, when one is about to depart, the other overcomes it, and vice versa. Allah controls time just as He controls space and matter, 4 liB i i iVerily, in these things, there are Ayat for people who reflect.} who reflect on Allah s signs and the evidences of His wisdom. Allah said, 4^j jii J"ji\ jj}

iAnd in the earth are neighboring tracts,} Meaning, next to each other, some of them are fertile and produce what benefits people, while others are dead, salty and do not produce anything. This meaning was collected from Ibn Abbas Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and several others . This also covers the various colors and types of diverse areas on the earth; some red, some white, or yellow, or black, some are stony, or flat, or sandy, or thick, or thin, all made to neighbor each other while preserving their own qualities. All this indicates the existence of the Creator Who does what He wills, there is no deity or lord except Him. Allah said next, gj Ik1^} iand gardens of vines, and green crops (fields), and date palms...} Allah s statement, next, iSinwanun wa (or) Ghayru Sinwan.} Sinwan means, growing into two or three from a single stem, such as figs, pomegranate and dates. Ghayru Sinwan means, having one stem for every tree, as is the case with most plants. From this meaning, the paternal uncle is called one s Sinw of his father. There is an authentic Hadith that states that the Messenger of Allah ^ said to Umar bin Al- Khattab, Jr-f P* jtOJLz ul" Do you not know that man's paternal uncle is the Sinw of his father?* Allah said next, 4 jfZ JZfuj j Xu jll} ^watered with the same water; yet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat.} At-Tabari 16:331-333. Muslim 2:677.

Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet commented on Allah s statement, 4^= of*? 'r iyet some of them We make more excellent than others to eat.} o77ie Dagal/ the Persian, the sweet, the bitter..."|21 At-Tirmidhi collected this Hadith and said, "Hasan Gharib. Therefore, there are differences between plants and fruits with regards to shape, color, taste, scent, blossoms and the shape of their leaves. There are plants that are very sweet or sour, bitter or mild, fresh; some plants have a combination of these attributes, and the taste then changes and becomes another taste, by Allah s will. There is also some that are yellow in color, or red, or white, or black, or blue, and the same can be said about their flowers; and all these variances and complex diversities are watered by the same water. Surely, in this there are signs for those who have sound reasoning, and surely, all this indicates the existence of the Creator Who does what He wills and Whose power made distinctions between various things and created them as He wills. So Allah said, 4^ iVerily, in these things there are Ayat for the people who understand.} \ Z aij i*. jLJU& tt y4 p zi &V' fw mi 45. And if you wonder, then wondrous is their saying: When we are dust, shall we indeed then be (raised) in a new creation?" They are those who disbelieved in their Lord! They are those who will have iron cluins linking their hands to their necks. They will be dwellers of the Fire to abide therein forever.} I 1 * These are different dates. ' TuhfatAl-Ahwadhi8 :544

Denying Resurrection after Death, is Strange Allah says to His Messenger Muhammad, peace and blessings be upon him, J^j) iAnd if you wonder.) at the rejection of the polytheists who deny Resurrection, even though they witness Allah s signs and evidences that He made in His creation which testify that He is able to do everything. Yet, they admit that Allah originated the creation of all things

removed from it. ^ yi 4: a; ^ * j14; Hj ^+4^ j" jj'Sj . They ask you to hasten the evil before the good, while exemplary punishments have indeed occurred before them. But verily, your Lord is full offorgiveness for mankind, in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment.} The Disbelieversask forthe Punishment tobe delivered now! Allah said, iThey ask you to hasten}, in reference to the disbelievers, iLZti i} ifhe evil before the good,} meaning, the punishment. Allah said in other Ayat that they said, U xir 4 c i 4W4&\$\$4 4 ^ 'h " '4'n & uo iAnd they say: "O you to whom the Dhikr (the Qur'an) has been sent down! Verily, you are a mad man! Why do you not bring angels to us ifyou are of the truthful?" We send not the angels down except with the truth (i.e.for torment), and in that case, they (the disbelieves) would have no respite!}\15:6-8], and two Ayat; iAnd they ask you to hasten on the torment!}\29:53-54] Allah also said, 4A questioner asked concerning a torment about to befall.} [70:1],

4 if % il 1) *jt~j ji [" ^==oJ Jji ilf they belie you, say: "Your Lord is the Owner of vast mercy, and never will His wrath be turned backfrom the people who are criminals."M6: 147] 4JL4 X*% fcp Ifr iVerily, your Lord is quick in retribution and certainly He is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.>[7:167],

and, 4:g iis ji jts%f jLp jjjX gi4 4Declare unto My servants that truly I am the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My tortnent is indeed the most painful torment. 15:49-50] There are many other Ayat that mention both fear and hope. 4:.r;jU fj X\ i j VjJ i & cM J 47. And the disbelievers say : "Why is not a sign sent down to him from his Lord?" You are only a wamer, and to every people there is a guide.} The Idolators ask for a Miracle Allah states that out of their disbelief and stubbornness, the idolators asked why is not a miracle sent down to the Messenger j from his Lord, just like the earlier Messengers? For instance, the disbelievers were being stubborn when they asked the Prophet jj to turn As-Safa into gold, to remove the mountains from around them, and to replace them with green fields and rivers. Allah said, 4ojjjVf ^ J Vt sj o' G2: & 4And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people ofold denied them.>[17:59] Allah said here, 4Yow are only a wamer}, and your duty is only to convey Allah s Message which He has ordered you,

whether it will have a long or a short life. Allah said in other Ayat, m & jrta ij \$ 4He knows you well when He created you from the earth, and when you wererefetuses. [53:32], and, 4He creates you in the wombs of your mother: creation after creation in three veils ofdarkness.\$[39:6] meaning stage after stage. Allah also said, ') f} 4 ULLi &L* Y ot S&!{} & SjSj\$ } 'J4 fij2S &, S5 3f tS3 S3^ OT G&S Sfiif 4 *# ' \$23 'if 433 i32. 4And indeed We created man out o/ an extract o/ c/ay. Thereafter We made him as a Nutfah in a safe lodging. Then We made the Nutfah into a clot, then We made the clot into a little lump offlesh, then We made out of that little lump offlesh bones, then We clothed the bones with flesh, and then We brought it forth as another creation. So Blessed is Allah, the Best ofcreators.\$[23:12-14] In the two Sahihs it is recorded that Abdullah bin Mas*ud said that the Messenger of Allah 3g\$ said, ^ J4 bjfc p tijj; jif ^ jU- jj" jjjj *T~^i X'J?\ d-"w jU c tills Jij Jjwai j_j **A^*-i" 4 SjaS'J lThe matter of the creation ofone ofyou is put together in the womb of the mother in forty days, and then he becomes a clot of thick blood for a similar period, and then a piece offlesh for a similar period. Then Allah sends an angel who is ordered to write four things. He is ordered to write down his provisions, his life span, his deeds, and whether he will be blessed or wretched."n1 m Fath Al-Bari 1 1 1486, Muslim 4 :2036.

In another Hadith, the Prophet jg said, Ui Ui r'J " > ikilJLDl "JiiJl 4Js :Jil iThen the angel asks, O my Lord! Is it a male or a female, miserable or happy, what is its provisions and life span? Allah then ordains and the angel records if. Allah said next, 4 ltj,} iand by how much the wombs fall short or exceed.}

Qatadah commented on Allah s statement, Y-tJi sCsr ^Everything with Him is in proportion.} For a term appointed. Allah has the records of the provisions and terms of His creation and made an appointed term for everything. An authentic Hadith mentioned that one of the Prophet s daughters sent (a messenger) to him requesting him to come as her child was dying, but the Prophet jg returned the messenger and told him to say to her, jyjaM Uj J"-l{ J**' ^ ti oj1 "Verily, whatever Allah takes is for Him and whatever He gives is for Him, and everything with Him has a limited fixed tern (in this world), and so she should be patient and hope for Allah's reward . [1 Allah said next, 4All-Knower of the Ghayb (the unseen) and the Shahadah (the witnessable),} Who knows everything that the servants see and all what they cannot see, and none of it ever escapes His knowledge, 4the Most Great}, greater than everything, 4^} 4the Most High.} above everything, 4th&& iCU 4(Allah) surrounds all things in

(His) knowledge.}[65:12), and has full power over all things, the necks are under His control and the servants are subservient to Him, willingly or unwillingly. in Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :502

Allah. Verily, Allah will not change the (good) condition of a people as long as they do not change their state (of goodness) themselves. But when Allah wills a people's punishment, there can be no turning it back, and they will find besides Him no protector.} Allah's Knowledge encompasses all Things Apparent and Hidden Allah declares that His knowledge is encompassing all of His creation, those who declare their speech or hide it, He hears it and nothing of it ever escapes His observation. Allah said in other Ayat, iAnd if you speak aloud, then verily, He knows the secret and

that which is yet more hidden>[20:7], and, fojC C%;) 4And (Alldh) knows what you conceal and what you reveal A ishah said, All praise is due to Allah Whose hearing has encompassed all voices! By Allah, she who came to complain about her husband to the Messenger of Allah was speaking while I was in another part of the room, yet I did not hear some of what she said. Allah sent down, Gf 2if ol illj J" 4 jj" iif Zf. Ji) * - ilndeed Allah has heard the statement of her that disputes with you concerning her husband and complains to Allah. And Allah hears the argument between you both. Verily, Allah is All- Hearer, All-Seer.}[58:1] Allah said next, /A /'V j* Vj? 4whether he be hid by night), in his house in the darkness of the night, *f^j) ior goes forth freely by day.) moves about during the daylight; both are encompassed by Allah's knowledge. Allah said in other Ayat, 'ofZZ Ow \$) iSurely, even when they cover themselves with their garments.) [1 1:51, and, H bjfi h" i yt ^ Vj ylijj j; dj ijhj Zf) 04 % Jlllf 4 Vj J?ji\ }Ji JVi oi cf- v> 4 %1 V;M m Al-Bukhari 7385, An-Nasal in Al-Kubra 11570, Ibn Majah 188, Af- Tabri 5 :28

^Neither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an nor you do any deed, but We are witness thereof when you are doing it. And nothing is hidden from your Lord (so much as) the a speck of dust on the earth or in the heaven . Not what is less than that or what is greater than that but is (written) in a Clear Record.>[10 :61 The Guardian Angels Allah said next, Ju . ^ ~ f * " ^ ft 4For him (each person), there are angels in succession, before and behind him. They guard him by the command of Allah.> Allah states that there are angels who take turns guarding each servant, some by night and some by day. These angels protect each person from harm and accidents. There are also angels who take turns recording the good and evil deeds, some angels do this by day and some by night. There are two angels, one to the right and one to the left of each person, recording the deeds. The angel to the right records the good deeds, while the angel to the left records the evil deeds. There are also two angels that guard and protect each person, one from the back and one from in front. Therefore, there are four angels that surround each person by day and they are replaced by four others at night, two scribes and two guards. An authentic Hadith states, " ! , " * * ' i * * I * * I i tJjXSaj .OjlyLi "Angels take turns around you, some at night and some by day, and all of them assemble together at the time of the Fajr and Asr prayers. Then those who have stayed with you throughout the night, ascend to Allah Who asks them, and He knows the answer better than they about you, "How have you left My servants?" They reply, "As we have found them praying, we have left them praying FathAl-Bari 13 :426 .

Ar-Ra d (12-13) (Part-13 Imam

Clouds, Thunder and Lightning are Signs of Allah's Power Allah states that He has full power over Al-Barq (lightning), which is the bright light that originates from within clouds. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn

Abbas once wrote to Abu Al-Jald asking about the meaning of Al-Barq, and he said that it is water. Qatadah commented on Allah's statement, {as a fear and as a hope.} Fear for travelers, for they feel afraid of its harm and hardship, and hope for residents, awaiting its blessing and benefit and anticipating Allah's provisions. Allah said next, {And it is He Who brings up the clouds, heavy.} meaning, He originates the clouds that are heavy and close to the ground because of being laden with rain. Mujahid said that this part of the Ayah is about clouds that are heavy with rain. * Allah's statement, {And Ar-Ra'd (thunder) glorifies and praises Him}, is similar to His other statement, {And there is not a thing but glorifies His praise.} [17:44] Imam

man from Ghifar said that he heard the Prophet (ﷺ) say, "Verify, Allah originates the clouds, and they speak in the most beautiful voice and laugh in the most beautiful manner. It appears, and Allah has the best knowledge, that the cloud's voice is in reference to thunder and its laughter is the lightning. MQS& bin Ubaydah narrated that Sa'd bin Ibrahim said, Allah sends the rain and indeed, none has a better smile than it, nor more comforting voice. Its smile is lightning and its voice is thunder. Supplicating to Allah upon hearing Ar-Ra'd (Thunder) Imam

Your Lord, the Exalted and Most High, said, Had My servants obeyed Me, I would have given them rain by night and the sun by day, and would not have made them hear the sound of the Ra'd (thunder).'
 1^ Allah's statement, {He sends the thunderbolts, and therewith He strikes whom He wills,} indicates that He sends thunderbolts as punishment upon whom He wills, and this is why thunderbolts increase as time comes to an end. Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Qasim At-Tabarani narrated that Ibn Abbas said that Arbad bin Qays bin Juzu bin Julayd bin JaTar bin Kulab, and Amir bin At-Tufayl bin Malik came to Al-Madlnah to the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) and sat where he was sitting. Amir bin At-Tufayl said, O Muhammad! What will you give me if I embrace Islam? The Messenger of Allah said, {You will have the rights and duties of all Muslims.} Amir bin At-Tufayl said, Will you make me your successor if I embrace Islam? The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said, "That is not your right, nor your people's right. However, I could appoint you a commander of the horsemen (i.e., war). Amir said, I am already the commander of the horsemen of Najd (in the north of Arabia). Give me control over the desert and you keep the cities. The Messenger of Allah refused. When these two men were leaving the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ), Amir said, By Allah! I will fill it (Al-Madlnah) with horses and men (hostile to Muslims). The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) replied, "Rather, Allah will prevent you. When Amir and Arbad left, Amir said, O Arbad! I will keep m Afimad 2 :359

Muhammad busy while talking to him, so you can strike him with the sword. Verily, if you kill Muhammad, the people (Muslims) will agree to take blood money and will hate to wage war over his murder. Then we will give them the blood money. Arbad said, I will do that, and they went back to the Messenger (ﷺ). Amir said, O Muhammad! Stand next to me so that I can talk to you. The Messenger stood up, and they both stood next to a wall talking to each other. Arbad wanted to grab his sword, but his hand froze when it touched the sword's handle and he could not take the sword out of its sheath. Arbad did not strike the Messenger (ﷺ) as Amir suggested, and the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) looked at Arbad and realized what he was doing, so he departed. When Arbad and Amir left the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) and arrived at Al-Harrah of Waqim area, they dismounted from their horses. However, Sa'd bin Mu'adh and Usayd bin Hudayr came out saying, Come, O enemies of Allah! May Allah curse you. Amir

asked, Who is this with you, O Sa d? Sa d said, This is Usayd bin Hudayr. They fled until they reached the Riqm area, where Allah struck Arbad with a bolt of lightning and he met his demise. As for Amir, he went on until he reached the Kharim area, where Allah sent an open ulcer that struck him. During that night, Amir took refuge in a woman s house, from Banu Salul. Amir kept touching his open ulcer and saying, An ulcer as big as a camel s hump, while I am at the house of a woman from Bani Salul, seeking to bring my death in her house! He rode his horse, but he died while riding it headed to his area. Allah sent down these Ayat (13:8-11) in their case, * &-> U p. iAllah knows what everyfemale bears} until, 4-.and they will find besides Him no protector.} Ibn Abbas commented, The angels in succession, guard Muhammad, peace be upon him, by the command of Allah. He next mentioned the demise of Arbad by Allah s command, reciting this Ayah,

iHe sends the thunderbolts,) 111 Allah said next, iyet they (disbelievers) dispute about Allah.) they doubt Allah s greatness and that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, iXi) %) iAnd He is Mighty in strength and Severe in punishment.) Allah s torment is severe against those who rebel against Him, defy Him and persist in disbelief, according to the Tafsir of Ibn Jarir At-Tabari.²¹ There is a similar Ayah in the Qur an, i-i'J- jf j (j Sjj&j) ' % 13^ iSo they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation all together.^[27:50-51] Ali bin Abi Talib said that, iXlj j.A%) iAnd He is Mighty in strength and Severe in punishment (Al- Mihal)), means, His punishment is severe.³ to \ F-f j ot 'j/*-*' 4 k> 4i i j* ty il4. For Him is the Word of Truth. And those whom they invoke besides Him, answer them no more than one who stretches forth his hand for water to reach his mouth, but it reaches him not; and the invocation of the disbelievers is nothing but misguidance.) *** At-TabarfiLni 10:379-381. A Hadith mentioning some of this story was collected by Al-Bukhari, no. 4091, it does not mention the sayings of the Prophet s. At-Tabari 16:394. At-Tabari 16:396.

Allah s statement, 4For Him is the Word of Truth.} is in reference to Tawhid, according to Ibn Jarir At-Tabari. Ibn Abbas, Qatadah, and Malik who narrated it from Muhammad bin Al-Munkadir, said that, 4For Him is the Word of Truth.} means, La ilaha illallah. W Allah said next, Ji opM J&j} 4And those whom they invoke besides Hitn...}, meaning, the example of those who worship others besides Allah, i -i jj# JJ\$} 4like one who stretches forth his hand for water to reach his mouth,} Ali bin Abi Talib commented, Like he who stretches his hand on the edge of a deep well to reach the water, even though his hands do not reach it; so how can the water reach his mouth? 131 Mujahid said about, 4& 4like one who stretches forth his hand} Calling the water with his words and pointing at it, but it will never come to him this way. 141 The meaning of this Ayah is that he who stretches his hand to water from far away, to either collect some or draw some from far away, will not benefit from the water which will not reach his mouth, where water should be consumed. Likewise, those idolators who call At-Tabari 16:398. 12] Ibid.Tabari 16:400. 4 > Ibid.

Af&i !5r***i fJr ot l* J! [4H they not observed things that Allah has created: (Imv) their shadows incline.} [16:48] !/ * Uii A-j'V ~i -.05' jJ ji ilif j" oJliJt 05 '_0*- A lo?- jO'j Ji ft J-Oj JLiVt jJ55 Ji js 4 ._r4^' J-rJ' S*J *Cr o- *i' Jj Ji" J 426. Say : Who is the Lord of the heavens and the earth?" Say: (It is) Allah." Say: Have you then taken (for xvorship) Aioliyd' (protectors) other than Him, such as have no power eitherfor benefit orfor harm to themselves?" Say: Is the blind equal to the one who sees? Or

darkness equal to light? Or do they assign to Allah partners ivho created the like of His creation, so that the creation seemed alike to them?" Say: "Allah is the Creator of all things; and He is the One, the Irresistible."} Affirming Tawhid Allah affirms here that there is no deity worthy of worship except Him, since they admit that He alone created the heavens and the earth and that He is their Lord and the Disposer of all affairs. Yet, they take as lords others besides Allah and worship them, even though these false gods do not have the power to benefit or harm themselves, or those who worship them. Therefore, the polytheists will not benefit or have harm removed from them by these false deities. Are those who worship the false deities instead of Allah equal to those who worship Him alone, without partners, and thus have a light from their Lord? This is why Allah said here, ijili. M Juf- fl jJJ'j cixlii' sf i Ji ft j i \ Ji jsSay : Is the blind equal to the one who sees? Or darkness equal to light? Or do they assign to Allalt partners who created the like of His creation, so that the creations seemed alike to them?"} Allah asks, T)o these polytheists worship gods besides Him

(polytheism) and ordering them to refrain from worshipping others besides Allah. They defied their Messengers and rebelled against them, and this is why the word of punishment struck them as a worthy recompense, iAnd your Lord treats no one with injustice (18:49) \$ j Jjc. li UjSi % . ijG ii. 'CS\ o.j)t uu Jtiifj jioi iit 4^ ji 4 a i&i j:dif ' e- 417. He sends down waterfrom the sky, and the valleys flow according to their measure, but the flood bears away the foam that mounts up to the surface - and (also)from that (ore) which they heat in the fire in order to make ornaments or utensils, rises a foam like unto it, thus does Allah (by parables) show forth truth andfalsehood. Then, as for thefoam it passes away as scum upon the banks, while that which is for the good of mankind remains in the earth. Thus Allah setsforth parables.} Two ParablesprovingthatTruthremainsandFalsehood perishes This honorable Ayah contains two parables which affirm that truth remains and increases, while falsehood diminishes and perishes. Allah said, 4iu tU' j* Jjfy 4He sends down waterfrom the sky,} He sends rain, 4WjSi cJCj} iand the valleysflow according to their measure,} each valley taking its share according to its capacity, for some valleys are wider and can retain more water than others which are small and thus retain smaller measures of water. This Ayah indicates that hearts differ, for some of them can retain substantial knowledge while others cannot entertain knowledge, but rather sire bothered by knowledge, 4tj; ^

{but the flood bears away the foam that mounts lip to the surface^ of the water that ran down the valleys; this is the first parable. Allah said next, {and (also) from that (ore) ivhich they heat in the fire in order to make ornaments or utensils...} This is the second parable, whereas gold and silver ore is heated with fire to make adornments with it, and iron and copper ore are heated to make pots and the like with it. Foam also rises to the surface of these ores, just as in the case with water, ithus does Allah (by parables) showforth truth andfalsehood.} when they both exist, falsehood does not remain, just as foam does not remain with the water or the gold and silver ores which are heated in fire. Rather, foam dissipates and vanishes, {'Xjur JyJ' iThen, as for the foam it passes away as scum upon the banks,} for it carries no benefit and dissipates and scatters on the banks of the valley. The foam also sticks to trees or is dissipated by wind, just as the case with the scum that rises on the surface of gold, silver, iron and copper ores; it all goes away and never returns. However, water, gold and silver remain and are used to man s benefit. This is why Allah said next, {while that which is for the good of mankind remains in the earth. Thus Allah sets forth parables.} Allah said in a similar Ayah, Cj tyiii &&& {And these

similitudes We putforward for mankind; but none will understand them except those who have knowledge.} [29:43]

Some of the Salaf (rightly guided ancestors) said, When I would read a parable in the Qur'an that I could not comprehend, I would cry for myself because Allah the Exalted says, iBut none will understand them except those who have knowledge.} [29:43] Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Abdullah bin Abbas commented on Allah's statement, cJi X .Clil cSi iHe sends down water from the sky, and the valleys flow according to their measure,} This is a parable that Allah has set; the hearts carry knowledge from Him, and certainty according to the amount of doubt. As for doubt, working good deeds does not benefit while it exists. As for certainty, Allah benefits its people by it, hence Allah's statement, iThen, as for the foam}, which refers to doubt, 4 J.Q\ 4 u l % XjL 4J,Sj} it passes away as scum upon the banks, while that which is far the good of mankind remains in the earth.} in reference to certainty. And just as when jewelry is heated in fire and is rid of its impurity, which remains in the fire, similarly Allah accepts certainty and discards doubt. The Qur'an and the Sunnah contain Parables that use Water and Fire Allah has set two examples in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah (chapter 2) about the hypocrites, one using fire and another using water. Allah said, 4fe U isttf ES fit' sffJA rfjlf JS3 m At-Tabari 16:410.

liij dJ.L j"J Ij* f** *}i Uj 4)1 4)1 t ,! , , ^ jj jjii jIa ju_j The example of guidance and knowledge with which Allah has sent me is like abundant rain falling on the earth, some of which was fertile soil that absorbed the rain water and brought forth vegetation and grass in abundance. And another portion of it was hard, it held the rain water and Allah benefited the people with it and they utilized it for drinking, grazing, making their animals drink from it and for irrigation purposes. And another portion of it fell on barren land, which could neither hold the water nor bring forth vegetation. The first is the example of the person who comprehends Allah's religion and gets benefit, as well as benefiting others (from the knowledge and guidance) which Allah has revealed through me and learns and then teaches others. The last example is that of a person who does not care for it and does not embrace Allah's guidance revealed through me. i This parable uses water in it. In another Hadith that Imam Ahmad collected, Abu Hurayrah narrated that the Messenger of Allah said, J"- U o;Lii llii \j\ S I Jf'j jiu " Lfc? J& Jt ijllll ji- |*la ijllll je. _L>.I til JIS My example and the example of you is like that of a person who lit a fire. When the fire illuminated his surroundings, butterflies and insects started falling into it, as they usually do, and he started swatting at them to prevent them from falling; but they overwhelmed him and kept falling into the fire. This is the parable of me and you, I am holding you by the waist trying to save you from the Fire, saying, Go away from the Fire," yet you overwhelm me and fall into itM21Al-B ui 1 : 211 , Muslim 4:1788. 2| Ahmad 2:312.

The Two Sahih's also collected this Hadith J This is a parable using fire. -5- 4 U (43 CS' j> ijUlj ^ pJi 4 V* ylijl >- >-T*J jA-J Ajm 426. For those who answered their Lord's call is Al-Husna. But those who answered not His call, if they had all that is in the earth together with its like, they would offer it in order to save themselves. For them there will be the terrible reckoning. Their dwelling place will be Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.} Reward of the Blessed and Wretched Ones Allah mentions the final destination of the blessed ones and the wretched ones, ^rrJ. iFor those who answered their Lord's call} obeyed Allah and followed His Messenger (Muhammad, peace be upon him) by obeying

his commands and believing in the narrations she brought about the past and the future, theirs will be, iAl-Husnd}, which is the good reward. Allah said that Dhul-Qamayn declared, AV . 4 f\$ j d) jy m {j 4 u \jff\ j* j! Jjic j \$ 4As for him who does wrong, we shall punish him, and then he will be brought back unto his Lord, Who will punish him with a terrible torment (Hell). But as for him who believes and works righteousness, he shall have the best reward (Al-Husna), and we shall speak unto him mild words by your command}[18: 87-88] Allah said in another Ayah, &31 1 iFor those who have done good is the best (Al-Husnd) and even m Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :323 , Muslim 4 : 1790

more.} [10:26] Allah said next, iBut those who answered not His call,} disobeyed Allah, ixLJ: jf}.i\ 4 u iif they had all that is in the earth together} meaning, in the Hereafter. This Ayah says: Had the earth s fill of gold and its like with it, they would try to ransom themselves from Allah s torment at that time. However, this will not be accepted from them. Verily, Allah the Exalted will not accept any type of exchange from, -' iFor them there luill be the terrible reckoning.} in the Hereafter, when they will be reckoned for the Naqu and the Qitmir}2 ^ the big and the small. Verily, he who is reckoned in detail on that Day will receive punishment, hence Allah s statement next. iTheir dwelling place will be Hell; and worst indeed is that place for rest.} &A jL Jy' yLu il9. Shall he then wlv knows that what has been revealed unto you from your Lord is the truth, be like him who is blind? But it is only the men of understanding that pay heed.} The Believer and the Disbeliever are never Equal Allah says, They could never be equal; those among people who know that what, ihas been revealed unto you}, O Muhammad, The speck on the back of a date stone. The thin membrane over the date stone

VjtJ> (** iyy-iy U-j * fde J&l J* (*^ oj'--'*. p4 JL oj & JO ^ |OV 420. Those who fulfill, the covenant of Allah and break not the trust.} 421 . And those who join that which Allah has commanded to be joined and fear their Lord, and dread the terrible reckoning.} 422. And those who remain patient, seeking their Lord's Face, perform the Saldh, and spend out of that which We have bestowed on them, secretly and openly, and repel evil with good, for such there is a good end.} 423. Adn Gardens, which they shall enter and (also) those who acted righteously from among their fathers, and their wives, and their offspring. And angels sluill enter unto them from every gate (saying) :} 424. Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed is the final home! } Qualities of the Blessed Ones, which will lead to Paradise Allah states that those who have these good qualities, will earn the good, final home: victory and triumph in this life and the Hereafter, 4Those who fulfill the covenant of Allah and break not the trust.} They are nothing like the hypocrites who when one of them makes a covenant, he breaks it; if he disputes, he is most quarrelsome; if he speaks, he lies; and if he is entrusted, he betrays his trust. Allah said next, 4And those who join that which Allah has commanded to be joined} they are good to their relatives and do not sever the bond of

kinship. They are also kind to the poor and the needy and generous in nature, irtv iand fear their Lord}, in what they do or do not do of actions and statements. They remember that Allah is watching during all of this and are afraid of His terrifying reckoning in the Hereafter. Therefore, all their affairs are on the straight path and correct, whether they are active or idle, and in all of their affairs, including those that affect others, 4And those who remain patient, seeking their Lord's Face,} They observe patience while staying away from sins and evil deeds, doing so while dedicating themselves to the service of their Lord the Exalted and Most Honored and seeking His pleasure and generous reward, iand perform the Satah},

preserving its limits, times, bowing, prostration and humbleness, according to the established limits and rulings of the religion, and spend out of that which We have bestowed on them,} They spend on those whom they are obliged to spend on them, such as their spouses, relatives and the poor and needy in general, secretly and openly,} They spend during all conditions and times, whether during the night or the day, secretly and openly, and repel evil with good} they resist evil with good conduct. When the people harm them they face their harm with good patience, forbearing, forgiveness and pardon. Allah said in another Ayah, @1 hf jjjL j}

Jii Ji I4I4I; Cy il)W> ^ iRepel (the evil) with one which is better, then verily he, between whom and you there was enmity, (will become) as though he was a close friend. But none is granted it except those who are patient - and none is granted it except the owner of the great portion in this world.} [41:34-35] This is why Allah states here that those who have these good qualities, the blessed ones, will earn the final home, which He explained next, 4 Adn Gardens}, where, Adn, indicates continuous residence; they will reside in the gardens of everlasting life. Allah said next, 'iff and (also) those who acted righteously from among their fathers, and their wives, and their offspring.} Allah will gather them with their loved ones, from among their fathers, family members and offspring, those who are righteous and deserve to enter Paradise, so that their eyes are comforted by seeing them. He will also elevate the grade of those who are lower, to the grades of those who are higher, a favor from Him out of His kindness, without decreasing the grade of those who are higher up (in Paradise). Allah said in another Ayah, ('r rrij* | iAnd those who believe and whose offspring follow them in faith : to them shall We join their offspring.} (52:21] Allah said next, / s "> .- -V # < * > > \ ^ , ! Jxc- fjye Uj Qpyt J" yi pr~ Oji-A, 7 iAnd angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Salamun Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed is the final home!"} The angels will enter on them from every direction congratulating them for entering Paradise. The angels will

welcome them with the Islamic greeting and commend them for earning Allah's closeness and rewards, as well as, being admitted into the Dwelling of Peace, neighbors to the honorable Messengers, the Prophets and the truthful believers. Imam

Ar-Ra d (25) (Part-13 Jr zmm ^ ' ' \ + * > > + < + * * ' > > ' -TTTTf^ j1 tjrAJlbyiaAifij Aii " Oj C * -Ar * j y / }, **, * > * y/.X/'\<. tH -*i-f' *V J XX ? '**.* C'X * TV* "?" " oyi-jj 4jl(O 4\0 ^ ^ ." ;> " , ;^ v " i_jjUl^\jj*ji34U / ==yj iM4Ul__pj>_yi the unhappy (evil) home (i.e. Hell).) iSalamun Alaykum (peace be upon you) for you persevered in patience! Excellent indeed is the final home!) 1| t if + * ' " r.r\ Jm> (j* ' AfrP Oj^ai-i i/JyJT z4j i J*\ U ^jyAuJJ a1Z-4 ofjV' 4 oja~juj J-oj> o' . # iiaf jiijl 4 . And those who break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Allah has commanded to be joined, and work mischief in the land, on them is the curse, and for them is Characteristics of the Wretched Ones which will lead to the Curse and the Evil Home This is the destination of the Wretched ones and these are their characteristics. Allah mentioned their end in the Hereafter, to contrast the end that the believers earned, since their characteristics were to the opposite of the believer's qualities in this life. The latter used to keep Allah's covenant and join that which Allah has ordained on them to join. As for the former, they used to, / P < * > 1 > f 's\ X' ' > \l'" , < *" (f i-'ik 4 C-jUj O' All! ^a\ \a OJJUUJJ -AJC JUo if* A4P Ojr^T 2:168.

break the covenant of Allah, after its ratification, and sever that which Allah has commanded to be joined, and work mischief in the land,) An authentic Hadith states that, jU- 3' If-j \ij icfjs eJsi- ijj jiClJl ill "The signs of a hypocrite are three: Whenever he speaks, he tells a lie; whenever he promises, he always breaks it (his promise); if you entrust him, he proves to be dishonest."a In another narration, the Prophet jg said, lip jji- iali liJJD //he enters into a covenant, he betrays it; and if he disputes, he proves to be most quarrelsome.n12 This is why Allah said next. ion them is the curse,) they will be cast away from Allah s mercy, iM .#) iandfor them is the unhappy home.) the evil end and destination, iTheir dwelling place will be Hell; and luorst indeed is that placefor rest.) [13:18] i26. Allah increases the provision for whom He wills, and straitens (it for whom He wills), and they rejoice in the life of the world, whereas the life of this world compared to the Hereafter is but a briefpassing enjoyment.)Al-Bari 1:111. [a] Ibid.

Increase and Decrease in Provision is in Allah s Hand Allah states that He alone increases the provisions for whom He wills and decreases it for whom He wills, according to His wisdom and perfect justice. So, when the disbelievers rejoice with the life of the present world that was given to them, they do not know that they are being tested and tried. Allah said in other Ayat, . * ****' / -vr- >/ { > ^ / // t / > // < v V J m., JL* ixt >****? ^ t 4.Do they think that in wealth and children with ivhich We enlarge them. We hasten unto them with good things. Nay, but they perceive not.^[23:55-56] Allah belittled the life of the present world in comparison to what He has prepared for His believing servants in the Hereafter, {whereas the life of this xoord compared to the Hereafter is but a briefpassing enjoyment.} Allah said in other Ayat, iSay: "Short is the enjoyment of this world. The Hereafter is (far) better for him who has Taqwd, and you shall not be dealt with unjustly even equal to the amount of a Fatila.}^ [4:77] and. 'V TillIAVJ Jr iNay, you prefer the life of this world, although the Hereafter is better and more lasting.} [87:16-17] Imam

Ar-Ra d (27-29) (Part-13) iLet him then bring us an Ayah like the ones (Prophets) that were sent before (with signs)!} (21 :5) We mentioned this subject several times before and stated that Allah is able to bring them what they wanted. There is a Hadith which mentions that the idolators asked the Prophet to turn Mount As-Safa into gold and, they also asked him for a spring to gush forth for them and to remove the mountains from around Makkah and replace them with green fields and gardens. Allah revealed to His Messenger jg: If You wish, O Muhammad, I will give them what they asked for. However, if they disbelieve thereafter, I will punish them with a punishment that I did not punish any among the Alamtn (mankind and the Jinns). Or, if you wish, I will open for them the door to repentance and mercy. The Prophet jg said, zji\ ^c "Rather , open for them the door to repentance and mercy. This is why Allah said to His Messenger ;eg next, icM S3 iSay: Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides unto Himself those who turn to Him in repentance."} Allah states that He brings misguidance or guidance whether the Messenger jg was given a sign (a miracle) according to their asking or not. Verily, earning the misguidance or the guidance are not connected to the miracles or the lack of them. Allah said in other kyat. iBut neither Aydt nor wamers benefit those who believe not.} (10 :101] ly C** (*r*t jb Y o{ } iTrtdy, those, against whom the Word of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.}[10:96-97], There is a Hadith with similar wording recorded byAhmad 1 :?42.

and, 6\$ 'rfl Uj 0 %} ip&k Yj 'if 'XZ1 ol% 4And even ifWe had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and We had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they xould not have believed, unless Allah willed, but most ofthem behave ignorantly.} [6:111] Allah said here, o-* Ifcii ,> j-iu Jif iSay : "Verily, Allah sends astray whom He wills and guides unto Himself those who turn to Him in repentance."} meaning, He guides to Him those who repent, turn to Him, beg Him, seek His help and humbly submit to Him. The Believer sHeart findsComfort in theRemembrance ofAllah Allah said, Jx 4\$ P'-^} iThose who believed, and whose hearts find rest in the remembrance ofAllah.} for their hearts find comfort on the side of Allah, become tranquil when He is remembered and pleased to have Him as their Protector and Supporter. So Allah said, 4f\ if 4 Verily, in the remembrance ofAllah do hearts find rest.} and surely, He is worthy of it.

The Meaning of Tuba Allah said, iThose who believed, and xoork righteousness, Tuba is for them and a beautiful place of (final) return.} Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that Tuba

means, Happiness and comfort or refreshment of the eye. I 1 ' Ikrimah said that Tuba means, How excellent is what they earned, |21 while Ad-Dahhak said, A joy for them. 13 ' Furthermore, Ibrahim An-Nakhi said that Tuba means, Better for them, * while Qatadah said that it is an Arabic word that means, you have earned a good thing. In another narration, Qatadah said that 'Tuba, for them means, It is excellent for them, iatid a beautiful place of return and final destination. These meanings for Tuba are all synonymous and they do not contradict one another. Imam

Jr tor j> ry '* ' m . * s*' < ' j*-4> {^J * \$ve .jsj IP^WKj\$ (i&tikx&Kh i^ryuga st^ ts&&'8tfJi 02Wad4jj^i-l'-^ jla,>;,aj dil^VL^u*jJ-uljf 1^ ^ iit 0-3' An-Nu'mSn bin Abi Ayyash Az-Zuraqi added, Abu Said Al- Khudri narrated to me that the Prophet ^ said, jtri *-* t#* op sijjJi 441 u fu Su *There is a tree in Paradise, ifa rider travels in its shade on a fast, sleek horse for one hun- dred years, he would not be able to cross it.J In his Sahth, Imam

Ar-Ra'd (30) (Part-13) Paradise. Verily, the miscarriage of a womem will be swimming in one of the rivers of Paradise until the Day of Resurrection commences, when he will be gathered with people while forty years of age. Ibn Abi Hatim collected this statement. 4^*^* clk= 'J* 'A\ v 430. Tims have We sent you to a community before whom other communities have passed away, in order that you might recite unto them what We have revealed to you, while they disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah). Say: "He is my Lord! None has the right to be worshipped but He! In Him is my trust, and to Him I turn. } Our Prophet || was sent to recite and call to Allah s Revelation Allah says, Just as We sent you, O Muhammad, to your Ummah, !&3> 4..in order that you might recite unto them what We have revealed to you,} so that you deliver to them Allah s Message. Likewise, We sent others to earlier nations that disbelieved in Allah. The Messengers whom We sent before you, were also denied and rejected, so you have an example in what they faced. And since We sent Our torment and revenge on those people, then let these people fear what will strike them, for their denial of you is harsher than the denial that the previous Messengers faced, 4ty*& dl I3S j&} 4By Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you.}[16-63] Allah said in another Ayah, Ji? Vj J5"- ijJT U ijL/L*a i &j} ot &> 5Sf Cb#, 4Verily, many Messengers were denied before you, with

280 Tafsir Ibn Kathir patience they bore the denial and suffering until; till Our help reached them, and none can alter the Words (decree) of Allah. Surely, there has reached you the information (news) about the Messengers (before you). [6-34], meaning, How We gave them victory and granted the best end for them and their followers in this life and the Hereafter. Allah said next, while they disbelieve in the Most Gracious (Allah). Allah says, These people, that We sent you to, disbelieve in the Most Gracious and deny Him, because they dislike describing Allah by Ar-Rahman Ar-Rahim [the Most Gracious, Most Merciful]. This is why on the day of Al-Hudaybiyyah, as

Ar-Ra d (31) (Part-13) deity worthy of worship except Him, in Him is my trust,} in all of my affairs, 4^ and to Him I turn.} meaning: to Him I return and repent, for He alone is worthy of all this and none else besides Him. 4JJ df ii ii JU' Ojy* jl \j-& Oyi' 'ij ii' ILiJ jj J j !" - *_ii& V ii' rti' qlj ^bj'j i!\ ^n 431 . And if there had been a Qur'an with which mountains could be moved (from their places), or the earth could be cloven asunder, or the dead could be made to speak (it would not have been other than this Qur'an) . But the decision of all things is certainly with Allah. Have not then those who believed yet known that had Allah untied, He could have guided all mankind? And a disaster will not cease to strike those who disbelieved because of their (evil) deeds or it (i.e. the disaster) settles close to their homes, until the promise of Allah comes to pass. Certainly, Allah breaks not His promise.} Virtues of the Qur'an and the Denial of Disbelievers Allah praises the Qur'an which He has revealed to Muhammad, peace be upon him, and prefers it to all other divinely revealed Books before it, ^ CjjZ. iWj l>\ Jij} 4And if there had been a Qur'an with which mountains could be moved,} Allah says, If there were a Book among the previous Divine Books with which the mountains could be moved from their places, or the earth could be cleaved asunder, or the dead speak in their graves, it would have been this Qur'an and none else. Or, this Qur'an is more worthy to cause all this, because of its marvelous eloquence that defies the ability of

Ar-Ra d (31) (Part-13) Messenger of Allah jg said, i'J-j 2b,f ^jji Stf uIv, i^iii Jz. 'j*\ u j\ jjj vi "ua5i iLi; M 5ii h? Ji & "Every Prophet was given (a miracle) the type of which would make (some) people believe. What I was given, however, is a revelation from Allah to me, and I hope that I will have the most following among them (Prophets) on the Day of Resurrection .n 1 This Hadith indicates that every Prophet's miracle disappeared upon his death, but this Qur'an will remain as evidence for all times. Verily, the miracle of the Qur'an will never end, nor will it become old the more it is read, nor will scholars ever have enough of it. The Qur'an is serious and is not meant for jest; any tyrant that abandons it, Allah will destroy him; he who seeks guidance in other than the Qur'an, then Allah will misguide him. Allah said next, iBut the decision of all things is certainly with Allah.} Ibn Abbas commented, He will only do what He wills and He decided that He will not do that. ' Ibn Ishaq reported a chain for this, and Ibn Jarir At-Tabari agreed with it. Allah said next, Jt J & (*trW 3 ZtJ' J'ji iAnd a disaster will not cease to strike those who disbelieved because of their (evil) deeds or it settles close to their homes,} because of their denial, disasters will still strike them in this life or strike those all around them, as a lesson and example for them. Allah said in other Ayat, {j" C 152EJ iAnd indeed We have destroyed towns round about you, and We have shown (them) the Ayat in various ways that theyAl-Bari 8:619. ' At-Tabari 16:447

284 Tafsir Ibn Kathir might return (to the truth). 46-27], and, iSee they not that We gradually reduce the land (in their control) from its outlying borders? Is it then they who will overcome?\$ [21:44] Qatadah

narrated that Al-Hasan commented on Allah's statement, "Qari'ah" for it settles close to their homes, It is in reference to the disaster. 11 This is the apparent meaning here. Al-Awfi reported that bin Abbas said about, "Qari'ah" (disaster) strikes them because of their (evil) deeds. A torment that descends on them from heaven, "Qari'ah" for it settles close to their homes, when the Messenger of Allah ﷺ camps near their area and fights them. Similar was reported from Mujahid and Qatadah. Ikrimah said in another narration he reported from Ibn Abbas that, "Qari'ah" means affliction. These scholars also said that, "Qari'ah" until the promise of Allah comes to pass. "Qari'ah" refers to the conquering of Makkah. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said that it refers to the Day of Resurrection. Allah said next, "Qari'ah" -if m At-Jabari 16:459.

Certainly, Allah breaks not His promise.} to His Messengers to aid them and their followers in this life and the Hereafter, "O Messenger, Allah will not fail to keep His promise to His Messengers. Certainly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution" [14:47]. "y y" " < < " y * # ^ ^ y "y V dA ==> ^ Cri -i^JT 432. And indeed (many) Messengers were mocked at before you but I granted respite to those who disbelieved, and finally I punished them. Then how (terrible) was My punishment!} Comforting the Messenger of Allah ﷺ Allah says to His Messenger, while comforting him in facing his people's denial of him, "And indeed (many) Messengers were mocked at before you}, so you have a good example in them. "but I granted respite to those who disbelieved,} deferred their judgment for a term appointed, "and finally I punished them."} > with encompassing punishment. How did you obtain the news of how I gave them respite and then took them with punishment? Allah said in another Ayah, "And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing. Then (in the end) I seized it (with punishment). And to Me is the (final) return (of all)." [22:48] It is recorded in the Two Sahih's that the Prophet ﷺ said, "Lit rJiku ai!"

<* Verily, Allah gives respite to the unjust until when He seizes him, He never lets go of him. The Messenger ﷺ next recited this Ayah, "Such is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Verily, His punishment is painful, (and) severe." [11:102] "m J^r1 ' jji j* Jyi' Si fiZ u % a si . is //ten He (Allah) Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned (like any other deity who knows nothing)? Yet, they ascribe partners to Allah. Say: Name them! Is it that you will inform Him of something He knows not in the earth or is it (just) a show of false words." Nay! To those who disbelieved, their plotting is made fair-seeming, and they have been hindered from the right path; and whom Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide. There is no Similarity between Allah and False Deities in any Respect Allah said, "Then He (Allah) Who takes charge of every person and knows all that he has earned?" Allah is the guard and watcher over every living soul and knows what everyone does, whether good or evil, and nothing ever escapes His perfect observation. Allah said in other Ayat. "H, Jti^ 'i =* m ,311s . v: x l . ' > .1 iNeither you do any deed nor recite any portion of the Qur'an, Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997.

nor you do any deed, but we are witness thereof, when you are doing it." [10:61] and Allah said, "And no moving creature is there on earth but its provision is due from Allah. And He knows its dwelling place and its deposits. All is in a Clear Book." [11:6], "iyj oj lA o* *Ay*fr frit is the same (to Him) whether any of you conceals his speech or declares it openly, whether he be hid by night or goes forth freely by day." [13:10] "4 jA frHe knows the secret and that which is yet more hidden." [20:7] and, "And He is with

you wherever you may be. And Allah is the All-Seer of what you do. [57:4] Is He Who is like this similar to the idols, that the polytheists worship, which can neither hear nor see nor do they have a mind nor able to bring good to themselves or to their worshippers nor prevent harm from themselves or their worshippers? The answer to the question in the Ayah was omitted, because it is implied, for Allah said next, "Yet, they ascribe partners to Allah, which they worshipped besides Him, such as idols, rivals and false deities, Say 'Name them!'"

And We have assigned for them (devils) intimate companions, who have made fair-seeming to them. Allah said next, if and they have been hindered from the right path; Some read with Fatha over the Sad (i.e. wa Saddu), which would mean, and they hindered from the right path, feeling fond of the misguidance they are in, thinking that it is correct, they called to it and thus hindered the people from following the path of the Messengers. Others read it with Damma over the Sad (i.e. wa Suddu), which would mean, and they have been hindered from the right path, explained it this way: because they thought that their way looked fair or correct, they were hindered by it from the right path, so Allah said, "and whom Allah sends astray, for him there is no guide." Allah said in similar instances, "And whomsoever Allah wants to suffer a trial, you can do nothing for him against Allah." [5:41], and, "if you covet for their guidance, then verily, Allah guides not those whom He makes to go astray. And they will have no helpers." [16:37] & "Sv'j oj hip Cj \jffS idjJ td)t j p} 4& 35 M sj l)Lif Ji iXit [p\ 134. For them is a torment in the life of this world, and certainly, harder is the torment of the Hereafter. And they have no defender (or protector) against Allah." 135. The description of the Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised: Underneath it rivers flow, its provision is eternal and so is its shade; this is the end (final

290 Tafslr Ibtt Kathir destination) of those who have Taqwa, and the end (final destination) of the disbelievers is Fire Punishment of the Disbelievers and Reward of the Pious Believers Here, Allah mentions the punishment of the disbelievers and the reward of the righteous believers, after describing the Kufr and Shirk that the disbelievers indulge in, "For them is a torment in the life of this world, by the hands of the believers, killing and capturing them, and certainly, the torment of the Hereafter, which will come after they suffer humiliation in this life, is harder many times harder. The Messenger of Allah said to those who agreed to Muld'anah" OjaI CjJI Ass. jU "Surely, the torment of this life, is easier than the torment of the Hereafter" V2 ' Indeed, and just as the Messenger of Allah stated, the torment of this life ends but the torment of the Hereafter is everlasting in a Fire that is seventy times hotter than our fire, where there are chains whose thickness and hardness are unimaginable. Allah said in other Ayat, "None will punish as He will punish. And none will bind as He will bind." [89:25-26], and, "The curse invoked when it is believed that the spouse has committed adultery and there are no witnesses. See the Tafsir of Surat An-Nur 24:11-13.

1 & S& & ii ULS & Z i -0 \$MX ix A%&& 3 i'iM MS & i jS? itX-MS\$X p?k XM i And for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire. When it (Hell) sees them from a far place, they will hear its raging and its roaring. And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction. Exclaim not today for one destruction, but exclaim for many destructions. Say: "Is that (torment) better, or the Paradise of Eternity promised for those who have

Taqwa?" It will be theirs as a reward and as a final destination>[25:11-15] Similarly He said; iThe description of the Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised^ meaning its description and qualities; iJ&Vf ^Underneath it riversflow> these rivers flow in the various parts and grades of Paradise and wherever its people wish they flow and gush forth for them. Allah also said, MS /X J& \$ JfjMMX fe M\$ 0) 4 (MS vIM otQ, MM ctifh\$ fk -f iThe description of Paradise which those who have Taqwa have been promised (is that) in it are rivers of water the taste and smell ofwhich are not changed, rivers ofwine delicious to those who drink, and rivers of clarified honey, therein for them is every kind offruit, andforgiveness.> [47:15] Allah said next, iits provision is eternal and so is its shade

call of nature, but Paradise is pure [from feces and urine]? The Prophet sg said, ,/tA 1 * ~ 'I if o Ixij j 1 One o/ them (residents of Paradise) relieves the call of nature through a sweat that emanates from the skin, with the scent of musk, and the stomach becomes empty again. Imam Ahmad and An-Nasal collected this HadithJ Allah said in other Ayat, 4i&f iAnd fruit in plenty, whose supply is not cut off nor are they out of reach.>[56:32-33], and, iAnd the shade thereof is close upon them, and the bunches of fruit thereofwill hang low urithin their reach.}[76:14] The shade of Paradise is everlasting and never shrinks, just as Allah said, Q% Ug-S y* utffr swjfeega v.A iBut those who believe and do deeds of righteousness, We shall admit them to Gardens under which rivers flow, abiding therein forever. Therein they shall have pure mates, and We shall admit them to shades wide and ever deepening. \$[4:57] Allah often mentions the description of Paradise and the description of the Fire together, to make Paradise appealing and warn against the Fire. This is why, after Allah mentioned

the description of Paradise here. He next said,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2833–2846]

ithis is the end (final destination) of those who have Taqwa, and the end (final destination) of the disbelievers is Fire.} Allah said in another Ayah , Ahmad 4:367 , An-Nasal in Al-Kubrd 1178.

^ j 1 2_4j ^Say; Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe."} [17:107], until, CJ 2? iTruly, the promise ofour Lord must be fulfilled.} [17:109] meaning, Allah s promise to us in our Books to send Muhammad jg is true. It is certain and will surely come to pass and be fulfilled, so all praise to our Lord, how truthful is His promise, all the thanks are due to Him, i&fr 4And they fall down on their faces weeping and it increases their humility.} [17: 109] Allah said next, %-A J* 'off} ibut there are among the Ahzdb (Confederates) those who reject a part thereof.} meaning, There are those among the sects who disbelieve in some of what was revealed to you (O Muhammad). Mujahid said that, ibut there are among the Ahzdb (Confederates)}, refers to Jews and Christians, ithose who reject a part thereof}, meaning, They reject a part of the truth that came down to you - O Muhammad. Similar was reported from Qatadah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam. Allah said in similarAyat, tyiii oJ he iAnd there are, certainly, among the People of the Scripture, At-Tabari 16:474. Meaning Allah has not done those things mentioned in Ayahno 3 1

Sarah 13. Ar-Ra'd (38-39) (Part-13) 297 tJj e&m xot ,W 6* ^ u!\Js , ,4^i \3jUupjfc eiy* -.-'jlgdJ liiWij jGJi^.^iSsJW-*'"-" - *> 4f/ien you will not have any Wall (protector) or defender against Allah.} This part of the Ayah warns people of know- ledge against following the paths of misguid- ance after they

had gained knowledge in (and abided by) the Prophetic Sunnah and the path of Muhammad, may Allah's best peace and blessings be on him. 43 " 4Z &\$ ^S> tf lij 2 # p 4mT 4 ij jl t Z \$*,<& fi p rCuftj 4rLJ "WS. C <&! 4 >- ""*-=="') 438. And indeed We sent Messengers before you, and made for them wives and offspring. And it was not for a Messenger to bring a sign except by Allah's leave. (For) every matter there is a decree (from Allah).} 439. Allah blots out what He wills and confirms (what He wills). And with Him is the Mother of the Book.} All Prophets and Messengers were Humans Allah says, Just as We have sent you O Muhammad, a Prophet and a human, We sent the Messengers before you from among mankind, that eat food, walk in the markets, and We gave them wives and offspring. Allah said to the most honorable and Final Messenger,

Meaning of Allah blotting out what He wills and confirming what He wills of the Book Allah said, C& i Z} iAllah blots out what He wills} of the divinely revealed Books, iand confirms}, until the Qur'an, revealed from Allah to His Messenger peace be upon him, abrogated them all. Mujahid commented; lit \U^} iAllah blots out what He wills and confirms (what He wills).} Except life and death, misery and happiness [i.e., faith and disbelief], for they do not change. MansUr said that asked Mujahid, Some of us say in their supplication, O Allah! If my name is with those who are happy (believers), affirm my name among them, and if my name is among the miserable ones (disbelievers), remove it from among them and place it among the happy ones. Mujahid said. This supplication is good. I met him a year or more later and repeated the same question to him and he recited these Ayat, iWe sent it (this Qur'an) down on a blessed night.} Mujahid commented next, During Laylatul-Qadr (Night of the Decrees), Allah decides what provisions and disasters will occur in the next year of. He then brings forward or back (or blots out) whatever He wills. As for the Book containing the records of the happy (believers) and the miserable (disbelievers), it does not change. 12 Al-A'mash narrated that Abu Wall, Shaqiq bin Salamah said that he used to recite this supplication often, O Allah, if You wrote us among the wretched ones, remove this status from us and write us among the blessed ones. If You wrote us among the blessed ones, please let us stay that way, for surely, You blot out and At-Tabari 16:479. Tabari 16:480.

wills. And Allah is able to do all things.> [2:284] id L T ji^c. Liji jl Juo alley U vat^% ,L j^ -5 i I^L- ^Vi\$ ci t 440. Whether We show you part of what We have promised them or cause you to die, your duty is only to convey (the Message) and on Us is the reckoning.} 441 . See they not that We gradually reduce the land from its outlying borders. And Allah judges, there is none to put back His judgement, and He is swift at reckoning.} Punishment is by Allah, and the Messenger's job is only to convey the Message Allah said to His Messenger j , 4^%/ 4Whether We show you O Muhammad, part of the disgrace and humiliation We have promised your enemies in this life, 4MZ 4or cause you to die} before that, 4ki" 0,6} 4your duty is only to convey} We have only sent you to convey to them Allah's Message, and by doing so, you will have fulfilled the mission that was ordained on you, i&j} 4and on Us is the reckoning}, their reckoning and recompense is on Us. Allah said in similar Ayat, im* Oj Jr l v'iJi 4So remind them - you are only one who reminds . You are not a dictator over them - Save the one who turns away and Al-Qurtubi 9 :33 1

disbelievers. Then Allah will punish him with the greatest punishment. Verily, to Us will be their return. Then verily, for Us will be their reckoning.}[88:21-26] Allah said next. iSee they not that We gradually reduce the land from its outlying borders. Ibn Abbas commented, See they not that We are granting land

after land to Muhammad (^J? Al-Hasan and Ad-Dahhak commented that this Ayah refers to Muslims gaining the upper hand over idolaters,121 just as Allah said in another Ayah, j3> c gffl iAnd indeed We have destroyed towns round about you.} [46:27] fa. j&3f fafaj^y c iu ifaf. yfai ^ Zj} 442. And verily, those before them did devise plots, but all planning is Allah's. He knows what every person earns, and the disbelievers will know who gets the good end (final destination).} The Disbelievers plot, but the Believers gain the Good End Allah says, 4And verily, those before them did devise plots,} against their Messengers, they wanted to expel them from their land, but Allah devised plots against the disbelievers and gave the good end to those who fear Him. Allah said in other Ayat,)&& \& 'S4 HJ} At-Tabari 16:493. (2) Al-Tabari 16:494.

4And (remember) when the disbelievers plotted against you tc imprison you, or to kill you, or to get you out; they wen plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the Best of those who plot.} [8:30], and, ilil* ==> V ffi l4= 4So they plotted a plot, and We planned a plan, while they perceived not. Then see how was the end of their plot! Verily, We destroyed them and their nation, all together.^[27:50,51] Allah said next, 4He knows what every person earns,} meaning, He alone knows all secrets and concealed thoughts and will reckon each person according to his work, OP fe') and the Kafir (disbeliever) will know ijP} or the Kuffar (disbelievers) according to another way] reciting, &&& of iwho gets the good end.} who will earn the ultimate and final victory, they or the followers of the Messengers. Indeed, the followers of the Messengers will earn the good end in this life and the Hereafter, all thanks and praise is due to Allah. Xfr Cr J cjri0 P=> J* 'K-~Vr '- *-1 \iP 1' 443. And those who disbelieved, say: "You are not a Messenger." Say: "Sufficient as a witness between me and you is Allah and those too who have knowledge of the Scripture. }

X , 4And My mercy embraces all things. That (mercy) I shall ordain for those ivho have Taqwd, and give Zakah; and those who believe in Our Ayat; Those who follow the Messenger, the Prophet who can neither read nor write whom theyfind written with thetn in the Tawrdh and the Injil [7:156-157] and, *ip j* \$&m ilt is not a sign to them that the learned scholars of the Children of Israel knew it (as true)? \$[26:\97) There are similar Ayat that affirm that the scholars of the Children of Israel know this fact from their divinely revealid Books. This is the end of Surat Ar-Ra d, and all praise is due to Allah and all favors are from Him.

306 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr The TafslrofSurah Ibrahim (Chapter -14) Whichwas revealed inMakkah P * In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. Jl " JM -krf j-+?j ujU # 4;^' Jfp' ofjV' 4 llj oy 1J') U j; SrOJ /' /. *A / jp qii /" >*" 1 ^ *' f <>// il. Alif-Ldm-Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light by their Lord's leave to the path of the Almighty, the Praised.} 42. Allah to Whom belongs all that is in the heavens and all that is in the earth! And woe unto the disbelieversfrom a severe torment.} ijAj^ Yj

Module 17

Surah 14: Ibrahim, Surah 15: Al-Hijr

Surah 14: Ibrahim

PDF pages 2847–2918

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2847–2918]

Opening 43. Those who prefer the life of this world to the Hereafter, and hinder (men) from the path of Allah and seek crookedness therein - they are far astray.} Describing the Qur'an and warning Those Who defy it Previously we discussed the meaning of the separate letters that appear in the beginnings of some Surahs. 4 (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you. Allah says, This is a Book that We have revealed to you, Muhammad. This Book, is the Glorious Qur'an, the most honored Book, that Allah sent down from heaven to the most honored Messenger of Allah sent to all the people of the earth, Arabs and non-Arabs alike, in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light} We sent you, O Muhammad, with this Book in order that you might lead mankind away from misguidance and crookedness to guidance and the right way, Jit S{ \ \$x 4\$ tij jl Jit ot fvsrjTH 4Allah is the Wall (Protector or Guardian) of those who believe. He brings them out from darkness into light. But as for those who disbelieve, their Awliya (supporters and helpers) are Taghut (false deities), they bring them out from light into darkness.} [2:257], and, 4-S' St tfj' f*} it is He Who sends down manifest Ayat to His servant that He may bring you out from darkness into light.} [57:9] Allah said next, by their Lord's leave}. He guides those whom He destined to be guided by the hand of His Messenger jg, whom He

on account of those who defy or betray it. When the disbelievers do this, they become engulfed in ignorance and misguidance far away from truth, and therefore, there is no hope that they will gain guidance and correctness while on this state. jij i4. And We sent not a Messenger except with the language of his people, in order that he might make (the Message) clear for them. Then Allah misleads whom He wills and guides whom He wills. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise Every Prophet was sent with the Language of His People; Guidance or Misguidance follows the Explanation Allah is Kind and Compassionate with His creation, sending Messengers to them from among them and speaking then- language, so that they are able to understand the Message that the Messengers were sent with. Allah said next, 4* iy *tlj j* ' iThen Allah misleads whom He wills and guides whom He wills. after the proof and evidence have been established for the people, Allah misguides whom He wills from the path of guidance and guides whom He wills to the truth, 4And He is the All-Mighty,} whatever He wills occurs and whatever He does not will never occurs, 4the All-Wise. in His decisions, misleading those who deserve to be misled and guiding those who deserve guidance. This is from Allah's wisdom with His creation, every Prophet He sent to a people spoke their language and everyone of these Prophets were only sent to their people. Muhammad bin Abdullah, Allah's Messenger, peace and blessings be upon him, was sent to all people. It is recorded in the Two SahOis that Jabir said that the Messenger of Allah said,

ij .bt ji ^ iBring out your people from darkness into light,} call them to all that is good and righteous, in order that they might turn away from the darkness of ignorance and misguidance they indulged in, to the light of guidance and the enlightenment of faith, iand remind them of the annals (or days) of Allah} remind them (O MQsa) of Allah's days, meaning, favors and bounties which He bestowed on them when He delivered them from the grip of Fir'awn and his injustice, tyranny and brutality. This is when Allah delivered them from their enemy, made a passage for them through the sea, shaded them with clouds, sent down manna and quails for them, and other favors and bounties. Mujahid, Qatadah and several others said thisJV Allah said next, iTruly, therein are Ayatfor every patient, thankful (person).} Allah says, Our delivering ofOur loyal supporters among thie Children of Israel from the grasp of Fir'awn and saving therh from the disgraceful torment, provides a lesson to draw from for those who are patient in the face of affliction, and thankful in times of prosperity. Qatadah said, Excellent is the servant who if he is tested, he observes patience, and if he is granted prosperity, he is thankful for it. It is recorded in the Sahih that the Messenger of Allah jg said, out 43 b's V ii 'j \ -" t\ j^out Iv, "Verily, all of the matter of the believer is amazing, for every decision that Allah decrees for him is good for him. If an affliction strikes him, he is patient and this is good for him; if a bounty is give to him, he is thankfid and this is At-Tabari 16:521. AMabari 16:523.

312 Tafsir Ibtî Kathir ^ mm ^ ,> -i" *. t *>- :? 'Ci ^ > c.c *. jvJbsSille- 4tt\Aa_m> ^=="jl^J_yjp" _y* ** JP> S0Z-jfSpj\$%[<& J ^ jl1^==^* > 0+tfJh0X%&c&&&Z good for him. \lr*~g"J A-ijjI i" _y* J'i ij_>^ jl pfesUlc *i' A".JU /"> . \$< > > " / " ' I.' j** >-u>>^"-* * ^ j> . ' ./T^ - / p-==U> Jj f="*W U^r^vwIJ ifjJJ* , 04 > ^>=6 o0 f|3j^ ip i < 0*^=* ? Mj\$ 0^ &y liy^ioCJ i^Jjc tlf jtf & 4.0 f - l " . ,i sf{.,*,-*-^ *n' 46. And (remember) when Musa said to his people: "Call to mind Allah's favor to you, when He delivered you \from Fir'awn's people who were afflicting you with horrible torment, and were slaughtering your sons and letting your women live; and in it was a tremendous trialfrom your Lord."} 47. And (remember) when your Lord proclaimed: "If you give tlwnks, I will give you more; but if you are thankless, verily. My punishment is indeed severe."} 48. And Musa said: "If you disbelieve, you and all on earth togetlw, then verily, Allah is Rich (free of all needs), Worthy of all praise."} Allah states that Musa reminded his people about Allah s annals and days and of Allah s favors and bounties that He bestowed on them, when He saved them from Fir awn and his 111 MusUm 4:2295.

people and the torment and disgrace they used to exert on them. They used to slaughter whomever they could find among their sons and let their females live. Allah delivered them from all this torment, and this is a great bounty, indeed. This is why Allah described this affliction, It iatid in it was a tremendous trialfrom your Lord.) Tor He granted you (O Children of Israel) a great favor Ifor which you are unable to perfectly thank Him. Some scholars said that this part of the Ayah means, what Fir awn used to do to you was a tremendous 4trial.) Both meanings might be considered here and Allah knows best. Allah said in another Ayah , iAnd We tried them with good and evil in order that they might him (to Allah).) (7:168) Allah s statement next, 4And (remember) when your Lord proclaimed) means, proclaimed and made known His promise to you. It is possible that this Ayah means, your Lord has vowed and sworn by His might, grace and exaltness. Allah said in a similar Ayah, 4i^ij)' | OwJ illy iAnd (remember) when your Lord declared that He would certainly keep on sending against them (i.e. the Jews), till the Day of Resurrection .) (7:167) Allah said,)Ifyou give tlmnks, I will give you more;) meaning, if you appreciate My favor on you, I will give more of it, vAj)

"O My servants. If the first and the last among you, mankind and Jinns among you, had the heart of the most pious and righteous man among you, that will not increase my kingdom in the least. O My servants! If the first and the last among you, mankind and the Jinns among you, had the heart of the most wicked man among you, that will not decrease My kingdom in the least. O My servants! If the first and the last among you, the mankind and Jinns among you, stood in one fiat area and each asked me (what they wish), and I gave each one of them what they asked, that will not decrease My kingdom except by that which the needle carries (of water) when inserted in the ocean ." Verily, all praise and gloiy are due to Allah, the Rich [free of need], the Worthy of all praise. * U \$5 px iR" | kijfX .ij 49. Has not the news reached you, of those before you, the people ofNQh, "Ad, and Thamud? And those after them? None knows them but Allah. To them came their Messengers with clear proofs, but they put their hands in their mouths and said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent, and we are really in grave doubt as to that to which you invite us."4 Earlier Nations disbelieved in Their Prophets Allah narrated to this Ummah (followers of Muhammad the stories of the people of Prophet Nuh, Ad and ThamQd, and other ancient nations that belied their Messengers. Only Allah knows the count of these nations, 4To them came their Messengers with clear proofs, they brought them evidences and plain, tremendous proofs and signs. Ibn Ishaq reported that Amr bin Maymun said that 4:1994.

'Abdullah said about Allah s statement, i'M\$\$ 'j) iNone knows them but Allah.) The genealogists utter lies. * This is why Urwah bin Az- Zubayr said, We did not find anyone who knows the forefathers of Ma'dd bin Adman. 12 Meaning of, **Theyput TheirHands in TheirMouths? Allah said next, tj ibut they put their hands in their mouths) It is said that they pointed to the Messengers mouths asking them to stop calling them to Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. It is also said that it means, they placed their hands on their mouths in denial of the Messengers. It was also said that it means that they did not answer the call of. the Messengers, or they were biting their hands in rage. Mujahid, Muhammad bin Ka*b and Qatadah said that they belied the Messengers and refuted their call with their mouths.13* I (Ibn Kathlr) say that Mujahid s Tafsir is supported by the completion of the narrative. 4 tr# \go iand said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent, and we are really in grave doubt as to that to which you invite us.") Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, When they heard Allah s Word, they were amazed and placed their hands on their mouths, 14 u jl,}%& ti iand said: "Verily, we disbelieve in that with which you have been sent.")Tabari 16:528. * TafsirAl-Qurtubi9 :344 131 AMabari 16:534. |4* At-Tabari 16:533.

to v ^.>.v\\ "w \$^j4i: \$yu^o- \$i 4&^ i=4f 3iici^;^i They said, We do not believe what you brought us, and have strong doubt in i}ts authenticity. -if 41 ;# -ite \$ &K 4&& & 0* j- { f * -si5} ii 9c3^ i< > .1 '* l \it"U^- ujJUa> o OJJj> L - i#U \$&: iii' ^ a ^ #i *JZ. % 61. O' d* <" |"^=4 u ^ ij; . "i^e o- '.ill S 6%ic^i (Xsts ll -111 Je "jl LJ ly 405^ -if J5 te>; t 6; t^Gui J& 410. TTieir Messengers said: "(What!) Can there be a doubt about Allah, the Creator of the heavens and the earth? He calls you that He may forgive you of your sins and give you respite far a term appointed." They said: "You are no more than human beings like us! You wish to turn us awayfrom what our fathers used to worship. Then bring us a clear authority."} 411. Their Messengers said to them: "We are no more than human beings like you, but Allah bestows His grace to whom He wills of His servants. It is not ours to bring you an authority (proof) except by the permission of Allah. And in AllSh (alone) let the believers put their trust."} 422. "And why should we not put our trust in Allah while He

Ibrahim (10-12) (Part-13) Disbelievers reject Prophethood because the Messengers were Humans! Their nations said, 4&%%z 4You are no more than human beings like us!} so why should we follow you just because you say so, even! though we did not witness a miracle by your hands, &JL} 4Then brittg us a clear authority . 4 , a miracle of our choice. 4 'tl oj iTheir Messengers said to than "We are no more than human beings like you ..."4 affirming that truly, they were only human being like their nations, 4but Allah bestows His grace to whom He wills of His servants.4, with prophethood and messengership which is His choice, J u vLK vf} is not ours to bring you an authority} according to your choice, 4except by the permission of Allah.}, after we beg Him and He provides us with a miracle, 4L i\ \$ &&} 4And in Allah (alone) let the believers put their trust.} in all their affairs. Their Messengers said to them next, 43SS U V,} 4And why should we not put our trust in Allah}, after He had guided us to the best, most clear and plain way, Xi ii/yUlj} 4And we shall certainly bear with patience all the hurt you may cause

Ibrahim (13-17) (Part-13) The people of Prophet Lut, peace be upon him, said, 4 02 J' iDrive out thefamily ofLutfrom your city.} [27:56] Allah said about the idolators of Quraysh, " 'Ail- -CjSjr-k y bjj {jL JjJrfij Jfjii Lrt IAK==* j!_j^ iAnd verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to I drive you out from the land. But in that case they would not have stayed after you, exceptfor a little while.} [17:76] and, -4*- <*' fiiJ OjJSwj A \$ A^ju jl JjLjj i^iST crA\ A, 'fAA Aff} i!\$. iAnd when the disbelievers plotted against you to imprison you, or to kill you, or to expel you out; they were plotting and Allah too was plotting; and Allah is the Best of those who plot.} [8:30] Allah gave victory and aid to His Messenger jg after he emigrated from Makkah and gathered followers, supporters, and soldiers around him, who fought in the cause of Allah, the Exalted. Allah kept granting His Messenger jg more dominance until He opened for him Makkah, which sought to expel him. Allah gave him dominance over it, even when his enemies from Makkah and the rest of the people of the earth disliked it. Soon after, people began embracing the religion of Allah in large crowds and in a very short time Allah s Word and religion became high over all other religions, from the eastern and! western parts of the world. Hence Allah s statement, iSo their Lord revealed to them : "Truly, We shall destroy the wrongdoers. And indeed. We shall make you dwell in the land after them."} [14:13,14] Allah said in other Aydt, GjT iAnd, verily. Our Word has gone forth of old for Our

WgJ fli* Oli. C/4 I iThen for him who transgressed all bounds, and preferred the life of this world, verily, his abode will be Hellfire. But as for him whofeared standing before his Lord, and restrained himself from impure evil desires and lusts. Verily, Paradise will be his abode.}]79:37-41] and, SC iButfor him who fears the standing before his Lord, there will be two Gardens.^[55:46] Allah said next, iAnd they sought victory and help} refers to the Messengers who sought the help and victory of their Lord over their nations, according to Abdullah bin Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah.m Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said that this Ayah refers to the nations, invoking Allah s victory against themselves! Some idolaters said, Allah ! If this (Qur'an) is indeed the truth (revealed) from You, then rain down stones on us from the sky or bring on us a painful torment.} [8:32] It is possible that both meanings are desired here, for the idolaters (of Quraysh) invoked Allah against themselves on the day of Badr, and the Messenger of Allah invoked Him foj- victory and support Allah said to the idolaters then, 4(0 disbelievers) if you ask for a judgment, now has the judgment come unto you; and if you cease (to do wrong), it At-Tabari 16:544-545. At-Tabari 16:545.

O* J-f iis is so/ Then let than taste it - Hamim and Ghassaq. And other (torments) of similar kind all together! } {38:57-58\ Mujahid and Ikrimah said that this festering water is made of puss and blood. 11 ' Allah said in other Ayat, 4And be given to drink boiling water so that it cuts up their bowels.} (47:15) and, & }y& IAsSM iAnd if they ask for help, they will be granted water like boiling oil, that will scald their faces.} [18:29] Allah's statement, iHe will sip it unwillingly}, indicates that he will hate to drink this water, but he will be forced to sip it; he will refuse until the angel strikes him with an iron bar, idw " fob iAndfor them are hooked rods of iron.}[22:21] Allah said next, Ms-i %b iand he will find great difficulty in swallowing it down his throat,} meaning, he will hate to swallow it because of its awful taste, color and unbearable heat or coldness, i^S oj J2(JCj} iand death will come to himfrom every side,} his organs, limbs and entire body will suffer pain because of this drink. Amr bin Maymun bin Mahran commented, Every Al-Tabari 16:548.

326 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr bone, nerve and blood vessel. Ad-Dahhak reported that Ibn Abbas commented on Allah s statement, It iand death will come to himfrom every side,} All types of torment that Allah will punish him with on the Day of Resurrection in the fire of Jahannam will come to him carrying death, if he were to die. However, he will not die because Allah the Exalted said, JU* Vj ifiOj y} iNeither will it affect them that they die nor shall its torment be lightenedfor them^ISSiSe]. 121 Therefore, according to Ibn Abbas, may Allah be pleased with him and his father, every type of punishment will come to him (the obstinate, rebellious tyrant) carrying death with it, if he will ever die there. Yet, he will not die, he will instead receive eternal punishment and torment. Hence Allah s statement here, iand death will come to him from every side, yet he will not die,} Allah said, iand in front ofhim, will be a great torment.} even in this condition, he will still suffer another severe type of torment, more severe and painful from the one before it, harsher more bitter. Allah described the tree ofZaqqum, oJ0 |*rlf m-j '\$ U (v+Py* f Oj f |p4 1? We# Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5:16. ' Ad-DurrAl-Manthur5 :16

Ibrahim (13-17) (Part-13) iVerily, it is a tree that springs out of the bottom of Hellfire, the shoots of its fruits stalks are like the heads of Shayatin; Truly, they will eat thereofand fill their bellies therewith. Then on top of that they will be given boiling water to drink so that it becomes a mixture. Then thereafter, verily, their return is to theflaming fire ofHell.}[37:64-68] Allah states that they will either be eating from the Zaqquxn, drinking the Hamim, or being tormented in the Fire, again and again; we seek refuge with Allah from all of this. Allah also said, iThis is the Hell which the criminals denied. They will go between it (Hell) and thefierce boiling wafer/^(55:43-44], iVerily, the tree ofZaqqum will be thefood of the sinners. Like boiling oil, it will boil in the bellies, like the boiling of scalding water. (It will be said) Seize him and drag him into the midst of blazing Fire, then pour over his head the torment of boiling water. Taste you (this)! Verily, you were the mighty, the generous! Verily, this is that whereof you used to do"f/ >[44:43-50]. 4And those on the Left Hand - how (unfortunate) will be those on the Left Hand? In fierce hot wind and boiling water, and shadow of black smoke, neither cool nor pleasant.^[56:41-44], and. <*ii *jO-* jLfii jSj jl!" ^ iThis is so! And for the Taghiin will be an evil final return. Hell! Where they will bum, and worst is that place to rest!

This is so! Then let them taste it Hamim and Ghassaq. And other (torments) of similar kind all fogef/ier/ ^[38:55-58] There are many other similar Ayat that indicate that the punishment they will receive is of different kinds, and that it is repeated in various types and forms that only Allah the Exalted knows, as

just recompense, iAnd your Lord is not at all unjust to (His) slaves. [41:46] Sdjaj V fy. 4 ii ' 1 ^} 438. 77ie parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works are as ashes, on which the wind blows furiously on a stormy day; they shall not be able to get aught of what they have earned. That is the straying, far away (from the right path).} A Parable for the Deeds of the Disbelievers This is a parable that Allah has given for the deeds and actions of the disbelievers who worshipped others besides Him and rejected His Messengers, thus building their acts on groundless basis. Their actions vanished from them when they were most in need of their rewards. Allah said, ^ & iThe parable of those who disbelieved in their Lord is that their works} on the Day of Judgment, when they will seek their rewards from Allah the Exalted. They used to think that they had something, but they will find nothing, except what remains of ashes when a strong wind blows on it, fy ^} ion a stormy day;} They will not earn rewards for any of the good works they performed during this life, except what they can preserve of ashes during a day of strong wind. Allah said in other Ayat,

^ ' 'T irt ^ dll 4And We shall him to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.\$[25:23], e/j- cjd\ y* l\i gy jil =* liJ!? ^ o C &&\$ 'tub 111 iThe parable of what they spend in this world is that of a wind which is extremely cold; it struck the harvest of a people who did wrong against themselves and destroyed it. Allah wronged them not, but they wronged themselves . \$[3:1 17],and, % h% &4 tfiVb &Z, * ! fc UM Ck 3tj tS gz h -j*. V% \ => lii fr6 40 you who believe! Do not render in vain your Sadaqah I (charity) by reminders of your generosity or by injury, like him who spends his wealth to be seen of men, and he does not believe in Allah, nor in the Last Day. His parable is tuit of a 'N smooth rock on which is a little dust; on it falls heavy rain which leaves it bare. They are not able to do anything with what they have earned. And Allah does not guide the disbelieving people.\$[2:264] I Allah said in this Ayah, iLS&&> djy>\$ iThat is the straying, far away from tthe right path\$ meaning, their work and deeds were not based on firm, correct grounds, and thus, they lost their rewards when they needed them the most, 4L\$ jiilt iThat is the straying, far away from the right path.\$ ^ "& vIj j&iA& oi 4-S & dJ j 419. Do you not see that Allah has created the heavens and the

earth with truth? If He wills, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation!} i20. And for Allah that is not hard or difficult. Proof that Resurrection occurs after Death Allah affirms His ability to resurrect the bodies on the Day of Resurrection, stating that He has created the heavens and earth which are stronger than the creation of man. Is not He Who is able to create the heavens, high, wide and strongly built, which include in them the planets and stars and the various heavenly objects and clear signs. Is not He Who created this earth with all what it contains of land, valleys, mountains, deserts, green fields, barren lands, seas and various shapes, benefits, species and colors of trees, plants and animals? Sf-- & if- of*^ dk pj cfjyt "a1 ii fijty 4Do they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and was not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead? Yes, He surely, is able to do all things. 46:33], G oi i3 if j iafi Ski (A) jG Tij" tJC jit ^ J42* \$k J ^ jE. 4 J# #4 && J o. ;j4 Tii tii 4Does not man see that We have created him from Nutfah (drop of sperm). Yet behold he (stands forth) as an open opponent. And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust? Say: "He will give life to them Who created them for the first time! And He is the All- Knower of every creation!" He Who produces for you fire out of the green tree, when behold you kindle therewith. Is not He

Ibrahim (19-20) (Part-13 Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be!" - and it is! So glorified is He and exalted above all that they associate with Him, and in Whose Hands is the dominion of all things: and to Him you shall be returned.}[36:77-83] Allah's statement, if He wills, He can remove you and bring (in your place) a new creation! And for Allah that is not hard or difficult.} means, it is not hard or impossible for Allah to do that. Rather, it is easy for Him, that if you defy His order, He takes you away and brings in your place another creation who is unlike you. Allah said in other Ayat, e.g., 'JjJ-r Cf 40 mankind! It is you who stand in need of Allah. But Allah is Rich, Worthy of all praise. If He willed, He could destroy you and bring about a new creation. And that is not hard for Allah.}[35:15-17], "J3 l -3 2 4 And if you turn away, He will exchange you for some other people and they will not be your likes.} [47:38] rr 4j-* -Oti 0* &J. if [A 1* \$ } 40 you who believe! Whoever from among you turns back from his religion, Allah will bring a people whom He will love and they will love Him.^[5:54] and, if He wills, He can take you away, O people, and bring others. And Allah is Ever All-Potent over that.}[4:133]

Y"A imm V, y} \ ^ sm. \jc. JihUj^ otJ'^ibj! ^UZ;^kzz JA Oo-^citQc^b^i -it \$jaift ^ oAsI4AJ.I ijlfic^ll JUi jjl !>^y ii4=. q i2 L;(<\$1, :'-r > ri : " s" Cj t Ojr'+** j~*' tM-* v*J 3 jjJfe \$ iK jA ~y>'j .5: pi'A %\ &Z U U ^Jy*> p ij3 1- j Crt 422. And f/iey all shall appear before Allah; then the weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Verily, we were following you; can you avail us anything against Allah's torment?" They will say: "Had Allah guided us, we would have guided you. It makes no difference to us (now) whether we rage, or bear (these ' torments) with patience; there is no place of refuge for us."} Disbelieving Chiefs and Their Followers will dispute in the Fire Allah said, iAnd they shall appear} meaning, all the creatures, the wicked and the righteous among them, will appear before Allah the One, the Irresistible. They will be gathered on a flat plain that does not have anything those present could use for cover, then the weak will say} the followers who used to obey their chiefs, leaders and notables will say,

4!Z&J 4to those who were arrogant^ who rebelled against worshipping Allah alone without partners and obeying the Messengers, p &=, [} 4 Verily, we were following you,}, we obeyed your orders and implemented them, / t X J* // * 'x X* > > { x'^ \ * s J+"r you avail us anything against Allah's torment?} They will ask, can you prevent any of Allah's torment from striking us as you used to promise and vow to us? The leaders will say in response, 4p= j& \$} 4Had Allah guided us, we would have guided you.} \ but the statement of our Lord shall come to pass concerning us, and the destiny that He has appointed for us and you shall come true; the word of punishment shall befall the disbelievers, U lx 41t makes no difference to us (now) whether we rage, or bear (these torments) with patience; there is no place of refuge for us.} I we have no means of escape from what we are in, whether we face it with patience or grief. I (Ibn Kathir) say that it appears that this conversation will occur in the Fire after they enter it, just as Allah said in other Ayat, JJij# j SpZ.10 jlli dA Llwu & 4M^^And, when they will dispute in the Fire, the weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Verily, we followed you, can you then take from us some portion of the Fire?" Those who were arrogant will say: "We are all (together) in this (Fire)! Verily,

Ibrahim (22-23) (Part-13) /wue been believers! And those who were arrogant will say to those who were deemed weak: "Did we keep you back from guidance after it had come to you? Nay, but you were wrongdoers Those who were deemed weak will say to those who were arrogant: "Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day : when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him! And We shall put iron collars round the necks of those who disbelieved. Are they requited aught except what they used to do?^[34:31-33] S? 'J, U fa) B J 'Vj fX-" ^ , ,if <. >-"4 r> > T'S r, V > jwlliaJ' Jr* Uj 0^-=a ^ *! Uj Ifi j* dJ/ (t4* 'ri 422 . And Shaytan will say when the matter has been decided "Verily, Allah promised you a promise of truth. And I too promised you, but I betrayed you. I had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. So blame me i not, but blame yourselves. I cannot help you, nor can you help me. I deny your former act in associating me (Shaytan) as a partner with Allah (by obeying me in the life of the world). Verily, there is a painful tormentfor the wrongdoers I 423. And those who believed and did righteous deeds, will be made to enter Cardens under which rivers flow, - to dwell therein for ever (i.e. in Paradise), with the permission of their Lord. Their greeting therein will be: "Salam (peace!). Shaytan disowns His Followers on the Day of) Resurrection Allah narrates to us what Iblis will say to his followers after i Allah finishes with the judgement between His servants, sending the believers to the gardens of Paradise and the disbelievers to the lows (of the Fire). Iblis, may Allah curse him, will stand and address the latter, in order to add depression to their depression, sorrow to their sorrow and grief to their grief. He will declare,

4jflL jij iul ^jf} iVerily, Allah promised you a promise of truth.} by the words of His Messengers that if you follow them, you will gain safety and deliverance. Truly, Allah s promise was true and correct news, while I promised you then betrayed you.' Allah said in another Ayah, iHe (Shaytan) makes promises to than, and arouses in them false desires; and Shaytan's promises are nothing but deceptions.} (4:120) Jt 3 of C,} 41 had no authority over you} Shaytan will say, T had no proof for what I called you to, nor evidence for what I promised you, iexcept that I called you, and you responded to me.} even though the Messengers establish the proof and unequivocal evidences against you and affirmed the truth of what they were sent to you with. But you disobeyed the Messengers and ended up earning this fate, iSo blame me not,} today, ibut blame yourselves.}, because it is your fault for defying the proofs and following me in the falsehood that I called you to. Shaytan will say next, cannot help you}, I cannot benefit, save, or deliver you from what you are suffering, %} 4nor can you help me.}, nor can you save me and deliver me

from the torment and punishment I am suffering, 41 deny yourformer act of associating me (Shaytan) as a partner with Allah. or because you associated me with Allah before, according to Qatadah. * Ibn Jarir commented; I deny being a partner with Allah, the Exalted and Most Honored. This opinion is the most plausible, for Allah said in other Ayat, jt 'fkj jy J] vi v OJJ CK 4 ^ fL \j J-!3 _j~>- 4And who is more astray than one who calls on others besides Allah, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, l and who are (even) unaware of their calls to them? And when mankind are gathered, they will become their enemies and will deny their worshipping.^[46:5-6] and, 4Nay, but they (the so-called gods) will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.}[19:82] Allah said next, ol> 4Verily, the wrongdoers who deviate from truth and follow falsehood, will earn a painful torment. It appears that this part of the Ayah narrates the speech that Shaytan will deliver to the people of the Fire after they enter it, as we stated. Amir Ash- Sha*bi said, On the Day of Resurrection, two speakers will

address the people. Allah the Exalted will say to Isa, son of Maryam, 4^)-3 jjGJJ tS.it 4Did you say unto men : "Worship me and my mother as two gods besides Allah? } [5:116] until,Tabari 16:564. At-Tabari 16:561.

g & 'if ti} 4Allah will say: "This is a Day on which the truthful will profitfrom their truth."}[5:1 19] Shaytan, may Allah curse him, will stand and address the people, 41 had no authority over you except that I called you, and you responded to me. ll] Allah next mentioned the final destination of the miserable ones, who earned the disgrace and torment and having to listen to Shaytdn address them, then He mentioned the final destination of the happy ones, iZfrf &*^ tjUj \p: pfo 4And those who believed and did righteous deeds, will be made to enter Gardens under which riversflow,} wherever they wish them to flow and wherever they may be, 4to dwell therein for ever,} and will never transfer or be transferred from it, 4with the permission of their Lord. Their greeting therein will be: Salam (peace!)."} AMh said in other Aydt, 4 =& tij ; \ij%. iii p} 4Till, when they reach it, and its gates will be opened and its keepers will say: "Salamun Alaykum (peace be upon you!)" (39:73] 4&p yCf j: Sjl '&\$\$,} 4And angels shall enter unto them from every gate (saying): "Salamun 'Alaykum (peace be upon you!)."} [13:23-24] At-Tabari 16:562,

{Therein they shall be met with greetings and the word ofpeace and respect.} [25:75] k pL ^ pg; jtff {Their way of request therein will be Subhanaka Allahumma (glory to you, O Allah) and Salam (peace!) will be their greetings therein (Paradise)! And the close of their request will be: Al-Hamdu Lilldhi Rabbil-'Alamin [all praise to Allah the Lord of that ejrisfsJ.>[10:10], ujLUJ JIMfi ii' uiL JT 1 1 1^ -i1 ay . \" . "lh -*? / f {24. See you not how Allah sets forth a parable? A goodly word as a goodly tree, whose root is firmly fixed, and its branches (reach) to the sky.} {25. Giving its fruit at all times, by the leave of its Lord, and Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember.} {26. And the parable of an evil word is that of an evil tree uprootedfrom the surface ofearth, having no stability.} The Parable oftheWord ofIslam and theWord ofKufr Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Abdullah bin Abbas commented that Allah s statement, {tA'i^te} {a parable: a goodly word}, refers to testifying to La ildha illaUah, (none has the right to be worshipped but Allah) while, {i4&} {as a goodly tree}, refers to the believer, and that,

iwhose root is firmly fixed>, indicates that La ilaha illalldh, (none has the right to be worshipped but Allah) is firm in the believers heart, i&zit iand its branches (reach) to the sky.\$ with which the believer s works are ascended to heaven. Similar is said by Ad-Dahhak, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Mujahid and several others. 121 They stated that this parable describes the believer s deeds, good statements and good actions. The believer is just like the beneficial date tree, always having good actions ascending at all times, by day and by night.

Ibrahim (24-26) (Part-13 Abdullah bin Abbas said that, 4"s a goodly tree}, is a tree in Paradise. * Allah said next, 0} 4Giving its fruit at all times,^ It is said that it means by day and by night. And they say that describes the believer as a tree that always has fruits during summer and winter, by night and by day. This is the parable of the believer whose good works ascend to heaven by day and by night and at all times, iby the leave of its Lord,} thus earning perfection and becoming beneficial, plentiful, pure and blessed, u-L-U. &J^j} iand Allah sets forth parables for mankind in order that they may remember.} Allah said next. a&& 4And the parable ofan evil word is that ofan evil tree} describing the disbelief of

the disbeliever, for it has no basis or stability. It is similar to the colocynth tree (a very bitter, unscented plant) which is also called, Ash-Shiryan '. Shu*bah narrated that Mu'awiyah bin Abi Qurrah narrated that Anas bin Malik said that it is the colocynth tree. Allah said, iuprooted}, meaning, was cutoff from the root, o;***- ifrom the surface ofearth, having no stability.} therefore, existing without basis or stability, just like Kufr (disbelief), for it does not have a basis or roots. Surely, the At-Tabari 16:573. * At-Tabari 16:569.

342 Tafstr Ibn Kathir works of the disbelievers will never ascend nor will any of them be accepted. J-sKJ Lr- nOJ " ' > - 427. Allah ivill keepfirm those who believe, with the word that standsfirm in this world, and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the wrongdoers to go astray, and Allah does what He wills.} Allah keeps the Believers Firm in This Life and in the Hereafter with aWord that stands Firm

refuge with Allahfrom the punishment of the grave. He said next, && 4\ s^ j* Jdij di)i j* j b\ s lit jiii b\ l)Us\ ja yS ("4" |"4*yrj& "HUL J xj*~ * ^ "4 ' Lf ^ !" ">" J <&' Si J\ i^T^ ^r^J' :J> " i--b jIp " Ui>-f Ijji i LaJL>-ti i.UDIJ fjA ifaii\ J..-7 Ui ij__ ^"Ji 7- JI" - ^ Jj ^ ui ui* ?i ui j4* * * <* _ ' j i jS/ 1 O-j Jp oi ".*!.*-; Mi i_D>(t\ il" _^DI ?Bji ,*" 5ii u ill'll vi i&fclij St; J* ji: * i ix>~ J **j* ""I)>^ ^jjJl }Sllll {fr^i iji :j_) Ujjji! jUi js 13 3 din .udi J| * i_4=L: Ij^" :^I .111)1 JI i* JI iys JI ,UDi JI r*f 443 4* JI* J! 44 J ts# 4 l4 1) 4^* "j(3 (.AllJ O-Jj jlii : JI" l^S^sT-f ojli l Ji* :J ?ilLa U : *} jV i&l J5 :J ?i J jtfJ3 tji)l J i J_- -sj i^ill ll* i 7 _jj i i^VI^l ill* iOJLpj 4j d"U jll 1-liS ot'j" l'j5'.M*la Lij ; Jj j'iyd d l_) "lj .^ i)1 jj4 o_j-iyti ^Jl-p jxl of 7.111)1 ^ ifr Jt r4"3 4>-jj Iri 7- JU - dlJl JJ CU ^JJ Ij j^S Jyt~* i Ji I i J" c^IJI jI>- tj>-^Jl J^j ^ -y J 7 ij Jyii &y v lS ^jjJl Iji t4plDI |^l " ipID I ^f !J i^llJl DUpl lil ! (Jj) ^Jj Ju3^ J4- lATien a believing slave is reaching the end of his term in the life of this world and the beginning ofhis term in the Hereafter, a group of angels, whose faces are white and as radiant as the sun, will descend onto him from heaven. They will carry with them white shroud from Paradise, and fragrance for

enshroudingfrom Paradise. Titey will sit as farfrom him as the sight goes. Then, the angel of death, will come until he sits right next to his head, saying, "O, good and pure soul! Depart (your body) to Allah's forgiveness and pleasure." So the soul flows (out of its body), just as the dropflows outfrom the tip of the jug, and the angel of death captures it. When he captures the soul, they (the group of angels) will not leave it with him for more than an instance, and they will seize it and wrap it in that shroud, and in that fragrance. A most pleasant musk scent ever found on the earth, will flow out of the soul, and the angels will ascend it (to heaven). They will not pass by, but they will say, "Whose is this Tayyib (good) soul?" They (the angels who are ascending the soul) ivill reply, "Such person, the son of such and such person," - calling him by the best names that he used to be called in the world. They will reach the lower heaven and will ask that its door be opened for him, and it will be opened for them. The best residents of every heaven will then see him to the next heaven, until he is brought to the seventh heaven. Allah, the Exalted and Ever High, will say, "List my servants record in TIUyyin and send him back to earth, for I have created them from it, and into it I shall return than, and from it I shall bring than out once again." The soul will be joined with its body, and two angels will come to him, sit him up and ask him, "Who is your Lord?" He will say, "Allah is my Lord." They will ask him, "What is your religion?" He will say, "My religion is Islam." They will say to him, "What do you say about this man (Prophet Muhammad) who was sent to you?" He will say, "He is the Messenger of Allah." They will ask him, "And what proof do you have about it? He will say, "I read the Book ofAllah (the Qur'an), and

had faith and belief in him." Then, a caller (Allah) will herald from heaven, My servant has said the truth. Therefore, furnish him from Paradise, and let him wear from (the clothes of) Paradise, and open a door for him to Paradise." So he is given from Paradise's tranquillity and good scent, and his grave will be expanded for him as far as his sight can reach. Then, a man, with a handsome face and handsome See Surat Al-Mutafifin 83 :18-21

Ibrahim (27) (Part-13) clothes and whose scent is pleasant, will come to him, saying, Receive the glad tidings with that which pleases you. This is the Day which you were promised." He will ask him, "Who are you; for yours is the face that carries the good news?" He will reply, "I am your good works." He will say, O Lord! Hurry up with the commencement of the Hour, hurry up with the commencement of the Hour, so I can return to my family and my wealth. 4\ ji jtpP J otf ill j&i vil jp : Jli i jS -4 ipLo b^pjl s olUL3 l J"iw pj bit iJl P-oJl Lpl : J_p" pUp opJi JiU -_ipi!! ja 3yiLi\ US Ifj-fLj oJuU- iJS ' ~ Jli - -oi-j 4)1 ja sill;^ UjJUXJ iip ?4d^ UP P UJU-i lili Ui>-Ui iJjAlUl iLjj jj.uio.l U-j Op-j ip- ij plS Ip :jffd ^j J P U : ipii Nj iS5*Jip)u Ju p pp; j! P ir*- P p ^-Lj jLS "JUS.i jpl uJ'iSi ji j"& 4*J*t jP 4ll bJ_pj p p ^Ai ~ ' " b Ujjl .UDl j p=s ipsi :iii jfd ii p 4 jiif g &. sj&i si; .pi i2ks 4A. i_p PP ly p - U-p k(piJi p;Vi p jUw. P ilia 4^- yfc J * d^S jt jJC ji .13? P S/ olo oL& !dpi ?"SLj ! jS/pjj (1 jLSLL. ojtp i oj >- i^Jl Jpp IJU U : jNpii 1 S? "U "U : Jpli U : iJ jSIpi tSff piS jt r.UUJ! p illa ^jjCi iSpt S? "U Sli :Jp" ' 1 U ^ja o-j(j tjllj P) LL .j0l "j"ijiU lJ^ lv_4Ul3l *_ " l4>-_pl ^_3 Jj>-J ojui <_4 op *lip j !Jpj t -Uy Ow ji" ^j lli b ^JlJ ! Jpj b^j^Jl S/ ! bJ_p3 bc^ojl L I ! J_p3 ^pJL 4^o"o jpp>-y b bZ-jl "UIUI And u)/ien the disbelieving person is reaching the end of his term in the world and the beginning of his term in the

Hereafter, there will descend onto him from heaven angels with dark faces. They will bring with them Musiih, m and will sit as far from him as the sight reaches. Then the angel of death will come forward and sit right next to his head, saying, "O impure, evil soul! Depart (your body) to the anger of Allah and a wrath from Him." The soul will scatter throughout his body, and the angel of death will seize it as when the thorny branch is removed from wet wool. The angel of death will seize the soul, and when he does, they (the group of angels) will not let it stay in his hand for more than an instance, and they will wrap it in the Musiih. The most putrid smell a dead corpse can ever have on earth will emit from the soul, and the angels will ascend with it. Whenever they pass by a group of angels, they will ask, "Whose is this evil soul?" The angels will respond, "He is such person son of such person," - calling him by the worst names he was known by in the world. When they reach the lowest heaven, they will request that its door be opened for him, and their request will be denied. "For them the gates of heaven will not be opened, and they will not enter Paradise until the camel goes through the eye of the needle." [7:40] Allah will declare, "List his record in Sijjin in the lowest earth." The wicked soul will then be thrown [from heaven]. "And whoever assigns partners to Allah, it is as if he had fallen from the sky, and the birds had snatched him, or the wind had thrown him to a far off place." [22 :31] His soul will be returned to his body, and two angels will come to him, sit him up and ask him, "Who is your Lord?" He will say, "Oh, oh! I do not know." They will ask him, "What is your religion?", and he will say, "Oh, oh! I do not know." They will ask him, "What do you say about this man (Prophet Muhammad) who was sent to you?" He will say, "Oh, oh, I do not know!" A caller (Allah) will herald from heaven, "My servant has lied, so furnish him with the Fire and open a door for him to the Fire." He will find its heat and fierce hot wind. And his grave will be reduced in size, until his bones crush each other. Then, a man

with a dreadful face, wearing dreadful clothes and with a disgusting l 1 ' The Musuh: a piece of thick, hard cloth made from animal hides. See Surat Al-Mutafifui 83:8.

Ibrahim (27) (Part-13) smell emitting from him will come to him, saying, Receive the glad tidings with that which will displease you! This is the Day that you have been promised. He will ask that man, And who are you, for yours is the face that brings about evil?" He will say, I am your evil work." He will therefore cry, "O, my Lord! Do not commence the Hour!"

next, uir " "So he will see both seats. Qatadah added, We were told that his grave will be enlarged up to seventy forearms length and will be filled with -greenery for him until the Day of Judgement. 121

i l XP * oL-UU USI>- i_ t fVw*^ x1p3 ic 11p3 4

the Prophet jg said, j^i xp ofij* ** JJ1^ a ^p j ^P SlSjilj 4-" JLP a^Luijl L* jl ^^ JI OLJ-X0 ^'3 ^ ^'3^' U -"j ^p U Jya 4"~.l., Jj ,j 34 l* jp J C-it* jJ 1 4J Jilili iji-JU U ! ol^Jl ! JjA-fi Lgjp l) ! aJ jLLi -li : Jyd tiuLli lU jJ-ti .Jilii Ji:j : j Jlij 4JLif ? +1; iuu; iaj j^i iuu j^Li Sis ^Jji cJi^l :ju5 otujlj U"L>" *jfj 4 4J)l lJfi~J Ajf -Ax-i i iJjJSl j*J4a IJ JLi : JjJLJ jl dJu 1c_* JjJi c i i-Ui _^Lp : "J Jilili 1 aljJa.^t 4 jIp 4? OjJi yu 4J iaj 4j u--"j pi *L" cw jjJj jj 4 iLi? =* * in jpI u ji 3 4} Jlij Jj U -CJJ' iUuj 4 4l^ ^/T1-! ji-* >- ..till .- . ' I ,y V/ 3 ' JiTabari 16:596.

350 Tafstr Ibtt Kathir "By He Who owns my life! The dead person hears the sound of your slippers (or shoes) when you depart and leave him. If he is a believer, the prayer will stand by his head, Zakah to his right and the fast by his left; the righteous deeds, such as charity, keeping relations with kith and kin and acts of kindness to people will stand by his feet. He will be approached from his head, and the prayer will declare, No entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his right, and Zakah will declare, There is no entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his left, and the fast will declare, 'There is no entrance from my side.' He will be approached from his feet, and the acts of righteousness will declare, There is no entrance from our side.' He will be commanded to sit up, and he will sit up while the sun appears to him just like when it is about to set. He will be told, Tell us about what we are going to ask you.' He will say, 'Leave me until I pray.' He will be told, 'You will pray, but first tell us what we want to know.' He will ask, What are your questions?' He will be told, 'This man who was sent among you, what do you say about him and what is your testimony about him?' He will ask, 'Muhammad?' He will be answered in the positive and he will reply, 7 bear witness that he is the Messenger of Allah and that he has brought us the proofs from our Lord. We believed in him.' He will be told, 'This is the way you lived and died and Allah willing, you will be resurrected on it.' His grave will be made wider for him seventy forearms length, and it will be filled with light. A door will also be opened for him to Paradise. He will be told, 'Look at what Allah has prepared for you in it.' He will increase in joy and delight and then his soul will be placed with the pure souls, inside green birds eating from the trees of Paradise. The body will be returned to its origin, dust. So Allah said. ilP?5f Gill 4 JjiTij ip: iif > iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world, and in the Hereafter. fr"111 Ibn Hibban collected this Hadith, and his narration added the At-Tabari 16:596.

'^ ^==== ^ t*ujij ' i3ji vp-i Jjifl i i & \$ *j"(jc-^yLjaj Ijljljl jl^ iaJl ^ ,v.s .s 1 ,i4-ii 'll *-t- ' " i'.X>' ". JUIiSjLJJj 0^ > i& J^(> ^ pPjUL^W "-i disbeliever s answer and his torment. 11 Abdur-Razzaq recorded that Tawus said, jjai ip: \& ig" 4Qli> yai j c-i3f iAllah will keep firm those who believe, with the

word that stands firm in this world,} is in reference to La ilaha ilallah, while, iand in the Hereafter} is in reference to the questioning in the grave. 2| Qatadah commented, As for this life, Allah will make them firm on the way of righteousness and good deeds, iand in the Hereafter.} in the grave. 3 Several others among the Salaf said the same. 4 'fP tif,fP jb pj> ip> {p P c-jj ip pi JI y fii \$ oji i^Lj jj pfi if 'jLj J IjUll ijlii-j t^pj'ipi pLj itppi Jj ppj i28. Have you not seen those who have changed the blessings of Allah into disbelief (by denying Prophet Muhammad jg and m Ibn Hibban 5:45. Abdur-Razzaq 2 :342 At-Tabari 16:602. At-Jabari 16:602.

his Message of Islam), and caused their people to dwell in the house of destruction?} 429. Hell, in which they will hum, - and what an evil place to settle in!} 430. And they set up rivals to Allah, to mislead (men) from His path! Say: "Enjoy (your brief life)! But certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire!"} The Recompense of Those Who have changed the Blessings of Allah into Disbelief

Ibrahim (28-30) (Part-13) and Ali said that it refers to the disbelievers of Quraysh on

the day of Badr.' He also said that the blessing of Allah was faith that came to the polytheists of Quraysh, and they changed this blessing into disbelief and led their people to utter destruction.'21 This includes all disbelievers, for Allah sent Muhammad | as a mercy and a blessing to all mankind. Those who accepted this blessing and were thankful for it, will enter Paradise, while those who denied it and disbelieved in it, will enter the Fire. Allah said next, & iJ-4 \J & iAnd they set up rivals to Allah, to mislead from His path!} meaning, they set up partners to Allah whom they worship besides Him and called the people to worship them. Allah threatened them and warned them by the words of His Prophet sg, 4 fo 4\$ay: "Enjoy (your brief life)! But certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire! } Whatever you are able to do in this life, then do it, for no matter what will happen, iM jj iBut certainly, your destination is the (Hell) Fire!} for to Us will be your destination and end. Allah said in other Ayat, OjTJUi S V iWe let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We shall force them to (enter) a great torment.>[31:24] and, llj Jt J? (i. V. >> ./ (HIV' t3ilf 4 i(A brief) enjoyment in this world! And then unto Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest At-Tabari 17:6. IbnAbiHatim 12273.

Ibrahim (32-34) (Part-13) will be fairness and justice. Qatadah said, Allah knows that in this life, there is mutual bargaining and there are friendships which people benefit from. A man chooses his friends and the reasons behind befriending them; if it was for Allah's sake, their friendship should be maintained, but if it was for other than Allah, their friendship is bound to be cutoff. |2 ' I say that the meaning of this, is that Allah the Exalted is declaring that on that Day, no mutual bargaining or ransom will avail anyone, even if he ransoms himself with the earth's fill of gold if he could find that amount! No friendship or intercession shall avail one if he meets Allah while a disbeliever. Allah the Exalted said, jU Xj * jin Sr*. uj* ^ &Jt | 4And fear the Day when no person shall avail another, nor shall compensation be accepted from him, nor shall intercession be of use to him, nor shall they be helped. \$[2:123] and, % %L% zb J ss a- i \f4 \p: sM 40 you believe! Spend of that with which We have provided for you, before a Day comes when there will be no bargaining, nor friendship, nor intercession. And it is the disbelievers who are the wrongdoers.^[2:254] % c l)f . A ^ 'SPj pffoi P4 oJj C o; 4 j^CJj ojrb JH11\ -P4^bp* v\$3P tla 432 . Allah is He Who has created the heavens and the earth and sends down water (rain) from the sky, and thereby brought forth fruits as provision for you ; and He has made

the ships to be of service to you, that they may sail through the sea by His Tabari 17:12. * At-Tabari 17:12.

command; and He has made rivers (also) to be of service to you.} 433. And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses, to be of service to you; and He has made the night and the day to be of service to you 434. And He gave you of all that you asked for, and if you [try to] count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them. Verily, man is indeed an extreme wrongdoer, ungrateful.} Describing Some of Allah's Tremendous Favors Allah mentions some of the favors He has done for His creatures, such as creating the heavens as a protective ceiling and the earth as a bed. He also sends down rain from the sky and, in its aftermath brings forth a variety of vegetation, fruits and plants of different colors, shapes, tastes, scents and uses. Allah also made the ships sail on the surface of the water by His command and He made the sea able to carry these ships in order that travelers can transfer from one area to another to transport goods. Allah also created the rivers that flow through the earth from one area to another as provision for the servants which they use to drink and irrigate, and for other benefits, jiiitp 4 And He has made the sun and the moon, both constantly pursuing their courses}, rotating by night and by day. 7^ 'i) J u ujj; y} it is not for the sun to overtake the moon, nor does the night outstrip the day. They all float, each in an orbit.^[36:40] and, jiSi 3 \$ 4* pit; i'j&Zy L'> fit 4 He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars subjected to His command. His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} [7:54]

The sun and the moon rotate in succession, and the night and the day are opposites, each taking from the length of the other or giving up some of its length, a 3-4 4 (Allah) merges the night into day, and merges the day into night . {35:13] and, 4A"d He has subjected the sun and the moon. Each running (on a fixed course) for an appointed term. Verily, He is the Almighty, the Oft-Forgiving.} (39:5] Allah said next, i And He-gave you of all that you asked for}, He has prepared for you all that you need in all conditions, and what you ask Him to provide for you. i and if you [try to] count the blessings of Allah, never will you be able to count them.} Allah states that the servants are never able to count His blessings, let alone thank Him duly for them. In Sahdi Al- Bukhari it is recorded that the Messenger of Allah jg used to supplicate; 'ij % 'JZ.> iUJl ill jtflu "O Allah ! All praise is due to You, without being able to sufficiently thank You, nor ever wish to be cutoff from You, nor ever feeling rich from relying on You; our Lord/o' 1 1 It was reported that Prophet Dawud, peace be upon him, used to say in his supplication, O Lord! How can I ever duly thank You, when my thanking You is also a favor from You to me? Allah the Exalted answered him, Now, you have thanked Me sufficiently, O Dawud, meaning, Svhen you Al-Bdri9 :493 .

J TVmm ia&S&CUS^i^ig)fCiVt^oj ^ ^J*^aC'i> tiUL.Xfr \$ 4^(a1>^| *^ (g&a3) jU ^ admitted that you will never be able to duly thank Me. <&* vj frf^L J Hj^ igy cfr-*rb lij)" jJJ' UL itj\ v*J - J t^*S i>^ OS&* i>* it tL^ "i*/ . 1 Z*' *// ***" >*i? L^UaC- *>"J |t riTi * . *_ " You are indeed Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 435. And (remember) when Ibrahim said: "O my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) one of peace and security, and keep me and my sons away from worshipping idols.} 436. O my lord! They have indeed led astray many among mankind. But whoso follows me, he verily, is of me. And whoso disobeys me, still Ibrahim's Supplication to Allah when He brought Isma H to Makkah Allah mentions here,

while bringing forth more evidences against Arab polytheists, that the Sacred House in Makkah was established on the worship of Allah alone, without partners. He also states that Ibrahim, who established the city, has disowned those who worship others besides Allah, and that he begged Allah to make Makkah peaceful and secure, / . jLS ill jiLf ^f} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) of peace and security,}

Ibrahim (35-36) (Part-13) and Allah accepted his supplication. Allah said in other Ayat, i&: tjz. @ ^ iHave they not seen that We have made (Makkah) a secure sanctuary .> [29:67] and, -,i-s p : (SjL" ife. ojUU yi, Jj5 4u" oK" ^Uo 4Verily , thefirst House (ofworship) appointedfor mankind was that at Bakkah (Makkah), full of blessing, and a guidance for Al-'Alamin. In it are manifest signs, the Maqdm of Ibrahim; whosoever enters it, he attains security.^[3:96] Allah said here that Ibrahim supplicated, 354' ^f} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) a of peace and security,} saying, this city , after he established it, and this is why he said afterwards, 4AU praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'il and Ishaq.} [14:39] It is well-known that Ismail was thirteen years older than Ishaq. When Ibrahim took Ismail and his mother to Makkah, while Ismail was still young enough to nurse, he supplicated to Allah, li* j Cjj} 40 my Lord! Make this city (Makkah) a place of peace and security.} [2:126] as we in explained in Surat Al-Baqarah. Ibrahim then said, 4and keep me and my sons awayfrom worshipping idols.} It is proper for whoever supplicates to Allah to also ask for the benefit of his parents and offspring, as well as himself. Ibrdhim next mentioned that many among mankind were led astray because of idols, and he disowned those who worship them and referred their matter to Allah; if Allah wills, He will

punish them, and if He wills. He will forgive them. Isa, peace be upon him, said similar words, *!f ilf You punish them, they are Your servants, and if You forgive them, verily, You, only You are the Almighty, the All- Wise.>[5:1 18] This supplication refers this and all matters to Allah, not that it is actually going to happen. Abdullah bin Amr narrated that the Messenger of Allah jg recited Ibrahim s supplication, 40 my Lord! They have indeed led astray many among mankind.}, and the supplication of Isa, ilfYou punish them, they are Your servants .} [5:118] then raised his hands and said, "O Allah, Save my Ummah! O, Allah, Save my Ummah! O, Allah, Save my Ummah! and cried. Allah said to the angel Jibril, O Jibril, go to Muhammad, and Your Lord has more knowledge, and ask him what makes him ciy. Jibril came to the Prophet jg and asked him, and he repeated to him what he said (in his supplication). Allah said, Go to Muhammad and tell him this; *We will make you pleased with your Ummah, O Muhammad, and will not treat them in awayyou dislike. JLJ' Wj oLto X gjj fc. j zil J-& 4^ tSyf 437. "O our Lord! I have made some ofmy offspring dwell in an uncultivable valley by Your Sacred House in order, O our Lord, that they may perform Saldh. So fill some hearts among hi Muslim 1 :19 1

Ibrahim (37) (Part-13) men with love towards them, and (O Allah) provide them with fruits so that they may give thanks.} This Ayah indicates that this was different supplication than the first one that Ibrahim said when he left Hajar and her son Ismail in Makkah, before the Sacred House was built. This prayer, it appears, was said after the House was built, begging Allah and seeking His favor, and He is the Exalted and Most Honored. Ibrahim said here. iby Your Sacred House...} then he, Cj} 40 our Lord, that they may perform Salah.} Ibn Jarir At-Tabari commented that this, Refers to his earlier statement, 4the

Sacred...}, " meaning, You have made this House Sacred so that people establish the prayer next to it, ^br "j;&' "as\$ 4So fill some hearts among men with love towards them,} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Said bin Jubayr said, Had Ibrahim said, The hearts of mankind , Persians, Romans, the Jews, the Christians and all other people would have gathered around it. * However, Ibrahim said, 4o& U} 4among men}, thus making it exclusive to Muslims only. He said next, ^} 4and (O Allah) provide them with fruits} *'* See Al-Bukhari no. 3364, where it is clear that Ibrahim said this supplication when he first arrived in Makkah leaving his wife and Ismail ApTabari 17:25-26.

in order that they may be helped in obeying You, and because this is a barren valley; bring to them fruits that they might eat. Allah accepted Ibrahim s supplication, ugU Uy ijl 2 iHave We not established for them a secure sanctuary (Makkah), to which are brought fruits of all kinds, a provision from Ourselves.} [28:57] This only indicates Allah s compassion, kindness, mercy and blessing, in that there are no fruit producing trees in the Sacred City, Makkah, yet all kinds of fruits are being brought to it from all around; this is how Allah accepted the supplication of the Khalil - Allah s intimate friend, Prophet Ibrahim, peace be upon him. Vj urfjfi 4 Uf- 02 ji' j6 tjfo. b) ly jn*- L JW "l [, JjSj fj 438. "O o"r Lord! Certainly, You know what we conceal and what we reveal. Nothing on the earth or in the heaven is hidden from Allah."} 439. "All praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'il and Ishaq. Verily, my Lord is indeed the All-Hearer of invocations."} 440. "O my Lord! Make me one who performs Salah, and (also) from my offspring, our Lord! And accept my invocation."} "Our Lord! Forgive me and my parents, and (all) the believers on the Day when the reckoning will be established."} Ibn Jarir At-Tabari said, Allah said that Ibrahim, His KhalU, said, tJ \ j} 40 our Lord! Certainly, You know what we conceal and what we reveal.} meaning, You know the intention behind my supplication for

the people of this town, seeking Your pleasure in sincerity to You. You know all things, apparent and hidden, and nothing escapes Your knowledge on the earth or in heaven. He next praised and thanked his Lord the Exalted and Most Honored for granting him offspring after he became old, 4A// praise is due to Allah, Who has given me in old age Isma'it (Ishmael) and Ishaq (Isaac). Verily, my Lord is indeed the All-Hearer of invocations.} *He accepts the supplication of those who invoke Him, and has accepted my invocation when I asked Him to grant me offspring. Ibrahim said next, 40 my Lord! Make me one who performs Salah,}, preserving its obligations and limits, i^o6} iand (also) from my offspring,}, make them among those who establish the prayer, as well, ^} iour Lord! And accept my invocation.}, all of my invocation which I invoked You with herein, iOur Lord! Forgive me and my parents,} Ibrahim said this before he declared himself innocent from his father, after he became sure that he was an enemy of Allah, iand the believers}, all of them. 44^"J' f_A* ' } ion the Day when the reckoning will be established.} on the Day when You will reckon Your servants and recompense or reward them for their deeds - good for good and evil for evil.

> -r *; /ji Ci IpM fcs; iii -tuZ 'it ^>- i>: *J oJ: fax# 442. Consider not that Allah is unaware of that which the wrongdoers do, but He gives them respite up to a Day ivhen the eyes will stare in horror.} 443. (They will be) hastening forward with necks outstretched, their heads raised up (towards the sky), their gaze returning not towards than and their hearts empty.} Allah gives Respite to the Disbelievers and is never unaware of what They do Allah says, O Muhammad, do not think that Allah is unaware of

what the unjust disbelievers do. Do not think because Allah gave them respite and delayed their punishment that He is unaware or ignoring punishing them for what they do. Rather, Allah keeps full account of this for them and keeps it on record against them, 4but He gives them respite up to a Day when the eyes will stare in horror.} from the horror of the Day of Resurrection. Allah next mentions how they will all be raised up from their graves and hurriedly gathered for the Day of Gathering, i.e. hastening forward}, in a hurry. Allah said in other Ayat, 4Hastening towards the caller.} [54:8] 4on that Day mankind will follow strictly Allah's caller, no crookedness will they show him.} [20:108] until, && :j\$ 4And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the

Sustainer.} [20:111] Allah said: another Ayat, 5The Day when they will come out of the graves quickly. [70:43] Allah said next, iwith necks outstretched> meaning, raising their heads up, according to Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and several others. Allah said next, '4>.# itheir gaze returning not towards them> meaning, their eyes are staring in confusion, trying not to blink because of the horror and tremendous insights they are experiencing, and fear of what is going to strike them, we seek refuge with Allah from this end. This is why Allah said. 4and their hearts empty.} meaning, their hearts are empty due to extreme fear and fright. Qatadah and several others said that the places of their hearts are empty then, because the hearts will ascend to the throats due to extreme fear. 121 Allah said next to His Messenger sg, (4-^j oj ^ Si ? j&J l ,h ^ o;Ji j iij l O^J xej liJfc ij <(44. And warn mankind of the Day when the torment will come unto them; then the wrongdoers will say: "Our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your call andTabari 17:31-32.Tabari 17:34.

follow the Messengers!" (It will be said:) "Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter)."} 445. "And you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves, and it was clear to you how We dealt with them. And We put forth (many) parables for you. } 446. Indeed, they planned their plot, and their plot was with Allah, though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} There will be no Respite after the Coming of the Torment Allah mentions what those who committed injustice against themselves will say when they witness the torment, g-Sj T2j} 4our Lord! Respite us for a little while, we will answer Your call and follow the Messengers!} Allah said in other Ayat, 4Until, when death comes to one of them, he says: "My Lord! Send me back. }[23:99] and, 4fi\$ \p: (\$ } 40 you who believe! Let not your properties divert you.} (63:9-10) Allah described the condition of the wrongdoers on the Day of Gathering, when He said, 4And if you only could see when the criminals shall hang their heads.} (32:12), 'tj je iij i] Ztj jf} 4If you could but see when they will be held over the Fire! They will say: "Would that we were but sent back (to the world)! Then we would not deny the Ayat of Our Lord..."!} [6:27] and.

4Q. t iTherein they will cry.} (35:27) Allah refuted their statement here, oi & Jt '5^=^ |"Had you not sworn aforetime that you would not leave> Allah says, *Had you not vowed before, that your previous state will not change, that there will be no Resurrection or Reckoning? Therefore, taste this torment because of what you vowed before. Mujahid commented that, 4\$ > Cii \$ ithat you would not leave.} refers to leaving this worldly life to the Hereafter. 111 Allah also said, iAnd they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up him who dies.} [16:38] Allah said next. ^ fk^S jit C/Jii 4 i^X-4 J^VTp iAnd you dwelt in the dwellings of men who wronged themselves, and it was clear to you how We had dealt with them. And We put forth (many) parables for you.} Allah says, you have

witnessed or heard of the news of what happened to the earlier disbelieving nations, but you did not draw a lesson from their end, nor did what We punished them with provide an example for you, iPerfect wisdom but the wamers benefit then not.^(54:5) Shu*bah narrated that Abu Ishaq said that Abdur-Rahman bin Dabil said that Ali bin Abi Talib commented on Allah s statement, m Al-Tabari 17:36.

368 TafsTr Ibn Kathir 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} He who disputed with Ibrahim about his Lord, took two eaglets and raised them until they became adult eagels. Then he tied each eagel s leg to a wooden box with ropes and left them go hungry. He and another man sat inside the wooden box and raised a staff with a piece of meat on its tip. So, the two eagles started flying. The king asked his companion to tell him what he was seeing, and he described the scenes to him, until he said that he saw the earth as a fly. So, the king brought the staff closer to the eagels and they started landing slowly. This is why Allah said, Jjj3pp SIS jp) though their plot was hardly one to remove the mountains from their places. Mujahid also mentioned that this story was about Nebuchadnezzar, and that when the king s sight was far away from earth and its people, he was called, O tyrant one! Where are you headed to? He became afraid and brought the staff closer to the eagels, which flew faster with such haste that the mountains almost shook from the noise they made. The mountains were almost moved from their places, so Allah said, 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places Ibn Jurayj narrated that Mujahid recited this Ayah in a way that means, though their plot was such as to remove the mountains from their places. However, Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that, 4J1^' ii* jff} ithough their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.} indicates that their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places. Similar was said by Al-Hasan Al- At-Jabari 17:39.Jabari 17:39.

Basri. Ibn Jarir reasoned that, Associating others with Allah and disbelieving in Him, which they brought upon themselves, did not bother the mountains nor other creatures. Rather, the harm of their actions came to haunt them. I (Ibn Kathir) said, this meaning is similar to Allah s statement, 3cl) p m^ JA a \$And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth, nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height.\$[17:37] There is another way of explaining this Ayah] Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that, iij jjJj 4though their plot was not such as to remove the mountains from their places.\$ refers to their Shirk, for Allah said in another Ayah, 4*^ ^Whereby the heavens are almost tom.\$ ll] [19:90] Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah said similarly.12 ' > t* ' /f 4. ,4' " 4i[p.i^ A hirej i47. So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to His Messengers. Certainly, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Able of Retribution.\$ 448. On the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens, and they (all creatures) will appear before Allah, the One, the Irresistible. Allah never breaks a Promise Allah affirms His promise, ^t43lImj -oil uw*- ys 4So think not that Allah will fail to keep His promise to HisTabari 17:41. (2> At-Tabari 17 :41

Messengers.} His promise to grant them victory in this life and on the Day when the Witnesses shall come forth. Allah affirms that He is All-Able and that nothing He wills escapes His power and none can resist Him. Allah affirms that He is Able to exact retribution from those who disbelieve in Him and deny Him, \$Woe that Day to the deniers!}(77:15) Allah said here, iOn the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens, meaning. His promise shall come to pass on the Day when the earth will be changed to an earth other than this earth that we know and recognize. It is

recorded in the Two Sahih's that Sahl bin Sa'd said that the Messenger of Allah said, pjj. JU udi "On the Day of Resurrection, the people will be gathered on a white (barren), flat earth just like the wheat bread, it has no recognizable features for anyone .n111 Imam

Ibrahim (47-48) (Part-13) On the S'raf. '

Jli 1 * JI* *?d3Lo-i>* d)l ;Jij . d)^>-j ji ySj UUU-I lip i jA^>^ jf^Jl JUj t *Ut : Jla ijJ^Jt dtfU *J^)'& jfcii#* "ip *Ju;*^ tfif cJf^ii^ ji^Ji>* J JUi lOj-ajl jJJJ Ulilj O- i .l.^ di) Jli Jjil oi^i till J>- ii>^ f-4J ^*j *<* ^-- j* '-i* jiJ" :2|| I<| ill I Jn /he darkness before the Bridge (Jasr). * He asked, *Who will be the first to pass it? He said, The poor emigrants (Muhajirin). * He asked, What will their (refreshment) be when they enter Paradise? He said, iThe caul offish liver. He asked, *What will they have after that? He said, *A bull of Paradise which grazed through its pathways will be slaughtered for them.* He asked, From what will they drink? He said, iFrom a fountain whose name is Salsabil ." He said, You have said the truth. I have come to ask you something about which none of the inhabitants of the earth knows, with the exception of a Prophet or one or two other men. He said, *Would you benefit by me informing you about it?* He replied, 7 would listen. I have come to ask you about the child. He jfe said, *The fluid of the man is white, and the woman's is yellow. When they meet, if the discharge of the man is greater than that of the woman, then it becomes a male, by Allah's permission. W7ien the womans discharge is greater than the man's, it becomes a female by Allah's permission ." The Jew said, You have told the truth and are indeed a Prophet. Then he left. So Allah s Messenger jg said; "He asked me such things that I had no knowledge of it until Allah gave it to we. Allah said next, 4k iand they will appear before Allah}, describing when the creatures will be resurrected before Allah from their graves, m Muslim no. 315.

Jr emm n\ mm if3!JJLi4>'3-' p-f~ o'UlJjJl^*^*[^> ,* ? - "i _> ji" c4" _- ,_) ^ ^JlJg j^lLl Jjjj c ij;*j 3 3Ci% , > "'si' *. 't'''^ \<.x *. j~*i >^'<-S_A> t) (^liy j~*^ AiW*}i/*- \$aS^iw Jjjjwllj^Dl '3l" swift at reckoning.> itiie One, the Irresisti- ble.} Who has full power and control over all things and to Whom the necks and minds are subservient. y^*Ji Or^' < r*Jr o' ^+Lp 4 v >>^ >> . , '1 *s v. "%jLiN cs-^J ylr" lljLT 12 .jJi j^ Sit "jt g/i iii j[449. And you will see the criminals that Day, Muqarranun (bound together) in fetters.} 450. Their garments will be of Qatiran (tar), and fire will cover their faces.} 451 . That Allah may requite each person ac- cording to what he has earned. Truly, Allah is The Condition of the criminals on the Day of Resurrection Allah said. % J&i jS? " 40n the Day when the earth will be changed to another earth and so will be the heavens} and the creations will be brought before their Lord, and you, O Muhammad, will witness the criminals who committed the crimes of Kufr and mischief,

<&*} {Muqarranin} bound together, each with his or her like, just as Allah said, yn4 {Assemble those who did wrong, together with their companions.} [37:22] {And when the souls are joined with their bodies.}[81:7], ds&l j&d b'6& \$1 Z\$} {And when they shall be thrown into a narrow place thereof, chained together, they will exclaim therein for destruction.} [25:13] and. 4 4^ {And also the Shayatin from the Jinn (including) every kind of builder and diver, and also others bound in fetters.^[38:37-38] Allah said next, {Their garments will be ofQatiran (pitch),} that is used to coat camels. Qatadah commented that Qatirdn (tar) is one of the fastest objects to catch fire. Ibn Abbas used to say that the Qatirdn, mentioned in the Ayah, is dissolved lead.111 It is possible that this Ayah reads as: (yU** hi

referring to heated lead that has reached tremendous heat, according to Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr Al-Hasan and Qatadah.[21 Allah said next, {j\j& }} {and fire will cover their faces}, which is similar to His other At-Tabari 17:56. At-Tabari 17:55-56.

Sarah 14. Ibrahim (49-51) (Part-13 statement, iThe Fire will bunt theirfaces, and therein they will grin, with displaced lips.>[23: 104] Imam

when He wills to reckon a servants of His, for He knows everything and nothing ever escapes His observation. Verily, His power over all of His creation is the same as His power over one creature, 4The creation ofyou all and the resurrection ofyou all are only as a single person.^(31:28] And this is why Mujahid said, 4swift at reckoning}, means keeping count. ."A 452 . This (Qur'an) is a Messagefor mankind (and a clear proof against them), in order that they may be warned thereby, and that they may know that He is the only One God and that men ofunderstanding may take heed.} Allah states that this Qur an is a Message for mankind, 4(So) that 1 may therewith warn you and whomsoever it may reach.} [6:19] This Qur an is for all mankind and the Jinns, just as Allah said in the beginning of this Surah, QfA. 4Alif-Lam-Ra. (This is) a Book which We have revealed unto you in order that you might lead mankind out of darkness into light.} \14:1] Allah said next, 4in order that they may be warned thereby}, or to receive and draw lessons from it, 4Vj '42O &>

iand that they may know that He is the only One God} using its proofs and evidences that testify that there is no true deity except Allah, iand that men of understanding may take heed.} meaning those who have good minds.

Surah 15: Al-Hijr

PDF pages 2919–2967

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2919–2965]

Opening >> about the Jahannamiyyun (the sinners among the believers who will stay in Hell for some time), when they (the disbelievers) see them being brought out of Hell. iHow much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been Muslims. Ibn Jarir reported that Ibn Abbas and Anas bin Malik explained that this Ayah refers to the Day when Allah will detain the sinful Muslims in Hell along with the idolaters. He said: The idolaters will say to them, What you used to worship on earth has not helped you. Then by virtue of His mercy, Allah will be angry for their sake, and He will remove them [from it]. That is when <^ \ \$ i ! S- '4% O,} 4How much would those who disbelieved wish that they had been Muslims}. iLeave them to eat and enjoy} this is a stem and definitive threat for them, like His saying, j] iSay : "Enjoy your brief life! But certainly, your destination is the Fire! } [14:30] 4(0 disbelievers!) Eat and enjoy yourselves (in this worldly life) for a little while. Verily, you are the guilty>[77:46] Allah says: < .V(4let them be preoccupied with false hope.} i.e., distracted from repentance and turning to Allah, for 4^r^t Sf-"} At-Tabari 17:62. At-Tabari 17:62.

Al-Hiir (4-9) (Part-14 48. We do not send the angels down except with the truth, and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!) 49. Verily, We, it is We Who revealed the Dhikr (i.e. the Qur'an) and surely We will guard it (from corruption).} The Accusation that the Prophet^ was a Madman and Demands forHim to bringdown Angels Allah tells us about the disbelief, arrogance and stubbornness of the disbelievers as reflected in their words: 40 you (Muhammad) to whom the Dhikr (the Qur'an) has been revealed!} i.e., the one who claims to receive it. i&i5 iVerily, you are a mad man!} i.e., by your invitation to us to follow you and leave the way ofour forefathers. 4&pi C }} 4Why do you not bring angels to us} i.e., to bear witness to the accuracy of what you have brought to us is true, if you are really telling the truth? This is similar to what Pharaoh said: f (kt T 4Why then are not golden bracelets bestowed on him, or angels sent along with him?}[43:53). And Allah said: tsj \$ uu) dkk-k v c jf ju jAnd those who do not expect a meeting, with Us (i.e., those , who deny the Day ofResurrection and the life of the Hereafter), say : "Why are not the angels sent down to us, or why do we not see our Lord?" Indeed they think too highly of themselves, and are scornful with great pride. On the Day that they do see the angels - there will be no good news given on that day to the guilty. And they (angels) will say: "All kinds of glad tidings areforbidden for you."} (25:21-22) For this reason Allah said:

382 TafsTr Ibn KathTr w n & c" iWe do not send the angels down except with the truth, and in that case, they (the disbelievers) would have no respite!} Mujahid said in this Ayah -Ji233\$ c> iWe do not send the angels down except with the truth |i.e.,J with the Message and the punishment. 1 Then Allah, may He be exalted, stated that He is the One Who revealed the Dhikr to him, which is the Qur an, and

He is protecting it from being changed or altered. *i 1\$ s)yj os pjji 44 ja tS&jt ^ % -X jfoS. V vjiS a 4# < y>" 410. Indeed, We sent (Messengers) before you (O Muhammad) amongst the earlier communities. ill. And there never came a Messenger to them but that they mocked him. ill. Thus We allow it to enter the hearts of the guilty. il3. They would not believe in it (the Qur'an); and already the example of the ancients has gone forth.} The Idolaters of Every Nation made a Mockery of their Messengers Consoling His Messenger ig for the rejection of the disbelieving Quraysh, Allah says that He has sent Messengers before him to the nations of the past, and no Messenger came to a nation but they rejected him and mocked him. Then He tells him that He lets disbelief enter the hearts of those sinners who are too stubborn and too arrogant to follow His guidance. ^ yjii /S3LLa4uT> iThus We allow it to enter the hearts of the guilty.} m At-Tabari 17:68.

this referred to Shirk. ,1) ili cii- iand already the example of the ancients has gone forth> meaning the destruction wrought by Allah on those who rejected His Messengers, and how He saved His Prophets and their followers in this world and in the Hereafter, is well known. 414. And even if We opened to them a gate to the heavens and they were to continue ascending through it (all day long.) 415. They would surely say (in the evening): "Our eyes have been (as if) dazzled (we have not seen any angel or heaven). Nay, we are a people bewitched.") The Stubborn Disbelievers will never believe, no matter what Signs and Wonders They see Allah explains the extent of their disbelief and stubborn resistance to the truth by stating that even if a door to heaven were to be opened for them, and they were to be taken up through it, they would still not believe. Rather, they would say: 4&4 I4> 40ur eyes have been (as if) dazzled.) Mujahid, Ibn Kathir and Ad-Dahhak said, [this means] our vision has been blocked. 121 Qatadah narrated that Ibn Abbas said, (this means] our eyesight has been taken away. Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, (this means] we were confused and put under a spell. 40ur eyes have been (as if) dazzled.) At-Tabari 17:70. Af-Tabari 17:74. At-Jabari 17:75.

rvr j&j l^j ><|r if*' .i * - i''^*'' - x _> ** < " 0'''*!% ^^jilsjaLv{/<& ,iLT^i~ ^y &gS3 Tafefr Ibn Kathlr 0 -i^*nUjili.-UJ_>|^p(CT^ci"U^j"A/si,^y)_> ^sL^CLlj ^ Ujii^^O; (ji^ssS0HUIJU"_j I^I jj* j^agsga ^ Ibn Zayd said: The one who is dazzled [lit. intoxicated] is the one who cannot reason. > &3\ ^ Gw wj> 0^S l *^9+V^\$ OJ jat &:f i~_ ;"aj 1\$Wju jT OJ lj Gwl> (sf L(j LWj 3p>* }j^ Ti^ / . r j^ ' i>*J <_- 416. And indeed, We have put the big stars in the heaven and We beautified it for the beholders. 417. And We have guarded it (near heaven) from every outcast Shaytan (devil). 418. Except him (devil) who steals the hearing, then he is pursued by a clear flaming fire.} 419. And We have spread out the earth, and have placed firm mountains in it, and caused all kinds of things to grow in it, in due proportion.} 420. And in it We have provided means of living, for you and for those whom you provide not.} The Power of Allah and His Signs in the Heavens and on Earth To those who ponder, and look repeatedly at the dazzling signs and wonders that are to be seen in the creation, Allah mentions His creation of the heavens, with their immense height, and both the fixed and moving heavenly bodies with

which He has adorned it. Here, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Buruj [big stars] refers to the heavenly bodies . 1 11 (I say): This is like the Ayah : 4 Blessed be He Who has placed the big stars in the heavens . [25:61] Atiyah Al- Awfi said: Buruj here refers to sentinel fortresses. 121 He made the shooting stars to guard it against the evil devils who try to listen to information conveyed at the highest heights. If any devil breaches it and advances hoping to listen, a clear shooting star comes to him and

destroys him. He may already have passed on whatever he heard before the fire hit him, to another devil below him; the latter will then take it to his friends [among humans], as is stated in the Sahlh. Explaining this Ayah, Al-Bukhari reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet sg said: $\text{c2jJ} > \text{jLUL J}'' \text{yS I ill I bln 'yue JLLJL}$. "When Allah decrees any matter in heaven, the angels beat their wings in submission to His Word, [with a sound like] a chain [beating] on a smooth rock." (Ali and other subnarrators said, The sound reaches them.) When the fright leaves their (angels) hearts, they (angels) are asked: What did your Lord say? They respond: The truth. And He is the Most High, the Most Great. So those who hope to hear something listen, and they are standing one above the other. Sufyan [the narrator] described them with a gesture, spreading the fingers of his right hand and holding it in such a way that the fingers were above one another. Sometimes the flaming fire hits one of these listeners before he is able to convey what he has heard to the one who is beneath him, and he is burned up, or sometimes the fire does not hit him until he has pit on to the one beneath him, At-Tabari 17:77. Al-Baghawi 3 :45

so he brings it to the earth. Perhaps Sufyan said: ...until it reaches the earth and he puts it into the mouth of the sorcerer or fortune-teller, so that after telling a hundred lies he gets something right, and the people say, T)id he not tell us that on such and such a day such and such would happen, and we found it to be the truth among the statements which were heard from heaven. 111 Then Allah mentions His creation of the earth and how He spread it out, and the firm mountains, valleys, lands and sands that he has placed in it, and the plants and fruits that He causes to grow in their appropriate locations. t'y yfr tall kinds of things in due proportion.> Ibn Abbas said that this means with their predetermined proportions. This was also the opinion of Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, Abu Malik, Mujahid, Al-Hakim bin Utaybah, Al-Hasan bin Muhammad, Abu Salih and Qatadah . Ijj j 3 \$And We have provided therein means of living, for you\$ Here Allah mentions that He created the earth with different means of provisions and livelihood of all kinds. 4andfor those whom you provide not.\$ Mujahid said, This refers to the riding animals and the cattle. 131 Ibn Jarir said, They are slaves, men and women, as well as the animals and the cattle. The meaning is that Allah, may He be exalted, is reminding them of the ways of earning provision that He has made easy for them, and of the animals that He has subjugated for them to ride and to eat, and the slaves from whom they benefit, but the provision of all of these comes from Allah alone. 141 Al-Bari8 :23 1Tabari 17:79-81.Tabari 17:82.Tabari 17:82.

&' irfj 3^#% ^ fc5 1C 2Ji Si a#" *' ' ' " Z% oS^ tfj gja^t n. >"~ - * > j 421 . And there is not a thing, but the supplies for it are with Us, and We do not send it down but in a known measure.} 422 . And We send the winds fertilizing, then We cause the water to descend from the sky, and We give it to you to drink, and it is not you who are the owners of its supply.} 423 . And certainly We! It is We Who give life, and cause death, and We are the Inheritors .} 424 . And indeed, We know the first generations of you who have passed away, and indeed, We know the present generations of you (mankind), and also those who will come afterwards.} And verily, your Lord will gather them together. Truly, He is Most Wise, (and) Knowing.} The Supplies for All Things are with Allah Allah tells us that He is the Owner of all things, and that everything is easy for Him. He has the supplies for all things with Him. Cj} iand We do not send it down but in a known measure.} meaning, as He wills and as He wants. Doing so out of His great wisdom and mercy towards His servants, in a way that He is under no obligation to do. But He has decreed mercy for Himself. Yazld bin Abi Ziyad reported from Abu Juhayfah that Abdullah said:

No year has more rain than another, but Allah divides the rain between them as He wills, it rains here a year and there a year. Then he recited: *lixjji ur j* d\j}* iAnd there is not a thing, but the supplies for it are with Us...}

388 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Reported by Ibn Jarir.¹¹¹ Benefits of the Winds 4 And We send the winds fertilizing i.e., fertilizing the clouds so that they give rain, and fertilizing the trees so that they open their leaves and blossoms. These winds are mentioned here in the plural form because they give results, unlike the barren wind (Ar-Rih Al- Aqim, see Adh- Dhariyat 51:41), which is mentioned in the singular and described as barren since it does not produce anything; because results can only be produced when there are two or more things. iAnd We sent the winds fertilizing. Abdullah bin Mas'ud said, The wind is sent bearing water from the sky, then it fertilizes the clouds until rain begins to generously fall, just as the milk of the pregnant camel flows generously. ¹²¹ This was also the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i and Qatadah.¹³ Ad-Dahhak said: Allah sends it to the clouds and it gets fertilized and becomes full of water. ¹⁴¹ TJBayd bin TJmayr Al-Laythi said: Allah sends the wind which stirs up the earth, then Allah sends the wind which raises clouds, then Allah sends the wind which forms clouds, then Allah sends the fertilizing wind which pollinates the trees. Then he recited, cf9' {And We sent the winds fertilizing, At-Tabari 17:84.Tabari 17-86.Tabari 17:87-88.Tabari 17:88 151 Ibid.

Al-Hiir (21-25) (Part-14 Fresh Water is a Blessing from Allah iand We give it to you to drink,) This means, and We send it down to you fresh and sweet, so that you can drink it; if We had wished. We could have made it salty (and undrinkable) , as Allah points out in another Ayah in Surat Al-Waqi ah, where He says: *iill jj Ji jp'f j, jjifc %'\$)* ad iTell Me! The water that you drink, is it you who cause it to come down from the rain clouds, or are We the cause of it coming down? IfWe willed, We verily could make it salty (and undrinkable), why then do you not give thanks (to Allah?) (56:68-70). And Allah says: *f3 & Lilt sfj* JjJ xs& j>)* iHe it is Who sends water down from the sky; from it you drink and from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.) (16:10) *iZ&k fi V;)* iand it is not you who are the owners of its supply.) The meaning is, You are not taking care of it; rather We send it down and take care of it for you, making springs and wells flourish on the earth." If Allah so willed, He could make it disappear, but by His mercy He sends it down and makes it fresh and sweet, maintaining the springs, wells, rivers and so on, so that they may drink from it all year long, water their livestock and irrigate their crops. The Power of Allah to initiate and renew Creation o*1) ty)) iAnd certainly We! We it is Who give life, and cause death,) Here Allah tells us of His power to initiate creation and renew it. He is the One Who brings life to creatures out 'of

390 Tafsir Ibn Kathir nothingness, then He causes them to die, then He will resurrect all of them on the Day when He will gather them together. He also tells us that He will inherit the earth and everyone on it, and then it is to Him that they will return. Then He tells us about His perfect knowledge of them, the first and the last of them. He says *ip.* iAnd indeed, We know the first generations of you who had passed away...}. Ibn Abbas said, The first generations are all those who have passed away since the time of Adam. The present generations and those who will come afterward refer to those who are alive now and who are yet to come, until the Day of Resurrection. Something similar was narrated from Ikrimah, Mujahid, Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah, Muhammad bin Ka b, Ash-ShaTa and others. Ibn Jarir reported from Muhammad bin Abi Ma'shar, from his father, that he heard Awn bin Abdullah discussing the following

Ayah with Muhammad bin Ka*b: %pt iAnd indeed, We know the first generations of you who had passed away, and indeed, We know the present generations of you (mankind), and also those who will come afterwards}, and it was stated that it refers to the rows for prayer. Muhammad bin Ka*b said, This is not the case. ipi iix &;} iAnd indeed, We know the first generations of you who had passed away} it refers to those who are dead or have been killed, and; ib^} iand also those who will come afterwards} meaning those who have yet to be created. I 1 * At-Tabari 17:91. > At-Tabari 17:90-92.

Al-Hiir (26-27) (Part-14) 4And verily your Lord will gather them together. Truly, He is Most Wise, (and) Knowing}. Awn bin Abdullah said, May Allah help you and reward you with good. 111 J5 J? 5 p'f / / V 426. And indeed, We created man from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud.} 427. And the } inn, We created earlier from the smokeless flame of fire.} The Substances from which Mankind and Jinns were created Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said that Salsal means dry mud.121 The apparent meaning is similar to the Ayah: cc o* c'jfc-} 4He created man (Adam) from sounding clay like the potter's clay, And He created the jinns from a smokeless flame of fire.} (55:14-15) It was also reported from Mujahid that, 4^,} idried (sounding) clay} means putrid",131 but it is more appropriate to interpret an Ayah with another Ayah. p~ ^} io of altered mud} means the dried clay that comes from mud, which is soil. Altered here means smooth. /A' i " o; 4And the jinn, We created earlier} means before creating humans. At-Tabari 17:90. At-Tabari 17:96. [3] At-Tabari 17:97.

' i ifrom the smokeless flame of fire Ibn Abbas said, It is the smokeless flame that kills. 11 ' Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi said that Shu*bah narrated to them from Abu Ishaq, who said: I visited Umar Al-Asamm when he was sick, and he said: Shall I not tell you a Hadith that I heard from Abdullah bin Mas*ud? He said: This smokeless flame is one of the seventy parts of the smokeless fire from which the Jinn were created. Then he recited, i o; Jj j; 4And the Jinn, We created earlier from the smokeless flame of fire}. The following is found in the Sahih, Juej f Si JI>-j ijU {a jt C~IL> -j i jy iSySfru,Jl nThe angels were created from light, the Jinn were created from a smokeless flame of fire, and Adam was created from that which has been described to youV3' The Ayah is intended to point out the noble nature, good essence and pure origin of Adam. \ij p- ot & && j \ pi Jli TT^ J yl ,ill U Jli ^ ofri jl zi) fr- J* J.'C"i .o Ji /Oili. iJ 428. And (remember) when your Lord said to the angels: "J am going to create a man (Adam) from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud."} 429. "So, when I have fashioned him completely and breathed into him (Adam) of My spirit (the soul which I created for (1 > At-Tabari 17:99.Tabari 16:21. Muslim 4:2294

Al-Hiir (34-38) (Part-14) him,) then fall down, prostrating yourselves before him."} 430. So the angels prostrated themselves, all of them together. 431. Except Iblis (Shaytan) - he refused to be among the prostrate.} 432. (Allah) said: O Iblis! What is your reason for not being among the prostrate?" 433. [Iblis] said: I am not one to prostrate myself to a human, whom You created from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud."} The creation of Adam, the Command to the Angels to prostrate to Him, and the Rebellion of Iblis Allah informs us of how He mentioned Adam to His angels before He created him, and how He honored him by commanding the angels to prostrate to him. He mentions how His enemy Iblis, amidst all the angels, refused to prostrate to him out of envy, disbelief, stubbornness, arrogance, and false pride. This is why Iblis said: * fr ce, jSl ^ty 41 am not one to prostrate myself to a human, whom You created from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud.} this is like when he said, Ji jU & gZL i>

tty 4/ am better than him (Adam), You created me from Fire and him You created from clay.} [7:12) and 4^ tfil Jlijvty 4 "Do you see this one whom You have honored above me..."} [17:62] tili il> JU c\j Jltty (Allah) said: Then leave, for verily, you are an outcast. }

435. "And verily, the curse shall be upon you until the Day of Recompense."} 436. [Iblis] said: "O my Lord! Then give me respite until the Day they (the dead) will be resurrected."} 437. Allah said: Then verily, you are of those reprieved,"} 438. Until the Day of the time appointed."} The Expulsion of Iblis from Jannah, and His Reprieve until the Day of Resurrection Allah tells us how He issued an unconditional command to Iblis to leave the position he held among the highest of heights. He told him that he was an outcast, i.e., cursed, and that he would be followed by a curse that would hound him until the Day of Resurrection. It was reported that Said bin Jubayr said: When Allah cursed Iblis, his image into something different from that of the angels, and he made a sound like a bell. Every bell that rings on this earth until the Day of Resurrection is part of that. This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. fr ... ^ * y ^ Si si 61 0142 \$ lit fri yC d j2r lift It 439. [Iblis] said: O my Lord! Because You misled me, I shall indeed adorn the path of error for them (mankind) on the earth, and I shall mislead them all."} 440. "Except Your chosen (guided) servants among them."} 441 . (Allah) said : "This is the way which will lead straight to Me."} 442. Certainly, you shall have no authority over My servants, except those of the astray who follow you."} 443. And surely, Hell is the place promised for them all.} 444. It has seven gates, for each of those gates is a class assigned.}

Al-Hiir (39-44) (Part-14) The Threat of Iblis to tempt Mankind, and Allah's Promise of Hell for him Allah informed about the rebellion and arrogance of Iblis, in that he said to the Lord: 4Because You misled me,} i.e., because You misled me and misguided me. 4I shall indeed adorn the path of error for them meaning, for the progeny of Adam. 4dfX1 4on the earth,} meaning - I will make sin dear to them, and will encourage, provoke and harass them to commit sin. 4and I shall mislead them all.} meaning - just as You have misled me and have ordained that for me. 4Except Your chosen, (guided) servants among them.} This is like the Ayah: t / f* v % * i S' * , / v "jit 4 Do you see this one whom You have honored above me, if You give me respite until the Day of Resurrection, I will surely seize and mislead his offspring, all but a few!"} (17:62). 4(Alldh) said, i.e., threatening and warning Iblis. 4This is the way which will lead straight to Me.} means, all of you will return to Me, and I will reward or punish you according to your deeds: if they are good then I will reward you, and if they are bad then I will punish you.

396 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir This is like the Ayah:) 5)^ iVerily, your Lord is ever watchful. (89:14) and iAnd it is up to Allah to show the right way.} (16:9) iCertainly, you shall have no authority over My servants} meaning, You will have no way to reach those for whom I have decreed guidance. dibt ^ ^except those of the astray who follow you.} Ibn Jarir mentioned that Yazid bin Qusayt said: The Prophets used to have Masjids outside their cities, and if a Prophet wanted to consult with his Lord about something, he would go out to his place of worship and pray as Allah decreed. Then he would ask Him about whatever was concerning him. Once while a Prophet was in his place of worship, the enemy of Allah - meaning Iblis - came and sat between him and the Qiblah (direction of prayer). The Prophet said, I seek refuge with Allah from the accursed Shaytan.' [The enemy of Allah said, Do you know who you are seeking refuge from? Here he is! The Prophet said, I seek refuge with Allah from the accursed

Shaytan], and he repeated that three times. Then the enemy of Allah said, Tell me about anything in which you will be saved from me. The Prophet twice said, No, you tell me about something in which you can overpower the son of Adam? Each of them was insisting that the other answer first, then the Prophet said, Allah says, Si cr% rp- ^Certainly, you shall have no authority over My servants, except those of the astray whofallow you.} The enemy of Allah said, heard this before you were even bom. The Prophet said, And Allah says,

p. %\&&p^ u iAnd ifan evil whisper comes to you from Shaytan then seek refuge with AllSh. Verily, He is All-Hearing, All-Knowing} (7:200). By Allah, I never sense that you are near but I seek refuge with Allah from you. The enemy of Allah said, *You have spoken the truth. In this way you will be saved from me. The Prophet said, Tell me in what ways you overpower the son of Adam. He said, T seize him at times of anger and times of desire. iAnd surely, Hell is the place promisedfor them all.} meaning, Hell is the abode designated for all those who follow Iblls, as Allah says in the Qur an: "ii j. .* JK ibut those of the sects (Jews, Christians and all the other non-

Al-Hiir (45-50) (Part-14 448. No sense offatigue shall touch them, nor shall they be asked to leave it. 449. Declare to My servants that I am truly the Forgiving, the Most Merciful . 450. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment. Description ofthe People ofParadise Since Allah mentioned the condition of the people of Hell, He followed that by mentioning the people of Paradise. He tells us that they will dwell in Gardens and water springs. 4/i 4Enter it in peace^ meaning free of all problems. 4and security.} meaning free from all fear and concern. They will not have any fear of expulsion, nor will they fear that their condition will be disrupted or end. >> /< . * # 4And We shall remove any deep feeling of bitternessfrom their breasts. (So they will be like) brothers facing each other on thrones.} Al-Qasim narrated that Abu Umamah said: The people of Paradise will enter Paradise with whatever enmity is left in their hearts from this world. Then, when they come together, Allah will remove whatever hatred the world has left in their hearts. 1 11 Then he recited: 4And We shall remove any deep feeling of bitternessfrom their breasts.} This is how it was narrated in this report, but Al-Qasim bin Abdur-Rahman is weak in his reports from Abu Umamah. However, this is in accord with the report in the Sahih where HI At-Tabari 17:107.

Qatadah says, Abu Al-Mutawakkil An-Naji told us that Abu Said Al-Khudri told them that the Messenger of Allah sg said: 0=? Y)^ J* Iff Sjijijl (*-^ Oif *P**J 'il klJlf jvJUii <^ "^\ Jy-i "The believers will be removed from the Fire, and they will be detained on a bridge between Paradise and Hell. Then judgment will be passed between them concerning any wrong they have committed in this world against one another, until they are cleansed and purified. Then permission will be given to them to enter Paradise.n 111 4No sense of fatigue shall touch them> meaning no harm or hardship, as was reported in the Sahuhs Njj a. oi tiJi o? 1 Sil jt *Allah' commanded me to tell Khadijah the good news of a jeweled palace in Paradise in which there will be no toil and no fatigue, b (*-* ^ inor shall they (ever) be asked to leave it.\$ As was reported in the Hadlth: .y dl Op t ljl 1yj, ji I^ jf dl ! JaI !J : ^ ^ op \yrr> if jp i \Ju\ 1fifra 'ji a tjbi l "/f will be said, O dwellers of Paradise! You will be healthy and never fall sick; you will live and never die; you will be young and never grow old ; you will stay here and never leavefr3 Al-Bukhari no. 6535. ^ Path Al-Bari 7 :166 , Muslim 4 :1887 3| Muslim 4:2182.

Al-Hijr (51-56) (Part-14) Allah says: Oyu V V* ^Wherein they shall dwell (forever) . They will have no desire to be removed from it.} (18:108) '-' .< x 5 , ; . t '.A y** J'J ^Declare to My servants, that I am truly the Oft-Forgiving, the Most Merciful. And that My torment is indeed the most painful torment.} meaning, O Muhammad, tell My servants that I am the source of mercy and I am the source of punishment. Similar Ayat to this have already been quoted above, which indicate that we must always be in a state between hope (for Allah s mercy) and fear (of His punishment). n" .jx&jjp Li ^J IS ijJLSi I,j jl 'f -J' > * -J ' / > ^ ^ ^ , Jli{p J1) ^ ^JIS)W[z jJ I3--0'^ -r v yu jii iljji yui ijtj ji .juu> ^ jjli -*t" ^ r~="3" ^ Jli fgj.jJe ^iu 1 Jr? c>; l"-i; (j'j Jli ' ^OS^jJl Vi iS*JI{ 4S;^juji . And tell them about the guests (i.e., the angels) of Ibrahim.} 452. When they entered upon him, and said: Saldman (peace!)." He said: Indeed we arefrightened ofyou."}

453. They said: "Do not be afraid! We bring you the good news of a boy possessing much knowledge and wisdom."} 454. He said: "Do you give me this good news while old age has overtaken me? Of what then is your news about? } 455. They said: "We give you good news in truth. So do not be of those who despair."} 456. He said: "And who despairs of the mercy of his lord except those who are astray? } The Guests of Ibrahim and their Good News of a Son for Him Allah is saying: Tell them, O Muhammad, about the story of the guests of Ibrahim.} 4they entered upon him, and said: "Saldman (peace!)." He said: "Indeed we arefrightened ofyou."} meaning that they were scared. The reason for their fear has been mentioned previously, which is that they noticed that these guests did not eat of the food that was offered, which was a fattened calf. ij~ 1 4They said: "Do not be afraid!..."} meaning, do not be scared. 4We bring you the good news of a boy possessing much knowledge and wisdom.} this refers to Ishaq, as was previously mentioned in Surat Hud. Then 4He said} meaning he spoke with wonder and astonishment, asking for confirmation, because he was old and his wife was old:

4Do you give me this good news while old age has overtaken me? Of what then is your news about?} They responded by confirming the good news they had brought, good news after good news: o; iThey said: We give you good news in truth. So do not be of those who despair."} 457. He said: What then is the business for which you have come, O messengers?"} 458. They said: We have been sent to a guilty people."} 459. "(All) except the family of Lut, all of whom we are to save (from the destruction)." } 460. "Except for his wife, of whom We have IJ1 decreed that she shall be of those who remain behind."} The Reason why the Angels came Allah tells us that after Ibrahim had calmed down from the excitement of this good news, he started to ask them why they had come to him. They said, dl taj \} 4We have been sent to a guilty people.} meaning the people of Lut. They told him that they were going to save the family of Lot from among those people, except for his wife, because she was one of those who were doomed. Thus it was said, yavs&& *> l 1 * Qaddamd meaning, we have determined is interpreted by the scholars of Tafsir as it has been translated. They say that the angels speak in this form because of their closeness to Allah, a status of which other creatures do not have the honor. See the Tafsir of Af-Tabari

lii- [yjdj -l3 Sij ^ J ji"A" jA> jj'i' ilU, i \Loijf#; in of 465. "Then travel for a portion of the night with your family, and you go behind them in the rear, and let no one amongst you look back, but go on to where you are ordered."} 466. And We made this decree known to him that those (sinners) would be rooted out in the early morning.} Lut is ordered to leave with His Family during the Night Allah tells us

that His angels ordered Lut to set out after part of the night had passed. They told him to walk behind them, to protect them. Similarly, the Messenger of Allah would walk in the rear of the army on military campaigns, order to help the weak and carry those who had no means transport. 453 pB-vt %} iand let no one amongst you look back,} meaning - when you hear the people screaming from thjeir torment, do not turn around to look at them; leave them face whatever punishment and vengeance is coming to them ibut go on to where you are ordered.} - it is as if they had a guide with them to show them the way. ij\ i 4And We made this decree known to him} meaning - We already told him about that. 4^ %&} ithat those (sinners) would be rooted out in the early morning.} meaning in the morning, as in another Ayah. 4Indeed, morning is their appointed time. Is not the morning near?} [11:81] to

406 Tafoir Ibn Kathir % Vi Jtt j-lf #3 if^# 4 -J>: \$ ju \$t% Z >^+""i (^l 467. And the inhabitants of the city came rejoicing.} 466. [Lilt] said: "Verily, these are my guests, so do not shame me. } 469. "And have Taqwd ofAllah, and do not disgrace me. } 470. They said: Did we not forbid you from entertaining any of the Alamin? } 471. [Lilt] said: "These are my daughters, if you must act (so)."} 472. Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.} The People ofthe City arriveupon the Angels, thinking that they areMen Allah tells us about how Lut s people came to him when they found out about his handsome guests, and they came happily rejoicing about them. 4[Lut] said: "Verily, these are my guests, so do not shame me. And have Taqwd ofAllah, and do not disgrace me. } This is what Lot said to them before he knew that his guests were messengers from Allah, as mentioned in Surat Hud, but here (in this Surah), we have already been told that they are messengers from Allah, and this is followed by an account of Lot's people coming and his exchange with them. However, here the conjunction {wa, meaning and) does not imply the sequence of events, especially since there is something to indicate that this is not the case. They said answering him, 4Did we notforbid youfrom entertaining (or protecting) any of the 'Alamin?} meaning, did we not tell you that you should not have anyone

as a guest? He reminded them about their womenfolk and of an what their Lord had created for them in the women permissible sexual relationships. This issue has already belen explained and is no need to repeat the discussion here. of this happened while they were still unaware of inevitable calamity and punishment that was about to befall them the following morning. Hence Allah, may He be exalted, said to Muhammad \$sg, ^J 4Verily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.} Allah swore by the life of His Prophet jg, which is immense honor reflecting his high rank and noble status. Amr bin Malik An-Nakari reported from Abu Al-Jawza that Han Abbas said: Allah has never created or made or formed aay soul that is dearer to him than Muhammad jg. I never heard that Allah swore by the life of anyone else. Allah says, iVerily, by your life, in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.} meaning, by your life and the length ofyour stay in this worj 4in their wild intoxication, they were wandering blindly.}^ This was reported by Ibn Jarir. Qatadah said: iin their wild intoxication} It means - in their misguided state;l 4they were wandering blindly} means - they were playing. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: d, * ! * See the Tafsirof SurahHud. At-Tabari 17:118. At-Tabari 17:119.

Al-Hiir (73-77) (Part-14) down, and stones of baked clay [As-SijjU) raining down upon them. The discussion of As-SijjU in Surah Hud is a sufficient explanation. Allah said: iSurely, in this are signsfor

those who see.} meaning that the traces of the destruction of that city are easily visible to any one who ponder about it, whether they look at it with physical eyesight or mental and spiritual insight, as Mujahid said concerning the phrase. {those who see} he said, those who have insight and discernment. It was reported from Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak that it referred to those who look.² * Qatadah said: those who learn lessons. ' iU&A } {those who see} therefore the meaning is those who ponder . The City of Sodom on the Highroad ⁴And verily, they were right on the highroad.} meaning that the city of Sodom, which was physically and spiritually turned upside down, and pelted with stones until it became a foul smelling lake (the Dead Sea), is on a route that is easily accessible until the present day. This is like the Ayah, ⁴Verily, you pass by them in the morning, and at night. Will you not then reflect?} (37:137-138). Tabari 17:120. ' At-Tabari 17:121. ' At-Tabari 17:121.

⁴ {if illi j i Surely, there is indeed a sign in that for the believers.) meaning, All that We did to the people of Lut, from the destruction and the vengeance, to how We saved Lut and his family, these are clear signs to those who believe in Allah and His Messengers. ⁴⁷⁸. And the Dwellers of Al-Aykah, were also wrongdoers.) ⁴⁷⁹. So, We took vengeance on them. They are both on an open route, plain to see.) The Destruction of the Dwellers of Al-Aykah, the People of Shu'ayb The Dwellers of Al-Aykah, were the people of Shu'ayb. Ad- Dahhak, Qatadah and others said that Al-Aykah refers to intertwined trees * Their evil doing included associating partners with Allah (Shirky, banditry and cheating in weights and measures. Allah punished them with the Sayhah (the awful cry or torment), the earthquake, and the torment of the Day of Shadow.¹²¹ They lived near the people of Lut, but at a later time, and the people of Lut were known to them, which is why Allah says, {They are both on an open route, plain to see.) Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak and others said, a visible route. ¹³¹ This is why, when Shu'ayb warned his people, he said to them, {And the people of Lut are not far off from you!} [1 1:89] I Jt Jabari 17:125. |2) At-Tabari 17:125.

{if tiP C /. g jcu fuf' "io ⁴⁸⁰. And verily, the Dwellers of Al-Hijr denied the Messengers.> ⁴⁸¹ . And We gave them Our signs, but they were averse to them.} ⁴⁸². And they used to hew out dwellings from the mountains, (feeling) secure.} ⁴⁸³ . But the Sayhah (torment - awful cry) overtook them in the early morning.} And all that they used to earn availed them not.} The Destruction of the Dwellers of Al-Hijr, Who are the People called Thamud The Dwellers of the Al-Hijr were the people of Thamud who rejected their Prophet, Salih. Whoever denies even one Messenger, then he has disbelieved in all of the Messengers, thus they are described as rejecting the Messengers . Allah tells us that he (Salih) brought them signs to prove that what he was telling them was true, such as the she-camel which Allah created for them out of a solid rock in response to the supplication of Salih. This she-camel was grazing on their lands, and the people and the camel took water on alternate days that were well-known. When they rebelled and killed it, he said to them, Ji- ⁴"Enjoy yourselves in your homes for three days. This is a promise which will not be belied."} (1 1:65) Allah said: its \$ " ² &;} ⁴And as for Thamud, We showed them and made the path of truth clear but they preferred blindness to guidance.} [41:17] Allah tells us that, JLi f

⁴And they used to hew out dwellings from the mountains, (feeling) secure.} meaning, they were without fear and they had no real need for those houses; it was merely a form of extravagance and work without a purpose. This could be seen from their work in the houses in the Al-Hijr through which the

Messenger of Allah jg passed on his way to Tabuk. He covered his head and urged his camel to go faster, saying to his Companions: ty M^ j i (tf\ iJJ.i v" p At jf Do not enter the dwellings of those who were punished unless you are weeping, and if you do not weep then make yourself weep out offear that perhaps what struck them may also strike yoM-B 1 4But the Sayhah (torment - awful cry) overtook them in the early morning.} meaning in the morning of the fourth day. ZfSb IX \S 4And all that they used to earn availed them not.} meaning all of the benefits that they used to gain from their crops and fruits, and the water which they did not want to share with the she-camel that they killed so that it would not reduce their share of the water - all of that wealth would not protect them or help them when the command of their Lord came to pass. CJ4; Cy u\ luU- Iaj} 485. And We did not create the heavens and the earth and all that is between them except with the truth, and the Hour is surely coming, so overlook their faults with gracious forgiveness.} 486. Verily, your Lord is the Knowing Creator.} IM Ahmad 2 :91

The World hasbeen created for some Purpose, then the Hour willcome Allah says, ^ Vi Cj i {And We did not create the heavens and the earth and all that is between them except with the truth, and the Hour is surely coming}, i.e., with justice to - Q \& 'S {requite those who do evil with that which they have done [53:31] Allah says, Si 'jf*' U& S-j* \}/& iwM S "stti L^> tA*j sU' tili- {And We did not create the heaven and the earth, and all that is between them without purpose! That is what those who disbelieve think! Then let those who disbelieve be warned of the Fire!}(38:27) v Jtff 30 if v t4[pS { Did you think that We created you in play, and that you would not be brought back to Us?" So exalted be Allah, the Truth, the King, none has the right to be worshipped but He, the Lord of the Honored 7?irone/^(23:115-116). Then Allah informed His Prophet jg about the Hour, and that it will be the faults of the idolators when they insult him and reject the Message that he brings to them. This is like thi Ayah, / Jib,* > I*, 'f'frV Or-" pi- J"j fr {So him away from them, and say: "Saldm (Peace!)."} But , they will come to know} (43:89). i Mujahid, Qatadah and others said: This was before fighting was prescribed . It is as they said, because this Surah was revealed in Makkah and fightingwas prescribed after the Hijrah

iVerily, your lord is the Knowing Creator)!15:86). This is a confirmation of the Day of Resurrection and that Allah, may He be exalted, is able to bring the Hour to pass. He is the Creator and nothing is beyond Him. He is the Knowing, Who knows what has been dispersed from people s bodies and scattered throughout the regions of the earth, as He says: o&' j*j ck .hi J ..ju 'i&z g % jj; j in,4 Tii ,:ji] U[jjiy not He, Who created the heavens and the earth able to create the like of them? Yes, indeed! He is the Knowing, Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, "Be! - and it is! So glorified and exalted is He above all that they associate with Him, and in whose Hands is the dominion of all things, and to Him you shall return.>(36:81-83). 4,87. And indeed, We have bestowed upon you seven of the MathaniP1 and the Grand Qur'an .) 488. Look not with your eyes ambitiously at what We have given to certain classes of them, nor grieve over them. And lower your wings to the believers.) A Reminder of the Blessing of the Qur an and the Command to focus on its Message Allah is saying to His Prophet Since We have given you the Grand Qur an, then do not look at this world and its attractions, or the transient delights that we have given to its people in order to test them. Do not envy what they have in this world, and do not upset yourself with regret for their m Ma.th6.nimeans often recited

rejection of you and their opposition to your religion. iAttd lower your wings to the believers who follow you} (26:215) meaning - be gentle with them, like the Ayah, Jai> iVerily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves. It grieves him that you should receive any injury or difficulty. He is anxious for you, for the believers - he is full of pity, kind and merciful}(9:28). There were some differences among the scholars over the meaning of seven of the Mathani . Ibn Mas'ud, Ibn Umar, Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ad-Dahhak and others said that they are the seven long (Surahs), meaning Al-Baqarah, Al- Imran, An-Nisa , Al-Ma idah, Al-An am, Al-A raf and Yunus. There are texts to this effect reported from Ibn Abbas and Said bin Jubayr. Said said: In them, Allah explains the obligations, the Hudud (legal limits), stories and rulings. Ibn Abbas said, He explains the parables, stories and lessons. 111 The second opinion is that they (the seven of the Mathani) are Al-Fatihah, which is composed of seven Ayat. This was reported from Ali, Umar, Ibn Mas'ud and Ibn Abbas. Ibn Abbas said: The Bismillah, is completing seven Ayah, which Allah has given exclusively to you (

416 Tafsir Ibn Kathir was praying. He called out for me but I did not come until I finished my prayer. Then I came to him, and He asked, j l iLLu La What stopped you from coming to me?* I said, T was praying . He said, Jii ji; " Did not Allah say k i C *if \$s> iO you who believe! Answer Allah (by obeying Him) and (His) Messenger when he calls you . . ?> [8:24] 4* J l IjA j>- \ o! Jj Jjj (jiii- \ viLili-f 'if Shall I not teach you the most magnificent Surah before I leave the Masjid?# Then the Prophet went to leave the Masjid, and I reminded him, so he said, ?dli)' v _y 4j l 4 Al-Hamdu Lillahi Rabbil-'Alamin [All praises and thanks be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists]}{1:2). jlijl ili^ *This is the seven of the Mathani and the Qur'an which I have been given.* (The second Hadith) was reported from Abu Hurayrah who said that the Messenger of Allah^ said: jTjiilj "Umm Al-Qur'an (the Mother or the Essence of the Qur'an,) is the seven Mathani, and the Grand Qur'an. n 1 This means that Al-Fatihah is the seven Mathani and the Grand Qur'an, but this does not contradict the statement that the seven Mathani are the seven long Surahs, because they also share these attributes, as does the whole Qur'an. As Allah m Path Al-Bari 8 :232

417 Sural: 15. Al-Hiir (89-93) (Part-14 says, a% iAllah has sent down the best statement, a Book (this Qur'an), its parts resembling each other in goodness and truth, oft- recited) (39:23). So it is oft-recited in one way, and its parts resemble one another in another way, and this is also the Grand Qur'an. 4J44 * C d[V& 1) iLook not with your eyes ambitiously at what We have given to certain classes of them) [20:131] meaning, be content with the Grand Qur'an that Allah has given to you, and do not long for the luxuries and transient delights that they have. iLook not with your eyes ambitiously) Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: He [in this Ayah forbade a man to wish for what his companion has. ' iat what We have given to certain classes of them,) Mujahid said: This refers to the rich. j'vji* <> 0 X3T jffj\ bl fa) 489. And say (O Muhammad): "I am indeed a plain wamer.") 490. As We have sent down on the Muqtasimin (conspiring confederates),) 491 . Who have made the Qur'an into parts.) 492. So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account.) 493 . For all that they used to do.) Al-Tabari 17:141. Al-Tabari 17:141.

418 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Messenger jg is a Plain Warner Allah commanded His Prophet jg to tell the people: 41 am indeed a plain wamer} coming to warn the people of a severe punishment that they will suffer if they reject him, as happened to those nations before them who disbelieved in their Messengers,

upon whom Allah sent His punishment and vengeance. In the two Sahihs it is reported from Abu Musa that the Prophet ﷺ said: $\text{cjtj yi ! : JUi \ 4i -di I U AAjS ^jA apQati jjljl Ul c j~? OjjS j ^ ja * \j2iaj\j At O-i*- La if J~* jv^Lali If ii '^J (jjLi*- Jlij "77i(?}$ parable of myself and that with which Allah has sent me is that of a man who came to his people and said, O people! I have seen the [invading] army with my own eyes, and I am a naked warmer, so escape, escape!' Some of his people obeyed him and set out at nightfall, setting off at a slow pace and managing to escape. Others did not believe him and stayed where they were until the next morning when the [invading] army overtook them and destroyed them, wiping them out. This is the parable of the one who obeys me and follows what I have brought, and the example of the one who disobeys me and rejects the truth that I have brought. Explanation of Al-Muqtasimin 4the Muqtasimm} refers to those who had made a pact to oppose, deny, and insult the Prophets. Similarly, Allah tells us about the people of Salih: $\text{^ JcOjj ait ts yu^ I 1 * FathAl-Bari 13:264, Muslim 4:1788.}$

iThey said, Swear to one another [Taqdsamu] by Allah that we shall make a secret night attack on him and his household [27:49] i.e., they plotted to kill him at night. Mujahid said Taqdsamu means they swore an oath." 4And they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up one who dies^(16:38). $\text{ui \yjs= 4(11 will be said): Did you not before swear that you would not leave (the world for the Hereafter)}\}$ (14:44) they those, of whom you swore that Allah would never show them mercy}[7:49] It is as if they took an oath for every single thing that they denied in this world, so they are called the Muqtasimin. 4Who have made the Qur'an into parts.} meaning, they have split up the Books that were revealed to them, believing in parts of them and rejecting parts of them. Al-Bukhari reported that Ibn Abbas said, $\text{4'-^~tt 4Who have made the Qur'an into parts.}$ They are the People of the Book, who divided the Book into parts, believing in some of it, and rejecting some of it. 111 Some have said that Al-Mutaqasimin refers to the Quraysh, that the Qur'an means this Qur'an [as opposed to the Scriptures of the People of the Book], and that made it into parts referred to what Ata said that some of them said that he (the Prophet ﷺ) was a sorcerer, some said he was crazy, or a soothsayer. These various allegations were the parts. This Fath Al-Bari 8 :233

420 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr opinion was also reported from Ad-Dahhak and others. Muhammad bin Ishaq reported from Ibn Abbas that Al- Walid bin Al-Mughlah - holding a noble position among the people - rallied a group of Quraysh behind him when Al- Mawsim (the time for pilgrims to meet in Makkah for Hajj) had come. He said to them, O people of Quraysh! The time of Al- Mawsim has come, and delegations of Arabs will come to you during this time. They will have heard some things about this companion of yours (meaning the Prophet ﷺ), so agree on one opinion, let there be no contradicting or denials of each other's sayings. They said, And you, O Abu Abd Shams, give us an opinion and we will say that. He said, No, you make the suggestions and I will listen. They said, We say he is a soothsayer. He said, He is not a soothsayer. They said, We say he is crazy. He said, He is not crazy. They said, We say he is a poet. He said, He is not a poet. They said, We say he is a sorcerer. He said, He is not a sorcerer. They said, So what should we say? He said, By Allah, what he says is as palatable (to the average person) as something sweet, so you cannot say anything against it without it being obviously false. Therefore the most appropriate thing you can say is that he is a sorcerer. So they left having agreed upon that, and Allah revealed concerning them: iWho have made the Qur'an into parts> meaning, of different types, and 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For

all that they used to do> Those were the group who said that about the Messenger of Allah jg. iSo, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.\$ 111 Sirah Ibn Hisham, 1 :288. This narration is not authentic due to one of the narrators being unknown

Al-Hiir (94-99) (Part-14) Abu Ja'far reported from Ar-Rabl that Abu Al- Aliyah said, All the people will be asked about two things on the Day of Resurrection: what they used to worship, and what their response was to the Messengers. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, ds;;& 4So, by your Lord, We shall certainly call all of them to account. For all that they used to do.} then he said: A *M 1 r asos&s nv - s's"" ' -.r >'***' + '.H ' 'l'" A"iJuujjV'y >. 0 3&JLfrtj wcm\m jf i.P'ot >"^ on that Day no question will be asked of man or jinn as to his sin (55:39). He said, They will not be asked, T you do such and such? Because Allah knows better than they do about that. But He will say, *Why did you do such and such? 494. Therefore openly proclaim what you have been Tabari 17:150. At-Tabari 17:150.

422 Tahir Ibt Kathir commanded, and turn away from the idolators.> 495. Truly, We will suffice you against the mockers,) 496. Who make another god along with Allah; but they will come to know .fr 497. Indeed, We know that your breast becomes tight because of what they say.) 498. So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those who prostrate themselves (to Him).) 499. And worship your Lord until the certainty (i.e. death) comes to you.) The Command to proclaim the Truth openly Allah commanded His Messenger to convey what He sent him with, to proclaim and spread the Message, which means confronting the idolators with it. Ibn Abbas said that the Ayah, 4% U,) 4Therefore openly proclaim that what you have been commanded,) means, Go ahead with it. 111 According to another report it means, Therefore proclaim that which you commanded. Mujahid said, It is reciting the Qur an aloud during prayer. 121 Abu TJBaydah reported that Abdullah bin MasTkd said, The Prophet jg was still practicing and preaching Islam secretly until this Ayah was revealed: 4s\$W Z) 4Therefore openly proclaim that which you are commanded) then he and his Companions came out into the open. Tabari 17:151.Tabari 17:151.Tabari 17:152.

Al-Hijr (94-99) (Part-14) The Command to turn away from the Idolators, and the Guarantee of Protection against the Mockers Allah s statement, iand turn away from idolators. Truly, We will suffice you against the mockers.) meaning - convey that which has been revealed to you by your Lord, and do not pay attention to the idolators who want to turn you away from the signs of Allah. t-L iA* J) iThey wish that you should compromise for them, so that they would compromise for you) (68:9). Do not fear them because Allah will suffice you against them, and He will protect you from them. This is like the Ayah: .< <- i// . - aJL-j ..l.iil; li 40 Messenger! Proclaim that which has been revealed to you from your Lord. And if you do not do it, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind.) [5:67] Muhammad bin Ishaq said: The great ones of the mockers were five people, who were elders and noblemen among their people. From Banl Asad bin Abd Al-TJzza bin Qusayy there was Al-Aswad bin Al-Muttalib Abu Zam ah. According to what I heard, the Messenger of Allah (s^) had supplicated against him because of the pain and mockery he had suffered at his hands. He sg| had said, aojJJ ^S-\ 1 3 "0 Allah, make him blind and take (the life of) his son. From Ban! Zahrah there was Al-Aswad bin Abd Yaghuth bin Wahb bin Abd Manaf bin Zahrah. From Banl Makhzum there was Al-Walld bin Al-Mughlrah bin Abdullah bin Umar bin Makhzum. From Banl Sahm bin Amr bin Husays bin Ka*b bin

Encouragement to bear Difficulties, and the Command

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2965–2967]

to glorify and worship Allah until Death Allah said, Si -> 4* Cr** a*. 4Indeed We know that your breast becomes tight because of what they say. So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those who prostrate themselves (to Him).} meaning We know, O Muhammad, that you are distressed by their insults towards you, but do not let that weaken your resolve or cause you to give up conveying the Message of Allah. Put your trust in Him, for He will suffice you and will support you against them. Keep yourself busy with remembering Allah, praising Him, glorifying Him, and worshipping Him (which means Salah, or prayer) Hence Allah says: S;& -PiQpb }So glorify the praises of your Lord and be of those who prostrate themselves (to Him)} Imam Ahmad reported from Nu'aym bin Hammar that he heard the Messenger of Allah say: u'jA iusl o "Allah said, O son of Adam! It is not too difficult for you to perform four Rak'dt at the beginning of the day, (and if you do them,) I will take care of you until the end of it." iJi JDt Xl\j} iAnd worship your Lord until the certainty comes to you} (15:99). Al-Bukhari said: Salim said, (This means) death. 12 ' This Ahmad 5:286. Al-Bari 8:235.

= 2 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Salim is Salim bin Abdullah bin 'Umar. Ibn Jarir also recorded from Salim bin Abdullah, jLj JLtt,} iAnd worship your Lord until the Yaqm comes to you.} He said, Death. 111 It is reported in the Sahih from Umm Al- Ala - one of the women of the Ansar - that when the Messenger of Allah ^ entered upon Uthman bin Maz*un after he had died, Umm Al- Ala said, May the mercy of Allah be upon you, Abu As-Sa ib. My testimony over you is that Allah has honored you. The Messenger of Allah^ said, 2 ! iiiji; How do you know that Allah has honored him? I said, May my father and mother be sacrificed for you, Messenger of Allah! If not him, then who else? He said, djliJl Jlii y* lif "As far as he is concerned, the death has come to him, and I hope for good for him ."121 This is evidence that the meaning of this Ayah, iAnd worship your Lord until the certainty comes to you.} is that acts of worship, such as prayer and the like, are obligatory on man so long as his mind is sound, so he should pray according to his best ability. It was reported in Sahih Al-Bukhari from Imran bin Husayn jfe that the Messenger of Allah^ said: p 0-LfrUi jU jji i Uili oPray standing, and if you cannot, then sitting, and if you cannot, then on your side. From this we may understand that it is a mistake to interpret Yaqui (the certainty) as Ma'rifah (spiritual knowing) At-Jabari 17:160. FathAl-Bdri 3:137. FathAl-Bdri 2:684.

Al-Hijr (94-99) (Part-14) as some of the Sufis do. According to them, when one of them attains the level of Ma'rifah, they consider him to be free of these obligations. This is disbelief, misguidance and ignorance. The Prophets - peace be upon them - and their companions, were the most knowledgeable of people about Allah, about His rights. His attributes, and the glorification that He deserves. But at the same time, they were the people who worshipped Him the most, continuing in good deeds until the time they died. Therefore, what is meant by Vdqm here is death, as we have stated above. To Allah be praise and thanks. Praise be to Allah for His guidance. It is to Him that we turn for help and it is in Him that we put our trust. He is the One Whom we ask to help us to reach the best of circumstances, for He is the Most Generous and Kind. This is the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Hijr. Praise be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.

Module 18

Surah 16: An-Nahl

Surah 16: An-Nahl

PDF pages 2968–3089

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 2968]

Opening 428 Tafsir Von Kathir The Tafsir of Surat An-Nahl (Chapter - 16) Which was revealed in Makkah \$ *- In the Name of Allah, the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful. * **\$3 41. The Event ordained by Allah has indeed come, so do not seek to hasten it. Glorified and Exalted be He above all that they associate as partners with Him .}

Warning about the approach of the Hour

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 2968–3000]

Allah is informing about the approach of the Hour in the past tense [in Arabic] in order to confirm that it will undoubtedly come to pass. This is like the following Ayat, in which the verbs appear in the past tense in Arabic: 4SY ' * .. . i', ' iMankind's reckoning has drawn near them, while they turn away in heedlessness.^[21:1] 4The Hour has drawn near, and the moon has been cleft.} [54:1] \$} 4so do not seek to hasten it.} means, what was far is now near, so do not try to rush it. As Allah said, - ^ w ft9? u\j And they ask you to listen the torment (for them), and had it not been for a term appointed, the torment would certainly have

come to them. And surely, it will come upon them suddenly while they are unaware! They ask you to hasten on the torment. And verily! Hell, of a surety, will encompass the disbelievers (29:53-54). Ibn Abi Hatim reported from TjQbah bin Amir that the Messenger of Allah jg said: Jly ui JI apIzJI xp JU jJS !> m# t; :i" 3e: ^ tuui j u j" Wj : If* p4M r**- j jLl t j4AJ p < ""; _ Jt U Wfien the Hour approaches, a black cloud resembling a shield will emerge upon front the west. It will continue rising in the sky, then a voice will call out, 'O mankind!' The people will say to one another, 'Did you hear that?' Some will say, 'yes', but others will doubt it. Then a second call will come, 'O mankind!' The people will say to one another, 'Did you hear that?' And they will say, 'Yes.' Then a third call will come, 'O mankind!' The Event ordained by Allah has indeed come, so do not seek to hasten if The Messenger of Allah sg said: f\ jji i Ijbi C\jjh, l"j jty -...) j!\ tjj t oJLj ^ . " 1 ^ ~ Ijbl L"J AI3U J\ kjjJ fc Ijji It..J Uj ijAo .l (Jb "Bi/ the One in Whose Hand is my soul, two men will spread out a cloth, but will never refold it; a man will prepare his trough, but will never water his animals from it; and a man will milk his camel, but will never drink the milk. Then he said, "The people will be distracted. ^ Then Allah tells us that He is free from their allegations of partners to their worship of idols, and making equals for Him. Glorified and exalted be He far above that. These are the people who deny the Hour, so He says: 111 Al-HS kim 4 : 539

iAffA Hi #*;^)^Glorified and Exalted be He above all that they associate as partners with Him.) \$ ^ VA J "jCs & *&&& it i2. He sends down the angels with the Ruh (revelation) ofHis command to those servants of His whom He wills (saying): "Warn mankind that none has the right to be worshipped but I, so have Taqwa ofMe.") Allah sends Whomever He wills with the Message of Tawhtd i&A &> iHe sends down the angels with the Ruh) refers to the revelation. This is like theAyah by in.A iAnd thus We have sent to you a Rfth (revelation) by Our command. You knew not what is the Book, nor what is the faith. But We have made it a light by which We guide whomever We will among Our servants.) (43:52) in 4S"* " 4to those servants of His whom He wills) meaning the Prophets, as Allah says: iAllah best knows where to place His Message.) [6:124] iAllah chooses Messengers from angels and from men.) (22:751

4He sends the Ruh (revelation) by His command to whoever among His servants He wills to, that he may warn of the Day of Meeting. The Day when they will (all) come out, nothing about them will be hidden from Allah. Whose is the kingdom this Day?: It is Allah's, the One, the Irresistible!} (40:15-16) i(saying) : Warn..."} meaning that they should alert them. ithat none has the right to be worshipped but I, so have Taqwd ofMe.} means, fear My punishment, if you go against My commands and worship anything other than Me. j < >- - i " 43. He has created the heavens and the earth with truth. High is He, Exalted above all that they associate as partners with Him.} 44. He has created man from a NutfahJ then behold, this same (man) becomes an open opponent.} Allah is the One Who has created the Heavens, the Earth, andMan Allah tells us about His creation of the upper realm, which is the heavens, and the lower realm, which is the earth, and everything in them. They have been created for a true purpose, not in vain, so that 4# hk t \jd -S 4He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done (i.e. punish them in Hell), and reward those who do good, Drop of sperm.

with what is best (i.e. Paradise).} [53:31] Then He declares Himself to be above the Shirk of those whoworship others besides Him. He is independent of His creation, alone with no partner or associate. For this reason He deserves to be worshipped Alone, without partners. Then Hementions how man has been created from a Nutfah, i.e., something that is insignificant, weak and has no value - but when man becomes independent and is able to fend for himself - then he begins to dispute with his Lord, may He be exalted, and disbelieves in Him and fights His Messengers. Butman was created to be a servant, not an opponent, as Allah says: S<>->> & jjuff Sj %} iAnd it is He Who has created manfrom water, and gave him descendants, and made Him kindred by marriage, and your Lord is capable (of all things). And they worship besides Allah, that which can neither profit them nor harm them; and the disbeliever is ever a helper (of Shaytdn) against his Lord (25:54-55). And; & 13 y \$ ijSL jk) fj-* Jj^ hlil ZsJii Ji Oi iSSSL i3 y \$} 6 (fy y Jli faii- iDoes not man see that We have created himfrom Nutfah. Yet, behold he stands as an open opponent. And he putsforthfor Us a parable, and forgets his own creation. He says: "Who will give life to these bones after they are rotten and have become dust?" Say: "He will give life to them Who created them the first time! And He is the knower of every creature!"} (36:77- Imam Ahmad and Ibn Majah reported that Busr bin Jahhash said: The Messenger of Allah spat in his palm, then he said,

^ "*" ^ JI i? :> il j*^s=6j2 Jri . - .y. \ ^j- .t r> -j # 'jjf - ; , > ,> JI- j* ^a!> ^LA-LO "JAZjy~* IS] V 0AS JI:s>; ^^ ' -x x - " x , ' # X * O.<>>* i JU"j 2Ju- : dii f ^iiAii oiL; iii Ji jljf ijjLjali uAllah, may He be

exalted, says : O son of Adam, how could you be more powerful than 1 when I have created you from something like this, and when I have fashioned you perfectly and made you complete, you walk wearing your tzvo garments and the earth makes a sound (beneath your feet). You collect money but do not give anything to anyone, then when the soul of a dying person reaches the throat, you say, 'I want to give in charity', but it is too late for clarity. (40:77) And the cattle, He has created them for you ; in them there is warmth (warm clothing), and numerous benefits, and you eat from them. (2:166) And there is beauty in them for you, when you bring them Ahmad 2 :410 , Ibn Majah 2 :903

animals for all kinds of purposes, for riding and for carrying loads, as Allah says: (23:21-22) And verily, there is indeed a lesson for you in the An'am (cattle). We give you to drink (milk) of that which is in their bellies. And there are numerous (other) benefits in them for you. Of them you eat, and on them and on ships you are carried.) (23:21-22) Allah, it is He Who has made cattle for you, so that some you may ride, and some you may eat. And you find (many other) benefits in them; you may reach by their means a desire that is in your breasts (i.e. carry your goods, loads), and on them and on ships you are carried. And He shows you His Ayat. Which, then of the Ayat of Allah do you deny?) (40:79-81). Thus here Allah says, after enumerating these blessings, (40:79-81) meaning, your Lord is the One Who has subjugated the An'am (cattle) to you. This is like the Ayat: 'And He shows you His Ayat. Which, then of the Ayat of Allah do you deny?' (40:79-81). Do they not see, that of what Our Hands have created, We created the An'am (cattle) for them, so that they may own them, and We subdued them so that they may ride some and they may eat some. (36:71-72).

And He made mounts for you out of ships and cattle. In order that you may ride on their backs, and may then remember the favor of your Lord when you mount upon them, and say: "Glory be to the One Who subjected this to us, and we could never have it (by our efforts). And verily, to Our Lord we indeed are to return!" (43:12-14) Ibn Abbas said, 'In them there is warmth refers to clothing; and numerous benefits' refers to the ways in which they derive the benefits of food and drink from them. (43:12-14) And (He has created) horses, mules and donkeys for you to ride, and as an adornment. And He creates (other) things of which you have no knowledge. This refers to another category of animals that Allah has created as a blessing for His servants; horses, mules and donkeys, all of which He made for riding and adornment. This is the main purpose for which these animals were created. It was reported in the Two Sahihahs that Jabir bin Abdullah said: The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) forbade us to eat the meat of domestic donkeys, but he allowed us to eat the meat of horses. Imam Ahmad and Abu Dawud reported with two chains of narration, each of which meet the conditions of Muslim, that Jabir said: On the day of Khaybar we slaughtered horses, mules and donkeys. The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) forbade us from eating the mules and donkeys, but he did not forbid us from eating the horses. According to Sahih Muslim, Asma bint Abi Bakr (may Allah be pleased with them both) said: At the time of the Messenger (ﷺ) At-Jabari 17:168. Fath Al-Bari 9 :570 , Muslim 3 :1541 ' Ahmad 3:356,362, Abu Dawud 4:149, 151.

An-Nahl (9) (Part-14) of Allah we slaughtered a horse and ate it when we were in Al-Madinah. (9:14) And it is up to Allah to show the right way. But there are ways that stray. And had He

willed, He would have guided you all.} Explanation of the Different Religious Paths When Allah mentioned the animals which may be used for the purpose of physical journeys, He also referred to the moral, religious routes that people may follow. Often in the Qur'an there is a shift from physical or tangible things to beneficial spiritual and religious matters, as when Allah says, j'rt ji. } iAnd take a provision (with you) for the journey, but the best provision is Taqwa (piety, righteousness).} [2:197] And, 40 Children of Adam! We have granted clothing for you to cover yourselves, as well as for adornment; but the raiment of righteousness, that is better.} [7:26] Since Allah mentioned cattle and other such animals in this Surah, all of which are ridden or can be used in any way necessary, carrying people's necessities for them to distant places and on difficult journeys - then He mentions the ways which people follow to try to reach Him, and explains that the right way is the one that does reach Him. He says: 4i Jej} iAnd it is up to Allah to show the right way.} This is like the Ayat, cA lAr5 Ar'^ 'it. \$j} iAnd verily, this is My straight path, so follow it, and do not m Muslim 3 : 1541

4If your Lord had willed, then all who are in the earth would have believed.} (10:99) Kijj |'y J* V) l>*Q* jft lily ili 4 owrl oVIV iLK" ol 4A"d if your Lord had so willed, He could surely, have made humanity one Ummah, but they will not stop disagreeing. Except those for whom your Lord has granted mercy. And it is for this that He did create them; and the Word of your Lord has been fulfilled (i.e. His saying) : "Surely, I shall fill Hell with Jinn and men all together."} (11:118-119). iiSAim ja k& ft t'A 'ft > Cftft fxi + ft 420. He it is Who sends water down from the sky; from it you drink and from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.} 422. With it He causes crops to grow for you, the olives, the date palms, the grapes, and every kind of fruit. Verily, in this there is indeed an evident proof and a manifest sign for people who give thought.} The Blessings of Rain, and explaining how it is one of the Signs When Allah mentions the blessings of cattle and other animals that He has granted mankind, He then mentions how He has blessed them by sending rain down from the sky above, which has been fulfilling the needs and bringing joy to people and their cattle. Allah says: 4 i j3> ifrom it you drink} meaning, He made it fresh and pure so that they can drink it, not salty and undrinkable. iand from it (grows) the vegetation on which you send your cattle to pasture.}

An-Nahl (12-13) (Part-14) Signs in the Subjection of Night and Day, the Sun and the Moon, and in that which grows on Earth Allah mentions the mighty signs and immense blessings to be found in His subjection of night and day, which follow one another; the sun and moon, which revolve; the stars, both fixed and moving through the skies, offering light by which people may find their way in the darkness. Each of (these heavenly bodies) travels in its own orbit, which Allah has ordained for it, and travels in the manner prescribed for it, without deviating in any way. All of them are under His subjugation, His control and His decree, as Allah says: JiV'j jSi a J \$c 34 yJei' ii' Qfj ^Indeed, your Lord is Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth in Six Days, and then He rose (Istawa) over the Throne. He brings the night as a cover over the day, seeking it rapidly, and (He created) the sun, the moon, the stars (all) subjected to His command. Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} (7:54) Thus Allah says; iStirely, in this are proofs for people who understand . meaning, they are indications of His immense power and might, for those who think about Allah and understand His signs. ft 4And whatsoever He has created of varying colors on the earth for you.} When Allah points out the features of the skies, He also points out the wondrous things that He has created on

earth, the variety of its animals, minerals, plants and inanimate features, all having different colors and shapes, benefits and qualities. 4a. *-\$

4Verily, in this is a sign for people who reflect. meaning (those who remember) the blessings of Allah and give thanks to Him for them. 424. And He it is Who subjected the sea (to you), that you may eat from the fresh tender meat, and that you bring forth out of it ornaments to wear. And you see the ships plowing through it, that you may seek from His bounty and that you may perhaps be grateful . \$ 415. And He has driven firm standing mountains into the earth, lest it should shake with you; and rivers and roads, that you may guide yourselves. 416. And (by the) landmarks; and by the stars, they guide themselves. 417. Is then He Who creates the same as one who creates, not? Will you not then reflect? \$ 418. And if you would try to count the favors of Allah, you would never be able to count them. Truly, Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful Signs in the Oceans, Mountains, Rivers, Roads and Stars Allah tells us how He has subjected the seas, with their waves lapping the shores, and how He blesses His servants by subjecting the seas for them so that they may travel on them, and by putting fish and whales in them, by making their flesh permissible to eat - whether they are caught alive or dead - at all times, including when people are in a state of Ihram. He has created pearls and precious jewels in the oceans, and made it easy for His servants to recover ornaments that they can wear from the ocean floor. He made the sea such that it carries the ships which plow through it. He is the One Who taught mankind to make ships, which is the inheritance of

An-Nahl (14-18) (Part-14) their forefather Nuh. He was the first one to travel by ship, he was taught how to make them, then people took this knowledge from him and passed it down from generation to generation through the centuries, so that they could travel from country to country and from place to place, bringing goods from here to there and from there to here. Thus Allah says: {that you may seek from His bounty and that you may perhaps be grateful.} - for His bounty and blessings. Then Allah mentions the earth and how He placed in it mountains standing firm, which make it stable and keep it from shaking in such a manner that the creatures dwelling on it would not be able to live. Hence Allah says, {And the mountains He has fixed firmly.} (79:32). {and rivers and roads} meaning He has made rivers which flow from one place to another, bringing provision for His servants. The rivers arise in one place, and bring provision to people living in another place. They flow through lands and fields and wildernesses, through mountains and hills, until they reach the land whose people they are meant to benefit. They meander across the land, left and right, north and south, east and west - rivers great and small - flowing sometimes and ceasing sometimes, flowing from their sources to the places where the water gathers, flowing rapidly or moving slowly, as decreed by Allah. There is no god besides Him and no Lord except Him. He also made roads or routes along which people travel from one land or city to another, and He even made gaps in the mountains so that there would be routes between them, as He says: 4And We placed broad highways for them to pass through.} (21:31]

4And landmarks meaning, signs like great mountains and small hills, and so on, things that land and sea travelers use to find their way if they get lost. > Sif 'V 4^~r. (" {and by the stars (during the night), they (mankind) guide themselves.} meaning, in the darkness of the night. This was the opinion of Ibn Abbas. Worship is Allah's Right Then Allah tells us of His greatness, and that worship should be directed to Him alone, not to any of the idols which do not create but are rather themselves created. Thus He says

41\$ then He, Who creates, the same as one who does not create? Will you not then reflect?}(16:17). Then He shows His servants some of the many blessings He granted for them, and the many kinds of things that He has done for them. He says; 4And if you would try to count the favors of Allah, you would never be able to count them. Truly, Allah is Forgiving, Most Merciful.} (16:18) meaning that He pardons and forgives them. If He were to ask you to thank Him for all of His blessings, you would not be able to do so, and if He were to command you to do so, you would be incapable of it. If He punishes you. He is never unjust in His punishment, but He is Forgiving and Most Merciful, He forgives much and rewards for little. Ibn Jarir said: It means that Allah is Forgiving when you fail to thank Him properly, if you repent and turn to Him in obedience, and strive to do that which pleases Him. He is Merciful to you and (i) Al-Tabari 17:185.

An-Nahl (19-21) (Part-14) YM % ^ojX-r j> *~~=^L"i / i T *' } * i/t *, { QM 4j"i ^ J 4il' 4.^ Ujfrju -. yj)Ut^L j"uLliu <^L-')_-jU A-"*u' ^* s=*aJa v^!S>^y_U > { <\ \> jfc.yZ* *{ ':ut'n\J&V does not punish you if you turn to Him and repent. Cj ^Xr-j ^ * *. ^j} os 0 ^i2 jvJij lid. JyAjt V Alii jjJ y^.'i >-. !.i .!i. ': ' J y S*& tO* . ^,|Oj*>; 04' 419. And Allah knows what you conceal and what you reveal.} 420. Those whom they invoke besides Allah have not created any- thing, but are themselves created.} 421. (They are) dead, not alive; and they do not know when they will be resurrected.} Allah tells us that He knows what is hidden in people's hearts as well as what is apparent. He will reward or punish everyone for their deeds on the Day of Resurrection. If their deeds are good then they will be rewarded, and if their deeds are evil, then they will be punished. The gods of the idolaters are created, they do not create. Then Allah tells us that the idols which people call on instead of Him cannot create anything, they are themselves created, as Al-KhaJS. (Ibrahim) said: 4@\$jES6 \$3L &s ZfUZ U*&} 4"Do you worship that which you (yourselves) carve? While in Al-Tabari 17:187.

An-Nahl (24-25) (Part-14) Allah, and their hearts reject the idea of singling Him out, as Allah says: {Verily! Those who scorn My worship they will surely enter Hell in humiliation/> [40:60] So here, Allah says; {Certainly}, meaning truly, 4oj4^S ^*J ii' 4^ {Allah knows what they conceal and what they reveal. meaning He will requite them for that in full. {Truly, He does not like the proud. (j && 9. And when it is said to them : "What is it that your Lord has revealed?" They say : "Tales of the max of old!" {25. They will bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge. Evil indeed is that which they shall bear!} The Destruction of the Disbelievers and Intensification of their Punishment for rejecting the Revelation Allah informs us that when it is said to those liars, {\}Z &U} {"What is it that your Lord has revealed?" They say,} not wanting to answer, {"Tales of the men of old!" meaning nothing is revealed to him, what he is reciting to us is just tales of the men of old, taken from the previous Books.

As Allah says, 4 1^=4 iS Jk VjuJ> they say: "Tales of the ancients, which he has written down, and they are dictated to him morning and afternoon."} (2Si5j i.e., they tell lies against the Messenger j and say things contradicting one another, but all of it is false, as Allah says, y ^ / I ** ! // .i // , . " .. 4 j^Lk-s Vi ijU" viii [4Loot at the parables they make of you, so they have gone astray, and they are not able to find the right way.>>(17:48) Once they have gone beyond the bounds of the truth, whatever they say will be in error. They used to say that he (the Prophet jfe) was a sorcerer, a poet, a soothsayer, or a madman, then they settled on an idea proposed by their leader, an individual known as Al-WalTd bin

Al-Mughlrah Al- Makhzumi, when: k & % jtS iHe thought, and plotted. So let him be cursed, how Ik plotted! And once more let him be cursed, how he plotted! Then he thought. Then he frowned and he looked in a bad tempered way; then he turned back, and was proud. Then he said: "This is nothing but the magic of old. } (74:18-24) meaning something that had been transmitted and passed down. So they dispersed having agreed on this opinion, may Allah punish them. iThey will bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of tlw burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge.} meaning, *We decreed that they would say that, so they will carry the burden of their own sins and some of the burden of those who followed them and agreed with them, i.e., they will be held guilty not only for going astray themselves, but also for tempting others and having them follow them. As it says in

a Hadith Iri J* jyr^ j4 iji ^^ JI ^ j 'j i*B\ ^jA ^Ul I {jA 5-lp j IS iJ^Li JI li-J 1 ll i J. Ju>>& "Whoever invites people to guidance, he will receive a reward like that of those who follow him, without diminishing their reward in the least. And whoever invites people to misguidance, he will bear a burden of sin like that of those who follow him, without diminishing their burden in the least. a ' Allah says; g pB iThey shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own; and they shall be questioned about their false allegations on the Day of Resurrection (29:13) Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas that it is like the Ayah: j)j\$ Ji) p) ^ iThat they may bear their own burdens in full on the Day of Resurrection, and also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge (16:25) Allah says, pB 4They shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own> (29: 13). Mujahid said: They will bear the burden of their own sins, and they will bear the sins of those who obeyed them, but that will not lessen the punishment of those who obeyed them at all. 131 <. *i . Ji ii' J6 Oi ^BB ;C\ \K" - -> .'.ir : { > ,'.i - - o'. ***- fj* ^ Jt >-***>" o; 111 MusUm 4:2060.Tabari 17:191. 131 Af-Tabari 17:190.

450 Tafslr Ibn Kathir \$. 'ySj ijii\ ! il\ ijj ju ^ k\$ 3fe 426. Those before them indeed plotted, but Allah struck at the foundation of their building, the roof fell down upon them from above them, and the torment overtook them from directions they did not perceive.} 427. Then, on the Day of Resurrection, He will disgrace them and will say: "Where are My (so-called) partners, those over which you caused so much discord?" Those who have been given the knowledge will say : "Indeed it is a Day of disgrace and misery for the disbelievers."4 Discussion about what the previous Peoples did, and what was done to Them 4j- ? iThose before than indeed plotted,} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: This refers to Namrud (Nimrod), who built the tower. 11 Others said that it refers to Bukhtanassar (Nebuchadnezzar). The correct view is that this is said by way of example, to refute what was done by those who disbelieved in Allah and associated others in worship with Him. As Nuh said, 4"And they have hatched a mighty scheme."} (71:22) meaning, they used all sorts of ploys to misguide their people, and tempted them to join them in their Shirk via all possible means. On the Day of Resurrection their followers will say to them: iZti 2 &jz 4"Nay, but it was your plotting by night and day, when you ordered us to disbelieve in Allah and set up rivals to Him! } (34:33) (M At-Jabari 17:193).

41^ iii ibut Allah struck at the foundation of their building.} meaning, He uprooted it and brought their efforts to naught. This is like the Ayah: % \fs& u } iEvery time they kindled the fire of war, Allah extinguished it.} (5:64) and 4\$" rvik prj?. oyjn, ^ cJiiJ fjljJSi f j. iif jM !#" 4But Allah's (torment) reached them from a place where they were not expecting it, and He cast terror into their hearts so that

they destroyed their own dwellings with their own hands and the hands of the believers. So then take admonition, O you with eyes (to see).} [59:2] Allah says here: "itfat X&S^ c"i ^ ibut Allah struck at the foundation of their building, and then the roof fell down upon them, from above them, and the torment overtook them from directions they did not perceive. Then, on the Day of Resurrection, He will disgrace them} [16:26-27] meaning. He will expose their scandalous deeds and what they used to hide in their hearts, and He will bring it out in the open. As He says, iThe Day when all the secrets will be (exposed and) examined.} (86:9) They will be displayed and made known, as found in the Two Sahihs, where Ibn Umar reported that the Messenger of Allah said: ij& 5ji :JUj jji j4 udi { i\ji jsj

452 Tafoir Ibn Kathir tOn the Day of Resurrection a banner will be set up by his backsidefor every deceitful person, (whose size is) in accordance with the amount of his deceit. It be said, "This is the one who deceived so-and-so, the son ofso-and-so. Thus, what they used to plot in secret will be made public. Allah will humiliate them before all of His creation, and the Lord will say to them, in rebuke and reprimand; uOJI j}} {Where are My (so-called) partners, those over which you caused so much discord?} meaning, you fought and made enemies for their sake, so where are they now to help and save you? {Can they help you or (even) help themselves?} [26:93] {Then will (man) have no power, nor any helper.} [86: 10] When evidence and proof is established against them, and the Word (of Allah) is justified against them, and they will be unable to give any excuse, realizing that escape is impossible, then O\ dsM ft} {Those who have been given the knowledge will say} who are the leaders in this world and the Hereafter and who know about the truth in this world and the Hereafter - will say, {ifytfosR jp b\} {Indeed it is a Day ofdisgrace and miseryfor the disbelievers.} meaning, today those who disbelieved in Allah and worshipped others who have no power either to benefit or to harm them are now surrounded by disgrace and punishment. Al-Bdri 10:578 Muslim 3 :1360

2* C iyti r ai1 ^JUi J-4* *ri \$ J" ^ojlllu li ^Jc 42S. Those whose lives the angels take while they are doing wrong to themselves. Then, they will (falsely) submit (saying): We did not do any evil." (The angels will reply): "Yes! Truly, Allah is Most Knowing ofwhat you did 429. "So enter the gates of Hell, to abide therein, and indeed, what an evil abode there isfor the arrogant."} The Condition ofthe Disbeliever duringand alterDeath Allah informs us of the state of the idolaters who are doing wrong to themselves when death approaches and the angels come to seize their evil souls. 4i^" iThen, they will (falsely) submit meaning, they will make it appear as if they used to listen and obey by saying, 4.t0r* oi S*-*> 1^=" iWe did not do any evil.} Similarly, on the Day of Resurrection, they will say, iBy Allah, our Lord, we were not idolaters.} [6:23] 4 CT J) iLp- lii } 4On the Day when Allah will resurrect them all together; then they will swear to Him as they swear to you.} [58:18] Allah says, rejecting what they say, <* ti ~a '(** ^ Sjili 'iff iij af S) i Yes! Truly, Allah is Most Knowing of what you did. So enter the gates of Hell, to abide therein, and indeed, what an evil abode there isfor the arrogant."} (16:28-29), meaning, a miserable position in the abode of humiliation for

454 Tafstr Ibn Kathir those who were too arrogant to pay atten- tion to the signs of Allah and follow His Messengers. They will enter Hell from the day they die with their souls, and their bodies will feel the heat and hot winds of their graves. When

the Day of Resurrec- tion comes, their souls will be reunited with their bodies, to abide forever in the fire of Hell, and % ^ s,1' >? :> ^I4ji.1t j 4-t- ujj; ilt will not be complete enough to kill them nor shall its

torment be lightened for them (35:36) As Allah says, "The Fire, they are exposed to it morning and afternoon. And on the Day when the Hour will be established (it will be said to the angels): Cause Fir'awn's people to enter the severest torment!" (40:46).
 Oi 1 ^yyyC #>/' J "" -/ y Lji-' < . . \$::>/v "" .' i.f . - ^ tvfir >i'Y S^i - '* Q" j JA ^UjujuS j-**jlt ^ f>
 "x'ty'm'

{in it they will have all that they wish> this is like the Ayah: Si 5 5fcj JLiVl^ cu# it (there will be) all that souls could desire, and all that eyes could delight in, and in it you will live forever.} [43:71] fir jfc\$f} {Thus Allah rewards those who have Taqwa.} meaning, this is how Allah rewards everyone who believes in Him, fears Him, and does good deeds. Then Allah tells us about their condition when death approaches them in a good state, i.e., free from Shirk, impurity and all evil. The angels greet them and give them the good news of Paradise, as Allah says: &2% \j SjcZ p fit C& \6 l\} \$ alii a\$&& ^ Oi j 3j Oo fCb {Verily, those who say: Our Lord is Allah (alone)," and then behave righteously, on them the angels will descend (at the time of their death) (saying) : "Fear not, nor grieve! But receive the good news of Paradise as you have been promised! I've been your friends in the life of this world and are (so) in the Hereafter. In it you shall have (all) that your souls desire, and in it you shall have (all) that you ask for. An entertainment from (Allah), the Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."^(41:30:32) We have already referred to the Hadiths that have been reported on the taking of the soul of the believer and the soul of the disbeliever, when we discussed the Ayah, firU& t 9 Qlii i ' ^ fir fir fcj {Allah will keep firm those who believe, with the word that stands firm in this world (i.e. they will keep on worshipping Allah Alone and none else), and in the Hereafter. And Allah will cause the wrongdoers to stray, and Allah does as He wills.} (14:27)

458 Tafclr Ibn Kathtr K % iSSp\$% j &*Pl J%U& &) i; ^ jCj # J&X \$&, j&%%& *> V . Are they but waiting for the angels to come to them, or there comes the command of your Lord? Thus did those before them. And Allah did not wrong them, but they were wronging themselves.) 434. Then, they were afflicted by their evil deeds, and they were surrounded by that which they used to mock.) The Disbelievers' Refrain from Faith means that They were simply awaiting Punishment Threatening the idolaters for their persistence in falsehood and their conceited delusions about this world, Allah says: Are these people waiting only for the angels to come and take their souls? Qatadah said: 40r there comes the command of your Lord?) means the Day of Resurrection and the terror that they will go through. Ji) 4Thus did those before them.) means, thus did their predecessors and those who were like them among the idolaters persist in their Shirk, until they tasted the wrath of Allah and experienced the punishment and torment that they suffered. \Zj) 4And Allah did not wrong them.) because by sending His Messengers and revealing His Books He gave them enough warning and clearly demonstrated His proofs to them. &&W %) ibut they were wronging themselves.) meaning, by opposing the Messengers and denying what they brought. For this reason m At-Tabari 17:199.

TVN msmsT%, {j*tJL-jcU 4jjiiL-ip 'Sj ill' 1) Vj4j J^rs^LijuJuilj(^ i > ; ^ /' > " <*>" > t-,ff>. <-j> 4JS' j>- \$Uily'ml (g) L*j -i-y^dji p piUpL-ilj \& kj!4>^u\$J & & Allah s punishment tormented them. irfi it they were surrounded> meaning, they were overwhelmed by the painful torment. 44"*jr-i i \yfby that which they used to mock.\$ meaning, they used to make fun of the Messengers when they warned them Allah s punish- ment, and for this it will be said to them on the Day of Resurrection: VS* \$ p3 iThis is die

Fire which you used to belie. (52:14). J \&\ JSj> }& Ji fb* ck X> 'lift** J* t o# i-iJj C Sf iLi J^= CJ1 jjJJ '^C5_p! j^Jl ^ jlpf Jb Jv >+U 4; J"i4'T OJj- O jbj 4JJ> 4* p4 :.i OydaN ilt \jjljd '~r^ "5?AJ Sil Jc 4) Jlj^a 4 * >+i j~4 0. V ilf 435. And those who worshipped others with Allah said: If Alliih had so willed, neither we nor our fathers would have worshipped any but Him nor would we have forbidden anything without (a command from) Him." Those before them did the same. Then! Are the Messengers charged with anything but to

clearly convey the Message?} 436. And We have indeed sent a Messenger to every Ummah (community, nation) (saying): Worship Allah (Alone), and shun the Taghiit (all false deities)." Then among them were some whom Allah guided, and among them were some who deserved to be left to stray. So travel through the land and see

the end of those who denied (the truth).}

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3000–3011]

437. [Even] if you desire that they be guided, then verily, Allah does not guide those whom He allowed to stray, and they will have no helpers.} The Idolaters Argument that their Shirk was Divinely decreed, and the Refutation of their Claim Allah tells us about the idolators delusion over their Shirk, and the excuse they claimed for it based on the idea that it is ordained by divine decree. He says: Cti X, tjtl. 'jj jVi l> lai \$} Hi 4(They say:) "If Allah had so willed, neither we nor our fathers would have worshipped any but Him, nor would we have forbidden anything without (a command from) Him."} They had superstitious customs dealing with certain animals, e.g. the Bahirahll] the Sa ibah and the WasQah and other things that they had invented and innovated by themselves, with no revealed authority. The essence of what they said was: If Allah hated what we did, He would have stopped by punishing us, and He would not have enabled us to do it. Rejecting their confusing ideas, Allah says: 4**k \$&} 4Are the Messengers charged with anything but to clearly convey the Message?} meaning, the matter is not as you claim. It is not the case that Allah did not rebuke your behavior; rather, He did rebuke you, and in the strongest possible terms, and He emphatically !i| See the Tafsir of Surah Yunus nos . 59-60

An-Nahl (35-37) (Part-14) forbade you from such behavior. To every nation - that is, to every generation, to every community of people - He sent a Messenger. All of the Messengers called their people to worship Allah (Alone) as well as forbidding them from worshipping anything or anybody except for Him. lilt 'jilt' ^Worship Allah (Alone), and shun the Tdghiit (all false deities).} Allah continued sending Messengers to mankind with this Message, from the first incidence of Shirk that appeared among the Children of Adam, in the people to whom NQh was sent - the first Messenger sent by Allah to the people of this earth - until He sent the final Messenger, Muhammad jg|, whose call was addressed to both men and Jinn, in the east and in the west. All of the Messengers brought the same Message, as Allah says: 4 : ft Vi\ V % 4\ &j>% Jj i : i"" \" 4And We did not send any Messenger before you (O Muhammad) but We revealed to him (saying): None has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah), so worship Me (alone and none else). } (21:25) 4And ask (O Muhammad) those Messengers of Ours whom We sent before you: Did We ever appointed to be worshipped besides the Most Gracious (Allah)?" (43:45) And in this Ayah tnis Ayan, rnian says: 43.JM ij sit |#tf jj* d Zij} 4And We have indeed sent a Messenger to every Umtnah (community, nation) (saying): "Worship Allah (alone), and

shun the Taghiit (all false deities)."} So how could any of the idolators say, 4}& Ot i Si t j!fAllah had so willed, we would not have worshipped any but Him,}

462 Tafsir Ibrt Kathir The legislative will of Allah is clear and cannot be taken as an excuse by them, because He had forbidden them to do that upon the tongue of His Messengers, but by His universal will [i.e., by which He allows things to occur even though they do not please Him] He allowed them to do that as it was decreed for them. So there is no argument in that for them. Allah created Hell and its people both the Shayatin (devils) and disbelievers, but He does not like His servants to disbelieve. And this point constitutes the strongest proof and the most unquestionable wisdom. Then Allah informs us that He rebuked them with punishment in this world, after the Messengers issued their warning, thus He says: O* (v4~y iSJL* a iThen among them were some whom Allah guided, and among them were some who deserved to be left to stray. So travel through the land and see the end of those who denied (the truth). This means: ask about what happened to those who went against the Messengers and rejected the truth, see how: && ?>} iAllah destroyed them completely, and a similar (end awaits) the disbelievers .> (47:10) and, ^ '^j} 4And indeed those before them belied (the Messengers ofAllah), so then how terrible wasMy denial (punishment)?} (67:18) Then Allah told His Messenger sg| that His eagerness to guide them will be ofno benefit to them ifAllah wills that they should be misguided, as He says: iAnd for whoever Allah wills to try with error, you can do nothingfar him against Allah} (5:41). Nuh said to his people:

J i;_ ift if a) "\ -1 i A O' o\ Li & 4 And my advice will not profit you, even if I wish to give you good counsel, ifAllah's will is to keep you astray. ^ (1 1:34). In this Ayah, Allah says: 4 j-i" V iji 4(Even) if you desire that they be guided, then verily, Allah does not guide those wlwm He allowed to stray,} As Allah says: ^Whomsoever Allidt allows to stray, then there is no guide for him; and He lets them wander blindly in their transgressions.} (7:186) \>~ -v .1' iTruly! Those deserving the Word (wrath) of your Lord will not believe, even ifevery sign should come to them - until they see the painful torment (10:96-97). 4then verily, Allah meaning, this is the way in which Allah does things. If He wills a thing, then it happens, and if He does not will a thing, then it does not happen. For this reason Allah says: 4 J-i" <**.r. 4Allah does not guide those whom He allowed to stray,} meaning the one whom He has caused to go astray, so who can guide him apart from Allah? No one. 4 3} 4And they will have no helpers.} means, they will have no one to save them from the punishment of Allah, 4Surely, His is the creation and commandment. Blessed is

Allah, the Lord of all that exists!} (7:54). UJ !)J fo ^ i * it \OS\{f} < \$& *\$ j^% Sv^i\$ i2" 43S. And they swear by Allah with their strongest oaths, that Allah will not raise up one who dies. Yes, (He will raise them up), a promise (binding) upon Him in truth, but most of mankind know not 439. In order that He may make clear to them what they differed over, and so that those who disbelieved may know that they were liars. 440. Verily, Our Word to a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it: "Be! - and it is.} The Resurrection after Death is true, there is Wisdom behind it, and it is easy for Allah Allah tells us that the idolators swore by Allah their strongest oaths, meaning that they made oaths swore fervently that Allah would not resurrect the one who died. They considered that to be improbable, and did not believe the Messengers when they told them about that, swearing that it could not happen. Allah said, refuting them: 4Yes}, meaning it will indeed happen, IMj} 4a promise (binding) upon Him in truth,} -

meaning it is inevitable, but most of mankind know not.} means, because of their ignorance they oppose the Messengers and fall into disbelief. Then Allah mentions His wisdom and the reason why He will resurrect mankind physically on the Day of Calling (between the people of Fire and of Paradise). He says,

An-Nahl (38-40) (Part-14) order that He may make clear to them} means, to mankind, what they differed over,} means, every dispute. 3 iSiS)& u* ijd sM%%} that He may requite those who do evil with that which they have done (i.e. punish them in Hell), and reward those who do good, with what is best (i.e. Paradise).} (53:31) and so that those who disbelieved may know that they were liars.} meaning that they lied in their oaths and their swearing that Allah would not resurrect those who die. Thus they will be pushed down by force to the Fire with horrible force on the Day of Resurrection, and the guards of Hell will say to them: c sp 142 ji%% iThis is the Fire which you used to belie. Is this magic or do you not see? Taste its heat, and whether you are tolerant of it or intolerant of it - it is all the same. You are only being requited for what you have done.} (52:14-16). Then Allah tells us about His ability to do whatever He wills, and that nothing is impossible for Him on earth or in heaven. When He wants a thing, all He has to do is say to it Be! and it is. The Resurrection is one such thing, when He wants it to happen, all He will have to do is issue the command once, and it will happen as He wills, as He says: -*-" " tj} iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) and, -Si jB?% \" iThe creation of you all and the resurrection of you all are only as (the creation and resurrection of) a single person.} (31:28) And in this Ayah, Allah says:

466 Tafsir Ibtisami Kathir V j' ' -V . /i X .y . J Jyi J aIjjj' 'ij Uy Lj, Our Word to a thing when We intend it, is only that We say to it: Be!" - and it is.} meaning, We issue the command once, and then it happens. Allah does not need to repeat or confirm whatever He commands, because there is nothing that can stop Him or oppose Him. He is the One, the Compelling, the Almighty, whose power, might and dominion have subjected all things. None has the right to be worshipped except Him, and there is no Lord other than Him. jj 'jH;^ aii? j I# c* ii& j sj?j> 442 . And as for those who emigrated for the cause of Allah, after they had been wronged, We will certainly give them good residence in this world, but indeed the reward of the Hereafter will be greater; if they but knew!} 442. (They are) those who remained patient, and put their trust in their Lord.} The Reward of the Muhajirin Allah tells us about the reward of those who migrated for His sake, seeking His pleasure, those who left their homeland behind, brothers and friends, hoping for the reward of Allah. This may have been revealed concerning those who migrated to Ethiopia, those whose persecution at the hands of their own people in Makkah was so extreme that they left them and went to Ethiopia so that they would be able to worship their Lord. Among the most prominent of these migrants were Tjthman bin Affan and his wife Ruqayyah, the daughter of the Messenger of Allah JaTar bin Abi Talib, the cousin of the Messenger jg, and Abu Salamah bin Abdul-Asad, among a group of almost eighty sincere and faithful men and women, may Allah be pleased with them. Allah promised them a great reward in this world and the next. Allah said: 4We will certainly give them good residence in this world,}

An-Nahl (43-44) (Part-14) Ibn Abbas, Ash-Sha'bi and Qatadah said: (this means) Al- Madinah." It was also said that it meant good provision . This was the opinion of Mujahid.12* There is no contradiction between these two opinions, for they left their homes and wealth, but Allah compensated them with

something better in this world. Whoever gives up something for the sake of Allah, Allah compensates him with something that is better for him than that, and this is what happened. He gave them power throughout the land and caused them to rule over the people, so they became governors and rulers, find each of them became a leader of the pious. Allah tells us that His reward for the Muhajirin in the Hereafter is greater than that which He gave them in this world, as He says: & 'M> 4but indeed the reward of the Hereafter will be greater} meaning, greater than that which We have given you in this world. 4ifthey but knew!} means, if those who stayed behind and did not migrate with them only knew what Allah prepared for those who obeyed Him and followed His Messenger jg. Then Allah describes them as: ^ s&i a\$} 4those who remained patient, and put their trust in their Lord.} (16:42), meaning, they bore their people s persecution with patience, putting their trust in Allah Who made their end good in this world and the Hereafter. V 'JX ol jil' j-ii 1 XT# ^ .01 iXji tj} 443. And I've sent not (as Our Messengers) before you (O At-Tabari 17:205, 206. At-Tabari 17:206.

Muhammad) any but men, whom We sent revelation. So ask Ahl Adh-Dhikr, ifyou know not.) 444. With clear signs and Books (We sent the Messengers). And We have also revealed the Dhikr to you so that you may clearly explain to men what was revealed to them, and that perhaps they may reflect.} OnlyHuman Messengers have been Sent Ad-Dahhak said, reporting from Ibn Abbas: When Allah sent Muhammad jg as a Messenger, the Arabs, or some of them, denied him and said, Allah is too great to send a human being as a Messenger. Then Allah revealed: o' fr-J j', tL A ojllll 4Is it a wonder to people that We have sent Our Inspiration to a manfrom among themselves (saying) : "Warn mankind. . ." and He said, V^ o\ pt iil & uy J ,,r*> " 4And We sent not (as Our Messengers) before you (O Muliammad) any but men, whom We sent Revelation. So ask Ahl Adh-Dhikr, ifyou know not.}. meaning, (ask) the people of the previous Books, were the Messengers that were sent to them humans or angels? If they were angels, then you have the right to find this strange, but if they were human, then you have no grounds to deny that Muhammad is a Messenger. Allah says: ir a 4And We sent not before you (us Messengers) any but men to whom We revealed, from among the people of townships.} [12:109] and not from among the people of heaven as you say. 111 It was reported by Mujahid from Ibn Abbas that what is meant m At-Jabari 17:208.

by Ahl Adh-Dhikr is the People of the Book. 111 This is as Allah says: 4Say: Glorified be my Lord! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?" And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said : "Has Allah sent a man as (His) Messenger?"} (17:93-94) 4^ \$ VI U iXi Zj} 4And We never sent before you (O Muhammad) any of the Messengers but verily, they ate food and walked in the markets.} (25:20) \ \$ ly oJ^= V IxX Zj} 4And We did not create them (the Messengers, with) bodies that did not eatfood, nor were they immortals.}(21:8) 4S~)\ -h < U 4Say (O Muhammad jfi): "I am not a new thing among the Messengers."} [46:9], 43) fry. I&t 4Say (O Muhammad): I am only a man like you. It has been revealed to me."} [18:110] Then Allah informs those who doubt that a Messenger can be a human to ask those who have knowledge of the previous Scriptures about the Prophets who came before: were their Prophets humans or angels? Then Allah mentions that He has sent them, iwith clear signs}, meaning proofand evidence, and Al-Tabari 17:208.

J TVT t&smir\, 0Jr ^*oZ&lcj Z}j^==,j}l (fp^~y^i.p- o' J"lUj Oji^oitjOjtO Ij jl\ij0" / 4so that perhaps they may reflect.} meaning, they should examine themselves and be guided by it, so that they may

attain the victory of salvation in this world and the next. j yt ya" ' Pj; "sl JLi " *".< > .y " 1V /ff <& !*/
i ^ ^-e- j: > * '* .>/>!, < (** Ui (viji-S j' jl -* => '-bv . Do then those who devise evil plots feel se- cure
that Allah will not cause them to sink into the earth, or that tor- ment will not seize them \from where
they do not perceive it?} 446. Or that He may punish them in the midst of their going to and fro (in
their livelihood), so that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)?} 447. Or that He may
punish them where they fear it most? Indeed, Your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful.}

How the Guilty can feel Secure

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3011–3029]

Allah informs us about His patience, and how He delays the punishment for the sinners who do evil things and call others to do likewise, plotting to call others to do evil - even though He is able to make the earth swallow them or to bring His wrath upon them.

ifrom where they do not perceive it}, meaning in such a way that they do not know where it comes from. As Allah says: jm 4 j ft o. & P>^ oi 4 j JT t-ft 54X 4Do you feel secure that He Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause you to sink into the earth, when it quakes? Or do you feel secure that He Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send a storm ofstones upon you? Then you shall know how My warning really is.} (67:16-17). iOr that He may punish them in the midst of their going to andfro meaning, when they are busy with their daily business, travel, and other distracting activities. Qatadah and As-Suddi said: 44&} iTheir going to andfro} means theirjourneys. 1 11 As Allah says: r&fc J 'J i K J 'JZ} pi^ax iDid the people of the towns feel secure against the coming of Our punishment by night while they were asleep? Or, did the people of the towns feel secure against the coming of Our punishment in the forenoon while they were playing?} (7:97- 98) r*^ iso that there be no escape for them (from Allah's punishment)?} meaning, it is not impossible for Allah, no matter what their situation. iOr that He may punish them where theyfear it most?} meaning, or Allah will take from them what they most fear, (M At-Tabari 17:213.

which is even more frightening, because when the thing you most fear to happen does happen, this is even worse. Hence Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said that, ii 40r that He may punish them where theyfear it most?\$ means that Allah is saying: If I wish, I can take him after the death of his companion and after he has become frightened of that. *' This was also reported from Mujahid, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and others. 121 Then Allah says: ^Indeed your Lord is full of kindness, Most Merciful.> meaning, because He does not hasten to punish, as was reported in the Two Sahihs: Ij* ""*""> *No one is more patient in the case of hearing offensive speech than Allah, for they attribute to Him a son, while He [alone] is giving them provision and good health. And it is also recorded in Two Sahihs, p Jiif \i\ Ji- pJUai Sil 01. *Allah will let the wrongdoer continue until, when He begins to punish him, He will never let him goJ Then the Messenger of Allah jg recited: %S\ jf, 2J til iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong. Indeed, His punishment is painful, (and) severe (11:102) And Allah says:Tabari 17:214.Tabari 17:215. Al-Bari 13 :372 , Muslim 4 :2160. Al-Bari 8 :205 , Muslim 4 :1997

their prostrations are their shadows. Abu Ghalib Ash-Shaybani said: The waves of the sea are its prayers . It is as if reason is attributed to these inanimate objects when they are described as prostrating, so Allah says: - i l"j 4 U *kj} 4And to Allah prostrate all that are in the heavens and all that are in the earth, of the moving creatures} As Allah says: O- -W-> jHjJ 4And to Allah (alone) all who are in the heavens and the earth fall in prostration, willingly or unwillingly, and so do their shadows in the mornings and in the afternoons.} (13:15) iand the angels, and they are not proud.} means, they prostrate to Allah and are not too proud to worship Him. iThey fear their Lord above them} means, they prostrate out of fear of their Lord, may He be glorified. iand they do what they are commanded.} meaning they continually obey Allah, doing what He tells them to do and avoiding that which He forbids. 4 % 'J\$ VS j> ^ stf J'u ,r, &*\$**& s > -if / .Iff- >-> 4Jl> j-*-* igj&l & tkV fii jfc 51* a2" 6|2 4 "K y < ". \ x- ; s', ' >" > 4V 1 * f llyoU 451. And Allah said Do not worship two gods. Indeed, He (Allah) is only One God. Then fearMe Alone.} 452. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and the earth and the religion. Will you then fear any other than Allah?} 453 . And whatever of blessings and good things you have, it is from Allah. Then, when harm touchtes you, unto Him you cry

aloudfor help> . Then, when He has removed the harm from you, behold! some of you associate others in worship with their Lord (Allah)) 455. So they are ungrateful for that which We have given them! Then enjoy yourselves but you will soon come to know) Allah Alone is Deserving ofWorship Allah tells us that there is no god but He, and that no one else should be worshipped except Him, alone, without partners, for He is the Sovereign, Creator, and Lord of all things. iHis is the religion Wasiba} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Maymun bin Mahran, As- Suddi, Qatadah and others said that this means forever. * It was also reported that Ibn Abbas said, It means obligatory. * Mujahid said: It means purely for Him, i.e., worship is due to Him Alone, from whoever is in the heavens and on earth. As Allah says: yi 4 ir* nlj 4*' irii jS' iDo they seek other than the religion of AllSh, while to Him submitted all creatures in the heavens and the earth, willingly or unwillingly. And to Him shall they all be returned) (3:83) This is in accordance with the opinion of Ibn Abbas and Ikrimah, which is that this Ayah is merely stating the case. According to the opinion of Mujahid, it is by way of instruction, i.e., it is saying: You had better fear associating partners in worship with Me, and be sincere in your obedience to Me. As Allah says: i'Mf ctJira yi" At-Tabari 17:222. > At-Tabari 17:223.

Ati-Nahl (51-55) (Part-14) iSurely, the pure religion (sincere devotion) is for Allah only.} (39:3) Then Allah tells us that He is the One Who has the power to benefit and harm, and that the provisions, blessings, good health and help, His servants enjoy are from His bounty and graciousness towards them. iThen, when harm touches you, to Him you cry aloud for help.} meaning because you know that none has the power to remove that harm except for Him, so when you are harmed, you turn to ask Him for help and beg Him for aid. As Allah says: oty jji' Ji V) 3 fCS* \> } iAnd when harm touches you at sea, those that you call upon vanish, except for Him. But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away. And man is ever ungrateful.}(17:67) Here, Allah tells us: t,!*!m m %" iThen, when He has removed the harm from you, behold! some of you associate others in worship with their Lord (Allah). So they are ungrateful for that which We have given them!} (16:54-55) It was said that the Ldm here (translated as So) is an indicator of sequence, or that it serves an explanatory function, meaning, We decreed that they would conceal the truth and deny the blessings that Allah has bestowed upon them.

He is the One Who bestows blessings and the One Who removes distress. Then Allah threatens them, saying: {Then enjoy yourselves} meaning, do what you like and enjoy what you have for a little while.

457. And they assign daughters to Allah! Glorified (and Exalted) is He (above all that they associate with Him!). And for themselves (they assign) what they desire;} 458. And when the news of (the birth of) a female (child) is brought to any of them, his face becomes dark, and he is filled with inner grief!} 459. He hides himself from the people because of the evil of what he has been informed. Shall he keep her with dishonor or bury her in the earth? Certainly, evil is their decision.} 460. For those who do not believe in the Hereafter is an evil description, and for Allah is the highest description. And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.}

Among the Behavior of the Idolators was vowing to Things that Allah had provided for Them to their gods Allah tells us about some of the heinous deeds of those who used to perform baseless worship of other gods besides Him, such as idols and statues, with no grounds for doing so. They gave their idols a share of that which Allah had provided for them, 4 .H, L ^ 'j[j ji 477iei/ say: "This is for Allah," according to their claim, "and this is for our partners." But the share of their "partners" is not directed to Allah, while the share of Allah is directed to their "partners"! How evil is that with which they judged (6:136) That is they assigned a share for their idols as well as Allah, but they gave preference to their gods over Him, so Allah swore by His Almighty Self to question them about these lies and fabrications. He will most certainly call them to account for it and give them the unrelenting punishment in the fire of Hell. So He says, 4By Allah, you shall certainly be questioned about (all) that you used to fabricate.} Then Allah tells us how they used to regard the angels, who are servants of the Most Merciful, as being female, and that they considered them to be Allah's daughters, and they worshipped them with Him. In all of the above, they made very serious errors. They attributed offspring to Him when He has no offspring, then they assigned Him the kind of offspring they regarded as inferior, namely daughters, which they did not even want for themselves, as He said: {Are the males for you and the females for Him? That is indeed an unfair division!} (53:21-22) And Allah says here:

male children over her? {or bury her in the earth?} meaning bury her alive, as they used to do during the days of ignorance. How could they dislike something so intensely, yet attribute it to Allah? 4Certainly, evil is their decision.} meaning how evil are the words they say, the way they want to share things out and the things they attribute to Him. As Allah says: 4And if one of them is informed of the news of (the birth of a girl) that which he sets forth as a parable to the Most Gracious (Allah), his face becomes dark, and he is filled with grief!} (43:17). Here, Allah says: 4For those who do not believe in the Hereafter there is an evil description,} meaning, only imperfection is to be attributed to &&K iand for Allah is the highest description} meaning He is absolutely perfect in all ways and this absolute perfection is His Alone. 4And He is the All-Mighty, the All-Wise.} &p A 3 1# } v Vj ^ -U" &&A % *&#&. And if Allah were to punish (all) mankind for their wrongdoing. He would not leave on it (the earth) a single moving creature, but He defers them to an appointed term ; and when their term comes, they can neither delay nor advance it an hour (or a moment).}

462. They assign to Allah that which they dislike (for themselves), and their tongues assert the lie that the better things will be theirs. No doubt the Fire is for them, and they will be forsaken. Allah does not immediately punish for Disobedience Allah tells us about His patience with His creatures, even though

they do wrong. If He were to punish them for what they have done, there would be no living creature left on the face of the earth, i.e., He would have destroyed every animal on earth after destroying the sons of Adam. But the Lord - magnificent is His gloiy - is forbearing and He covers people s faults. He waits until the appointed time, i.e.. He does not rush to punish them. If He did, then there would be no one left. Ibn Jarir reported that Abu Salamah said: Abu Hurayrah heard a man saying, The wrongdoer harms no one but himself. He turned to him and said, That is not true, by Allah! Even the buzzard dies in its nest because of the sins of the wrongdoer. They attribute to Allah what They Themselves dislike 4They assign to Allah that which they dislike (for themselves), meaning, daughters, and partners, who are merely His servants, yet none of them would like to have someone sharing in his wealth. ifcii% d} 4and their tongues assert the lie that the better things will be theirs.} This is a denunciation of their claims that better things will be theirs in this world, and in the Hereafter. Allah tells us about what some of them said, as in the Ayat: m At-Tabari 17:231.

4And if We give man a taste of mercy from Us, and then take it from him, verily! He is hopelessly, ungrateful. But if We let him taste of goodness after harm has touched him, he is sure to say: "Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is cheerful, and boastful (ungrateful to Allah).} (11:9-10) i-jli icLU' 'ii ifjfi I Xu llj ijiue- lij li ilxt. And if We give him a taste of mercy from Us, after some adversity has touched him, he is sure to say: "This is due to me; I do not think that the Hour will occur. But if I am brought back to my Lord, then , with Him, there will surely be the best for me." Then, We will certainly show the disbelievers what they have done, and We shall make them taste severe torment.} (41:50) 4 * & jkkza ifjil }Have you seen the one who disbelieved in Our Ayat and said: "I shall certainly be given wealth and children (if I came back to life)."} (19:77) Allah tells us about one of the two men: C_> jjjC* xS J 1)^ C Jtt ." iJ Jij /cjj-. *} I L**- oju-V ^ oyj a^L_" 4He went into his garden while wronging himself. He said : "I do not think that this will ever perish. And I do not think that the Hour will ever come, and if indeed I am brought back to my Lord, (on the Day of Resurrection), then surely, I shall find better than this when I return to Him."} (18:35-36) These people combined bad deeds with the false hopes of being rewarded with good for those bad deeds, which is impossible. Thus Allah refuted their false hopes, when He said: I 4No doubt}, meaning, truly it is inevitable that

484 Tafslr Ibn Kathir (for them is the Fire), meaning, on the Day of Resurrection. iand they will be forsaken). Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Qatadah and others said: This means they will be forgotten and neglected there. * This is like the Ayah: 4'ji 4So today We forget them just as they forgot meeting on this day of theirs.) (7:51). It was also reported from Qatadah that, 4they will be forsaken) means *they are hastened into the Fire. 121 There is no contradiction between the two, because they will be hastened into the Fire on the Day of Resurrection, then they will be forgotten there, i.e., left to dwell there for eternity. taz u, 4\ zs^ yz /f) ijif JIM 0' * (fX '%> tdii & Jf iifj fjA 463. By Allah, We indeed sent (Messengers) to the nations before you, but Shaytan made their deeds seeming fair to them. So today he is their helper, and theirs will be a painful torment.) 464. And We have not revealed the Book to you, except that you may clearly explain to them those things in which they differ, and (as) a guidance and a mercy for a people who believe.) 465. And Allah sends water down from the sky, then He revives the earth with it after its death . Surely that is a sign for people who listen.)Jabari 17:233.Jabari 17:234.

Finding Consolation in the Reminder of Those Who came before Allah says. He sent Messengers to the nations of the past, and they were rejected. You, O Muhammad, have an example in your brothers among the Messengers, so do not be distressed by your people's rejection. As for the idolators rejection of the Messengers, the reason for this is that the Shaytdn made their deeds attractive to them. 4So today he (Shaytdn) is their helper,} meaning they will be suffering punishment while Shaytdn is their only helper, and he cannot save them, so they have no one to answer their calls for help, and theirs is a painful punishment. The Reasonwhy the Qur'an was revealed Then Allah says to His Messenger jg that He has revealed the Book to him to explain the truth to mankind in matters which they dispute over. So the Qur'an is a decisive arbitrator for every issue that they argue about. iand (as) a guidance} meaning, for their hearts. iand a mercy} meaning, for the one who adheres to it. ifor a people who believe.} Just as Allah causes the Qur'an to bring life to hearts that were dead from disbelief, so He brings the earth to life after it has died, by sending down water from the sky. i'oflll 4,7 lifl'i j, iSurely that is a sign for people who listen.} meaning those who understand the words and their meanings.

mixed with another after separating, and none of them is affected by the other. iUtrM {pure milk; palatable to the drinkers.> meaning nothing to cause one to choke on it. When Allah mentions milk and how He has made it a palatable drink for mankind, He follows this with a reference to the drinks that people make from the fruits of the date palm and grapevine, and what they used to do with intoxicating Nabidh (drink made from dates) before it was forbidden. Thus He reminds them of His blessings, and says: 4 ^=" o} {And from the fruits of date palms and grapes, you derive strong drink} This indicates that it was permissible to drink it before it was forbidden. It also indicates that strong drink (i.e., intoxicating drink) derived from dates is the same as strong drink derived from grapes. Also forbidden are strong drinks derived from wheat, barley, com and honey, as is explained in detail in the Sunnah. 4 feu {r^=i^} {strong drink and a goodly provision.} Ibn Abbas said: Strong drink is the product of these two fruits that is forbidden, and the good provision is what is permitted of them. According to another report: Strong drink is its unlawful, and the goodly provision is its lawful, ,21 referring to the fruits when they are dried, like dates and raisins, or products derived from them such as molasses, vinegar and wine (of grapes, dates) which are permissible to drink before they become strong (becomes alcoholic), as was stated in the Sunnah. life ^ b\} {There is indeed a sign in thisfor those ofreason.} Tabari 17:241.Tabari 17:242.

a drink of varying colors, in which there is a cure for men. There is indeed a sign in thatfor people who reflect. In the Bee and itsHoney there is Blessingand a Lesson

What is meant by inspiration here is guidance. The bee is

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3029–3040]

guided to make its home in the mountains, in trees and in structures erected by man. The bee's home is a solid structure, with its hexagonal shapes and interlocking forms there is no looseness in its combs. Then Allah decrees that the bee will have permission to eat from all fruits and to follow the ways which Allah has made easy for it, wherever it wants to go in the vast spaces of the wilderness, valleys and high mountains. Then each bee comes back to its hive without swerving to the right or left, it comes straight back to its home where its offspring and honey are. It makes wax from its wings, and

regurgitates honey from its mouth, and lays eggs from its rear, then the next morning it goes out to the fields again. and follow the routes of your Lord made easy (for you)) Qatadah and Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said: This means, in an obedient way, understanding it to be a description of the route of migration. Ibn Zayd said that this is like the Ayah: 4 And We have subdued them for them so that some they may ride and some they may eat.) (36:72) He said: Do you not see that they move the bees home from one land to another, and the bees follow them? The first opinion is clearly the more likely, as it describes the routes that the bees follow, i.e., follow these routes as they are easy' The word translated here as made easy" is Dhululan. This may be understood as meaning made easy, in which case it refers to the routes followed by the bees, or it may be understood as meaning subjugated, in which case it refers to the bees themselves. These two scholarly interpretations are the two opinions discussed here, 21 At-Tabari 17:249. Tabari 17:249.

for you. This was stated by Mujahid. Ibn Jarir said that both opinions are correct. i There comes forth from their bellies, a drink of varying colors, wherein is healing for men.} [meaning, honey, that is] white, yellow, red, or of other good colors, depending on the different things that the bees eat. i M tin which there is a cure for men.} meaning there is a cure in honey for diseases that people suffer from. Some of those who spoke about the study of Prophetic medicine said that if [Allah] had said, in which there is the cure for men, then it would be the remedy for all diseases, but He said, in which there is a cure for men, meaning that it is the right treatment for every cold disease, because it is hot, and a disease should be treated with its opposite.

It is reported in the Two Sahdis from A ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, that the Messenger of Allah used to like sweet things and honey. This is the wording of Al-Bukhari, who also reported in his Sahih from Ibn 'Abbas that the Messenger of Allah said: p) * p 'i - Jt uJ "Healing is to be found in three things: the cut made by the cupper, or drinking honey, or in branding with fire (cauterizing), but I have forbidden my Ummah to use branding. d j p C d; d # l) (j \ } i There is indeed a sign in that for people who reflect.} meaning in the fact that Allah inspires this weak little creature to travel through the vast fields and feed from every kind of fruit, then gather it for wax and honey, which are some of the best things, in this is a sign for people who think about the might and power of the bee s Creator Who causes all of this to happen. From this they learn that He is the Initiator, the All- Powerful, the All-Wise, the All-Knowing, the Most Generous, the Most Merciful. k te Z & V & pg & % * & P * > & 470. And Allah created you and then He will cause you to die; and among you there are some who are sent back to senility, so that they know nothing after having known (much). Truly, Allah is Knowing, capable of all things.} In Man there is a Lesson Allah tells us that He is controlling the affairs of His servants. He is the One Who created them out of nothing, then He will cause them to die. But there are some of them that He allows to grow old, which is a physical weakness, as Allah says: Al-B6ri 10 :81, Muslim 2 : 1101 121 Path Al-Bari 10:143.

t * y - u > t > ? j * " - rtXJiU- c ^ j J ' " ^ is He Who created i / om in (a state of) weakness, then gave you strength after weakness, then after strength gave (you) weakness} (30:54) i so that they know nothing after lowing known.} meaning, after he knew things, he will reach a stage where he knows nothing because of weakness of mind due to old age and senility. Thus Al-Bukhari, when commenting on this Ayah, reported a narration from Anas bin Malik that the Messenger of Allah sg used to pray: o L L U \ j L p v - k J l

Oj I seek refuge with You from miserliness, laziness, old age, senility, the punishment of the grave, the Fitnah of the Dajjdl and the trials of life and deathM*' Zuhayr bin Abi Sulma said, in his famous Mu allaqah:i2] I became exhausted from the responsibilities of life. Whoever lives for eighty years, no wonder he is tired. I saw death hitting people like a crazed camel, and whoever it hit dies, but whoever is not hit lives until he grows old. i71. And Allah honored some ofyou over others with wealth and properties. Then, those who are so honored will by no means hand over their wealth and properties to those (captives of war) whom their right hands possess, so that they may be equal with them in that. Do they then deny thefavor ofAllah?} 111 Path Al-Bari 8:239 Mu allaqah (lit. suspended"): during the days of Jahiliyyah, poetry , in the form of the Qasldahs or odes , was the only means of literary expression. Seven Qasldahs which were masterpieces of their genre were suspended on the walls of the Ka'bah. They are known as the Seven Mu'aUaqat".

An-Nahl (71) (Part-14) There is a Sign and a Blessing in Matters of People s Livelihood Allah explains to the idolaters the ignorance and disbelief involved in their claim that Allah has partners while also admitting that these partners are His servants. In their Talbiyah111 for Hajj, they used to say, Here I am, there are no partners for You except Your own partner, You own him and eveiything he owns. Allah says, denouncing them: You would not accept for your servant to have an equal share in your wealth, so how is it that Allah would accept His servant to be His equal in divinity and glory? As Allah says elsewhere: '-f-i "7" *>.V 4He sets forth a parable for you from yourselves : Do you have partners among those whom your right hands possess (i.e. your servant) to share as equals in the wealth We have granted you, those whom you fear as you fear each other?} (30 :28) Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas mentioned this Ayah, saying, Allah is saying - If they did not want their servant to have a share with them in their wealth and wives, how can My servant have a share with Me in My power? Thus Allah says: ' il^d} 4Do they then deny thefavor ofAllah According to another report, Ibn Abbas said: How can they accept for Me that which they do not accept for themselves? Jui > 4Do they then deny thefavor ofAllah?} meaning, they assign to Allah a share of the tilth and cattle which He has created. They denied His blessings and associated others in worship with Him. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: Umar bin Al-Khattab wrote this letter to Abu Musa Al-Ash ari: *Be content with your provision in this world, for the Most *** The audible supplication uttered upon the commencement of the Hajj rites, "Here IamO Allah . . . Tabari 17:252.

494 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr Merciful has honored some of His servants over others in terms of provision as a test of both. The one who has been given plenty is being tested to see if he will give thanks to Allah and fulfill the duties which are his by virtue of his wealth... It was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. 472. And Allah has made for you mates ofyour own kind, and has made for you, from your mates, sons and grandsons, and has granted you good provisions. Do they then believe in false deities and denyfavor ofAllah?} AmongHis Blessingsand Signs are Mates, Children and Grandchildren Allah mentions the blessing He has bestowed upon His servant by giving them mates from among themselves, mates of their own kind. If He had given them mates of another kind, there would be no harmony, love and mercy between them. But out of His mercy He has made the Children ofAdam male and female, and has made the females wives or mates for the males. Then Allah mentions that from these wives He creates children and grandchildren, one s children s children. This was the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah, Al-Hasan, Ad-Dahhak and Ibn ZaydJ Shu bah said, narrating from Abu Bishr from Said bin

Jubayr from Ibn Abbas: Children and grandchildren, who are one's children and one's children's children. * It was also said that this means servants and helpers, or it means sons-in-law or in-laws. I say: if we understand 4grandsons^ to refer back to wives, then it must mean children, children's children, and sons-in-law, because they are the husbands of one's daughter or the children of one's wife. M S* fzjof} At-Tabari 17:256, 257. Tabari 17:257.

An-Nahl (73-74) (Part-14) and has granted you good provisions.} meaning your food and drink. Then Allah denounces those who associate others in worship with the One Who bestows blessings on them: i'dpS. 4Do they then believe in false deities}, meaning idols and rivals to Allah and deny the favor of Allah?} meaning, by concealing the blessings that Allah has given them and attributing them to others. According to a Sahih Hadith, the Prophet said: /{ fii : "&^ jh 2 Si/ "Allah will say to His servant on the Day of Resurrection, reminding him of His blessings: "Did I not give you a wife? Did I not honor you? Did I not subject horses and camels to your use, and cause you to occupy a position of leadership and honor -> Vj (ill ufjJij ^+1 elil; V 4 V 2k %_& hi j V(k 2 473. And they worship others besides Allah such as do not have power to grant them any provision from the heavens or the earth nor the ability to do so.} 474. So do not give examples on behalf of Allah. Truly, Allah knows and you know not.} Denouncing the Worship of anything besides Allah Allah tells us about the Mushrikin who worship others besides Him, even though He alone is the bountiful Provider, the Creator and Sustainer, without partners or associates, but they still worship idols and make rivals for Him. He says: HI Muslim 4 .2279

Jr limits rvo iZs&VP ns, isuch as do not have J&Vui ^ upjsj rtitoi [L_>-lajj\L^j jJ-iV IS^LLi rtlljulaU power to grant them any provision from the heavens or the earth meaning, nobody can cause rain to fall, or make plants and trees grow. They cannot do these things for themselves, even if they wanted to. Thus Allah says: 4J&VJ k !A> \$\$ iSo do not give examples on behalf of Allah.} meaning, do not set up rivals to Him or describe anything as being like Him. 4ofX* V jdj "Xk. iTruly, Allah knows and you know not.} meaning, He knows and bears witness that there is no god but Him, but you are ignorant and associate others in worship with Him. i53 s ' ' \U*' i'v'i i - '>%" % * '< ' x UJjIAJJj Ujy it} AXijj iyj . jJju V \xfc- yj* ibt Cj/ 475. Allah gives the example of a servant under the possession of another, he has no power of any sort, and a tnan on whom We have bestowed good provisions from Us, and he spends from that secretly and openly. Can they be equal? (By no t?ieans). All the praises and thanks are to Allah. Nay! (But) most of them know not.}

An-Nahl (76) (Part-14) The Example of the Believer and the Disbeliever, or the Idol and the True God Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said: This is the example which Allah gives of the disbeliever and the believer. 1 11 This was also the view of Qatadah¹² and Ibn Jarir . 131 The servant who has no power over anything is like the disbeliever, and the one who is given good provisions and spends of them secretly and openly is like the believer. Ibn Abi Najih reported that Mujahid said: This is an example given of the idol and the True God - can they be the same? 14 ' Once the difference between them is so clear and so obvious, no one can be unaware of it except the one who is foolish. Allah says: ii V jj 4ti jl^h} 4AU the praises and thanks are to Allah. Nay! (But) most of them know not.} & jjiu ^ j-*\i yj j* 'Sy** S* ^ u-j} i yy f^Ta. 476. And Allah gives an example of two men, one of them dumb, who has no power over anything, and he is a burden on his master; whichever way he directs him, he brings no good. Is such a man equal to one who commands justice, and is himself on the straight path?} Another

Example Mujahid said, This also refers to idols and the True God, may He be exalted. Meaning that the idol is dumb and cannot speak or say anything, good or otherwise. It cannot do anything at all, no words, no action, it is dependent and is a burden on its master. 111 Al-Tabari 17:261. 121 Al-Tabari 17:261. Al-Tabari 17:263. Al-Tabari 17:263.

His complete power, which no one can oppose or resist, means that when He wants a thing, He only has to say to it Be! and it is, as Allah says: 4And Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye.\$ (54 :50) meaning, whatever He wills happens in blinking. Thus Allah says here: 4And the matter of the Hour is not but as a twinkling of the eye, or even nearer. Truly, Allah is Able to do all things. Elsewhere, Allah says: ipz%pa 4The processes of creating you all and resurrecting you all are but like that of (the creation and resurrection of) a single person> (31 :28) AmongtheFavorsAllahhas granted People are Hearing, Sight and the Heart Then Allah mentions His blessings to His servants in that He brought them from their mothers wombs not knowing a thing, then He gives them hearing to recognize voices, sight to see visible things and hearts - meaning reason - whose seat, according to the correct view, is the heart, although it was also said that its seat is the brain. With his reason, a person can distinguish between what is harmful and what is beneficial. These abilities and senses develop gradually in man. The more he grows, the more his hearing, vision and reason increase, until they reach their peak. Allah has created these faculties in man to enable him to worship his Lord, so he uses all these organs, abilities and strengths to obey his Master. Al-Bukhari reported in his Sahih from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger of Allah said: tCs . c)\ *r'S55 Juj^.^

(J-Ki 1 ti Ji pt-i tijJl liU-i ciS t5r^ j-'*' (j^t* (Si*'j d*U & ti>- Jt ojyy U} t iljL*V ^ i(J"ii.l ij &lj. i'jljopi 2# uAllah says: Whoever takes My friend as an enemy, has declared war on Me. My servant does not draw near to Me with anything better than his doing that which I have enjoined upon him, andMy servant keeps drawing near to Me by doing Nawafil (supererogatory) deeds until I love him. And when I love him, I am his hearing with which he hears, his vision with which he sees, his hand with which he strikes and his foot with which he walks. Were he to ask Me for anything, I would give it to him, ifhe were to call on Me, I would respond, ifhe were to seek Me for refuge I would surely grant him it. I do not hesitate to do anything as I hesitate to take the soul of My believing servant, because he hates death and I hate to upset him, but it is inevitable."t 1

The meaning of the Hadith is that when a person is sincere

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in his obedience towards Allah, all his deeds are done for the sake of Allah, so he only hears for the sake of Allah, he only sees for the sake of Allah - meaning he only listens to or looks at what has been allowed by Allah. He does not strike or walk except in obedience to Allah, seeking Allah's help in all of these things. Thus in some versions of the Hadith, narrated outside the Sahih, after the phrase his foot with which he walks, there is added: * I - - " > ' * ' " - "So through Me he hears, through Me he sees, through Me he strikes and through Me he walks . ,z| Thus Allah says: p2 iAnd He gave you hearing, sight, and hearts that you might Al-Bari 1 1 :348 Fath Al-Bari 1 1 :352

give thanks .} Elsewhere, He says: 4' 2 J@3^ eu t'4% jZ% p?%& & ji / /" ^/"i " v y A"// o")^ j fA 4Sai/ if is He Who has created you, and endowed you with hearing and seeing, and hearts. Little thanks you give. Say: "It is He Who has created you on the earth, and to Him shall you be gathered (in the Hereafter)."} (67 :23-24) In the Subjection of the Birds in the Sky there is a Sign Then Allah tells His servants to look at the birds held (flying) in the sky, between heaven and earth, and how He has caused them to fly with their wings in the sky. They are held up only by Him, it is He Who gave them the strength to do that, subjecting the air to carry them and support them. As Allah says in Surat Al-Mulk: Si f'. -1. i . 2Z 4i ! - " - 4Do they not see the birds above them, spreading their wings out and folding them in? None holds them up except the Most Gracious (Allah). Verily, He is the All-Seer of everything.} (67 :19) And here Allah says: iVerily, in this are clear signs for people who believe.} (S. Gj. 1> \b\j} **!# ^ jyjJ j3 vfcik 3L IL: 5 ?*>' C 4 jiOt \$j> C) t^'dSy)s 480. And Allah had made your homes a place of rest for you,

and made dwellings for you out of the hides of the cattle which you find so light when you travel and when you camp; and furnishings and articles of convenience out of their wool, fur, and hair - comfort for a while.} 481 . And Allah has made shade for you out of that which He has created, and He has made places of refuge in the mountains for you, and He has made garments for you to protect you from the heat, and coats of mail to protect you from your violence. Thus does He perfect His favor for you, that you may submit yourselves to His will.} 482. Then, if they turn away, your duty (O Muhammad) is only to convey (the Message) in a clear way.} 483. They recognize the grace of Allah, yet they deny it (by worshipping others besides Allah) and most of them are disbelievers.} Homes, Furnishings and Clothing are also Blessings from Allah Allah mentions His great blessings for His servant in that He has given them homes to dwell in and protect themselves with, in which they find all kinds of benefits. He has also given them homes from the hides of cattle, i.e., leather, which are light and easy to carry on journeys and can be erected wherever they stop, whether they are traveling or are settled. Thus Allah says: (yj (y. 4 which you find so light when you travel and when you camp; } UiW lyy} 4 out of their wool, fur and hair } refers to sheep, camels and goats respectively. 4 furnishings } meaning what you take from them, i.e., wealth. It was also said that it means articles of convenience, or clothing. The correct view is more general in meaning than this; it means that you make carpets, clothing and other things from them- wool, hair etc., which you use as wealth and for trade. Ibn

Abbas said: Al-Athath means articles of convenience and comfort. * This was also the view of Mujahid, Tkrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Atiyah Al-'Awfi, Ata Al-Khurasani, Ad- Dahhak and Qatadah. The phrase, if for a while } means, until the appointed time. Shade, Places of Refuge in the Mountains, Garments and Coats of Mail are also Blessings from Allah 4&i3L iL; &% } } And Allah has made shade for you out of that which He has created, } Qatadah said: This means trees. j3^ } i and He has made places of refuge in the mountains for you, } meaning fortresses and strongholds. 4 3'& } i and He has made garments for you to protect you from the heat, } meaning clothing of cotton, linen and wool. 4j =A Xj" J i and coats of mail to protect you from your violence. } such as shields made of layers of sheet iron, coats of mail and so on. 4^ * \$ } i Thus does He perfect His favor for you, } meaning, thus He gives you what you need to go about your business, so that this will help you to worship and obey Him. i that you may submit yourselves to His will. This is interpreted by the majority to mean submitting to Allah or becoming Muslim. m At-Tabari 17:268. At-Tabari 17:269.

Jr rvn mm3% M \$j40 iaj =4; >!(f.1-ii rjj All the Messenger has to do is convey the Message 4\$4> } Then, if they turn away,} meaning, after this declaration and reminder, do not worry about them. i'o \ git j& iyour duty (O Muhammad) is only to convey (the Message) in a clear way}, and you have delivered the Message to them. 'K if >-> 4Jll r < " v. KIM iThey recognize the grace of Allah, yet they deny it} meaning they know that Allah is the One Who grants these blessings to them, and that He is Bountiful towards them, but they still deny this by worshipping others besides Him and thinking that their help and provisions come from others besides Him. 4S#3 iand most ofthem are disbelievers.} S'.. ' ' ' > > ' .1. > 9> SI K \ r ! -A p-* X* oy*! \$ ot pjgjr "p du\$ c 4 iij j&l B ^ j. [# CT4 3j ijlii ij/&" *jt iJiS "" lig* J-i-j .stilt jl i^itj

/ % >">< y < '*' *>" C* S ' * -5 // 4S4. And on the Day when Wie resurrect a witness from each nation, then those who disbelieve will not be given leave, nor will they be allowed (to return to the world) to repent and ask for Allah's forgiveness.} 85. And once those wlv did wrong see the torment, it will not decreasefor them, nor will they be given respite. i86. And when those who associated partners with Allah see their partners, they will say: "Our Lord! These are our partners wlwrn we used to call upon besides you." But they will throw back their statement at them (saying): "You indeed are liars!"} 487. And they will offer (theirfull) submission to Allah on that Day, and what they falsely invented will wander away from them.} 488. Those who disbelieved and tried to obstruct the path of Allah, for them We will add torment on top of the torment because of the corruption they spread.} The Plight ofthe Idolators on the Day ofJudgement Allah tells us about the predicament of the idolators on the Day when they will be resurrected in the realm of the Hereafter. He will raise a witness from every nation - that is - their Prophet, to testify about their response to the Message he conveyed from Allah. 4then, those who disbelieved will not be given leave.} meaning, they will not be allowed to offer any excuse, as Allah says: 4That will be a Day when they do not speak. And they will not be permitted to present any excuse} (77:35-36). Hence, Allah says:

ilf only those who disbelieved knew (about the time) when they will not be able to protect their faces nor their backs from the Fire, and they have no help. Nay, it (the Fire) will come upon them all of a sudden and will perplex them, and they will have no power to avert it nor will they have any respite.} (21:39- 40) The gods ofthe Idolaters will disownThem at the Time when They needthem most Then Allah tells us that their gods will disown them*when they need them most. He says: 4And when those who associated partners with Allah see their partners} meaning, those whom they used to worship in this world. fi\ u ot is; itthey will say: "Our Lord! These are our partners whom we used to call upon besides you." But they will throw their statements back at them (saying) : "You are indeed liars!"} i.e., those gods will say to them, you are lying. We nev commanded you to worship us. Allah says: if (* i "" : "J ' sy JI J. V jil ojj Cri j-J lyj} 4 Ojf ft ip&1' lip iAnd who is more astray than one who calls upon others besides AlldJt, such as will not answer him till the Day of Resurrection, and who are (even) unaware of their invocations to them? And when the people are gathered (on the Day of Resurrection), they (false deities) will become their enemies and will deny their worship,} (46:5-6) 4And they have taken gods besides Allah, tlwt they might give them honor, power and glory. Nay, but they will deny their

508 Tafsir Ibtī Katiir worship, and become their adversaries (on the Day of Resurrection).) (19:81-82) Al-Khalil (Ibrahim) said: J&i) ibut on the Day of Resurrection, you will disown each other) [29:25] And Allah says: ! t iAnd it will be said (to them): "Call upon your partners") [28:64] And there are many other similar Ayat. Everything will surrender to Allah on the Day of Resurrection ihA it j" 0j) iAnd they will offer (their full) submission to Allah on that Day,) Qatadah and Ikrimah said: They will humble themselves and surrender on that Day, i.e., they will all surrender to Allah, there will not be anyone who does not hear and obey. As Allah says: J> jJj g\ iHow clearly will they see and hear, the Day when they will appear before Us!) [19:38] meaning, they will see and hear better than they have ever seen and heard before. And Allah says: 4 '- *" j i* (*r*J*J \f-i^ H SSP J iAnd if you only could see when the guilty hang their heads before their Lord (saying) ; "Our Lord! We have now seen and heard.") [32:12] Al-Tabari 17:276.

4^& :j\$^} 4And (all) faces shall be humbled before the Ever Living, the Sustainer.} [20:111] meaning, they will humble and submit themselves. 4And they will offer (their full) submission to Allah on that Day, and what they falsely invented will wander away from them.} The things that they used to worship which were sill based on fabrications and lies, will all disappear, and they will have no helper or supporter, and no one to turn to. Those among the Idolaters who corrupted Others will receive a Greater Punishment Then Allah tells us: 4Those who disbelieved and tried to obstruct the path of Allah, for them We will add torment} meaning one punishment for their disbelief and another punishment for turning others away from following the truth, as Allah says: .L (*>? 4And they prevent others from him and they themselves keep awayfrom him} [6:26] meaning they forbade others to follow him and they themselves shunned him, but: 4&Z" Vi &} 4they destroyed only themselves, while they do not realize it.} This is evidence that there will be varying levels of punishment for the disbelievers, just as there will be varying degrees of Paradise for the believers, as Allah says: 4'ofZ -JM p 4For each one there is double (torment), but you know not.}

510 Tafstr Ibn Kathir [7:38] Ujij Hy* & oi \$* '-V+i i| "L"j ts > tsz<&& p, iQ, d& 489. And on the Day when lNe resurrect a witness from each nation from among themselves, and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these. And We have revealed the Book (the Qur'an) to you as an explanation ofeverything, a guidance, a mercy, and good newsfor the Muslims.} Every Prophet will bear Witness against his Nation on the Day ofResurrection Allah addressed His servant and Messenger Muhammad sg, saying: d* Iju (^trr4* i s' \$ }And on the Day when We resurrect a witness from each nation from among themselves, and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these.}, meaning, your Ummah. The Ayah means: remember that Day and its terrors, and the great honor and high position that Allah has bestowed upon you. This Ayah is like the Ayah with which Abdullah bin Mas ud ended when he recited to the Messenger of Allah sg from the beginning of Surat An-Nisa . When he reached the Ayah: ft iti 'H '-&*} }How (will it be) then, when We bring from each nation a witness and We bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these?} [4:41] the Messenger of Allah jg said to him: uEnoughj Ibn Mas'ud said: I turned to him and saw his eyes streaming with tears. m Fath Al-BQri 8:99.

An-Nahl (89) (Part-14) The Qur an explains Everything p teoa&& iAnd We revealed the Book (the Qur'an) to you as an explanation ofeverything,} Ibn Mastid said: (Allah] made it clear that in this Qur

an there is complete knowledge and about everything. 1 11 The Qur'an contains all kinds of beneficial knowledge, such as reports of what happened in the past, information about what is yet to come, what is lawful and unlawful, and what people need to know about their worldly affairs, their religion, their livelihood in this world, and their destiny in the Hereafter. 4a guidance^ means, for their hearts. 4a mercy, and good news for the Muslims.} Al-Awza'i said: 4tcfP te && Q&& 4And We have revealed the Book (the Qur'an) as an explanation of everything, 4 meaning, with the Sunnah.(2) The is the reason why the phrase, 4CZ \&& (\$) } 4And We have revealed the Book to you is mentioned immediately after the phrase, 4H3^& &rr And We shall bring you (O Muhammad) as a witness against these.} the meaning - and Allah knows best - is that the One Who obligated you to convey the Book which He revealed to you, will also ask you about that on the Day of Resurrection. At-Tabari 17:269. Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 : 158 .

4 .K J j^ iThen We shall indeed question those (people) to whom it (the Book) was sent and We shall indeed question the Messengers. (7:6) 4So by i/owr Lord We question them all about what they did.} (15:92-92) J^e" ^^ V 'jl '*(Jyu> j-Ljli iif iTV? 40m the Day when Allah gathers the Messengers together and says to them: "What was the response you received (to your Message)?" They will say: "We have no knowledge, indeed only You are the Knower of all that is hidden." (5:109) And Allah says: 4** ^i() Jajj Lfjji 4Verily, He Wlw obligated the Qur'an upon you (O Muhammad) will surely bring you back to the return.} [28:85] meaning, the One Who gave you the obligation of conveying the Qur'an will bring you back to Him, and your return will be on the Day of Resurrection, and He will question you about your commission of the duty He gave you. This is one of the opinions, and it presents a good understanding of it. 4#^& pL;#5 490. Verily, Allah orders justice and kindness, and giving (help) to the relatives, and He forbids immoral sins, and evil and tyranny. He admonishes you, so that perhaps you may take heed.} The Command to be Fair and Kind Allah tells us that He commands His servant to be just, i.e., fair and moderate, and that He encourages kindness and good treatment. As He says: J . jjjj U i iLaJ f jX. ojj}

4And if you punish them, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted. But if you have patience with them, then it is better Jbr those who are patient (16:126) iThe recompense for an offense is an offense the like thereof; but whoever forgives and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah.} [42:40] iand wounds equal for equal. But if anyone remits the retaliation by way of charity, it shall count as atonement for him.} [5:45] And there are other Ayat which support the institution of justice in Islam, as well as encouraging a fair and generous attitude. The Command to maintain the Ties of Kinship and the prohibition of Immoral Sins, Evil and Tyranny S'i if&ij} iand giving Qielp) to relatives,} meaning that Allah is commanding us to uphold the ties of kinship, as He says: Vj is l^Cj} iAnd give the relative his due and to the poor and to the wayfarer. But do not spend wastefully in the manner of a spendthrift.} (17:26) iand He forbids immoral sins, and evil} Fahsha refers to all things that are forbidden, and Munkar refers to those forbidden deeds that are committed openly by the one who does them. Hence Allah says elsewhere: G JL J~# Ci ji> 4Say (O Muhammad): (But) the things that my Lord has indeed forbidden are the indecencies, whether committed openly

them whom He killed at Badr, then His Messenger and the believers gained the upper hand, and Allah enabled His Messenger^ to conquer Makkah, and He disgraced them and humiliated them (the

disbelievers). Then Allah says: who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah or denies the truth, when it comes to him?} There is no one who will be more severely punished than one who tells lies about Allah and says that Allah revealed something to him at the time when Allah did not reveal anything to him, or says, I shall reveal something like that which Allah revealed. And there is no one who will be more severely punished than one who denies the truth when it comes to him, for the former is a fabricator and the latter is a disbeliever. Allah says: Is there not a dwelling in Hell for the disbelievers?} Then Allah says: For those who strive hard for Us, meaning the Messenger[^] and his Companions and those who follow him, until the Day of Resurrection, We will surely guide them to Our paths.} means, *We will help them to follow Our path in this world and the Hereafter. Ibn Abi Hatim narrated that Abbas Al-Hamdani Abu Ahmad - one of the people of Akka (Palestine) - said, concerning the Ayah: [^] CLj di&j} iAs far those who strive hard for Us (in Our cause), We will surely guide them to Our paths. And verily, Allah is with the doers of good.}

she has spun, after it has become strong, by taking your oaths as a means of deception among yourselves when one group is more numerous than another group. Allah only tests you by this, and on the Day of Resurrection, He will certainly clarify that which used to differ over.} The Command to fulfill the Covenant This is one of the commands of Allah, to fulfill covenants, keep promises and to fulfill oaths after confirming them. Thus Allah says: AS3\$ iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them} There is no conflict between this and the Aydt. "jj} 4And do not use Allah as an excuse in your oaths} (2:224] iThat is the expiation for oaths when you have sworn. And protect your oaths.} [5:89] meaning, do not forgo your oaths without offering the penance. There is also no conflict between this Ayah (16:91) and the Hadith reported in the Two Sahths according to which the Prophet jgl said: [^]iJl c_;f VJ l 'js*- tjfc jrti <_J[^] *-[^] V "&' jj 4llj [^]l" Cj'jj oij - j "By Allah, if Allah wills, I will not swear an oath and then realize that something else is better, but I do that which is better and find a way to free myself from the oath. According to another report he said: "and I offer penance for my oath. i I 1 ' There is no contradiction at all between all of these texts and the Ayah under discussion here, which is: FathAl-Bari 1 1 :525, Muslim 3 :1269

518 Tafstr Ibn Kathir iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them} because these are the kinds of oaths that have to do with covenants and promises, not the kind that have to do with urging oneself to do something or preventing him from doing something. Therefore Mujahid said concerning this Ayah: 4&+SZ %} iand do not break the oaths after you have confirmed them The oath here refers to oaths made during Jahiliyyahfi 1] This supports the Hadth recorded by Imam Ahmad from Jubayr bin Mut'im, who said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: iijJ 'i UUjl J SiS jL- U:V| [^] 'jt sli "There is no oath in Islam, and any oath made during the Jahiliyyah is only reinforced by Islam, This was also reported by MuslimJ3 The meaning is that Islam does not need oaths as they were used by the people of the Jahiliyyah-, adherence to Islam is sufficient to do away with any need for what they used to customarily give oaths for. In the Two Sahihis it was reported that Anas said: The Messenger of Allah ([^]) swore the treaty of allegiance between the Muhajirin (emigrants) and the Ansar (helpers) in our house. ' This means that he established brotherhood between them, and they used to inherit from one another, until Allah abrogated that. And Allah knows best. L ii \ iVerily, Allah knows what you do.} This is a warning and a threat to those who break their oaths after confirming them. Tabari 17:282. (2) Ahmad 4:83. * Muslim 4 :1961 ' Path Al-B&ri 4 :552, Muslim 4 : 1960

&&U SjZ iAnd do not be like the one who undoes the thread which she has spun, after it has become strong, Abdullah bin Kathir and As-Suddi said: This was a foolish woman in Makkah. Everytime she spun thread and made it strong, she would undo it again. 111 Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said: This is like the one who breaks a covenant after confirming it. 121 This view is more correct and more apparent, whether or not there was a woman in Makkah who undid her thread after spinning it. The word Ankathan could be referring back to the word translated as undoes, reinforcing the meaning, or it could be the predicate of the verb to be, meaning, do not be Ankathan, the plural of Nakth (breach, violation), from the word Nakith (perfidious). Hence after this, Allah says: 4.by taking your oaths as a means of deception among yourselves^ meaning for the purposes of cheating and tricking one another. 0U\$ Jt& & iwhen one group is more numerous than another group.} meaning, you swear an oath with some people if they are more in number than you, so that they can trust you, but when you are able to betray them you do so. Allah forbids that, by showing a case where treachery might be expected or excused, but He forbids it. If treachery is forbidden in such a case, then in cases where one is in a position of strength it is forbidden more emphatically. Mujahid said: They used to enter into alliances and covenants, then find other parties who were more powerful and more numerous, so they would cancel the alliance with the first group and make an alliance with the second who were more powerful and more numerous. This is what they were forbidden to do." Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said something similar. At-Tabari 17:285. At-Tabari 17:285.

520 Tafstr Ibn Kathir ^ tva V, T ^ </UW, on/y fflfs ycm fry //iis^ Said bin Jubayr said: This means (you are tested) by the large numbers. 111 This was reported by Ibn Abi Hatim. Ibn Jarir said: It means (you are being tested) by His command to you to adhere to your covenants. ^ C j3 4AmJ on the Day of Resurrection, He will certainly clarify that which you differed over.} Everyone will be rewarded or punished in accordance with his deeds,goodorevil.121 %% \$3 fir its j5j" 'j \ \}j% <&% f2 ^ ^ E5\$ gisjcs & fir ! s% fiu Jr^ ^ ;i*ss ^ < (5 ' xe -i&t &*, r* S' a)^ j - S* ji* ie 4^ i y=" c Ua-" o'Jr '1^SC^ieUj >" *, *\" >'.' '*{." ;>'.' ".t.t /. - ^-1 . * ~> ayf-ji. >!. .U Ijl I^'S . t < \ s' 'i " o^ => je. ^ ' 'ft . And luid Allah willed, He would have made you (all) one nation, but He allows whom He wills to stray and He guides whom He wills. But you shall certainly be called to account for what you used to do.} 111 Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :163Tabari 17:287.

An-Nahl (93-96) (Part-14) 494. And do not make your oaths a means of deception among yourselves, resulting in the slip of a foot after it was firmly planted, and you taste the evil ofhaving hinderedfrom the path ofAllah, and you will suffer a terrible punishment.} 495. And do not use an oath by Allah for the purchase of little value, what is with Allah is betterfor you ifyou only knew. 496. Whatever you have will be exhausted, and what is with Allah will remain. And to those who are patient. We will certainly grant them their rewards in proportion to the best of what they used to do.} IfAllahhad willed,He would have made allofHumanity one Nation Allah says: 4And had Allah willed, He would have made you} meaning - O mankind. 4(oil) one nation,} This is like the Ayah ofjV' y iliy ili 4And had your Lord willed, all of those on earth would luwe believed together.} [10:99], meaning, He could have created harmony among them, and there would not be any differences, conflicts or hatred between them. Vl iii 33- 4: 52, 3j} 4And ifyour Lord had so willed, He would surely, have made mankind one Ummah [nation or community], but they will not cease to disagree . Except him on whom your Lord

has bestowed His mercy, and for that did He create them.) (1 : 1 18- 1 19) Similarly, Allah says here: ' "

ibnt He allows whom He wills to stray and He guides whom He wills.} Then on the Day of Resurrection, He will ask them all about their deeds, and will reward or punish them even equal to a scalish thread in the long slit of a date stone or the size of a speck on the back of a date stone, or even a thin membrane of the date stone. The Prohibition on taking an Oath for Purposes of Treachery Then Allah warns His servant against taking oaths as means of deception, i.e., using them for treacherous purposes, lest a foot should slip after being firmly planted. This is an analogy describing one who was on the right path but then deviated and slipped from the path of guidance because of an unfulfilled oath that involved hindering people from the path of Allah. This is because if a disbeliever were to find that after having agreed to a covenant, then the believer betrayed him, then the believer will have hindered him from entering Islam. Thus Allah says: JC- tL \jjZj} iand you taste the evil of having hindered from the path of Allah, and you will suffer a terrible punishment.> Do not break Oaths for the sake of Worldly Gain Then Allah says: iAnd do not use an oath by Allah for the purchase of little value.} meaning, do not neglect an oath sworn in the Name of Allah for the sake of this world and its attractions, for they are few, and even if the son of Adam were to gain this world and all that is in it, that which is with Allah is better for him, i.e., the reward of Allah is better for the one who puts his hope in Him, believes in Him, seeks Him and fulfills his oaths in the hope of that which Allah has promised. This is why Allah says:

An-Nahl (97) (Part-14) iif you only knew. Whatever you have will be exhausted, meaning, it will come to an end and will vanish, because it is only there for a certain, limited time. iand what is with Allah will remain .} meaning, His reward for you in Paradise will remain, without interruption or end, because it is eternal and will never change nor disappear. i&XZ afXXX uX iAnd to those xvho are patient, We will certainly grant them their rewards in proportion to the best of what they used to do.} Here the Lord swears, with the Lam of affirmation, that He will reward the patient for the best of their deeds, i.e., He will forgive them for their bad deeds. i' i," a ' < -it ' "V 497. Whoever does righteous deeds - whether male or female - while he (or she) is a believer; then We will certainly give them a good life, and We will certainly grant them their rewards in proportion to the best of what they used to do.} Righteous Deeds and their Reward This is a promise from Allah to those Children of Adam, male or female, who do righteous deeds - deeds in accordance with the Book of Allah and the Sunnah of His Prophet with a heart that believes in Allah and His Messenger jg, while believing that these deeds are commanded and enjoined by Allah. Allah promises that He will give them a good life in this world and that He will, reward them according to the best of their deeds in the Hereafter. The good life includes feeling tranquillity in all aspects of life. It has been reported that Ibn Abbas and a group (of scholars) interpreted it to mean good, lawful provisions. It was reported that Ali bin Abi Talib interpreted as contentment. This was also the opinion of Ibn Abbas, Ikrimah and Wahb bin Munabbih. Ali bin Abi Talhah

An-Nahl (101-102) (Part-14) would not confuse him or stop him from thinking about and pondering over the meaning of what he reads. Hence the majority of scholars said that refuge should be sought with Allah before starting to read. iVerily, he has no power over those who believe and put their trust only in their Lord.} Ath-Thawri said: He has no power to make them commit a sin they will not repent

from." Others said: it means that he has no argument for them. Others said it is like the Ayah 4Except Your chosen servants amongst them.} [15:40] 4His power is only over those who obey/ and follow him (Shaytan),} Mujahid said: Those who obey him. 121 Others said, Those who take him as their protector instead of Allah. 4and those who join partners with Him.} means, those who associate others in worship with Allah. ^ .U. "if s'.' :t > > >' { ' :i jl' c-nJ -i'jj j" o;*jJ' jj Ah J" j ' 4101. And when We change a verse in place of another - and Allah knows best what He reveals - they (the disbelievers) say: "You (O Muhammad) are but a forger." Rather, most of them know not.} 4102. Say (O Midiammad); "Ruh-ul-Qudus has brought it (the Qur'an) down from your Lord with truth." for the conviction of those who believe, and as a guide and good news for the Muslims.} Tabari 17:294. Tabari 17:294.

2 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Idolaters Accusation that the Prophet was a Liar since some Ayat were abrogated, and the Refutation of their Claim Allah tells us of the weak minds of the idolaters, and their lack of faith and conviction. He explains that it is impossible for them to have faith when He has decreed that they are doomed. When they saw that some rulings had been changed by being abrogated, they said to the Messenger of Allah jg: ipZ 'JU\) iYoti are but a forger') meaning one who tells lies. But Allah is the Lord Who does whatever He wills, and rules as He wants. iAtid when We change a verse (of the Qur'an) in place of another) Mujahid said: this means, We remove one and put another in its place. ' Qatadah said: this is like the Ayah: iWhatever verse We change [abrogate] or omit [the abrogated]..." (2:106). (2 ' Allah said, in response to them: \$Say: Ruh-ul-Qudus has brought it..." meaning, Jibril, -> ifrom your Lord with truth,) meaning, with truthfulness and justice ifor the conviction of those who believe,) so that they will believe what was revealed earlier and what was revealed later, and humble themselves towards Allah. At-Jabari 17:297. At-Jabari 17:297.

o' ft ' .yii ' .V\<. rfSc" # ,1 " ,<:<' 0jl# } ^\&Q%'\pLXL \,d& JLgjUJplait^r_l" iatid as a guide and good news for the Muslims.} meaning He has made it a guide and good news to the Muslims who believe in Allah and His Messengers. U^l -&f} j^a is Ijcjy i i) ba 4103. And indeed We know that they (polytheists and pagans) say : "It is only a human being who teaches him." The tongue of the man they refer to is foreign , while this (the Qur'an) is (in) a clear Arabic tongue.} The Idolaters Claim that the Qur'an was taught by a Human, and the Refutation of their Claim Allah tells us about the idolaters lies, allegations, and slander when they claimed that this Qur'an which Muhammad gg had recited for them, was actually taught to him by a human. They referred to a foreign (i.e., non-Arab) man who lived among them as the servant of some of the clans of Quraysh and who used to sell goods by As-Safa. Maybe the Messenger of Allah jg used to sit with him sometimes and talk to him a little, but he was a foreigner who did not know much Arabic, only enough simple phrases to answer questions when he had to. So in refutation of their claims of fabrication, Allah said: 4S4 JLpz la, iLij > jjfo s J \}

iThe tongue of the man they refer to is foreign, while this (the Qur'an) is a (in) clear Arabic tongue. meaning, how could it be that this Qur'an with its eloquent style and perfect meanings, which is more perfect than any Book revealed to any previously sent Prophet, have been learnt from a foreigner who hardly speaks the language? No one with the slightest amount of common sense would say such a thing. Gl %\ ^ l\} 4104. Verily, those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat (signs, or revelation), Allah will not guide them, and theirs will be a painful punishment. 4105. It is only those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat who fabricate the falsehood, and it is they who are liars.} Allah tells us that He does not guide

those who turn away from remembering Him and who are heedless of that which He revealed to His Messenger jg, those who have no intention of believing in that which he has brought from Allah. This kind of people will never be guided to faith by the signs of Allah and the Message which He sent His Messengers in this world, and they will suffer a painful and severe punishment in the Hereafter. Then Allah informs us that His Messenger jgjj is not a forger nor a liar, because the one who fabricates falsehood about Allah and His Messenger is the most evil of creatures. 4\$ 4Verily, those who do not believe in Allah's Ayat,} Allah will not guide them, and theirs will be a painful punishment, meaning, the disbelievers and heretics who are known to the people as liars. The Messenger Muhammad lj , on the other hand, was the most honest and righteous of people, the most perfect in knowledge, deeds, faith and conviction. He was known among his people for his truthfulness and no one among them had any doubts about that - to such an extent that they always addressed him as Al- Amin (the Trustworthy) Muhammad. Thus when Heraclius, the king of the Romans, asked Abu Sufyan about the attributes of the Messenger of Allah one of the things he said to him was.

Did you ever accuse him of lying before he made his claim? Abu Sufyan said, No . Heraclius said, He would refrain from lying about people and then go and fabricate lies about Allah? bl4 i ^Lj\3x. C~^ > \$j" 1j-w> 'Qjy- 3\$ SMi V it^ i ii Lll V j*-A l"viut) J . Wlwever disbelieves in Allah after his belief - except one who was forced while his heart is at peace with the faith - but whoever opens their breasts to disbelief, on them is wrath from Allah, and theirs will be a terrible torment.} 4107. That is because they preferred the life of this world over that of the Hereafter. And Alltih does not guide the people who disbelieve.} 4108. They are those upon whose hearts, hearing (ears) and sight (eyes) Allah has set a seal over. And they are the heedless!} 4109. No doubt, in the Hereafter they will be the losers.} Allah s Wrath against the Apostate, except for the One Who is forced into Disbelief Allah tells us that He is angry with them who willingly disbelieve in Him after clearly believing in Him, who open their hearts to disbelief finding peace in that, because they understood the faith yet they still turned away from it. They will suffer severe punishment in the Hereafter, because they preferred this life to the Hereafter, and they left the faith for the sake of this world and Allah did not guide their hearts and help them to stand firm in the true religion. He put a seal on their hearts so that they would not be able to understand

what is beneficial for them, and He sealed their ears and eyes

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3069–3089]

so that they would not benefit from them. Their faculties did not help them at all, so they are unaware of what is going to happen to them.

4No doubt means, it is inevitable, and no wonder that those who are like this - 4 \) 4in the Hereafter, they will be the losers.) meaning, they will lose themselves and their families on the Day of Resurrection. ijliw jtiiij "> s="i f iexcept one who was forced while his heart is at peace with the faith) This is an exception in the case of one who utters statements of disbelief and verbally agrees with the Mushrikin because he is forced to do so by the beatings and abuse to which he is subjected, but his heart refuses to accept what he is saying, and he is, in reality, at peace with his faith in Allah and His Messenger \$^g. The scholars agreed that if a person is forced into disbelief, it is permissible for him to either go along with them in the interests of self-preservation, or to refuse, as Bilal did when they were

inflicting all sorts of torture on him, even placing a huge rock on his chest in the intense heat and telling him to admit others as partners with Allah. He refused, saying, Alone, Alone. And he said, By Allah, if I knew any word more annoying to you than this, I would say it. May Allah be pleased with him. Similarly, when the Liar MQsaylimah asked Habib bin Zayd Al- Ansari, Do you bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah? He said, Yes. Then Musaylimah asked, Do you bear witness that I am the messenger of Allah? Habib said, I do not hear you. Musaylimah kept cutting him, piece by piece, but he remained steadfast insisting on his words. It is better and preferable for the Muslim to remain steadfast in his religion, even if that leads to him being killed, as was mentioned by Al-Hafiz Ibn Asakir in his biography of Abdullah bin Hudhafah Al-Sahmi, one of the Companions. He said that he was taken prisoner by the Romans, who brought him to their king. The king said, Become a Christian, and I will give you a share of my kingdom and my daughter in m Asad Al-Ghabah 1049.

An-Nahl (106- 109) (Part-14 marriage. Abdullah said: If you were to give me all that you possess and all that Arabs possess to make me give up the religion of Muhammad jg even for an instant, I would not do it. The king said, Then I will kill you. Abdullah said, It is up to you. The king gave orders that he should be crucified, and commanded his archers to shoot near his hands and feet while ordering him to become a Christian, but he still refused. Then the king gave orders that he should be brought down, and that a big vessel made of copper be brought and heated up. Then, while Abdullah was watching, one of the Muslim prisoners was brought out and thrown into it, until all that was left of him was scorched bones. The king ordered him to become a Christian, but he still refused. Then he ordered that Abdullah be thrown into the vessel, and he was brought back to the pulley to be thrown in. Abdullah wept, and the king hoped that he would respond to him, so he called him, but Abdullah said, I only weep because I have only one soul with which to be thrown into this vessel at this moment for the sake of Allah; I wish that I had as many souls as there are hairs on my body with which I could undergo this torture for the sake of Allah. According to some reports, the king imprisoned him and deprived him of food and drink for several days, then he sent him wine and pork, and he did not come near them. Then the king called him and asked him, What stopped you from eating? Abdullah said, It is permissible for me (under these circumstances), but I did not want to give you the opportunity to gloat. The king said to him, Kiss my head and I will let you go. Abdullah said, And will you release all the Muslim prisoners with me? The king said, Yes. So Abdullah kissed his head and he released him and all the other Muslim prisoners he was holding. When he came back, TJmar bin Al- Khattab said, Every Muslim should kiss the head of Abdullah bin Hudhafah, and I will be the first to do so. And he stood up and kissed his head. May Allah be pleased with them both.!

1 u dJi& t'i' / *' " \ 't Y. \ l* M < " t "A * < f Al-Hafiz (Ibn Hajar) mentioned this story in brief in Al-Isdbah (4641) , and attributed it to Al-Bayhaqi.

^vil? 'J L.j- U y-a j^=" 4220. 77ie", verily, your Lord far those who emigrated after they were put to trials and then performed Jihad, and were patient, - after this, your Lord is indeed Forgiving, Most Merciful.} 4222 . (Remember) the Day when every person will come pleadingfar himself, and every one will be paid in fall far what he did, and they will not be dealt with unjustly.} TheOnewho isforcedtorenounceIslam willbe forgiven ifHe does Righteous Deeds afterwards This refers to another group of people who were oppressed in Makkah and whose position with their own people was weak, so they went along with them when they were tried by them. Then they managed to escape by emigrating, leaving their homeland, families and wealth behind, seeking the pleasure and forgiveness of

Allah. They joined the believers and fought with them against the disbelievers, bearing hardship with patience. Allah tells them that after this, meaning after their giving in when put to the test, He will forgive them and show mercy to them when they are resurrected. i(Remember) the Day when every person will come pleading meaning making a case in his own defence. } ifar himself.} means, no one else will plead on his behalf; not his father, not his son, nor his brother, nor his wife. / ; " ?> ^oL-c. L HyjT iand every one will be paid in fall for what he did,} meaning whatever he did, good or evil. v >} iand they will not be dealt with unjustly.} meaning there will be no decrease in the reward for good, and no increase in the punishment for evil. They will not be dealt

frf ^ &F [tr > 3*p vf? tp' :pres qBqv sb jbsj o; paau ou poq aq pus ajos sbm aq 'qmpfBi^ pajajua jaAaoq/w ;i jo apisjno ajaq/vutiaAa uiojj Xbmb paqajBus Suxaq aia/w uaui apqM iCiBrqauBS ajnaas b ajqBjs puB pryaoBad amoas uaaq pinq qoiq/w qBjppew jo ajdoad aq; o; sjajaj ajduiBxa sxqx qBqqupijo afdnnrata aqx 4*susopSuoum 3U3m foqi 3/11/02 ui3i{t pszps }U3iiuof sif) os 'tuiif psuwp /hip jnq ssapsuisip Suoiuo Uiojf U3Su3SS3p\l V UtStfl 0} 3U103 SVl(3J31U H) i P!P folQ }Vl{(TLfo 3Stwo -sq 'uv3f puv (juuiivf) J3%um{ 3U13J)X3 3)SV1 1} 3pvui qpuv os -IQ}} -IY fo sxoavf siff psxusp (3} do3d si}) V 1nq '33v\ d fu303 uiojf souvpunqv ut a oi 8umoo uotsiaoud SI! ' inf33V3d puv 3X1133\$ svm a '(t{V3pp>]^\i) dftfs -ucnoi v fo 3jduwx3 sqi S3(u8 ifpjy puy lift icp?# fXr rXi thrift n yr<*l -< if ip"-'. ,|, n' Crmr *"-*- "l ' ' < ' ' 'Vs- 'V < irf5 rjRf^ b -5\$ \yf if %&> \?< ft? 3? ? S TTfrt f+\ T0 # 5P CP 9-? -iCBM ;sa;qSqs aq; ui /Cflsnfun qiM ?fp^rr^fe !trific? 5r=^r!TTT!f1 '?r?rrS\$ ^"v-J-fr> *cri<" q-"r(j-J ipnri /nrc==ip^ #! r*r""^vvor^?r v- ^ ^ ^" *?5^rTTf^05ESj53P f' < ' ! y "o; Vi ees (w-w) mi-zu)wh-w 9ims

4and fear}. This refers to the fact that their sense of security was replaced with fear of the Messenger of Allah sH and his Companions after they had migrated to Al-Madlnah. They feared the power and the attack of his armies, and they started to lose and face the destruction of everything that belonged to them, until Allah made it possible for His Messenger sg to conquer Makkah. This happened because of their evil deeds, their wrongdoing and their rejection of the Messenger that Allah sent to them from among themselves. He reminded them of this blessing in the Ayah: Oj 'ijr'j c> 4Indeed, Allah blessed the believers when He sent Messenger from among themselves to them.} (3:164) and, 4i ^ < *j3i 3 2 C 'S -4V? jjk& 4So have Taqwd of Allah! 0 men of understanding who have believed, Allah has indeed revealed to you a reminder (this Qur'an). (And has also sent to you) a Messenger.} [65:10-1 1] and: 4Similarly (as a blessing), We have sent a Messenger to you from among you, reciting Our Aydt to you, and purifying you, and teaching you the Book (the Qur'an) and the Hikmah (i.e. Sunnah).} Until iand do not be ungrateful.} (2:151-152) Allah changed the situation of the disbelievers and made it the opposite of what it had been, so they lived in fear after being secure, they were hungry after having plenty of provisions. After the believers lived in fear, Allah granted them security, giving them ample provisions after they lived in poverty, making them rulers, governors and leaders of mankind. This is what we say about the example that was given of the people of Makkah. It was also the opinion of Al-

Awfi and Ibn Abbas,111 Mujahid, Qatadah, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam, and Malik narrated it from Az-Zuhri as well. May Allah have mercy on them all. 4 4? 4 if ip i^M; ci if pL&z n. \ if pj '{S,O pLS\dpa & if 4 fr% % J 3p y vi3? if 1\$ 4 vjS3' if ! \$ u j ui 4#\$ # jie 4114. So eof of the lawful and good food which Allah has provided for you. And be grateful for Allah's favor, if it is He Whom you worship.

4115. He has only forbidden dead flesh, blood, the flesh of swine, and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah. But if one is forced by necessity, without willful disobedience, nor transgressing, then, Allah is Pardoning, Most Merciful 4116. And do not describe what your tongues have lied about, saying: "This is lawful and this is forbidden," to invent lies against Allah. Verily, those who invent lies against Allah, will never succeed 4117. A passing brief enjoyment (will be theirs), but they will suffer a painful torment. The Command to eat Lawful Provisions and to be Thankful, and an Explanation of what is Unlawful Allah orders His believing servants to eat the good and lawful things that He has provided, and to give thanks to Him for that, for He is the Giver and Originator of all favors. Who alone deserves to be worshipped, having no partners or associate. Then Allah mentions what He has forbidden things which harm them in both religious and worldly affairs, i.e., dead meat, blood and the flesh of pigs. At-Tabari 17:309. At-Tabari 17:310.

and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for other than Allah.) meaning, it was slaughtered with the mention of a name other than that of Allah. Nevertheless, at iBut if one is forced by necessity.) meaning, if one needs to do it, without deliberately disobeying or transgressing, then, O-& \$t iAllah is Pardoning, Most Merciful.) We have already discussed a similar Ayah in Surat Al-Baqarah, and there is no need to repeat it here. And to Allah be praise. Then Allah forbids us to follow the ways of the idolators who declare things to be permitted or forbidden based upon their own whims and whatever names they agree on, such as the Bahlrah (a she-camel whose milk was spared for the idols and nobody was allowed to milk it), the Sa ibah (a she-camel let loose for free pasture for their false gods, idols, etc., and nothing was allowed to be carried on it), the Wasflah (a she- camel set free for idols because it has given birth to a she- camel at its first delivery and then again gives birth to a she- camel at its second delivery) and the Ham (a stallion camel freed from work for the sake of their idols, after it had finished a number of acts of copulation assigned for it), and so on. All of these were laws and customs that were invented during jdhUiyyah. Then Allah says: fd& ui pLJ JUQ \&%) And do not describe what your tongues have lied about, saying: "This is lawful and this is forbidden, to invent lies against Allah.) This includes everyone who comes up with an innovation (Bid'ah) for which he has no evidence from the SharVah, or whoever declares something lawful that Allah has forbidden, or whoever declares something unlawful that Allah has permitted, only because it suits his opinions or whim to do so.

{describe what . meaning, do not speak lies because of what your tongues put forth. Then Allah warns against that by saying: {Verily, those who invent lies against Allah, will never succeed meaning, either in this world or the Hereafter. As for this world, it is transient pleasure, and in the Hereafter, theirs will be a severe punishment, as Allah says: {We let them enjoy for a little while, then in the end We will drive them into an unrelenting punishment. (31:24) Mi !\$6-c^ v&i' ^ {Verily, those who invent a lie against Allah, will never be successful. (A brief) enjoyment in this world! and then to Us will be their return, then We shall make them taste the severest torment because they disbelievedf (10:69-70) ->' *? ft s"\' > '.A. x|yo Uj di* mj) U yil* /M\ jJpjy "iU'i Juu ot j>*Lj Jr * S\ ijL* d! IjVpJjildij 0"i ,>* ilijj uj {118. And for those who are Jews, We have forbidden such things as We have mentioned to you beforeP And We did not wrong them, but they wronged themselves\$ {119. Then, your Lord for those who did evil out of ignorance and afterward repent and do righteous deeds - verily, after that, your Lord is Pardoning, Most Mercifiilf 111 See Al-An'dm 6:146.

Some Good Things were Forbidden for the Jews After mentioning that He has forbidden us to eat dead meat, blood, the flesh of swine, and any animal which is slaughtered as a sacrifice for others than Allah, and after making allowances for cases of necessity - which is part of making things easy for this Ummah, because Allah desires ease for us, not hardship - Allah then mentions what He forbade for the Jews in their laws before they were abrogated, and the restrictions, limitations and difficulties involved therein. He tells us: *And for those who are Jews, We have forbidden such things as We have mentioned to you before.* meaning in Surat Al-An'am, where Allah says: *And unto those who are Jews, We forbade every (animal) with undivided hoof, and We forbade them the fat of the ox and the sheep except what adheres to their backs* Until, *We are indeed truthful* [6:146] Hence Allah says here: *And We did "of wrong them,"* meaning, in the restrictions that We imposed upon them. *But they wronged themselves.* meaning, they deserved that. This is like the Ayah (31:17) *"Because of the wrong committed of those who were Jews, We prohibited certain good foods which had been lawful for them - and (also) for their hindering many from Allah's way."* (4:160)

Allah, a Hanif (monotheist), and he was not one of the idolaters.} 4121. (He was) thankful for His favors. He (Allah) chose him and guided him to a straight path.} 4122. And We gave him good in this world, and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.} 4123. Then, We have sent the revelation to you: Follow the religion of Ibrahim (he was a) Hanif, and he was not one of the idolaters."} The Khalil (Close Friend) of Allah Allah praises His servant, Messenger and close friend Ibrahim, the Imam of the Hanifs the father of the Prophets, and Allah declares Ibrahim's innocence of the idolaters, Jews or Christians. Allah says: *Verily, Ibrahim was (himself) a Ummah, obedient to Allah, a Hanif (monotheist)* Ummah here means the leader who is followed. Qanit (obedient to Allah) means humble and obedient. Hanif means one who deliberately steers clear of Shirk in favor of Tawhid. Hence Allah says: *and he was not one of the idolaters.* Mujahid said: Ummah [here] means that he was a nation on his own. (He was) thankful for His favors.} means, he gave thanks for the blessings that Allah gave him. As Allah says: *And of Ibrahim the one who fulfilled.* (53:37) which means that he did everything that Allah commanded him to do.

542 Tafsir Ibtisami He (Allah) chose him^ means. He selected him, as Allah says : *And before, We indeed gave Ibrahim his integrity, and We were indeed most knowledgeable about him* (21:51). Then Allah says: *and guided him to a straight path.* which means to worship Allah alone, without partners or associate, in the manner that He prescribed and which pleases Him. *And We gave him good in this world,* meaning, *We granted him all that a believer may require for a good and complete life in this world.* *and in the Hereafter he shall be of the righteous.* Concerning the Ayah: *And We gave him good in this world,* Mujahid said: This means a truthful tongue. *Then, We have sent the revelation to you: "Follow the religion of Ibrahim (he was a) Hanif..."* meaning, because of his perfection, greatness, and the soundness of his Tawhid and his way, We revealed to you, O Seal of the Messengers and Leader of the Prophets *Follow the religion of Ibrahim (he was a) Hanif and he was not of the idolaters.* This is like the Ayah in Surat Al-An'am:

"Truly, my Lord has guided me to a straight path, a right religion, the religion of Ibrahim, (he was a) Hanif and he was not of the idolaters. (6:161). Then Allah rebukes the Jews, and says: "The Sabbath was only prescribed for those who differed

concerning it, and verily, your Lord will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection about what they differed over. \$ The Prescription of the Sabbath for the Jews There is no doubt that for every nation, Allah prescribed one day of the week for people to gather to worship Him. For this Ummah He prescribed Friday, because it is the sixth day, on which Allah completed and perfected His creation. On this day He gathered and completed His blessings for His servants. It was said that Allah prescribed this day for the Children of Israel through His Prophet Musa, but they changed it and chose Saturday because it was the day on which the Creator did not create anything, as He had completed His creation on Friday. Allah made observance of the Sabbath obligatory for them in the laws of the Tawrah (Torah), telling them to keep the Sabbath. At the same time, He told them to follow Muhammad jg| when he was sent, and took their promises and covenant to that effect. Hence Allah says: iThe Sabbath was only prescribed Jbr those who differed concerning it,\$ Mujahid said: They observed the Sabbath (Saturday) and ignored Friday. 1 11 Then they continued to observe Saturday until Allah sent Isa bin Maryam. It was said that he told them m At-Tabari 17:320.

to change it to Sunday, and it was also said that he did not forsake the laws of the Tawrah except for a few rulings which were abrogated, and he continued to observe the Sabbath until he was taken up (into heaven). Afterwards, the Christians at the time of Constantine were the ones who changed it to Sunday in order to be different from the Jews, and they started to pray towards the east instead of facing the Dome (i.e., Jerusalem). And Allah knows best. It was reported in the Two Sahxhs that Abu Hurayrah heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: Ua pj llllj jy w-'lfSjJl & liiOjl fy OjaAJJ\ jyZjt ' ? ili Q Wifi Jill ^JJl ^ y jUxJlj Ijlp 3 *We are the last, but we will be the first on the Day of Resurrection, even though they were given the Book before us. This is the day that Allah obligated upon them, but they differed concerning it. Allah guided us to this day, and the people observe their days after us, the Jews on the following day and the Christians on the day after that. This version was recorded by Al-Bukhari. It was reported that Abu Hurayrah and Hudhayfah said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: fy. fA I liili jIS 5i' j-i' oJlJlj Jit! Uligi iL Jill tdill jil ja djyfVl illill fy 0 JJa liifSj i.0 II4JI *Allah let the people wlv come before us stray from Friday, so the Jews had Saturday and the Christians had Sunday. Tlien Allah brought us and guided us to Friday. So now there are Friday, Saturday and Sunday, thus they will follow us on the Day of Resurrection. We are the last of the people of this world, but will be the first on the Day of Resurrection, and will be the first to be judged, before all of creation ."[21 *** Fath Al-Bari 11 :526, Muslim 2 :586. Muslim 2:586.

An-Nahl (125) (Part-14) It was reported by Muslim. illy o) <->-1 jUii iVi-Ji o* j-" itii 4225. Jmrite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and fair preaching, and argue with them with that which is best. Truly, your Lord best knows who has strayed from His path, and He best knows those who are guided.) The Command to invite people to Allah with Wisdom and Good Preaching Allah commands His Messenger Muhammad jgg to invite the people to Allah with Hikmah (wisdom). Ibn Jarir said: That is what was revealed to him from the Book and the Sunnah. iand fair preaching) meaning, with exhortation and stories of the events that happened to people that are mentioned in the Qur an, which he is to tell them about in order to warn them of the punishment of Allah. iand argue with them with that which is best.) meaning, if any of them want to debate and argue, then let that be in the best manner, with kindness, gentleness and good speech, as Allah says elsewhere: iUk Jt sigJi & %) iAnd do not argue with the People of the Book, unless it be with that which is best, except for those who purposefully do

wrong.) [29:46] Allah commanded him to speak gently, as He commanded Musa and Harun to do when he sent them to Pharaoh, as He said: *And speak to him mildly, perhaps he may accept admonition* At-Jabari 17:321.

546 Tafsir Ibn Kathir or fear (Allah) {20:44}. *Truly, your Lord best knows who has strayed from His path,* meaning, Allah already knows who is doomed (destined for Hell) and who is blessed (destined for Paradise). This has already been written with Him and the matter is finished, so call them to Allah, but do not exhaust yourself with regret over those who go astray, for it is not your task to guide them. You are just a warner, and all you have to do is convey the Message, and it is He Who will bring them to account. *You cannot guide whom you love* [28:56] - *It is not up to you to guide them, but Allah guides whom He wills.* [2:72] *And if you punish them, then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted. But if you have patience with them, then it is better for those who are patient.* 4227. *And be patient, and your patience will not be, but by the help of Allah. And do not grieve over them, and do not be distressed by their plots.* 4128. *Truly, Allah is with those who have Taqwa, and the doers of good.* *The Command for Equality in Punishment* Allah commands justice in punishment and equity in settling the cases of rights. Abdur-Razzaq recorded that, concerning the Ayah, *See the Tafsir of Surat At-Tawbah 9:120*

An-Nahl (126-128) (Part-14) *then punish them with the like of that with which you were afflicted.* Ibn Sirin said, If a man among you takes something from you, then you should take something similar from him. This was also the opinion of Mujahid, Ibrahim, Al-Hasan Al-Basri, and others. Ibn Jarir also favored this opinion. Ibn Zayd said: They had been commanded to forgive the idolators, then some men became Muslim who were strong and powerful. They said, O Messenger of Allah, if only Allah would give us permission, we would sort out these dogs! Then this Ayah was revealed, then it was later abrogated by the command to engage in Jihad. *And be patient, and your patience will not be but by the help of Allah.* This emphasizes the command to be patient and tells us that patience cannot be acquired except by the will, help, decree, and power of Allah. Then Allah says: *And do not grieve over them,* meaning, those who oppose you, for Allah has decreed that this should happen. *and do not be distressed* means do not be worried or upset. *by their plots.* meaning; because of the efforts they are putting into opposing you and causing you harm, for Allah is protecting, helping, and supporting you, and He will cause you to prevail and defeat them. *Truly, Allah is with those who have Taqwa, and the doers of good.* Abdur-Razzaq At-Tabari 17:524, 525. At-Tabari 17:324.

those who have Taqwa means, they keep away from that which is forbidden. *and the doers of good.* meaning they do deeds of obedience to Allah. These are the ones whom Allah takes care of, He gives them support, and helps them to prevail over their enemies and opponents. This is end of the Tafsir of Surat An-Nahl To Allah be praise and blessings, and peace and blessings be upon Muhammad and his family and Companions.

Module 19

Surah 17: Al-Isra

Surah 17: Al-Isra

PDF pages 3090–3273

Opening

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF p. 3090]

Opening The Tafsir of Surat Al-Isra (Chapter - 17) Which was revealed in Makkah

The Virtues of Surat Al-Isra'

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3090–3125]

Imam Al-Hafiz Abu Abdullah Muhammad bin Ismail Al-Bukhari recorded that Ibn Mas'ud ra said concerning Surah Bani Isra U (i.e., Surat Al-Isra), Al-Kahf and Maryam: They are among the earliest and most beautiful Surahs and they are my treasure. Imam

Who took His servant for a journey} refers to Muhammad sa by Night means, in the depths of the night. from Al-Masjid Al-Haram} means the Masjid in Makkah. to Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa,} means the Sacred House which is in Jerusalem, the origin of the Prophets from the time of Ibrahim Al-Khalil. The Prophets all gathered there, and he (Muhammad j) led them in prayer in their own homeland. This indicates that he is the greatest leader of all, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him and upon them. the neighborhood whereof We have blessed} means, its agricultural produce and fruits are blessed in order that We might show him}, i.e., Muhammad j of Our Ayat.} i.e., great signs. As Allah says:

! 41)1 (J) Al-Buraq was brought to me, and it was a white animal bigger than a donkey and smaller than a mule. One stride of this creature covered a distance as far as it could see. I rode on it and it took me to Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem), where I tethered it at the hitching post of the Prophets. Then I entered and prayed two Rak'ahs there, and came out. Jibril brought me a vessel of wine and a vessel of milk, and I chose the milk. Jibril said: 'You have chosen the Fitrah (natural instinct).' Then I was taken up to the first heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Adam, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the second heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw the two maternal cousins, Yahya and Isa, who welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the third heaven and Jibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened for us, and there I saw Yusuf, who had been given the beautiful half. He welcomed me and prayed for good for me. Then I was taken up to the fourth heaven

and Jibril asked far it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened far us, and there I saw Idris, who welcomed me and prayed far good far me. - then (the Prophet jg) said : Allah says 4 And We raised him to a high station (19:57).

JiJr ^ J : Jrfi Jijfr ^li wliJl jUiJl J] \L_ & 4JI Ji Jli ?4Jl J < jf Jij :JJ jJjb : Jli J3 :JJ j*bli jJolUl *UbJl JJ li J Iaaj ^ Cy-'y JjJlf; tf liji J*db : J3 : Jli J Jrfi J;Jr- J ui vAS* f^Jl jIla lii liji 0 ^ii . CJj ki_"i Ai : Jli ?vjj JiJ?r Jli ?oJlJ J-ii J;Jr *^bJl jlliJl JJ 0 p ii .<?JiJ ji : Jli ?0I vi-i ji; :JJ JUAI : Jli ?iUJ J3 :JJ 3* ^L) J^*- "Jl O;;! Jl >;. 4 3* ljJ If^Ul a lif lili 'j]iJ~J l 3jJ"- JJ t#i V** (J J! *ili* <-"jf "j^r" fji J^ o^i: iiLd u jii j{J 1434J Uii t jSuiis' U^: iij3 lihii ji& i"i33 Wj ** Ji A JI*j 4I1 I J"- jl>-{ Ui 3^ i03 f3i J*J J* * ^ J! "&' ;J^ J^ :oii ?id JU j >>> U : Jli JI cJ-li id Sji *id/ iuiii JjUii il3 j'j : jii ijfcjj f>: jsj JSb. da J3 J! c-^j : jii* jji o)L; Ai j) iuj jjJ V :JUJ JJ >--^' cJjZi 1 HA>- J .A Jeu^i ^ i3 Ji g ja ibf jl : Jlii U_l>- ^^a h>- jS : c.ia" ?cJUJ li J"*i3 ty*y iy.i (jiJ Ji ^ (*Ai : Jli tbi*^! -_a..j.b] l 4ibli d j (*J J5J 'f' J-*^ J 1 ""^ U : Jli j^Llls^ Lll^ js- i d>- i5 J-*^ jUi j_^JL1>- Jibi t^JLp 5^u> Oji 4 li-i 4 3vJ |"J 1^L1aJ ^ii Ainmmt 4 I^JLp C-^ I^JL^P dj J! Cjj J*J J! J>- djii ioi*-l3 iSb Ji3)1 JJ Jlii idi j"J V klbl J^i kib^l ^LyJl 4jbli # |4 * ' , , S 4 < 1 1 * # / 4 tO_^il^ JJ O^J [Then he resumed his narrative:] "77ien I was taken up to the fifth heaven and fibril asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his

Al-Isrd' () (Part-15) Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.?' So it was opened far us, and there I saw Hariin, who welcomed me and prayed far good far me. Then I was taken up to the sixth heaven and fibril asked far it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.?' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.?' So it was opened far us, and there I saw Musa, who welcomed me and prayed far good far me. Then I was taken up to the seventh heaven and fibril asked far it to be opened. It was said, 'Who are you?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was asked, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'His Mission has started.' So it was opened far us, and there I saw Ibrahim, who was leaning back against the Much-Frequented House (Al-Bayt Al-Ma'miir) . Every day seventy thousand angels enter it, then they never come back to it again. Then I was taken to Sidrat Al-Muntaha (the Lote tree beyond which none may pass), and its leaves were like the leaves [ears] of elephants and its fruits were like jugs, and when it was veiled with whatever it was veiled with by the command of Allah, it changed, and none of the creatures of Allah can describe it because it is so beautiful. Then Allah revealed that which He revealed to me. He enjoined on me fifty prayers every day and night. I came down until I reached Musa, and he said, 'What did your Lord enjoin on your Ummah?' I said, 'Fifty prayers everyday and night.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce (the burden) far your Ummah, far your Ummah will not be able to do that. I tested the Children of Israel and found out how they were.' So I went back to my Lord and said, 'O Lord, reduce (the burden) far my Ummah far they will never be able to do that.' So He reduced it by five. I came back down until I met Musa and he asked me, 'What did you do?' I said, '(My Lord) reduced (my burden) by five.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce (the burden) for your Ummah.' I kept going back between my Lord and Musa, and (my Lord) reduced it by five each time, until He said, 'O Muhammad, these are five prayers every day and night, and far every prayer there is (the reward of) ten, so they are (like) fifty prayers. Whoever wants to do

556 Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr something good then does not do it, one good deed will be recorded for him, and if he does it, ten good deeds will be recorded for him. Whoever wants to do something evil and does not do it, no evil deed will be recorded for him, and if he does it, one evil deed will be recorded for him.' I came down until I reached Musa, and told him about this. He said: 'Go back to your Lord and ask him to reduce (the burden) for your Ummah, for they will never be able to do that.' I had kept going back to my Lord until I felt too shy. This version was also recorded by

'ji* *-5^ ^T*)* (ji lSj~^ i On the night when I was taken on my Night Journey (Al Isrā'), I passed by Musa, who was standing, praying in his grave. This was also recorded by

The Prophet jg said: Ahmad 3:120. 2375.

uijJi "UiJi (.^Ui *Lii- ijijrr jii";ii dp j\ :JJ i-uA" : jli ?di* :JJ : Jli ?lJu _ ~ j*-dj *i Jti" j"-~ i jli Vdj J-{ ji c-dJ tdi- jJLi fST il^l iJLi : jli ifSLUl di ffl l* i liii c..^U Uli iai - JU i^ukll ^Jj jJLiJl : Jli p pdUl ^ dU 2di jdi; vi-i d^u ft j:\ jii ?iLC u : ;i jj iiiLUL liUl jjJt> jJ : Jli . y> 141>--Ij id }~*l jl ;jj i : Jli ^j*j : j_i ijijj-* : jli ?IJU ;jj li idi 0 ^jii : jli t l>- j ll>-j" jj j*j dli ?dj dp j-d-U : jli dp jjLJ jd*id! '-i* : jlii fdiJi d* j"r?d! d * -*?j (*j _ jli j^ldJl ,lj jjLiJl L^ja "jli (J il"d^Jl a^i oii I jlii tJiJl jliT lfij_j li[j i^ Jdj j!U l^ili li^i j I SjJ-. li -oJa5 fcjl^ad JI^JJ l)0?U jlj^l ajji lijj c jli SjJL-. ol^i)_j JJli jl^alljl lifj .dj l j^ii j0"0l lil : jli l< lii ddi z)\ gj p - jii - Jli I aws mounted upon it and Jibril brought me to the first heaven, and asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Wlw is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Adam, (fibril) said, 'This is your father Adam, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous son and righteous Prophet.' Then I was taken up to the fifth heaven, and (fibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'fibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Harun. (fibril) said, 'This is Harun, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous brother and righteous Prophet.'

Then I was taken up to the sixth heaven, and (Jibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad.' It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Musa. (Jibril) said, 'This is Musa, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous brother and righteous Prophet.' When I passed by him, he wept, and it was said to him, 'Why are you weeping?' He said, 'I am weeping because a young man was sent after me and more people from his Ummah than from mine will enter Paradise.' Then I was taken up to the seventh heaven, and (Jibril) asked for it to be opened. It was said, 'Who is this?' He said, 'Jibril.' It was said, 'Who is with you?' He said, 'Muhammad'. It was said, 'Has his Mission started?' He said, 'Yes.' It was said, 'Welcome to him, blessed is the one who comes.' So it was opened for us and when I entered, I saw Ibrahim. (Jibril) said, 'This is Ibrahim, greet him.' So I greeted him, and he returned the greeting then said, 'Welcome to the righteous son and righteous Prophet.' Then I was taken up to Sidrat Al-Muntaha\ wlvse fruits like the clay jugs of Hajar (a region in Arabia) and its leaves were like the ears of elephants. (Jibril) said: 'This is Sidrat Al-Muntaha.' And there were four

rivers, two hiddeti and two visible. I said, What is this, O Jibril?' He said, 'The two hidden rivers are rivers in Paradise, and the two visible rivers are the Nile and the Euphrates. Then I was shown Al- Bayt Al-Ma'mur.n Qatadah said: Al-Hasan told us narrating from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet^ saw Al-Bayt Al-Ma mur. Each bay seventy thousand angels enter it, then they never return from it. Then he continued to narrate the Hadith of Anas; Zfh\ oiifc - jti - ji4, d 0 " # ' 0 " j-Jj- d - Jli - cif 5 ij* j 'ipy -4 ^ ~ ~ fji (3^ 'j jl : Jli ifji JS :Jli A-ii ^j\jL* \ jJ

- Jli - I je. ~aji oi"-y - JI> - v_j;a Jtili jjJ} J) k : Jli lf>:> :Jji ?o>{ ^ :JlIS J.y Jj i_ oJlJij Juj)l ai } JS s^_i >*J "LU V Jj l{ - Jli - iiLi iij Ji ^}i lit Jji^i iS*y Jj ^~*>-y y^ Ji -"y o}J Ji Jlj iii(j) :ji JSli wu j(ili *ILj Jj grjli i*-"Jl JLiL o"Jlij iilili :JU JI iJUj t iji Ji oJUj - Jli - ib^ y ^ jl iji 'fy ^^Li if.j* ?) ,*-jy ^ i C-A> ? o>(13.T jji^ o^Jii/iui >&i oyj- Ji JI} lf>; js ;*i 4>(iji Ji dii> - ji - ik& Jofj J! "-}i : Jlii JS olji jIm oyi :o-Ui ? . jyf jj : Jlii" I JI cJi-y vliJiij iui ,)io> Ji Jj} f>;> oiji JiJ Vid ji - Ji - ibiV Jijcii iiLi iL*}*Jj ^}i t^j'idi lif Jor^i> p i * f ' , tiJ* - * i< J * ' '* * " "tJ i | / J # (c * - f- ; <_r^ i>! y fji cr-^v *-0*" ^; ,la: . V Jid jl : Jlii JS olji oyf :cJU" d &'A >: ** l fy JS olji JLib Ji :cii - Ji - idtf Juii&\ ijbii i } Jj ^-}i ij^j'idi ! ' { * . : . "** 'iJ i "?.(- ' . { " - 0_~a JJ .ill* ^Jb OAXJ ipJL"lj J^jl JZjj 'Jj t ^ " ,s ' * " * ? jy cii>-} ce-^y "Then I was brought a vessel of wine, a vessel of milk and a vessel of honey. I chose the milk, and he [Jibril] said, This is the Fitrah (natural instinct) on which you and your Ummah will be.' Then the prayer was enjoined upon me, fifty prayers each day. I came down until I reached Musa, who said, What did your Lord enjoin upon your Ummah?' I said, Fifty prayers each day. He said, Your Ummah will not be able to do fifty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your

) (Part-15) 561 Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten. I came back to Musa and he asked, What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Forty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do forty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 7 was commanded to do thirty prayers each day.' He said, 'Your Ummah will not be able to do thirty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten . I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, Twenty prayers each day.' He said, Your Ummah will not be able to do twenty prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and the number was reduced by ten more. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, 'Ten prayers each day. He said, Your Ummah will not be able to do ten prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah.' So I went back, and I was commanded to do five prayers every day. I came back to Musa and he asked, 'What were you commanded to do?' I said, Five prayers each day.' He said, Your Ummah will not be able to do five prayers each day. I tried the people before you, I had to deal with the Children of Israel and it was very difficult for me. Go back to your Lord and ask Him to reduce the burden on your Ummah. I said, 7 have asked my Lord until I feel too shy. I accept this and submit to

Him.' Then a voice called out: My order has been decreed and I have reduced the burden on My servants .n Similar narrations were recorded in the 4:208.

562 Tafstr Ibn Kathlr Two Sahibs. The Report of Anas from Abu Dharr

said, This is Adam, and these multitudes to his right and left are the souls of his descendants. The people on his right include the people of Paradise, and the people on his left include the people of Hell, so when he looks to his right he smiles, and when he looks to his left he weeps.' Then he took me up to the second heaven .. Tlten we passed by Ibrahim, who said, Welcome to the righteous Prophet and the righteous son.' I said, Who is this?' He said, Tins is Ibrahim . " Az-Zuhri said: Ibn Hazm told me that Ibn Abbas and Abu Habbah Al-Ansari used to say: the Prophet sg narrated here - "Then I was taken up until I reached a level where I could hear the sound of the pens. Ibn Hazm and Anas bin Malik said: the Messenger of Allah 3g said: Jv* u** i j*- jil J* &l Jli y> J "l jj U :JU i i^U l U Jr) cJjI jJ i itff ty JI grjti V*y V sllLil >-jt * Jlii i La * C-ii i y> i&(JjJj JJ Tj\ : Jtii 4\ .ilii jjJ liil Jj^Jl N j :JlSi ojl^i iiUi c":j ^ -hij J! (jj-j' :Jt^ J! (' (? ^ ' fcy** Oj-U. JI ,_/>^ Ji*ll illJl l*!> lip 4313111 lili 4&JI "A//fl/j enjoined upon my Ummah fifty prayers. I came back with this (message) until I passed by Musa, who said, What did your Lord enjoin upon your Ummah? I said, He enjoined fifty prayers.' Musa said, 'Go back to your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and He reduced it by half. Then I came back to Miisa and said, 'It has been reduced by half.' He said, 'Go back to your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and it was reduced by half. I came back to him, and he said, 'Go back to

your Lord, for your Ummah will not be able to do that.' So I went back, and He said: They are five but equal in reward to fifty/ farMy word does not change.' I came back to Musa and he said, Go back to your Lord.' I said, 7feel too shy before my Lord.' Then I was taken up until I reached Sidrat Al-Muntahd, which was veiled in indescribable colors. Then I entered Paradise, in which 1 saw nets of pearls and its soil of muskj This version was recorded by

"/ saw light. The Report of Jabir bin Abdullah Imam

This is Bilal, the Mu adhdhin. When the Prophet jg came back to the people, he said, IjS j C-jfj JjD tBilal has succeeded, I saw that he will have such and such . He [the Prophet jg] was met by Musa, who welcomed him and said, 'Welcome to the Unlettered Prophet. He was a tall, dark man with lank hair coming down to his ears or above his ears. He said, Who is this, O Jibril? He said, This is Musa. Then he went on and met a venerable, distinguished old man, who welcomed him and greeted him with Salam, and all of them were greeting him. He said, Who is this, O Jibril? He said, This is your father Ibrahim. Then he looked into Hell and saw some people eating rotten meat. He said, Who are these people, O Jibril? He said. They are those who used to eat the flesh of the people [i.e., backbiting]. He saw a man who was very red and dark blue, and said, Who is this, O Jibril? He said, This is the one who slaughtered the she-camel (of Salih). When the Messenger of Allah sg came to Al-Masjid Al-Aqsa, he stood up to pray, and all the Prophets gathered and prayed with him. When he finished, he was brought two cups, one on his right and one on his left, one containing milk and one containing honey. He took the milk and drank it, and the one who was carrying the cup said, 'You have chosen the Fitrah (natural instinct). The chain of narrators is Sahih, although they (Al-Bukhari and Muslim) did not record it.

Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn Abbas said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was taken on the Night Journey to Bayt Al-Maqdis, then he came back and told them about his journey and the features of Bayt Al-Maqdis and the caravan (of Quraysh). Some people said, We do not believe what Muhammad is saying, and they left Islam and became disbelievers. Allah destroyed them when He destroyed Abu Jahl. Abu Jahl said: Muhammad is trying to scare us with the tree of Zaqqum. Bring some dates and butter and let us have some Zaqqum. The Prophet also saw the Dajjal in his true form, in real life, not in a dream, and he saw Isa, Musa and 1:257.

Ibrahim. The Prophet ﷺ was asked about the Dajjal, and he said: *Jj fl Ite i&i Isf \s L:\i ilJUvf fit CUii &lj t [LLi] "JU- I jj jL^apf i ^Sl ^ - y* ^Jyy t ^ Jio> vi li ^ Jj ,Ui f^ji < . ^i>;i Jio> ; cjiiJi olLi .ilJ JU^ : jij^- Jli tj^u Its / saw /jj'm as a tall and huge man, with a whitish complexion. One of his eyes stood out like a shining star. The hair on his head looked like the branches of a tree. And I saw Isa, white with airy hair and an intense gaze, of average build. I saw Musa, dark-skinned, with a lot of hair and a strong build. I looked at Ibrahim and did not see anything in him that I do not see in myself; it is as if he were your companion [meaning himself], fibril said: 'Greet your father with Salam,' so I greeted him with Salam . This was also recorded by

568 Tafstr Ibn Kathtr 4So be not you in doubt ofmeeting him.} [32:33] Qatadah used to interpret this to mean that the Prophet of Allah -gz met MQsa. iAnd We made it [or him] a guide to the Children of Israel [32:33] Qatadah said: (This means) Allah made MQsa a guide for the Children of Israel. 111

"Yes". Abu Jahl did not want to say to his face that he was lying, lest he deny saying it when he called other people to hear him, so he said: Do you think that if I call your people, you will tell them about what happened? The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "Yes." Abu Jahl said, O people of Bani Ka*b bin Lu ay! People got up from where they were sitting and came to join them. Abu Jahl said, Tell your people what you told me. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: aim^ Ji" "/was taken on a Journey last night.*They said, Where to? He said, To Bayt Al-Maqdis ." They said, Then this morning you were among us? He said, Yes". They began to clap their hands together and put their hands on their heads in astonishment at this lie - as they claimed it to be. They said, Can you describe the sanctuary to us? Among them were some who had travelled to that land and seen the sanctuary, so the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, JaA lj l_ * ^ Jli 4-"Jl i Jjlp I cJj LJ j Jli Jl Jaj\ U Ij oc> Jlip j\ Jlp jli jjj r-pj (Ji>- OL^t AiJ *LIJj cJDI lit Jl jUi - Jli - jJii f started to describe it, until I reached a point where I was not sure about some of the details, but then the sanctuary was brought close and placed near the house of Uqayl - or 'Iqal - s< I could look at it and describe the details ." T I could not remember those description. The people said, for the description, by Allah he has got it right. This recorded by An-Nasa i and Al-Bayhaqi. As was 1,1 Ahmad 1:309. * An-Nasal in Al-Kubr& : 11285 , Dala ilAn-Nubuwwah 2 :363

570 Tafstr Ibn Kathir The Report of Abdullah bin Mas'ud Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bayhaqi reported that Abdullah bin Mas'ud said: When the Messenger of Allah ﷺ was taken on the Night Journey, he went as far as Sidrat Al-Muntaha, which is in the sixth heaven. Everything that ascends stops there, until it is taken from that point, and everything that comes down stops there, until it is taken from there. 4When that covered As-Sidrat Al-Muntaha which did cover it!} [53:16] Ibn Mas'ud said: It is covered with gold butterflies. The Messenger of Allah ﷺ was given the five prayers and the final Ayat of Surat Al-Baqarah, and forgiveness was granted for major sins to those who do not associate anything in worship

with Allah. This was recorded by Muslim in his Sahih. The Report of Abu Hurayrah Al-Bukhari and Muslim reported in their Sahih that Abu Hurayrah said: the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: - Jli - jJrj lip V; O-yJJ ijli to JI>*J {jA (5 JbL*AA Jli t l.IU {jA Axjj - Jli 1 j : Jli w *j ojJj aLZI uij jl ijhu!\ J~b .Oj I i.oij L^j(JL>- Jj j^ijl oJb^f jl vlljl uf 'i "Wlien / iwas taken on the Night Journey, I met MiisaJ He described him as a man - I think he said - a curly-haired man, as if he were from the tribe of Shanu ah. *And I met 7sfl." And the Prophet ﷺ described him as being of average height, with a reddish complexion, as if he had just come out of the bath. "And I met Ibrahim, and I am the one who resembles him most among his children. I was brought two vessels, one containing milk and the other containing wine. It was said to me, Take whichever one you want. So I took the

milk and drank it, and it was said to me, You have been guided to the Fitrah - or - You have chosen the Fitrah. If you had chosen the wine, your Ummah would have gone astray.V hl They also recorded it with another chain of narrators.

572 Tafsir Ibtî Kathîr The Time that Isra* took place, and the Fact that it included both Body and Soul, when the Propheti was awake, not in a Dream Musa bin TJqbah said, narrating from Az-Zuhri: The Isrd happened one year before the Hijrah This was also the opinion of TJrwah . As-Suddi said: It happened sixteen months before the Hijrah. The truth is that the Prophet was taken on the Night Journey when he was awake, not in a dream, and he went from Makkah to Bayt Al-Maqdis riding on Al-Buraq. When he reached the door of the sanctuary, he tied up his animal by the door and entered, where he prayed two Rak'ahs to greet the Masjid . Then the Mi raj was brought to him, which is a ladder with steps which one climbs up. So he went up on it to the first heaven, then he went up to the rest of the seven heavens. In each heaven he was welcomed by the most pious' of its inhabitants, and he greeted the Prophets who were in the various heavens according to their positions and status. He passed by MQsa, the one who spoke with Allah, if* the sixth heaven, and Ibrahim, the close friend (Khalil) of Allah in the seventh heaven. Then he surpassed them and all the Prophets in status and reached a level where he could hear the creaking of the pens, i.e., the pens of destiny which write down what is decreed to happen. He saw Sidrat Al-Muntahd, covered by the command of Allah, and its greatness, its butterflies of gold and various colours, surrounded by the angels. There he saw Jibril in his real form, with six hundred wings. He saw green cushions blocking the horizon. He saw Al-Bayt Al-Ma'mur, and Ibrahim Al-Khalil, the builder of the earthly Ka bah, leaning back against it, the heavenly Ka bah, every day, seventy thousand angels enter and worship therein, then they do not return to it until the Day of Resurrection. He saw Paradise and Hell, and Allah enjoined upon him fifty prayers, then reduced it to five, as an act of mercy and kindness towards His servants. In this is a strong indication of the greatness and virtue of the prayers. Dala UAn-Nubuwwah 2:355. Dala UAn-Nubuwwah 2 :354 131 Al-Qurtubi, 10:210.

) (Part-15) 573 Then he came back down to Bayt Al-Maqdis, and the Prophets came down with him and he led them in prayer there when the time for prayer came. It may have been the dawn prayer of that day. Some people claim that he led them in prayer in heaven, but the reports seem to say that it was in Bayt Al-Maqdis. In some reports it says that it happened when he first entered (i.e., before ascending into the heavens), but it is more likely that it was after he came back, because when he passed by them in the places in the heavens, he asked Jibril about them, one by one, and Jibril told him about them. This is more appropriate, because he was first required to come before the Divine Presence, so that

what Allah willed could be enjoined upon him and his Ummah. When the matter for which he was required had been dealt with, he and his brother-Prophets gathered, and his virtue and high position in relation to them became apparent when he was asked to come forward to lead them, which was when Jibril indicated to him that he should do so. Then he came out of Bayt Al-Maqdis and rode on Al-BurQq back to Makkah in the darkness of the night. And Allah knows best. As for his being presented with the vessels containing milk and honey, or milk and wine, or milk and water, or all of these, some reports say that this happened [n Bayt Al-Maqdis, and others say that it happened in the heavens. It is possible that it happened in both placejs, because it is like offering food or drink to a guest when he arrives, and Allah knows best. The Prophet 3 was taken on the Night Journey with body and soul, he was awake, not asleep. The evidence for this is tne Ayah jgft ji 3 ." "i xsii' <&- ^Glorified (and Exalted) be He (Allah) Who took His servantfor a Journey by Nightfrom Al-Masjid Al-Hardm to Al-Masjid Al- Aqsa, the neighborhood whereofWe have blessed,} The words Subhan Allah (Glorified and exalted be Allah) are spoken in the case of serious matters. If it had been a dream, it would have been a significant matter and would not have

574 Tafsfr Ibn Kathir been so astounding; the disbelievers of the Quraysh would not have hastened to label him a liar and the group of people who had become

narrator) said that Abu Sufyan (later) said: By Allah, nothing stopped me from saying something to Heraclius to make him despise (Muhammad) but the fact that I did not want to tell a lie that would later be found out, and he would never believe me again after that. Then I told him about the night on which he was taken on the Night Journey. I said: O King, shall I not tell you of something from which you will know that he is lying? He said, What is it? I said: He claims that he went out of our land, the land of Al-Haram, in one night, and came to your sanctuary in Jerusalem, then came back to us the same night, before morning came. The Patriarch of Jerusalem was there, standing next to Caesar. The Patriarch of Jerusalem said: I know that night. Caesar looked at him and said, How do you know about this? He said, I never used to sleep at night until I closed the doors of the sanctuary. On that night I closed all the doors except for one, which I could not manage to close. I asked my workers and others who were with me to help me deal with it, but we could not move it. It was like trying to move a mountain. So 1 called the carpenters, and they looked at it and said: The lintel and some part of the structure has fallen onto it. We cannot move it until morning, when we will tie able to see what the problem is. So I went back and left tho^e two doors open. The next morning I went back, and saw that the stone at the comer of the sanctuary had a hole in it, and there were traces of an animal having been tethered there. I said to my companions: This door has not been closed last night except for a Prophet, who prayed last night in sanctuary. And he mentioned the rest of the Hadith. In his book At-Tanwir fi Mawlid As-Siraj Al-Munir, Al-Hafiz Abu Al-Khattab TJmar bin Dihyah mentioned the Hadith of the /srd* narrated from Anas, and spoke well about it, then he said: The reports of the Hadith of the Isra reach the level) of Mutawatir. They were narrated from Umar bin Al-Khattab, Ali, Ibn Mas ud, Abu Dharr, Malik bin Sa sa ah, Abu Hurayrah, Abu Said, Ibn Abbas, Shaddad bin Aws, Ubayy bin Ka*b, Abdur-Rahman bin Qarat, Abu Habbah Al-Ansari, Abu Layla Al-Ansari, Abdullah bin Amr, Jabir, Hudhayfah, Buraydah, Abu Ayyub, Abu Umamah, Samurah bin Jundub, Abu |A1- Hamra , Suhayb Ar-Rumi, Umm Hani , and A ishah and Asma , the daughters of Abu Bakr As-Siddlq, may Allah be oyir

4for the Children of Israel (saying) : "Take none . means, lest they should take, 4"... other than Me as (your) Wakil means, *you have no protector, supporter or god besides Me, because Allah revealed to every Prophet that he should worship Him alone with no partner or associate. Then Allah says: 4% 40 offspring of those whom We carried (in the ship) with Nw/i^j by addressing the descendants of those who were carried in the ship with NQh there is a reminder of the blessings, as if Allah is saying: O descendants of those whom We saved and carried in the ship with Nuh, follow in the footsteps of your father, 15? \4 iVerily, he was a grateful servant>. Remember the blessing I have granted you by sending Muhammad. Imam

578 Tafstr Ibn Kathir He quoted the Hadith at length, and in the Hadith, the Prophet jg said: dUi ^ jS/ JI djl C- kilij U !0 L>- jjjti sJijj 0 ijSLi Ijl* iul uThey will come to Nuh and will say, O Nuh, you were the first of the Messengers sent to the people of earth, and Allah called you grateful servant, so intercede for us with your Lord.*' And he quoted the Hadith in full. fy* ufjV> j oi-ii i-' 4 Ji&i xf> Jit ijLj Jja^ . Gj IjUc lILu U*jJ jcyj it. Is^ ysi jyl ^ ijiJi ^ &; iij% a ffcJ# -&^ jt &'& ^\$& C !(# i -VJ 44. And We decreedfor the Children of Israel in the Scripture: "Indeed you would do mischief in the land twice and you will become tyrants and extremely arrogant!"} 45. So, when the promise camefor the first of the two, We sent against you servants of Ours given to terrible warfare. They entered the very innermost parts ofyour homes . And it was a promise (completely) fulfilled.} 46. Then We gave you a return of victory over them. And We helped you with wealth and children and made you more numerous in manpower.} 47. (And We said): "Ifyou do good, you do goodfor your own selves, and ifyou do evil (you do it) against yourselves." Then, when the second promise came to pass, (We permitted your enemies) to disgrace yourfaces and to enter the Masjid as they had entered it before, and to destroy with utter destruction all thatfell in their hands.} 48. It may be that your Lord may show mercy unto you, but if m FathAl-Bari 6 :43 1

you return (to sins), We shall return (to Our punishment). And We have made Hell a prison for the disbelievers.} It was mentioned in the Tawrah that the Jews would spread Mischieftwice Allah tells us that He made a declaration to the Children of Israel in the Scripture, meaning that He had already told thlm in the Book which He revealed to them, that they would caijise mischief on the earth twice, and would become tyrants and extremely arrogant, meaning they would become shameless oppressors of people, Allah says: { JX 3J Jll;S4 iAnd We made known this decree to him, that the root of those (sinners) was to be cut off in the early morning.^(15:66), meaning, We already told him about that and informed him of it. The First Episode of Mischiefcaused by the Jews, and their Punishment for it 404t m iSo, when the promise came for the first of the two} meaning the first of the two episodes of mischief. 4 4i' ^^ iWe sent against you servants of Ours given to terrible warfare.} 1 means, We unleashed soldiers against you from among Our creatures who were given to terrible warfare, i.e., they had great strength and weapons and power. They entered the veiy innermost parts of your homes, meaning they took possession of your land and invaded the very innermost parts of ypur homes, going between and through your houses, coming and going freely with no fear of anyone. This was the promise (completely) fulfilled. I The earlier and later commentators differed over the identity of these invaders. Many Isra'iliyydt (reports from Jewish sources) were narrated about this, but I did not want to miake

The Second Episode of Mischief Then Allah says: iThen, when the second promise came to pass,} meaning, the second episode of mischief, when your enemies came again, 4(We permitted your enemies) to disgrace your faces} meaning, to humiliate you and subdue you, tidty} 4and to enter die Masjid} meaning, Bayt Al-Maqdis (Jerusalem). 4\$ =*} 4as they had entered it before,} when they entered the very innermost parts of your homes. iand to destroy} wrecking and inflicting ruin upon it. i&C} 4all that fell in their hands.} everything they could get their hands on. iwith utter destruction. It may be that your Lord may show mercy unto you} meaning that He may rid you of them. t 4 j >} i but if you return (to sins). We shall return (to Our punishment).} meaning, if you return to causing mischief, 4We shall return} means, We will once again punish you in this world, along with the punishment and torment We save for you in the Hereafter. 4k~~ fdtr uZ*&}

582 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Jr mm TAr \$ iic^taj^ruo*ir5l; ^ f > *A * < * > , ^*r jl^a* "y CJ J^=3J ^ J (jC-IS /x ^ / -""*' >'> _" . > < > ""**"% x.l saSiga iAnd We have made Hell a prison [Hasir] for the disbelievers.) meaning, a place of permanent detention, a prison which cannot be avoided or escaped. Ibn Abbas said, Hasir here means a jail. Mujahid said, They will be detained in it. 121 Others said like- wise. Al-Hasan said, Hasir means a bed of Fire. ' Qatadah said: The Children of Israel returned to aggression, so Allah sent this group against them, Muhammad jg and his companions, who made them pay the Jizyah, ' with willing submission, and feeling themselves subdued. ' 1 jvl u* fji** ijUyi]* IJCa ^ && v "lf st; i*f #&". / -f" < , >* ' ./z& > ~f . Verily, this Qur'an guides to that which is most just and right and gives good news to those who believe, those who do righteous deeds, thut they will have a great reward (Paradise.) 410. And that those who do not believe in the Hereafter, for m At-Tabari 17:390. ' At-Tabari 17:390. ' At-Tabari 17:390. * Jizyah : a tax levied from People of the Book (Jews and Christians) who are under the protection of a Muslim government '5| At-Tabari 17:389.

Al-Isrd' (11) (Part-15) them We have prepared a painful torment (Hell).} Praising the Qur an Allah praises His noble Book, the Qur an, which He revealed to His Messenger Muhammad sg. It directs people to the best and clearest of ways. igives good news to those who believe,} in it a ij ji' } ithose who do righteous deeds,} in accordance with it, telling them 0P 3 } ithat they will have a great reward,} i.e., on the Day pf Resurrection. And He tells ithose who do not believe in the Hereafter,} that iLj C\Z } ifor them is a painfiil tormet it,} i.e. on the Day of Resurrection. As Allah says: 4... then announce to them a painful torment.} [84 :24] ill. And man invokes (Allah) for evil as he invokes (Allah) for good and man is ever hasty.} Man s Haste and Prayers against Himself Allah tells us about man s haste and how he sometimes prays against himself or his children or his wealth, praying for something bad to happen for them, or for them to die or be destroyed, invoking curses, etc. If Allah were to answer pis prayer, he would be destroyed because of it, as Allah says: A %}

584 Tafisir Ibn KathTr 4And were Allah to hasten for mankind the evil...^ [10:1 1] This is how it was interpreted by Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah. We have already discussed the Hadith: SUi Uu 41 & it Ji tj JU -I' * ' * < Do not pray against yourselves or your wealth, for that might coincide with a time when Allah answers prayers , " What makes the son of Adam do that is his anxiety and haste. Allah says: 4# Stf 4And man is ever hasty.) Salman Al-Farisi and Ibn Abbas mentioned the story of Adam, when he wanted to get up before his soul reached his feet. When his soul was breathed into him, it entered his body from his head downwards. When it reached his brain he sneezed, and said, Al-Hamdu Lillah

(praise be to Allah), and Allah said, May your Lord have mercy on you, O Adam. When it reached his eyes, he opened them, and when it reached his body and limbs he started to stare at them in wonder. He wanted to get up before it reached his feet, but he could not. He said, O Lord, make it happen before night comes. [31 ci iJ* liLr) jil *,K jji 412. And We have appointed the night and the day as two Ayat (signs). Then, We have obliterated the sign of the night (with darkness) while We have made the sign of the day illuminating, that you may seek bounty from your Lord, and that you may know the number of the years and to count (periods of time). And We have explained everything (in detail) with full explanation .) At-Tabari 17:393, 394. [2] Muslim 4 :2304 AMabari 17:394,395.

The NightandDay are Signs ofthe GreatPower ofAllah Allah reminds us of the great signs that He createdj including the alternation of the night and day, so that people may rest at night, and go out and earn a living, do their workj and travel during the day, and so that they may know the number of days, weeks, months and years, so they will know the appointed times for paying debts, doing acts of worship, dealing with transactions, paying rents and so on. Allah says: 4that you may seek bounty from your Lord,} meaning, in your living and travels etc. iand that you may know the number of the years and to count.} If time stood still and never changed, we would not know any of these things, as Allah says: jal J* jt \$ C&. jdl iflf Oj dl 3 \$ i oo i ySH u, iSay: "Tell me! IfAllah made the night continuous for you till

the Day of Resurrection , which god besides Allah could bring

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3125–3155]

you light? Will you not then hear? Say: "Tell me! If Allah made the day continuous for you till the Day of Resurrection, which god besides Allah could bring you night wherein you rest? Will you not then see?" It is out of His mercy that He has made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and that you may seek ofHis bounty - and in order that you may be grateful .} (28:71-73) lsJi 'jhh >; ^ t 2l> 4 ~ 4Blessed be He Who has placed the big stars in the heaven, and has placed therein a great lamp (sun), and a moon giving light.

light and measured out for it stages that you might know the number of years and to count (periods of time). Allah did not create this but in truth.} [10:5) until, iAyat for those people who keep their duty to Allah, and fear Him much.} [10:6) c-jy Jt 3* &&:} iThey ask you about the crescent moons. Say: "These are signs to mark fixed periods of time for mankind and for the pilgrimage."} [2:189] i\ ft: %Vp} iThen, We have obliterated the sign of the night (with darkness) while We have made the sign of the day illuminating,} Ibn Jurayj reported that -Abdullah bin Kathlr commented oh this Ayah: (It means] the darkness of the night and the twilight of the day. m Ibn Jurayj reported that Mujahid said: The sun is the sign of the day and the moon is the sign of the night. 4\$ i'i Hjrij} 4We have obliterated the sign of the night} this refers to the moon s blackness, which is how Allah has created it. 121 4And We have appointed the night and the day as two Aydt.} Ibn Abi Najih reported that Ibn Abbas said: By night and day, this is how Allah created them, may He be glorified. y* \$^' (j. ii* j 1\$ -0^ JLiiS&& At-Jabari 17:396. At-Tabari 17:396. At-Jabari 17:397.

413. And We have fastened every man's Ta'irah (deeds) to his neck, and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring out for him a Book which he will find wide open. 414. (It will be said to him): "Read your Book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day."} Every Person will have the Book of his Deeds with Him After mentioning time, and the deeds of the son of Adam that take place therein, Allah says: 4And We have fastened every man's Ta'irah (deeds) to his neck,} The word Ta'irah (lit. something that flies) refers to man's deeds which fly from him, as Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and others said. It includes both good deeds and bad deeds, he will be forced to acknowledge them and will be rewarded or punished accordingly. 1 4'7i7.YrJ 'i - Tv , i'r-Z C"- tji A ju 4So whosoever does good equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it. And whosoever does evil equal to the weight of a speck of dust shall see it.} (99:7-8). Allah says: 4_ij jjji VJ Jji j; Lil; U jl jfc, } i(Remember) that the two receivers (recording angels) receive (each human being), one sitting on the right and one on the left (to note his or her actions). Not a word does he (or she) utter but there is a watcher by him ready (to record it).} (50:17-18) 4But verily, over you (are appointed angels in charge of mankind) to watch you, Kiraman (Honorable) Kdtibin - writing down (your deeds), they know all that you do.} (82:10-12) m At-Tabari 17:398, 400.

iYou are only being requited for what you used to do.} (52:16) ^whosoever works evil, will have the recompense thereof.}\ [4:123] The meaning is that the deeds of the sons of Adam are preserved, whether they are great or small, and they are recorded night and day, morning and evening. iZai % yfo} iand on the Day of Resurrection, We shall bring out for him a Book which he will find wide open.} meaning, *We will collect all of his deeds for him in a Book which will be given to him on the Day of Resurrection, either in his right hand, if he is one of the blessed, or in his left hand if he is one of the wretched. iwide open} means, it will be open for him and others to read all of his deeds, from the beginning of his life until the end. fj* ^ j J _ _ i. . iOn that Day man iwill be informed of what (deeds) he sent forward, and what (deeds) he left behind. Nay! Man zwill be a witness against himself, though he may put forth his excuses.} (75:13-15) Allah says: 4:1:4^& i(It will be said to him): "Read your Book. You yourself are sufficient as a reckoner against you this Day."} meaning, you have not been treated unjustly and nothing has been recorded against you except what you have done, because you remember everything that you have done, and no one will forget anything that he did. Everyone will be able to read his Book, whether he is literate or illiterate.

No One will have to bear the Sins of Another Allah tells us that whoever is guided and follows the truth, walking in the footsteps of the Prophet [g, he will gain the good consequences of that for himself. iAnd whoever goes astray,} meaning from the truth, deviating from the way of guidance, he is wronging himself and will have to bear the consequences. Then Allah says: \$ Oi Sj%} Ot 4No one laden with burdens can bear another's burden. no one will have to bear the sins of another, and he does not wrong anyone besides himself, as Allah says: iand if one heavily laden calls another to (bear) his load, nothing of it will be lifted> [35:15] There is no contradiction between this and other Ayat iAnd verily, they shall bear their own loads, and other loads besides their own.} [29:13] and: iand also of the burdens of those whom they misled without knowledge.} [16:25] For those who called others to do evil will bear the sin of their own deviation as well as the sin of those whom they led astray, without detracting the least amount from the burden of those people, and none of this burden shall be removed from them. This is

the justice and mercy of Allah towards His servants. As Allah says: iAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning).}

No Punishment until a Messenger has been sent Allah tells us that out of His justice, He does not punish anyone until He has established proof against him by sending a Messenger to him, as He says: u Lib ji 1 & S- Jii- T-i'i V VH/" ^- gf if* ja I UJ> y 4^ g 4Even/ time a group is cast therein, its keeper will ask: "Did no wamer come to you?" They will say: "Yes, indeed a wamer did come to us, but we belied him and said: Allah never sent down anything (of revelation) ; you are only in great error.""} (67:8-9) And, (*+' tJiSj b) #- Jk> f^=* UM \$ ijj'i 'f4 {& > * \$4* JAj jifl those who disbelieved will be driven to Hell in groups, till, when they reach it, the gates thereof will be opened. And its keepers will say, "Did not the Messengers come to you from yourselves - reciting to you the verses of your Lord, and warning you of the meeting of this Day of yours?" They will say: "Yes," but the Word of torment has been justified against the disbelievers!} (39:71) And, ii fei ifJ' ji. ijj dfy^a> 4 tfr, Ji Li j;jJii O they will cry: "Our Lord! Bring us out, we shall do righteous good deeds, not (the evil deeds) that we used to do." (AllSh will reply:) "Did We not give you lives long enough, so that whosoever would receive admonition could receive it? And the wamer came to you . So taste you (the evil of your deeds) For the wrongdoers there is no helper."} (35:37) There are other Ayat which indicate that Allah will not make anyone enter Hell except after sending a Messenger to them.

Allah will accept their pledge of obedience to Him, then He will send word to them that they should enter the Fire. By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, if they enter it, it will be cool and safe for them .

says: > ' > p-J j*j \Vy "liU cJls' l^JU-S (fij "Whoever enters it will find it cool and safe, and whoever does not enter it will be dragged into ifV 11 This was also recorded by Ishaq bin Rahwayh from Mu'adh bin Hisham , 121 and by Al-Bayhaqi in Al-Vtiqad. He said: This is a Sahih chain. It was reported by Ibn Jarir from the Hadith of Ma'mar from Hammam from Abu Hurayrah, who attributed it to the Prophet gs. Then Abu Hurayrah said: Recite, if you wish: AAnd We never punish until We have sent a Messenger (to give warning)}. This was also narrated by Ma'mar from Abdullah bin Tawus from his father, from Abu Hurayrah, but it is Mauquf (it was not attributed directly to the Prophet jg). The Second Hculith from Abu Hurayrah He said that the Messenger of Allah jg said: & ^ j jJft J "Every newborn is bom in a state of Fitrah (the natural state of man), then his parents make him into a Jew or Christian or Zoroastrian, as animals produce whole animals - do you see any that is bom mutilated (with something missing)? According to one report they said: O Messenger of Allah, what about those who die when they are little? He said, "Allah knows best what they would have done. Ahmad 4:24. At-Tabarflni, 1 :287. AMabari 17:403. Al-Qurtubi 10:232. Al-Bukhari 1385, Muslim 2658.

Meanings of Amama The commentators differed over the meaning of this word. It was said that the phrase translated here as Amama those who live luxuriously. Then, they transgress therein means, We send Our decree upon them as Allah says elsewhere: iOur decree reaches it by night or by day> For [Amama cannot mean Our command^ because Allah does not command or enjoin immorality. Or, they said it means that Allah subjugated them to commit immoral deeds, so they deserved the punishment. Or it was said that it means: We commanded them to obey Us, but they committed immoral sins, so they deserved punishment. This was reported from Ibn Jurayj from Ibn Abbas, 111 and it is also the

view of Said bin Jubayr.¹² 4ft 2 ft iAmama those who live luxuriously. Then, they transgress therein Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: [this means] We gave power to the evil people, so they committed sin therein (in the town), and because they did that, Allah destroyed them with the punishment. This is similar to the Ayah: iAnd thus We have set up in every town great ones of its wicked people} ¹³ [6:133] This was also the view of Abu Al- Aliyah, Mujahid and Ar- Rabl bin Anas. 141 4ft 3 ft>'\$ 4? J 1\$ iAnd when We decide to distroy a tenon (populaton), Amama At-Tabari 17:403.Tabari 17:403. At-Tabari 17:404. At-Tabari 17:404.

Al-Isrd' (17-19) (Part-15 this world), We readily grant him what We will for whom We like. Then, afterwards, We have appointedfor him Hell; he will bum therein disgraced and rejected.} 419. And whoever desires the Hereafter and strives for it, with the necessary effort due for it while he is a believer, then such are the ones whose striving shall be appreciated, (rewarded by Allah).} The Reward ofThose who desire this World and Those who desire the Hereafter Allah tells us that not everyone who desires this world and its luxuries gets what he wants. That is attained by those whom Allah wants to have it, and they get what He wills that they should get. This Ayah narrows down the general statements made in other Ay&t. Allah says: 4'f+*r /J .Li j^Ji Jii U Jl \X*i-} 4We readily grant him what We will for whom We like, afterwards, We have appointedfor him Hell} meaning, in the Hereafter, 4VLU,} 4he will bum therein} means, he will enter it until it covers on all sides, idisgraced} means, blamed for his bad behaviour and deeds, because he chose the transient over the eternal, evil 4(} irejected.} means, far away (from Allah's mercy), humiliated and put to shame. ft ' >} 4And whoever desires the Hereafter} wanting the Hereafter and its blessings and delights, 4 a 4and strivesfor it, with the necessary effort duefor it}

420. On each these as well as those VJe bestow from the bounties ofyour Lord. And the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden.} 4.21 . See how We prefer one above another (in this world), and verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} Allah says: 4%} 40n each} meaning, on each of the two groups, those who desire this world and those who desire the Hereafter, We bestow what they want 4<&> &.}

ifrom the bounties ofyour Lord.} means, He is the One Who is in control of all things, and He is never unjust. He gives to each what he deserves, whether! it is eternal happiness or doom. His decree is unstoppable, no one can withhold what He gives or change what He wants. Allah says: iiP 3\$ scX c,} iAnd the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden .} meaning, no one can withhold or prevent them. Qatadah said, iAnd the bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden.} (It means) they can never decrease . i&z AS 0? Cj} iAnd the Bounties ofyour Lord can never beforbidden} Al-Hasan and others said, (It means) they can never be prevented. Then Allah says: \$ zszau s?jX} iSee how We prefer one above another,} meaning in this world, so that some are rich and some are poor, and others are in between; some are beautiful, some are ugly and others are in between; some die young while others live to a great age, and some die in between. iand verily, the Hereafter will be greater in degrees and greater in preferment.} means, the differences between them in the Hereafter will be greater than the differences between them in this world. Soihe of them will be in varying levels of Hell, in chains and fetters, while others will be in the lofty degrees of Paradise, with its blessings and delights. The people

of Hell will vary in their positions and levels, just as the people of Paradise will, in Muslim At-Tabari 17:410.

Al-Isr' (23-24) (Part-15 Allah Jg said: *J 4>! J-iji jilt icili L IjJjili a"U oLii "J 'js. CYj Ul ^Whoever is afflicted with poverty and goes and asks people for help, will never get rid of his poverty, but if he asks Allah for help, then Allah will grant him the means of independence sooner or later. " 11 This was also recorded by Abu Dawud and At-Tirmidhi, who said, Hasan Sahih Gharib .121 Juu; C4j j; a.# f Z1XS 4 j - ^ oj jij ot 4-ii' u+j 423 . And your Lord has Qadd [decreed] that you worship none but Him. And that you be dutiful to your parents. If one of them or both of them attain old age in your life, say not to them a word of disrespect, nor reprimand them but address them in terms of honor.} 424. And lower unto them the wing of submission and humility through mercy, and say: "My Lord! Bestow on them Your mercy as they did bring me up when I was young."} The Command to Worship Allah Alone and to be Dutiful to One's Parents Allah commands us to worship Him alone, with no partner or associate. The word Qada [normally having the meaning of decree] here means commanded . Mujahid said that AAnd He has Qada} means enjoined.[3* This is also how Ubayy bin Ka*b, Ibn Mas'ud and Ad-Dahhak bin Muzahim recited the Ayah as: 1 :407. Abu Dawud 2 :296, Tuhfat al-Ahwadhi 6:617. At-Jabari 17:414.

And lower unto them the wing of submission and humility through mercy,^ means, be humble towards them in your actions. U&j ^ ilij 4and say: My Lord! Bestow on them Your Mercy as they did bring me up when I was young."} means, say this when they grow old and when they die. Ibn Abbas said: But then Allah revealed: io&Q ! iiLS j g C j C} it is not (proper) for the Prophet and those who believe to ask Allah for forgiveness for the idolaters...y^ (9:13) There are many Hadiths which speak about honoring one's parents, such as the Hadith narrated through a number of chains of narration from Anas and others, which states that the Prophet climbed up on the Minbar, and then said, ((Amin, Amin, Amin.)) It was said, O Messenger of Allah , why did you say Amin? He said: :ji iwill* ail* J>-j wii jJm U : Jlii Jijl^- p-k qp- j*! oLjlaj aIL* jiS J"-j :Ju ^ :cJla" \$ tyfA J>-j wif :Jli p t-lfA : ji iH fou j-jl : W. l.ai ij-aT ;ji jUi /ifriZ came to me and said, O Muhammad, he is doomed who hears you mentioned and does not say Salla upon you." He said, "Say Amin," so I said Amin. Then he said, "He is doomed who sees the month of Ramadan come and go, and he has not been forgiven." He said, "Say Amin, so I said Amin. Then he said, "He is doomed who grows up and both his parents or one of them are still alive, and they do not cause him to enter Paradise." He said, "Say Amin," so I said Amin."[21 Another Hadith Imam Ahmad reported from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet M said: At-Tabari 17:421. Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :550

606 Tafsir Ibtisam Kathir Jlip [U*J] iijy} ifa'J '^ '1 j*^ gS1*JI J>-jJ jJj "He is doomed, he is doomed, he is doomed, the man whose parents, one or both of them, reach old age while he is alive and he does not enter ParadiseJ This version is Sahih although no one recorded it other than

Al-Isra' (25) -15) enjoins you concerning your close relatives then the next in closeness. This was recorded by

608 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Qatadah said: To the obedient who pray. iHe is Ever Most Forgiving to those who turn to Him in repentance.} Shuhah narrated from Yahya bin Said from Said bin Al- Musayyib; This refers to those who commit sin then repent, and commit sin then repent. Ata bin Yasar, Said bin Jubayr

and Mujahid said: They are the ones who return to goodness. * Mujahid narrated from TJBayd bin TJmayr, concerning this Ayah: This is the one who, when he remembers his sin when he is alone, he seeks the forgiveness of Allah. Mujahid agreed with him on that. Ibn Jarir said: The best view on this matter is of those who said that it refers to the one who repents after committing sin, who comes back from disobedience to obedience and who leaves that which Allah hates for that which He loves and is pleased with. * What he said is correct, for Allah says, in iVerily, to Us will be their return} (88:25). And according to a SahQi Hadlth, the Messenger of Allah would say when he returned from a journey, I've have returned repenting, worshipping and praising our Lord. jjJ Hj c^> & os& ^ as At-Tabari 17:422. * At-Tabari 17:423. At-Tabari 17:424, 425. * At-Tabari 17:424. * At-Tabari 17:425. Al-Bdri3:724.

Al-Isrd' (26-28) (Part-15) i26. And give to the kinsman his due, and to the Miskin (poor), and to the wayfarer. But spend not wastefully (your wealth) in the manner of a spendthrift> 427. Verily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the ShayatTn (devils), and the Slwytan is ever ungrateful to his Lord.\$ i28. And if you turn away from them and you are awaiting a mercy from your Lord far which you hope, then, speak unto them a soft, kind word The Command to maintain the Ties of Kinship and the Prohibition of Extravagance When Allah mentions honoring one s parents, He follows this with the command to treat one s relatives well and to maintain the ties of kinship. According to the Hadith: P* Jj p c iutj Your mother and your father, then your closest relatives and the next closest ."(1 According to another Hadith: .jj d iijj J> il a* ^Whoever would like to see his provision expanded and his life extended, let him maintain his ties of kinship ." <&&u iBut spend not wastefully (your wealth) in the manner of a spendthrift When Allah commands spending, He forbids extravagance, Spending should be moderate, as stated in another Ayah: pj P 4And those wfw, when they spend, are neither extravagant nor stingy". [25:67] Then He says, to discourage extravagance: -.Sh [21 Ahmad 2 :226 Muslim 4 :1982.

iVerily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the Shaydtin,) They have this trait in common. Ibn Mas'ud said: This refers spending extravagantly when it is not appropriate. 111 Ibn Abb&s said likewise . 121 Mujahid said: If a man spends all his wealth on appropriate things, then he is not a spendthrift, but if he spends a little inappropriately, then he is a spendthrift. 131 Qatadah said: Extravagance means spending money on sin in disobeying Allah, and on wrongful and corrupt things. 141 Imam

Al-Isrd' (29-30) (Part-15) "Yes, if you give it to my messenger, you will have fulfilled it, and you will have the reward for it, and the sin is on the one who changes it.* iVerily, the spendthrifts are brothers of the Shayatfn,} meaning, they are their brothers in extravagance, foolishness, failing to obey Allah and committing sin. Allah said: & m \$and the Shaytdn is ever ungrateful to his Lord i meaning, he is an ingrate, because he denied the blessings of Allah and did not obey Him, turning instead to disobedience and rebellion. y /. *i " . ' / *v m* ' i y > " >; fJ-j JUy^ H>? \$And if you him away from them and you are awaiting a mercy from your Lord If your relatives and those to whom We have commanded you to give, ask you for something, and you do not have anything, and you turn away from them because you have nothing to give, \$then, speak unto them a soft, kind word.> meaning, with a promise. This was the opinion of Mujahid, Ikrimah, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah and others.'2' \$29. And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck, nor overextend it (like a spendthrift), so that you become blameworthy and in severe poverty. 3:136. Some scholars consider this Hadith authentic^, although it is

not confirmed that its narrator, Said bin Abi Hilal, actually heard from Anas bin Malik. At-Tabari 17:431,432

430. Truly, your Lord expands the provision for whom He wills and straitens (for whom He wills). Verily, He is Ever All-Knower, All-Seer of His servants. Moderation in Spending Allah enjoins moderation in living. He condemns miserliness and forbids extravagance. Jju? Sljy 4And let not your hand be tied (like a miser) to your neck,) this means, do not be miserly and stingy, never giving anything to anyone, as the Jews - may the curses of Allah be upon them - said, Allah's Hand is tied up (i.e., He does not give and spend of His bounty) . They attributed miserliness to Him, Exalted and Sanctified be the Most Generous Bestower! inor overextend it (like a spendthrift)) means, nor be extravagant in spending and giving more than you can afford, or paying more than you earn, lest you become blameworthy and find yourself in severe poverty. If you are a miser, people will blame you and condemn you, and no longer rely on you. When you spend more than you can afford, you will find yourself without anything to spend, so you will be worn out, like an animal that cannot walk, so it becomes weak and incapable. It is described as worn out, which is similar in meaning to exhausted. As Allah says: jij gf f jA* ifj J iThen look again : "Can you see any rifts?" Then look again and yet again, your sight will return to you in a state of humiliation and worn out.) (67:3-4) meaning, unable to see any faults. Similarly, Ibn Abbas, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj, Ibn Zayd and others understood this Ayah as miserliness and extravagance. ' It was reported iiT At-Tabari 17:434, 435.

in the Two Sahihs from the Hadith of Abu Az-Zinad from Al-A'raj that Abu Hurayrah heard the Messenger of Allah jg say: J\ It* If* o&r J&rj jLs Jflitj J;*Jl Jilt, CjQ*** ~ J AJ ; Yl y jLL>- 3^1 bt hiji J^yJl t^lj io^li ^i The parable of the miser and the almsgiver is that of two persons wearing iron cloaks from their chests to their collar-bones. When the almsgiver gives in charity, the cloak becomes spacious until it covers his whole body to such an extent that it hides his fingertips and covers his tracks (obliterates his tracks - or, his sins will be forgiven). And when the miser wants to spend, it (the iron cloak) sticks and (its) every ring gets stuck to its place, and he tries to widen it, but it does not become loide ."[1 This version was recorded by

Prohibition of killing Children This Ayah indicates that Allah is more compassionate towards His servants than a father to his child, because He forbids killing children just as He enjoins parents to take care of their children in matters of inheritance. The people of Jahiliyyah would not allow their daughters to inherit from them, and some would even kill their daughters lest they make them more poor. Allah forbade that and said: 4& zii pi %} 4And kill not your children for fear of poverty.} meaning, lest they may make you poor in the future. This is

why Allah mentions the children's provision first:

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3155–3171]

4We shall provide for them as well as for you.} In Surat Al-An'am, Allah says: ikill not your children because of poverty.} [6:151] \$&& 4We provide sustenance for you and for them} [6:151) and. iSurely, the killing of them is a great sin.} means, a major sin. In Two Sahihs it is recorded that Abdullah bin Mas'ad said: I said, O Messenger of Allah, which sin is the worst? He said, it " . u" 0 jLL-" y pi : To

appoint rivals of Allah when He has created you.* I asked, Then what? He said, "To kill your child lest he should eat with you.* I asked, Then what? He said, To commit adultery with your neighbor's wife.* Fath Al-Bdri 8:13.

<: r-Ls jfcTj < 432. And come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is Fahishah (immoral sin) and an evil way.} The Command to avoid Zina (Unlawful Sex) and Everything that leads to it Allah says, forbidding His servants to commit Zina or to approach it or to do anything that may lead to it: of lijii igjii Slj} iAnd come not near to unlawful sex. Verily, it is a Fahishah (immoral sin)} meaning a major sin, iand an evil way.} meaning, a terrible way to behave. Imam

the Prophet jg said, >{ . Come closer The young man came to him, and he said, Sit down " so he sat down. The Prophet jg said, Would you like it (unlawful sex) for your mother?" He said, No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you. The Prophet jg said, 'Ij1 "Neither do the people like it for their mothers . " The Prophet jg said, Would you like it for your daughter?" He said, No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you. The Prophet jg said,

ZjL: % "Neither do the people like it for their daughters ." The Prophet said, Would you like it for your sister?* He said, No, by Allah, may I be ransomed for you. The Prophet jg said, "Neither do the people like it for their sisters ." The Prophet said, *Would you like it for your paternal aunt?* He said, No, lay Allah, O Allah s Messenger! may I be ransomed for you. Tne Prophet jg said, !ji ij 1 "Neither do the people like it for their paternal aunts.* The Prophet m, said, Would you like it for your maternal aunt?* He said, No, tj"y Allah, O Allah s Messenger! may I be ransomed for you. Tne Prophetm said, *Neither do the people like it for their maternal auntsJ Then the Prophet put his hand on him and said, ' - .1 - ' . , 1V3 j&J O Allah, forgive his sin, purify his heart and guard his chastity. After that the young man never paid attention to anything of that nature. 1 * .^j) GEL JJ ^ j!^ ys to ifr;^ A jSK 4 -ip. ,M Ahmad 5 :256.

pleased with him, and Mu'awiyah did event- ually take power, as Ibn Abbas said oin the basis of this Ayah. This is one of the stranger of matters, 4 %} 4But let him not exceed limits in the matter of taking life. They said: this means the heir should not go to extremes in killing the killer, such ajs mutilating the body or taking revenge on persons other than the killer. iVerily, he is helped:} means, the heir is helped against the killer by the SharVahand by divine decree. mm tao j\Jj }j_) - psJSM^c0d^S i\ ipx ijtj'j jt&& *& i j c>;p sf> iPi & \% -K Ii <& 434. And come not near to the orphan's property except to improve it, until he attains the age offull strength. And fulfill (every) covenant. Verily, the covenant will be questioned about.} 435. And givefull measure when you measure, and weigh with a balance that is straight. That is good (advantageous) and better in the end.}

The Command to handle the Orphan's Wealth properly and to be Honest in Weights and Measures 4And come not near to the orphan's property except to improve it, until he attains the age offull strength .} meaning, do not dispose of the orphan s wealth except in a proper manner. it& ibut consume it [the orphan's property] not wastefully and hastily fearing that they should grow up, and whoever (among guardians) is rich, he should take no wages, but if he is poor, let him have for himself what is just and reasonable (according to his labor).} [4:6] In Sahih

Al-Isrd' (36) (Part-15) }And givefull measure when you measure.} meaning, do not try to make it weigh less nor wrong people with their belongings. jA\> \yjj} iand weigh with a balance meaning

scales, i that is straight.} meaning that which is not distorted nor that which will cause confusion. i that is good^ for you, in your daily life and in your Hereafter. So Allah says: i and better in the end.} meaning, with regard to your ultimate end in the Hereafter. J"*f '.. Tk i That is good (advantageous) and better in the end.} Said narrated that Qatadah said that this means Better in reward and a better end. ' Ibn Abbas used to say: O people, you are entrusted with two things for which the people who came before you were destroyed - these weights and measures. [21 0] - it oB oA b wjmS }36. And follow not that of which you have no knowledge. Verily, the hearing, and the sight, and the heart of each of those ones will be questioned (by Allah).} Do not speak without knowledge Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said: This means) do not say (anything of which you have no knowledge). Al- Awfi said: Do not accuse anyone of that of I Tabari 17:446. Tabari 17:446. Tabari 17:446.

which you have no knowledge. I 1 ' Muhammad bin Al- Hanafiyyah said: It means bearing false witness. ,21 Qatadah said: Do not say, I have seen , when you did not see anything, or I have heard , when you did not hear anything, or I know , when you do not know, for Allah will ask you about all of that. In conclusion, what they said means that Allah forbids speaking without knowledge and only on the basis of suspicion, which is mere imagination and illusions. As Allah says: (jj \jff i Avoid much suspicion; indeed some suspicions are sins.) [49:12] According to a Hadith: 4-Jit 1%}\ "Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the falsest of speech.^ The following Hadith is found in Sunan Abu Dawud n What an evil habit it is for a man to say, They claimed ...'151 " According to another Hadith jU U *Z1Z jJ-jJl I jj" i The worst of lies is for a man to claim to have seen something that he has not seen .^ ,e| In the Sahih it says: QgJplL Jj Jla*j of LJlp- o Whoever claims to have seen a dream (when he has not seen) will be told on the Day of Resurrection to make a knot between m At-Tabari 17:447. Tabari 17:447. ,3) At-Tabari 17:446. Al-Bari 9 :106. 151 Abu Dawud 5:254. Fath Al-B&ri 12 :446

Al-Isrd' (37-38) (Part-15) tivo barley grains, and he will not be able to do ifV ieach of those ones} means these faculties, hearing, sight and the heart, ijZ} twill be questioned.} means, the person will be asked about them on the Day of Resurrection, and they will be asked about him and what he did with them. Jib\$ c- f: 437. And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance. Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth nor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height .} i38. All the bad aspects of these (the above mentioned things) are hateful to your Lord.} Condemnation of strutting Allah forbids His servants to strut and walk in a boastful manner: 4 And walk not on the earth with conceit and arrogance.} meaning, walking in boastful manner and acting proud, like those who are arrogant oppressors. 4 Verily, you can neither rend nor penetrate the earth} means, you cannot penetrate the earth with your walking. This was the opinion of Ibn Jarir. W jofg ^j;} inor can you attain a stature like the mountains in height.} means, with your arrogance, pride and self-admiration. Indeed,. Al-Bari 12 :446 .

such behavior may bring about the opposite of what one pretends to be, as was reported in the Sahih: * OJ- ij | ^^ ji; us" f>: Ji ly 3^ uWliile a man from the people before you was walking arrogantly in his garments, the earth swallowed him and he is still sinking down into it, until the Day of ResurrectionJ [I] Allah also tells us about Qarun, who went to his people wearing his finery, then Allah caused the earth to swallow him and his house. 4(sSvIaji^* ott i jf) 4 All the bad aspects of these (the above mentioned things) are Sayi'uhu [hatefiil] to your Lord.) Some scholars recite this as Sayi atan, meaning evil deeds,

i.e., everything mentioned is forbidden, from the Ayah, 42 .p}\$2 4And kill not your children for fear of poverty) [17:31] up to this Ayah. So everything that is mentioned here is a Sayi ah (evil deed) for which a person is to be blamed before Allah, Who does not like or accept these deeds. As for the recitation Sayi'uhu, it is a genitive construction, meaning the bad aspects of these i.e., everything mentioned from the Ayah, 4%\ 'jjU\$ & j) 4And your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him) [17:23] up to this Ayah, [17:38] meaning that the worst of these mentioned are disliked by Allah. This was the view of Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. [This is the end of Volume Five. Volume Six begins with Ayah number 39 of Surat Al-Isra .} Muslim 3 :1654.

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TAFSIRIBN KATHIR (ABRIDGED)VOLUME 6 (Surat Al-Isra , Verse 39 to the end of Surat Al-Muminun) AGROUP OF SCHOLARS UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF SHAYKH SAFIUR-RAHMAN AL-MUBARAKPURI Riyadh Jeddah Al-Khobar Sharjah Lahore London Houston New York

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aqx ,vfiiquv-ivmus jo sanjttA aqx .vfyqv-iv jo jis/dx aqx sjoojj joj sjiaqjXjoj aqj jo jsanbay aqx ufm
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Important Guidelines About the Authenticity of the Reports and Quotations in the Tafsir of Ibn Kathir Reports from the Companions of the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) Reports that are attributed to the companions of Allah's Messenger are commonly used for additional explanation of the meanings of the Qur'an. As for those quotes that Ibn Kathir mentions in passing, these quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as an evidence against what is known to be authentic. Additional information in this regard is found in the Introduction of Ibn Kathir. Incomplete Chains of Narration The following is a list of common incomplete chains of narrations that Al-Hafiz Ibn Kathir often quotes. - Ali bin Abi Talhah (Al-Walibi) reported that Ibn Abbas said... - (Atiyah) Al-Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said... - Ad-Dahhak from Ibn Abbas. - As-Suddi reported from Abu Malik and Abu Salih from Ibn Abbas, Ibn Mas'ud and [or] some men among the companions. - Al-Hasan Al-Basri reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ. - Qatadah reporting from or about the Prophet ﷺ All narrations coming from these chains are unauthentic according to the Sciences of Hadith. Their meanings, however, may be correct as understood by authentic texts, and for this reason they are commonly referenced. Reports from the Followers of the Companions and those who Follow them The following is a list of those who did not see the Prophet

55s, but they report from companions of the Prophet ﷺ, while often they themselves are quoted for Tafsir. Reports that are attributed to them are used as additional support in understanding certain issues by Ibn Kathir. Such quotes may, or may not be authentically attributed to them. Wherever it is mentioned that one of them said something, and that statement contradicts other clearly authentic texts, then such statements can not be held as evidence against the authentic evidence. Abu Aliyah, Said bin Jubayr, Said bin Al-Musayib, Ata (bin Abi Rabah), Ata Al-Khurasani, Muqatil bin Hayyan, Ar-Rabi bin Anas, Ash-ShaTibi, Qatadah, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam (Ibn Zayd) Ibn Jurayj. Other Scholars After the Companions The following are some scholars that Ibn Kathir often quotes from. Since these scholars are not well known to the average English reader, one should beware that their own statements about the Prophet ﷺ, his companions, or circumstances surrounding the Qur'an's revelation, are not to be considered as important as authentically narrated texts. Waki, Sufyan Ath-Thawri, Muhammad bin Ishaq, Ibn Atiyyah, Ibn Abi Hatim, Ibn Jarir (At-Tabari).

وَالَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ لَنُدْخِلَنَّهُمْ فِي الصَّالِحِينَ (part) of Al-Hikmah (wisdom) which your Lord has revealed to you. And set not up with Allah any other god lest you should be thrown into Hell, blameworthy and rejected (from Allah's mercy). Everything previously mentioned is Revelation and Wisdom Allah says: What We have commanded you to do is part of good manners, and what We have forbidden you are evil qualities. We have revealed this to you, O Muhammad, so that you may command the people likewise. And set not up with Allah any other god lest you should be thrown into Hell, blameworthy meaning, your own self will blame you, as will Allah and His creation. And rejected means far removed from everything good. Ibn Abbas and Qatadah said: (It means) cast out. 11 This is an address to the Ummah via the Messenger ﷺ, for he is infallible. 440. Has then your Lord preferred for you sons, and taken for Himself from among the angels daughters? Verily, you indeed utter an awful saying Refutation of Those Who claim that the Angels are Daughters of Allah Allah refutes the lying idolators who claim, may the curse of Allah be upon them, that the angels are the daughters of Allah. They made the angels, who are the servants of Allah. At-Tabari 17:452.

18 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Rahman (the Most Beneficent), females, and called them daughters of Allah, then they worshipped them. They were gravely wrong on all three counts. Allah says, denouncing them: Has then your Lord preferred for you sons, meaning, has He given only you sons? and taken for Himself from among the angels daughters? > meaning, has He chosen for Himself, as you claim, daughters? Then Allah denounces them even more severely, and says: 4 Verily, you indeed utter an awful saying. meaning, in your claim that Allah has children, then you say that His children are female, which you do not like for yourselves and may even kill them by burying them alive. That is indeed a division most unfair! Allah says: Z. oA cf& A& o' yji Cj ! > o' J JiK, jfcvJ oji 4)* oyUlt 4 J^=" o), 4 And they say: "The Most Beneficent (Allah) has begotten a child." Indeed you have brought forth (said) a terrible evil thing. Whereby the heavens are almost torn, and the earth split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins. That they ascribe a son child to the Most Beneficent. But it is not suitable for (the majesty of) the Most Beneficent that he should beget a child. There is none in the heavens and the earth but comes unto the Most Beneficent as a servant. Verily, He knows each one of them, and has

counted them a full counting. And every one of them will come to Him alone on the Day of Resurrection .4 (19 :88-95)

Al-Isrd' (41-43) (Part-15) 442 . And surely, We have explained in this Qur'an that they may take heed, but if I in- creases them in naught save aversion.} Allah says: / / . / *** \ 4 ui/"^ JUJjy 4And surely. We have explained in this Qur an} meaning, We have explained Our warni- ngs so that they may remember the proof, evidence and exhorta- tions contained there- in, and be prevented from Shirk, wrong- doing and scandal. ifeCj} ibut it increases them in naught} the wrong- doers among them isave aversion.} aversion towards the truth; they go further away from it. TA-t isas ^ >. is ?< : ,<>> *,/ >,* . / . vV < S' + ? / / > / > ^J1)4- ;4jl4 > x > Zn^yjaS^j b^JM b^ic-UJ^-oD .4jWf"i-JuJO 3 l*r J UliU- j /* 'A <' y "A" 9st/i bj*> J "-Wj *jsW j V \j"j ~kS^T" VJbtJ * ^ ^ i * /" //<' ^ " * / > t # ^ / ys ^ b/I* OJo Ju "Jb^jj^k&US'b Vjjlij 4^ fo &> %\$. & * ii \$& 4 oj>; ff n/. ,ib'^ jj. Say: If there had been other gods along with Him as they assert, then they would certainly have sought out a way to the Lord of the Throne.} 443 . Glorified and Exalted is He high above what they say!} Allah says: Say, O Muhammad, to these idolaters who claim that Allah has a partner among His creation, and who worship others besides Him that they may bring them nearer to Him: if

20 Tafsir IbtI Kathir the matter is as you say, and there is another god besides Him whom you worship in order to draw closer to Him and so that he will intercede for you with Him, then those whom you worship would themselves worship Him and seek means to draw closer to Him, So worship Him alone, just as those on whom you call besides Him worship Him. You have no need of a deity to be an intermediary between you and Him, for He does not like or accept that, rather He hates it and rejects it, and has forbidden that through all of His Messengers and Prophets. Then He glorifies and sanctifies Himself far above all that, and says: &&&& ^Glorified and Exalted is He high above what they say!} meaning these idolaters who transgress and do wrong when they claim that there are other gods besides Him. 4high above} means, far above. He is Allah, the One, the Self- Sufficient Master, Whom all creatures need. He begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none comparable or coequal unto Him. "J J3j }1 Jt ir* <>*-> PP& 4 it :4 444. The seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, glorify Him and there is not a thing but glorifies His praise. But you understand not their glorification. Truly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.} Everything glorifies Allah Allah says: the seven heavens and the earth and all that is therein, meaning the creatures that dwell therein, sanctify Him, exalt Him, venerate Him, glorify Him and magnify Him far above what these idolaters say, and they bear witness that He is One in His Lordship and Divinity. In everything there is a sign of Allah indicating that He is One. As Allah says:

&& ! cJ & ^HTiereby the heavens are almost tom, and the earth is split asunder, and the mountains fall in ruins, That they ascribe child to the Most Beneficent} (19:90-91).] *(jr J iand there is not a thing but glorifies His praise.} there is no created being that does not celebrate the praises of Allah. iBut you understand not their glorification .} means, You do not understand them, O mankind, because it is not like your languages. This applies to all creatures generally, animal, inanimate and botanical. This is the better known of the two opinions according to the most reliable of two opinions. It was reported in Sahih

Allah will let the wrongdoer carry on until, when He does seize him. He will never let him go²] Then the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} recited: iSuch is the punishment of your Lord when He seizes the (population of) towns while they are doing wrong.} [1:02] Allah says: 4a^{il}U Ca> LA < 5 J; 4And many a township did I give respite while it was given to wrongdoing.} [22:45] until the end of two Ayat. 4And many a township did We destroy while they were given to wrongdoing.} [22:48] Whoever gives up his disbelief and disobedience, and turns back to Allah in repentance, Allah will accept his repentance, as He says: -*

4 j* IIX iTruly, He is Ever Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving.4 At the end of Surah Fatir, He says: H ^ at oi U'j J i \ 4Verily, Allah grasps the heavens and the earth lest they should move away from their places, and if they were to move away from their places, there is not one that could grasp them after Him. Truly, He is Ever Most Forbearing, Oft-Forgiving .. \$ until His saying; 4S '& il' JUr\$ 4And if Allah were to punish men\$[35:41-45) (\$ V egj i5S* biX jfe-p' J)a> *j4*b J 4 . And when you recite the Qur'an, We put between you and those who believe not in the Hereafter, an invisible veil. 446. And We have put Akinna^h over their hearts, lest they should understand it, and in their ears deafness. And when you make mention of your Lord Alone in the Qur'an, they turn on their backs, fleeing in extreme dislike The Veil over the Hearts of the Idolators Allah says to His Messenger Muhammad jgg: When you recite Qur'an to these idolators. We put an invisible veil between you and them. Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said, It is coverings over their hearts, 11 as Allah says: 4Q-& di uj bX 'cjaj Jij xij 4 lyki CLj > . i; "> y . 4And they say: "Our hearts are under coverings (screened) from that to which you invite us; and in our ears is deafness; and between us and you is a screen hi At-Tabari 17:457.

meaning, there is something that is stopping and preventing your words from reaching us. ian invisible veil.} meaning something which covers, or that cannot be seen, so there is a barrier between them and guidance. This is the interpretation that Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him) thought was correct. Al-Hafiz Abu Ya*la Al-Mawusili recorded that Asma bint Abi Bakr (may Allah be pleased with her) said, When the Ayah, iPerish the two hands of Abu Lahab and perish he!} (111:1) was revealed, the one-eyed woman Umm Jamil [the wife of Abu Lahab] came with a stone pestle in her hand, screaming, What was sent to us is somebody blameworthy, or, we reject somebody blameworthy [Abu Musa - one of the narrators - said, it is I who am not sure what was said); we shun his religion and disobey whatever he commands! The Messenger of Allah was sitting with Abu Bakr by his side. Abu Bakr, may Allah be pleased with him, said, This woman has come and I am afraid she will see you. The Prophet jg said, jJ "Certainly she will not see me." and he recited Qur'an through which he was protected from her: iWJZ <&' \$And when you recite the Qur'an, We put between you and those who believe not in the Hereafter, an invisible veil}. She came and found Abu Bakr, but she did not see the Prophet jg. She said, O Abu Bakr, I have heard that your companion is lampooning me. Abu Bakr said, No, by the Lord of this House [the Ka'bah], he is not lampooning you. Then she went away, saying, The Quraysh know that I am the daughter of their master. I1 * Musnad Abu Ya'la 1 :53.

4And VJe have put coverings over their hearts, Akinna^h (coverings) is the plural of Kinan, which covers the heart. ilest they should understand it,} means, lest they should understand the Qur'an. 4% (V 4and in their ears deafness^ something that will stop them from hearing the Qur'an in such a way that they will understand it and be guided by it. 4ZZ 4 4And when you make mention of your Lord Alone in

the Qur'an,} means, when you declare Allah to be One in your recitation, and say La flaha. IUallah, ithey turn} means they turn away 4on their backs, fleeing in extreme dislike.} As Allah says: 4And when Allah Alone is mentioned, the hearts of those ivho believe not in the Hereafter are filled with disgust (from the Oneness ofAllah).} [39:45] 4And when you make mention of your Lord Alone in the Qur'an,} Commenting on this Ayah, Qatadah said that when the Muslims said La. Raha Rlaldh, the idolators disliked this and found it intolerable. Iblls and his troops hated it, but Allah insisted on supporting it so that it would prevail over those who opposed it. Whoever uses it against his opponent will

prevail, and whoever fights for it will be victorious. Only the Muslims of the Arabian Peninsula, which can be traversed by a rider in a few nights, knew it and accepted it, out of all mankindJ 4i -Ls * ij&SM J2 oZ JJ& . We know best of what they listen to, when they listen to you. And when they take secret counsel, then the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a beivitchd man."} 448 . See what examples they have putforwardfor you . So they have gone astray, and never can theyfind a way The Secret Counsel ofQuraysh afterhearing the Qur an Allah tells His Prophet jg about what the leaders of Quraysh discussed when they came and listened to him reciting Qur an in secret, without their people knowing about it. They said that he was Mashur which according to the better-known view means someone affected by magic (Sifyt); it may also mean a man who has a lung, i.e., a mere human being, as if they were saying that ifyou follow Muhammad, you will only be following a human being. This second suggestion does not sound correct, because what they meant here was that he was under the influence of Sihhr (magic) which made him see dreams in which he learned these words that he recited. Some of them said he was a poet, or a soothsayer, or crazy, or a sorcerer. Allah says: *" ij& 3Z 4See what examples they have put forward for you. So they have gone astray, and never can theyfind a way.} meaning, they will never be guided to the truth and will never find a way to reach it. Muhammad bin Ishaq said in As-Sirah: Muhammad bin Muslim bin Shihab Az-Zuhri told me that it happened that Abu Sufyan bin Harb, Abu Jahl bin Hisham and Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq bin Amr bin Wahb Ath-Thaqafi, the ally of Bani Zahrah, went out one night to listen to the m At-Jabari 17:458.

Messenger of Allah when he was praying at night in his house. Each one of them took up a position for listening, and none of them knew that the others were also there. They stayed listening to him all night until dawn came. When they left, they met up on the read, each of them blaming the others, saying to one another, Do not come back again, lest you give the wrong impression (i.e., that you like what you hear]. Then they went away until the second night came, when each of them came back to his place and spent the night listening. When dawn came they left, then when they met up on the road, each of them blamed the others, saying the same as they had said the previous night. Then they went away until the third night came, when each of them came back to his place and spent the night listening. When dawn came they left, then when they met up on the road, they said to one another, Let us not leave until we promise not to come back, so they made a promise to that effect, and went their separate ways. In the morning, Al-Akhnas bin Shurayq took his stick and went to the house of Abu Sufyan bin Harb, where he said, Tell me, O Abu Hanzalah [i.e., Abu Sufyan], what do you think of what you have heard from Muhammad? Abu Sufyan said, O Abu Thalabah [i.e., Al-Akhnas], by Allah, I have heard something I understand and I know what is meant by it, and I have heard things I do not understand and do not know what is meant by it. Al-Akhnas said: Me too, by the One by Whom you swore. Then he left and

went to Abu Jahl, and entered his house. He said, O Abu Al-Hakam [i.e., Abu Jahl], what do you think of what you have heard from Muhammad? He said, What did you hear? He said, *We and Banu Abd Manaf competed for honor and position: they fed people so we fed people, they engaged in battle so we engaged in battle, they gave so we gave, until we were neck and neck, like race horses. Then they said, we have a Prophet among us who receives revelation from heaven. How could we compete with that? By Allah we will never believe in him. Then Al- Akhnas got up and left him. 111 y jl ij i;jr jiig^& U m Ibn Hisham 1 :337

28 Tafsir Ibtī Kathir * 'ir* i\$ a4 j -=*i 1 l2t 3 2 ^JS& Jg ? > ' ? . t?>; y ;l> jr fj> mp* >^y ui oji^j 449. And they say: "When we are bones and fragments (destroyed), should we really be resurrected (to be) a new creation?" } 450. Say: "Be you stones or iron," } 451 . "Or some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts." Then, they will say: "Who shall bring us back (to life)?" Say: "He Who created you first!" Then, they will shake their heads at you and say: "When will that be?" Say: "Perhaps it is near!" } 452. On the Day when He will call you, and you will answer with (words of) His praise and obedience, and you will think that you have stayed (in this world) but a little while! } Refutation of Those Who do not believe in Life after Death Allah tells us about the disbelievers who think it very unlikely that the Resurrection will happen and who say, in a tone of denial, < & it C\ } 4When we are bones and fragments. } meaning earth. This was the view of Mujahid. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported from Ibn Abbas that it means dust. 4\% & U } 4should we really be resurrected (to be) a new creation? } meaning, on the Day of Resurrection after we have disintegrated and become nothing, and have been forgotten. Allah tells us about them elsewhere: i&% m At-Jabari 17:464.

Al-Isrd' (49-52) (Part-15 iThey say: Shall we indeed be returned to (our) former state of life? Even after we are crumbled bones?" They say: It would in that case, be a return with loss!" } (79:10-12). And, ? } And he puts forth for Us a parable, and forgets his own creation . } until the end of two Ayat. (36:78-79) Allah commands His Messenger sg to respond to them, so He says: &\$ } iSay (O Muhammad): Be you stones or iron," } - which are more difficult to restore than bones and fragments, iOr some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts. } Ibn Ishaq narrated from Ibn Abi Najih from Mujahid: I asked Ibn Abbas about that, and he said: This is death. _ l Atiyah reported that Ibn Umar explained of this Ayah: If you were dead I would still resurrect you. 111 This was also the view of Said bin Jubayr, Abu Salih, Al-Hasan, Qatadah, Ad- Dahhak and others. This means that if you were to assume that you would become dead, which is the opposite of living, Allah will resurrect you when He wills, for nothing can stop Him when He wills a thing. iOr some created thing that is yet greater (or harder) in your breasts. } Mujahid said: This means the heavens, earth and mountains. According to another report, Whatever you want to be, go ahead, Allah will still resurrect you after you die. a4Jabari 17:463. AMabari 17:463.

iThen, t)ie\j will say: Who shall bring us back (to life)?" } meaning, who will resurrect us if we are stones or iron or some other strong created thing? jji iSay: "He Who created you first!" } meaning, He Who created you when you were nothing, then you became human beings, walking about. He is able to create you anew, no matter what you have become. ' ,>/v iAnd He it is Who originates the creation, then He will repeat it; and this is easier for Him. } [30:27] >' >> iThen, they will shake their heads at you } Ibn Abbas and Qatadah said, They will move their heads in a gesture of mockery. 111 This view

expressed by Ibn Abbas and Qatadah is what the Arabs understand from the language, because the word used Fasayunghidun indicates an up-and- down movement Nughcid. A word derived from the same root, Naghd, is used to refer to the young of the ostrich, because when it walks, it walks quickly and moves its head. The same word is used to describe a tooth when it becomes loose and is detached from its place. > * iand say: "When will that be?"} This shows that they thought it very unlikely that it would happen, as Allah says: iAnd they say: "When will this promise (i.e. Resurrection) be fulfilled, ifyou are truthful?"} (36:48) i i+j V I*; iThose who believe not therein seek to hasten it [the Hour]} [42:18] At-Jabari 17:467.

4CJ J \$} iSay : Perhaps it is near!"} meaning, beware of it, for it is at hand and will no doubt come to you, and what will be will be. \y\$ iOn the Day what He will call you,} meaning the Lord, may He be blessed and exalted: iWhen He will call you by a single call, behold, you will come outfrom the earth} [30:25] meaning, when He commands you to come out from the earth, for nothing can oppose Him or prevent His command from being fulfilled. Rather, it is as He says: 3.' i*j} iAnd Our commandment is but one as the twinkling of an eye} (54:50) i>;\$4\$ 3 i lit ujs a\} iVerily, Our Word unto a thing when We intend it, is only that We say unto it : "Be!" - and it is} (16:40) r* or v"-3 iBut it will be only a single ZajrahJ When behold, theyfind themselves (on the surface of the earth) alive (after their death).} (79:13-14), meaning, it will be just one definitive command, then the people will have come out from the inside of the earth to its surface, as Allah says: fj>}.} iOn the Day when He will call you, and you ivill answer with (words of) His praise} meaning, you will all rise up in response to His commandland in obedience to His will. See the explanation of Surat An-Naz'iat [79 : 13- 14)

32 Tafslr Ibn Kathir \$and you will think^ means, on the Day when you rise up from your graves, ithat you have stayed in this earthly abode, ^\} ibut a little while.} This is like the Ayah: ju i \$\$\$. i g 477ie Day they see it, (it will be) as if they had not tarried (in this world) except an afternoon or a morning.} (79:46). Allah says: 4T/ie Day when the Trumpet toill be blown : that Day, We shall gather the blue or blind-eyed loith thirst. They will speak in a very low voice to each other (saying) : "You stayed not longer than ten (days)." We knoiv very well what they will say, when the best among them in knowledge and wisdom will say: "You stayed no longer than a day!"} (20:102-104). fj&ZZ. ji. U 'qyJ*LS\ Acll!' 'f?f} iAnd on the Day that the Hour will be established, they will swear that tlmy stayed not but an hour - thus were they ever deluded.} (30:55) jjjLJi J* -i 1* .. 4 f 3^^ j&1 J vi Jlij c& 4He will say: "What number ofyears did you stay on earth?" They will say: "We stayed a day or part of a day. Ask of those who keep account. He will say: "You stayed not but a little, if you had only known!"} (23: 112-114). Ij-lc jiLi)' 5) 0 4 J> Jf 'jljii lijC-J

it- And say to My servants that they should say those words that are best. (Because) Shaytdn verily, sows a state of conflict and disagreement among them. Surely, Shaytdn is to man a plain enemy.} People should speak GoodWords with Politeness Allah commands His servant Muhammad (j) to tell the believing servants of Allah that they should address one another in their conversations and discussions with the best and politest of words, for if they do not do that, Shaytdn will sow discord among them, and words will lead to actions, so that evil and conflicts and fights will arise among them. For Shaytdn is the enemy of Adam and his descendants, and has been since he refused to prostrate to Adam. His enmity is obvious and manifest. For this reason it is forbidden for a man to point at his

34 Tafslr Ibn Kathfr the earth. Arid indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others, and to Dazviid We gave the Zabiir.} Allah says: 4% >! gfr 4Your Lord knows you best;} O mankind, meaning, He knows best who among you deserves to be guided and who does not deserve to be guided. itfHe wills. He will have mercy on you,} by helping you to obey Him and turn to Him. 4or if He wills, He will punish you. And We have not sent you} - 4 ^ = ias a guardian over them.} meaning, *We have sent you as a warner, so whoever obeys you, will enter Paradise and whoever disobeys you, will enter Hell. 4And your Lord knows best all who are in the heavens and the earth.} meaning, their status or level of obedience or disobedience. The Preference ofsome Prophets above Others 4And indeed, We have preferred some of the Prophets above others.} As Allah says: ft ' " * . * "j (v* a4 J** . & (*-+ -*> iThose Messengers! We preferred some of them to others; to some of them Allah spoke (directly); others He raised to degrees (ofhonor.)) [2:253] This does not contradict the report in the Two SahVis which

says that the Messenger of Allah jg said: Don't give superiority to any Prophet among (Allah's Prophets .s' 11

What is meant in this Hadith is giving a superiority based on

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3200–3222]

whims and fanaticism or sectarian feelings, not on the basis of evidence. If there is solid evidence, we have to follow it. There is no dispute that the Messengers are better than the rest of the Prophets, and that the mighty Messengers of Great Resolve are the best of all. They are the five mentioned in two Ayat of the Qur an, in Surat Al-Ahzab: ifA d) t jc op (4^ ^ \$And (remember) when We took from the Prophets their covenant, andfrom you andfrom Nuh, Ibrahim, Musa and Isd son ofMaryam.} [33:7] and in Surat Ash-Shura: !s"JO odl' oi s: (a list 3 \$He has ordained for you the same religion which He ordained for Niih, and that which We have revealed to you, and tlmt which We ordained for Ibrahim, Musa and Isa saying you should establish religion and make no divisions in it.} [42:13] There is no dispute that Muhammad is the best of them, then Ibrahim, then Musa, then Isa (peace be upon them all), according to the best-known view. We have discussed the evidence for this in detail elsewhere, and Allah is the source of help. Allah s saying, s#mi iand to Dawiid We gave the Zabur.} is an indication of his virtue and honor.

" tAv 'Wie Qur'an (i.e. revea- t/s ^ ~i >>'** was made easy f r Da~ Xr^ SJ ls ji^> loud, so he would callfor tr &** -"sK >-" >' >> "rf " > his mounts to be saddled, and^ wouldfinish recit- 0Q&jZ in8 i{0 e., the Zabur) be- , :tt\ , ./" & *:{ fare thejobwasdonej' 1] ^ c/j1' !' a* x\$ & itCJ 4^ jijUi ^ . Say: "Call upon >/ */ those - besides Him "-r> -^ whom you pretend . They \"-' >\"Y. >/ */ r/iose - oesiaes Him K~Sjji -o whom you pretend . They jljlvi have neither the power ,vr ' ss.' 's>" t0 remove the adversity /him you nor even to shift (it from you to another person)."} . TTiose whom they call upon, desire a means of access to their Lord, as to which ofthem should be the nearest; and they hopefor His mercy andfear His torment. Verily, the torment of your Lord is (something) to be afraid of!} The gods ofthe Idolators can neither benefit nor harm; rather they themselves seek to draw close to Allah Allah says: 4\$} 4Say} O Muhammad to these idolators who worship things Fath Al-Bari 6:522

other than Allah, j* ctj' ! "> 4Ca// upon those - besides Him whom you pretend .> such as idols and rivals of Allah. Even if you turn to them, ip -p\ dgC iThey have neither the power to remove the adversity from you} they have no such power at all, in or even to shift (it from you to another person.)} to lift the distress from you and give it to someone else. The meaning is that the only one Who is able to do that is Allah Alone, with no partner or associate, Who is the One Who creates and issues commands. iSay: Call upon those whom you pretend} Al- Awfi reported from Ibn Abbas, The people of Shirk used to say, we worship the angels and the Messiah and TJzayr, while these (the angels and the Messiah and Uzayr) themselves call upon Allah. iThose whom they call upon, desire}

ithey hope for His mercy and fear His torment. Worship cannot be complete or perfect unless it is accompanied by both fear and hope. Fear stops one from doing things that are forbidden, and hope makes one do more good deeds. X^& % iVerily, the torment of your Lord is (something) to be afraid of! meaning, one should beware of it and be afraid lest it happen. We seek refuge with Allah from that. 4 iX '-1,4.1 j' jy Jj yit of) i58. And there is not a town (population) but We shall destroy it before the Day of Resurrection, or punish it with a severe torment. That is written in the Book (of Our decrees) The Destruction or Torment of all Disbelieving Towns before the Hour begins Here Allah tells us that He has decreed and it is written in Al-Lawh Al-Mahfuz (The Preserved Tablet) which is with Him, that there is no town that He will not destroy by wiping out all its people or by punishing them, iwith a severe torment. either by killing them or sending calamities upon them as He wills. This will be because of their sins, as Allah says of the past nations: 4We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves. 11 : 101] 4:\C 0 M jc; 4So it tasted the evil residt of its affair (disbelief), and the

Al-Isrd' (59) (Part-15) consequence of its affair (disbelief) was loss.} [65:9] Qj\$ If- oj cMb iAnd many a town (population) revolted against the command of its Lord and His Messengers [65:8] and many Ayat. \jff* iiUll ^ J V> . And nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamud as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to make them afraid (of destruction).} The Reason why Allah did not send Signs or Miracles Said bin Jubayr said, The idolators said: O Muhammad, you claim that before you there were Prophets, among whom was one to whom the wind was subjugated, and another who could bring the dead back to life. If you want us to believe in you, ask your Lord to turn As-Safa into gold for us. Allah conveyed to him by inspiration (Wahy): 1 have heard what they have said. If you wish, I will do what they say, but if they do not believe after that, the punishment will come down upon them, because after the sign has been sent, there is no room for speculation. Or if you wish, I will be patient with your people and give them more time. He said: "O Lord, give them more time.a This was also narrated by Qatadah, Ibn Jurayj and others.121 Imam

were destroyed. He said, jk-i j: "A/o, fee patient and give them more time.* Then Allah revealed: 4Awd nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them.

jr TAA t tr- Cj^QoSOS^SS[Jjjus J0\SiZ2'{AW^tai^uiu;^ U^jCa tiijj r. Jli tT-^ ".r? ""ll I'l t * 'A' ' ""1- jid' oj-i ^j =- quake were to strike again, I will subject you to such and such. 111 The Prophet gg said, in a Hadith whose authenticity is agreed upon: olJU bAy***b^ Ajij *| /- / ^ * " " . */ ^ Jtij virbvi5>^aj(*t~J j* j T ^ijij .^--lli !ji" uliJi N U*Jij jill ott ioUAJ j4i oVJ JjLji jUjij 10SU ojLiilJ-lj 4jI o a^S"i JJ - .4 * > , > 4jblj U I |W piji j ' J 1 fi{ I-' >>"T .*C *f * * ' Ol U t 41 ^j*S J oJLP U jjiJLiu jJ Xl>"> "77te sun and

the moon are two of the signs of Allah, and they are not eclipsed for the death or life of anyone. Allah uses them to make His servants afraid, so if you see them, hasten to remember Him, call on Him and seek His forgiveness. Then he said: "O Ummah of Muhammad, by Allah, no one has a greater sense of jealousy than Allah if He sees His servant, or female servant, committing Zina (illegal sexual intercourse). O Ummah of Muhammad, if you knew what I know, you would laugh little and weep much." [21] ; j3j oM ili ^ SOJ ivf 4 C.j l0i SO i[JSu ifiX &jS (S^o. (0 f-V-ifr j iyili' Ibn Abi Shaybah , 2 : 473 2| Fath Al-Bari 2:615, Muslim 2:618.

42 TafsTr Ibn Kathlr . And (remember) when We told you: Verily, your Lord has encompassed mankind." And We made not the vision which We showed you but a trial for mankind, and (likewise) the accursed tree in the Qur'an. We warn and make them afraid but it only increases them in naught save great disbelief, oppression and disobedience to Allah.} AllahhasencompassedMankindandmade the Visionof His Prophet a Trial forThem Allah says to His Messenger jg, encouraging him to convey the Message and informing him that He is protecting him from the people, that He is able to deal with them and that they are in His grasp and under His domination and control. U" s\j} iAnd (remember) when We told you: "Verily, your Lord has encompassed mankind.."} Mujahid, Urwah bin Az-Az-Zubayr, Al-Hasan, Qatadah others said, This means, He protected you from them. 111 iJi&i% xg\ V:j\ fis; Cf} and iAnd We made not the vision which We showed you but a trial for mankind,}

Al-Isra' (60) (Part-15) Ahmad, Abdur-Razzaq and others. ' It was also reported by Al- Awfi from Ibn Abbas. 2' It was also interpreted as referring to the Night of the Isra by Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Al-Hasan, Masruq, Ibrahim, Qatadah, Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd and several others. 3 We have already quoted at length a comprehensive collection of Hadith about the Isra at the beginning of this Surah, praise be to Allah. We have also already stated that some people gave up their Islam after they had been following the truth, because their hearts and minds could not comprehend that, and they denied what their knowledge could not grasp, but Allah caused it to increase and strengthen the faith of others, and so He says: ibut a trialK meaning a test. As for the cursed tree, this isj the Tree of Zaqquq.^ When the Messenger of Allah sg told them that he had seen Paradise and Hell, and seen the Tree of Zaqquq, they did not believe that, and Abu Jahl, upon whom be the curses of Allah, even said, Bring us some dates and butter, and he started eating them and saying, Let us have some Zaqquq, we don t know any other Zaqquq but this. This was narrated by Ibn Abbas, Masruq, Abu Malik, Al- Hasan Al-Basri and others. Everyone who interpreted the Ayah to refer to the Night of the Isra , also interpreted it to refer to the Tree of Zaqquq. i[We] make them afraid meaning, *We make the disbelievers afraid with Our warnings and punishments and torment. ibut it only increases them in naught save great disbelief, oppression and disobedience to Allah.} Ahmad 1 :221 , Abdur-Razzaq 2 :380. 2 * At-Tabari 17:481, 484. At-Tabari 17 :480 , 481 , 482 See SCLrat As-Saffat [37 :62] ' At-Tabari 17:484, 485, 486.

means, it only pushes them further into their disbelief and misguidance, and this is because Allah has forsaken them. jtt If' -wif. jtf 04U V v s"* . And (remember) when We said to the angels: "Prostrate yourselves unto Adam. They prostrated themselves except Iblis. He said: "Shall I prostrate myself to one whom You createdfrom clay?"} . He said: "See this one whom You have honored above me, ifYou give me respite to the Day of Resurrection, I will surely, seize and mislead his offspring, all but a few!"} The Story ofAdam and Iblis Allah mentions here the enmity of Iblis, may the curse of Allah be upon

him and his progeny. This is an ancient hatred, dating from the time that Allah created Adam, when He commanded the angels to prostrate to Adam, and all of them prostrated except Iblis, who was too arrogant and he haughtily refused to prostrate to him. He said in a tone indicating contempt: iL 33L 'fi jiJ: 4He said: Shall I prostrate myself to one whom You created from clay? } According to another Ayah, he said: ii& Jt </ am better than he. You created me from fire, and You created him from clay.} [7:12) He also said, speaking to the Lord with disbelief and insolence, but the Lord bore it patiently: iff 4'&& ti} 4He said: See this one whom You have honored above me..."}

Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, He is saying, I am going to dominate his offspring, all but a few. Mujahid said (it means), I am going to surround them. Ibn Zayd said (it means), I am going to lead them astray. "I 1 ' All of them are close in meaning, and the meaning of the Ayah is, Do You see this one whom You have honored and made greater than me? If You give me time, I will lead his descendants astray, all but a few of them. Cj i jLij Cyb {i4y fr% Sm SI k Yi jUi. (Allah) said: Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all) an ample recompense. 464. "And fool them gradually, those whom you can among them with your voice, Ajlib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry, share with them wealth and children, and make promises to them." But Shaytan promises them nothing but deceit. 465. Verily, My servants, you have no authority over them. And All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian."} When Iblis asked for respite, Allah said to him: 4Go,} I will give you respite. According to another Ayah (Allah) said: ^ -ik d) of aftjp} 4Verily, you are of those allowed respite till the Day of the time appointed.} (38:80-81). Then Allah warned him and those who follow him among the progeny of Adam about Hell: 4'M'S'JrTabari 17:489.

i(Allah) said: "Go, and whosoever of them follows you, surely, Hell will be the recompense of you (all)} meaning, for your deeds. tan ample recompense.} Mujahid said, Sufficient recompense. 11 Qatadah said, It will be abundant for you and will not be decreased for you. 4And fool them gradually those whom you can among them with your voice,\$ It was said that this refers to singing. Mujahid said, With idle entertainment and singing, * meaning, influence them with that. ikx . pri 9 4And fool them gradually those whom you can among them with your voiced Ibn Abbas said, Eveiy caller who calls people to disobey Allah. * This was the view of Qatadah, * and was also the opinion favored by Ibn Jarir. iAjlib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry.} Send your troops and cavalry and infantry against them. The meaning is, send whatever forces you have at your disposal against them. This is a command (related to the divine decree), as Allah says elsewhere: 4See you not that We have sent the ShayatTn against the disbelievers to push them to do evil.} (19:83), [1 At-Tabari 17:490. * At-Tabari 17 :490 At-Tabari 17:490. At-Tabari 17:491. *s * At-Tabari 17:491.

meaning, to provoke them and drive them towards evil. iAjlib upon them with your cavalry and your infantry, Ibn Abbas and Mujahid said, Everyone who rides or walks to go and commit sin and disobey Allah. * Qatadah said, He has infantry and cavalry among the Jinn and among humans. They are the ones who obey him. * The Arabs use the verb Ajlaba when describing somebody shouting at another person. Hence it is forbidden in races to shout at one another and push one another. From this root is also derived the word Jalabah, which means raising voices. iand share with them wealth and children, Ibn Abbas and Mujahid said, This means what he commands them to do of spending money in disobedience to Allah, may He be exalted. iand children, Ibn Abbas, as reported by Al- Awfi, Mujahid

and Ad-Dahhak said, This means the children of Zina (i.e., illegitimate children). Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said, This means the children whom they used to kill out of folly, without knowledge. Qatadah reported that Al-Hasan Al-Basri said: Allah caused Shaytan to take a share of wealth and children by making them Magians, Jews and Christians, and making them follow any religion other than Islam, and by making them give a part of their wealth to the Shaytan. Qatadah said the same. 7 ;V\$ jy'v? jTabari 17:491, 492. At-Tabari 17:491. * At-Tabari 17:493. At-Tabari 17:494. *s| At-Tabari 17:494.) At-Tabari 17:495. At-Tabari 17:495.

iVerily, My servants, you have no authority over them.} Here Allah tells us that He supports His believing servants, and guards and protects them against the accursed Shaytan. Allah says: 4^r#y JjQ} iAnd All-Sufficient is your Lord as a Guardian. meaning, as a Protector, Supporter and Helper. 466. Your Lord is He Who drives the ship for you through the sea, in order that you may seek of His bounty. Truly, He if ever Most Merciful towards you .} Ships are a Sign of the Mercy of Allah Allah tells us of His kindness towards His servants by subjugating for them ships on the sea. He makes it easyj for them to use ships to serve their interests, seeking His bounty through trade between one region and another. He says: I iTruly, He is ever Most Merciful towards you.} meaning, He does this for you out of His grace and mercy towards you. 467. And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanish from you except Him. But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away. And man is ever ungrateful.} When Harm befalls Them, the Disbelievers do inot remember anyone except Allah Allah tells us thatwhen harm befalls people, they call on Him, turning toHimand sincerelybeseechingHim. HenceAllah says: 4 J'iN j^~And when harm touches you upon the sea, those that you call upon vanishfrom you except Him.}

meaning, everything they worship besides Allah disappears from their hearts and minds. Similar happened to Tkrimah bin Abi Jahl when he fled from the Messenger of Allah gg after the conquest of Makkah, and headed for Ethiopia. He set out across the sea to go to Ethiopia, but a stormy wind arose. The people said to one another: None can save you except Allah Alone. Ikrimah said to himself, By Allah if none can benefit on the sea except Allah then no doubt none can benefit on land except Allah. O Allah! I promise You that if You bring me safely out of this, I will go and put my hand in the hand of Muhammad and surely, I will find him full of pity, kindness and mercy. They came out of it safely and were delivered from the sea. Then Ikrimah went to the Messenger of Allah jg, and declared his Islam, and he became a good Muslim, may Allah be pleased with him. iBut when He brings you safe to land, you turn away.} means, you forget what you remembered of Divine Oneness (Tawhid) when you were on the sea, and you turn away from calling on Him Alone with no partner or associate. 4And man is ever ungrateful.> means, by nature he forgets and denies His blessings, except for those whom Allah protects. 2 } \$ a; p * ot 468. Do you then feel secure that He will not cause a side of the land to swallow you up, or that He will not send against you a Hasib? Then, you shallfind no guardian.} Does not the Punishment ofAllah come on Land too? Allah says, do you think that by emerging onto dry land you will be safe from His vengeance and punishment, that a side of the land will not swallow you up or He will not send against you a Hasib - which is a kind of rain that carries stones? This 111 Al-Hakim 3:241.

was the view of Mujahid and others. 11 ' As Allah says: Oi rf\, > ("V^ (trl iVerily, We sent against them, except the family of Lut, them We saved in the last hour of the night. As a favor from Us.) (54:34-35)

Elsewhere, Allah says: if??-? ir*. 1+?* t(h^)} iand We rained on them stones of Sijjil/ 21 in a well-arranged manner one after another o' f o* {A f' 'l jy^ df, i' ^ }j iDo you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not cause the earth to sink with you, and then it should quake? Or do you feel secure that He, Who is over the heaven (Allah), will not send against you a Hasib? Then you shall biow how (terrible) has been My warning (67 :16-17) P& * ft iThen, you shall find no guardian .} no helper to turn the punishment away from you and save you. y SS" J ft) ft 469 . Or do you feel secure that He will not send you back a second time to sea and send against you a Qasifand drown you because of your disbelief? Then you will not find any avenger therein against Us.} PerhapsHe will sendYouback to the Sea Allah says, ift ft iOr do you feel secure}, *you who turn away from Us after At-Tabari 17 :498, from Qatfidah ' See the explanation of Surah Hud. 1 1 :82

iVerily, We created man in the best stature (mould).} (95:4) He walks upright on his two feet and eats with his hand, while other living creatures walk on four feet and eat with their mouths, and He has given him hearing, sight and a heart with which to understand all of that, to benefit from it, and distinguish between things to know which are good for him and which are harmful, in both worldly and religious terms. iand We have carried them on land means, on animals such as cattle, horses and mules, and also on the sea in ships and boats, great and small. iand have provided them with At-Tayyibat,} meaning agricultural produce, fruits, meat, and milk with all kinds of delicious and desirable flavors and colors and beautiful appearance, and fine clothes of all kinds of shapes colors and sizes, which they make for themselves or are brought to them by others from other regions and areas. & &>>} iand have preferred them above many of those whom We hope created with a marked preferment.} means, over all living beings and other kinds of creation. JThis Ayah indicates that human are also preferred over the angels. 4. (And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam (i.e. the Book of deeds). So whosoever is given his record in his right hand, such will read their records, and they will not be dealt with unjustly in the least.} 172. And whoever is blind in this [world] then he will be blind in the Hereafter, and most astrayfrom the path.}

Al-Isra' (71-72) (Part-15 speaks about you with truth. Verily, We were recording what you used to do.} (45:28-29) This does not contradict the fact that the Prophet will be brought forward when Allah judges between his Ummah, for he will inevitably be a witness against his Ummah over their deeds. But what is meant here by Imam is the Book of deeds. Allah says: * >"Z' i(Atid remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam. So whosoever is given his record in his right hand, such will read their records,} means, because of their happiness and joy at what is recorded therein of good deeds - they will read it and want to read it. As Allah says: ! ?& a) 5 iThen as for him who will be given his record in his right hand will say : Here! read my record!} until His saying. iBut as for him who will be given his record in his left hand,} [69:19-29) %} }and they will not be dealt with unjustly in the least [Fatilan].} We have already mentioned that the FatU is the long thread in the groove of a date-pit. Al-Hafiz Abu Bakr Al-Bazzar recorded a Hadxth from Abu Hurayrah according to which the Prophet \$g said, concerning the Ayah, y^' {s.} 4(And remember) the Day when We shall call together all human beings with their (respective) Imam.} V i . \ (>* \ - | * V, ^ ^ }pj) ir! irf^J LJ J>-j J) ft) ftrife 1 '4* ijt ^ * "'Hi ffUl

*i^ ^ j l5fj *** J4 : 4j lit; V *** *j~ Iji jt il-ii ^ jiil iji: alia JL p L" JSU ii I : J^ " j4ij| One 0/ you tw7/ fee called and uri/1 fee given fits Book in his right hand. He will be in a good physical state, with a white face, and there will be placed on his head a crown of shining pearls. He will go to his companions and they will see him from afar, and will say, "O Allah, let him come to us and bless us with this." Then he will come to them and will say to them, Rejoice, for every man among you will be like this." As for the disbeliever, his face will be black and his body will be enlarged. His companions will see him from afar and will say, "We seek refuge in Allah from this, or from the evil of this, O Allah, do not let him come to us." "Then he will come to them and they will say, O Allah, humiliate him!" He will say, "May Allah cast you away, every man among you will be like this." Then Al-Bazzar said: This was only reported through this chain." i,jji j jji} iAnd whoever is blind in this Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Qatadah and Ibn Zayd said: this means in this worldly life. iblind> means, blind to the signs and proofs of Allah. ithen he will be blind in the Hereafter,} as he was blind in this world. i-Lf. &} iand most astray from the path.} most astray as he was in this world. We seek refuge with Allah from that.12 Maw&ridAz-Zaman no . 2588 At-Tabari 17:504, 505.

Al-Isrd' (73-75) (Part-15) ssssm ^ ^ ^ . V, > * * > [/>! o^Ij -U-^j !A4^j2t^|3i#e&& & > "///// ^ /-'z . ^ /// v< ^ i>^ll t, .V.UH.^li ni >- * A /i*> ">*/--- j^- " ' ' \$5LioA4vj^ ^ >"< \ ' <' ^ / / / / ^ // > ^ / *' , * / / / > " * } ' * \ j)' ^ i)jV s" iL iiii Lftl . , . * " ^y_i. Wv is)j j iuT & >& J VjJj 'H ~f44& < ,/< * / " ' ' * i i>^" i_iw -..Ul'-iij a / **/ *' > " <> ^ >/ < tjt nil juj v y v^r 473. Verily, they were about to tempt you away from that which We have revealed to you, to fabricate something other than it against Us, and then they would certainly have taken you as an intimate friend! 474. And had We not made you stand firm, you would nearly have inclined to them a little.) 475. In that case We would have made you taste a double portion in this life and a double portion after death. And then you would have found none to help you against Us.)

How the Prophet would have been punished if He had

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3222–3269]

given in at all to the Disbelievers' Demands that He change some of the Revelation Allah tells us how He supported His Prophet and protected him and kept him safe from the evil plots of the wicked transgressors. Allah is the One Who took care of him and helped him, and would not leave him to any of His creation. He is the One Who is His Helper, Supporter and Protector, the One Who is to help him achieve victory and make His religion prevail over those who resist him and

oppose him and fight him in the east and in the west. May Allah send peace and blessings upon him until the Day of Judgement. ySi* 'i 'ijj ji oj^Vi Ot b\$ C&u Sfj OLj")SLi . And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land. But in that case, they would not have stayed (therein) after you, except for a little while. 477. A Sunnah with which We sent Our Messengers before you and you will not find any alteration in Our Sunnah.} The Reason why these Ayat were revealed This was revealed concerning the disbelievers among the Quraysh, when they wanted to expel the Messenger of Allah from among themselves. So Allah issued a warning to them in this Ayah, telling them that if they expelled him, they would not stay in Makkah for very long after that. And this is what happened after he migrated from them when their persecution became so intense. Only a year and a half

after that, Allah brought him and them together on the battlefield of Badr, without any pre-arranged appointment, and He caused him to prevail over them and defeat them, so he killed their leaders and took their families as captives. Hence Allah said: 40:3 SS^ZX} 4A Sunnah with ivhich We sent} meaning this is what We usually do to those who reject Our Messengers and persecute them by driving the Messenger out from among themselves - the punishment comes to them. If it were not for the fact that the Prophet jg was the Messenger of Mercy, vengeance would have come upon them such as had never been seen before in this world. So Allah says: 4& Cj} 4And Allah would not punish them while you are among them.} [8:33] XX ty. XX ijLil' jj\}

J * it. rn. ^J lili 'j t 3 Jd" 0 .. / > 47S. Perform the Salah from midday till the darkness of the] night, and recite the Qur'an in the early dawn. Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early daion is ever witnessed.} 479. And in some parts of the night (also) offer the Salah with , it as an additional prayerfor you. It may be that your Lord will] raise you to Maqam Mahmud.} The Command to offer the Prayers at their appointed Times Allah says, commanding His Messenger jfa to offer the prescribed prayers at the appointed times: JjUji Jf} 4Perform the Salatfrom midday.} Hushaym narrated from Mughlrah from Ash-Sha'bi from Ibn Abbas: Midday means when the sun is at its zenith. This was also reported by Nafi from Ibn Umar,12 and by Malik in his Tafsir from Az-Zuhri from Ibn TJmar. 131 This was the opinion of Abu Barzah Al-Aslami and Mujahid, and of Al- Hasan, Ad-Dahhak, Abu JaTar Al-Baqir and QatadahJ41 It is also understood to [generally] refer to the times of the five prayers. Allah said; S ifrom midday till the darkness of the night,} meaning darkness, or it was said, sunset. This was understood to mean Zuhr Asr, Maghrib and Isha . 4^ *.%) iand recite the Qur'an in the early dawn.} meaning Salat Al-Fajr. The details of the timings of the prayers m At-Tabari 17:514. At-Tabari 17:515. At-Tabari 17:515. 4| At-Tabari 17:515, 516.

60 Tafisir Ibn Kathir were reported in the MutQ.WQ.tir Sunnah from the words and deeds of the Prophet and this is what the people of Islam have followed until the present day, passing it down from generation to generation, century after century, as we have stated in the appropriate place, praise be to Allah. The Meeting ofthe Angels at the Times ofFajrand Asr Prayers S)> iVerily the recitation of the Qur'an in the early down is ever witnessed.} Ibn MasHid reported from Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with them both) that the Prophet said concerning this Ayah : 4^& k 4and recite the Qur'an in the early dawn. Verily, the recitation of the Qur'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.} tit is witnessed by the angels of the night and the angels of the dayA Al-Bukhari narrated from Abu Hurayrah that the Prophet #5 said: *The prayer offered in congregation is twenty-five degrees better than the prayer offered individually, and the angels of the night and the angels of the day meet at Salat Al-Fafr." Abu Hurayrah said: Recite, ifyou wish: ^ J3 35 ks 4and redte the Qur'an in the early dawn . Verily, the recitation of the Qar'an in the early dawn is ever witnessed.} Tabari 17:520. |2i FathAl-Bari8:251.

Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) Imam

62 Tafsir Ibn Kathir The Command to pray Tahajjud iAnd in some parts of the night (also) offer the Salah with it as an additional prayerfor you.} Here Allah commands him (the Prophet jg) to offer further prayers at night after the prescribed prayers. It was reported in Sahih Muslim from Abu Hurayrah that when the Messenger of Allah was asked which prayer is best after the prescribed prayers, he said, ajdli aThe Night prayerd ' * Allah commanded His Messenger to pray the Night prayer after

offering the prescribed prayers, and the term Tahajjud refers to prayer that is offered after sleeping. This was the view of Alqamah, Al-Aswad, Ibrahim An-Nakha'i and others. It is also well-known from the Arabic language itself. A number of Haddiths report that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ used to pray Tahajjud after he had slept. These include reports from Ibn Abbas, [3] A'ishah and other Companions, may Allah be pleased with them. This has been discussed in detail in the appropriate place, praise be to Allah. Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, This is what comes after 'isha, or it ^{**} could mean what comes after sleeping. ,[S] iati additional prayer (Nawafil)} means the Night prayer has been made an extra prayer specifically for the Prophet ﷺ, because all his previous and future sins had been forgiven. But for other members of his Ummah, offering optional prayers may expiate for whatever sins they may commit. This was the view of Mujahid, 61 and it was reported in Al-Musnad from Abu Muslim 2:821.Jabari 17:524. FathAl-Bari8:83. [41 FathAl-Bari 3:39. At-Jabari 17:524. At-Tabari 17:525.

Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) Umamah Al-Bahili.' Lit* alj i. 1! ilt may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud.} meaning, do that which you are commanded to do, and We will raise you to a station of praise and glory (Maqam Mahmud) on the Day of Resurrection, where all of creation will praise you, as will their Creator, may He be glorified and exalted. Ibn Jarir said, Most of the commentators said, This is the position to which Muhammad will be raised on the Day of Resurrection, to intercede for the people so that their Lord will relieve them of some of the hardships they are facing on that Day. ' It was reported that Hudhayfah said, Mankind will be gathered in one arena, where they will all hear the call and will all be seen. They will be standing barefoot and naked as they were created, and no person shall speak except by the leave of Allah. He will call out, O Muhammad, and he will respond, Nj ilL UJu Sj Jlu i drip JiLj iii& js b&j "orii JL.3 dritLp At your service, all goodness is in Your Hands and evil is not to be attributed to You. The one who is guided is the one whom You guide. Your servant is before You, from You, and to You and there is no salvation or refuge from You except with You. May You be blessed and exalted, Glory be to You, Lord of the House (the Ka'bah) ." This is the position of praise and honor {Maqam Mahmud} which was mentioned by Allah. Ibn Abbas said, The position of praise and honor is the position of intercession. '4 ' Ibn Abi Najih reported something 5:255.Tabari 17:526. ' At-Tabari 17:526.Tabari 17:527.

similar from Mujahid, and this was also the view of Al-Hasan Al-Basri. 1 Qatadah said, He is the first one for whom the earth will be opened on the Day of Resurrection, and he will be the first one to intercede. ,2! So the scholars consider this the position of praise and glory to which Allah referred in the Ayah: ilt may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud. I, Ibn Kathir, say: the Messenger of Allah ﷺ will have honors in the Day of Resurrection in which no one else will have a share, honors which will not be matched by anyone else. He is the first one for whom the earth will be opened and he will come forth riding to the gathering place. He will have a banner under which Adam and anyone else will gather, and he will have the Hawd (Lake) to which no one else will have more access than he. He will have the right of the Grand Intercession with Allah when He comes to judge between His creation. This will be after the people ask Adam, then Nuh, then Ibrahim, then Mfisa, then Isa to intercede, and each of them will say, I am not able for that. Then they will come to Muhammad ﷺ, and he will say, oLiJ u! gj uf" "/" can do that, I can do that . We will mention this in more detail shortly, If Allah wills. Part of that will be that he will intercede for some people who had been commanded to be taken to Hell, and they will be brought back. He is the first Prophet whose Ummah will be judged, and the first to take

them across the Bridge over the Fire, and the first to intercede in Paradise, as was reported in Sahih Muslim³^ In the Hadith about the Trumpet, it says that none of the believers will enter Paradise except through his intercession. He will be the first to enter Paradise, and his Ummah will be the first nation to enter. He will intercede for the status to be Jabari 17:527. Tabari 17:528. ,³i Muslim 1:182.

raised for people whose deeds could not get them there. He is the one who will reach Al-Wasilah, which is the highest position in Paradise, which befits no one but him. When Allah gives permission for intercession on behalf of sinners, the angels, Prophets and believers will intercede, and he will intercede for people whose number is known only to Allah. No one will intercede like him and no one will match him in intercession . 1,1 This has been explained in comprehensive detail at the end of the Book of Sirah, in the chapter on the specific qualities. Praise be to Allah. Now with the help of Allah we will mention the Hadiths that were reported concerning Al-Maqam Al-Mahmud.

66 Tafsir Ibn Kathir ^-DJi Jii ; -'UUo Jill uThat will be the Day when Allah resurrects him to a position of praise and glory, and all the people will praise him ' Abu Dawud At-Tayalisi recorded that Abdullah said, Then Allah will give permission for intercession, and Ar-Ruh Al- Quddus, Jibril, will stand up, then Ibrahim, the close Friend of Allah will stand up, then Isa or Musa will stand up - Abu Az-Zar said, I do not know which of them, - then your Prophet will stand up and will intercede, and no one after him will intercede as much as he does. This is the position of praise and glory to which Allah referred: U. vitj o' ilt may be that your Lord will raise you to Maqam Mahmud. y W The Hadith of Abu Hurayrah Imam

Silrah 17. Al-Isra' (78-79) (Part-15) 67 j l Jj V LxJj Ji U ^jt N I i ^ djjj 0 -311 Ji *-> \j 4 -Iu aIL* oJjw s_wa*j /JJ Alia aLj ^ ..A" ^ pJ Luip j3l " -3p 3i J[Ij lwl ^yJb ^yJC jS J* S^S J CJ^ ^Jai j^a aJL>-j \j I jjjjJa3 p-A^J jjj13 4 <*~A \jj\ : j^ii ? ji u j) vi i*j y* l u j'J vi i j Ji G ^lii <^jSJ" ' jj aJULa a_L*j _ r> j t ajjLa aJls iu pJ LjtP ^jli 1 v^jp jJ J {jr~*y> jjJ0> t j" ^j-aS^ i\$z* ij*\ cyr^ c"? 4, ~ Aa * jJ aj*VL--^j au! l3Ltlaj? 1 1 (Jy**j *i 1 j^" L ! 0jJjLj j*^L JI a~1p Jj33 ?U*Jj Ji La ^ ^ c a"3 y>*j La jj t ^iljj j^i LJ t^-01 ajj*j 3*-> /Jj 4 Alia aL\$ > .3 pJ L"J P ^j3l 3 -3P -3 ^j jl \y^y J! k* t"r_5-r i* 1 yf^ GLii cJG Ji i*ii- n PP J * ^ J * * * ^ P * * pt * " " liiLcJl CftKJ 4JJ I Jy~*J v^-i l U ! i)jlyLJ "P i)yi Lj y^L^Sr ^Jl j'J vi iir. JI d ^LLii 4J1j j; JI fjji c-ii. ji Jj ji :j-^ j^i jjii *?GJ: ji u j> vl .u JJ u i j*JJ t oJL*j ,S2*i ^ I Alla aJl j pj LJLP *i~p ' . 1 ;/ n 1 >"* . t. 1 >"* * " ^va u . ijjyjAJi lJLk->" _J jjj Li i Juk^va ^Jl lJmAI ^ ^jl lJmAI i^mmSj i (, ^ ^ ' ' j i + * r ' ' | ' ' , " ^ { * ^ ^ , I ^ | { k J>-Ij Laj JjLjS J^a ^JuJ La 1 Jur jiJ i t-U-J J ^JU-J ajjl Jj-jj Oj I ("jiti V Ljjj Ji La jj N 1 1 Aji ^J>"j La ^ ^ I Jjuj ^Jl 0 oJLaUJ ly orH^j J* P 3* y). ' p G. ^li <.Jjjji ^J-*iaJ wJL lJ jl *L"^^a U . JLLj i ^yL"J C#^ A^JL"L La 4-Lp t-0Jl J U I iu *j IJ c\$^* 'djiLi i ^aJLi ^a-11j t aIaaj *^ zji ^ ' !- >- V slli^ ^ juP* U :Jlv ivjj ^Gij J 15 ct.-l^iSII i j-Gl "-l^J* ^-"l_j-i j l i J- J; G5 -JJ ^jUu Jpr.J^Jl J- li jj ojJ xL j-A ^ijj-jzij -SU j-. US "/" will be the leader of mankind on (Ik Day of Resurrection . Do you know why it will be so? Allah will gather the first and the last in one place, and they will hear a voice calling out, and

they will all be seen. The sun will come close until their anguish and distress becomes unbearable, and some will say to others, "Do you not see how much you are suffering? Why do you not find someone to intercede for you with your Lord?" And some of the people will say to others, "How about Adam?" So they will go to Adam and say, "O Adam, you are the father of mankind, Allah created you with His Hand and breathed into you of His spirit, and commanded the angels to prostrate to you. Intercede for us with

your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Adam will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. He forbade me to approach the Tree and I disobeyed Him. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Niih." So they will go to Niih and say, "O Niih, you are the first of the Messengers sent to the people of earth, and Allah called you a grateful servant. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Niih will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. There is a prayer that I prayed against my people. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Ibrahim." So they will go to Ibrahim and say, "O Ibrahim, you are the Prophet of Allah and His close Friend among the people of earth. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Ibrahim will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again." And he mentioned some untruths he had told. "Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Musa." So they will go to Miisd and say, "O Musa, you are the Messenger of Allah, Allah chose you above others by selecting you to convey His Message and by speaking to you directly. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Musa will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again. I killed a soul whom I had not been

commanded to kill. Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Isa." So they will go to Isa and say, O Isa, you are the Messenger of Allah and His Word which He bestowed upon Maryam and a spirit created by Him. You spoke to the people as an infant in the cradle. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" Isa will say, "My Lord is angry today in a way that He has never been angry before and He will never be this angry again." And he will not mention any sin. "Myself, myself, myself [i.e., I am only concerned about myself]. Go to someone else. Go to Muhammad So they will go to Muhammad and will say, O Muhammad, you are the Messenger of Allah and the Last of the Prophets, Allah forgave all your past and future sins. Intercede for us with your Lord, do you not see the state we are in, how bad it is?" I will stand up and come before the Throne, and will fall prostrating to my Lord, may He be glorified and exalted. Then Allah will inspire me to speak and I will speak beautiful words of praise such as no one has ever been inspired with before. It will be said, "O Muhammad, raise your head and ask, it will be granted to you. Intercede, and your intercession will be heard." So I will raise my head and say, "My Ummah, O Lord, my Ummah, O Lord, my Ummah, O Lord." It will be said, "O Muhammad, admit those who will not be brought to account from among your Ummah through the right-hand gate of Paradise. Then the rest of your Ummah will share the other gates with the rest of the people."* Then he said, * By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Muhammad, the distance between two of the gateposts of Paradise is like the distance between Makkah and Hajar, or between Makkah and Bu\$ra. II] It was also reported in the Two Sahths.W foil ." vdiiJ if J T- 480. And say: "My Lord! Let my entry be good, and (likewise) 2:435. 121 Al-Bukhari 4712, Muslim 894.

my exit be good. And grant me from You a helping authority,"} 481. And say: "Truth has come and falsehood has vanished. Surely, falsehood is ever bound to vanish."} The Command to emigrate Imam

tC IjI o' li iAnd grant mefrom You a helping authority.} Al-Hasan Al-Basri explained this Ayah; His Lord promised to take away the kingdom and glory of Persia and give it to him, and the kingdom and glory of Byzantium and give it to him. ' Qatadah said, The Prophet of Allah jg knew that that he could not achieve this without authority or power, so he asked for authority to help him support the Book of Allah, the Laws of Allah, the obligations of Allah and to establish the religion of Allah. Authority is a mercy from Allah which He places among His servants, otherwise some of them would attack others, and the strong would consume the weak. Alongside the truth, he also needed power and authority in order to suppress those who opposed and resisted him, hence Allah said: uij Ciiji ilndeed Wi? have sent Our Messengers with clear proofs,} until His saying, u_/ij} iAnd We broughtforth iron (57:25) A Threat to the Disbelievers ofthe Quraysh iAtid say: "Truth has come andfalsehood has vanished..."} This is a threat and a warning to the disbelievers of the Quraysh, for there has come to them from Allah the truth of which there can be no doubt and which they have no power to resist. This is what Allah has sent to them of the Qur an, faith and beneficial knowledge. Their falsehood has perished or vanished and been destroyed, it cannot remain or stand firm in the face of the truth.Jabari 17:536. At-Jabari 17:536.

72 Tafstr Ibn Kathir J i"9tfc5 < > :> TV "?" %> .li&ILL^ "itall * < I.If" " fr^ ,-" > f" ^Aj-C-ivg-S M - ; ,t'4\$*k./ > .< |>|^" ".i " " " .:/ /ULL" 4iib t'_ . <- ' > ili3'&* < 0fc#ifcu ^rv /> ^ i^f ^ i/' LL, il | j>/c j^==^ oi JLP'Ji^ffcA ^^Lyl iln^iuSLiLiojJlj uj' L"_j f^l^=1)l'- "lciij tillA_^-*i tilj| l _ *> -jli\$jjL JI j~ < A &j y> v 4 &* '& iNay, We fling the truth against the false- hood, so it destroys it, and behold, it disappears.}

The Qur'an is a Cure and a Mercy Allah tells us that His Book, which He has revealed to His Messenger Muhammad sg, the Qur an to which falsehood cannot come, from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise, is a cure and a mercy for the believers, meaning that it takes away whatever is in their hearts of doubt, hypocrisy, Shirk, confusion and inclination towards falsehood. The Qur an cures all of that. It is also a mercy through which one attains faith and wisdom and seeks goodness. This is only for those who believe in it and accept it as truthful, it is a cure and a mercy only for such people. As for the disbeliever who is wronging himself by his disbelief, when he hears the Qur an, it only makes him further from the truth and increases him in his disbelief. The problem lies with the disbeliever himself, not with the Qur an, as Allah says: ^ tj v Ok > 3^ iSay: It is for those who believe, a guide and a cure. And as for those who disbelieve, there is heaviness in their ears, and it is blindness for them. They are those who are called from a place far away (so they neither listen nor understand). } (41 :44 ijLX 0\$ uS 0>[JjIj J- ^ ? . m (* +?-ri 1, i ilj, 4And whenever there comes down a Surah, some of them (hypocrites) say : "Which of you has had his faith increased by it?" As for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice. But as for those in whose hearts is a disease, it will add suspicion and doubt to their suspicion, disbeliefand doubt; and they die while they are disbelievers .} (9 :124-125) And there are many other similar Ayat. r, . > / ' V'f'X 4And We send down of the Qur'an that which is a cure and a mercy to the believers,}

Qatadah said, When the believer hears it, he benefits from it and memorizes it and understands it. iand it increases the wrongdoers in nothing but loss.} They do not benefit from it or memorize it or understand it, for Allah has made this Qur an a cure and a mercy for the believers. ^ >& ps .m 483. And when V\Ie bestow Our grace on man, he turns away and becomes arrogant. And when evil touches him,

he is in great despair.} 484. Say: Each one does according to Shakilatihī, and your Lord knows best of him whose path is right."} Turning away from Allah at Times of Ease and despairing at Times of Calamity Allah tells us about the weakness that is inherent in man, except for those whom He protects at both times of ease and calamity. If Allah blesses a man with wealth, good health, ease, provision and help, and he gets what he wants, he turns away from the obedience and worship of Allah, and becomes arrogant. Mujahid said, (It means) he goes away from Us. 111 I say, this is like the Ayah: p di cs* i &=>%&But when We have removed his harm from him, he passes on as if he had never invoked Us for a harm that touched him!} (10:12) and; 4But when He brings you safe to land, you turn away.} When man is stricken with evil, which means disasters, accidents and calamities. m At-Tabari 17:539.

Silrah 17. Al-Isrd' (83-84) (Part-15) 75 ihe is in great despair.}, meaning that he thinks he will never have anything good again. As Allah says, lu& p ii Mi ^ ? *' ' ' Af .1, >?, > t' 'y * J7'. ' ' ' A'*'C M\ / j; tsf' ~? ^ - >-* -O" *U*J 4;|^=.; t4i; 4And i/We give man a taste of mercy from Us, and remove it from him, verily, He is despairing, ungrateful. But if We let him taste good after evil has touched him, he is sure to say: Ills have departed from me." Surely, he is exultant, and boastful. Except those who show patience and do righteous good deeds: those, theirs will be forgiveness and a great reward.} (11:9-11) iSay: "Each one does according to Shakilatihī..."} Ibn Abbas said, According to his inclinations. Mujahid said, According to his inclinations and his nature. Qatadah said, According to his intentions. 13 * Ibn Zayd said, According to his religion. All these suggestions are close in meaning. This Ayah - and Allah knows best - is a threat and a warning to the idolaters, like the Ayah: Je ijlllt V Sii Jij} iAnd say to those who do not believe: "Act according to your ability and way"} (11:121) So Allah says: iSay: Each one does according to Shakilatihī, and your Lord knows best of him whose path is right. }Tabari 17:541.Tabari 17:541.Tabari 17:541.Tabari 17:541.

The Ruh (the spirit) is one of the things, the knowledge of which is only with my Lord. And of knowledge, you (mankind) have been given only a little.

iAttd they ask you concerning the Riih...} They said, You claim that we have only a little knowledge, but we have been given the Tawrah, which is the Hikmah, < 4,1& he, to whom Hikmah is granted, is indeed granted abundant good.} [2:269] Then the Ayah ' f * > Y-t .'" Us-. J >-bl J*w (3 to 4And i/ a// f/ie frees on the earth were pens and the sea (were ink wherewith to write), with seven seas behind it to add to its (supply),} [31:27] was revealed. He said, Whatever knowledge you have been given, if Allah saves you from the Fire thereby, then it is great and good, but in comparison to the knowledge of Allah, it is very little. 111 iAnd they ask you concerning the Riih.} Al- Awfi reported that Ibn Abbas said, This was when the Jews said to the Prophet j j, Tell us about the Ruh and how the Ruh will be punished that is in the body - for the Ruh is something about which only Allah knows, and there was no revelation concerning it. He did not answer them at all, then Jibril came to him and said: V] ' <>* } j l jJ' i j>} } Say : The Riih (the spirit) is one of the things, the knowledge of which is only with my Lord. And of knowledge, you (mankind) have been given only a little."} So the Prophet s told them about that, and they said, Who told you this? He said, <" 4* J* Ji-^T Ji lTabari 17:542.

fibril brought it to me from Allah j They said, By Allah, no one has told you that except our enemy [i.e., Jibril]. Then Allah revealed: a&&\$6% Jiis ffm \$ iSaij: "Whoever is an enemy to Jibril (let him die in his fitry), for indeed he has brought it (this Qur'an) down to your heart by Allah's permission,

confirming what came before it [2:97] The Ruh and the Nafs As-Suhayili mentioned the dispute among the scholars over whether the Ruh is the same as the Nafs, or something different. He stated that it is light and soft, like air, flowing through the body like water through the veins of a tree. He states that the Ruh which the angel breathes into the fetus is the Nafs, provided that it joins the body and acquires certain qualities because of it, whether good or bad. So then it is either a soul in (complete) rest and satisfaction (89:27) or inclined to evil (12:53), just as water is the life of the tree, then by mixing with it, it produces something else, so that if it mixes with grapes and the grapes are then squeezed, it becomes juice or wine. Then it is no longer called water, except in a metaphorical sense. Thus we should understand the connection between Nafs and Ruh; the Ruh is not called Nafs except when it joins the body and is affected by it. So in conclusion we may say: the Ruh is the origin and essence, and the Nafs consists of the Ruh and its connection to the body. So they are the same in one sense but not in another. This is a good explanation, and Allah knows best. 121 I say: people speak about the essence of the Ruh and its rulings, and many books have been written on this topic. One of the best of those who spoke of this was Al-Hafiz Ibn Mandah in a book which we have heard about the Ruh. ***y ^ Jd i isil oCijj GLi At-Tabari 17:543. There are many narrations about this. The narration from Ikrimah is Mursal. ,2) Ar-Rawd Al-Anf ,2 :62.

* & < "v i v, * * x#- * * - ^ /O" . / / // - x> ' i , Jijj lj5U J 3* J" *y, * " =" o(/ / X /" /y ,/// /:' / f - - . ! >!/ . / , / . " x>!/ x - > "> ^ X -1 * jUj ,aa, ^p ia - _pj V 'J) u;dl> jSI\$^^ jxg0K 486. And i/ I've willed, We could surely take away that which We have revealed to you . Then you would find no protector for you against Us in that respect.} 487. Except as a mercy from your Lord. Verily, His grace unto you is ever great.} 488. Say: "If mankind and the Jinn were together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could not produce the like thereof, even if they helped one another."} 489. And indeed We have fully explained to mankind, in this Qur'an, every kind of similitude, but most of mankind refuse (the truth and accept nothing) but disbelief.} If Allah willed. He could take away the Qur'an Allah mentions the blessing and great bounty that He has bestowed upon His servant and Messenger Muhammad by revealing to Him the Noble Qur'an to which falsehood cannot come, from before it or behind it, (it is) sent down by the All-Wise, Worthy of all praise. Ibn Mas'ud said, A red wind will come to the people, meaning at the end of time, from the direction of Syria, and there will be nothing left in a man's Mushaf (copy of the Qur'an) or in his heart, not even one Ayah." Then Ibn Mas'ud recited: 4Jdi04 u44)} 4And if We willed, We could surely take away that which We have revealed to i/oh.^ Challenging by the Qur'an Then Allah points out the great virtue of the Qur'an, and says that even if mankind and the Jinn were all to come together and agree to produce something like that which was revealed to His Messenger they would never be able to do m At-Jabari 17:546.

it, even if they were to cooperate and support and help one another. This is something which is impossible. How could the words of created beings be like the Words of the Creator Who has no equal and peer, for there is none like unto Him? 4And indeed We have fully explained to mankind, meaning, We have furnished them with evidence and definitive proof, and We have shown them the truth and explained it in detail, yet despite that most of mankind insist on disbelief, i.e., denying and rejecting the truth. o j*tA> cjj jj.45 jjjJti J_/u ' - / !"> ^ , jCy"j24^ J 1^ ".f' < -i 7* ' ' ^ x"v-y v. . * / u w t ji &-C & C^i CT 't3> lii jS j|i" ^ P2 i L j V? 'j & *, <- Jj 4 d> ^ " 2ii >* j v j? f^ -zDij 4U . And they say: We shall not believe in you, until you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us;" } 491 . Or you have a garden

of date palms and grapes, and cause rivers to gush forth in their midst abundantly;" } 492. "Or you cause the heaven to fall upon us in pieces, as you have pretended, or you bring Allah and the angels before

(us) face to face; } 493 . "Or you have a house of Zukhruf/ or you ascend up into the sky, and even then we will put no faith in your ascension until you bring down for us a Book that we would read. Say : Glorified be my Lord! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?" } The Demand of Quraysh for a specific Sign, and the Rejection of that Ibn Jarir recorded from Muhammad bin Ishaq, An old man from among the people of Egypt who came to us forty-odd years ago told me, from Ikrimah, from Ibn Abbas, that Utbah and Shaybah - the two sons of Rabl ah, Abu Sufyan bin Harb, a man from Bani Abd Ad-Dar, Abu Al-Bakhtari - the brother of Bani Asad, Al-Aswad bin Al-Muttalib bin Asad, Zam'ah bin Al-Aswad, Al-Walld bin Al-Mughirah, Abu Jahl bin Hisham, Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah, Umayyah bin Khalaf, A1- As bin Wa il, and Nabih and Munabbih - the two sons of Al-Hajjaj As- Sahmin, gathered all of them or some of them behind the Ka'bah after sunset. Some of them said to others, Send for Muhammad and talk with him and argue with him, so that nobody will think we are to blame. So they sent for him saying, The nobles of your people have gathered for you to speak to them. So the Messenger of Allah came quickly, thinking that maybe they were going to change their minds, for he was very keen that they should be guided, and it upset him to see their stubbornness. So he came and sat with them, and they said, O Muhammad, we have sent for you so that nobody will think we are to blame. By Allah we do not know any man among the Arabs who has brought to his people what you have brought to your people. You have slandered our forefathers, criticized our religion, insulted our reason, slandered our gods and caused division. There is no objectionable thing that you have not brought between us. If you are preaching these things because you want wealth, we will collect some of our wealth together for you and make you Meaning gold. See the Tafsir of Surat Az-Zukhruf [43:35], it is briefly mentioned and shortly as well

U" f * * > > * S t , t f i Aj La Jji > i Uj jJJ 1 JuP Lwl iC.U; t jill j*Sj j~u> jilp s_jSjJ jlj iS^sj-Vlj Gill ^ ajLjj jU , p-SCJl p^tlJ ,jrt Alt a-***" "/ was not sent for this purpose. I have brought to you from Allah that which He has sent me, and I have conveyed to you the Message which I was sent to you . If you accept what I have brought to you, then this is your good fortune in this world and the Hereafter, but if you reject it, I shall wait patiently for the command of Allah until Allah judges between me and you . They said, If you will not do this for us, then at least do something for yourself. Ask your Lord to send an angel to confirm that what you are saying is the truth and to speak up on your behalf. Ask Him to give you gardens and treasures and palaces of gold and silver, and to make you independent so that you will not have to do what we see you doing, for you stand in the marketplaces seeking provision just as we do. Then we will know the virtue of your position with your Lord and whether you are a Messenger as you claim. The Messenger of Allah said to them: If I will not do that, and I will not ask my Lord for this. I was not sent to you for this reason. But Allah has sent me to you to bring you good news and a warning. If you accept what I have brought to you, then this is your good fortune in this world and the Hereafter, but if you reject it, I shall wait patiently for the command of Allah until Allah judges between me and you . They said, Then cause the sky to fall upon us, as you claim that if your Lord wills, He can do that. We will not believe in you until you do this. The Messenger of Allah said to them: That is for Allah to decide. If He wills. He will do that to you

They said, O Muhammad, did your Lord not know that we would sit with you and ask you what we have asked and make the requests that we have made? He should have told you beforehand and taught you how to reply to us, and informed you what He would do to us if we do not accept what you have brought to us. We have heard that the one who is teaching you this, is a man in Al-Yamamah called Ar-Rahman. By Allah, we will never believe in Ar-Rahman. We are warning you, O Muhammad, that we will not let you do what you want to do until you or we are destroyed. One of them said, *We worship the angels who are the daughters of Allah. Another said, *We will never believe in you until you bring Allah and the angels before (us) face to face. When they said this, the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} got up and left them. Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah bin Al-Mughlah bin Abdullah bin Umar bin Makhzum, the son of his paternal aunt Atikah, the daughter of Abdul-Muttalib, also got up and followed him. He said to him, O Muhammad, your people have offered you what they have offered you, and you did not accept it. Then they asked for things for themselves so that they would know your position with Allah, and you did not do that for them. Then they asked you to hasten on the punishments with which you are scaring them. By Allah, I will never believe in you unless you take a ladder to heaven and ascend it while I am watching, then you bring with you an open book and four angels to testify that you are as you say. By Allah, even if you did that, I think that I would not believe you. Then he turned away from the Messenger of Allah ^{sg}, and the Messenger of Allah ^{sg} went home to his family, grieving over having missed out on what he had hoped for when his people had called him, because he saw that they were resisting him even more. 111 The Reason why the Idolaters Demands were refused In the case of this gathering where the Quraysh came together to speak with the Messenger of Allah ^{sg}, if Allah knew that they were making these requests in order to be guided, they would have been granted, but He knew that they were making these demands out of disbelief and stubbornness. It Tabari 17 :557. This story is not authentic.

Al-Isrd' (90-93) (Part-15 was said to the Messenger of Allah ^{sg}, If you wish, We will give them what they are asking, but if they then disbelieve, I will punish them with a punishment that I have never imposed upon anyone else in the universe; or if you wish, I will open for them the gate of repentance and mercy. He said: uRather, You open for them the gate of repentance and mercy, n 1 This is like the Ayah ipi JiQf UCJ "; J V) o' U" -" iAnd nothing stops Us from sending the Ayat but that the people of old denied them. And We sent the she-camel to Thamiid as a clear sign, but they did her wrong. And We sent not the signs except to warn, and to make them afraid (of destruction) (17:59) And Allah says: { --.r > JUZ 4 jjj % SfiMfw ;Xi)i jc JidjpL jU; IX op jl 5^,4 yii jS@# ip jiVi Xb ip .-,i they say: Why does this Messenger eat food, and walk about in the markets (as we). Why is not an angel sent down to him to be a wamer with him? Or (why) has not a treasure been granted to him, or why has he not a garden whereof he may eat?" And the wrongdoers say: "You follow none but a man bewitched." See how they coin similitudes for you, so they have gone astray, and they cannot find a path. Blessed be He Who, if He wills, will assign you better than that - Gardens under Ahmad 1 :242

86 TafsTr Ibn Kathir which rivers flow and will assign you palaces. Nay, they deny the Hour, and for those who deny the Hour, We have prepared a flaming Fire.} (25:7-11) Allah ^s saying, 4&J+. u &-} iuntil you cause a spring to gush forth from the earth for us} refers to a spring of flowing water. They asked him to bring forth springs of fresh water in the land of Al-Hijaz, here and there. This is easy for Allah, may He be glorified and exalted; if He willed, He could do that. He could have responded to all

their demands, but He knew that they would not be guided by that, as He says: 4Truly, those, against whom the Word (wrath) of your Lord has been justified, will not believe. Even if every sign should come to them, until they see the painful torment.} (10:96-97) And Allah says: < & ^ u\$0 %} 4And even if We had sent down unto them angels, and the dead had spoken unto them, and I've had gathered together all things before their very eyes, they would not have believed} [6 :111 His saying; 4 IT iii j} 40r you cause the heaven to fall upon us in pieces, as you have pretended,} means, *you promised us that on the Day of Resurrection the heavens will be split asunder, being broken and tom up, with parts of it falling down, so do that in this world and make it fall in pieces. This is like when they said: 4f^S\ Sj fceS* J-di 1 u lii 0)X^} 40 Allah! If this (the Qur'an) is indeed the truth from You,

then rain down stones on us from the sky.} [8:32] Similarly, the people of Shu'ayb asked him: 4 jl lli liJi^ iSo cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!} (26:187) So Allah punished them with the punishment of the day of Shadow (a gloomy cloud), which was the torment of a Great Day. [26:189] As for the Prophet of Repentance and Mercy, who was sent as a mercy to the worlds, he asked Allah to delay their punishment, in the hope that Allah would bring forth from their offspring people who would worship Allah Alone, with no partner or associate. This is what indeed did happen, for among those who are mentioned above were some who later embraced Islam and became good and sincere Muslims, even Abdullah bin Abi Umayyah, who followed the Prophet jir (out of that meeting) and spoke to him as he did. He became a sincere Muslim and turned to Allah in repentance. iOr you have a house of Zukhruf.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said, This is gold. 1 11 This was also what was said in the recitation of Ibn Mas'ud, Or you have a house of gold. ' ior you ascend up into the sky,} meaning, you climb up on a ladder while we are watching you. &C ila" j< > Jij} iand even then we will put no faith in your ascension until you bring down for us a Book that we would read.} Mujahid said, This means a book in which there would be one page for each person, on which would be the words: This is a book from Allah to so-and-so the son of so-and-so, which At-Tabari 17:553. A^Tabari 17:553.

he would find by his head when he woke up in the morning. 1' 4Say: "Glorified be my Lord! Am I anything but a man, sent as a Messenger?") meaning, Glorified, exalted and sanctified be He above the notion that anyone would come before Him concerning any matter pertaining to His authority and sovereignty. He is the One Who does what He wills. If He willed, he could have given you what you asked for, or if He willed, he could have refrained. I am only a Messenger to you, sent to convey the Messages of my Lord and advise you. 1 have done that, and the response to what you have asked is to be decided by Allah, may He be glorified. ji Ji ii' cLjui i*' ij u -4 494. And nothing prevented men from believing when the guidance came to them, except that they said: "Has Allah sent a man as (His) Messenger?") 495. Say: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security, We should certainly have sent down for them from the heaven an angel as a Messenger.") The refusal of the Idoiators to believe because the Messenger^ was aHuman - and its refutation iS-ti C3) 4And nothing prevented men) means, most of them, lit& 4from believing) and following the Messengers, except the fact that they found it strange that human beings would be sent as Messengers, as Allah says:Tabari 17:554.

90 Tafslr Tbn Kathir iVerily, there has come unto you a Messenger from among yourselves [10:128] 4# g#& :*;& } i -J is U45 iSimilarly, We have sent among you a Messenger of your own, reciting to you

Our verses (the Qur'an) and purifying you, and teaching you the Book and the Hikmah, and teaching you that which you used not to know. Therefore remember Me. I will remember you, and be grateful to Me and never be ungrateful to Me.} (2:151-152) Allah says here: Ztjji} iSay: "If there were on the earth, angels walking about in peace and security,} meaning, just as you do, yfj., \$A} }We should certainly have sent down for them from the heaven an angel as a Messenger}. meaning, one of their own kind. But as you are human, We have sent to you Messengers from yourselves, as a kindness and a mercy. \ ' ' > * " k, v ~ ^ uo /i] a (S?. a_. 496. Say: "Sufficient is Allah for a witness between me and you. Verily, He is Ever the All-Knower, the All-Seer of His servants."} Allah tells His Prophet how to prove that what he has brought is true, saying to him to tell them: He (Allah) is a witness over me and over you. He knows what I have brought to you. If I were lying to you, He would take revenge on me in the severest manner, as Allah says: (UImI r K**. .. W* Jjii fAnd if he had forged a false saying concerning Us, We surely would have seized him by his right hand. And then We certainly would have cut off his life artery.} (69:44-46)

Al-lsr'd' (97) (Part-15 Allah said; i> if& 4 Verily, He is Ever the All-Knower, the All-Seer of His servants meaning, He knows best who among them deserves blessings, good treatment and guidance, and who deserves to be doomed and led astray. He says: 497. And he whom Allah guides, he is led aright; and whomever He leaves astray can never find helpers other than Him, and We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces, blind, dumb and deaf; their abode will be Hell; whenever it abates, We shall increase for them the fierceness of the Fire> Guidance and Misguidance are in the Hands of Allah Allah tells us how He deals with His creation and how His rulings are carried out. He tells us that there is none who can put back His judgement, for whomever He guides cannot be led astray, and whomever He leaves astray can never find helpers other than Him^to guide him. As Allah says: j iHe whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no Wall (guiding friend) to lead him (18:17) The Punishment of the People of Misguidance 4and We shall gather them together on the Day of Resurrection on their faces,

J assswss TST X- 4-JIJ4" 4ll>, > />>' > . >> > ">,< ^.3U;j^jji5^V5vS3fS2-jJi O^iSAjL! *u 1 p^ jIJ / L ! / ^ * > * > " / / , * * ^ i * ' ' ' / / (JlAd jJ^ * ^ ^ r , JyUx^ -AcjjJJ# ' ^ ' < ' f-i JI'V H) p-v> 'jyj*f 4!fi C'j - 4So taste you (the results of your evil actions). No increase shall We give you, except in torment.} (78:30) 1^ (Hp\ ['>- j^ r w & sj^ cj && si S' \$ \$ isVfJ 9' 5 *\$ J*"j j-t^-i <->' 2Jf Ji'-> r<> /# ' < //1 _ " t"U *j v-j 'll 1U 4:.v>:<\$' \$> oA^' 498. That is their recompense, because they denied Our Ayat and said: When we are bones and fragments, shall we really be raised up as a new creation?"} 499. See they not that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, is able to create the like of them. And He has decreed for them an appointed term, whereof there is no doubt. But the wrongdoers refuse but disbelief.} Allah says: This punishment, being resurrected blind, dumb and deaf, is what they deserve, because they disbelieved, i&&} iOur Ayat}, i.e., Our proof and evidence, and did not think that the resurrection could ever happen. 4u& l^e&U iand said: "When we are bones and fragments..."}

meaning, when we have disintegrated and our bodies have rotted away, l)} is tall we really be raised up as a new creation?} meaning, after we have disintegrated and disappeared and been absorbed into the earth, will we come back a second time? Allah established proof against them and told them that He is able to do that, for He created the heavens and the earth, so raising them up again is easier for Him than

that, as He says: *io&# be &3} iThe creation of the heavens and the earth is indeed greater than the creation of mankind;* [40:57] *fff-. J 'if i/i ff 4^ J iDo they not see that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, and is not wearied by their creation, is able to give life to the dead?* [46:33] *J4? dr. -/ 4-hi fk o' if off f iHb iff 4' of'Pf \$ % j>: cJ liLI4 Tit ,&\ t5i 4/s not He Who created the heavens and the earth, able to create the like of than? Yes, indeed! He is the All-Knowing Supreme Creator. Verily, His command, when He intends a thing, is only that He says to it, Be!" and it is!* (36:81-82) And Allah says here: *jU; j if& & 4' & aK ?f} 4See they not that Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth, is able to create the like of them.* meaning, on the Day of Resurrection, He will recreate and restore their bodies, as He created them in the first place. *4Is* C iAnd He has decreed for them an appointed term, whereof there*

is no doubt. means, He has set a time for them to be re-created and brought forth from their graves, an appointed time which must surely come to pass. As Allah says: *IS# iAnd We delay it only for a term (already) fixed.* (1 1:104) *iBut the ivrotigdoers refuse} - after the proof has been established against them, i<&& 4(and accept nothing) but disbelief.* means, they persist in their falsehood and misguidance. *i -.ip &(^ ZZ ill qj \$ _) Jif 4100. Say: "If you possessed the treasure of the mercy of my Lord, then you would surely hold back for fear of spending, and man is ever miserly!"}* Holding back is Part of Man's Nature Allah says to His Messenger *sg: Tell them, O Muhammad, even if you had authority over the treasures of Allah, you would refrain from spending for fear of exhausting it. Ibn Abbas and Qatadah said, This means for fear of poverty, lest it run out, despite the fact that it can never be exhausted or come to an end. This is because it is part of your nature. So Allah says: Af 4and man is ever miserly.* Ibn Abbas and Qatadah said: (This means) stingy and holding back. 121 Allah says: *iAte Syj. VA \$} 40r have they a share in the dominion? Then in that case they would not give mankind even a Naqira (4:53), At-Jabari 17:563. At-Jabari 17:563.*

Al-Isrd' (101-104) (Part-15) destruction!"} 4103. So he resolved to turn them out of the land. But We drowned him and all who were with him.} 4104. And We said to the Children of Israel after him: "Dwell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as mixed crowd."} The Nine Signs of Musa Allah tells us that He sent Musa with nine clear signs, which provided definitive proof that his prophethood was real and that what he was conveying from the One Who had sent him to Fira wn was true. These clear signs were: his staff, his hand, the years of famine, the sea, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs and the blood. This was the view of Ibn Abbas.111 Muhammad bin Ka b said, They were his hand and his staff, the five signs mentioned in Al-A raf and destruction of wealth121 and the rock. 131 Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ash-Shabi and Qatadah said: They are his hand, his staff, the years of famine, the failure of the crops, the flood, the locusts, the lice, the frogs and the blood. 141 iYet they remained arrogant, and they were of those people ivho were criminals,} [7:133] meaning, despite all these signs and their witnessing of them, they disbelieved them and belied them wrongfully and arrogantly, although they were themselves were convinced of them, so they did not have any effect on them. By the same token, (Allah tells His Messenger here,) if We were to respond to what these people are asking you for, who have said that they wilt not believe in you until you cause springs to gush forth throughout the land for them, they would not respond or believe except if Allah willed. As Fira*wn said to At-Tabari 17:564. See the Tafsir of Surah Yunus 10:88. Tabari 17:565. At-Tabari 17:565, 566.

Musa, even though he had witnessed the signs which he brought, 4"O Musa! I think you are indeed bewitched."} It was said that this meant he thought he was a sorcerer, but Allah knows best. These nine signs which were mentioned by the Imams (scholars) quoted above are what is referred to here, and in the Ayah : V criri v4" flji* jj o*. \1C_, CJi JUat 4" And throw down your stick!" But when he saw it moving as if it were a snake, he turned in flight, and did not look back. (It was said:) "O Musa ! Fear not."4 until His saying, 4" prl -**j iamong the nine signs (you ivill take) to Fir'awn and his people. Verily, they are a people who are rebellious.} [27:10-12] These Ayat include mention of the stick and the hand, and the rest of the nine signs are mentioned in detail in Surat Al- A'raf. Musa was also given many other signs, such as striking the rock with his staff and water flowing from it, their being shaded with clouds, manna and quails, and other signs which were bestowed upon the Children of Israel after they had left the land of Egypt. But here Allah mentions the nine signs which were witnessed by his people in Egypt. These became evidence against them, because they stubbornly rejected them out of disbelief. So Musa said to Fira*wn: 4"Verily, you know that these signs have been sent down by none but the Lord of the heavens and the earth. meaning, as proof and evidence of the truth of what I have brought to you. 4And I think you are indeed, O Fir'awn, doomed to destruction!} i.e., bound to be destroyed. This was the view of Mujahid and

Stirah 17. Al-Isra' (101-104) (Part-15) 99 Qatadah. Ibn Abbas said: It means cursed. 121 Ibn Abbas and Ad-Dahhak said: 4doomed to destruction .} means defeated. 131 As Mujahid said, doomed includes all of these meanings. The Destruction of Fir'awn and His People he resolved to turn them out of the land.} means, he wanted to expel them and drive them out. Ai' iSA Si It U-*r /u iBut We drowned him and all who were with him. And We said to the Children of Israel after him: "Dwell in the land... } This is good news for Muhammad sg, a foretelling of the conquest of Makkah, even though this Surah was revealed in Makkah before the Hijrah. Similarly, the people of Makkah wanted to expel the Prophet jg from the city, as Allah says in two Ayat : 4 JjyrS-i u-t \)S==3 c\j} } And verily, they were about to frighten you so much as to drive you out from the land...} [17:76-77] Hence Allah caused His Messenger sg to inherit Makkah, so he entered it by force, according to the better-known of the two opinions, and he defeated its people then out of kindness and generosity, he let them go, just as Allah caused the Children of Israel, who had been oppressed, to inherit the land, east and west, and to inherit the land of Fir'awn s people, with its farmland, crops and treasures. As Allah said, it thus We caused the Children of Israel to inherit them.} (26:59). Here Allah says: At-Jabari 17:571. Jabari 17:570. At-Jabari 17:570.

100 Tafsir Ibn Kathir J *U- bji 4 Li- ft 4And We said to the Children of Israel after him : "Dwell in the land, then, when the final and the last promise comes near, We shall bring you altogether as mixed crowd."} meaning, all of you, you and your ene mies. Ibn Abbas, Qatadah and Ad-Dahhak said, It means all together. 111 k> J} 3JAj } // >/ /*> 4105. And ivith truth We have sent it down, and with truth it has descended. And We have sent you as nothing but a bearer of glad tidings, and a wamer.} 4106. And a Qur'an which We have divided (into parts), in order that you might recite it to men at intervals. And We have revealed it by stages.} / ; //-v />< , / ^ // 4#"*" ("*" / ^ >/ OyJ Vj ' Js s *y y \K" ft > . I-X" wOldj jjJTy Juili'jsJ^SLiiii^ \ ipLa \$'^aJi The Revelation of the Qur'an in Stages Allah tells us that His Book, the Glorious Qur'an, has been sent with truth, i.e., it contains the truth, as Allah says: m At-Jabari 17:572, 573.

iBut Allah bears witness to that which He has sent down unto you ; He has sent it down with His knowledge, and the angels bear witness} [4:166] meaning, it contains the knowledge which Allah wanted to teach to you, with His rulings, commands and prohibitions. iand with truth it has descended.} means, It has been sent down to you, O Muhammad, preserved and protected, not contaminated or mixed with anything else, with nothing added or taken away. It has come to you with the truth, brought down by one mighty in power, trustworthy and strong, one who is obeyed by the higher group (angels). iJiLLj Zj} 4And We have sent you} O Muhammad iUSa& ias nothing but a bearer of glad tidings and a wamer}. a bearer of glad tidings for the believers who obey you and a wamer to the disbelievers who disobey you. iAnd (it is) a Qur'an which We have divided}, The word translated here as We have divided may be read in two ways. If it is read as Faraqnahu , with no Shaddah, the meaning is: We have made it depart from Al-Lawh Al- Mahfuz to Bayt Al-'Izzah in the lowest heaven, then it was revealed in stages to the Messenger of Allah, according to events, over a period of twenty-three years. This was narrated by Ikrimah from Ibn Abbas. 111 It was also narrated that Ibn Abbas read it as Farraqnahu", with a Shaddah, meaning, We revealed it Ayah by Ayah , and have explained it and made it clear.^ Hence Allah says: & fax} Tabari 17:574. At-Jabari 17:573, 574.

102 Tafstr Ibn Kathir \$in order that you might recite it to men}, meaning, convey it to the people and recite it to them, &} 4at intervals meaning slowly. 4And We have revealed it by stages. means, little by little. '- pri* '>! I*}5 Oi (*V' of jj V _}1 34, i^Ji ji^> ^iOy ^ i>[kj; Cyjjiy SvyJ'jjj / >> 4107. Say: "Believe in it or do not believe (in it). Verily, those who were given knowledge before it, when it is recited to them, fall down on their chins (faces) in humble prostration ."} 4108. And they say: "Glory be to our Lord! Tndy, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled."} 4109. And they fall down on their chins (faces) weeping and it increases their humility.} Those Who were given Knowledge before truly admit the Qur'an Allah says to His Prophet Muhammad j&: 4\$ay} O Muhammad to these disbelievers concerning what you have brought to them of this Glorious Qur'an: 4*j~ty J* ja, "Believe in it (the Qur'an) or do not believe (in it).} meaning, it is all the same whether you believe in it or not, for it is true in and of itself. It was revealed by Allah, Who mentioned it previously in the Books that He revealed to other Messengers. Hence He says: 4z& py* of 4Verily, those xwho were given knowledge before it,} meaning righteous people among the People of the Book, who

Al-Isrd' (107-109) (Part-15) adhered to their Books and appreciated them without distorting them. iwhen it is recited to them> means, when this Qur'an is recited to them, 0k ifall down on their chins (faces) in humble prostration> means, to Allah, in gratitude for the blessing He has bestowed on them by considering them fit to live until they met this Messenger to whom this Book was revealed. Hence they say: 4Z; iClory be to our Lordly, meaning, they extol and glorify their Lord for His perfect power and for not delaying the fulfillment of the promise which He made through His earlier Prophets, that He would send Muhammad Hence they said: tfJZi iClory be to our Lord! Truly, the promise of our Lord must be fulfilled.} 400.0k \$And they fall down on their chins (faces) weeping} means, in submission to Allah, may He be glorified, and in expression of their belief and faith in His Book and His Messenger 4 0-0 iand it increases their humility.} means, it increases them in faith and submission. As Allah says: iWhile as for those who accept guidance, He increases their guidance and bestows on them their Taqzoa.} (47 :17). 4f iAnd theV fall down} is a description rather than an action (i.e., this is a further description of their humility as referred to in

Ayah 107; it does not imply that they prostrate twice).

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3269–3273]

Vj 'tj ^litl Cl.Vi' \ft-S. li 111 Iy.'J J\ ^,1 (y.lf 4 a& i 4# ilii jlJ Jjj/i ; jju. jlil Sj^ jf ; -5j. Srti/: "Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), by whatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names. And offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud nor in a low voice, but follow a way between .> 4227. And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Wlw has not begotten a son, and Who has no partner in (His) dominion, nor is He low to have a supporter. And magnify Hun with all magnificence. } To Allah belong the Most BeautifulNames Allah says: iSay} O Muhammad, to these idolators who deny that Allah possesses the attribute of mercy and refuse to call Him Ar- Rahman, 4^> \yC.j'. U ill 'sfyf' [j al jl a! I y.jt} i"Invoke Allah or invoke Ar-Rahman (the Most Gracious), by ivhatever name you invoke Him (it is the same), for to Him belong the Best Names.} meaning, there is no difference between calling on Him as Allah or calling on Him as Ar-Rahman, because He has the Most Beautiful Names, as He says: i ^ % v 4\ iit f>} 4He is Allah, beside Whom none has the right to be worshipped but He the All-Knower of the unseen and the seen . He is the Most Gracious, the Most Merciful.} (59:22) Until His saying; ijfjij o\$3 4O' 4 1C.VI 'A}

4To Him belong the Best Names. All that is in the heavens and the earth glorify Him.} [59:24] Makhul reported that one of the idolators heard the Prophet jg saying when he was prostrating: O Most Gracious, O Most Merciful. The idolator said, he claims to pray to One, but he is praying to two! Then Allah revealed this Ayah. This was also narrated from Ibn 'Abbas, and by Ibn Jarir. TheCommand to recite neither loudly nor softly JfU %} iAnd offer your Salah neither aloud} Imam Ahmad reported that Ibn Abbas said: This Ayah was revealed when the Messenger of Allah ^ was preaching underground in Makkah. \$And offer your Salah neither aloud nor in a low voice,} Ibn Abbas said: When he prayed with his Companions, he would recite Qur an loudly, and when the idolators heard that, they insulted the Qur an, and the One Who had revealed it and the onewho had brought it. So Allah said to His Prophet sfe: %} iAnd offer your Salah (prayer) neither aloud} means, do not recite it aloud, lest the idolators hearyou and insult the Qur an, i, i-ij inor in a low voice,} means, nor recite it so quietly that your companions cannot hear the Qur an and learn it from you. iO'i Cft ~}}j} ibutfollow a way between.} ^ This was also reported in the Two SahihsP* Ad-Dahhak also narrated something similar from Ibn Abbas, and added: [1) At-Tabari 17:580. * Ahmad 1 :23. * Fath Al-Bari 8 :257 , Muslim 1 : 329

When he migrated to Al-Madlnah, this no longer applied, and he recited as he wished. Muhammad bin Ishaq said that Ibn Abbas said, When the Messenger of Allah jgj recited Qur an quietly while he was praying, the (idolaters) would disperse and refuse to listen to him; if one of them wanted to hear some of what he was reciting in his prayer, he would tiy to listen without anyone seeing him, because he was afraid of them. If he realized that anybody knew he was listening, he would go away lest they harm him, so he would stop listening. If the Prophet jg lowered his voice, those who wanted to listen to his recitation could not hear anything, so Allah revealed, 4And offer your Salah neither aloud^ meaning, do not recite aloud, lest those who want to listen disperse for fear of attracting unwelcome attention, 4C? oik inor in a low voice,} but do not make your voice so soft that the one who is trying to listen without being seen cannot hear anything at all. Perhaps he will pay attention to some of what he hears and

benefit from it. ix f Jib 1C 4but follow a way between.} ^ This was the view of Ikrimah, Al-Hasan Al-Basri and Qatadah that this Ayah was revealed concerning recitation in prayer.¹³ * It was narrated from Ibn Mas'ud: Do not make it so soft that no one can hear it except yourself. Declaration of Tawhid jtji 2 4And say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has *' At-Tabari 17:584. * At-Tabari 17:585. At-Tabari 17:587. At-Tabari 17:589.

not begotten a son... } because Allah has stated that the Most Beautiful Names belong to Him, and has declared Himself to be above having any faults or defects. / > } / ji A/ // '/ !> * ^ A', 4 v J illi/i W jjj 'Jj jiO; 2 liJ' xJ-' Jsif sfli/ : All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has not begotten a son, and W7io has no partner in (His) dominion..." } indeed, He is Allah, (the) One, the Self-Sufficient Master, Who begets not, nor was He begotten, and there is none co-equal or comparable unto Him. I;% i& inor He is low to have a supporter.} means, He is not so humble or weak that He needs to have a helper or supporter or adviser, rather He Alone, with no partner or associate, may He be exalted, is the Creator of all things and is the One Who is running and controlling them by His will, with no partner or associate. *% i&& inor He is low to have a supporter).} Mujahid said: He does not form an alliance with anyone, nor does He seek the support or help of anyone.' iAnd magnify Him with all magnificence.} means, glorify and extol Him far above whatever the transgressors and aggressors say. Ibn Jarir recorded that Al-Qurazi used to say about this Ayah, y 4jj, juA-i iAnd say : "All the praises and thanks be to Allair, Wlro has not begotten a son . .." } that the Jews and Christians said that Allah has taken a son; m At-Tabari 17:590.

108 Tafsir Ibtt Kathir the Arabs said, At Your service, You have no partner except the partner You have, and You possess him and whatever he owns; and the Sabians and Magians said, If it were not for the supporters of Allah, He would be weak. Then Allah revealed this Ayah : & "% i J? ij a 4/ %& i;\$ i4\ & sai& iAnd. say: "All the praises and thanks be to Allah, Who has not begotten a son, and Who has no partner in (His) dominion, nor is He low to have a supporter. And magnify Him with all magnificence End of Tafsir Surah Subhan (Surat Al-Isra). And to Allah be the praise and blessings. hi At-Tabari 17:590.

Module 20

Surah 18: Al-Kahf

Surah 18: Al-Kahf

PDF pages 3274–3389

The Tafsir of SuratAl-Kahf

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3274–3289]

(Chapter - 18) Which was revealed in Makkah. What has been mentioned about the Virtues of this Surah and the first and last ten Ayat, which provide protection from the Dajjal Imam

He said, it is Hasan Sahih. In his Mustadrak,

The Revelation of the Qur'an brings both Good News and a Warning. In the beginning of this Tafsir, we mentioned that Allah, praises His Holy Self at the beginning and end of matters, for He is the One to be praised in all circumstances, all praise and thanks be to Him, in the beginning and in the end. He praises Himself for revealing His Mighty Book to His Noble Messenger Muhammad ﷺ, which is the greatest blessing that Allah has granted the people of this earth. Through the Qur'an, He brings them out of the darkness into light. He has made it a Book that is straight, neither distorted nor confusion therein. It clearly guides to a straight path, plain and manifest, giving a warning to the disbelievers and good news to the believers. This is why Allah says: *And We have placed therein no crookedness.* meaning, there is nothing twisted or confusing about it. But He has made it balanced and straightforward as He said: *And We have made it straight*, meaning straightforward. *And We give warning of a severe punishment from Him*, meaning, to those who oppose His Prophet ﷺ and disbelieve in His Book, He issues a warning of severe punishment hastened in this world and postponed to the world Hereafter. *And We give good news to the believers*, meaning, those who believe in this Qur'an and confirm their faith by righteous actions. *And We give them a fair reward*, meaning, a beautiful reward from Allah.

And they shall abide therein means, in what Allah rewards them with, and that is Paradise, where they will live forever. *And they shall abide therein forever*, meaning, for always, never ending or ceasing to be. *And We warn those who say, "Allah has begotten a child."* Ibn Ishaq said: These are the pagan Arabs, who said, We worship the angels who are the daughters of Allah. *And they have no knowledge of such a thing*, meaning, this thing that they have fabricated and made up. *And their fathers are their predecessors*, meaning, their predecessors. *And the word is that they have made up*. This highlights the seriousness and enormity of the lie they have made up. Allah says: *And the word is that they have made up*, meaning, it has no basis apart from what they say, and they have no evidence for it apart from their own lies and fabrications. Hence Allah says: *And they utter nothing but a lie*. Reason why this Surah was revealed Muhammad bin Ishaq mentioned the reason why this Surah was revealed. He said that an old man from among the people of Egypt who came to them some forty-odd years ago told him, in At-Tabari 17:595.

Al-Kahf (1-5) (Part-15) from Ikrimah that Ibn Abbas said: The Quraysh sent An-Nadr bin Al-Harith and Tjubah bin Abi Malt to the Jewish rabbis in Al-Madinah, and told them: Ask them (the rabbis) about Muhammad, and describe him to them, and tell them what he is saying. They are the people of the first Book, and they have more knowledge of the Prophets than we do. So they set out and when they reached Al- Madinah, they asked the Jewish rabbis about the Messenger of Allah sg. They described him to them and told them some of what he had said. They said, You are the people of the Tawrah and we have come to you so that you can tell us about this companion of ours. They (the rabbis) said, Ask him about three things which we will tell you to ask, and if he answers them then he is a Prophet who has been sent (by Allah); if he does not, then he is saying things that are not true, in which case how you will deal with him will be up to you. Ask him about some young men in ancient times, what was their story? For theirs is a strange and wondrous tale. Ask him about a man who travelled a great deal and reached the east and the west of the earth. What was his story? And ask him about the Ruh (soul or spirit) - what is it? If he tells you about these things, then he is a Prophet, so follow him, but if he does not tell you, then he is a man who is making things up, so deal with him as you see fit. So An-Nadr and Tjubah left and came back to the Quraysh, and said: O people of Quraysh, we have come to you with a decisive solution which will put an end to the problem between you and Muhammad. The Jewish rabbis told us to ask him about some matters, and they told the Quraysh what they were. Then they came to the Messenger of Allah sg and said, 'O Muhammad, tell us, and they asked him about the things they had been told to ask. The Messenger of Allah jg said, jUlti lit IOp "/ will tell you tomorrow about what you have asked me. but he did not say Tf Allah wills. So they went away, and the Messenger of Allah jg stayed for fifteen days without any revelation from Allah concerning that, and Jibril, peace be upon him, did not come to him either. The people of Makkah started to doubt him, and said, Muhammad promised to tell

us the next day, and now fifteen days have gone by and he has not told us anything in response to the questions we asked. The Messenger of Allah jg felt sad because of the delay in revelation, and was grieved by what the people of Makkah were saying about him. Then Jibril came to him from Allah with the Surah about the companions of Al- Kahf, which also contained a rebuke for feeling sad about the idolators. The Surah also told him about the things they had asked him about, the young men and the traveler. The question about the Ruh was answered in the Ayah; /% A* * i* A* * '/A if 4And they ask you concerning the Ruh (the spirit); say: "The Ruh... M17:85].m ^ nt iagiai Vi //. / >* / 1> x*" / A ' * IJU"1iyjLJ^as-l I" ^ ^ ^ *. > . Lxtujj^ *As--5(*r" 1Ojbij [jllis |y"l_3 JLjjjis /> , / i;/^ / ^ j- UL* J* C bin. L5l IjJfJ W. o] jJ JLi gti "\$!&- eij 3\$ d^ . Perhaps, you would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps, because they believe not in this narration .} 47. Verily, we have made that which is on earth an adornment At-Tabari 17:592.

Al-Kahf(6-8) (Part-15) /or it, in order that We way test which of them are best in deeds. i8. And verily, We shall make all that is on it bare, dry soil.} Do not feel sorry because the Idolators do not believe Allah consoles His Messenger for his sorrow over the idolators because they would not believe and keep away from him. He also said: 4So destroy not yourself in sorroi for them .} [35:8] iAnd grieve not over them .4 [16:127] vi JLi-t ^} ilt may be that you are going to kill yourself with grief, that they do not become believers.} [26:3] meaning, maybe you will destroy yourself with your grief over them. Allah says: iPerhaps, you would kill yourself in grief, over their footsteps, because they believe not in

this narration.} meaning the Qur an. &} in grief} Allah is saying, do not destroy yourself with regret. Qatadah said: killing yourself with anger and grief over them. 11 Mujahid said: with anxiety. These are synonymous, so the meaning is: Do not feel sorry for them, just convey the Message of Allah to them. Whoever goes the right way, then he goes the right way only for the benefit of himself. And whoever goes astray, then he strays at his own loss, so do not destroy yourself in sorrow for them. m At-Tabari 17: 597-598. ,21 At-Tabari 17:598.

jOjJx- 49 . Do you think that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} 410. When the young men fled for refuge to Al-Kahf. They said: Our Lord! Bestow on us mercy from Yourself, and facilitate for us our affair in the right way!"} 411. Therefore, We covered up their hearing in Al-Kahf for a number of years.} 412. Then We raised them up, that We might test which of the two parties was best at calculating the time period they tarried.} The Story of the People of Al-Kahf Here Allah tells us about the story of the people of Al-Kahf in brief and general terms, then He explains it in more detail. He says: 4Do you think} -O Muhammad - oty 4that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} meaning, their case was not something amazing compared to Our power and ability, for the creation of the heavens and earth, the alternation of night and day and the subjugation of the sun, moon and heavenly bodies, and other mighty signs indicate the great power of Allah and show that He is able to do whatever He wills. He is not incapable of doing more amazing things than the story of the people of the Cave. Similarly, Ibn Jurayj reported Mujahid saying about, 4Do you think that the people of Al-Kahf and Ar-Raqim were a wonder among Our signs?} Among Our signs are things that are more amazing than this. 11 ! m At-Tabari 17:601.

Al-Kahf(9-12) (Part-15) they fled taking refuge in the cave of a mountain, where they hid from their people. When they entered the cave, they asked Allah to show mercy and kindness towards them, ///' / / V iOur Lord! Bestcnv on us mercy from Yourself,} meaning, give us Your mercy and conceal us from our people. it u iandfacilitate for us our affair in the right way.} means, direct our matter well, i.e., grant us a good end. As was reported in the Hadith: Iju- oj t- jLis ^ja 0 i~ ^Wimtever You have decreed for us, make its consequences goodn . I 1 ' iTherefore, We covered up their hearing in the cave for a number of years.} meaning, *We caused them to sleep when they entered the cave, and they slept for many years. {Then We raised them up} from that slumber, and one of them went out with his Dirhams (silver coins) to buy them some food, as it will be discussed in more detail below. Allah says: iThen We raised them up, that We might test which of the two parties} meaning, the two parties who disputed about them, \jJ O&^} iwas best at calculating the time period that they tarried. } It was said that this refers to how long they stayed in the cave. Cr (*ri JpJij (i-"v o** i^r Ahmad 6: 147.

Liii jiJ x^jjJ Jt J ^_Vj Jjj Ljj 'jllii '_yLi jl .-fj_^li CJ^* >^gU Ij VjJ 4-4JI* x ^ 'j LLii H 4^' til ' "ii' lij il^ ; 4i' ,J* ^Jol o*-i jJLUt X* S*P t**y *- "v j* jPj P JP 413. We narrate unto you their story with truth: Truly, they were young men who believed in their Lord (Allah), and We increased them in guidance.} il4. And We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said: Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, never shall we call upon any god other than Him; if ive did, we should indeed have uttered an enormity in disbelief.} 415. These our people have taken for worship gods other than Him. Why do they not bring for them a clear authority? And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah.} 416. (77ie young men said to one another:) And when you withdraw from them,

and that which they worship, except Allah, then seek refuge in the cave; your Lord will open a way for you from His mercy and will make easy for you your affair."} Their Belief in Allah and their Retreat from their People From here Allah begins to explain the story in detail. He states that they were boys or young men, and that they were more accepting of the truth and more guided than the elders who had become stubbornly set in their ways and clung to the religion of falsehood. For the same reason, most of those who responded to Allah and His Messenger *sw* were young people. As for the elders of Quraysh, most of them kept to their religion and only a few of them became Muslims. So Allah tells us that the people of the cave were young men. Mujahid said, I was informed that some of them wore some kind of earrings, then Allah guided them and inspired them to fear Him, so they recognized His Oneness, and bore witness that there is no god besides Him.

and We increased them in guidance.} From this and other similar Ayat, several scholars, such as Al-Bukhari and others, understood that faith may increase, that it may vary in degrees, and that it may fluctuate.¹¹¹ Allah says: *And We increased them in guidance.* as He said elsewhere: 4 . o\$} } iWhile as for those who accept guidance, He increases their guidance and bestows on them their Taqwa.} [47:17] % till {JJC <<\$ u\$> for those who believe, it has increased their faith, and they rejoice.} [9:124], i...that they may grow more in faith along with their (present) faith.} [48:4] There are other Ayat indicating the same thing. It has been mentioned that they were followers of the religion of Al-Masih Isa, isa bin Maryam, but Allah knows best. It seems that they lived before the time of Christianity altogether, because if they had been Christians, the Jewish rabbis would not have cared about preserving because of their differences. We have mentioned above the report from Ibn Abbas that the Quraysh sent a message to the Jewish rabbis in Al-Madinah to ask them for things with which they could test the Messenger of Allah *sw*, and they told them to ask him about these young men, and about Dhul-Qarnayn (the man who traveled much) and about the Rah. This indicates that this story was something recorded in the books of the People of the Book, and that it came before Christianity. And Allah knows best. m Fath Al-Bari 6 :426

iAnd We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said: "Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth,)> Here Allah is saying: *We gave them the patience to go against their people and their city, and to leave behind the life of luxury and ease that they had been living. Several of the earlier and later Tafsir scholars have mentioned that they were sons of the kings and leaders of Byzantium, and that they went out one day to one of the festivals of their people. They used to gather once a year outside the city, and they would worship idols and offer sacrifices to them. They had an arrogant, tyrannical king who was called Decianus, who commanded and encouraged the people to do that. When the people went out to attend this gathering, these young men went out with their fathers and their people, and when they saw their people's actions with clear insight, they realized that the prostrations and sacrifices the people were offering to their idols should only be dedicated to Allah, Who created the heavens and the earth. Each of them started to withdraw from his people and keep aloof from them. The first one of them to move away on his own went and sat in the shade of a tree, then another came and sat with him, then another came and sat with them, then four more followed suit one by one. None of them knew the others, but they were brought together by the One Who instilled faith in their hearts. As it says in the Hadith recorded by

Al-Kahf 13-161 (Part-15) Messenger of Allah ﷺ People say that similar qualities or characteristics are what bring people together. So each of the young men was trying to conceal what he really believed from the others, out of fear of them, not knowing that they were like him. Then one of them said, O people, you know by Allah that only one thing is making you leave your people and isolate yourselves from them, so let each one of you say what it is in his case." Another said, As for me, by Allah I saw what my people are doing and I realized that it was false, and that the only One Who deserves to be worshipped Alone with out partner or associate is Allah Who created everything, the heavens, the earth and everything in between. Another said, By Allah, the same thing happened to me. The others said the same, and they all agreed and became brothers in faith. They adopted a particular location as a place of worship and began worshipping Allah there, but their people found out about them and told their king about them. The king ordered them to appear before him, and asked them about their beliefs. They told him the truth and called him to Allah, as Allah says about them: Of jJ O jV'j oy-. ' yj tfy j] ^ iAtid We made their hearts firm and strong when they stood up and said : "Our Lord is the Lord of the heavens and the earth, never shall we call upon any god other than Him..."} Never (Lari) implies an absolute and eternal negation, meaning, this will never happen, and if we were to do that it would be false. So Allah says about them: \ uii i - if we did, we should indeed have uttered an enormih/ in disbelief.} meaning, untruth and utter falsehood. J Vjj lAjjJ ijAjld lily iThese, our people, have taken for worship gods other than Him (Allah). Why do they not bringfor them a clear authority?} Fath A l-Bari 1 :87 .

meaning, why do they not produce some clear evidence and genuine proof for their behavior? 4And who does more wrong than he who invents a lie against Allah. > They said: *but by saying that they are lying transgressors. It was said that when they called their king to believe in Allah, he refused, and warned and threatened them. He commanded them to be stripped of their clothing bearing the adornments of their people, then he gave them some time to think about the situation, hoping that they would return to their former religion. This was a way that Allah showed kindness for them, because during that time they managed to escape from him and flee from persecution for the sake of their religion. This is

what is prescribed in the ShaiTah during times of trial and

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3289–3291]

persecution - a person who fears for his religion should flee from his persecutors, as was reported in the Hadlth: jLaH ,*ilykj JC Lie- (JU Ji Zi4i aSoon there will come a time when the best wealth any of you can have will be sheep, which he can follow to the tops of the mountains and places where rain falls, (fleeing) for the sake of his religion from persecution. In such cases, it is allowed to seclude oneself from people, but this is not prescribed in any other case, because by such seclusion one loses the benefits of congregational and Friday prayers. These young men were determined to flee from their people, and Allah decreed that for them, as He says about them, 4And when you withdraw from them, and that which they worship, except Allah , \$> meaning, when you depart from them and follow a different religion, opposing their worship of others besides Allah, then hi Path Al-Bdri 7:11.

Al-Kahf (13-16) (Part-15) separate from them in a physical sense too. 4then seek refuge in the cave; your Lord will open a way for youfrom His mercy meaning, He will bestow His mercy upon you, by

which He will conceal you from your people. 4and xvill make easy for you your affair.\$ means, He will give you what you need. So they left and fled to the cave where they sought refuge. Then their people noticed they were missing, and the king looked for them, and it was said when he could not find them that Allah concealed them from him so that he could not find any trace of them or any information about them, as Allah concealed His Prophet Muhammad jg and his Companion [Abu Bakr] As-Siddlq, when they sought refuge in the cave of Thawr. The Quraysh idolaters came in pursuit, but they did not find him even though they passed right by him. When the Messenger of Allah \$g noticed that As-Siddlq was anxious and said, O Messenger of Allah, if one of them looks down at the place of his feet, he will see us, he told him: iil j }j U Jz d u" "0 Abu Bakr, what do you think of two who have Allah as their third?" And Allah said: i!0 Cjf i ji H& yfi ^ sti y .***# i! & !# . jd 4If you help him not, for Allah did indeed help him when the disbelievers drove him out, the second of the two; when they were in the cave, he said to his companion: Do not grieve, surely, Allah is with us." Then Allah sent down His tranquillity upon him, and strengthened him with forces which

you saw not, and made the word of those ivho disbelieved the lower, while the Word ofAllah became the higher ; and Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise. [9:40]

The story of this cave (Thawr) is far greater and more

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3291–3298]

wondrous than that of the people of the Cave. o'j preA1 --i -& if" jj'y J5 ji&. cA * ij hi }^S 4 Jiliri . { A- - 427. And you might have seen the sun, when it rose, declining to the right from their cave, and when it set, turning away from them to the left, while they lay in the midst of the cave. That is from the Aydt of Allah. He whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided ; but he whom He sends astray, for him you will find no guardian to lead him.} The Location ofthe Cave This indicates that the entrance to the cave faced north, because Allah tells us that when the sun was rising, sunlight entered the cave 4the right}, meaning that the shade decreased towards the right, as Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said: ideclining} means leaning. 1 11 Every time the sun rises on the horizon, its rays decline until there is nothing left in such a place when it reaches its zenith. So Allah said, 4JV4J' O'i 'i}jand when it set, turning awayfrom them to the left,} meaning, it entered their cave from the left of its entrance, which means from the west. This proves what we say, and it is clear to anyone who thinks about the matter and has some knowledge of astronomy and the paths of the sun, moon and stars. If the m At-Tabari 17:620.

Al-Kahf(17) (Part-15) entrance of the cave faced east, nothing would have entered it when the sun set, and if it faced the direction ofthe Qiblah (in this case, south), nothingwould have entered it at the time ofsunrise or sunset, and the shadows would have leaned neither to the right nor the left. If it had faced west, nothingwould have entered it at the time ofsunrise, until after the sun had passed its zenith, and would have stayed until sunset. This supports what we have said, and to Allah is the praise. Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah said that turning away from them means that it would shine on them and then leave them. 11 ' Allah has told us this, and He wants us to understand it and ponder its meaning, but He did not tell us the location of this cave, i.e., in which country on earth it is, because there is no benefit for us in knowing that, and no legislative objective behind it. If there was any spiritual or religious

interest that could be served by our knowing that, Allah and His Messenger would have taught us about it, as the Prophet *g said: Ai;, Vi &ji Ji f& X Up Is) u" / have not left anything that will bring you closer to Paradise and keep xjou further away from Hell but I have certainly taught you about if."|21 So Allah has told us about the features of the cave, but He did not tell us where it is, and He said, 0* jyy lit piiiit Sjj} iAnd you might have seen the sun, when it rose, declining from their cave.} Malik narrated from Zayd bin Aslam, Leaning. ithe right, and when it set, turning away from them to the left, while they lay in the midst of the cave.} meaning, the sun entered the cave without touching them, because if it had touched them, it would have burnt their At-Tabari 17:621 ,622. Abdur-Razzaq 11:125.

yj^C'p S^ JLft-LS \Oj*pu"pu ~M ^^ *u'X >i ' Ji liJVj 4J Uili^j'^Ll^j^ J-^i >"g ;.l^JL^^'o^jjOwj'oU^^iaiJj3Jp-&J ^-i^bjJxyil J4254&&-.J\$ ^ V / /"rf x ^ z y" ^ // { 0 ^ *UjJL*^ / fSoj)^> oj^Stjo^ iiii^ -ZjiliUIjljjob(H-^-(jp ^=*jj~jjj\ ^ bodies and clothes. This was the view of Ibn Abbas. 111 foil U oj LtU'i iThat isfrom the Ayat of Allah), how He guided them to this cave where He kept them alive, and the sun and wind entered the cave preserving their bodies. Allah says, 4"i' Oi>' Zlli^ iThat is from the Ayat of Allah.) Then He says: if+S ii' -4-' l>*) iHe whom Allah guides, he is the rightly-guided;) meaning that He is the One Who guided these young men to true guidance among their people, for the one whom Allah guides is truly guided, and the one whom Allah leaves astray will find no one to guide him. ^ jLo & 3,i3' 3& j \ o'S -fgfj :& ^j) Wj\Slj |iy-2 oiUJj -2 0^l5 (vj oil*' jJ il8. And you ivould have thought them awake, whereas they were asleep. And \Ne turned than on their right and on their left sides, and their dog stretching forth his two forelegs at the Wasid. Had you happened upon them, you would certainly have turned backfrom than in flight, and would certainly have been filled with awe of them.) m At-Tabari 17:620.

Their Sleep in the Cave Some of the scholars mentioned that when Allah caused them to sleep, their eyelids did not close, lest disintegration took hold of them. If their eyes remained open to the air, this would be better for the sake of preservation. Allah says: '6i\z3\$ iAnd you ivould have thought them aivake, whereas they were asleep. > It was mentioned that when the wolf sleeps, it closes one eye and keeps one eye open, then it switches eyes while asleep. ^JV* o'jj o'S j ^ iAnd VVe turned them on their right and on their left sides,} Ibn Abbas said: If they did not turn over, the earth would have consumed them. 111 iand their dog stretchingforth his two forelegs at the Wastd} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr and Qatadah said: The Wasld means the threshold. 121 Ibn Abbas said: By the door. 131 It was said: On the ground. The correct view is that it means on the threshold, i.e., at the door. iVerily, it shall be closed upon them} [104:81 Their dog lay down at the door, as is the habit of dogs. Ibn Jurayj said, He was guarding the door for them. 141 It was his nature and habit to lie down at their door as if guarding them. He was sitting outside the door, because the angels do not enter a house in which there is a dog, as was reported in As- Sahih, nor do they enter a house in which there is an image, a person in a state of ritual impurity or a disbeliever, as was At-Tabari 17:620. At-Tabari 17:624,625. At-Tabari 17:625.Tabari 17:625.

narrated in the Hasan Hadith)^ The blessing they enjoyed extended to their dog, so the sleep that overtook them overtook him too. This is the benefit of accompanying good people, and so this dog attained fame and stature. It was said that he was the hunting dog of one of the people which is the more appropriate view, or that he was the dog of the king s cook, who shared their religious views, and

brought his dog with him. And Allah knows best. Allah says: -4 (n?6 cJjii' ffr 4Had you happened upon them, you ivould certainly have turned backfrom them in flight, and ivould certainly have been filled with awe ofthem> meaning that Allah made them appear dreadful, so that no one could look at them without being filled with terror, because of the frightening appearance they had been given. This was so that no one would come near them or touch them until the appointed time when their sleep would come to an end as Allah willed, because of the wisdom, clear proof and great mercy involved in that. j'1 L*ji LSLj iyii jsLi J'j- (44: j 2 iixjf ji fey fU) c %\ iju y; o) (f*! .4 jt 1*j 3^ ULd.,1: 4 v 'll ob j j"1 bjfh 419. Likeivise, We ivoke them that they might question one another. A speaker among them said: "How long have you stayed (here)?" They said: "Wehave stayed a day orpart ofa day." They said: "Your Lord knozos best hoto long you have stayed (here). So send one ofyou with this silver coin ofyours to the toivn, and let himfind out which is the Azkafood, and bring some of that to you. And let him be careful and let no man know ofyou. > 420. "For, if they come to know of you, they ivill stone you or turn you back to their religion ; and in that case you will never be successful ."4 m Abu Dawud 2 :192-193 with different wording.

Al-Kahf (19-20) (Part-15 Theirawakeningand sendingOne ofThemselves tobuy Food Allah says: just as We caused them to sleep, We resurrected them with their bodies, hair and skin intact, and nothing lacking in their form and appearance. This was after three hundred and nine years. This is why they asked each other, iHow long have you stayed (liere)?} meaning, *how long have you slept? 4-^ji iThey said: "VJe have stayed a day or part ofa day."} because they entered the cave at the beginning of the day, and they woke up at the end ofthe day, which is why they then said, 4 -{Ji J**! 4". ..or a part of a day." They said: "Your Lord knows best hoiv long you have stayed..."} meaning, Allah knows best about your situation. It seems that they were not sure about how long they had slept, and Allah knows best. Then they turned their attention to more pressing matters, like their need for food and drink, so they said: iSo send one ofyou with this silver coin ofyours ^ They had brought with them some Dirhams (silver coins) from their homes, to buy whatever they might need, and they had given some in charity and kept some, so they said: iSo said one ofyou with this silver coin ofyours to the town,} meaning to their city, which they had left. The definite article indicates that they were referring to a known city. ita,&\$ iand let him find out which is the Azka food.} Azka means purest , as Allah says elsewhere. ^ jfi* iCJ-jj jit jii

4And had it not been for the grace of Allah and His mercy on you, not one of you would ever have been pure [Zakal from sins^ [24:21] and ilndeed whosoever purifies himself fTazakka] shall achieve success.} [87:14] From the same root also comes the word Zakah, which makes one s wealth good and purifies it. 4And let him be careful meaning when he goes out buying food and coming back. They were telling him to conceal himself as much as he could, 4444. ij^+L jt \x4 4and let no man know of you. For, if they come to know of you, they will stone you} means, if they find out where you are, itthey will stone you or turn you back to their religion ;} They were referring to the followers of Decianus, who they were afraid might find out where they were, and punish them with all kinds of torture until they made them go back to their former religion, or until they died, for if they agreed to go back to their (old) religion, they would never attain success in this world or the Hereafter. So they said: <\5d 'H 542 4and in that case you will never be successful.} o&Z ii ^ ^ & ipU iSI4^j} jl+> \4) yul (4^ . 421. And

thus We made their case known, that they might know that the promise of Allah is true, and that there can be no doubt about the Hour. (Remember) when they (the people)

Al-Kahf(21) (Part-15) disputed among themselves about their case, they said: "Construct a building over them; their Lord knows best about them," (then) those who won their point said: We verily, shall build a place of worship over them."

How the People of the City came to know about Them;

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3298–3303]

building a Memorial over the Cave il'i =*)} . 4And thus We made their case known,} means, We caused the people to find them. / "/ < /. s / , ^f f "">* vjj V itLlii ol> *sA juJ 4that they might know that the promise of Allah is true, and that there can be no doubt about the Hour.} Several scholars of the Salaf mentioned that the people of that time were skeptical about the Resurrection. Ikrimah said: There was a group of them who said that the souls would be resurrected but not the bodies, so Allah resurrected the people of the Cave as a sign and proof of resurrection. They mentioned that when they wanted to send one of their members out to the city to buy them something to eat, he disguised himself and set out walking by a different route, until he reached the city, which they said was called Daqsus. He thought that it was not long since he left it, but in fact century after century, generation after generation, nation after nation had passed, and the country and its people had changed. He saw no local landmarks that he recognized, and he did not recognize any of the people, elite or commoners. He began to feel confused and said to himself, Maybe I am crazy or deluded, maybe I am dreaming. Then he said, By Allah, I am nothing of the sort, what I know I saw last night was different from this. Then he said, I had better get out of here. Then he went to one of the men selling food, gave him the money he had and asked him to sell him some food. When the man saw the money he did not recognize it or its imprint, so he passed it to his neighbor and they all began to pass it Tdrikh At-fabari 2:9.

m aaeaffitt V,4^ose who won their ' point said: We verily, ghall tuild a place of worship over them."} ^ W- c. -^~rv> -rr-t Those who said this were the people of >.y:r,@ power and influence, but were they good UypfJS people or not? There is some debate on r/ ' c ^ 's' this point, because the Prophet sg said: i' "">' Cr*' lit^>, J-^-5 fiy^^v3V^ r^Uj has cursed lhe"Allsh has cursed the Op who took the graves of "M> Prop' cte ""? ri*w >--- s&fty V> e0HS Peore flS P aces f ^= c 'jl p '-*_"Az4-ij zuors/n)^' Warning y? what they f-^ " - - " IIWe have reported about the Commander of the faithful TJmar bin Al-Khattab that when he found the grave ofDanyal (Daniel) in Iraq during his period ofrule, he gave orders that news of this grave should be withheld from the people, and that the inscription containing mention of battles etc., that they found there should be buried. 12 ' ^ ^> L '4y^> & Jp ft y f&k nh ft4 i ^jtU V^-5 ij (r& 422 . They say they were three, the dog being the fourth among Al-Bari 1 :634. ' Al-Bidayah Wan-Nihayah 7 :88.

them; and they say they were five, the dog being the sixth, guessing at the unseen; and they say they were seven, and the dog being the eighth. Say: "My Lord knows best their number; none knows them but a few." So debate not except with the clear proof. And consult not any of them (about the people of the Cave).} TheirNumber Allah tells us that people disputed over the number of the people of the Cave.

The Ayah mentions three views, proving that there was no fourth suggestion. Allah indicates that the first two opinions are invalid, by saying, {they guessed at the unseen}, meaning that they spoke without knowledge, like a person who aims at an unknown target - he is hardly likely to hit it, and if he does, it was not on purpose. Then Allah mentions the third opinion, and does not comment on it, or He affirms it by saying, {and the dog being the eighth.} indicating that this is correct and this is what happened. 4 Say: "My Lord knows best their number..." indicating that the best thing to do in matters like this is to refer knowledge to Allah, because there is no need to indulge in discussing such matters without knowledge. If we are given knowledge of a matter, then we may talk about it, otherwise we should refrain. {One knows them but a few.} of mankind. Qatadah said that Ibn Abbas said: I am one of the few mentioned in this Ayah; they were seven. Ibn Jurayj also narrated that Ata Al-Khurasani narrated from him, I am one of those referred to in this Ayah," At-Tabari 17:642.

Al-Kahf (23-24) (Part-15 and he would say: Their number was seven. Ibn Jarir recorded that Ibn Abbas said: {One blows them but a few.} I am one of the few, and they were seven. The chains of these reports narrated from Ibn Abbas, which say that they were seven, are Sahih, and this is in accordance with what we have stated above. 4 So debate not except with the clear proof.} meaning, gently and politely, for there is not a great deal to be gained from knowing about that. } And consult not any of them (about the people of the Cave).} meaning, They do not have any knowledge about it except what they make up, guessing at the unseen; they have no evidence from an infallible source. But Allah has sent you, O Muhammad, with the truth in which there is no doubt or confusion, which is to be given priority over all previous books and sayings. {I will do such and such thing tomorrow.} 423. And never say of anything, I shall do such and such thing tomorrow. } 424. Except (with the saying), "If Allah wills!" And remember your lord when you forget and say: "It may be that my Lord guides me to a nearer way of truth than this." } Saying "If Allah wills" when determining to do something in the future Here Allah, may He be glorified, shows His Messenger {the correct etiquette when determining to do something in the future; this should always be referred to the will of Allah, the m At-Tabari 17:642.

138 Tafslr Ibt Kathir Knower of the Unseen, Who knows what was and what is yet to be and what is not to be, and how it will be if it is to be. It was recorded in the Two Sahihs that Abu Hurayrah said that the Messenger of Allah said: {I will go around to seventy women [according to some reports, it was ninety or one hundred women] so that each one of them will give birth to a son who will fight for the sake of Allah. It was said to him [according to one report, the angel said to him] Say: If Allah wills ", but he did not say it. He went around to the women but none of them gave birth except for one who gave birth to a half-formed child.* The Messenger of Allah {said, "But the One in Whose hand is my soul, had he said, "If Allah wills, he would not have broken his oath, and that would have helped him to attain what he wanted ." According to another report, *They would all have fought as horsemen in the cause of Allah . At the beginning of this Surah we discussed the reason why this Ayah was revealed: when the Prophet {was asked about

the story of the people of the Cave, he said, "I will tell you

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3303–3347]

tomorrow. Then the revelation was delayed for fifteen days.' Since we discussed this at length at the beginning of the Surah, there is no need to repeat it here. ^C4_j ij[JZj iAnd remember your Lord when youforget ^ *** Fath Al-B&ri 6 :41 Muslim 3 :1275. [2i At-Tabari 17 :592

Al-Kahf (23-24) (Part-15) It was said that this means, ifyou forget to say If Allah wills", then say it when you remember. This was the view of Abu Al- Aliyah and Al-Hasan Al-Basri. Hushaym reported from Al- A mash from Mujahid that concerning a man who swears an oath, Ibn Abbas said He may say If Allah wills even if it is a year later. Ibn Abbas used to interpret this Ayah: 4And remember your Lord token you forget} in this way. Al-A mash was asked, Did you hear this from Mujahid?" He said, Layth bin Abi Salim told it to me. 12 * The meaning of Ibn Abbas view, that a person may say If Allah wills , even if it is a year later, is that if he forgets to say it when he makes the oath or when he speaks, and he remembers it later, even a year later, the Sunnah is that he should say it, so that he will still be following the Sunnah of saying If Allah wills , even if that is after breaking his oath. This was also the view of Ibn Jarir,131 but he stated that this does not make up for breaking the oath or mean that one is no longer obliged to offer expiation. What Ibn Jarir said is correct, and it is more appropriate to understand the words of Ibn Abbas in this way. And Allah knows best. 'il iLia o' iiU'i Joli jl *jLiJ Zjiyu ~dj} 4And never say of anything, I shall do such and such thing tomorrow." Except (with the saying), "If Allah wills!" And remember your Lord when you forget} At-Tabarani recorded that Ibn Abbas said that this meant saying, If Allah wills. '41 4and say : "It may be that my Lord guides me to a nearer way of truth than this."} meaning, *if you (O Prophet) are asked about something youTabari 17:645.Tabari 17:645.Tabari 17:646. ' At-Tabarani in Al-Awsat7 :4545

Al-Kahf (25-26) (Part-15) such as Mujahid and others among the earlier and later generations. iAnd they stayed in their cave three hundred years,} Qatadah said, this was the view of the People of the Book, and Allah refuted it by saying: i\ 4*^ ^Say : Allah knows best how long they stayed.. ."} meaning, that Allah knows better than what the people say. 1 This was also the view of Mutarraf bin Abdullah. However, this view is open to debate, because when the People of the Book said that they stayed in the cave for three hundred years, without the extra nine, they were referring to solar years, and if Allah was merely narrating what they had said, He would not have said, ^adding nine.} The apparent meaning of the Ayah is that Allah is stating the facts, not narrating what was said. This is the view of Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him). And Allah knows best. 4^\) j } iHcrw clearly He sees, and hears (everything)!} He sees them and hears them. Ibn Jarir said, The language used is an eloquent expression of praise. 3 The phrase may be understood to mean, how much Allah sees of everything that exists and how much He hears of everything that is to be heard, for nothing is hidden from Him! It was narrated that Qatadah commented on this Ayah: At-Tabari 17:647. At-Tabari 17:648. At-Tabari 17:650.

142 TafsTr Ibn Kathtr iHow clearly He sees, and hears (everything)!} No one hears or sees more than Allah. 111 iThey have no protector other than Him, and He makes none to share in His decision and His rule.} meaning, He, may He be glorified, is the One Who has the power to create and to command, the One Whose ruling cannot be overturned; He has no adviser, supporter or partner, may He be exalted

and hallowed. J* Jol. V J* Jyl t> ff))} yi 2C1 js> y> ,4ij jjUjv |4ej cjif ^ j O* ^ ^ yj GjJt jj^jt lSj ij 4\$R\$ 427 . And recite what has been revealed to you (O Muhammad) of your Lord's Book. None can change His Words, and none will you find as refuge other than Him.} 428. And keep yourself (O Muhammad) patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon, seeking His Face; and let not your eyes overlook them, desiring the pomp and glitter of the life of the world; and obey not him whose heart We have made heedless of Our remembrance, and who follows his own lusts, and whose affair has been lost.} The Command to recite the Qur'an and to patiently keep Company with the Believers Commanding His Messenger jg to recite His Holy Book and convey it to mankind, Allah says, iNone can change His Words,} meaning, no one can alter them, distort them or misinterpret them. m At-Tabari 17:650.

Al-Kahf (27-28) (Part-15) Cft -*4 iand none will you find as a refuge other than Him> It was reported that Mujahid said, A shelter, ' and that Qatadah said, A helper or supporter. 12' Ibn Jarir said: Allah is saying, if you O Muhammad, do not recite what is revealed to you of the Book of your Lord, then you will have no refuge from Allah. 13 ' As Allah says: u> iifj oil; U Si iO Messenger! Proclaim (the Message) which has been sent down to you from your Lord. And if you do not, then you have not conveyed His Message. Allah will protect you from mankind.^[5:67] ^ jjj[] Ifj iVerily, He Who has given you the Qur'an, will surely bring you back to the place of return. [28 :85] meaning, He will call you to account for the duty of conveying the Message which He entrusted you with. \$And keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon, seeking His Face meaning, sit with those who remember Allah, who say La Itaha niallah , who praise Him, glorify Him, declare His greatness and call on Him, morning and evening, all the servants of Allah, whether rich or poor, strong or weak. It was said that this was revealed about the nobles of Quraysh when they asked the Prophet si to sit with them on his own, and not to bring his weak Companions with him, such as Bilal, >" At-Tabari 17:651. At-Tabari 17 :651Tabari 17:651.

Ammar, Suhayb, Khabbab and Ibn Mas*ud. They wanted him to sit with them on his own, but Allah forbade him from doing that, and said, Yj) iAnd him not away those who invoke their Lord, morning and afternoon.) Allah commanded him to patiently content himself with sitting with those people (the weak believers), and said: iAnd keep yourself patiently with those who call on their Lord morning and afternoon...) Imam

TW iS&tmn means, those who are distracted by this world from being committed to the religion and from worshipping their Lord. iand whose affair (deeds) has been lost.) means, his actions and deeds are a foolish waste of time. Do not obey him or admire his way or envy what he has. As Allah says elsewhere: Uj!' Jyt) jVfi. u' = " : ' : - >' r. vi"*j yijj) aj 4A"d strain not your eyes in longing for the things We have given for enjoyment to various groups of them, the splendor of the life of this world, that We may test them thereby. But the provision of your Lord is better and more lasting> [20:131] LjIj cnUjiM txxl . "U . ; v-3 o*, OiUi.j j!j UjjJ. jjJL_i!^ off "i' J-j j3L-e.-Ot> 3j <-/. ;TS ^ . .. ^ - r* >> * < Sit *..* V- j[n) *Jfl^i y "/ yy- P **/ ^ " -' //' /"J / ' (j *t ^ . And say: "The truth is from your Lord." Then whosoever wills, let him believe; and whosoever wills, let him disbelieve. Verily, We have prepared for the wrongdoers, a Fire whose walls will be surrounding them. And if they ask for drink, they will be granted water like Al-Muhl, that will scald their faces. Terrible is the drink, and an evil Murtafaq/\$>

Al-Kahf(29) (Part-15 Qat&dah said, Ibn Mas ud melted some gold in a grove, and when it became liquid and foam rose to the top, he said, this is the thing that is most like Al-Muhl. * Ad-Dahhak said: The water of Hell is black, and it itself is black and its people are black. There is nothing contradictory in these comments, for Al-Muhl includes all of these unpleasant characteristics, it is black, evil-smelling, thick and hot, as Allah said, 4[it] will scald their faces .^ meaning because of its heat. When the disbeliever wants to drink it and brings it close to his face, it will scald it so that the skin of his face falls off into it. Said bin Jubayr said, When the people of Hell get hungry, they will ask for relief from it, and they will be given the tree of Zaqqum from which they will eat. The tree will tear off the skin of their faces, and if anyone who knew them were to pass by, he would recognize the skin of their faces in the tree. Then they will feel thirsty, so they will ask for drink, and they will be granted water like Al-Muhl, that is what has been heated to the ultimate temperature. When it is brought near their mouths, the flesh of their faces from which the skin has been torn off will be baked. ' After describing this drink in these horrifying qualities, Allah says: ^Terrible is the drink, meaning, how awful this drink is. Similarly, He says in another Ayah 4 tLf it iand be given to drink boiling water so that it cuts up their bowels .) [47:15] iThey will be given to drinkfrom a boiling spring.) [88:5] _____m At-Tabari 18:13. At-Tabari 18:13. ' At-Tabari 18:14.

Al-Kahf (30-31) (Part-15) 4they will be adorned} means, with jewelry. AJ* - J!\$ If,^ Awith bracelets ofgold,} Allah says elsewhere: fvo; Si 4and pear/s and their garments therein will be ofsilk} (22:23|. This is explained in more detail here, where Allah says: A P Cu > } }and they will wear green garments ofSundus and Istabraq.} Sundus refers to a fine garment, like a shirt and the like, and Istabraq is thick and shiny velvet. je IJj U0-*} AThey will be Muttaki'in therein on Ara'ik. The word Muttaki'in implies lying down, or it was said that it means sitting with one s legs crossed, which is closer to the meaning here. In a Sahih Hadith, the Prophet jg said: jf? Sti ui "As for me, I do not eat sitting with legs crossed (Muttaki'an)". Ara ik is the plural of Arikah, which is a bed under a canopy. And Allah knows best. AHow good is the reward, and what an excellent place of rest (Murtafaq)! } means, how blessed is Paradise as a reward for their good deeds. And what an excellent Murtafaq means, and how good a place to dwell and rest and stay. Previously, Allah had said of Hell, Jj ATerrible is the drink, and an evil place of rest (Murtafaq)!} [18:29]. PI Tuhfat Al-Ahwadhi 5 :557

TheExample oftheRich IdolatorsandthePoorMuslims After mentioning the idolators who were too arrogant to sit with the poor and weak among Muslims, showing off before them with their wealth and noble lineage, Allah then gives a parable for them of two men, one of whom Allah gave two gardens of grapes, surrounded with palm trees and cultivated with crops throughout. All of the trees and plants were abundantly fruitful, providing readily accessible, good quality produce. Allah says: i\ 0# (%) iEach of those two gardens broughtforth its produce,} meaning, produced its fruits, %} iand failed not in the least therein,} meaning, nothing at all was diminishing. 4& "% iand We caused a river to gush forth in the midst ofboth.} means, rivers were flowing through them here and there. 42 /" iAnd he had Thamar,} It was said that what was meant here was wealth, and it was said that what was meant were fruits, which is the more apparent meaning here. This is also supported by the alternative recitation, Thumr, which is the plural of Thamrah (fruit) just as Khushb is the plural of Khashab (wood). Others recite it as Thamar. 4'M iand he said} the owner of the two gardens 4 jj(k .*^J} ito his companion in the

course of discussion} means, while he was disputing with him and boasting to him and showing off, m At-Tabari 18:21.

i&>% ft il am greater than you in wealth and have a mightier entourage.} meaning, I have more servants, attendants and children. Qatadah said, This, by Allah, is the wish of the immoral to have a lot of wealth and a large entourage. 4 irr^ . pJ-i ' > j~*j} AAnd he went into his garden having been unjust to himself.} meaning, in his disbelief, rebellion, arrogance and denial of the Hereafter. itJuA JL*" J DA Z &} AHe said: "I do not think this will ever perish."} Thus he was allowing himself to be deceived because of the plants, fruits and trees that he saw, and the rivers flowing through the different parts of his gardens. He thought that it could never come to an end or cease or be destroyed. This was because of his lack of understanding and the weakness of his faith in Allah, and because he was enamored with this world and its adornments, and because he disbelieved in the Hereafter. So he said: A"And I do not think the Hour will ever come..."} meaning, will ever happen l+L by- olfV if) til OjjJ Aand if indeed I am brought back to my Lord, I surely shall find better than this when I return to Him.} meaning, *if there is a Hereafter and a return to Allah,, then I will have a better share than this with my Lord, for if it were not that I am dear to Him, He would not have given me all this. As Allah says elsewhere: fSst; if ol iff) odj} m At-Tabari 18:22.

iBut if I am brought back to my Lord, surely there will be for me the best with Him [41:50] lliilij jiJrr=> ,Jjt O. i <(\$&& ju; iHave you seen him who disbelieved in Our Ayat and said: "I shall certainly be given wealth and children [if I will be alive again). >[19:77] He took it for granted that Allah would give him this, without any sound evidence for that. The reason why this Ayah was revealed was because of Al- As bin Wa il, as we will explain in the appropriate place, if Allah wills. In Allah we put our trust. jr *> i'i'i' ** i' ** >> -4j"QipL-liu \&-oju-V />/ ^ O .y y ^yy.' jTtji/^\iilili.cSjJlCi/O I - > vjJJ '-^Sfj 'jjJo! -. 15 1 ^ . 1 - U . ' > } . / y' < y ,s' . " < .y " ^La_ "3u^"3 L.Jil C[p\^fjB 0.-wj' ?jd i ~ -il ^ a4j Vil'-wU JL^LijJl ,^,,5U) Jiy_ Jr ^ yl_P .>? lilli. isJij CJ^ i iyjU /4".lS ,J "jS V ii' *Li Ci iiCl*- 3jLi i[VjJJ rVl]ju-l (} J^ 'j jj ii> j-tJJ at fc-j ^ Gj df- t'. '-Ji) VC" iiLr Jii t' 0^_J jl V] \$ CsJU jyi' jl i; ;U! > .CU' ,ji (;C_1"- l^pL^U 437. His companion said to him during his discussion: Do you disbelieve in Him Who created you out of dust, then out of Nutfah , then fashioned you into a man?"} * * A drop of sperm. Usually used to refer to the mixture of the male and female discharge

4^ iand none shall I associate as partner with my Lord.} meaning, He is Allah, the One Who is to be worshipped Alone, with no partner or associate. Then he said: VI* jii Li' oj-j aLi V! ijjs V "i' "Li U ^ i' 4It was better for you to say, when you entered your garden, That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah! If you see me less than you in wealth, and children.} Here he was urging and encouraging him to say that, as if he was saying, When you entered your garden and looked at it and liked it, why would nt you praise Allah for the blessings He gave you and the wealth and children that He has given to you and not to others? Why did you not say That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah! One of the Salaf said, Whoever is delighted with something in his circumstances or his wealth or his children, let him say, That which Allah wills! There is no power but with Allah! This is based on this Ayah. It was reported in the Sahih from Abu Musa that the Messenger of Allah said: ajiL. V| iy Vj jy- V jfS^ -S Jj. i&{ Vb Shall I not tell you about some of the treasure of Paradise? La hawla wa Id quwwata ilia billah (There is no power or might but with Allah) ." ,li 4^~"r Jt 3 4It may be that

my Lord will give me something better than your garden,} in the Hereafter and will send on it} on your garden in this world, which you think will never come to an end or cease to be, Al-Bari 1 1 :217, Muslim 4 :2076.

ui iHusban from the sky,) Ibn Abbas, Ad-Dahhak and Qatadah' said - emd Malik narrated that Az-Zuhri said - a punishment from heaven. The apparent meaning is that it is a mighty rain which would disrupt his garden and uproot its plants and trees. As he said: 4then it will be as a barren slippery earth.) meaning, smooth mud in which one cannot get a foothold. Ibn Abbas said, Like land without vegetation, where nothing grows. ,21 4 3 iOr the water thereofbecomes Ghawran) means, it disappears into the earth, which is the opposite of flowing water that seeks the surface of the earth. So Gha ir is to go lower, as Allah says: iSay: "Tell me! If your water were Ghawran, who then can supply you withflowing water?") [67:30] meaning, water that flows in all directions. And here Allah says: 4i & ujt y4 40r the water thereof (of the gardens) becomes deep-sunken (underground) so that you will never be able to seek it.) Ghawr is from the same root as Gha ir and has a similar meaning, but is more intensive. J Jyy d Jp E d 442. So his fruits were encircled (with ruin). And began Yuqallibu his hands over what he had spent upon it, while it At-Tabari 18:25. At-Tabari 18:26.

Al-Kahf (42-44) (Part-15 was all destroyed on its trellises, and he could only say: Would that I had ascribed no partners to my Lord!" } 43 . And he had no group of men to help him against Alldlt, nor could he defend (or save) himself.) 444. There (on the Day of Resurrection), Al-Waldyah ivill be for Allah (Alone), the True God. He (Allah) is the best for reivard and the bestfor thefinal end.} The Evil Results ofKufr Allah says: 4So his fruits were encircled}, meaning his wealth, or according to the other opinion, his crops. What is meant is that what this disbeliever was afraid ofand what the believer had terrified him actually had happened. A storm struck his garden, a garden which he had erroneously thought would last forever, distracting him from thoughts of Allah, may He be glorified. 4 && p\} 4And he began Yuqallibu his hands over what he had spent upon it,} Qatadah said: He was clasping his hands together in gesture of regret and grief for the wealth he had lost. 4 ^ j*b j &^ . 3yti} 4and he could only say: "Would that I had ascribed no, partners to my Lord!" And he had no group ofmen } [l meaning a clan or children, as he had vainly boasted, 4'Ss k Cj2 ok oe 4to help him against Allah, nor could he defend himself. There, Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God. Here there are differences in recitation. Some of the reciters pause at the word there, 4Mlk;^k Cj} m At-Tabari 18:27.

inor could he defend himself there.}, i.e., at that time, when Allah sends the punishment upon him, there will be no one to save him. Then they start the next phrase with Al-Walayah; 4Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God.} Some of them pause at the phrase 4: Cj} 4nor could he defend himself} and start the next phrase; 4\$ i-f m ijf Safi} iTitere, Al-Walayah will befor Allah, the True God.} There is a further difference in the recitation of the word Al- Walayah. Some read it as Al-Walayah, which gives the meaning that all allegiance will be to Allah, i.e., on that Day everyone, believer or disbeliever, will return to Allah, for allegiance and submission to Him when the punishment comes to pass. This is like the Ayah: i&Z&Z }SZ k\ ijSli j& } 4So when they saw Our punishment, they said: "We believe in Allah Alone and reject (all) that we used to associate with Him as partners."} [40:84] and Allah says concerning the Fir awn; j* Siir-l Ir*. ii CfjJ' VJ j" iJjJf JS TIJ iTill when drowning overtook him, he said: "/ believe that none has the right to be worshipped but He in Whom the Children ofIsrael believe,

and I am one of the Muslims." Now! While you refused to believe before and you were one of the mischief-makers . 10:90-91] Some others read it as Al-Wilayah, meaning that on that Day the rule will belong to Allah, the True God. Some read Haqqu (True) referring to Al-Wilayah, as in the Ayah-, Jp Ly" (jl ==y V't:v 4The sovereignty on that Day will be the true (sovereignty).

Al-Kahf (45-46) (Part-15) belonging to the Most Gracious (Allah), and it will be a hard Day for the disbelievers [25:26). Others it read Haqqi referring to Allah, may He be glorified, as in the Ayah: iThen they are returned to Allah, their True Protector.} (6:62) So Allah says: 4C** C'_P 5*. 4He (Allah) is the best to reward and the best for the final end.} for deeds that were done for the sake of Allah, their reward is good and their consequences are all good. id JaUa-U .iT lij)' 5** ip* Vi lllJ' KmJ Oyjfj Jllii ! J ijXii oJX d -sY\ iV 445. And mention the parable of the worldly life: it is like the water which We send down from the sky, and the vegetation of the earth mingles with it, and becomes fresh and green. But (later) it becomes dry and broken pieces, which the winds scatter. And Allah is able to do everything .} 446. Wealth and children are the adornment of the life of this world. But the good righteous deeds that last, are better with your Lord for reward and better for hope.} The Parable of the Worldly Life Allah says: iAnd mention} O Muhammad, to the people, 4Q!i\ ip-' &} 4the parable of the worldly life}, its transient nature and how will eventually cease and come to an end. ijfiiP* iPS Sii# it

Al-Kahf (45-46) (Part-15) .A ->- Uilll "77iis world is sweet and green. i Between Wealth and Good Deeds juWealth and children are the adornment of the life of this world. } This is like the Ayah f^ ScJfj t^)>^ uJ j iBeautified for men is the love of things they covet; women, children, vaulted hoards of gold... [3:14], Allah says: %h -fitt 'a> iYour wealth and your children are only a trial, ivhereas Allah! With Him is a great reward (Paradise).} [64:15] turning towards Allah and worshipping Him is better for you than keeping busy with them, and accumulating wealth for them and going to extremes in feeling pity and compassion for them. Allah says: UjS Ay x* jf- 0^^' 4But the good righteous deeds that last, are better with your Lord for reward and better for hope.} Ibn Abbas, Said bin Jubayr and others among the Salaf said that the good righteous deeds that last are the five daily prayers.,2) Ata bin Abi Rabah and Said bin Jubayr narrated from Ibn Abbas, The good righteous deeds that last are Subhan Allah (glory be to Allah) , 'Al-Hamdu LiUah (praise be to Allah) , Ld ilaha iUalldh (there is none worthy of worship except Allah) , and Allahu Akbar (Allah is Most Great). " The Commander of the faithful, Uthman bin Affan was 4 :2098Tabari 18:32. At-Tabari 18:33.

questioned, Which are the good righteous deeds that last? He replied, They are: Ld ildha illalldh, Subhdn Allah, Al- Hamdu Lilldh, Allahu Akbar and Ld hawla wa la quwwata ilia billah hti- Aliyil-Azim (there is no strength and no power except with Allah the Exalted, the Almighty). This was recorded by Imam

mmw \good words. ' JjjXypw\$ > 'i' , ' -t rr *#&&&\$(&0'Usjjj4J *-'/ / /// > > // / * > UJl*JULiLjjOjSjiy ~>.-*V^o_ / ^Sfjajyw> \Jo-\ijJj 1/vjL- &> .Vi "*" > '." \ # \$ v'I a*l4Bji ufj^ rv, ? >.' {>" " <&s, pAj^Ad dyjJe jUiSjUJl Abdur-Rahman bin Zayd bin Aslam said, They are all righteous deeds. 121 This was also the view chosen by Ibn Jarir, may Allah have mercy on him. *A"sM /j JCb fj"uT j> - , ' > .:: >' "' .- jjU |^" "j^< li_0 tilij # cr^ J J**? J 1 ji "' > 'tXt' ,r' , ' : i /A <_ "' .So ..tA u~4)Yi *. Uia ju ' ' t / Vj jlliu V t. U V | i/!^" ciUj jlttu j^ . |j|* f;S;65 O^jiy And (remember) the Day We shall cause the mountains to pass away, and you will see the earth as a levelled plain, and We shall gather them so that We will leave

not one of them behind. 448. And they will be set before your Lord, aligned. (He will say :) "Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time. Nay, but you thought that We had appointed no meeting for you (with Us).") 449. And the Book will be produced, and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is therein. They will say: "Woe to us!" [18:35] At-Tabari 18:35.

Al-Kahf (47-49) (Part-15 will be visible to their Lord, and not one of them will be hidden from Him. Mujahid and Qatadah said, and you will see the earth as a levelled plain, No one will be hidden or absent. * Qatadah said, There will be no buildings and no trees. 40 (and we shall gather them, so that We will not leave one of them behind.) means, *We shall gather them all, the first of them and the last of them, and We shall not leave anyone behind, young or old. As Allah says: 4 Say: (yes) verily, those of old, and those of later times. All will surely be gathered together for an appointed meeting of a known Day.} [56:49,50] 4 U2 } y. S&j pim 4 That is a Day whereon mankind will be gathered together, and that is a Day when all will be present} [1 1:103]. i And they will be set before your Lord, aligned.} This may mean that all of creation will stand before Allah one row, as Allah says: 4 @t^& &)' 24 Z% b \$%0 4 The Day that Ar-Rilh (Jibril) and the angels will stand aligned, they will not speak except him whom the Most Gracious (Allah) allows, and he will speak what is right} [78:38]; or it may mean that they will stand in rows, as Allah says: in I 1 * At-Tabari 18:36. * At-Tabari 18:36.

i And your Lord comes with the angels in rams. j" (89:221 < 3) i Now indeed, you have come to Us as We created you the first time.} This is a rebuke to those who denied the Hereafter, a reprimand before all creation. This is why Allah says to them: i Nay, but you thought that We had appointed no meeting for you (with Us).}, meaning, you did not think that this would happen to you or that it would come to pass. i Kfi gjj} i And the Book will be produced,} the Book of deeds, which contains a record of everything, major or minor, significant or insignificant, great or small. i and you will see the criminals, fearful of that which is therein.} of their evil deeds and reprehensible actions. CiJyij} i They will say, "Woe to us!"} expressing words of regret for having wasted their lives. 4 U Vi Jill f Uift 3ft} i What sort of Book is this that leaves neither a small thing nor a large thing, but has recorded it with numbers!} it has left no sin, major or minor, and no action, no matter how small, but it has recorded it with the utmost precision and accuracy. ijL* u ijoiij} i And they will find all that they did, present,} everything, both good and evil, as Allah says, J * y ^ i i > ^ ^ ^ \

i On the Day when every person will be confronted with all the good he has done} [3:30]. Allah says: fj* fry. i On that Day man will be informed of what he sent forward, and what he left behind.} [75:13] And Allah says: j?0 i The Day when all the secrets will be exposed.} [86:9] meaning, everything that is hidden in people's hearts will become known. Imam

and leave the disbelievers there for eternity. He is the Judge Who never wrongs or oppresses. Allah says: jrj yyt JtiL ^ji i Sureh, Allah wrongs not even of the weight of a speck of dust, but if there is any good, He doubles it > [4:40] i And We shall set up Balances of justice on the Day of Resurrection, then none will be dealt with unjustly in anything.} Until His saying; to take account [21:47] And there are many similar Ayat. Imam

Al-Kahf (50) (Part-15) j* J4-3: "They will have nothing with them. Then a voice will call out to them that will be heard by those far away just as easily as it will be heard by those near: I am the Sovereign, I

am the fudge. None of the people of Hell should enter Hell if he is owed something by one of the people of Paradise, until I have settled the matter, and none of the people of Paradise should enter Paradise if he is owed something by one of the people of Hell, until I settle the matter - even if it is only the case of a slap."

170 Tafsir Ibtt Kathlr The Story of Adam and Iblis Allah points out to the Children of Adam the enmity of Iblis towards them and their father before them, and rebukes those who follow him and go against their Creator and Master. It is He who created them from nothing and sustains and nourishes them by His kindness, yet they still took Iblis as their friend and declared their enmity towards Allah. So Allah says: Gfi iAnd (remember) when We said to the angels}, meaning all the angels, as was mentioned in the beginning of Surat Al-Baqarah. W iProstrate yourselves unto Adam} a prostration of respect and honour, as Allah says: Z& % p. a pZ. " 2 && & x 10 A -L*', * -i . /J j*** jrju ot iAnd (remember) when your Lord said to the angels, 1 am going to create a human (Adam) from dried (sounding) clay of altered mud. So, when I have fashioned him completely and breathed into him the soul which I created for him, then fall (you) down prostrating yourselves unto him.} [15:28-29] 4So they prostrated themselves except Iblis . He was one of the Jinn;} meaning, his original nature betrayed him. He had been created from smokeless fire, whereas the angels had been created from light, as is stated in Sahih Muslim where it is reported that A isha, may Allah be pleased with her, said that the Messenger of Allah sjg said: it; fSl jJ>-j ljU ^A jU JA J JA jJS HI See volume one, the Tafsirof Surat Al-Baqarah 2:36.

"The angels were created from light, Iblis was created from smokeless fire, and Adam was created from that ivhich has been described to you ."[1 When matters are crucial, every vessel leaks that which it contains and is betrayed by its true nature. Iblis used to do what the angels did and resembled them in their devotion and worship, so he was included when they were addressed, but he disobeyed and went against what he was told to do. 'So Allah points out here that he was one of the Jinn, i.e., he was created from fire, as He says elsewhere: \$1 am better than he. You created me from fire, and Yowl created him from c/ay.^[38:76] Al-Hasan Al-Basri said, Iblis was not one of the angels, not even for a second. He was the origin of the Jinn just as Adajm, upon him be peace, was the origin of mankind. This was narrated by Ibn Jaiir with a Sahih chain.12 ' s'& ihe disobeyed the command of his Lord .} meaning by stepping beyond the bounds of obedience to Allah. Fisq (disobeying) implies going out or stepping beyond. When the date emerges from its flower, the verb used in Arabic^ is Fasaqat, the same verb is used to describe a mouse coming out of its hole when it comes out to do damage. Then Allah says, rebuking those who follow and obey Iblis: iWill you then take him and his offspring as protectors am helpers rather than Me} meaning, instead of Me. This is why Allah says: ill JL} iWhat an evil is the exchange for the wrongdoers.} This is like the Ayah in Surah Yd Sin where, after mentioning I 1 * Muslim 4 :2294 Tabari 18:506.

if* jji [/;,"*,j .Jtt (UjAAi O^ b-5^ Jyi fjo 41^* V* b-1^ . pb ^*Ab* oyj & "'o> 452. And (remember) the Day He will say: Call those (so- called) partners of Mine whom you claimed." Then they will cry unto thetn, but they will not answer them, and We shall put Mawbiq between them.} 453. And the criminals shall see the Fire and apprehend that they are to fall therein. And they will find no way of escape from it.) Their Partners are notable to respond and the Criminals are brought to the Fire Allah tells us how He

will address the idolaters on the Day of Resurrection before all of creation, rebuking and scolding them, 4 iCall those (so-called) partners of Mine whom you claimed.) meaning, in the world. Call them today to save you from the situation you are in! Allah says: l*j |^=y>"k *bj p lj"- U // Jj! fSjli- IT Zsfji iAnd truly, you have come unto Us alone as We created you the first time. You have left what you were given behind your backs and We do see not with you your intercessors whom you claimed were your partners. Now all relations between you and them have been cut off, and all that you used to claim has vanished from you.) [6:94] iThen they will cry unto them, but they will not answer them.) As Allah says:

4And it will be said (to them) : "Call upon those partners of yours, then they will call upon than, but they will not answer them .} (28:64) And the Ayah : 4\$ ^ A ?" oA Crt 'S-A f-t Aj} 4And who is more astray than one ivlio calls others besides Allah, such as ivill not answer him^ (46:5) Until the end of the two Ayat, they have taken gods besides Allah, that they may grant them honor. Nay, but they will deny their worship of them, and become opponents to them.)> (19:81-82) iand We shall put Matobiq between them.} Ibn Abbas, Qatadah and others said: Destruction. 1 ' 1 The meaning is that Allah is stating that these idolaters will have no way of reaching the gods they claimed in this world. He will separate them in the Hereafter and neither party will have any means of reaching the other. There will be devastation, great horrors and other terrible things in between them. Abdullah bin Amr understood the pronoun in the phrase between them" to refer to the believers and the disbelievers,121 meaning that the people of guidance and the people of misguidance will be separated. This then is like the Ayab 4 fju0} 4And on the Day when the Hour will be established - that Day shall (all men) be separated.} (30:14) iOn that Day men shall be divided.} [30:43], At-Tabari 18:46. AkTabari 18:46.

<\$ }# ! \$> 4(It will be said), "And O you the criminals! Get you apart this Day (from the believers).} [36:59] si ill&?t*fim 4And on the Day when We shall gather them all together, then We shall say to those who joined partners, "Stop in your place! You and your partners." T\en We shall separate between them... until, t^&} 4And what they invented will vanish from them.} [10:28-30] [] * jU_> oy jj} 4And the criminals shall see the Fire and apprehend that they are to fall therein. And they will find no way of escape from it.} meaning when they see Hell with their own eyes, since it is being dragged forth by seventy thousand reins, each pulled by seventy thousand angels. When, oy_fiS\ ^jj} 4the criminals shall see the Fire}, they will realize that they cannot escape being thrown into lit, and that will only intensify their anxiety and distress, because the anticipation and fear of punishment is in itself a real punishment. \$j} 4And they will find no way of escape from it.} means, they will have no way of fleeing, it will be inevitable. uKj JS* ^ r-a J* til* J) llir*> 454. And indeed We have given every kind of example in this Qur'an for mankind. But, man is ever more quarrelsome than anything.}

Examples put forth in the Qur an Allah says, In this Qur an, We have explained to mankind and given clear details of matters so that they will not stray from the truth or be misled from the path of guidance. Despite this explanation, man is very quarrelsome and opposes truth with falsehood, except for those whom Allah guides to the path of salvation. Imam

Al-Kahf (55-56) (Part-15 The Rebellion of the Disbelievers Allah tells us about the rebellion of the disbelievers in ancient times and in more recent times, and how they rejected the obvious truth even when they witnessed clear signs and proofs. Nothing stopped them from following the truth except their demand to witness with their own eyes the punishment which they were being warned about. As some

of them said to their Prophet: {HiJi Lile jii *liSo cause a piece of the heaven to fall on us, if you are of the truthful!} [26:187], Others said: 4 vJjuu iBring Allah's torment upon us ifyou are one of the truthful.} [29:29] The Quraysh said: oil ; 3J ^ h* " > fo 4^} ' * > 40 Allah! If this is indeed the truth from You, then rain doum stones on usfrom the sky or bring upon us a painful torment .} [8:32] ul- C j ;T:S And they say : "O you to whom the Reminder has been sent down! Verily, you are a mad man! Why do you not bring angels to us ifyou are of the truthful?"} [15:6-7], There are other Ayat refering to the same thing. Then Allah says: 4'j0 o'1 iexcept that the ways of the ancients be repeated with them,} meaning, their overwhelming punishment, destroying every last one of them.

4' ior the tortnent be brought to themface toface.} they see it with their own eyes, being directly confronted with it. Then Allah says: iAnd We send not the Messengers except as bearers of good news and wamers.} before the punishment they give good news to those who believe in them and follow them, and warnings to those who reject them and oppose them. Then Allah tells us about the disbelievers who argue: iwith falsehood, in order to refute the truth thereby.} they tiy to weaken the truth that the Messengers brought, but they cannot achieve that. i& Cj } iAnd they take My Aydt and that which they are warned for jest! } they take the proof, evidence and miracles sent with the Messengers to warn them, and make them fear the punishment; ias a jest and mockery} and they make fun of them, which is the worst type of disbelief. lil c-Ji jjff) jJK ')} Mil) =v , (jti Xjj jftii J Vxj.. l&x p. i 35. C r&a&Z 13 tf\$ & Mb " 457. And who does more wrong than he who is reminded of the Aydt (signs) of his Lord, but turns away from them, forgetting what his hands have sent forth. Truly, VVe have set aver their hearts Akinnah, lest they should understand this (the Qur'an),

and in their ears, deafness. And if you call them to guidance, even then they will never be guided.} 458. And your Lord is Most Forgiving, Owner of mercy. Were He to call than to account for what they have earned, then surely, He would have hastened their punishment . But they have their appointed time, beyond which they will find no escape .} 459. And these towns, We destroyed them when they did wrong. And We appointed a fixed timefor their destruction .} The Worst People are Those Who turn away after being reminded Allah says, Who among My creatures does more wrong than one who is reminded of the signs of Allah then turns av/ay from them, i.e., ignores them and does not listen or pay attention to them. ik C^} 4forgetting what his hands have saltforth.} means, bad deeds and evil actions. 4Tndy, We have set over their hearts} means, the hearts of these people, 4Z4J} 4Akimtah} means, coverings. 4lest they should understand this,} means, so that they will not understand this Qur an and its clear Message ifjj 4and in their ears, deafness.} means that they will be deaf in an abstract way, to guidance. iQ i'h jl J&e oH} 4And ifyou call them to guidance, even then they ivill never be guided.}

180 Tafslr Ibn Kathlr JJHii 4And your Lord is Most Forgiving, Owner ofmercy.^ means, your Lord, O Muhammad, is forgiving and has great mercy. ^IVere He to call them to account for what they have earned, then surely, He would have hastened their punishment. } This is like the Ayah: 4&Z oi jc dip u [iit 4And 1 / Allah were to punish men for that which they earned, He would not leave a moving creature on the surface of the earth.} [35:45] j34 ^ frji 4Bnf verily, your Lord is full of forgiveness for mankind in spite of their wrongdoing. And verily, your Lord is (also) severe in punishment} [13:6], And there are many Ayatwhich say the same thing. Then Allah tells us that He is patient, He conceals faults and forgives sins. He may guide some of them from wrongdoing to true guidance, and whoever

continues in his evil ways, then there will come to him a Day when infants will turn grey and every pregnant female will shed her load. He says: Oi J 00 iBut they have their appointed time, beyond which they will find no escape.} meaning, they will find no way out. 4And these towns, We destroyed them when they did wrong.} This refers to earlier nations in times past; We destroyed them because of their stubborn disbelief. "0 }And We appointed a fixed timefor their destruction.}

u2R!|jSS % L*J Vj*.fjrjJsP io -rr f ->-r " .If-f * >- 5- . I'-'.lU, li '^ "/V " 1* A A _ I A f > . Itv_) (j * a J.iJ 4i\$ <, JSi j) iiiiid_^J6irj^ , < * \ ,>> ^ -"f.f "" 'ft --" '-'>< L"uLa-A S *J""* "i_i) <^\ .-;r ' "" ~ We appointed for them a set time limit, not to be increased or decreased. The same applies to you, O icolators, so beware or what happened to them will happen to you too, for you have rejected the noble st Messenger ar.d greatest Prophet, aid you are not dearer to Us than them, so fear My punishment and wrath. 'j jfi jj >-l &p ^ Up jl Ij i. l 1 .- |Ujf Ljllj is j js*. jGIs qfc jis llj fjptj^ bnu- | L_JJ -li! U"L& lilt ot o'Wr .ill 4_^il L_j ojil i^j jli fcjl jli Vila iju.y USjS ji*& U Jili jte iJfjCe 4 ^ GjJ C liJi 6; A.* ASjill "Gallic >; 460. And (remember) when Musa said to his boy-servant: "I will not give up until I reach the junction of the two seas or a Huqub passes."} 462 . But when they reached the junction of the two seas, they forgot their fish, and it took its way through the sea as in a tunnel.} 462. So when they passed further on, Musa said to his boy- servant: Bring us our morning meal; truly, we have suffered

182 TafsTr Ibn Kathir Nasaban in this, ourjourney."} 463. He said: Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? 1 indeed forgot the fish; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it. It took its course into the sea in a strange (way)!"} 464. [Musa] said: That is what we have been seeking." So they went back retracing theirfootsteps.} 465. Then they found one of Our servants, on whom We had bestowed mercyfrom Us, and whom We had taught knowledge from Us.} The Story ofMusa and Al-Khidr

The reason for Musa's conversation with the boy-servant,

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3347–3360]

Yusha bin Nun, was that he had been told about one of the servants of Allah at the junction of the two seas, who had knowledge which Musa had not been granted, so he wanted to travel to meet him. So he said to that boy-servant of his: 41 will not give up} meaning, I will keep on traveling, 4until I reach the junction of the two seas} meaning, the place where the two seas met. 4tj - \$} 4or a Huqub passes.} meaning, even if I have to travel for a very long time. Ibn Jarir (may Allah have mercy on him) said, Some of the scholars of the Arabic language said that Huqub means a year in the dialect of [the tribe of] Qays, * then he narrated that Abdullah bin Amr said, Huqub means eighty years. Mujahid said, Seventy years. Ali bin Abi Talhah reported that Ibn Abbas said that it means a lifetime.¹⁴ * Qatadah and At-Jabari 18:56. At-Jabari 18:56. * At-Tabari 18:56. * At-Tabari 18:57.

Ibn Zayd said likewise.¹¹¹ Cj L j'.u Ljij \lLt} tu/ien they reacted the junction of the two seas, they forgot theirfish,} He had been commanded to carry a salted fish with him, and it had been said to him, when you lose the fish, that will be a sign that you have reached the right place. So they set out and traveled until they reached the junction of the two seas, where there was a spring called Ayn Al-Hayat (the Spring of Life). They went to sleep there, and the fish felt the drops of that water, so it came back

to life. It was in a vessel with Yusha , upon him be peace, and it jumped out of the vessel towards the sea. Yusha woke up and the fish fell into the water and started to swim through the water, leaving a track or channel behind it. Allah said: and it took its way through the sea as in a tunnel .} meaning, like going through a tunnel on land. Ibn Jurayj said, Ibn Abbas said, It left a trace as if it were a rock. "121 iSo when they had passed further on,} means, past the place where they had forgotten the fish. Forgetfulness is attributed to them both even though it was actually Yusha* who forgot. This is like the Ayah: jjiif Vi iOut of them both come out pearl and coral.} [55:22], although they come from the salt water, according to one of the two opinions. When they had passed one stage beyond the place where they had forgotten the fish, 4ui JSi u'.bi &} i[Musd] said to his boy-servant: Bring us our morning meal; m At-Tabari 18:57. [2' At-Tabari 18:57.

truly, we have suffered hi this, our journey meaning, their journey beyond the place where they should have stopped. 40,} 4Nasaban means, exhaustion. ^ j 0; !' j. .ji tj tlyil sioJ Lj/l ij jli^> 4He said: Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? I indeed forgot the fish ; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it..."} Then he said, took its course meaning its path, 4jij,& O jli :< Ce JCs\ 4 ...into the sea in a strange (way)!" [Musa] said: That is what we have been seeking. } meaning, this is what we have been looking for. 4^%} 4So they went back &} fiji Crl AliliC.J Oe i 4their footsteps.} 4Then they found one of Our servants, on whom We had bestowed mercy from Us, and whom We had taught knowledge from Us.} This was Al-Khidr, peace be upon him, as is indicated by the authentic Hadiths narrated from the Messenger of Allah jg. Al- Bukhari recorded that Said bin Jubayr said, 1 said to Ibn Abbas: Nawf Al-Bikali claims that Milsa, the companion of Al- Khidr was not the Musa of the Children of Israel. Ibn Abbas said, The enemy of Allah has told a lie. Ubayy bin Ka*b narrated that he heard the Messenger of Allah jg say,

^1 : y-Q I J;i : Ja2j Je'r'!^ ij? kJ' >* '->! fJl " i^Jl (*-M' jji jU ij jilt ill *J^ti >>- :JU J v.lilS'3 4o U '-^y Jli . Ill d" j"J 0_^Ajl OJL"j Lw>"j tUlii U.i^yj UJ iji..s>\ \ 121 Ijj jy y ~y. "& J ^ Ir'* jAJl ^ .kili O ' jiSUJl ^ OjjiJl t Jai-L-l 12k i^Uajl 4-le- jLki ' .UJl Ayr)l .M.'-lij *. l2 '- jrf oil lil ,_^> U x.:l.!j Lkfj^j J1L Uikili iOj a^"J jl iU-Li ^_2 ^L_i lj!* L2jl JLS3 U"Ui lli)* : olil] Jli jJl "Mi7sfl gof up to deliver a speech before the Children of Israel and he was asked, Wlw is the most learned person among the people?" Musa replied, "I am." Allah rebuked him because he did not refer the knowledge to Allah . So Allah revealed to him "At the junction of the two seas there is a servant of Ours who is more learned than you." Musa asked, "O my Lord, how can I meet him?" Allah said, "Take a fish and put it in a vessel and then set out, and where you lose the fish, you will find him." So Musa took a fish, put it in a vessel and set out, along with his boy-servant Yiisha bin Nun, peace be upon him, till they reached a rock (on which) they both lay down their heads and slept. The fish moved vigorously in the vessel and got out of it and fell into the sea and there it took its way through the sea (straight) as in a tunnel. Allah stopped the flow of water on both sides of the way created by the fish, and so that way was like a tunnel. When Musa got up, his companion forgot to tell him about the fish, and so they carried on their journey during the rest of the day and the whole night. The next morning Musa said to his boy-servant, i"Bring us our morning meal; truly, we have suffered much fatigue in this, our journey lolii A JU iAj e^al (_gjil jIJsJJI jJl>- ^>- jjj -ktfij li J I*j iitjLi ou Cjj\ :Jlii iLy a&j J kj : Jli 4C# 4

jljg ig j Uc^i : Jli I^jW* (j [if li S^, ^ a < , / ^ ^ ^ S > a- j > ^ i / ^ ^ , j JUa ^j^yr^ p-Lli iS^iwill JI :
 Jli : Jli ^ j-y : Jlii lit :JUi .f**Ul Ju-jl u ^ J ai# ilij cJU U- i it iul a Iip jJU^ jJU jJU cJj Jj ilia N oilp jill |
 *Jj? (*If *' ~ 7;iw Miisfl did not get tired till he had passed the place that Allah had ordered him to
 lookfor. His boy-servant then said to him, 4 Do you remember when we betook ourselves to the rock? I
 indeed forgot the fish; none but Shaytan made me forget to remember it. It took its course into the sea
 in a strange way."4 There was a tunnel for the fish and Miisa and his boy-servant were amazed. Musa
 said, 4"That is what we have been seeking." So they went back retracing theirfootsteps So they went
 back retracing their steps until they reached the rock. There they found a man covered with a garment.
 Musa greeted him. Al-Khidr said, "Is there such a greeting in your land?" Musa said, "I am Miisa." He
 said, "Are you the Musa of the Children of Israel?" Miisa said, "Yes," and added, "J have come to you
 so that you may teach me something of that bwknowledge which you have been taught." Al-Khidr said,
 4"You will not be able to have patience with me ." O Musa! I have some of Allah's knoivledge which
 He has bestoived upon me but you do not know it; and you too, have some of Allah's knowledge which
 He has bestowed upon you, but I do not knoiv it." :^r L\ J Jli 4ir* J (rCC ii* i_j J^ / * i S * * * ^ l ^ l * I
 ^ ^ ^ * yf V { _}jj l Iji k j l ^* _!L5n3 k O t ^I^Jl fjA U-U ^JLs Ji Jlj SfJ l?waj aLaJI ^a lls j ilia

tL V JG ^ j jit 3 j"> \y\ viir jij Musa said, 4' If Allah ivills, you will find me patient, and I will not
 disobey you in aught."} Al-Khidr said to hint, 4 Then, if you folloio me, ask me not about anything till I
 myselfmention it to you."} So they set out walking along the slwre, until a boat passed by and they
 asked the creiv to let them go on board. The crew recognized Al-Khidr and allowed them to go on
 board free of charge. When they went on board, suddenly Musa saw that Al- Khidr had pulled out one
 of the planks of the ship with an adz. Musa said to him, "These people gave us a free ride, yet you have
 broken their boat so that its people will droivn! Verily, you have done a terrible thing! 4"Al-Khidr said,
 "Did I not tell you, that you ivould not be able to have patience with me?"} 4Musd said, "Call me not to
 account for what I forgot and be not hard upon mefor my affair (with you)."} The Messenger of Allah
 sg said, 'j'y- 3* gji jydaI Vvj : Jli tCCJ ^-y 'j* I oltSo 3s: u? t : _rA"Jl Jlii fi'y f y> y-JJl ,J> ^ry- y jydo\ l-
 U ^aji, li Olj xijl -Lili ijuill iiJl 'j^aj\ jl J^LUl (fj> lip Xfj llii ' y JUi lilili oJu, iiSiSli 4j~ . i/i-*y J jil jii
 jsi jji jii In the first instance, Musa asked Al-Khidr because he had forgotten his promise. Then a bird
 came and sat on the edge of the boat, dipping its beak once or twice in the sea. Al-Khidr said to Musa,
 "My knowledge and your knowledge, in comparison to Allah's ktioivledge, is like what this bird has
 taken out of the sea." Then they both disembarkedfrom the boat, and while they were walking on the
 shore, Al-Khidr saw a boy playing ivith other boys. Al-Khidr took hold of the boy's head and pulled it
 off with his hands, killing him. Musa said to him,

188 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4"Have you killed an innocent person who had killed none! Verily, you have
 committed a thing Nukr!" He said, "Did I not tell you that you would not be able to have patience with
 me?"} ly ja J UkAju .(Jl5 IjU-jA Ua^aZ^i* O' ij U alC .J jo^ ^ii Utl 2sP" IaUwI ^ji 4+^^*i} iJ-; JUi i ^ -
 kjj IjlU JU *ffc. O-iiJ v-JL* UjiLa; jZJj Ujidaj (Ui 4-2* JJ & Jiij^ [The narrator] said, The second
 blame was stronger than the first one . 4Musa said, "If 1 ask you anything after this, keep me not in
 your company; you have received an excuse from me." Then they both proceeded until they came to the
 people of a town. They asked than for food but they refused to entertain them. (Then) theyfound there a
 wall on the point offalling down.} (Al-Khidr) set it up straight with his own hands. Musa said, "We
 came to these people, but they neither fed us nor received us as guests. 4Ifyou had wished, surely, you

could have taken wages for it!" (Al-Khidr) said: "This is the parting between you and I. I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were unable to be patient."} The Messenger of Allah jg said: -y CU Jil JaZ Ji i ji Ujjj1 oWe wish that Musa was patient so that Allah would have told us more about both of them. Said bin Jubayr said: Ibn Abbas used to recite [Ayah no. 79] (Cui* o")LZ> jLiu- JS i>-t jLJZ jLS j) (There was a king before them who seized every good- conditioned ship by force) and [Ayah no 80] (^S}i Wf\ b\sj \j\s ji& fviii liij)

(As for the hoy, he was a disbeliever and his parents were believers.)¹¹¹ Then (in another narration)

have knowledge from Allah that He has not taught you, and you have knowledge from Allah that He has not taught me. Each of us has responsibilities before Allah that the other does not share, and you will not be able to stay with me, 4And how can you have patience about a thing which you know not?} For I know that you will denounce me justifiably, but I have knowledge of Allah's wisdom and the hidden interests which I can see but you cannot. 4He said} meaning, Musa said: 4I/ Allah wills, you will find me patient,} with whatever I see of your affairs, 4and I will not disobey you in aught.} means, I will not go against you in anything. At that point, Al-Khidr, upon him be peace, set a condition: 4is? o* oil 4Then, if you follow me, ask me not about anything} do not initiate any discussion of the matter, 4tiU I myself mention of it to you.} meaning, until I initiate the discussion, before you ask me about it. (ig&z i* J cilj\$ jit ju 4:f:& 471- So they both proceeded, till, when they boarded the boat, he (Khidr) damaged it. Musa said: "Have you damaged it wherein its people will drown? Verily, you have committed a thing Imr."}

\$72. He said: Did I not tell you, that you would not be able to have patience with me?"} i73. He said: "Call me not to account for what I forgot, and be not hard upon me for my affair (with you)."} Damaging the Boat Allah tells us that Musa and his companion Al-Khidr set out having come to an agreement and reached an understanding. Al-Khidr had made the condition that Musa should not ask him about anything he found distasteful until he himself initiated the discussion and offered an explanation. So they went on board the ship, as described in the Hadith quoted above - the crew recognized Al-Khidr and let them ride on board free of charge, as an honor to Al-Khidr. When the boat took them out to sea and they were far from the shore, Al-Khidr got up and damaged the boat, pulling out one of its planks and then patching it up again. Musa, peace be upon him, could not restrain himself from denouncing him, so he said: iHave you damaged it wherein its people will drown? } The grammatical structure of the sentence in Arabic implies that this was the consequence, not the purpose, of his action. iVerily, you have committed a thing hnr,} About Imr, Mujahid said: An evil thing. Qatadah said, An astounding thing. 121 At this point, reminding him of the previously-agreed condition, Al-Khidr said: d City jii iDid I not tell you, that you would not be able to have patience with me?} meaning, This thing that I did deliberately is one of the things I told you not to denounce me for, because you do not know At-Tabari 18:72. At-Tabari 18:72.

Al-Kahf (74-76) (Part-16 the full story, and there is a reason and purpose for it that you do not know about. 4He saidK meaning, Musa said: % C ciA# iCall me not to account for what I forgot, and be not hard upon me for my affair (with you).} meaning, do not be harsh with me. Hence it says in the Hadith quoted above from the Messenger of Allah jg tr-J-* j-; "UCJ "/" the first instance, Musa asked Al-Khidr because he had forgotten his promise ." ' T\ Jiilb -A*liS)" Lda Jil j 1JUC-IJLr-jS Lya^afl I JIS 6-d

AlCvtSc jl fy ^ i/ ^ i*' cifyjsl jjJ^li1(3 i-jLj 3 IS bs^csf ^UHp La!LJj^UUaiU 1^ cif jil j-ij iff) tlii ciii jli UUc CiJ Ij^ UiliS^ !Mi LsjJu " C/- Jidfc. o', j6 -o jJ tilij oli Jii ji jli ^ y *,/:" *; - ;: ". -> \ V.^ jo. ,y o*au -4 ^ 'k .^i'. 474. Then they both proceeded till they met a boy, and he (Khidr) killed him. Musa said: "Have you killed an innocent person without Nafs? Verily, you have committed a thing Nukr/ > 475. He said: "Did I not tell you that you can have no |i| Fath Al-Bari8 :262

194 Tafsir Ibn Kathir patience with me?"} i76. He said: "If I ask you anything after this, keep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me."} The Story of killing the Boy 4Then they both proceeded,} means, after the first incident, UJ lij 4 till they met a boy, and he (Khidr) killed him.} It has been stated previously that this boy was playing with other boys in one of the towns, and that Al-Khidr deliberately singled him out. He was the finest and most handsome of them all, and Al-Khidr killed him. When Musa, peace be upon him, saw that he denounced him even more fervently than in the first case, and said hastily: 4 o-lii' iHavc you killed an innocent person?} meaning, a young person who had not yet committed any sin or done anything wrong, yet you killed him ^without Nafs} with no reason for killing him. 4(i & SI* J%} 4 Verily, you have committed a thing Nukr!} meaning, something that is clearly evil. 4 v i*-j -ifo, iii j"> jii jt"} 4He said: "Did I not tell you that you can have no patience with me?"} Once again, Al-Khidr reiterates the condition set in the first place, so Musa says to him: Of- i&b 0[] 4If I ask you anything after this,} meaning, if I object to anything else you do after this,

Juj jj i yj ikeep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me.} you have accepted my apology twice. Ibn Jarir narrated from Ibn Abbas that Ubayy bin Ka*b said: Whenever the Prophqt Sg mentioned anyone, he would pray for himself first. One day he said: : Jli ilSL'j .. * iuV 'f l^(J-j c."l> OA j lijjw aiilL-. the mercy of Allah be upon us and upon Musa. If he had stayed with his companion he would have seen wonders, but he said, i If 1 ask you anything after this, keep me not in your company, you have received an excuse from me.} Oj b"Li l^Ia' 1 *ia! ^ tx y > /_ / / " ' // / sibjJL- jij-uj (j'ji '-Ofc Jli vv J/>-' jui jJk*' U' ijl uilij j jl Jli A*1 o' 4 vv L- ^ O* Jr j L* Jojlit 477. Then they both proceeded till when they came to the people of a town, they asked them for food, but they refused to entertain them. Then they found therein a wall about to collapse and he set it up straight. (Musa) said: "If you had wished, surely you could have taken wages for it!"} i78. He said: "This is the parting between you and 1, I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were not able to be patient."

The Story of repairing the Wall

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3360–3365]

Allah tells us that 4u&u" ithey both proceeded} after the first two instances, iff} L? ~i| &.) At-Tabari 18:77.

4till when they came to the people of a town, ^ Ibn Jarir narrated from Ibn Sirin that this was Al-Aylah. According to the Hadith; lillJ Z ji Ijl uWhen they came there, the people of the town were mean.u^ i.e., miserly ^ tjj. jl Iflui lllliJ.f^ ithey asked them for food, but they refused to entertain them. Then they found therein a wall about to collapse and he (Khidr) set it up straight.) means, he fixed it so it was standing upright properly. We have already seen in the Hadith quoted above that he set it up with his own hands, supporting it until it was standing straight again, which is something extraordinary. At this

point Mtsa said to him: if you had wished, surely you could have taken wages for it!) meaning, because they did not entertain us as guests, you should not have worked for them for free. 3!A '-ii iHe said: This is the parting between you and I) meaning, because you said after the boy was killed that if you asked me anything after that, you would not accompany me any further. So this is the parting of the ways between me and you. 41 will tell you the interpretation) meaning explanation, 4fjf* C) 4of (those) things over which you were not able to be patient.) At-Tabari 18:78. 5:119.

J Ju 4i f Jjj op ijil+ul jL^ \$ 4 ; 479 As for the boat, it te&y&&&0i 3>&2i iz\$3i to poor people ,^V- - k ,^v , r V"1 ' c', working in the sea. So 1 U^l wished to make a defec- CJiU.ji tive dama8e in '*> iliJWj^ 'Cfae-I^JL^S them who seized every boat by force.") Interpretations of ^ged Ship liLJii jjb^lidiSlUkJ;'o&jL-\$-!j& This is an explanation of what Musa found so * hard to understand, and the appearance of ^ ,0> . >*. V.-f-f ' which he condemned. @ Allah showed Al-Khidr the hidden reasons, so he said, 1 damaged the ship to make it faulty, because they used to pass by a king who was one of the oppressors, who iU-\$ seized every boat), i.e., every good, sound boat i&) by force.) So I wanted to prevent him from taking this boat; by making it appear faulty, so that its poor owners who had nothing else could benefit from it. It was also said that they were orphans. u4Sj : =>; && J ti^ia tfjl 4# v^b ig & q;

Tafsir Ibn Kathir 180. "And as for the boy, his parents were believers, and we feared he would oppress them by rebellion and disbelief."} 181 . "So we intended that their Lord should exchange him for them for one better in righteousness and nearer to mercy."} Interpretation of why the Boy was killed Ibn Abbas narrated from Ubayy bin Ka*b that the Prophet m said: The boy Al-Khidr killed i was destined to be a disbeliever from the day he was created." It was recorded by Ibn Jarir from Ibn Abbas.111 He said: i his parents i were believers, and we feared he t would oppress them by rebellion and disbelief} Their love for him might make them follow him in disbelief. Qatadah said, His parents rejoiced when he was born and grieved for him when he was killed. If he had stayed alive, he would have been the cause of their doom. So let a man be content with the decree of Allah, for the decree of Allah for the believer, if he dislikes it, is better for him than if He were to decree something that he likes for him. An authentic Hadith says; Allah does not decree anything for the believer except it is good for /"m." And Allah says: i and it may be that you dislike a thing which is good for you.} (2:216). i4 . oi Muslim 2380, At-Tabari 18:85. At-Tabari 18:86. 3:117.

4So we intended that their Lord should exchange him for them for one better in righteousness and nearer to mercy.} A child who was better than this one, a child for whom they would feel more compassion. This was the view of Ibn Jurayj. ^ tfjjUig0&& && 4 \$4.^ #4 aU'j jc- i C-_) d&j Ji LjO^ IaL, ') U Jjjii 482. And as for the wall, it belonged to two orphan boys in\ the town ; and there was under it a treasure belonging to them ; and their father to a righteous man, and your Lord intended that they should attain their age of full strength and take out their treasure as a mercy from your Lord. And' 1 did them not of my own accord. That is the interpretation of those (things); over which you could not be patient.} Interpretation of why the Wall was repaired for no Charge In this Ayah there is a proof that the word Qaryah (village) may be used to refer to a city (Madinah), because Allah first says, 4if) U &.} 4till when they came to the people of a town (Qaryah)} [18:77], but here He says: , 4 '& 4it belonged to two orphan boys in the town (Al-Madinah) ;} This is like the Ayat. 4& ft *) of)} 4Atid

many a town (Qan/ali), stronger than your toivn ivhic'i has driven you out We have destroyed} [47:13] and; 4 r ' (C-^ ft f 'Ti J>)) \$lij}Tabari 18:86-87.

200 Tafstr Ibn Kathir 4And they say: Why is not this Qur'an sent down to some great man of the tioo towns (Al-Qaryataxy >[43:3 1] meaning Makkah and At-Ta if.

The meaning of Farwah here is a patch of withered vegetation.

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3367–3368]

This was the view of Abdur-Razzaq. It was also said that it means the face of the earth. {(*To& ') C j-yi; 4That is the interpretation of those (things) over which you could not be patient.} meaning, this is the explanation of the things which you could not put up with or be patient with until I took the initiative of explaining them to you. When he explained them and made them clear and solved the confusion, he used a milder form of the verb, {you could When the matter was still confusing and very difficult, a more intensive form was used, {&* t {I will tell you the interpretation of (those) things over which you were unable to be patient with} [18:78]. The intensity of the verbal form used reflects the intensity of the confusion felt. This is like the Ayah {So they (Ya'jiiij and Ma'juj) were not able to scale it} [18:97] which means ascending to its highest point, {a ja Cj} {nor are they able to dig through it} [18:97] which is more difficult than the former. The intensity of the verbal form used reflects the difficulty of the action, which has to do with the subtleties of meaning. And Allah knows best. If one were to ask, what happened to the boy-servant of Musa who appears at the beginning of the story but then is not mentioned? The answer is that the objective of the story is Fath Al-Bari 6 :499 2:318.

Sfinih IS. Al-Kahf (83-84) (Part-lb) 203 what happened between Musa and Al-Khidr. Musa s boy servant was with him, following him. It is clearly mentioned n the Sahih Hadiths referred to above that he was Yusha b n Nun, who was the one who became the leader of the Children of Israel after Musa, peace be upon him. ufjji j 4 SSA. \T J" (jAffSjA <_Si ,ji) 4 V *jry >! 483. And they ask you about Dhul-Qarnayn. Say: "/ shall recite to you something ofhis story."} 484. Verily, We established him in the earth, and We gave him the means of even/tliing .}

The Story of Dhul-Qarnayn

[Tafsir Ibn Kathir (Abridged), Darussalam English Edition, PDF pp. 3368–3389]

Allah says to His Prophet jg, 4And they ask you} O Muhammad jg, (>) if} iabout Dhul-Qarnayn.} i.e., about his story. We have already mentioned how the disbelievers of Makkah sent word to the People of the Book and asked them for some information with which they could test the Prophet *g. They (the People of he Book) said, Ask him about a man who traveled extensively throughout the earth, and about some young men who nobody knows what they did, and about the Ruh (the soul), then Surat Al-Kahfwas revealed. Dhul-Qarnayn had great Power iufji' 4 Jj it- iVerily, We established him in the earth,} means, We have him great power, so that he had all that kings could have might, armies, war equipment and siege machinery. So he dominion over the east and the west, all countries and kings submitted to him, and all the nations, Arab and n Arab, served him. Some of them said he was called Dh Qarnayn (the one with two horns) because he reached the glVi tb en of lad eir on- ul- Uvo

2Q4 Tafsir Ibn Kathir Homs" of the sun, east and west, where it rises and where it sets. 4^*- }^r Ji iand We gave him the means of everything.} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Said bin Jubayr, Ikrimah, As-Suddi, Qatadah, Ad-Dahhak and others said, This means knowledge. 111 Qatadah also said, -&\$ iand We gave him the means of everything.} The different parts and features of the earth. 121 Concerning Bilqis, Allah said, A;J- y, ishe has been given all things [27:23], meaning all things that monarchs like her are given. Thus too was Dhul-Qamayn: Allah gave him the means of all things, meaning the means and power to conquer all areas, regions and countries, to defeat enemies, suppress the kings of the earth and humiliate the people of Shirk. He was given all that a man like him would need. And Allah knows best. l' " " . > **J . {if / ' 5- LJi "*" m. Wv j0> /ijjj Jyj 'jOi & ft jii cJ o 1^ ot jj Jjii-j fj"r fd> !> ' . it* tlj Uj* dj \$85. So he followed a way.} i86. Until, when he reached the setting place of the sun, he found it setting in a spring of Hama'ah. And he found near it a people. We said: "O Dhul-Qamayn! Either you punish them or treat them with kindness." } 87. He said: As for him who does wrong, we shall punish him, and then he will be brought back unto his Lord, Who will punish him with a terrible torment (Hell). } 111 Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah 2 : 106, At-Tabari 18 :94-95. 121 Al-Bidayah wan-Nihayah 2 :106, At-Tabari 18:94-95.

Al-Kahf (85-88) (Part-16) <(88. But as for him who believes and works righteousness, he shall have the best reward, and we shall speak unto him mild words His traveling and reaching the Place where the Sun sets (the West) 4So he followed a way .} Ibn Abbas said that he followed different routes to achieve what he wanted.' 4So he followed a way.} Mujahid said that he followed different routes, east and west.' 2 ' According to one report narrated from Mujahid, said: he 4a way} means, A route through the land. 13 ' Qatadah said, | It means he followed the routes and landmarks of the earth. '4 ' V_>#*-Until, when he reached the setting place of the sun,} means, he followed a route until he reached the furthest point that could be reached in the direction of the sun's setting, which is the west of the earth. As for the idea of his reaching the place in the sky where the sun sets, this is something impossible, and the tales told by storytellers that he traveled so far to the west that the sun set behind him are not true at all. Most of these stories come from the myths of the People of the Book and the fabrications and lies of their heretics. 4he found it setting in a spring of Hama'ali At-Tabari 18:99. At-Tabari 18:95. At-Tabari 18:95. '4| At-Tabari 18:99.

206 Tafsir Ibn Kathir meaning, he saw the sun as if it were setting in the ocean. This is something which everyone who goes to the coast can see: it looks as if the sun is setting into the sea but in fact it never leaves its path in which it is fixed. Hama'ah is, according to one of the two views, derived from the word Hama'ah, which means mud. This is like the Ayah: p- Si A 3& & i I am going to create a man (Adam) from dried clay of altered Hama'h (mud)} [15:28], which means smooth mud, as we have discussed above. li.ec iAnd he found near it a people.} meaning a nation. They mentioned that they were a great nation from among the sons of Adam. 4^*- (*ti o' fy i) 'JO iWe (Allah) said (by inspiration): O Dhul-Qamayn! Either you punish them or treat them with kindness } means, Allah gave him power over them and gave him the choice: if he wanted to, he could kill the men and take the women and children captive, or if he wanted to, he could set them free, with or without a ransom. His justice and faith became apparent in the ruling he pronounced: 4As for him who does wrong, meaning who persists in his Kufr and in associating others in worship with his Lord, iwe shall punish him,} Qatadah said, i.e., by killing him. % ' } iand then he will be brought back unto his Lord, Wlw will

punish him with a terrible torment.} meaning a severe, far-reaching and painful punishment. This m At-Tabari 18:98.

Sfirah 18. Al-Kahf (89-91) (Part-16 ^ mmi r-r - -i' i,."" . > saaiii llu- llL- ^fo* / {/ {^/ ^ ^ #> {-/ ",< "< //"/"> /> J^wj jc_j"Jla3jlU^vyuMJCjUSL"jiU"J^X^JJ " :.*'< 4t. "rl u-iftfftrf^ * "".\$ &?ifr'i&j\$\$\$ & '&> &\$ ^- i/i" l"JUa*-^ja_^^La 4^jaL" j^A^tll'i?a"-^pL^ j"-ly u]0}L/^ ' \kLiLjJ^Vp*^yQj^aijOJ-i^V Jj-> ./ * ^V* * # >. J.^ y.^ *" yy *' ' |y- A implies a confirmation of the Hereafter and the reward an|< punishment. i*c z 0;> 4B"! as /or /iim tojio believes), meaning who follows us in our call to worship Allah Alone with no partnjer or associate, &&& 4he shall Iwve the best reward, meaning in the Hereafter, wijth Allah. AiA w *A ^y--j) iand we (DHul- Qarnayn) shall speak unto him mild words.) Mujahid said, (words of) kindness. 11 oi s-A S*y A fy & ^ 'j) i*"- ,A>.Lk iip&& Cl<& 5J 4 :f/L 4S9. Then /ie folloived (another) way,) 490. Until, when he came to the rising place of the sun, he found it rising on a people for whom We (Allah) had provided no shelter against the sun.) 491 . So (it was)! And We knew all about him (Dhul- Qamayn).) At-Tabari 18:99.

Tafsir Ibtī Kathīr 208 His Journey East Allah tells us that Dhul-Qarnayn then traveled from the west of the earth towards the east. Every time he passed a nation, he subjugated the people and called them to Allah. If they obeyed him, all well and good, otherwise he would humiliate them and take their wealth and possessions. From every nation he took what his armies needed to fight the next nation. When he reached the place where the sun rises, as Allah says, & j} ihefound it rising on a people meaning a nation, Wijj } ifor whom We (Allah) had provided no shelter against the sun.} meaning, they had no buildings or trees to cover them and shade them from the heat of the sun. Qatadah said, It was mentioned to us that they were in a land where nothing grew, so when the sun rose they would go into tunnels until it had passed its zenith, then they would come out to go about their daily lives and earn themselves a living. 111 ii Ct t&J iSo (it was)! And Webmv all about him.} Mujahid and As-Suddi said, This means that Allah knew everything about him and his army, and nothing was hidden from Him, even though they came from so many different nations and lands. For, ? a vj 4 *> iTruly, nothing is hidden from Allah, in the earth or in the heaven,}[3:5]"^ V bji I * . y1 -Wj ju ^ ^ v u_ /} At-Tabari 18:100. At-Tabari 18:101.

G, jlif o' U)"- ill! J-jf jv ^ jj-u-i- gjXi) 0 "-'C O' kjfcjttf' '- jjjJJ jj> loj pr fj j*y > _ "-^ U JIS 'y',0u. 4 , li3 Jli ij'-j jk^a- 'i) Jti cJji 'j) ^y>- 492. Then hefollowed (another) way,} 493. Until, ivhen he reached betxveen two mountains, hefound before them a people who scarcely understood a word 494. They said: "O Dhul-Qamayn! Verily, Ya'juj and Ma'juj are doing great mischief in the land. Shall we then pay you a tribute in order that you might erect a barrier between us and them?"} He said: "That in which my Lord had established me is better. So help me with strength, I will erect betxveen you and them a barrier."} "Give me Zubar of iron;" then, when he had filled up the gap betxveen the two mountain-cliffs, he said: "Bloxxv;" then when he had made them (red as) fire, he said: "Bring me Qitran to pour over them."} His Journey to the Land of Ya juj and Ma juj, and building the Barrier Allah says of Dhul-Qamayn: \ ?} iThen he folloived (another) xoay} meaning, he traveled from the east of the earth until he reached a place between the two mountains which were next to one another with a valley in between, from which Ya juj and Ma juj (God and Magog) will emerge into the land of the Turks and spread mischief there, destroying crops and people. Ya jQj and Ma juj are among he progeny of Adam, peace

be upon him, as was recorded in the Two Sahls; k : JjXj : J U : iul o|& _ i*p : J ?j0l <^Ju Uj jl . dlil . kl^lS k ^Jl -X>- gyth tip Y* jt ^ Jp\

mnv iv ^ Similarly, Dhul-Qarnayn said: What I have is better than what you want to give me, but help me with strength, i.e., with your labor and construction equipment, 4/ u;i// crecf between you and them a barrier. Give me Zubar of iron,} Zubar is the plural of Zubrah, which means pieces or chunks of something. This was the view of Ibn Abbas, Mujahid and Qatadah.¹¹¹ These pieces were like bricks or blocks, and it was said that each block weighed one Damascene QintajJ21 or 4 Of. isjc. *jj ig*-} 4then, when he had filled up the gap between the tioo mountain-cliffs,} means, he put the blocks on top of one another, starting at the bottom, until he reached the tops of the mountains, fili ng the width and height of the gap. The scholars differed about the precise width and height. 4he said: "Blozv;"} means, he lit a fire until the whole thing was burning hot. 4he said: "Bring me Qitrān to pour over them."} Ibn Abbas, Mujahid, Ikrimah, Ad-Dahhak, Qatadah and As- Suddi said it was copper. Some of them added that it was molten.¹³¹ This is similar to the Ayah: & \j} 4And We caused aount ofQitrān toflowfor him} [34:12]. So it resembled a striped cloak.Jabari 18:114. . 121 Qintdr; a unit of weight equivalent to 256.4 kg. (Hans Vfehr Dictionary of Modern Written Arabic) . See the explanation of SQrah Al Imran 3 :14 . j [3! At-Jabari 18:116-117, Ad-DurrAl-Manthur 5 :460

212 Tafstr Ibn Kathir Then Allah said: Jj -Xy ilf liji irt U" Jli Jd J J IpLilt 4/ . ** " . > >- , / ' j/*' \ZiC' a"-*A+ "/ ^ p4 ;,"* Jr-" J fj oj f 4 J-y; "J>_> ,Vk,U". jj j*, jly iB3 /Uf 4&3ti 497. So they could not scale it or dig through it.} 498. He said: "This is a mercy from my Lord, but wltēn the promise of my Lord comes, He shall Dakka' it down to the ground. And the promise ofmy Lord is ever true.} 499. And on that Day, We shall leave some of them to surge like waves on one another; and the Trumpet will be blown, and We shall collect them (the creatures) all together.} The BarrierrestrainsThem,but It willbebreachedwhen the Hour draws nigh Allah tells us that Ya'juj and Ma'juj could not climb over the barrier or penetrate its lower portion. Varying forms of the verb are used here in the Arabic text to reflect the difficulty of the action referred to. 4(|: % i j a) iSo they (Ya'juj and Ma'juj) could not scale it or dig through it.} This indicates that they could not penetrate it or dig through it. Imam

p iSj Yes, if evil increases .n ' This is a Sahlh Hadith, both A- Bukhari and

Allah is Sufficient for us and the best Disposer of affairs, in Allah have we put our trust .

r't m% ,/ > .//// "?y + S ~S S' - ' \m jSS| '\$\$& zj&q ; > '%C?'A'.s. ' >-^ -*;' i-lT , 'ji ty'i&J2-W) ^Uil ^"J, " \l .1 ji^r*.J Vlj^l^l _0 S(J^ 1J . .-!" .JLIJ.11^ #Sw4i'j i "V' S| 4^(0& (V. '~h , d(i> r*Si 4Say : "(Yes) verily, those of old, and those of late j- times. All will surely be gathered together for ap pointed meeting of knownDay.} (56:49-50 > ,2 :{. > ; <" u l*r" Ji1" { * (H-i/'-*-J7 4 'j4' 4'n</ we s/w// gather them all together so as o /eae not one of then behind.} [18:47] UgrQ H S. f*? &V-S 4 \$\$ ar y> ijy"..L^> V l_pl c^jii juje o' ir y? c~^ -^cp C[*Cl>' s)- b-W; '4 . And on that Day We s/irt// presetit Hell to the disbelievers, plain to view.} 4101. (To) those whose eyes had been under a covering from My Reminder, and they could not bear to hear (it).} 4102. Do then those who disbelieved think that they can take My servants as Awliya [protectors] besides Me? Verily, We have prepared Hell as an entertainmentfor the disbelievers.} Hell willbe displayedbefore the Disbelieverson theDay

of Resurrection Allah tells us what He will do to the disbelievers on the Day of Resurrection. He will show Hell to them, meaning He will bring it forth for them to see its punishment and torment before they enter it. This will intensify their distress and grief. In Sahih

Allah says that He has prepared Hell as their abode on the Day of Resurrection. [*r^ O'j]* Vy^ j frf- & pf ji M! (^ |i^jj ^ Julji ;W^liLi j)& M !\$ ^ rg/iS 4103. Sax/: "Shall I've tell you the greatest losers in respect of (their) deeds?"} 4104. "Those whose efforts have been wasted in this life while they thought that they were acquiring good by their deeds."} 4105. "They are those who deny the Ayat of their Lord and the meeting with Him. So their works are in vain, and on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them."} 4106. "That shall be their recompense, Hell; because they disbelieved and took My Ayat and My Messengers for jest."} The Greatest Losers in respect of (Their) Deeds

218 Tafslr lbn Kathir groups in particular; it is more general than that, because the Ayah was revealed in Makkah, before the Qur'an addressed the Jews and Christians, and before the Khawarij existed at all. So the Ayah is general and refers to everyone who worships Allah in a way that is not acceptable, thinking that he is right in doing that and that his deeds will be accepted, but he is mistaken and his deeds will be rejected, as Allah says: iSome faces, that Day will be humiliated. Laboring, weary. They will enter in the hot blazing Fire.} [88:2-4] iAnd We shall turn to whatever deeds they did, and We shall make such deeds as scattered floating particles of dust.} [25:23] 'jj tel ' A.;!*- iAs for those xvho disbelieved, their deeds are like a mirage in a desert. The thirshj one thinks it to be water, until he comes up to it, he finds it to be nothing [24:39] And in this Ayah Allah says: iSay: "Shall We tell you..."} meaning, Shall We inform you; iThe greatest losers in respect of (their) deeds?} Then Allah explains who they are, and says: iThose whose efforts have been wasted in this life} meaning, they did deeds that do not count, deeds that are not in accordance with the prescribed way that is acceptable to Allah. pr* 'ifr iwhile they thought that they were acquiring good by their deeds.}

means, they thought that there was some basis for their deeds and that they were accepted and loved. iThey are those who deny the Ayat of their Lord and the meeting with Him.} they denied the signs of Allah in this world, the proofs that He has established of His Oneness and of the truth of His Messengers, and they denied the Hereafter. iiiji pp iand on the Day of Resurrection, We shall assign no weight for them.'} means, *We will not make their Balance heavy because it is empty of any goodness.

1) 4No desire will they have for removal therefrom. means, they will never choose or want anything else. Th: Ayah tells us how much they love and desire it, even though one might imagine that a person who is to stay in one place forever would get tired and bored of it. But Allah tells us that despite this eternal stay, they will never choose to change move from where they are. jib jj Jj xxi op o'JfCi _}) 41\$ 4109. Say: "If the sea were ink for the Words of my Lord, surely, the sea would be exhausted before the Words of my Lord would be finished, even if We brought like it far its aid.") The Words of the Lord can never be finished Allah says: Say, O Muhammad, if the water of the sea were ink for a pen to write down the words, wisdom and signs of Allah, the sea would run dry before it all could be written down. jib> 4even if We brought like it) means, another sea, then another, and so on, additional seas to be used for writing. The Words (of Allah) would still never run out. As Allah says: o'4 u +% %\ " j)i\ 4a ^) ii' 4And if all the trees on the earth were pens and the sea (were ink), with seven seas behind it to increase

it, yet the Words of Allah would not be exhausted. Verily, Allah is All-Mighty, All-Wise.) [31:271 Ar-Rabl bin Anas said, The parable of the knowledge of all of mankind, in comparison to the knowledge of Allah, is that o drop of water in comparison to all of the oceans. Allah revealed that: 4^j jiw J Ji op jQ if* \$

i5& ty} iis One God}, with no partner or associate. iSo zohoever hopes for the meeting with his Lord,} i.e., hopes for good reward and recompense, ilet him zuork righteousness} meaning, in accordance with tlie prescribed laws of Allah, 4SS5 fj 4/j fj} iand associate none as a partner in the worship ofhis Lord.} This is what is meant by seeking the pleasure of Allah alone with no associate or partner. These are the two basic features of acceptable deeds: their intent is for the sake of Allah alone, and are done in accordance with the way of the Messenger of Allah jg . Imam

Jb {jA . jU* tfZb 4-3 UJJ y Aa\ , 4)1 0 4)1 jl^ i!rf \$j> iil| j. t\Z'Jj\ ^Allah will gather the first and the last on the Day of Resurrection, the Day concerning which there is no doubt. A voice will call out, "Whoever used to associate anyone with Allah in the deeds which he did, let him seek his reivard from someone other than Allah, for Allah is the least in need ofany partner or associate It was also recorded by At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah.12' This is the end of the Tafsir of Surat Al-Kahf. Praise be to Allah, the Lord of all that exists.